profitable to consider
briefly earlier works of Sartre's which serve as a kind of foundation for the fuller discussion in Being and Nothingness; second, I should like to discuss a few of the crucial problems presented in the latter work. In connection with the earlier writing, I shall be concerned only with those aspects which seem to me to be significantly connected with fundamental positions in Being and Nothingness; in the second part I am making no claim to presenting a full analysis or exposition of the book but merely offering some general comments as to a possible interpretation of certain central positions.
'
In an article called "La Transcendance de l'Ego. Esqnisse d'nne description phenomenologique"4 (1936) Sartre, while keeping within the general province of phenomenology, challenged Busserl's concept of the transcendental Ego. The article does more than to suggest some of the principal ideas of Being and Nothingness. It analyzes in detail certain fundamental positions which though basic in the later work are there hurriedly sketched in or even presupposed. Most important is Sartre's rejection of the primacy of the Cartesian cogito. He objects that in Descartes' formula-"I think; therefore I am"-the consciousness which says, "I am," is not actually the consciousness which thinks. (p. 92) Instead we are dealing with a secondary activity. Similarly, says Sartre, Descartes has confused spontaneous doubt, which is a consciousness, with methodical doubt, which is an act. (p. 104) When we catch a glimpse of an object, there may be a doubting consciousness of the object as uncertain. But Descartes' cogito has posited this consciousness itself as an object; the Cartesian cogito is not one with the doubting consciousness but has reflected upon it. In other words this cogito is not Descartes doubting; it is Descartes reflecting upon the doubting. "I doubt; therefore I am" is really "I am aware that I doubt; therefore I am." The Cartesian cogito is reflective, and its .object is not itself but the original consciousness of doubting. The consciousness which doubted is now reflected on by the cogito but was never itself reflective; its only object is the object which it is conscious of as doubtful. These conclusions lead Sartre to establish the pre-reflective cogito as the primary consciousness, and in all of his later work he makes this his original point of departure.
Now it might seem at first thought that this position would involve an
41.1 Recherches philosophiques. Vol. VI, 1936-1937. PP' 85-l:l.3.

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infinite regress. For if the Cartesian cogito reflects not on itself but on the pre-reflcctive consciousness, then in order for there to be self-consciousness, it might seem that we should need a cogito for the Cartesian cogito, another for this cogito and so on ad infinitum. But this would be the case only if self-consciousness required that the sclf be posited as an object, and Sartre denies that this is so. The very nature of consciousness is such, he says, that for it, to be and to know itself are one and the same. (p. 112) Consciousness of an object is consciousness of being consciousness of an object. Thus by nature all consciousness is self·consciousness, but by this Sartre does not mean that the self is necessarily posited as an object. When I am aware of a chair, I am non-reflectively conscious of my awareness. But when I

deliberately think of my awareness, this is a
totally new act of consciousness; and here only am I explicitly positing
my awareness or"myself as an object of reflection. The pre-reflective cogito
is a 'non-positional self-consciousness. Sartre uses the words conscience
non-positionelle (de) soi and puts the de in parentheses to show that
there is no separation, no positing of the self as an object of consciousness.
Similarly he speaks of it as a non-thetic self-consciousness. Thetic or
positional self-consciousness is conscience de soi in which consciousness
deliberately reflects upon its own acts and states and in so far as is possi-
ble posits itself as an object. The Cartesian cogito, of course, belongs
to the second order.
In this same article Sartre lays down two fundamental principles con-
cerning the pre-reflective consciousness which are basic in his later work.
First, he follows Husserl in holding that all consciousness is conscious-
ness of something; that is, consciousness is intentional and directive,
pointing to a transcendent object other than itself. Here is the germ for
Sartre's latcr view of man's being-in-the-world, for his "ontological proof"
of the existence of a Being-in.itself which is external to consciousness.
Secondly, the pre-reflective cogito is non-personal. It is not true that we
can start with some such statement as "I am conscious of the chair."
All that we can truthfully say at this beginni!lg stage is that "there is
(il y a) consciousness of the chair." The Ego (including both the "I"
and the "Me") docs not come into existence until the original conscious-
ness has been made the object of reflection. Thus there is never an Ego-
consciousness but only consciousness of the Ego. This is, of course, an-
other reason for Sartre's objecting to the primacy of the Cartesian cogito,
for Descartes was actually trying to prove the existence of the "I."
According to Sartre, the Ego is not in consciousness, which is utterly
translucent, but in the world; and like the world it is the object of con-
sciousness. This is not, of course, to say that the Ego is material but
only that it is not a subject which in some sense manipulates or directs
consciousne~s. Strictly speaking, we should never say "my consciousness"
but rather uconsciousness of me." This startling view is less extreme than

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it at first appears. It does not mean that consciousness is general, a uni-
versal pan-psyche. A consciousness is even at the start particular, for the
objects of which it is conscious are particular objects and not the whole
universe. Thus the consciousnesses of two persons are always individual
and always self-eonsciousnesses, but to be individual and to be self-
conscious does not mean to be personal. Another way of putting it is to
say that the Ego is "on the side of the psychic." (p. 106) Sartre makes a
sharp distinction between the individual consciousness in its purity and
psychic qualities, by which he means what is ordinarily thought of as
the personality. What he calls the pop~J1ar view holds that the Ego is
responsible for psychic states (e.g., love; hate) and that these in turn
"
determine our consciousness. The reality, he claims, is exactly the reverse.
Consciousness determines the state, and the states constitute the Ego.
For example, my immediate reaction of repulsion or attraction to some-
one is a consciollsness. The unity whi

he case of objects. But con-
sciousness is not in-the-midst-of-the-world; it is in-the-world. This means that consciousness is inevitably involved with the world (both because we have bodies and because by definition consciousness is consciousness of a transcendent object) but that there is a separation between consciousness and the things in the world. For consciousness in its primary form, as we saw earlier, is a non-positional self-consciousness; hence if consciousness is consciousness of an object, it is consciousness of not being the object. There is, in short, a power of withdrawal in consciousness such that it can nihilate (encase with a region of non-being) the objects of which it is conscious. Imagination requires two of these nihilating acts. When we imagine, we posit a world in which an object is not present_ in order that we may imagine a world in which our imagined object is present. I do not imagine a tree so long as I am actually looking at one. To accomplish this imagining act, we must first be able to posit the world as a synthetic totality. This is possible only for a consciousness capable of effecting a nihilating withdrawal from ·the world. Then we posit the imagined object as existing somehow apart from the world, thus denying it as being part of the existing world.
Hence the imaginative act is constituting, isolating, and nihilating. It constitutes the world as a world, for before consciousness there was no "world" but only full, undifferentiated being. It then nihilates the world from a particular point of view and by a second act of nihilation isolates

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the object from the world-as out-of-reach.
Once we accept this view of imagination, the answer to Sartre's two questions is clear. Obviously the conditions of possibility for an imagining consciousness are the same as for consciousness in general. Clearly the imaginary function is constitutive of the essence of consciousness. To conceive of a non-imagining consciousness is impossible. For if consciousness could not imagine, this could only be because it lacked the power of negating withdrawal which Sartre calls nihilation; and this would result in so submerging ~9.Jlsciousness in the world that it could no longer distinguish itself from the world. "If it were possible to conceive for a moment a consciousness which does not imagine, it would have to be conceived as completely engulfed in the existent and without the possibility of grasping anything but the existent." (p. 271).
In this early book Sartre had already linked the ideas of Nothingness and freedom. "In order to imagine, consciousness must be free from all specific reality and this freedom must be able to define itself by a "being-in-the-world which is--at-Once the constitution and the negation of the world." (p. 269) This means that consciousness must be able to effect the emergence of the "unreaL" "The unreal is produced outside of the world by a consciousness which stays in the world, and it is becal1se he is transcendentally free that man can imagine." (p. 271)
In The Emotions8 (1939) Sartre again discusses consciousness' consti· tution and organization of the world and from a different point of view, but the underlying ideas of the total involvement of consciousness in any of its acts and its possibility of choosing freely the way in which it will relate itself to the world remain the same. As we s

hould expect, he
completely rejects the idea that emotions are forces which can sweep over one and determine consciousness and its actions. Emotion is simply a way by which consciousness chooses to live its relationship to the world. On what we might call the everyday pragmatic level of existence, our perception constitutes the world in terms of demands. We form a sort of "hodological" map of it in which pathways are traced to and among objects in accordance with the potentialities and resistances of objects in the world. Thus if I want to go out into the street, I must count on so many steps to be taken. furniture to be avoided, a door to be opened, etc. Or to put it on a non-material level. if I want to persuade someone of a course of action, I must not only plan to use language which means more or less the same to him as to me but must observe certain "rules" of intersubjective relations if lam to appeal to his reason rather than to his

8 Esquisse d'une tMorie des emotions. Paris: Hennann. 1939. Quotations are from the English translation by Bernard Frechbnan: The Emotions: Outline of a Theory. New York: Philosophical Library. 1939. I have discussed this after The Psychology of the Imagination, even though the latter was published a year later, because the order seemed a more natural one in terms of the material which I have chosen for consideration.

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prejudice; I must approach him in terms of his experience .instead ~f referring to what he does not know, etc. In short, the objects which I want to realize appear to me as "having to be realized" in certain ways. "The world of our desires, our needs, and our acts, appears as if it were furrowed with strict and narrow paths which lead to one or the other determined end, that is, to the appearance of a created object." (p. 57) It might be compared to a pin-ball machine in which the ball which one wants to end up at a certain defined spot must arrive there by following one of several possible paths filled with pits and barriers. All of this is an anticipation of the hierarchy of "instrumental complexes'~ which Sartre describes in detail in Being and Nothingness and which is vital to his discussion of the body, our situation-in general what he calls our "facticity" or our "being there in the world."

It is important to note that although this hodological map depends to an extent on external brute matter and is hence to a significant degree the same for all people, still it is in part dependent on a constituting consciousness. This is true first because without any consciousness there could be no such meaningful organization. But it varies in meaning also according to the object aimed at and the attitude of the consciousness regarding the object. Thus the door may be a means of access to the outside or (if locked) a protection against unwanted guests. The appearance of the environment and its organization vary according to whether J walk or drive. Finally, Sartre claims, I may choose to ignore or neglect this instrumental organization altogether, and it is here that emotion enters in. I may in a fit of temper, so to speak, refuse to pull the handle of the pin-ball machine or say that the ball reached its destination even when it went into the wrong hole or (to put an extreme case) break the glass and put the ball where I want it or state that I had never intended really to pull the ha

ndle anyway. This world with its hodological mark-
ings is difficult; and if the situation becomes too difficult, if my plans
meet with utter frustration, I may seek to transform the whole character
of the world which blocks me. Since I can not do so in actuality, I
accomplish a parallel result by a sort of magical transformation. Emotion
"is a transformation of the world. When the paths traced out become
too difficult, or when we see no path, we can no longer live in so urgent
and difficult a world. All the ways are barred. However, we must act. So
we try to change the world, that is, to live as if the connection between
things and their potentialities were not ruled by deterministic processes,
but by magic." (p. 58) We construct new ways and relationships; but
since we can not do this by changing the world, we change ourselves. In
certain cases we' may even faint, thus magically and temporarily anni-
hilating the world by nullifying our connection with it. Even. ioyous
emotions fall into this same pattern since in joy we try to possess all at
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once and as a whole a desirable situation which if it is to be "really"
experienced must be achieved slowly and in terms of instrumental organi-
zations. In summary, emotion is a consciousness' personal relation to
the world and as such can be temporarily satisfying, but it is fundament-
ally ineffective and transient with no direct power to affect the environ-
ment.
In the three works just considered Sartre shows clearly that he is not
following very c1o~e1y the line of thought laid down by Husserl and his
followers although in all three, as well as in the case of Being and Nothing-
ness, Sartre calls his approach phenomenological. In these examples, how-
ever, we find very little of what we have become accustomed to think of
as inseparably connected with existentialism-namely, a concern with
the living person and his concrete emotions of anguish, despair, nausea,
and the like. Actually, until the publication of Being and Nothingness,
Sartre's concern with men's happiness and unhappiness, their ethical
problems, purposes, and conduct was expressed largely in his purely liter-
ary works. Of these the novel, Nausea" (1937), is richest in philosophical
content. In fact one might truthfully say that the only full exposition
of its meaning would be the total volume of Being and Nothingness.
But amidst the wealth of material which might serve as a sort of book of
illustrations for existentialist motifs there are two things of particular
significance. First there is the realization on the part of the hero, Roquen-
tin, that Being in general and he himself in particular are de trop; that is,
existence itself is contingent, gratuitous, unjustifiable. It is absurd in
the sense that there is no reason for it, no outside purpose to give it
meaning, no direction. Being is there, and outside of it-Nothing. In the
passage in which this thought is especially developed we find Roquentin
struggling with the idea that things overflow all the relationships and
designations which he can attach to them, a view which Sartre developed
later in the form of a theory of the "transphenomenality of Being."
Furthermore Roquentin realizes that since he is an existent he can not
escape this original contingency, this "obscene superfluity."
"We were a heap of living creatures, irritated, embarrassed
at ourselves, we hadn't the slight

concerned with the sensations by which our facticity is revealed to us. But the concept underlies his discussion of the body. Furthermore it is in connection with the study of facticity that he presents the most detailed analysis of the problem of freedom, for it is the limitations offered by man's connections with external being which offer the most serious threat to Sartre's view that the For-itself is absolutely free.

In Being and Nothingness, which as L'ittre et Ie. Neant8 appeared in France in 1943, Sartre has incorporated the views which I have mentioned here as well as a number of less important themes found in scattered short stories and essays. The basic positions have not been really changed, but they have been enriched and elaborated and worked into a systematic philosophy. The subject matter of this philosophy is as all inclusive as the title indicates, and throughout a large part of the book the treatment is fully as abstract. Yet we might also say that it is a study of the human condition; for since "man is the beir,g by whom Nothingness comes into the world:' this means that man himself is Being and Nothingness. And before he has finished, Sartre has not only considered such concrete problems as love,hate, sex, the crises of anguish, the trap of bad faith, but he has sketched in outline an approach by which we may hope to ascertain the original choice of Being by which real individuals have made themselves what they are.

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The underlying plan of this comprehensive description is comparatively simple. In the Introduction, which is by far the most difficult part of the book, Sartre explains why we must begin with the pre-reflective consciousness, contrasts his position with that of realism and of idealism, rejects any idea of a noumenal world behind the phenomenon, and explains his own idea of the "transphenomenality of Being." He then proceeds to present his distinction between unconscious Being (Being-in-itself) and conscious Being (Being-for-itself).9 Obviously certain difficulties arise. In particular, since the two types are radically diffcrcnt and separated from another, how can they both be part of one Being?

In search of an answer Sartre in Part One focuses on the question itself-as a question-and reveals the fact that man (or the For-itself) can ask questions and can be in question for himself in his very being because of the presence in him of a Nothingness. Further examination of this Nothingness shows that Non-being is the condition of any transcendence toward Being. But how can man be his own Nothingness and be responsible for the upsurge of Nothingness into the world? We learn that Nothingness is revealed to us most fully in anguish and that man generally tries to flee this anguish, this Nothingness which he is, by means of "bad faith." The study of "bad faith" reveals to us that whereas Being-

8 Paris: Gallimard.

II Sartre evidently got these tenns from Hegel's an-sich and fjjr-sich.

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in-itself simply is, man is the being "who is what he is not and who is not what he is." In other words man continually makes himself. Instead of being, he "has to be"; his present being has meaning only in the light of the future toward which he projects himself. Thus he is not what at any instant we might want to say that he is, and he is that toward which he projects himself but which he is not yet.lO This ambig

uity provides
the possibility for bad faith since man may try to interpret this evanescent "is" of his as though it were the "is" of Being-in-itself, or he may fluctuate between the two.

In Part Two Sartre, using this view of the For-itself as a Nothingness and as an always future project, discusses the For-itself as a pursuit of Being in the form of selfness. This involves the questions of possibility, of value, and of temporality, all of which prove to be integrally related to the basic concept of the For-itself as an internal negation of Being-in-itself. But if the For-itself is a relation to the In-itself, even by way of negation, then we must find some sort of bridge. This bridge is knowl~edge, the discussion of which concludes Part Two.

Since no full presentation of knowledge is possible without considera-tion of the senses, we are referred to the body. Part Three begins with a discussion of the body, and we soon perceive that one of the principal characteristics of a body is that it causes me to be seen by the Other. Hence Part Three is largely devoted to the study of Being-for-others, including descriptions of concrete personal relations. Finally our dis-covery of our rdations with others shows us that the For~itself has an outside, that while never able to coincide with the In-itself, the For-itself is nevertheless in the midst of it. And so at last in Part Four we return to the In-itself.

We are concerned with the In-itself from two fundamental points of view. First, how can we be in the midst of the In-itself without losing our freedom. Here we find the fullest exposition of Sartre's ideas on freedom and facticity. Second, we discover that our fundamental relation to Being is such that we desire to appropriate it through either action, possession, or the attempt to become one with it. Analysis of these reactions leads us to the question of our original choice of Being, and it is here that Sartre outlines for us his existential psychoanalysis. This completes the book save for the Conclusion, in which Sartre suggests various metaphysical and ethical implications which may emerge as the result of his long "pur·suit of Being" and also promises us another work in which he will further develop thc ethical possibilities.

Obviously the most stnkin~ly original idea here presented. as well as the unifying motif of the entire work, is the position that consciousness

10 The generdl psychological consequences of this distinction between Being-for·itself and Being·in.i,tsclf I have discussed in some detail in my introduction to Jean. Paul's Sartrc's Existential Psychoanalysis. New York: Philosophical Library. 1953·

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isa Nothingness. Yet as a Nothingness it is also a revelation of Being. Aside from the paradoxical nature of this position, we are immediately puzzled as to how to relate it to the traditional theories of idealism and realism; and I think that perhaps our best approach to the whole question of the negativity of consciousness is to observe just how Sartre himself believes that he can hold a theory not open to the objections generally directedag~either of the others. His philosopl1Y is not idealism, not even Husserl's brand of idealism, as he points out, because Being in no way creates consciousness or is in any way dependent on consciousness for its existence. Being is already there, without reason or justification. It is not

exhausted by any or by all of its appearances, though it is fully there in each one of its appearances. (That is, it does not serve as a sort of phenomenon with a noumenon behind it.) It always overflows whatever knowledge we have of it-just as it is presupposed by all our questions and by consciousness itself. This "transphenomenality of Being" means that the object of consciousness is always outside and transcendent, that there is forever a resistance, a limit offered to consciousness, an external something which must be taken into consideration. Nevertheless we have not substituted a realistic position for the idealistic. For without consciousness, Being does not exist either as a totality (in the sense of "the world," "the universe") ·or with differentiated parts. It is a fullness of existence, a plenitude which can not possibly isolate one part so as to contrast it with another, or posit a whole over against its parts, or conceive a "nothing" in opposition to which it is "everything.~' It is simply undifferentiated, meaningless massivity. Without consciousness there would not be a world, mountains, rivers, tables, chairs, etc.;there would be only Being. In this sense there is no thing without consciousness, but there is not nothing. Consciousness causes there to be things because it is itself nothing. Only through consciousness is there differentiation, meaning, and plurality for Being.

There is a tendency among some of Sartre's critics to criticize him for this view of consciousness as negativity as though it were somehow a slight to the dignity of the human being and made things more important than people. Such an objection seem~ unreasonable in the light of the tremendous consequences of this Nothingness. The more difficult problem, as it seemS to me, is how to account for these consequences without being false to the premise that consciousness is wholly negative; that is, without making it into a very formidable something. For when Sartre speaks of a Nothingness, he means just that and is not using the word as a misleading name for a new metaphysical substance. Yet the power to effect a Nothingness, to recognize and make use of it appears to be a positivity. If this power belongs to the For-itself, are we falling into a contradiction? And if the For-itself is a Nothingness, then in what

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sense is it Being?

In the Conclusion Sartre provides us with a helpful comparison by reminding us of a scientific fiction sometimes used to illustrate the physical principle of the conservation of energy.

"If, they say, a single one of the atoms which constitute the universe were annihilated, there would result a catastrophe which would extend to the entire universe, and this would be, in particular, the end of the Earth and of the solar system. This metaphor can be of use to us here. The For-itself is like a tiny nihilation which has its origin at the heart of Being; and this nihilation is sufficient to cause a total upheaval to happen to the In-itself. This upheaval is the world." (pp. 617-618)

We can see in this comparison that the For-itself has no reality except in so far as it is the nihilation of Being. It is, however, slightly qualified in that it is the nihilation of an individual, particular In-itself. It is not a general Nothingness but a particular privation, an individual Non-Being. Just as we might say, I suppose, that th

e catastrophe wrought by the
annihilated atom would vary in character according to which atom was
annihilated.
Does this mean then that we have one disintegrated Being or a clear
cut case of duality with the In-itself on the one hand and the For-itself
on the other? Sartre is not altogether clear on this point. He says that in
formulating metaphysical hypotheses to guide us in phenomenological
psychology, anthropology, and so forth, we may, as we like, keep the old
being-consciousness dualism or adopt a new idea of a phenomenon which
will be provided with two dimensions of being (tn-itself and For-itself).
But such hypotheses we may use only as the physicist may employ
ad libitum either the wave theory or the quanta theory; that is, not with
the idea that either is an exhaustive description but that it is merely an
expedient hypothesis within which one may carry out experiments.
In other passages Sartre makes it clear that Being-in-itself is logically
prior to Being-for-itself, that the latter is dependent on Being-in-itself,
both in its origin and in its continued history. In the original nihilation
the For-itself is made-to-be (est ete) by the In-itself. Nothing external
to Being caused the rupture in the self-identity of Being-in-itself. It oc-
curred somehow in Being. Thus the For-itself would be a mere abstrac-
tion withont Being, for it is nothing save the emptiness of this Being
and hence is n0t an autonomous substance. It is unseIbstandig. (p. 619)
"But as a nihilation it is; and it is· in a priori unity with the In-itself."
(p. 621) In an effort to make this point more clear, Sartre points out
that if we tried to imagine what "there was" before a world existed, we
could ~ot properly answer "nothing" without making both the "nothing"
and the "before" retroactive. That is, Nothing has no meaning without

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XXII
BEING AND NOTHINGNESS
Being, for it is that which is Other than Being. It there were somehow
no Being, Nothing would concomitantly disappear. (p. 16) As the
emptiness of a particular Being, every negation (by a reversal of Spinoza's
famous statement) is a determination. Nothingness takes on a kind of
borrowed being. In itself it is not, but it gets its efficacy concretely from
Being. "Nothingness can nihilate itself only on the foundation of being;
if nothingness can be given, it is neither before nor after being, nor in a
general way outside of being. Nothingness lies coiled in the heart of
being-like a worm." (p. :2.1) Thus Being-in-itself is logically prior to
Being-for-itself; for the In-itself has no need of Nothingness since it is
a plenitude, but the For-itself originates only by means of Being and as a
rupture at the heart of Being.
Moreover the For-itself is dependent on the In-itself not only in its
origin but in its continued existence. We have seen that consciousness
is a" revelation of Being and that this is because consciousness can make
a Nothingness slip in between itself and Being or between the various
parts of Being, thus bringing about a differentiation. We 'saw also in
connection with The Psychology of the Imagination that this ability
on the part of consciousness to separate itself from the world by a nihi-
lation enabled it to effect the emergence of the unreal, thus to dis-
tinguish between actual and possible, between image and perception,
etc. In Being and Nothingness Sartre develops consciousness' "revealing
intuition" as being

an "internal negation." An external negation is simply
a distinction between two objects such that it affects neither;-e.g. the
cup is not the table. But in an internal negation, which can exist only in a
consciousness, the being making the negation is affected in its being.
Thus consciousness perpetually negates the In-itself by realizing inwardly
that it is not the In-itself; it nihilates the In-itself both as a whole and in
terms of individual in-itselfs or objects. And it is by. means of knowing
what it is not that consciousness makes known to itself what it is. Thus
again in its daily existencc the For-itself is seen to depcnd on the In-itself.
For since it is nothing but the nihilating consciousness of not being its
objects, then once more its being depends upon that of its objects. For
consciousness, too, negation is dctermination.
It is important to recall that Sartre says of man that he is "the being
by whom nothingness comes into the world." He does not deny to man
any connection with being. Having noticed how the For-itself is dcpend-
ent on the In-itsclf, we can perhaps see more elearly how Sartre can both .
declare that the For-itself is nothing and yet treat it as if it were a sub-
division of Being and devote avolume of more than seven hundred pages
to a discussion of its nature and consequences. By itself the For-itself
is nothing at all and is not even conceivable, just as a reflection or a
shadow which would not be a reflection or shadow of anything could not
be conceived. But in relation to being, by being the nothingness of a

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particular being and thus deriving from the being which it nihilates a sort
of marginal, dependent being, it can give a new significance to all of Being.
Thus the For-itself is without any of that fullness of being which we
call the In-itself, but as a nihilation it is.
Sartre summarizes this position by saying, "For consciousness there is
no being except for this precise obligation to be a revealing intuition of
something." (p. 618) Immediately he recognizes that this definition
is closely parallel to Plato's category of the Otherll as described in the
Sophist. We note that with Plato, too, Otherness has no being except
its being-other, but as Other it is. In PI:lto's description we note also
the Other's characteristic of marginal or borrowed being, the trick of
disappearing if considered by itself, its complete separation from Being
at the same time that it cannot exist independcntly from Being. Sartre
feels that Plato failed to see the logical consequence of his position, which
would be that such an "otherness" could exist only in the form of con-
sciousness. "For the only way in which the other can exist as other is.
to be consciousness '(of) being other. Otherness is, in fact, an internal
negation, and only a consciousness can be constituted as an internal nega-
tion." (618) He also criticizes Plato for having restricted both categories
-"being" and "other"- to a dialectical genesis in which they are simply
genera. Sartre, of course, holds that the For-itself is an individual venture
and he is speaking of concrete being and living consciousness.
Sartre in his discussion of Nothingness presents a fairly detailed
criticism of both Hegel's and Heidegger's concepts. He~l he criticizes
for never having got beyond the logical formulation of Non-being so as
to relate it to human reality. Moreo

ver he objects .to Hegel's making
the notions of Being and Non-being contemporary instead of viewing
Non-being as logically dependent on Being. And he objects that Hegel
has inadvertently bestowed a being upon Non-being. Heidegger, according
to Sartre, has realized considerable progress by removing Being from
Nothingness and by seeing both Being and Non-being as a tension of
opposing forces; he is also to be commended for discussing Nothingness
as a part of human experience and not merely as an abstraction. But
Sartre feels that Heidegger by causing the world to be suspended in
Nothingness takes away all possibility of accounting for any origin for
nihilations. Also the experience of Nothingtless in dread which Heidegger
describes (an experience in which one feels, though one cannot intellectu-
ally know it, the slipping away of all-that-is into the Nothingness in which
it is suspended)-this, Sartre says, can in no way explain the infinite little
pools of Nothingness which make a part of our everyday life. It can not
account for the Non-being which is involved in every question, in every
negative judgment, in prohibitions, in ideas like "destruction" and
11 This, of coarse, is not fo be conflJsed with "'Inc Other" as Sarfre generaIly use!
it to denote other people.

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"distance.'-' Both Hegel and Heidegger, Sartre objects, have talked about
Nothingness without providing a being in which this Nothingness is
founded and which can establish the negations effected by this nihilating
power. In short they both neglect the structure of the human mind or
consciousness.
I think that Sartre has avoided the objections which he feels must be
raised against Plato, Hegel, and Heidegger. In a sense one might say that
his treatment of perception and imagination and knowledge all involve
the old logical relationship between determination and negation, that
the internal negation itself is a logical distinction.1,2 But even if we grant
this point, we must recognize that he is doing if in terms of the struc-
ture of the mind and not of an order effected within the products of
the mind or within the world itself. Moreover he believes that the original
choice of consciousness antedates logic itself, that by a pre-logical choice
we decide whether or not we will confine ourselves within the rules of
logic. In connection with the emotions we have seen that conscious-
ness may, if it chooses, use its nihilating power for a complete-though
ineffective and temporary-annihilation of the world. Sartre has not re-
stricted the use of Nothingness to concepts and relations. He uses it
in his discussion of anguish, which reveals considerable indebtedness
to Heidegger's treatment of dread. He uses it in his discussion of ethics,
where he shows that the particular dilemma of the human being stems
from the fact that there is always a Nothingness between motive and
act, that a motive becomes a motive only when freely constituted by
the free nihilation effected by consciousness. And finally he uses it in
his discussion of freedom. Consciousness is free because it is "not
enough." If it were full being, then it could not be free to choose being.
But since it has an insufficiency of being, since it is not one with the
real world, it is free to set up those relations with being which it desires.
Thus the For-itself is a revelation of Being, an internal nihilation of
Being, a relati

on to Being, a desire of Being, and a choice of Being.1s
All of these it can be, only because it is not Being. There is no question about the fact that Sartre throws the whole weight of being over onto the side of the In-itself, but in terms of significance and activity it is the For-itself which is responsible for everything-even though it could not

12 In his discussion of nihilation, especially in connection with perception and imagination, Sartre makes considerable use of the Gestalt psychology, particularly as related to the mind's treatment of "figure" and "ground."

13 Wilfrid Dcsan has worked out a detailed chart showing the relations existing between the In·i~self and the For-itself in its capacity as "Nothingness of Being, revelation of Being, etc." The Tragic Finale. Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard, 1954. p. 50. Desan's book is the most detailcd analysis of Being and Nothingness to be found in English. Although I disagree with some of his conclusions, I believe that he has attempted to see the total significance of Sartre's philosophy as well as to analyze its various parts.

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be without the In-itself. While the comparison is admittedly a bit far-fetched, I can not help being reminded in this connection of Schopenhauer's Reason, which created by the Will turns back upon the Will to deny it.

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As I pointed out above, Sartre criticizes Heidegger for restricting his experience of Nothingness to special crises and ignoring the host of everyday situations in which it figures. It is interesting, however, to note that Sartre, on the other hand, ignores an entire set of special experiences in which the idea of Nothingness is tremendously important; namely, the whole history of mysticism. It would be unreasonable to expect him to have written a full essay on mysticism; after all there is no room for it in his brand of existentialism. But it is a little surprising that he has not considered the subject at all, both because he is so frequently careful to provide his own explanation for phenomena generally considered religious and because there is in mystic literature much that would have been fruitful for his analysis. I think that if we but glance briefly at that part of the mystic ideal which is pertinent, we find that here, as in connection with his specific treatment of God, Sartre has either consciously or unconsciously taken those elements of experience which for the Believer (are privileged, which are apart from ordinary living and which are raised \ to the level of an ideal goal or at least furnished with divine guarantee, and that Sartre has woven these into the everyday data of the human condition.

We may note that the mystic's use of the concept of Nothingness differs from those already mentioned in (1) applying the concept in the form of negative definition to the ultimate reality, The One; (2) presenting the.loss of personality, which is a species of Nothingness, as an ideal goal; (3) giving an irrational (one might almost say sensational) cast to the whole experience. Without passing judgment on the validity of the mystic approach, we can at any rate observe that here, as with Sartre, the concept of Nothingness, while continuing to be a denial of "everything," becomes all important and heavy with consequence. One may hazard guesses as to how all of this came about. Probably here too it is in part due to observation of th

e logical interdependence of Being
and Non-Being. If the One is to be different from all of Being, then it
is not Being. The loss of self is probably due partly to the same cause (if
we are to be one with Cod, then we must be not-self) as well as to a desire
to escape from the responsibility for one's own being. Perhaps too,
observation of the way in which the senses tend to merge with one an-
other, to become pain or numbness if intensified too much, also the
fact that sound becomes silence if carried too high or too low may have
strengthened the feeling that there is an absolute surrounding Nothing-
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ness which has somehow significant characteristics.14
Sartre seems to have reduced all of this to purely human data. Whereas
the mystic sets up loss of the personality as a goal, Sartre begins with
the non-personal consciousness. In one sense our recognition of the
existence of this consciousness which transcends our Ego is still our salva-
tion; for acceptance of one's absolute freedom is the only existence com-
mensurate with an honest desire to exist fully as man. But the recogni-
tion comes not in ecstasy but in anguish. It is not a merging with a
higher power but a realization of one's isolation, not a vision of eternity
but the perception that one is wholly process, the making of a Self with
which one can not be united. The mystic looks inward and learns to put
away the Self and find himself united with the One; the For-itself seeks
to find the Self it can never in any final sense possess. The mystic strives to
surpass his being in an absolute Nothingness which is somehow fulfill-
ing; the For-itself spends its life in a futile pursuit of Being and tries in
vain to escape the nothingness which it is.
We have seen that as Nothingness the For-itself is not only the internal
negation and revelation of Being but also the desire and the Choice of
Being. I should like next to examine these last two aspects of the For-
itself since on these levels we may see more clearly the significance of
Sartre's view in relation to theology, which he attempts to supplart, and
to psychology, which he would greatly modify. When we view conscious-
ness as desire, we find the same situation which we have encountered
before; that is, its essential structure is negative but the results fully
positive. Here as always consciousness is consciousness of something; thus
we find now that it is consciousness of its object as desirable. Desire,
like value, resides neither in the outside world nor in consciousness. It
is a way by which consciousness relates itself to objects of the world.
Moreover just as consciousness is the revelation of particular objects on
the ground of the revelation of all of Being (as the world), so the For-
itself exists its specific desires on the ground of a fundamental desire of
Being. Each individual desire, however trivial, has meaning only in
connection with one's fundamental relation to Being (i.e., one's basic
choice of one's mode of being, the way in which one chooses to exist).
Thus somewhat paradoxically every concrete desire (and all desires are
concrete) is significant to Sartre as indicating the personal character of
the individual under consideration, but it is important not by itself alone
but because it points to the all pervasive irreducible desire which reveals
to us the per~on. Sartre's view is that since the For-itself in its r

elation to
objects is confronting the In-itself, this means that if it desires these ob-
14 I am well aware that there are many types of mysticism and that for some of them the characteristics which I have stated here would not be appropriate. I am thinking in particular of Neo-Platonism, but I believe that at least a very large proportion of other mysticism could be similarly described.

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jects, it is desiring to appropriate the In-itself. In other words, it desires Being, either directly in the sense that it wants to assimilate or be assimilated with Being and become one with it, or indirectly by first possessing (having) Being in the form of the world.

There seems to me to be a slight difficulty here. For on the one hand Sartre seems to say that we can grasp the individuality of the human being by tracking down this irreducible choice. On the other hand, he says that every For-itself (with the possible exception of one which has effected an existentialist type of katharsis) basically desires to be one with the In-itself (thus gaining an absolute security and certainty, by being a self, a fullness of being) withput, however, ceasing to be freely responsible for this self and without ceasing to be aware of thus founding one's own being. Clearly this desire, as Sartre says, is irrational; one can not both be beyond the need of self-foundation and be responsible for achieving it. It is both the desire of being caused (hence absolute, justified) and the desire of being the cause. In short, the ideal desired is that Causa Sui which we call God. Man desires to be Godl The religious implications of this position we may examine later. At present we may note that if this desire is true of all or almost all persons, then it is hard to see just how the ultimate choice of Being is revelatory of the individual. At most there.would seem to be but a few basic types. The answer seems to lie in the kinds of objects by which the individual chooses to work out this basic choice. In this way there is created an infinite variety of possibilities for people as we know them. In any case it may be said that the hypothesis that one's personality is reducible to the basic attitude which is assumed by the For-itself confronting the In-itself and its own lack of Being is no more a threat to the variety of personality structures than the concept of the Freudian libido or the Adlerian will to power. Sartre obviously feels that it is far less so.

It is interesting to see how Sartre's general concept of desire comes close to paralleling philosophical positions to which existentialism is basically opposed. Here as in connection with the notion of Nothingness it is perhaps best not to think that Sartre is borrowing from other systems unintentionally and then perhaps in spite of himself coinciding with them, but rather that he is giving a new interpretation of aspects of experience so basic that he can not ignore them any more than any other philosopher who would be comprehensive. There is, for example, a sense in which· the Sartrian desire parallels the concept of Eros in Plato's Symposium. In both writers the individual desire is meaningful only in the larger context of a desire for Being. But of course the difference is striking since the Platonic Eros leads one through less important stages to the philosophical vision of absolute truth whereas Sartrian desire

s whole endeavor is to explain man's predicament in
human terms without postulating an existent God to guarantee anything.
Those who read him as reiigious are saying that one may be religious
without any non-human absolute. This may be true, but Sartre says in
effect that we must call such a position an atheistic humanism. Kierke-
gaard would certainly have agreed with him.l~
Sartre's religious comments fall under two generalheadings. Firsnlfe-re
are those passages in which he specifically attacks the traditional concepts
of God and attempts to prove them false because self-contradictory.
Second, throughout all of Being and Nothingness there are religious
overtones, the use of traditional religious phraseology in contexts such
that evidently he is attempting to bring into an human framework phe-
nomena frequently held to be religious.
The logical arguments focus on three problems: (1) Is the idea of
God as a Creator self-consistent and does this leave any room for human
freedom? (2) Is there an inconsistency in the view of God as Causa Sui?
(3) Can God exist outside a totality?
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In considering the concept of God as the Creator, Sartre uses artistic
creation as a parallel. The book which I write emanates from me, but
once created, it is in a sense no longer mine. I can not control what use
is made of it or what people may think that it says to them. It may "say"
something which I never intended. So with the idea of God the Creator.
If the creature is still inwardly dependent on God, then he is not separate,
not free, not an independent existent. But if in his inner being he is not
dependent on God, then he no longer can receive from God any justifica-
tion for his existence or any absoluteness. He does not "need" a Creator.
Either man is free and does not derive his meaning from God, or he
is dependent on God and not free. For many reasons, some of them al-
ready discussed, Sartre rejects the second alternative. He rejects also two
other positions closely connected with the idea of God as Creator. One
of these is Leibniz' view of freedom, according to which God has deter-
mined each man's essence and then left him to act freely in accordance
with the demands of his essence. Sartre's reply here is to reject the view
that this is freedom. He argues that if God has given us an essence, this
is to detennine all our future actions by one original gesture. Thus by
implication Sartre once more rejects a Creator because of his own funda-
mental position on the For-itselfs total freedom. The other point he

1~ It has always seemed to me that T. S. Eliot in The Cocktail Party is presenting a dramatization of these two choices. Clearly Celia has taken the Kierkegaardian leap in faith. Lavinia and Edward would, according to my interpretation, represent the choice of atheistic existentialism as they reject any idea that they might escape from them· selves toward something higher, and soberly assume responsibility for their lives. The triviality of their lives even after their awakening to the truth about themselves may be partly a documentation of Sartre's view of the absurdity of existence or simply a reflection of Eliot's own view that life apart from God is a Wasteland.

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makes as the result of an interview which he says that he had with the
Reverend Father' Boisselot. (p. 538) Father Boisselot made the state-
ment that the Last Judgment is a kind of "clos

One may pick flaws in these arguments. For example, one might argue that Sartre is guilty of a petitio principis in his assertion that Being is contingent, or that his example of the work of art could by analogy be used to prove rather than to disprove the case for a divine Creator. More important, the religious believer might well assert that God by defini-
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tion does not have to meet the tests of human logic. Perhaps the more serious attack on religion lies not in these arguments but in Sartre's attempts to show how we can see for so-called religious phenomena an explana-
[I
tion which would not need to go outside a non-supernatural ontology.
It might be said that in so doing he is following the same line of approach as that employed by Freud when he tries to prove that God is a gigantic father image, a projection of the super-ego.
Thus Sartre claims that our idea of the Creator is simply an extrapolation from our recognition of ourselves as manipUlators of the instrumental complexes of the world. As each of us forms a center of reference for objects in the world and uses them, so we think of God as a kind of master artisan whQ stands both as an absolute center of reference and as the original fabricator of tools. In the same way the concept of an omniscient Deity arises consequent to our seareh for an absolute Third who would look at us without being in turn looked-at. This need OCcurs in us, Sartre says, because our only genuine sense of community comes in the form of an Us-object when we perceive ourselves along with others forming the object of the gaze of an Other. Our attempt to feel ourselves one with all of mankind necessitates the presence of a Third who looks at us all collectively but upon whom no outside gaze may be directed.
Interestingly enough, Sartre's view of the relation between the In-itself and the For-itself presents, as it seems to me, an old theological problem in neW'dress, though Sartrein this instance does not point up the connection. The For-itself, ~ I have repeatedly said, is absolutely dependent on the In-itself and is a mere abstraction without it. Yet the In-itself, since it is a plenitude, has no need of the For-itself. It is this lack of reciprocity which prevents our seeing in Being a perfect synthesis of two moments. If one likes, one may see here the old difficulty encountered by theology.

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If God is perfect, full Being, why did he feel the need to create men? Sartre is up against the same problem. If the In-itself is absolute fullness, why should it ever, or how could it ever have effected the "hole of Being" which we know as consciousness? Like many Believers Sartre is forced to accept this as an ultimate fact, if not a Mystery, and offers only an "as-if" explanation. Everything has happened "as if" Being in an effort to found itself had split and produced the For-itself, which is the foundation of its Own Nothingness but not of its own Being.
In addition to the passages devoted to the discussion of God, there are offered explanations of other concepts frequently associated with religion. One of the most important of these is Sartre's discussion of guilt. Here we may see a distinction between what I should like to call psychological guilt and existential guilt. Psychological guilt, by which I mean consciousness of doing the kind of wrong which can be avoided and for which one is thus per

sonally responsible, Sartre finds in thc con- '
duct of bad faith. It consists in not accepting one's responsibilities as
a For-itself, in seeking to blame SOmeone or something for what one has
done' freely oneself, in choosing to assert one's freedom only where
it is expedient and on other occasions to seek refuge in a theory of
psychological determinism. It is to pretend that one is born with a
determined self instead of recognizing that one spends one's life pur-
suing and making oneself. It is the refusal to face the anguish which
accompanies tIle recognition of Our absolute freedom. Thus guilt is a lack
of authenticity, which comes close to being the one new and absolute
virtue in existentialism.I6
But rather surprisingly in a non-theistic philosophy we find also a con-
cept of existential guilt, an inescapable guilt, a species of Original Sin.
"My original Fall is the existence of the Other." (p. 263) Both my shame
and my pride stem from the fact that I have an "outside" or "nature," a
self which exists for the Other and which I am unable to determine or
even to know. Thus although I can never, even if I try, be an object to
myself, I am made an object for others. "It is before the Othcr that I am
guilty. I am guilty first when beneath the Other's look I experience my
alienation and my nakedness as a fall from grace which I must assume.
This is the meaning of the famous line from Scripture: They knew that
they were naked." (p. 410) Thus the For-itself, which is to itself wholly
subjectivity, feels itself to be guilty because it is made an object by an-
other. It is guilty because it consents to this alienation and again guilty
in that it will inevitably cause the Other to experience this same aliena-
tion. We can not live without making objects and means of the Other,
thus transcending his transcendence, and this is to do violence to his
subjectivity. Fear before God, says Sartre, comes when one tries to glorify
16 Marjorie Grene has written an excellent article on this point. "Authenticity: An
Existential Virtue." Ethics. Vol. LXII, No..... July 1951. pp. 166-17....

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this object-state by positing oneself as only an object before an absolute
subject. (p. 290) But for Sartre this would be an intensification of one's
psychological guilt, for it amounts to a false denial of one's free subjec-
tivity. The reverse situation occurs when one without rejecting God's'
existence tries to make of him an absolute object by performing black
masses, desecrating the Host, desiring evil for evil's sake, etc. (In this
last instance, however, it must be noted that this is to desire evil only in
accordance with the conventional definition of it.)
In many passages where there is no explicit religious association Sartre
seems by his choice of words to, indicate su(;h connection. There is for
example his use of the, three -"ekstases." The term inevitably suggests
mystic connotations. Desan hints that the concept of three ekstases may
be compared to the Christian Trinity-although he never attempts to
carry out the comparison,17 I do not myself see any possibility of sustain-
ing a direct comparison between Sartre's three ekstases and the Father,
Son, and Holy Ghost. But since in each case the ekstasis is that standing
apart from self which was the mystic's goal, it seems probable that
here as frequently Sartre is offering as part of his description of t

he hu-
man condition an experience which in a different context altogether has been given a religious significance. Sartre's three ekstases are: (1) The ever renewed internal negation of the In-itself by the For-itself. This involves the "diaspora" of the three temporal ekstases. In the present the For-itself is not anything. But it is present to the In-itself. In the light of what the For-itself chooses to make of the past (by which is meant that which the For-itself has been, an in-itself from which it is now separated by a nothingness) the For-itself thrusts itself toward the Future by choosing. the Self which it will be. (2) The reflection by which the For-itself reflects on its original nihilation (a process known as pure reflection) and on its psychic states (impure reflection). (3) l~eing-for-others when the For-itself realizes that it has a Self which exists for the Other and which it can never know.

Certain other vaguely religious concepts are still more briefly treated. Eternity, for instance, Sartre defines as the ideal value which man is seeking and which "is not the infinity of duration, of that vain pursuit after the self for which I am myself responsible; man seeks a repose in self, the atemporality of the absolute coincidence with himself." (p. 141-142.) A sacred object is one which in the world points to transcendence beyond the world. (p. 374) TIle "margin of unpredictability" offered by the unforeseen resistance of the In-itself is related to the Greek habit of erecting an altar to an unknown god. (p. 507) A kind of corporeal pantheism too receives its due in Sartre's description of one way in which we may "exist our body." If a person chooses to identify himself with the body and its pleasures to the fullest extent possible, this

17 Desan. Op. cit., p. 73.. '\

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may be interpreted as one method by which the For-itself "makes the in-itself exist." "In this case the desired synthesis of the in-itself with the For-itself will be the quasi-pantheistic synthesis of the totality of the in-itself with the for-itself which recovers it. Here the body is the instrument of the synthesis; it loses itself in fatigue, for example, in order that this in-itself may exist to the fullest." (p. 456)

To such passages may be added others in which the mere language suggests that old terms are being deliberately worked into a new framework. Thus the process by which the For-itself faces up to its true being, a process which Sartre tells us is necessary before one can lead an ethical life, is called a katharsis or purification. External objects or beings are "revealed as co-present ill a world where the For-itself unites them with its own blood by that total ekstatic sacrifice of the self which is called presence." (p. 122) Even the proof of the transcendence, the transphenomcnality of Being, is termed an ontological proof. It is as though Sartre were attempting to use a new theological argument to prove the existence of absolute, unjustified, unconscious mass.

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Sartre's summary of his religious position is brief and to the point. "Evcrything happens as if the world, man, and man-in-the-world succeeded in realizing only a missing God." (p. 623) The qucstion has sometimes been raised as to just why since Sartre's whole interpretation of existence postulates the pursuit of God, he is not willing to go one step further and postulate

a God who exists. Or if this is asking too much
(and actually I think it would in effect overthrow the whole work) then
why does he not accept the concept as a valuable myth with inspirational
power? While Sartre has never in so many words posed this question
and answered it, I think that it is clear what his reply would be. He re-
jects the notion that God actually exists because. the idea appears to him
false on logical grounds. He refuses the myth partly because of his stem
conviction that we must face reality and not hide behind myths which·j
would tend to blur the sharp edge of the human dilemma. He refuses
it also because it is, at least he believes, inevitably accompanied by a
belief in absolutes and a theory of a human nature which would deter-
mine our destiny, because it conceals the fact that each man must dis-
cover and affirm his own values, that there is nothing to guarantee the
permanent validity of anyone set of ideals as compared with another.
The fact that ultimately Sartre's rejection of God is based on rational
arguments (whether or not his critics are persuaded of their cogency) is
extremely significant in view of the fact that existentialism is generally
regarded as an example of contemporary irrationalism. If we examine
Sartre's position carefully, we find that it emphasizes both reason and
unreason and in a manner precisely the reverse of what we find in the
writings of either the Scholastics or the Neo-Platonists. In the religious
writers we are familiar with the idca that man proceeds within the human

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sphere by relying on reason, that he may use reason in his initial approach
to God, but that the final vision and, paradoxically, the ultimate source
of true wisdom is non-rational. All this Sart~e completely reverses. When
consciousness first chooses its way of Being, this is a non-rational, actually
a pre-rational choice. The For-itself may choose to live rationally, to live
by emotion, to deny the validity of logic, to honor only scientific "objec-
tivity," to refuse to confine itself within anyone attitude-the possibilities
are many and varied. But it is clear that Sartre feels that the rational choice
is the best one. This was already evident in his treatment of the emotions.
The emotionahelation, which is a purely personal relation set up by the
For-itself between-- it and the In-itself, is inadequate because it is ineffec-
tive; it can not (at least not directly) affect the environment and produce
lasting results. This is because it is essentially a denial of the instrumental
complexes of the world; it refuses to admit the external resistance, what
Sartre (after Bachelard) calls the "coefficient of adversity" of the In-itself.
Reason, on the other hand, always takes this organized world into consid-
eration, for by definition knowledge is the one real bridge between the For-
itself and the In-itself. If we may say that reason is consciousness' percep-
tion of those organizations and relations which the brute universe is cap-
:.Ible of sustaining and that it is the perception of relations established in
human products (language, etC'.) such that any human being may recog-
nize them, that it is also the will to confine oneself within these limits,
then certainly in the final analysis Sartre's philosophy is a philosophy of
reason. It includes the irrational among its data and recognizes that man's
irrational behavio

original choice of a mode of Being by which the
For-itself has related itself to the world. But wherein does this person consist? It seems that it must be the Ego and not consciousness, for the latter is non-personal. Yet since it is consciousness (not the Ego) which makes the original choice and-as the For-itself realizes in anguish -may at any moment replace this first choice of Being by a different one, it seems that we have not found the person unless we have reached the pre-reflective consciousness. But how can we have an impcrsonal person? Possibly this is quibbling. Perhaps Sartre means that we are to learn about the choice made by the original consciousness and that obviously we are informed by observation of the Ego. This would seem to be the case, particularly since we can not at any event get inside another's subjectivity.
We may also ask about the nature of the unity of this personality.
In .rejecting the idea of an unconscious, Sartre not only insists that there

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are only consciotls acts hut claims that the For-itself always acts as a whole and hence is a unity. But it is a strange sort of unity since the For-itself is never united with its self but always separated from it in the various ekstases. Actually the problem may not be as difficult and insoluble as it first appears. Sartre is, of course, not the first philosopher to deny the existence of a Self-substance. When he speaks of our pursuit of a self, he means that we can not say that a particular For-itself is something any more than we can say that at any given instant the flying arrow is at the point C on the designated route A--Z. The nature of the For-itself is rather such that it is continually choosing to project itself toward .fu~ure possibilities. In this s~nse it is never united with a self because It IS process rather than entity. But we need not take the point of view of certain critics who argue that Sartre is here inconsistent in that he describes the For-itself as self-less and then treats it as an individualized being.
Desan, for example, discusses Sartre's "repudiation of the Ego" (which in itself is an inaccurate representation) so as to try to show that Sartre needs an Ego-less For-itself for ontology, but a personal For-itself for psychology, for ethics, and for relations with others; and he claims that Sartre alternates between the two concepts. All of Desan's arguments are based on the assumption that Sartre in stating that the Ego is not identical with the original consciousness has taken away any reality of being from the For-itself and has given up all right to employ the words "I" or "Me." But this is a misconception. In the first place Sartre has not repudiated the Ego; he has only made of it an object of the pre-reflective consciousness rather than contemporary with it. But it exists just as much as objects in the world exist. Also Sartre never denies the existence of an active, organizing (constituante), individual consciousness any more than does William James, who likewise rejected consciousness as an cntity. He merely insists that it is essentially a Nothingness which is individualized by its objects but never wholly determined by past objects to an extent which would prescribe what it will do with present or future ones. Consciousness can never blot out the fact that it has been aware of certain objects (part of which it has un

ne can be guilty of bad faith and of
vice, which somewhat unexpectedly Sattre defines as the love of failure. How is this possible? The answer seems to lie in concluding that an individual For-itself may not consider Bad Faith and love of failure, to be cvils. It is only from Sartre's point of view (and ours if we follow him)

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that a person may fail to choose the good, and this is because he does not know what we call evil to be evil.

On three other aspects of Sartre's psychology I should like to comment briefly. The first relates to his views on the subjective and the objective as related to the analysis of human character. As pointed out earlier, consciousness can not take a point of view on itself as a totality. Strictly speaking, any human fact is a subjective fact since any observation of the world is a human-subjective-observation. But at the same time while Sartre denies that consciousness can make an object out of itself, his position allows us to.see why the For-itself can take just as legitimate (and nO more so) an objective point of view ori certain of its own states as it can on the states of anyone else or as anyone else can with respect to it. If Pierre and Paul are both considering Pierre's love for a certain woman, they are both considering an objective state. For while the immediate impulse is a love-consciousness which Pierre is, the state of love is part of Pierre's object~ego (or at least his psyche). Both he and Paul may view it as an object. Each judges it in terms of the other objects of which his consciousness is and has been aware. Thus a person may under certain circumstances undertake his own psychoanalysis. He stands before his psyche not in any privileged position but exactly as does the psychiatrist. The relatively higher.or lower chances of his success will depend on the practical wisdom which he can bring to bear in his evaluations of his own psychic being. At the same time neither he nor the psychiatrist can analyze the pre-reflective consciousness, the patient because he is this consciousness, the analyst because he can know it only as object whereas its being is pure subjectivity. Both patient and analyst must attempt to judge the acts of his consciousness through its effects as revealed in the outside world and in the Ego.

Two other psychological positions, original, I believe, with Sartre, are of particular importance in connection with his views on the For-itself's relation with other people-the For-Others. These are his ideas about the nature of the body and about sexuality. In one sense, of course, the body represents man's facticity, his Being-there in the world. It determines certain physical limits to what the For-itself can do within or to the world. And if we speak of its actual chemical make-up, we are considering part of that Being with which the For-itself as Nothingness is forever contrasted. Yet except when it becomes a corpse the body does not actually belong within the province of the In-itself. As "existed" by the For-itself it is a psychic object; in fact we might more accurately say that the For-itself is its body. Without a body the For-itself could have no relation whatsoever with what we call the world. For the For-itself is consciousness of objects as seen, felt, etc., in other words, as perceived through the senses. The For-itself does not have senses. It is present to

nothing of importance to say on the
subject or because I.agree with those who claim that for the For-itself, as Sartre has portrayed it, no personal or social ethics is possible. It is simply that I believe it unwise to discuss a subject which Sartre himself has told us he is waiting to develop in another work. In the light of numerous statements to the effect that man is a useless passion and that life is absurd, and in view of Sartre's attempt to show that all of the familiar attitudes toward the Other-love, hate, masochism, sadism, and indifference-result in failure, it is no wonder that critics have been sceptical as to the possibility of future positive development. Yet it is important to note that Francis Jeanson, in a book prefaced by a letter of approval from Sartre himself, offers the idea that Sartre has described these concrete human proje~ts as they generally are, rather than as they have to be. On the level on which the "spirit of seriousness" chooses to live, life is absurd, but the absurdity consists precisely in maintaining life at this level,18 If consciousness will practice a "purifying reflection," it may find possibilities for a new set of ethical values consistent with its total freedom and unlimited self-responsibility.

In the absence of more information about this "purifying reflection" we are limited to observation of what Sartre has done in applying his philosophical conclusions in literary analyses. There is at least the foundation for a social ethics in an article which came out in 1946 called "Materialism et Revolution" (us Temps Modernes). Here in his portrayal of the New Revolutionary Sartre lays down a plan for a society which would allow for continual self-transcendence in the direction of greater freedom. As yet the nearest approach to an existentialist hero who would represent an ideal of personal ethics seems to be Orestes in The Flies. In this play, which is quite obviously an attack on the "spirit of seriousness" and conventional religious views, Orestes refuses to join with the people in their feeling of general guilt and need for atonement induced by the sin of Clytemnestra and Aegisthus (Adam and Eve?). He will not be awed by a display of the wonders .of the Universe (the Voice out of the Whirlwind?). He insists that he became free from his Creator at the moment of creation, and he claims that he is not in the Universe to

18 Jeanson, Op. cit. Especially page '1.76.

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carry out any prescribed orders laid down by a god. But what does he offer in return? He insists on accepting full responsibility for each of his acts. He gives up the role of spectator and voluntarily commits his freedom to the cause of the people of Argos. He is willing to give up his peace of mind for the sake of the suffering. He sets out alone to find new paths of action appropriate for man who can no longer discover his destiny by viewing himself as a part of Nature's plan. In short he accepts the tension of absolute freedom and total responsibility. In the play Orestes does not seem to know quite what course he will follow once he has left Argos, but we can feel sure that he will set a high premium on rational facing up to the facts of the human condition as he sees them and will work out principles of conduct consistent with his earlier pronouncements. I suspect that at the present moment this is about as far as we ar

xistent different from itself;
it has its own being. The first being which we meet in our ontological inquiry is the being of the appearance. Is it itself an appearance? It seems so at first. The phenomenon is what manifests itself, and being manifests itself to all in some way, since we can speak of it and since we have a certain comprehension of it. Thus there must be for it a phenomenon of being, an appearance of being, capable of description as·such. Being will be disclosed to us by some kind of immediate access-boredom, nausea, etc., and ontology will be the description of the phenomenon of being as it manifests itself; that is, without intermediary. However for any ontology we should raise a preliminary question: is the phenomenon of being thus achieved identical with the being of phenomena? In other words, is the being which discloses itself to me, which appears to me, of the same nature as the being of existents which appear to me? It seems that there is no difficulty. Husserl has shown how an eidetic reduction is always possible; that is, how one can always pass beyond the concrete phenomenon toward its essence. For Heidegger also "human reality" is ontic-ontological; that is, it can always pass beyond thephemomenon toward its being. But the passage from the particular object to the essence is a passage from homogeneous to homogeneous. Is it the same for the passage from the existent to the phenomenon of being: Is passing beyond the existent toward the phenomenon of being actually to pass beyond it toward its being, as one

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passes beyond the particular red toward its essence? Let us consider further.
In a particular object one can always distinguish qualities like color, odor, etc. And proceeding from these, one can always determine an essence which they imply, as a sign implies its meaning. The totality "object-essence" makes an organized whole. The essence is not in the object; it is the meaning of the object, the principle of the series of appearances which disclose it. But being is neither one of the object's qualities, capable of being apprehended among others, nor a meaning of the object. The object does not refer to being as to a signification; it would be impossible, for example, to define being as a presence since absence too discloses being, since not to be tllere means still to be. The object does not possess being, and its existence is not a participation in being, nor any other kind of relation. It is. That is the only way to define its manner of being; the object does not hide being, but neither does it reveal being. The object does not hide it, for it would be futile to try to push aside certain qualities of the existent in order to find the being behind them; being is being of them all equally. The object does not reveal being, for it would be futile to address oneself to the object in order to apprehend its being. The existent is a phenomenon; this means that it designates itself as an organized totality of qualities. It designates itself and not its being. Being is simply the condition of all revelation. It is being-for-revealing (etre-pour-dcvoiler) and not revealed being (etre devoile). What then is the meaning of the surpassing toward the ontological, of which Heidegger speaks? Certainly I can pass beyond this table or this chair toward its being and raise the question of the beillg-of-the-table or

of the self
to itself.
Furthermore the reflecting consciousness posits the consciousness reflected-on, as its object. In the act of reflecting I pass judgment on the consciousness reflected-on; I am ashamed of it, I am proud of it, I wiII it, I deny it, etc. The immediate consciousness which I have of perceiving does not permit me either to judge or to wiII or to be ashamed. It does not know my perception, does not posit it; aII that there is of intention in my actual consciousness is directed toward the outside, toward the world.. In tum, this spontaneous consciousness of my perception is constitutive of my perceptive consciousness. In other words, every positional consciousness of an object is at the same time a non-positional consciousness of itself. If I count the cigarettes which are in that case, I have the impression of disclosing an objective property of this coIlection of cigarettes: they are a dozen. This property appears to my consciousness as a property existing in the world. It is very possible that I have no positional conscious-.ness of counting them. Then I do not know myself as counting. Proof of this is that children who are capable of making an addition spontaneously can not explain subsequently how they set about it. Piaget's tests, which show this, constitute an excelIent refutation of the formula of Alain-To know is to know that one knows. Yet at the moment when these cigarettes are revealed to me as a dozen, I have a non-thetic consciousness of my adding activity. If anyone questioned me, indeed, if anyone should ask, "What are you doing there?" I should reply at once, "I am counting." This reply aims not only at the instantaneous consciousness which I can achieve by reflection but at those flceting consciousnesses which have passed without being reflected-on, those which are forevcr not-reflected-on in my immediate past. Thus reflection has no kind of primacy over the consciousness reflected-on. It is not reflection which reveals the consciousness reflected-on to itself. Ouite the contrary, it is the non-reflective consciousness which renders the reflection possible; there is a pre-reflective cogito which is the condition of the Cartesian cogito. At the same time it is the non-thetic consciousness of counting which is the very condition of my act of adding. If it were otherwise, how would the addition be the unifying theme of my consciousnesses? In order that this theme should preside over a whole series of syntheses of unifications and recognitions, it must be present to itself, not as a thing but as an operative intention which can exist only as the revealing-revealed (revelante-reveIee), to uSe an expression of Heidegger's. Thus in order to count, it is necessary to be conscious of counting.
Of course, someone may say, but this makes a circle. For is it not ?ecessary that I count in fact in order to be conscious of counting? That IS true. However there is no circle, or if you like, it is the very nature of consciousness to exist "in a circle." The idea can be expressed in these

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tenns: Every conscious existence exists as consciousness of existing. We understand now why the first consciousness of consciousness is not positional; it is because it is one with the consciousness of which it is consciousness. At one stroke it detennines itself as consciousness of perception and as perception. The necess

ity of syntax has compelled us hitherto
to speak of the "non-positional consciousness of self." But we can no
longer use this expression in which the "of self" still evokes the idea of
knowledge. (Henceforth we shall put the "of" inside parentheses to show
that it merely satisfies a grammatical requirement.)·
This self-consciousness we ought to consider not as a new conscious-
ness, but as the only mode of. existence which is possible for a conscious-
ness of somet~ing. Justas an extended object is compelled to exist accord-
ing to three qimensions, so an intention, a pleasure, a grief can exist only
as immediate self-consciousness. If the intention is not a thing in con-
sciousness, then the being of the intention can,be only consciousness. It
is not necessary to understand by this that on the one hand, some ex-
ternal cause (an organic trouble, an unconscious impulse, another Erleb-
nis) could ,determine that a psychic event-a pleasure, for example,-
produce itself, and that on the other hand, this event so detennined in
its material structure should be compelled to produce itself as self-con-
sciousness. This would be to make the non-thetic consciousness a quality
of the positional consciousness (in the sense that the perception, posi-
tional consciousness of that table, would have as addition the quality of
self-consciousness) and would thus fall back into the illusion of the theo-
retical primacy of knowledge. This would be moreover to make the psychic
event a thing and to qualify it with "conscious" just as I can qualify this
blotter with "red." Pleasure can not be distinguished-even logically-
from consciousness of pleasure. Consciousness (of) pleasure is constitu-
tive of the pleasure as the very mode of its own existence, as the material
of which it is made, and not as a fonn which is imposed by a blow upon a
hedonistic material. Pleasure can not exist "before" consciousness of pleas-
ure-not even in the fonn of potentiality or potency. A potential pleasure
can exist only as consciousness (of) being potential. Potencies of con-
sciousnes') exist only as consciousness of potencies.
Conversely, as I showed earlier, we must avoid defining pleasure by the
consciousness which I have of it. This would be to fall into an idealism of
consciousness which would bring us by indirect means to the primacy of
knowledge. Pleasure must not disappear behind its own self-consciousness;
it is not a representation, it is a concrete event, full and absolute. It is no
more a quality of self-consciousness than self-consciousness is a quality of
pleasure. There is no more first a consciousness which receives subsequent-
ly the affect "pleasure" like water which one stains, than there is first a
? Since English syntax does not require the "of," I shall henceforth freely translate
conscience (de) soi as "self-consciousness." Tr.,
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pleasure (unconscious or psychological) which receives subsequently
the quality of "conscious" like a pencil of light rays. There is an indivisible,
indissoluble being-definitely not a substance supporting its qualities like
particles of being, but a being which is existence through and through.
Pleasure is the being of self-consciousness and this self-consciousness
is the law of being of pleasure. This is what Heideggcr expressed very wcll
when he wrote (though speaking of Dasein, not of consciousness): "The
'how' (essentia) of this being, s

o far as it is possible to speak of it generally,
must be conceived in terms of its existence (existentia)." This means
that consciousness is not produced as a particular instance of an abstract
possibility but that in rising to the center of being, it creates and supports
its essence-that is, the synthetic order of its possibilities.
This means also that the type of being of consciousness is the opposite
of that which the ontological proof reveals to us. Since consciousness is
not possible before being, but since its being is the source and condition
of all possibility, its existence implies its essence. Husserl expresses this
aptly in speaking of °the "necessity of fact." In order for there to be an
essence of pleasure, there must. be first the fact of a consciousness (of)
this pleasure. It is futile to try to invoke pretended laws of consciousness
of which the articulated whole would constitute the essence. A law is a
transcendent object of knowledge; there,can be consciousness of a law, not
a law of consciousness. For the same reasons it is impossible to assign to a
consciousness a motivation other than itself. Otherwise it would be nec-
essary to conceive that consciousness to the degree to which it is an
effect, is not conscious (of) itself. It would be necessary in some manncr
that it should be without being conscious (of) being. We should fall into
that too common illusion which makes consciousness semi-conscious or a
passivity. But consciousness is consciousness through and through. It
can be limited only by itself.
This self-determination of consciousness must not be conceived as a
genesis, as a becoming, for that would force us to suppose that conscious-
ness is prior to its own existence. Neither is it necessary to conceive of this
self-creation as an act, for in that case consciousness would be conscious
(of) itself as an act, which it is not. Consciousness is a plenum of exist·
ence, and this determination of itself by itself is an essential characteristic.
It would even be wise not to misuse the expression "cause of self,"
which allows us to suppose a progression, a relation of self-cause to self-
effect. It would be more exact to say very simply: The existence of con-
sciousness comes from consciousness itself. By that we need not under-
stand that consciousness "derives from nothingness." There can not be
"nothingness of consciousness" before consciousness. "Before" conscious-
ness one can conceive only of a plenum of being of which no element can
refer to an absent consciousness. If there is to be nothingness of conscious-

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ness, there must be a consciousness which has been and which is no more
and a witnessing con~ciousness which poses the nothingness of the first
consciousness for a synthesis of recognition. Consciousness is prior to
nothingness and "is derived" from being.1i
One will perhaps have some difficulty in accepting these conclusions.
But considered more carefully, they will appear perfectly clear. The para-
dox is not that there are "self-activated" existences but that there is no
other kind. What is truly unthinkable is passive existence; that is, existence
which perpetuates itself without having the force either to produce itself
or to preserve itself. From this point of view there is nothing more incom-
prehensible than the principle of inertia. Indeed where would conscious-
ness "come" from if it did "come" from s

omething? From the limbo
of the unconscious or of the physiological. But if we ask ourselves how this limbo in its turn can exist and where it derives its existence, we find ourselves faced with the concept of passive existence; that is, we can no more absolutely understand how this non-eonscious given (unconscious or physiological) which does not derive its existence from itself, can nevertheless perpetuate this existence and find in addition the ability to produce a consciousness. This demonstrates the great favor which the proof a contingentia mundi has enjoyed.

Thus by abandoning the primacy of knowledge, we have discovered the being of the knower and encountered the absolute, that same absolute which the rationalists of the seventeenth century had defined and logically constituted as an object of knowledge. But precisely because the question concerns an absolute of existence and not of knowledge, it is not subject to that famous objection according to which a known absolute is no longer an absolute because it becomes relative to the knowledge which one has of it. In fact the absolute here is not-the result of a logical construction on the ground of knowledge but the subject of the most concrete of experiences. And it is not at all relative to this experience because it is this experience. Likewise it is a non-substantial absolute. The ontological error of Cartesian rationalism is not to have seen that if the absolute is defined by the primacy of existence over essence, it can not be conceived a~ a substance. Consciousness has nothing substantial, it is pure "appearance" in the sense that it exists only to the degree to which it appears. But it is precisely because consciousness is pure appearance, because it is total emptiness (since the entire world is outside it) -it is because of this identity of appearance and existence within it that it can be considered as the absolute.

Ii That certainly does not mean that consciousness is the foundation of its being. On the contrary, as we shall see later, there is a full contingency of the being of consciousness. We wish only to show (I) That notlling is the cause of consciousness. (:z) That consciousness is the cause of its own way of being.

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IV. THE BEING OF THE PERCIPI

IT seems that we have arrived at the goal of our inquiry. We have reduced things to the united totality of their appearances, and we have established that these appearances lay claim to a being which is no longer itself appearance. The "percipi" referred us to a percipiens, the being of which has been revealed to us as consciousness. Thus we have attained the ontological foundation of knowledge, the first being to whom all other appearances appear, the absolute in relation to which every phenomenon is relative. This is no longer the subject in Kant's meaning of the term, but it is subjectivity itself, the immanence of self in self. Henceforth we have escaped idealism. For the latter, being is measured by knowledge, which subjects it to the law of duality. There is only known being; it is a question of thought itself. Thought appears only through its own products; that is, we always apprehend it only as the signification of thoughts produced, and the philosopher in quest of thought must questioJ;l the established sciences in order to derive it from them as the condition of their possibility. We, on the other hand, ha

ve apprehended a being which
is not subject to knowledge and which founds knowledge, a thought which is definitely not given as a representation or a signification of expressed thoughts, but which is directly apprehended such as it is-and this mode of apprehension is not a phenomenon of knowledge but is the structure of being. We find ourselves at present on the ground of the phenomenology of Husser! although Husserl himself has not always been faithful to his first intuition. Are we satisfied? We have encountered a transphenomenal being, but is it actually the being to which the phenomenon of being refers? Is it indeed the being of the phenomenon? In other words is consciousness sufficient to provide the foundation for the appearance qua appearance? We have extracted its being from the phenomenon in order to give it to consciousness, and we anticipated that consciousness would subsequently restore it to the phenomenon. Is this possible? We shall find our answer in the examination of the ontological exigencies of the percipi.

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Let us note first that there is a being of the thing perceived-as perceived. Even if I wished to reduce this table to a synthesis of subjective impressions, I must at least remark that it reveals itself qua table through this synthesis, that it is the transcendent limit of the synthesis, the reaSOn for it and its end. The table is before knowledge and can not be identified with the knowledge which we have of it; otherwise it would be consciousness-i.e., pure immanence-and it would disappear as table. For the same cause even if a pure distinction of reason is to separate the table from the synthesis of subjective impressions through which I apprehend it, at least it can not be this synthesis; that would be to reduce I

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it to a synthetic activity of connection. In so far then as the known can not be reabsorbed into knowledge, we must discover for it a being. This being, we are told, is the percipi. Let us recognize first of all that the being of the percipi can not be reduced to that of the percipiens-i.e., to consciousness-any more than the table is reduced to the bond of representations. At most we can say that it is relative to this being. But this relativity does not render unneccssary an examination of the being of the percipi. Now the mode of the percipi is the passive. If then the being of the phenomenon resides in its percipi, this being is passivity. Relativity and passivity-such are the characteristic structures of the esse in so far as this is reduced to the percipi. What is passivity? I am passive when I undergo a modification of which I am not the origin; that is, neither the source nor the creator. Thus my being supports a mode of being of which it is not the source. Yet in order for me to support, it is still necessary that I exist, and due to this fact my existence is always situated on the other side of passivity. "To support passively," for example, is a conduct which I assume and which engages my liberty as much as to "reject resolutely." If I am to be for always "the-one-who-has-been-offended," I must persevere in my being; that is, I myself assume my existence. But all the same I respond on my own account in some way and I assume my offense; I cease to be passive in relation to it. Hence we have this choice of alternatives: either, indeed, I am not passive in my being, in which case I b

ecome
the foundation of my affections even if at first I have not been the origin of them-or I am affected with passivity in my very existence, my being is a received being, and hence all falls into nothingness. Thus passivity is a doubly relative phenomenon, relative to the activity of the one who acts and to the existence of the one who suffers. This implies that passivity can not affect the actual being of the passive existent; it is a relation of one being to another being and not of one being to a nothingness. It is impossible that the percipere affects the perceptum of being, for in order for the perceptum to be affected it would of necessity have to be already given in some way and exist before having received being. One can conceive of a creation on condition that the created being recover itself, tear itself away from the creator in order to close in on itself immediately and assume its being; it is in this sense that a book exists as distinct from its author. But if the act of creation is to be continued indefinitely, if the created being is to be supported even in its inmost parts, if it does not have its own independence, if it is in itself only nothingness-then the creature is in no way distinguished from its creator; it is absorbed in him; we are dealing with a false transcendence, and the creator can not have even an illusion of getting out of his subjectivity.6

6 It is for this reason that the Cartesian doctrine of substance finds its logical culmination in the work of Spinoza.

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Furthermore the passivity of the recipient demands an equal passivity on the part of the agent. This is expressed in the principle of action and reaction; it is because my hand can be crushed, grasped, cut, that my hand can crush, cut, grasp. What element of passivity can we assign to perception, to knowledge? They are all activity, all spontaneity. It is precisely because it is pure spontaneity, because nothing can get a grip on it that consciousness. can not act upon anything. Thus the esse est percipi would require that consciousness, pure spontaneity which can not act upon anything, give being to a transcendent nothingness, at the same time keeping it in its state of nothingness. So much nonsense! Husserl has attempted to overcome these objections by introducing passivity into the noesis; this is the hyle or pure flux of experience and the matter of the passive syntheses. But he has only added an additional difficulty to those which we have mentioned. He has introduced in fact those neutral givens, the impossibility of which we have shown earlier. To be sure, these are not "contents" of consciousness, but they remain only so much the more unintelligible. The hyle in fact could not be consciousness, for it would disappear in translucency and could not offer that resisting basis of impressions which must be surpassed toward the object. But if it does not belong to consciousness, where does it derive its being and its opacity? How can it preserve at once the opaque resistance of things and the subjectivity of thought? Its esse can not come to it from a percipi since it is not even perceived, for consciousness transcends it toward the objects. But if the hyle derives its being from itself alone, we meet once again the insoluble problem of the connection of consciousness with existents independent of it. Even if we grant to Husserl that the

re is hyletic
stratum for the noesis, we can not conceive how consciousness can transcend this ~ubjective toward objectivity. In giving to the hyle both the characteristics of a thing and the characteristics of consciousness, Husserl believed that he facilitated the passage from the one to the other, but he succeeded only in creating a hybrid being which consciousness rejects and which can not be a part of the world.
Furthermore, as we have seen, .the percipi implies that the law of being of the perceptum is relativity. Can we conceive that the being of the thing known is relative to the knowledge? What can the relativity of being mean for an existent if not that the existent has its own being in SOmething other than in itself; that is, in an existent which it is not. Certainly it would not be inconceivable that a being should be external to itself if one means that this being is its own externality. But such is not the case here. The perceived being is before consciousness; consciousness can not reach it, and it can not enter into consciousness; and as the perceived being is cut off from consciousness, it exists cut off from its own existence. It would be no use to make of it an unreal in the manner of Husserl; even as unreal it must exist.

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BEING AND NOTHINGNESS
Thus the two determinations of relativity and of passivity, which can concern modes of being, can on nO account apply to being. The esse of the phenomenon can not be its percipi. The transphenomenal being of consciousness can not provide a basis for the transphenomenal being of the phenomenon. Here we see the error of the phenomenalists: having justifiably reduced the object to the connected series of its appearances, they believed they had reduced its being to the succession of its modes of being. That is why they have explained it by concepts which can be applied only to the modes of being, for they are pointing out the relations between a plurality of already existing beings.
V. THE ONTOLOGICAL PROOF
BEING has not been given its due. We believed we had dispensed with granting transphenomenality to the being of the phenomenon because we had discovered the transphenomenality of the being of consciousness. We are going to see, on the contrary, that this very transphenomenality requires that of the being of the phenomenon. There is an "ontological proof" to be derived not from the reflective cogito but from the pre-reflective being of the percipiens. This we shall now try to demonstrate.
All consciousness is consciousness of something. This definition of consciousness can be taken in two very distinct senses: either we understand by this that consciousness is constitutive of the being of its object, or it means that consciousness in its inmost nature is a relation to a transcendent being. But thc first interpretation of the formula destroys itself: to be conscious of something is to be confronted with a concrete and full presence which is not consciousness. Of course one can be conscious of an absence. But this absence appears necessarily as a pre-condition of presence. As we have seen, consciousness is a real subjectivity and the impression is a subjective plenitude. But this subjectivity can not go out of itself to posit a transcendent object in such a way as to endow it with a plenitude of impressions.7 If then we wish at any price to make the being of the phenomenon depend on co

nsciousness, the object must be distinguished
from consciousness not by its presence but by its absence, not by its
plenitude, but by its nothingness. If being belongs to consciousness, the
object is not consciousness, not to the extent that it is another being, but
that it is non-being. This is the appeal to the infinite of which we spoke in
the first section of this work. For Husserl, for example, the animation of
the hyletic nucleus by the only intentions which can find their fulfilment
(Erfiil1ung) in this hyle is not enough to bring us outside of subjectivity.
The truly objectifying intentions are empty intentions, those which aim
'I I.e., in such a way that the impressions are objectified into qualities of the thing. Tr.
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beyond the present subjective appearance at the infinite totality of the
series of appearances.
We must futther understand that the intentions aim at appearances
which are never to be given at one time. It is an impossibility on principle
for the terms of an infinite series to exist all at the same time before con-
sciousness, along with the real absence of all these terms except for the
one which is the foundation of objectivity. If present these impressions-
even in infinite number-would dissolve in the subjective; it is their ab-
sence which gives them objective being. Thus the being of the object is
pure non-being. It is defined as a lack. It is that which escapes, that which
by definition will never be given, that which offers itself only in fleeting
and successive profiles..
But how cannon-being be the foundation of being? How can the
absent, expected subjective become thereby the objective? A great joy
which I hope for, a grief which I dread, acquire from that fact a certain
transcendence. This I admit. But that transcendence in immanence
does not bring us out of the subjective. It is true that things give them-
selves in profile; that is, simply by appearances. And it is true that each
appearance refers to other appearances. But each of them is already in
itself alone a transcendent being, not a subjective material of impressions
-a plenitude of being, not a lack-a presence, not an absence. It is futile
by a sleight of hand to attempt to found the reality of the object on the
subjective plenitude of impressions and its ob;ectivity on non-being; the
objective will never come out of the subjective nor the transcendent
from immanence, nor being from non-being. But, we are told, Husserl
defines consciousness precisely as a transcendence. In truth he does. This
is what he posits. This is his essential discovery. But from the moment
that he makes of the nocma an unreal, a correlate of the noesis, a noema
whose esse is percipi, he is totally unfaithful to his principle.
Consciousness is consciousness of something. This means that tran-
scendence is the constitutive structure of consciousness; that is, that con-
sciousness is born supported by a being which is not itself. This is what we
call the ontological proof. No doubt someone will reply that the existence
of the demand of consciousness does not prove that this demand ought
to be satisfied. But this objection can not hold up against an analysis of
what Husserl calls intentionality, though, to be sure, he misunderstood
its essential character. To say that consciousness is consciousness of some-
thing means that for consciousness there is no being outside of that prec

n with
consciousness.
We have shown also by the examination of the spontaneity of the non-reflective cogito that consciousness can not get out of its subjectivity if the latter has been initially given, and that consciousness can not act upon transcendent being nor without contradiction admit of the passive elements necessary in order to constitute a transcendent being arising from them. Thus we have ruled out the idealist solution of the problem. It appears that we have barred all doors and that we are now condemned to regard transcendent being and consciousness as two closed totalities without possible communication. It will be necessary to show that the problem allows a solution other than realism or idealism.
A certain number of characteristics can be fixed on immediately because for the most part they follow naturally from what we have just said.
A clear view of the phenomenon of being has often' been obscured by a very common prejudice which we shall call "creationism." Since people supposed that God had given being to the world, being always appeared tainted with a certain passivity. But a creation ex nihilo can not explain the coming to pass of being; for if being is conceived in a subjectivity, even a divine subjectivity, it remains a mode of intra-subjective being. Such subjectivity can not have even the representation of an objectivity, and consequently it can not even be affected with the will to create the objective. Furthermore being, if it is suddenly placed outside the subjective by the fulguration of which Leibniz speaks, can only affirm itself as distinct from and opposed to its creator; otherwise it dissolves in him. The theory of perpetual creation, by removing from being what the Germans call Selbstiindigkeit, makes it disappear in the divine subjectivity. If being exists as over against God, it is its own support; it does not preserve the least trace of divine creation. In a word, even if it had been created, being-in-itself would be inexplicable in terms of creation; for it assumes its being beyond the creation.
This is equivalent to saying that being is uncreated. But we need not conclude that being creates itself, which would suppose that it is prior to itself. Being can not be causa sui in the manner of consciousness. Being is itself. This means that it is neither passivity nor activity. Both of these notions are human and designate human conduct or the instruments of human conduct. There is activity when a conscious being uses means with an end in view. And we call those objects passive on which our activity is exercised, in as much as they do not spontaneously aim at the end which we make them serve. In a word, man is active and the means which he employs are called passive. These concepts, put absolutely, lose all meaning. In particular, being is not active; in order for there to be an end
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and means, there must be being. For an even stronger reason it can not be passive, for in order to be passive, it must be. The self-eonsistency of being is beyond the active as it is beyond the passive.
Being is equally beyond negation as beyond affirmation. Affirmation is always affirmation of something; that is, the act of affirming is distinguished from the thing affirmed. But if we suppose an affirmation in which the affirmed comes to fulfill the affirn1ing and is confused with it, this affirmation can not

e study of a single pattern of conduct.
We shall try on the contrary to describe several and proceeding from one kind of conduct to another, attempt to penetrate into the profound meaning of the relation "man-world." But first 0f all we should choose a single pattern which can serve us as a guiding thread in our inquiry.
Now this very inquiry furnishes us with the desired conduct; this man that I am-if I apprehend him such as he is at this moment in the world, I establish that he stands before being in an' attitude of interrogation. At the very moment when I ask, "Is there any cqnduct which can reveal to me the relation of man with the world?" I pose a question. This question I can consider objectively, for it matters little whether the questioner]'; myself or the reader who reads my work and who is questioning along with me. But on the other hand, the question is not simply the objective totality of the words printed on this page; it is indifferent to the symbols which express it. In a word, it is a human attitude filled with meaning. What docs this attitude reveal to us?
In every question we stand before a being which we are questioning. Every question presupposes a being who questions and a being which is questioned. This is not the original relation of man to being-in-itself, but rather it stands within the limitations of this relation and takes it for granted. On the other hand, this being which we question, we question about something. That about which I question the being participates in the transcendence of being. I question being about its ways of being or , about its being. From this point of view the question is a kind of expectation; I expect a reply from the being questioned. That is, on the basis

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of a pre-interrogative familiarity with being. I expect from this being a revelation of its being or of its way of being. The reply will be a "yes" or a "no." It is the existence of these two equally objective and contradictory possibilities which on principle distinguishes the question from affirmation or negation. There are questions which on the surface do not permit a negative reply-like, for example, the one which we put earlier, "What does this attitude reveal to us?" But actually we see that it is always possible with questions of this type to reply, "Nothing" or "Nobody" or "Never." Thus at the moment when I ask, "Is there any conduct which can reveal to me the relation of man with the world?" I admit on principle the possibility of a negative reply such as, "No, such a conduct does not exist." This means that we admit to being faced with the transcendent fact of the non-existence of such conduct.
One will perhaps- be tempted not to believe in the objective existence of a non-being; one will say that in this case the fact simply refers me to my subjectivity; I would learn from the transcendent being that the conduct sought is a pure fiction. But in the first place, to call this conduct a pure fiction is to disguise the negation without removing it. "To be pure fiction" is equivalent here to "to be only a fiction." Consequently to destroy the reality of the negation is to cause the reality of the reply to disappear. This reply, in fact, is the very being which gives it to me; that is, reveals the negation to me. There exists then for the questioner the permanent objective possibility of a negative reply. In relation

to this
possibility the questioner by the very fact that he is questioning, posits himself as in a state of indetermination; he does not know whether the reply will be affirmative or negative. Thus the question is a bridge set up between two non-beings: the non-being of knowing in man, the possibility of non-being of being in transcendent being. Finally the question implies the existence of a truth. By the very question the questioner affirms that he expects an objective reply, such that we can say of it, "It is thus and not otherwise." In a word the truth, as differentiated from being, introduces a third non-being as determining the question-the non-being of limitation. This triple non-being conditions every question and in particular the metaphysical question, which is our question.
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We set out upon our pursuit of being, and it seemed to us that the series of our questions had led us to the heart of being. But behold, at the moment when we thought we were arriving at the goal, a glance cast on the question itself has revealed to us suddenly that we are encom-p.assed with nothingness. The permanent possibility of non-being, out-~lde us and within, conditions our questions about being. Furthermore It is non-being which is going to limit the reply. What being will be must of. necessity arise on the basis of what it is not. Whatever being is, it Will allow this formulation: "Being is that and outside of that, nothing." Thus a new component of the real has just appeared tous-non-being.

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Our problem is thereby complicated, for we may no longer limit our inquiry to the relations of the human being to being in-itself, but must include also the relations of being with non-being and the relations of human non-being with transcendent-being. But let us consider further.

II. NEGATIONS

SOMEONE will object that being-in-itself can not furnish negative replies. Did not we ourselves say that it was beyondaffinnation as beyond nega-tion? Furthennore ordinary experience reduced to itself does not seem to disclose any non-being to us. I think that there are fifteen hundred francs in my wallet, and I find only thirteen hundred; that does not mean, some-one will tell us, that experience had discovered for me the non-being of fifteen hundred francs but simply that I have counted thirteen hundred-franc notes. Negation proper (we are told) is unthinkable; it could appear only on the level of an act of judgment by which I should establish a comparison between the result anticipated and the result obtained. Thus negation would be simply a quality of judgment and the expectation of the questioner would be an expectation of the judgment-response. As for Nothingness, this would derive its origin from negative judgments; it would be a concept establishing the transcendent unity of all these judg-ments, a propositional function of the type, "X is not."
We see where this theory is leading; its proponents would make us conclude that being-in-itself is full positivity and does not contain in itself any negation. This negative judgment, on the other hand, by virtue of be-ing a sabjective act, is strictly identified with the affirmative judgment. They can not see that Kant, for example, has distinguished in its internal texture the negative act of judgment from the affirmative act. In each case a synthesis of concepts is operative; that synthesis, which is a con-cret

e and full event of psychic life, is operative here merely in the manner of the copula "is" and there in the manner of the copula "is not."
In the same way the manual operation of sorting out (separation) and the manual ::>peration of assembling (union) are two objective conducts which possess the same reality of fact. Thus negation would be "at the end" of the act of judgment without, however, being "in" being. It is like an unreal encompassed by two full realities neither of which claims it; being-in-itself, if questioned about negation, refers to judgment, since being is only what it is-and judgment, a whol1y psychic positivity, refers to being since judgment formulates a negation which concerns being and which consequently is transcendent. Negation, the result of concrete psychic operations, is supported in existence by these very operations and is incapable of existing by itself; it has the existence of a noema-correlate; its esse resides exactly in its percipi. Nothingness, the conceptual unity

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of negative judgments, can not have the slightest trace of reality, save that which the Stoics confer on their "lecton."l Can we accept this concept?
The question can be put in these terms: Is negation as the structure of the judicative proposition at the origin of nothingness? Or on the contrary is nothingness as the structure of the real, the origin and foundation of negation? Thus the problem of being had referred us first to that of the question as a human attitude, and the problem .of the question now refers us to that of the being of negation.
It is evident that non-being always appears within the limits of a human expectation. It is because I expect to find fifteen hundred francs that I find only thirteen hundred. It is because a physicist expects a certain verification of his hypothesis that nature can tell him no. It would be in vain to deny that negation appears on the original basis of a relation of man to the world. The world does not disclose its non-beings to one who has not first posited them as possibilities. But is this to say that these non-beings are to be reduced to pure subjectivity? Does this mean to say that we ought to give them the importance and the type of existence of the Stoic "lecton," of Husserl's nocma? We think not.
First it is not true that negation is only a quality of judgment. The question is formulated by an interrogative judgment, but it is not itself a judgment; it is. a pre-judicative attitude. I can question by a look, by a gesture. In posing a question I stand facing being in a certain way and this relation to being is a relation of being; the judgment is only one optional expression of it. At the same time it is not necessarily a person whom the questioner questions about being; this conception of the question by making of it an intersubjective phenomenon, detaches it from the being to which it adheres and leaves it in the air as pure modality of dialogue. On the contrary, we musCconsider the question in dialogue to be only a particular species of the genus "question;" the being in question is not necessarily a thinking being. If my car breaks down, it is the carburetor, the spark plugs, etc., that I question. If my watch stops, I can question the watchmaker about the cause of the stopping, but it is the various mechanisms of the watch that the watchmaker will in turn question. What I expect

from the carburetor, what the watchmaker ex-
pects from the works of the watch, is not a judgment; it is a disclosure
of b ·'ing on the basis of which we can make a judgment. And if I expect
a disclosure of being, I am prepared at the same time for the eventu-
8.lity of a disclosure of a non-being. If I question the carburetor, it is
because I consider it possible that "there is nothing there" in the car·
buretor. Thus my question by its nature envelops a ccrtain pre-judicative
comprehension of non-being; it is in itself a relation of being with non-
1 An abstraction or something with purely nominal existence-like space or time. Tr.

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being, on the basis of the original transcendence; that is, in a relation of
being with being.
Moreover if the propel nature of the question is obscured by the fact
that questions are frequently put by one man to other men, it should be
pointed out here that there are numerous non-judicative conducts which
present this immediate comprehension of non-being on the basis of being
-in its original purity. If, for example, we consider destruction, we must
recognize that it is an activity which doubtless could utilize judgment
as an instrument but which can not be defined as uniquely or even pri.
marily judicative. "Destruction" presents the same structure as "the
question." In a sense, certainly, man is the only being by whom a de-
struction can be accomplished. A geological plication, a storm do not
destroy-or at least they do not destroy directly; they merely modify
the distribution of masses of beings. There is no less after the storm than
before. There is something else. Even this expression is improper, for to
posit otherness there must be a witness who can retain the past in
some manner and compare it to the present in the fornl of no longer.
In the absence of this witness, there is being before as after the storm-
that is all. If a cyclone can bring about the death of certain living beings,
this death will be destruction only if it is experienced as such. In order
for destruction to exist, there must be first a relation of man to being-
i.e., a transcendence; and within the limits of this relation, it is neces-
sary that man apprehend one being as destructible. This supposes a limit·
ing cutting into being by a being, which, as we saw in connection with
truth, is already a process of nihilation. The being under consideration is
tlwt and outside of that nothing. The gunner who has been assigned an
objective carefully points his gun in a certain direction excluding all
others. But even this would still be nothing unless the being of the gun-
ner's objective is revealed as fragile. And what is fragility if not a certain
probability of non-being for a given being under determined circum-
stances. A being is fragile if it carries in its being a definite possibilty of
nen-being. But once again it is through man that fragility comes into be-
ing, for the individualizing limitation which we mentioned earlier is the
condition of fragility; one being is fragile and not all being, for the latter is
beyond all possible destruction. Thus the relation of individualizing limi-
tation which man enters into with one being on the original basis of his;;
relation to being causes fragility to enter into this being as the appearance.
of a permanent possibility of non-being. But this is not all. In order ,for.
destructibility to exist, man

must determine himself 'in the face,tlffthis
possibility of non-being, either positively or negatively; he must,either
take the necessary measures to realize it (destruction proper) or, by a
negation of non-bcing, to maintain it always on the level of a simplp. possi-
bility (by preventive measures). Thus it is man who renders cities de-
structible, precisely because he posits them as fragile and.as precious and
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because he adopts a system of protective measures with regard to them.
It is because of this ensemble of measures that an earthquake or a vol-
canic eruption can destroy these cities or these human constructions.
The original meaning and aim of war are contained in the smallest
building of man. It is necessary then to recognize that destruction is an
essentially human thing and that it is man who destroys his cities through
the agency of earthquakes or directly, who destroys his ships through the
agency of cyclones or directly. But at the same time it is necessary to
acknowledge that destruc~<?n supposes a pre-judicative comprehension
of nothingness as such and a conduct in the face of nothingness. In addi-
tion destruction although coming into being through man, is an objective
tact and not a thought. Fragility has been impressed upon the very being
of this vase, and its destruction would be an irreversible absolute event
which I could only verify. There is a transphenomenality of non-being as
of being. The examination of "destruction" leads us then to the same
results as the examination of "the question."
But if we wish to· decide with certainty, we need only to consider an
example of a negative judgment and to ask ourselves whether it causes
non-being to appear at the heart of being or merely limits itself to deter-
mining a prior revelation. I have an appointment with Pierre at four
o'clock. I arrive at the cafe a quarter of an hour late. Pierre is always punc-
tual. Will he have waited for me? I look at the room, the patrons, and I say,
"He is not here." Is there an intuition of Pierre's absence, or does negation
indeed enter in only with judgment? At first sight it seems absurd to
speak here of intuition since to be exact there could not be an intuition
of nothing and since the absence of Pierre is this nothing. Popular con-
sciousness, however, bears witness to this intuition. Do we not say, for
example, "I suddenly saw that he was not there." Is this just a matter of
misplacing the negation? Let us look a little closer.
It is certain that the cafe by itself with its patrons, its tables, its booths,
its mirrors, its light, its smoky atmosphere, and the sounds of voices,
rattling saucers, and footsteps which fill it-the cafe is a fullness of being.
And all the intuitions of detail which I can have are filled by these odors,
these sounds, these colors, all phenomena which have a transphenomenal
being. Similarly Pierre's actual presence in a place which I do not know
is also a plenitude of being. We seem to have found fullness everywhere.
But we must observe that in perception there is always the construction
of a figure on a ground._No one object, no group of objects is especially
designed to be organized as specifically either ground or figure; all depends
0':1 the direction of my attention. When I enter this cafe to search for
PIerre, there is formed a synthetic organization of all the objects in the
caf~, on the ground of

which Pierre is given as about to appear. This organi-
zatIon of the cafe as the ground is an original nihilation. Each element of
the setting, a person, a table, a chair, attempts to isolate itself, to lift itself

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upon the ground constituted by the totality of the other objects, only to
fall back Once more into the undifferentiation of this ground; it melts into
the ground. For the ground is that which is seen only in addition, that
which is the object of a purely marginal attention. Thus the original
nihilation of all the figures which appear and are swallowed up in the total
neutrality of a ground is the necessary condition for the appearance of the
principle figure, which is here the person of Pierre. This nihilation is
given to my intuition; I am witness to the successive disappearance of all
the objects which I look at-in particular of the faces, which detain me
for an instant (Could this be Pierre?) and which as quickly decompose
precisely because they "are not" the face of Pierre. Nevertheless if I
should finally discover Pierre, my intuition would be filled by a solid
element, I should be suddenly arrested by his face and the whole cafe
would organize itself around him as a discrete presence.
But now Pierre is not here. This does not mean that I discover his
absence in some precise spot in the establishment. In fact Pierre is absent
from the whole cafe; his absence fixes the cafe in its evanescence; the
cafe remains ground; it persists in offering itself as an undifferentiated
totality to my only marginal attention; it slips into the background; it
pursues its nihilation. Only it makes itself ground for a determined figure;
it carries the figure everywhere in front of it, presents the figure every-
where to me. This figure which slips constantly between my look and
the solid, real objects of the cafe is precisely a perpetual disappearance;
it is Pierre raising himself as nothingness on the ground of the nihilation
of the cafe. So that what is offered to intuition is a flickering of nothing-
ness; it is the nothingness of the ground, the nihilation of which summons
and demands the appearance of the figure, and it is the figure-the noth-
ingness which slips as a nothing to the surface of the ground. It serves as
foundation for the judgment-"Pierre is not here." It is in fact the intui-
tive apprehension of a double nihilation. To be sure, Pierre's absence
supposes an original relation between me and this cafe; there is an infinity
of people who are without any relation with this cafe for want of a real
expectation which establishes their absence. But, to be exact, I myself
expected to see Pierre, and my expectation has caused the absence of
Pierre to happen as a real event concerning this cafe. It is an objective fact
at present that I have discovered this absence, and it presents itself as a
synthetic relation between Pierre and the setting in which I am looking
for him. Pierre absent haunts this cafe and is the condition of its self-
nihilating organization as ground. By contrast, judgments which I can
make subsequently to amuse myself, such as, "Wellington is not in this
cafe, Paul Valery is no longer here, etc."-these have a purely abstract
meaning; they are pure applications of the principle of negation without
real or efficacious foundation, and they never suc~eed in establishing a
real relation between the cafe and Welling

soon for us to hope to disengage the meaning of this nothingness, against which the question has suddenly thrown us. But there are several conclusions which we can formulate even now. In particular it would be worthwhile to determine the relations between being and that non-being' which haunts it. We have established a certain parallelism between the types of conduct man adopts in the face of being and those which he maintains in the face of Nothingness, and we are immediately tempted to consider being and non-being as two complementary components of the real-like dark and light. In short we would then be dealing with two strictly contemporary notions which would somehow be united in the production of existents and which it would be useless to consider in isolation. Pure being and pure non-being would be two abstractions which could be reunited only on the basis of concrete realities. Such is certainly the point of view of Hegel. It is in the Logic in fact that he studies the relations of Being and Non-Being, and he calls the Logic "The system of the pure determinations of thought." He defines more fully by saying. "Thoughts as they are ordinarily represented, are not pure thoughts, for by a being which is thought, we understand a being of which the content is an empirical content. In logic thoughts are apprehended in such a way that they have no other content than the content of pure thought, which content is engendered by it."2 To be sure, these determinations are "what is deepest in things but at the same time when one considers them "in and for themselves," one deduces them from thought itself and discovers in them their truth. However the effort of Hegelian logic is to "make clear the inadequacy of the notions (which it) considers one by one and the necessity, in order to understand them, of raising each to a more complete notion which surpasses them while integrating thcm."3

One can apply to Hegel what Le Senne said of the philosophy of Hamelin: "Each of the lower terms depends on the higher term, as the abstract on the concrete which is necessary for it to realize itself." The true concrete for Hegel is the Existent with its essence; it is the Totality produced by the synthetic integration of all the abstract moments which are surpassed in it by requiring their complement. In this sense Being will be the most abstract of abstractions and the poorest, if we consider it in itself-that is, by separating it from its surpassing toward Essence.

2 Introduction v. P. c. 2.cd. E~xxiv quoted by Lefebvre: Morceaux choisis.

8 Laporte: Le Probleme de I'Abstraction, p. 2.5 (Presses Universitaircs, 1940).

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mE ORIGIN OF NEGATION

In fact "Being is rehited to Essence as the immediate to the mediate. Things in general 'are,' but their being consists in manifesting their essence. Being passes into Essence. One can express this by saying, 'Being presupposes Essence.' Although Essence appears in relation to Being as mediated, Essence is nevertheless the true origin. Being returns to its ground; Being is surpassed in Essence."4

Thus Being cut from Essence which is its ground becomes "mere empty immediacy." This is how the Phenomenology of Mind defines it by presenting pure Being "from the point of view of truth" as the immediate. If the beginning of logic is to be the immediate, we shall then find beginning in Being, which is "the indetermination which pr

ecedes all
determination, the undetermined as the absolute point of departure."
But Being thus undetermined immediately "passes into" its opposite.
"This pure Being," writes Hegel in Logic (of the Encyclopaedia) is "pure abstraction and consequently absolute negation, which taken in its immediate moment is also non-being." Is Nothingness not in fact simple identity with itself, complete emptiness, absence of determinations and of content? Pure being and pure nothingness are then the same thing. Or rather it is true to say that they are different; but "as here the difference is not yet a determined difference-for being and non-being (;Onstitute the immediate moment such as it is in them-this difference can not be named; it is only a pure opinion."11 This means concretely that "there is nothing in heaven or on earth which does not contain in itself being and nothingness."6
It is still too soon for us to discuss the Hegelian concept itself; we need all the results of our study in order to take a position regarding this. It is appropriate here to observe only that being is reduced by Hegel to a signification of the existent. Being is enveloped by essence, which is its foundation and origin. Hegel's whole theory is based on the idea that a philosophical procedure is necessary in order at the outset of logic to rediscover the immediate in terms of the mediated, the abstract in terms of the concrete on which it is grounded. But we have already remarked that being does not hold the same relation to the phenomenon as the abstract holds to the concrete. Being is not one "structure among others," one moment of the object; it is the very condition of all structures and of all moments. It is the ground on which the characteristics of the phenomenon will manifest themselves. Similarly it is not admissible that the being of !hings "consists in manifesting their essence." For then a being of that bemg would be necessary. FU,rthermore if the being of things "consisted" in
4 Treatise on Logic, written/by Hegel between 1808 and 1811, to serve as the basis for his course at the gymnasium at Nuremberg.
II Hegel: P.c.-E.988
6 Hegel: Greater Logic, chap. 1.

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manifesting their essence, it would be hard to see how Hegel could determine a pure moment of Being where we could not find atleast a trace of that original structure. It is true that the understanding determines pure being, isolates and fixes it in its very determinations. But if surpassing toward essence constitutes the original character of being, and if the understanding is limited to "determining and persevering in the determinations:' we can not see precisely how it does not determine being as "consisting in manifesting."
It might be said in defense of Hegel that every determination is negation. But the understanding in this senSe is limited to denying that its object is other than it is. That is sufficient doubtless to prevent all dialectical process, but not enough to effect its disappearance at the threshold of its surpassing. In so far as being surpasses itself toward something else, it is not subject to the determinations of the understanding. But in so far as it surpasses itself-that is, in so far as it is in its very depths the origin of its own surpassing-being must on the contrary appear such as it is to the understanding which fixes it in its own determinations. To affirm t

hat being is only what it is would be at least to leave being intact so far as it is its own surpassing. We see here the ambiguity of the Hegelian notion of "surpassing" which sometimes appears to be an upsurge from the inmost depth of the being considered and at other times an external movement by which this being is involved. It is not enough to affirm that the understanding finds in being only what it is; we must also explain how being, which is what it is, can be only that. Such an explanation would derive its legitimacy from the consideration of the phenomenon of being as such and not from the negating processes of the understanding. But what needs examination here is especially Hegel's statement that being and nothingness constitute two opposites, the difference between which on the level of abstraction under consideration is only a simple "opinion."

To oppose being to nothingness as thesis and antithesis, as Hegel does, is to suppose that they are logically contemporary. Thus simultaneously two opposites arise as the two limiting terms of a logical series. Here we must note carefully that opposites alone can enjoy this simultaneity because they are equally positive (or equally negative). But non-being is not the opposite of being; it is its contradiction. This implies that logically nothingness is subsequent to being since it is being, first posited, then denied. It can not be therefore that being and non-being are concepts with the same content since on the contrary non-being supposes a irreducible mental act. Whatever may be the original undifferentiation of being, non-being is that same undifferentiation denied. This permits Hegel to make being pass into nothingness; this is what by implication has introduced negation into his very definition of being. This is self evident since any definition is negative, since Hegel has told us, making use of a state-
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ment of Spinoza's, that omnis determinatio est negatio. And does he not write, "It does not matter what the determination or content is which would distinguish being from something else; whatever would give it a content would prevent it from maintaining itself in its purity. It is pure indetermination and emptiness. Nothing can be apprehended in it."

Thus anyone who introduces negation into being from outside will discover subsequently that he makes it pass into non-being. B~t here we have a play on words involving the very idea of negation. For if I refuse to allow being any determination or content, I am nevertheless forced to affirm at least that it is. Thus, let anyone deny being whatever he wishes, he can not cause it not to be, thanks to the very fact that he denies that it is this or that. Negation can not touch the nucleus of being of Being, which is absolute plenitude and entire positivity. By contrast Non-being is a negation which aims at this nucleus of absolute density. Non-being is denied at the heart of Being. When Hegel writ-es, "(Being and nothingness) are empty abstractions, and the one is as empty as the other,"7 he forgets that emptiness is emptiness of something.s Being is empty of all other determination than identity witfritself, but non-being is empty of being. In a word, we must recall here against Hegel that being is and that nothingness is not.

Thus even though being can not be the support of any differentiated quality, nothingness is logicall

y subsequent to it since it supposes being in
order to deny it, since the irreducible quality of the not comes to add
itself to that undifferentiated mass of being in order to release it. That
does not mean only that we should refuse to put being and non-being
on the same plane, but also that we must be careful never to posit
nothingness as an original abyss from which being arose. The use which
we make of the notion of nothingness in its familiar form always supposes
a preliminary specification of being. It is striking in this connection that
language furnishes us with a nothingness of things and a nothingness of
human beings.1I But the specification is still more obvious in the majority
of instances. We say, pointing to a particular collection of objects, "Touch
nothing," which means, very precisely, nothing of that collection. Simi-
larly, if we question someone on well determined events in his private or
public life, he may reply, "I know nothing." And this nothing includes
the totality of the facts on which we questioned him. Even Socrates
with his famous statement, "I know that I know nothing," designates
by this nothing the totality of being considered as Truth.
7 P. c. 1 ed. E.~Lxxxvii.
8 It is so much the more strange in that Hegel is the first to have noted that "every
negation is a determined negation"; that is, it depends on a content.
liNe ?.. rien = "nothing" as opposed to ne ... personne = "nobody," which
are equally fundamental negative expressions. Sartre here conveniently has based his
ontology on the exigencies of a purely French syntax. Tr.

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If adopting for the moment the point of view of naive cosmogonies,
we tried to ask ourselves what "was there" before a world existed, and if
we replied "nothing," we would be forced to recognize that this "before"
like this "nothing" is in effect retroactive. What we deny today, we who
are established in being, is what there was of being before this being. Ne-
gation here springs from a consciousness which is turned back toward the
beginning, If we remove from this original emptiness its characteristic
of being empty of this world and of every whole taking the form of a
world, as well as its characteristic of before, which presupposes an after,
then the very negation disappears, giving way to a total indetermination
which it would be impossible to conceive, even and especially as a nothing-
ness. Thus reversing the statement of Spinoza, we could say that every
negation is determination. This means that being is prior to nothingness
and establishes the ground for it. By this we must understand not only
that being has a logical precedence over nothingness but also that it is
froIP being that nothingness derives concretely its efficacy. This is what we
mean when we say that nothingness haunts being. That means that
being has no need of nothingness in order to be conceived and that we
can examine the idea of it exhaustively without finding there the least
trace of nothingness. But on the other hand, nothingness, which is not,
can have only a borrowed existence, and it gets its being from being. Its
nothingness of being is encountered only within the limits of being,
and the total disappearance of being would not be the advent of the
reign of non-being, but on the contrary the concomitant disappeanm~eof
nothingness. Non-being exists only on the surface of being.
IV. THE PHENOMENOLOGICAL C

ONCEPT OF
NOTHINGNESS
THERE is another possible way of conceiving being and nothingness as complements. One could view them as two equally necessary components of the real without making being "pass into" nothingness·-as Hegel does- and without insisting on the posteriority of nothingness as we attempted to do. We might On the contrary emphasize the reciprocal forces of repulsion which being and non-being exercise On each other, the real in some way bdng the tension resulting from these antagonistic forces. It is toward this new conception that Heidegger is oriented.10
We need not look far to see the progress which Heidegger's theory of nothingness has made over that of Hegel. First, being and non-being are no longer empty abstIactions. Heidegger in his most important work
10 Heidegger: Qu'est-ce que la metaphysique (Tr. by Corbin, N.R.F. 1938). In English "What is Metaphysics?" Tr. by R.F.C. Hull and Alan Crick. From ExisteIlce and Being, ed. by Werner Brock, Henry Regnery. 1949.
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has shown the legitimacy of raising the question concerning being; the latter has no longer the character of a Scholastic universal, which it still retained with Hegel. There is a meaning of being which must be elarified; there is a "pre-ontological comprehension" of being which is involved in every kind of conduct belonging to "human reality"-i.e., in each of its projects. SiIPilarly difficulties which customarily arise as soon as a philosopher touches on the problem of Nothingness are shown to be with·, out foundation; they are important in so far as they limit the function of the understanding, and they show simply that this problem is not within the province of the understanding. There exist on the other hand numerous attitudes of "human reality" which imply a "comprehension" of nothingness: hate, prohibitions, regret, etc. For "Dasein" there is even a permanent possibility of finding oneself "face to face" with nothingness and discovering it as a phenomenon: this possibility is anguish. Heidegger, while establishing the possibilities of a concrete apprehension of Nothingness, never falls into the error which Hegel made; he does not preserve a being for Non-Being, not even an abstract being. Nothing is not; it nihilates itself.ll It is supported and conditioned by transcendence. We know that for Heidegger the being of human reality is defined as "being-in-the-world:' The world is a synthetic complex of instrumental realities inasmuch as they point one to another in ever widening circles, and inasmuch as man makes himself known in terms of this complex which he is. This means both that."human reality" springs forth invested with being and "finds itself" (sich befinden) in being-and also that human reality causes being, which surrounds it, to be disposed around human reality in the form of the world.
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But human reality can make being appear as organized totality in the world only by surpassing being. All determination for Heidegger is surpassing since it supposes a withdrawal taken from a particular point of view. This passing beyond the world, which is a condition of the very rising up pf the. world' as such, is effected by the Dasein which directs tht:'surpassing towarditself. The characteristic of selfness (Selbstheit) , irifact, is:that.'man is always separated from what he is by all the breadth of the being which he is not. He makes hims

elf known to himself from
the other sideofthe world and he looks from the horizon toward himself
to recover his inner being. Man is "a being of distances:' In the movement
of turning inward which traverses all of being, being arises :md organizes
itselfas the world without there being either priority of the movement
over the world, or the world over the movement. But this appearance of

11 Heidegger uses the by now famous expression "Vas Nicllts nichtei" or "Nothing nothings." I think "nihilate", is a closer equivalent to Sartre's neantise than "annihilate" because the fundamental meaning of the term is "to make nothing" rather than "to destroy or do away with." Nichtet, neantise, and nihilate are all, of course, equally without foundation in the dictionaries of the respective languages. Tr.

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the self beyond the world-that is, beyond the totality of the real-is' an
emergence of "human reality" in nothingness. It is in nothingness alone
that being can be surpassed. At the same time it is from the point of view
of beyond the world that being is organized into the world, which means
on the one hand that human reality rises up as ~n emergence of being
in non-being and on the other hand that the world is "suspended" in
nothingness. Anguish is the discovery of this double, perpetual nihila-
tion. It is in terms of this surpassing of the world that Dasein manages
to realize the contingency of the world; that is, to raise the question, "How
does it happen that there is something rather than nothing?" Thus the
contingency of the world appears to human reality in so far as human
reality has established itself in nothingness in order to apprehend the
contingency.

Here then is nothingness surrounding being on every side and at the
same time expelled frora being. Here nothingness is given as that by which
the world receives its outlines as the world. Can this solution satisfy us?
Certainly it can not be denied that the apprehension of the world qua
world, is a nihilation. From the moment the world appears qua world
it gives itself as being only tllat. The necessary counterpart of this ap-
prehension then is indeed the emergence of "human reality" in nothing-
ness. But where does "human reality" get its power of emerging thus in
non-being? Without a doubt Heidegger is right in insisting on the fact
that negation derives its foundation from nothingness. But if nothingness
provides a ground for negation, it is because nothingness envelops the not
within itself as its essential structure. In other words, it is not as undiffer-
entiated emptiness or as a disguised otherness12 that nothingness provides
the ground for negation. Nothingness stands at the origin of the negative
judgment because it is itself negation. It founds the negation as an act
because it is the negation as being. Nothingness can be nothingness only
by nihilating itself expressly as nothingness of the world; that is, in its
nihilation it must direct itself expressly toward this world in order to
constitute itself as refusal of the world. Nothingness carries being in its
heart. But how does the emergence account for this nihilating refusal?
Transcendence, which is "the pro-ject of self beyond," is far from being
able to establish nothingness; on the contrary, it is nothingness which is
at the very heart of transcendence and which conditions it.

Now the characteristic of Heidegger's philosophy

is to describe Dasein
by using positive terms which hide the implicit negations. Dasein is "outside of itself, in the world"; it is "a being of distances"; it is care; it is "its own possibilities," etc. All this amounts to saying that Dasein "is not" in itself, that it "is not" in immediate proximity to itself, and that it "surpasses" the world inasmuch as it posits itself as not being in itself and as not being the world. In this sense Hegel is right rather than Heidegger when he states that Mind is the negative. Actually we can put to each of them the same question, phrased slightly differently. We should say to Hegel: "It is not sufficient to posit mind as mediation and the negative; it is necessary to demonstrate negativity as the structure of being of mind. \Vhat must mind be in order to be able to constitute itself as negative?" And we can ask the same question of Heidegger in these words: "If negation is the original structure of transcendence, what must be the original structure of 'human reality' in order for it to be able to transcend the world?" In both cases we are shown a negating activity and there is no concern to ground this activity upon a negative being. Heidegger in addition makes of Nothingness a sort of intentional correlate of transcendence, without seeing that he has already inserted it into transcendence itself as its original structure.

Furthermore what is the use of affirming that Nothingness provides the ground for negation, if it is merely to enable us to form subsequently a theory of non-being which by definition separates Nothingness from all conerete negation? If I emerge in nothingness beyond the world, how can this extra-mundane nothingness furnish a foundation for those little pools of non-being which we encounter each instant in the depth of being. I say, "Pierre is not there," "I have no more money," etc. Is it really necessary to surpass the world toward nothingness and to return subsequently to being in order to provide a ground for these everyday judgments? And how can the operation be affected? To accomplish it we are not required to make the world slip into nothingness; standing within the limits of being, we simply deny an attribute to a subject. Will someone say that each attribute refused, each being denied is taken up by one and the same extra-mundane nothingness, that non-being is like the fullness of what is not, that the world is suspended in non-being as the real is suspended in the heart of possibilities? In this case each negation would necessarily have for origin a particular surpassing: the surpassing of one being toward another. But what is this surpassing, if not simply the Hegelian mediation-and have we not already and in vain sought in Hegel the nihilating ground of the mediation? Furthermore even if the explanation is valid for the simple, radical negations which deny to a determined object any kind of presence in the depth of being (e.g. Centaurs do not exist"-"There is no reason for him to be late"- "The ancient Greeks did not practice polygamy"), negations which, if need be, can contribute to constituting Nothingness as a sort of geometrical place for unfulfilled projects, all inexact representations, all vanished beings or those of which the idea is only a fiction-even so this interpretation of non-being would no l

12 Wh2t Hegel would call "immediate otherness."

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onger be valid for a certain kind of reality which is in truth the most frequent: namely, those negations which include non-being in their being. How can we hold that these are at once partly within the universe and partly outside in extra-mundane nothingness?

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Take for example the notion of distance, which conditions the determination of a location, the localization of a point. It is easy to see that it possesses a negative moment. Two points are distant when they are separated by a certain length. The length, a positive attribute of a segment of a straight line, intervenes here by virtue of the negation of an absolute, undifferentiated proximity, Someone might perhaps seek to reduce distance to being onJy the length of the segment of which the two points considered, A and B, would be the limits. But does he not see that he has changed the direction of attention in this case and that he has, under cover of the same word, given another object to intuition? The organized complex which is constituted by the segment with its two limiting terms can furnish actually two different objects to knowledge. We can in fact give the segment as immediate object of intuition, in which case this segment represents a full, concrete tension, of which the length is a positive attribute and the two points A and B appear only as a moment of the whole; that is, as they are implicated by the segment itself as its limits. Then the negation, expelled from the segment and its length, takes refuge in the two Jimits: to say that point B is a limit of the segment is to say that the segment does not extend beyond this point. Negation is here a secondary structure of the object. If, on the other hand, we direct our attention to the two points A and B, they arise as immediate objects of intuition on the ground of space. The segment disappears as a full, concrete object; it is apprehended in terms of two points as the emptiness, the negativity which separates them. Negation is not subject to the points, which cease to be Jimits in order to impregnate the very length of the segment with distance. Thus the total form consituted by the segment and its two limits with its inner structure of negation is capable of letting itself be apprehended in two ways. Rather there are two forms, and the condition of the appearance of the one is the disintegration of the other, exactly as in perception we constitute a particular object as a figure by rejecting another so as to make of it a ground, and conversely. In both instances we find the same quantity of negation which at one time passes into the notion of limits and at another into the notion of distance, but which in each case can not be suppressed. Will SOmeone object that the idea of distance is psychological and that it designates only the extension which must be cleared in order to go from point A to point B.? We shall reply that the same negation is included in this to clear since this notion expresses precisely the passive resistance of the remoteness. We will willingly admit with Heidegger that "human reality" is "remote-from-itself;" that is, that it rises in the world as that which creates distances and at the same time causes them to be removed (entfemend). But this remoteness-from-self, even if it is the necessary condition in order that there may be remoteness in general, envelops remoteness in itself as the negat

eived neither outside of being,
nor as a complementary, abstract notion, nor as an infinite milieu where being is suspended. Nothingness must be given at the heart of Being, in order for us to be able to apprehend that particular type of realities which we have called negatites. But this intra-mundane Nothingness cannot be produced by Being-in-itself; the notion of Being as full positivity does not contain Nothingness as one of its structures. We can not even say that Being excludes it. Being lacks all relation with it. Hence the question which is put to us now with a particular urgency: if Nothingness can be conceived neither outside of Being, nor in terms of Being, and if on the other hand, since it is non-being, it can not derive from itself the necessary force to "nihilate itself," where does Nothiflgness come hom?

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If we wish to pursue the problem further, we must first recognize that we can not grant to nothingness the property of "nihilating itself." For although the expression "to nihilate itself" is thought of as removing from nothingness the last semblance of being, we must recognize that only Being can nihilate itself; however it comes about, in order to nihilate itself, it must be. But Nothingness is not. If we can speak of it, it is only because it possesses an appearance of being, a borrowed being, as we have noted above. Nothingness is not, Nothingness "is made-to-be,"14 Nothingness does not nihilate itself; Nothingness "is nihilated." It follows therefore that there must exist a Being (this can not be the In-itself) of which the property is to nihilate Nothingness, to support it in its being, to sustain it perpetually in its very existence, a being by which nothingness comes to things. But how can this Being be related to Nothingness so that through it Nothingness comes to things? We must observe first that the being postulated can not be passive in relation to Nothingness, can not receive it; Nothingness could not come to this being except through another Being-which would be an infinite regress. But on the other hanel, the Being by which Nothingness comes to the world can not produce Nothingness while remaining indifferent to that production-like the Stoic cause which produces its effect without being itself changed.

14 The French is est ctc, which literally means "is been," an expression as meaningless in ordinary French as in English. Maurice Natanson suggests "is-was." (A Critique of lean-Paul Sartre's Ontology. University of Nebraska Studies. March 1951. p. 59,) I prefer "is made-to-be" because Sartre seems to be using ~tre as a transitive verb, here in the passive voice, tllUs suggesting that nothingness has been subjected to an act involving being. Other passages containing this expression will, I believe, bear out this interpretation. Te.

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It would be inconceivable that a Being which is full positivity should maintain and create outside itself a Nothingness or transcendent b~ing, for there would be nothing in Being by which Being could surpass itself toward Non-Being. The Being by which Nothingness arrives in the world must nihilate Nothingness in its Being, and even so it still runS the risk of establishing Nothingness as a transcendent in the very heart of immanence unless it nihilates Nothingness in its being in connection with its own being. The Being by which Nothingness arrives in the world is

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being such that in its Being, the Nothingness of its Being is in question. The being by which Nothingness comes to the world must be its own Nothingness. By this we must understand riot a nihilating act, which would require in turn a foundation in Being, but an ontological characteristic of the Being required. It remains to learn in what delicate, exquisite region of Being we shall encounter that Being which is its own Nothingness.

We shall be helped in our inquiry by a more complete examination of the conduct which served us as a point of departure. We must return to the question. We have seen, it may be recalled, that every question in essence posits the possibility of a negative reply. In a question we question a being about its being or its way of being. This way of being or this being is veiled; there always remains the possibility that it may unveil itself as a Nothingness. But from the very fact that we prcsume that an Existent can always be revealed as nothing, every question supposes that we realize a nihilating withdrawal in relation to the given, which becomes a simple presentation, fluctuating between being and Nothingness.

It is essential therefore that the questioner have the permanent possibility of dissociating himself from the causal series which constitutes being and which can produce only being. If we admitted that the question is determined in the questioner by universal determinism, the question would thereby become unintelligible and even inconceivable. A real cause, in fact, produces a real effect and the caused being is wholly engaged by the cause in positivity; to the extent that its being depends on the cause, it can not have within itself the tiniest germ of nothingness. Thus in so far as the questioner must be able to effect in relation to the questioned a kind of nihilating withdrawal, he is not subject to the causal order of the world; he detaches himself from Being. This means that by a double movement of nihilation, he nihilates the thing questioned in relation to himself by placing it in a neutral state, between being and non-being-and that he, nihilates himself in relation to the thing questioned by wrenching himself from being in order to be able to bting out of himself the possibility of a non-being. Thus in posing a question, a certain negative element is introduced into the world. We see nothingness making the world irridescent, casting a shimmer over things. But at the same time the question emanates from a questioner who in order to motivate

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himself in his being as one who questions, disengages himself from being. This disengagement is then by definition a human process. Man presents himself at least in this instance as a being who causes Nothingness to arise in the world, inasmuch as he himself is affected with non-being to this end.

TI,ese remarks may serve as guiding thread as we examine the negatites of which we spoke earlier. TIlere is no doubt at all that these are transcendent realities; distance, for example, is imposed on us as something which we have to take into account, which must be cleared with effort. However these realities are of a very peculiar nature; they all indicate immediately an essential relation of human reality to the world. They derive their origin from an act, an expectation, or a project of the human being; they all indicate an aspect of

being as it appears to the human being
who is engaged in the world. TIle relations of man in the world, which the negatites indicate, have nothing in common with the relations aposteriori which are brought out by empirical activity. We are no longer dealing with those relations ot instrumentality by which, according to Heidegger, objects in the world disclose themselves to "human reality." Every negatite appears rather as one of the essential conditions of this relation of instrumentality. In order for the totality of being to order itself around us as instruments, in order for it to parcel itself into differentiated complexes which refer one to another and which can be used, it is necessary that negation rise up not as a thing among other things but as the rubric of a category which presides over the arrangement and the redistribution of great masses of being in things. Thus the rise of man in the midst of the being which "invests" him causes a world to be discovered. But the essential and primordial moment of this rise is the negation. Thus we have reached the first goal of this study. Man is the being through whom nothingness comes to the world. But this question immediately provokes another: What must man be in his being in order that thro1lgh him nothingness may come to being?
Being can generate only being and if man is inclosed in this process of generation, only being will come out of him. If we arc to assume that man is able to question this process-i.e., to make it the object of interrogation-he must be able/to hold it up to view as a totality. He must be able to put himself outside ot being and by the same stroke weaken the structure of the being of being. Yet it is not given to "human reality" to annihilate even provisionally the mass of being which it posits before itself. Man's relation with being is that he can modify it. For man to put a particular existent out of circuit is to put himself out of circuit in relation to that existent. In this case he is not subject to it; he is out of reach; it can not act on him, for he has retired beyond a nothingness. Descartes following the Stoics has given a name to this possibility which human reality has to secrete a nothingness which isolates it-it is tree-
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dom. But freedom here is only a name. If we wish to penetrate further into the question, we must not be content with this reply and we ought to ask now, What is human freedom if through it nothingness comes into the world?
It is not yet possible to deal with the problem of freedom in all its fullness.u In fact the steps which we have completed up to nOw show clearly that freedom is not a faculty of the human soul to be envisaged and described in isolation. \\'hat we have been trying to define is the being of man in so far as he conditions the appearance of nothingness, and this being has appeared to us as freedom. Thus freedom as the requisite condition for the nihilation of nothingness is not a property which belongs among others to the essence of the human being. We have already noticed furthermore that with man the relation of existence to essence is not comparable to what it is for the things of the world. Human freedom precedes essence in man and makes it possible; the essence of the human being is suspended in his freedom. What we call freedom is impossible to distinguish from the being of "human reality." Man doe

s not exist first
in order to be free subsequently; there is no difference between the being of man and his being-free. This is not the time to make a frontal attack on a question which can be treated exhaustively only in the light of a rigorous elucidation of the human being. Here we are dealing with freedom in connection with the problem of nothingness and only to the extent that it conditions the appearance of nothingness.
What first appears evident is that human reality can detach itself from the world-in questioning, in systematic doubt, in sceptical doubt, in the E7l'OXiJ , etc.-only if by nature it has the possibility of self-detachment. This was seen by Descartes, who is establishing doubt on freedom when he claims for ,liS the possibility of suspending our judgments. Alain's position is similar. It is also in this sense that Hegel asserts the freedom of the mind to the degree that mind is mediation-i.e., the Negative. Furthermore it is one of the trends of contemporary philosophy to see in human consciousness a sort of escape from the self; such is the meaning of the transcendence of Hcidegger. The intentionality of Husserl and of Brentano has also to a large extent the characteristic of a detachment from self. But we are not yet in a position to consider freedom as an inner structure of consciousness. We lack for the moment both instruments and technique to permit us to succeed in that enterprise. What interests us at present is a temporal operation since questioning is, like doubt, a kind of behavior; it assumes that the human being reposes first in the depths of being and then detaches himself from it by a nihilating withdrawal. Thus we are envisaging the condition of the nihilation as a relation to the self in the heart of a temporal process. We wish simply to show that by identifying consciousness with a causal sequence indefi-
III Cf. Part IV, chap. I.

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nitely continued, one transmutes it into a plenitude of being and thereby causes it to return into the unlimited totality of being-as is well illustrated by the futility of the efforts to dissociate psychological determinism from universal determinism and to constitute it as a separate series. The room of someone absent, the books of which he turned the pages. the objects which he touched are in themselves only books, objects; i.e.? full actualities. The very traces which he has left can be deciphered as traces of him only within a situation where he has been already posited as absent. The dog-eared book with the well-read pages is not by itself a book of which Pierre has turned the pages. of which he no longer turns the pages. If we consider it as the present. transcendent motivation of my perception or even as the synthetic flux. regulated by my sensible impressions, then it is merely a volume with turned down. worn pages; it can refer only to itself or to present objects, to the lamp which illuminates it, to the table which holds it. It would be useless to invoke an association by contiguity as Plato does in the Phaedo, where he makes the image of the absent one appear on the margin of the perception of the lyre or of the cithara which he has touched. This image, if we consider it in itself and in the spirit of classical theories, is a definite plenitude; it is a concrete and positive psychic fact. Consequently we must of necessity pass on it a doubly negative judg

ment: subjectively. to signify that the
image is not a perception; objcctively. to deny that the Pierre, of whom
I form the image is here at this moment.
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This is the famous problem of the characteristics of the true,image.
which has concerned so many psychologists from Taine to Spaier. Associa-
tion, we see. docs not solve the problem; it pushes it back to the level
of reflection. But in every way it demands a negation; that is. at the very
least, a nihilating withdrawal of consciousness in relation to the image
apprehended as subjective phenomenon, in order to posit it precisely
as being only a subjective phenomenon.
Now I have attempted to show elsewhere18 that if we posit the image
first as a renascent perception, it is radically impossible to distinguish it
subsequently from actual perceptions. The image must enclose in its
very structure a nihilating thesis. It constitutes itself qua image while
positing its object as existing elsewl1ere or not existing. It carries within
it a double negation; first it is the nihiJation of the world (since the
world is not offering the imagined object as an actual object of percep-
tion). secondly the nihilation of the object of the image (it is posited as
not actual). and finally by the same stroke it is the nihilation of itself (since
it is not a concrete. full psychic process.) In explaining how I apprehend
the absence of Pierre in the room. it would be useless to invoke those
famous "empty intentions" of Husserl, which are in great part consti-
tutive of perception. Among the various perceptive intentions. indeed.
18 L'imagination. Alcan. 1936.
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there are relations of motivation (but motivation is not causation), and
among these intentions, some are full (i.e., filled with what they aim at)
and others empty. But precisely because the matter which should fill the
empty intentions does not exist, it can not be this which motivates them
in their structure. And since the other intentions are full, neither can
they motivate the empty intentions inasmuch as the latter are empty.
Moreover these intentions are of psychic nature and it would be an error
to envisage them in the mode of things; that ,is, as recipients which
would first be given, which according to circumstances could be emptied
or filled, and which would be by nature indifferent to their state of being
empty or filled. It seems that Husserl has not always escaped the materi-
alist illusion. To be empty an intention must be conscious of itself as
empty and precisely as empty of the exact matter at which it aims. An
empty intention constitutes itself as empty to the exact extent that it
posits its matter as non-existing or absent. In short an empty intention
is a consciousness of negation which transcends itself toward an object
which it posits as absent or non-existent.
Thus whatever may be the explanation which we give of it, Pierre's
absence, in order to be established or realized, requires a negative moment
by which consciousness in the absence of all prior determination, consti-
tutes itself as negation. If in terms of my perceptions of the room, I
conceive of the former inhabitant who is no longer in the room, I am of
necessity forced to produce an act of thought which no prior state can
determine nor motivate, in short to effect in myself a break with being.
And in so far as I continually use negatites to isolate and determin

negation as being. It is necessary then that conscious being constitute itself in relation to its past as separated from this past by a nothingness. It must necessarily be conscious of this cleavage in being, but not as a phenomenon which it experiences, rather as a structure of consciousness which it is. Freedom is the human being putting his past out of play by secreting his own nothingness. Let us understand indeed that this original necessity of being its own nothingness does not belong to consciousness intermittently and on the occasion of particular negations. This does not happen just at a particular moment in psychic life when negative or interrogative attitudes appear; consciousness continually experiences itself as the nihilation of its past being.

But someone doubtless will believe that he can use against us here an objection which we have frequently raised ourselves: if the nihilating consciousness exists only as consciousness of nihilation, we ought to be

17 See Introduction: III.

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able to define and describe a constant mode of consciousness, present qua consciousness, which would be consciousness of nihilation.

Does this consciousness exist? Behold a new question has been raised here: if freedom is the being of consciousness, consciousness ought to exist a consciousness of freedom. What form does this consciousness of freedom assume? In freedom the human being is his own past (as also his own future) in the form of nihilation. Ifour analysis has not led us astray, there ought to exist for the human being, in so far as he is conscious of being, a certain mode Of standing opposite his past and his future, as being both this past and this future and as not being them. We shall be able to furnish an immediate reply to this question; it is in anguish that man gets the consciousness of his freedom, or if you prefer, anguish is the mode of being of freedom as consciousness of being; it is in anguish that freedom is, in its being, in question for itself.

Kierkegaard describing anguish in the face of what one lacks charact~rizes it as anguish in the face of freedom.But Heidegger, whom we know to have bcen greatly influenced by Kierkegaard,t8 considers anguish instead as the apprehension of nothingness. These two descriptions of anguish do not appear to us contradictory; on the contrary the one implies the other.

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First we must acknowledge that Kierkegaard is right; anguish is distinguished from fear in that fear is fear of beings in the world whereas anguish is anguish before myself. Vertigo is anguish to the extent that I am afraid not of falling over the precipice, but of throwing myself over. A situation provokes fear if there is a possibility of my life being changed from without; my being provokes anguish to the extent that I distrust myself and my own reactions in that situation. The artillery preparation which precedes the attack can provoke fear in the soldier who undergoes the bombardment, but anguish is born in him when he tries ,to foresee the conduct with which he will face the bombardment, when he asks himself if he is going to be able to "hold up." Similarly the recruit who reports for active duty at the beginning of the war can in some instances be afraid of death, but more often he is "afraid of being :Jfraid;" that is, he is filled with anguish before himself. Most of the time dangerous or threat

sufficient in itself.
We could say, varying the expression of Berkeley, that their "being is a sustained-being" and that their "possibility of being is only an ought-to-be-sustained."19 Due to this fact their possibility has as a necessary condition the possibility cf negative conduct (not to pay attention to the stones in the road, to run, to think of something else) and. the pos-
111 We shall return to possibilities in the second part of this work.

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sibility of the opposite conduct (to throw myself over the precipice).
The possibility which I make my concrete possibility can appear as my possibility only by raising itself on the basis of the totality of the logical possibilities which the situation allows. But these rejected possibles in turn have no other being than their "sustained-being;" it is I who sustain them in being, and inversely, their prescnt non-being is an "ought-not-to-be-sustained." No external cause will remove them. I alone am the permanent source of their non-being, I engage myself in them; in order to cause my possibility to appear, I posit the other possibilities so as to nihilate them. This would not produce anguish if I could apprehend myself in my relations with these possibles as a cause producing its effects. In this case the effect defined as my possibility would be strictly determined. But then it would cease to be possible; it would become simply "about-to-happen." If then I wished to avoid anguish and vertigo, it would be enough if I were to consider the motives (instinct of self-preservation, prior fear, etc.), which make me reject the situation cnvisaged, as determining my prior activity in the same way that the presence at a determined point of one given mass determines the courses followed by other masses; it would be necessary, in other words, that I apprehend in myself a strict psychological determinism. But I am in anguish precisely because any conduct on my part is only possible, and this means that while constituting a totality of motives for pushing away that situation, I at the same moment apprehend these motives as not sufficiently effective. At the very moment when I apprehend my being as llOrror of the precipice, I am conscious of that horror as not determinant in relation to my possible conduct. In one sense that horror calls for prudent conduct, and it is in itself a pre-outline of that conduct; in another sense, it posits the final developments of that conduct only as possible, precisely because I do notapprehend it as the cause of these final developments but as need, .appeal, etc.
Now as we have seen, consciousness of being is the being of consciousness. There is no question here of a contemplation which I could make after the event, of an horror already constituted; it is the very being of horror to appear to itself as "not being the cause" of the conduct it calls for. In short, to avoid fear, which reveals to me a transcendent future strictly determined, I take refuge in reflection, but the latter has only an undetermined future to offer. This means that in establishing a certain conduct as a possibility and precisely because it is my possibility, I am aware that notlling can compel me to adopt that conduct. Yet I am indeed already there in the future; it is for the sakc of that being which I will be there at the turning of the path that I now exert all my strength, and in t

ives before deciding. The earlier resolution of "not playing anymore" is always there, and in the majority of cases the gambler when in the presence of the gaming table, turns toward it as if to ask it for help; for he docs not wish to play, or rather having taken his resolution the day before, he thinks of himself still as not wishing to play anymore; he believes in the effectiveness of this resolution. But what he apprehends then in anguish is precisely the total inefficacy of the past resolution. It is there doubtless but fixed, ineffectual, surpassed by the very fact that I am conscious of it. TIle resolution is still me to the extent that I realize constantly my identity with myself across the temporal flux, but it is no longer me-due to the fact that it has become an object for my consciousness. I am not subject to it, it fails in the mission which I have given it. The resolution is there still, I am it in the mode of not-being. What the gambler apprehends at this instant is again the permanent rupture in determinism; it is nothingness which separates him from himself; I should have liked so much not to gamble anymore; yesterday I even had a synthetic apprehension of the situation (threatening ruin, disappointment of my relatives) as forbidding me to play. It seemed to me that I had established a real barrier between gambling and myself, and now I suddenly perceive that my former understanding of the situation is no more than a memory of an idea, a memory of a feeling. In order for it to come to my aid once more, I must remake it ex nihilo and freely. TIle not-gambling is only one of my possibilities, as the fact of gambling is another of them, neither more nor less. I must rediscover the fear of financial ruin or of disappointing my family, etc., I must re-create it as experienced fear. It stands behind me like a boneless phantom. It depends on me alone to lend it flesh. I am alone and naked before temptation as I was the day before. After having patiently built up barriers and walls, after enclosing myself in the magic circle of a resolution, I perceive with anguish that nothing prevents me from gambling. The anguish is me since by the very fact of taking my position in existence as consciousness of being, I make myself not to be the past of good resolutions which I am. It would be in vain to object that the sole condition of this anguish is ignorance of the underlying psychological determinism. According to such a view my anxiety would corne from lack of knowing the real and effective incentives which in the darkness of the unconscious determine my action. In reply we shall point out first that anguish has not appeared to us as a proof of human freedom; the latter was given to us as the necessary condition for the question. We wished only to show that there exists a specific consciousness of freedom, and we wished to show that this con-· sciousness is anguish. This means that we wished to established anguish in its essential structure as consciousness of freedom. Now from this point of view the existence of a psychological determinism could not invalidate the results of our description. Either indeed anguish is actually an unrealized

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ignorance of this determinism-and then anguish apprehends itself in fact as freedom-or else one may claim that anguish is consciousness of being ignorant of the real causes of our acts. In the la

tter case anguish would
come from that of which we have a presentiment, a screen deep within ourselves for monstrous motives which would suddenly release guilty acts. But in this case we should suddenly appear to ourselves as things in the world; we should be to ourselves our own transcendent situation. Then anguish would disappear to give away to fear, for fear is a synthetic apprehension of the transcendent as dreadful.

This freedom which reveals itself to us in anguish can be characterized by the existence of that nothing which insinuates itself between motives and act. It is not because I am free that my act is not subject to the determination of motives; on the contrary, the structure of motives as ineffective is the condition of my freedom. If someone asks what this nothing is which provides a foundation for freedom, we shall reply that we can not describe it since it is not, but we can at least hint at its meaning by saying that this nothing is made-to-be by the human being in his relation with himself. The nothing here corresponds to the necessity for the motive to appear as motive only as a correlate of a consciousness of motive. In short, as soon as we abandon the hypothesis of the contents of consciousness, we must recognize that there is never a motive in consciousness; motives are only for consciousness. And due to the very fact that the motive can arise only as appearance, it constitutes itself as ineffective. Of course it does not have the externality of a temporal-spatial thing; it plways belongs to subjectivity and it is apprehended as mine. But it is by nature transcendence in immanence, and consciousness is not subject to it because of the very fact that consciousness posits it; for consciousness has now the task of conferring on the motive its meaning and its importance. Thus the nothing which separates the motive from consciousness characterizes itself as transcendence in immanence. It is by arising as immanence that consciousness nihilates the nothing which makes consciousness exist for itself as transcendence. But we see that the nothingness which is the condition of all transcendent negation can be elucidated only in terms of two other original nihilations: (1) Consciousness is not its own motive inasmuch as it is empty of all content. This refers us to a nihilating structure of the pre-reflective cogito. (2) Consciousness confronts its past and its future as facing a self which it is in the mode of not-being. This refers us to a nihilating structure of temporality.

There can be for us as yet no question of elucidating these two types of nihilation; we do not at the moment have the necessary techniques at our disposal. It is sufficient to observe here that the definitive explanation of negation can not be given without a description of self-consciousness and of temporality.

What we should note at present is that freedom, which manifests itself

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through anguish, is characterized by a constantly renewed obligation to remake the Self which designates the free being. As a matter of fact when we showed earlier that my possibilities were filled with anguish because it depended on me alone to sustain them in their existence, that did not mean that they derived from a Me which to itself at least, would first be given and would then pass in the temporal flux from one consciousness to another consciousness. Th

e gambler who must realize anew
the synthetic apperception of a situation which would forbid him to play, must rediscover at the same time the self which can appreciate that situation, which "is in situation." This self with its a priori and historical content is the essence of man. Anguish as the manifestation of freedom in the face of self means that man is always separated by a nothingness from his essence. We should refer here to Hegel's statement: "Wesen ist was gewesen ist." Essence is what has been. Essence is everything in the human being which we can indicate by the words-that is. Due to this fact it is the totality of characteristics which explain the act. But the ad is always beyond· that essence; it is a human act only in so far as it surpasses every explanation which we can give of it, precisely because the very application of the formula "that is" to man causes all that is designated, to have-been. Man continually carries with him a pre-judicative comprehension of his essence, but due to this very fact he is separated from it by a nothingness. Essence is all that human reality apprehends in itself as having been. It is here that anguish appears as an apprehension of self inasmuch as its exists in the perpetual mode of detachment from what is; better yet, in so far as it makes itself exist as such. For we call never apprehend an Erlebnis as a living consequence of that nature which is ours. The overflow of our consciousness progressively constitutes that nature, ,but it remains always behind us and it dwells in us as the permanent object of our retrospective comprehension. It is in so far as this nature is a demand without being a recourse that it is apprehended in anguish.

In anguish freedom is anguished before itself inasmuch as it is instigated and bound by nothing. Someone will say, freedom has just been defined as a permanent structure of the human being; if anguish manifests it, then anguish ought to be a permanent state of my affectivity. But, on the contrary, it is completely exceptional. How can we explain the rarity of the phenomenon of anguish?

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We must note first of all that the most common situations of our life, those in which· we apprehend our possibilities as such ,by means of actively realizing them, do not manifest themselves to us through anguish because their very structure excludes anguished apprehension. Anguish in fact is the recognition of a possibility as my possibility; that is, it is constituted when consciousness sees itself cut from its essence by nothingness or separated from the future by its very freedom. This means that a

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nihilating nothing removes from me all excuse and that at the same time what I project as my future being is always nihilated and reduced to the rank of simple possibility because the future which I am remains out of my reach. But we ought to remark that in these various instances we have to do with a temporal form where I await myself in the future, where I "make an appointment with myself on the other side of that hour, of that day, or of that month." Anguish is the fear of not finding myself at that appointment, of no longer even wishing to bring myself there. But I can also find myself engaged in acts which reveal my possibilities to me at the very instant when they are realized. In lighting this cigarette I learn my concrete possibility, or if you prefer, my d

esire
of smoking. It is by the very act of drawing toward me this paper and this pen that I give to myself as my most immediate possibility the act of working at this book; there I am engaged, and I discover it at the very moment when I am already throwing'myself into it. At that instant, to be sure, it remains my possibility, since I can at each instant tum myself away from my work, push away the notebook, put the cap on my fountain pen. But this possibility of interrupting the action is rejected on a second level by the fact that the action which discovers itself to me through my act tends to crystallize as a transcendent, relatively independent form. The consciousness of man in action is non-reflective consciousness. It is consciousness of something, and the transcendent which discloses itself to this consciousness is of a particular nature; it is a structure of exigency in the world, and the world correlatively discloses in it complex relations of instrumentality. In the act of tracing the letters which I am writing, the whole sentence, still unachieved, is revealed as a passive exigency to be written. It is the very meaning of the letters which I form, and its appeal is not put into question, precisely because I can not write the words without transcending them toward the sentence and because I discover it as the necessary condition for the meaning of the words which I am writing. At the same time in the very framework of the act an indicative complex of instruments reveals itself and organizes itself (pen-ink-paper-lines-margin, etc.), a complex which can not be apprehended for itself but which rises in the heart of the transcendence which discloses to me as a passive exigency the sentence to be written. Thus in the quasi-generality of every day acts, I am engaged, I· have ventured, and I discover.my possibilities by realizing them and in the very act of realizing them as exigencies, urgencies, instrumentalities.
Of course in every act of this kind, there remains the possibility of putting this act into question- in so far as it refers to more distant, more
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essential ends-as to its ultimate meanings and my essential possibilities. For example, the sentence which I write is the meaning of the letters which I trace, but the whole work which I wish to produce is the meaning of th~ sentence. And this work is a possibility in connection with which I
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can fed anguish; it is truly my possibility, and I do not know whether I wiI continue it tomorrow; tomorrow in relation to it my freedom can exercise its nihilating power. But that anguish implies the apprehension of the work as such as my possibility. I must place mysclf directly opposite it and realize my relation to it. This means. that I ought not only to raise with reference to it objective questions such as, "Is it necessary to write this work?" for these questions refer me simply to wider objective significations, such as, "Is it opportune to write it at this moment? Isn't this just a repetition of another such book? Is its material of sufficient interest? Has it been sufficiently thought through?" etc.-all significations which remain transcendent and give themselves as a multitude of exigencies in the world.
In order for my freedom to be anguished in connection with the book which I am writing, this book must appear in its relation with me. On the one hand, I mus

t discover my essence as what I have been-I have
been "wanting to write this book," I have conceived it, I have believed
that it would be i,nteresting to write it, and I have constituted myself in
such a way that it is not possible to understand me without taking into
account the fact that this book has been my essential possibility. On
the other hand, I must discover the nothingness which separates my free-
dom from this essence: I have been "wanting to write," but notlling,
not even what I have been, can compel me to write it. Finally, I must
discover the nothingness which separates me from what I shall be: I '
discover that the permanent possibility of abandoning the book is the
very condition of the possibility of writing it and the very meaning of my ,
freedom. It is necessary that in the very constitution of the book as my
possibility, I apprehend my freedom as being the possible destroyer in
the present and in the future of what I am. That is, I must place myself
on the plane of reflection. So long as I remain on the plane of action,
the book to be written is only the distant and presupposed meaning of
the act which reveals my possibilities to me. The book is only the impli-
cation of the action; it is not made an object and posited for itself; it does
not "raise the question;" it is conceived neither as necessary nor contin-
gent. It is only the permanent, remote meaning in terms of which I can
understand what I am writing in the present, and hence, it is conceived as
being; that is, only by positing the book as the existing basis on which
my present, existing sentence emerges, can I confer a determined mean-
ing upon my sentence.
Now at each instant we are thrust into the world and engaged there.
This means that we act before positing our possibilities and that these
possibilities which are disclosed as realized or in process of being realized
refer to meanings which necessitate special acts in order to be put into
question. The alarm which rings in the morning refers to the possibility
of my going to work, which is my possibility. But to apprehend the Sum-

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mons of the alann as a summons is to get up. Therefore the very act of
getting up is reassuring, for it eludes the question, "Is work my possibil-
ity?" Consequently it does not put me in a position to apprehend the
possibility of quietism, of refusing to work, and finally the possibility of
refusing the world and the possibility of death. In short, to the extent that
I apprehend the meaning of the ringing, I am already up at its summons;
this apprehension guarantees me against the anguished intuition that it
is I who confer on the alarm clock its exigency-I and I alone.
In the same way, what we might call everyday morality is exclusive of
ethical anguish. There is ethical anguish when I consider myself in my
original relation to values. Values in actuality are demands which lay
claim to a foundation. But this foundation can in no way be being, for
every value which would base its ideal nature on its being would thereby
cease even to be a value and would realize the heteronomy of my will.
Value derives its being from its exigency and not its exigency from its
being. It does not deliver itself to a contemplative intuition which would
apprehend it as being value and thereby would remove from it its right
over my freedom. On the contrary, it can be revealed only to an active
freedom w

hich makes it exist as value by the sole fact of recognizing it as such. It follows that my freedom is the unique foundation of values and that nothing, absolutely nothing, justifies me in adopting this or that particular value, this or that particular scale of values. As a being by whom values exist, I am unjustifiable. My freedom is anguished at being the foundation of values while itself without foundation. It is anguished in addition because values, due to the fact that they are essentially revealed to a freedom, can not disclose themselves without being at the same time "put into question,"' for the possibility of overturning the scale of values appears complementarily as my possibility. It is anguish before values which IS the recognition of the ideality of values.

Ordinarily, however, my attitude with respect to values is eminently reassuring. In fact I am engaged in a world of values. The anguished apperception of values as sustained in being by my freedom is a secondary and mediated phenomenon. The immediate is the world with its urgency; and in this world where I engage myself, my acts cause values to spring up like partridges. My indignation has given to me the negative value "baseness," my admiration has given lhe positive value "grandeur." Above all my obedience to a multitude of tabus, which is real, reveals these tabus to me as existing in fact. The bourgeois-who call themselves "respectable citizens" do not become respectable as the result of contemplating moral values. Rather from the moment of their arising in the world they are \ thrown into a pattern of behavior the meaning of which is respectability. Thus respectability acquires a being; it is not put into question. Values are sown on my path as thousands of little real demands, like the signs which order us to keep off the grass.

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THE ORIGIN OF NEGATION

Thus in what we shall call the world of the immediate, which delivers itself to our unreflective consciousness, we do not first appear to ourselves, to be thrown subsequently into enterprises. Our being is immediately "in situation;" that is, it arises in enterprises and knows itself first in so far as it is reflected in those enterprises. We discover ourselves then in a world peopled with demands, in the heart of projects "in the course of realization:' I write. I am going to smoke. I have an appointment this evening with Pierre. I must not forget to reply to Simon. I do not have the right to conceal the truth any longer from Claude. All these trivial passive expectations of the real, all these commonplace, everyday values, derive their meaning from an original projection of myself which stands as my choice of myself in the world. But to be exact, this projection of myself toward an original possibility, which causes the existence of values, appeals, expectations, and in general a world, appears to me only beyond the world as the meaning and the abstract, logical signification of my enterprises. For the rest, there exist concretely alarm clocks, signboards, tax forms, policemen, so many guard rails against anguish. But as soon as the enterprise is held at a distance frem me, as soon as I am referred to myself because I must await myself in the future, then I discover myself suddenly as the one who gives its meaning to the alarm clock, the one who by a signboard forbids himself to walk on a flower bed or on the lawn, the one from

whom the boss's order borrows its urgency, the one
who decides the interest of the book which he is writing, the one finally
who makes the values exist in order to determine his action by their demands. I emerge alone and in anguish confronting the unique and original
project which constitutes my being; all the barriers, all the guard rails collapse, nihilated by the consciousness of my freedom. I do not have nor can
I have recourse to any value against the fact that it is I who sustain values
in being. Nothing can ensure me against myself, cut off from the world
and from my essence by this nothingness which I am. I have to realize
the meaning of the world and of my essence; I make my decision concerning them-without justification and without excuse.
Anguish then is the reflective apprehension of freedom by itself. In this
sense it is mediation, for although it is immediate consciousness of itself,
it arises from the negation of the appeals of the world. It appears at the
moment that I disengage myself from the world where I had been engaged
-in order to apprehend myselt 1S a consciousness which possesses a pre-ontological comprehension of its'essence and a pre-judicative sense of its
possibilities. Anguish is opposed to the mind of the serious man who
apprehends values in terms of the world and who resides in the reassuring,
materialistic substantiation of values. In the serious mood I define myself
in terms of the object by pushing aside a priori as impossible all enterprises in which I am not engaged at the moment; the· meaning which
my freedom has given to the world, I apprehend as coming from the

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world and constituting my obligations. In anguish I apprehend myself
at once as totally free and as not being able to derive the meaning of the
world except as coming' from myself.
We should not however conclude that being brought on to the reflective
plane and envisaging one's distant or immediate possibilities suffice to
apprehend oneself in pure anguish. In each instance of reflection anguish
is born as a structure of the reflective consciousness in so far as the latter
considers consciousness as an object of reflection; put it still remains
possible for me to maintain various types of conduct with Jespect to my
own anguish-in particular, patterns of flight. Everything takes place,
in fact, as if our essential and immediate behavior with respect to anguish
is flight. Psychological determinism, before being a theoretical conception, is first an attitude of excuse, or if you prefer, the basis of all attitudes
of excuse. It is reflective conduct with respect to anguish; it asserts that
there are within us antagonistic forces whose type of existence is comparable to that of things. It attempts to fill the void which encircles us, to
re-establish the links between past and present, between present andfuture. It provides us with a nature productive of our acts, and these very
acts it makes transcendent; it assigns to them a foundation in something
other than themselves by endowing them with an inertia and externality
eminently reassuring because they constitute a permanent game of excuses.
Psychological determinism denies that, transcendence of human reality
which makes it emerge in anguish beyond its own essence. At the same
time by reducing us to never being anything but what we are, it reintroduces in us the absolute positivity o

f being-in-itself and thereby reinstates
us at the heart of being.
But this determinism, a reflective defense against anguish, is not given as a reflective intuition. It avails nothing against the evidence of freedom; hence it is given as a faith to take refuge in, as the ideal end toward which we can flee to escape anguish. That is made evident on the philosophical plane by the fact that deterministic psychologists do not claim to found their thesis on the pure givens of introspection. They present it as a satisfying hypothesis, the value of which comes from the fact that it accounts for the facts-or as a necessary postulate for establishing all psychology. They admit the existence of an immediate consciousness of freedom, which their opponents hold up against them under the name of "proof by intuition of the inner sense." They merely focus the debate on the value of this inner revelation. Thus the intuition which causes us to apprehend ourselves as the original cause of our states and our acts has been discussed by nobody. It is within the reach of each of us to try to mediate anguish by rising above it and by judging it as an illusion due to the mistaken belief that we are the real causes of our acts. The problem which presents itself then is that of the degree of faith in this mediation. Is an anguish placed under judgment a disarmed anguish? Evidently not. How-

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ever here a new phenomenon is born, a process of "distraction" in relation to anguish which, on,ce again, supposes within it a nihilating power.
By itself determinism would not suffice to establish distraction since determinism is only' a postulate or an hypothesis. This process of detachment is a more complete activity of flight which operates on the very level of reflection. It is first an attempt at distraction in relation to the possibles opposed to my possible. When I constitute myself as the comprehension of a possible as my possible, I must recognize its existence at the end of my project and apprehend it as myself, awaiting me down there in the future and separated from me by a nothingness. In this sense I apprehend myself as the original source of my possibility, and it is this which ordinarily we call the consciousness of freedom. It is this structure of consciousness and this alone that the proponents of free-will have in mind when they speak of the intuition of the inner sense. But it happens that I force myself at the same time to be distracted from the constitution of other. possibilities which contradict my possibility. In truth I can not avoid positing their existence by the same movement which generates the chosen possibility as mine. I cannot help constituting them as living possibilities; that is, as having the possibility of becoming my possibilities. But I force myself to see them as endowed with a transcendent, purely logical being, in short, as things. 1£ on the reflective plane I envisage the possibility of writing this book as my possibility, then between this possibility and my consciousness I cause a nothingness of being to arise which constitutes the writing of the book as a possibil(ty and which I apprehend precisely in the permanent possibility that the possibility of not writing the book is my possibility. But I attempt to place myseIfon the other side of the possibility of not writing it as I might do with respect to an observable object

, and I let myself be pene-
trated with what I wish to see there; I try to apprehend the possibility of
not writing as needing to be mentioned merely as a reminder, as not COll-
cerningme. It must be an external possibility in relation to me, like move-
ment in relation to the motionless billiard ball. 1£ I could succeed ill
this, the possibilities hostile to my possibility would be constituted as
logical entities and would lose their effectiveness. They would no longer
be threatening since they would be "outsiders," since they would surround
my possible as purely conceivable eveqtualities; that is, fundamentally,.
conceivable by another or as possibles of another who might find himself
in the same situation. They would belong to the objective situation as a
transcendent structure, or if you prefer (to utilize Heidegger's terminol-
ogy)-I shall write this book but someone could also not writc it. Thus
I should hide from myself the fact that the possibles are myself and that
they are immanent conditions of the possibility of my possible. They
would preserve just enough being to preserve for my possible its character
as gratuitous, as a free possibility for a free being, but they would be

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disanned of their threatening character. They would not interest me; the
chosen possible would appear-due to its selection-as my only concrete
possible, and consequently the nothingness which separates me from it
and which actually confers on it its possibility would collapse.
But flight before anguish is not only an effort at distraction before the
future; it attempts also to disarm the past of its threat. What I attempt
to flee here is my very transcendence in so far as it sustains and surpasses
my essence. I assert that I am my essence in the mode of being of the in-
itself. At the same time I always refuse to consider that essence as being
historically constituted and as implying my action as a circle implies its
properties. I apprehend it, or at least I try to apprehend it as the original
beginning of my possible, and I do not admit at all that it has in itself a
beginning. I assert then that an act is free when it exactly reflects my
essence. However this freedom which would disturb me if it were freedom
before myself, I attempt to bring back to the heart of my essence-i.e.,
of my self. It is a matter of envisaging the self as a little God which inhab-
its me and which possesses my freedom as a metaphysical virtue. It would
be no longer my being which would be free qua beingbut my Self which
would be free in the heart of my consciousness. It is a fiction eminently
reassuring since freedom has been driven down into the heart of an opaque
being; to the extent that my essence is not translucency, that it is tran-
scendent in immanence, freedom would become one of its properties.
In short, it is a matter of apprehending my freedom in my self as the
freedom of another.is We see the principal themes of this fiction: My
self becomes the origin of its acts as the other of his, by virtue of a per-
sonality already constituted. To be sure, he (the self) lives and transforms
himself; we will admit even that each of his acts can contribute to trans-
fonning him. But these harmonious, continued transformations are con-
ceived on a biological order. They resemble those which I can establish
in my friend Pierre when I see him after a separation. Bergson expressly
satisfied t

hese demands for reassurance when he conceived his theory of the profound self which endures and organizes itself, which is constantly contemporary with the consciousness which I have of it and which can not be surpassed by consciousness, which is found at the origin of my acts not as a cataclysmic power but as a father begets his children, in such a way that the act without following from the essence as a strict consequence, without even being forseeable, enters into a reassuring relation with it, a family resemblance. The act goes farther than the self but along the same road; it preserves, to be sure, a certain irreducibility, but we recognize ourselves in it, and we find ourselves in it as a father can recognize himself and find himself in the son who continues his work. Thus by a projection of freedom-which we apprehend in ourselves-into a psychic object which is the self, Bergson has contributed to disguise our IS CE. Part III, ch. I.

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anguish, but it is at the expense of consciousness itself. What he has established and described in this manner is not our freedom as it appears to itself; it is the freedom of the Other.

Such then is the totality of processes by which we try to hide anguish from ourselves; we apprehend our particular possible by avoiding considering all other possibles, which we make the possibles of an undifferentiated Other. The chosen possible we do not wish to see as sustained in being by a pure nihilating freedom, and so we attempt to apprehend it as engendered by an object already constituted, which is no other than ourself, envisaged and described as if it were another person. We should like to preserve from the original intuition what it reveals to us as our independence and our responsibility but we tone down all the original nihilation in it; moreover we are always ready to take refuge in a belief in determinism if this freedom weighs upon us or if we need an excuse. Thus we flee from anguish by attempting to apprehend ourselves from without as an Other or as a thing. What we are accustomed to call a revelation of the inner sense or an original intuition of our freedom contains nothing original; it is an already constructed process, expressly designed to hide from ourselves anguish, the veritable "immediate given" of our freedom.

Do these various constructions succeed in stifling or hiding our anguish? It is certain that we can not overcome anguish, for we are anguish. As for veiling it, aside from the fact that the very nature of consciousness and its translucency forbid us to take the expression literally, we must note the particular type of behavior which it indicates. We can hide an external object because it exists independently of us. For the same reason we can turn our look or our attention away from it-that is, very simply, fix our eyes, on some other object; henceforth each reality-mine and that of the object-resumes its own life, and the accidental relation which united consciousness to the thing disappears without thereby altering either existence. But if I am what 1 wish to veil, the question takes on quite another aspect. I can in fact wish "not to see" a certain aspect of my being only if I am acquainted with the aspect which I do not wish to see. This means that in my being I must indicate this aspect in order to be able to turn myself away from it; better yet, I must think of i

t constantly
in order to take care not to think of it. In this connection it must be understood not only that I must of necessity perpetually carry within me what I wish to flee but also that I must aim at the object of my flight in order to flee it. This means that anguish, the intentional aim of anguish, and a flight from anguish toward reassuring myths must all be given in the unity of the same consciousness. In a word, I flee in order not to know, but I can not avoid knowing that I am fleeing; and the flight from anguish is only a mode of becoming conscious of anguish. Thus anguish, properly speaking, can be neither hidden nor avoided.

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Yet to flee anguish and to be anguish can not be exactly the same thing. If I am my anguish in order to flee it, that presupposes that I can decenter myself in relation to what I am, that I can be anguish in the form of "not-being it," that I can dispose of a nihilating power at the heart of anguish itself. This nihilating power nihilates anguish in so far as I flee it and nihilates itself in so far as I am anguish in order to flee it. This attitude is what we call bad faith. There is then no question of expelling anguish from consciousness nor of constituting it in an unconscious psychic phenomenon; very simply I can make myself guilty of bad faith while apprehending the anguish which I am, and this bad faith, intended to fill up the nothingness which I am in my relation to myself, precisely implies the nothingness which it suppresses.
We are now at the end of our first description. The examination of the negation can not lead us farther. It has revealed to us the existence of a particular type of conduct: conduct in the face of non-being, which supposes a special transcendence needing separate study. We find ourselves then in the presence of two human ekstases: the ekstasis. which throws us into being-in-itself and. the ekstasis which engages us in non-being.
It seems that our original problem, which concerned only the relations of man to being, is Inow considerably complicated. But in pushing our analysis of transcendence toward non-being to its conclusion, it is possible for us to get valuable information for the understanding of all transcendence. Furthermore the problem of nothingness can not be excluded from our inquiry. If man adopts any particular behavior in the face of being-in-itself-and our philosophical question is a type of such behavior-it is because he is not this being. We rediscover non-being as a condition of the transcendence toward being. We must then catch hold of the problem of nothingness and not let it go before its complete elucidation.
However the examination of the question and of the negation has given us all that it can. We have been referred by it to empirical freedom as the nihilation of man in the heart of temporality and as the necessary condition for the transcending apprehension of negatites. It remains to found this empirical freedom. It can not be both the original nihilation and the ground of all nihilation. Actually it contributes to constituting transcendences in immanence which condition all negative transcendences. But the very fact that the transcendences of empirical freedom are constituted in immanence as transcendences shows us that we are dealing with secondary nihilations which suppose the existence of an original nothingness. They are on

r calls "the man of resentment"-in reality, the Not. But there exist more subtle behaviors, the description of which will lead us further into the inwardness of consciousness. Irony is one of these. In irony a man annihilates what he posits, within one and the same act; he leads us to believe in order not to be believed; he affirms to deny and denies to affirm; he creates a positive object but it has no being other than its nothingness. Thus attitudes of negation toward the self permit us to raise a new question: What are we to say is the being of man who has the possibility of denying himself? But it is out of the question to discuss the attitude of "self-negation" in its universality. The kinds of behavior which can be

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ranked under this heading are too diverse; we risk retaining only the abstract form of them. It is best to choose and to examine one determined attitude which is essential to human reality and which is such that consciousness instead of directing its negation outward turns it toward itself. This attitide, it seems to me, is bad faith (mauvaise foi).

Frequently this is identified with falsehood. We say indifferently of a person that he shows signs of bad faith or that he lies to himself. We shall willingly grant that bad faith is a lie to oneself, on condition that we distinguish the lie to oneself from lying in general. Lying is a negative attitude, we will agree to that. But this negation does not bear on consciousness itself; it aims only anhe transcendent. The essence of the lie implies in fact that the liar actually is in complete possession,of the truth which he is hiding. A man does not lie about what he is ignorant of; he does not lie when he spreads an error of which he himself is the dupe; he does not lie when he is mistaken. The ideal description of the liar would be a cynical consciousness, affirming truth within himself, denying it in his words, and denying that negation as such. Now this doubly negative attitude rests On the transcendent; the fact expressed is transcendent since it does not exist, and the original negation rests on a truth; that is, on a particular type of transcendence. As for the inner negation which I effect correlatively with the affirmation for myself of the truth, this rests on words; that is, on an event in the world. Furthermore the inner disposition of the liar is positive; it could be the object of an affirmative judgment. The liar intends to deceive and he does not seek tq hide this intention from himself nor to disguise the translucency of consciousness; On the contrary, he ha~ recourse to it when there is a question of deciding secondary behavior. It explicitly exercises a regulatory control over all attitudes. As for his flaunted intention of telling the truth ("I'd never want to deceive you! This is true! I swear itl")-all this, of course, is the object of an inner negation, but also it is not recognized by the liar as his intention. It is played, imitated, it is the intention of the character which he plays in the eyes of his questioner, but this character, precisely because he does not exist, is a transcendent. Thus the lie does not put into the play the inner structure of present consciousness; all the negations which constitute it bear on objects which by this fact are removed from conscious-
·lless. The lie then does not require special ontological foundati

on, and
the explanations which the existence of negation in general requires are valid without cbange in the case of deceit. Of course we have described the ideal lie; doubtless it happens often enough that the liar is more or less the victim of his lie, that he half persuades himself of it. But these common, popular forms of the lie are also degenerate aspects of it; they represent intermediaries between falsehood and bad faith. The lie is a behavior of transcendence.
The lie is also a normal phenomenon of what Heidegger calls the "Mit-

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sein."1 It presupposes my existence, the existence of the Other, my existence for the Other, and the existence of the Other for me. Thus there is no difficulty in holding that the liar must make the project of the lie in entire clarity and that he must possess a complete comprehension of the lie and of the truth which he is altering. It is sufficient that an over-all opacity hide his intentions from the Other; it is sufficient that the Other can take the lie for truth. By the lie consciousness affirms that it exi~ts by nature as hidden from tIle OtIler; it utilizes for its own profit the ontological duality of myself and myself in the eyes of the Other.
The situation can not be the same for bad faith if this, as we have said, is indeed a lie to oneself. To be sure, the one who practices bad faith is hiding a displeasing truth or presenting as truth a pleaSing untruth. Bad faith then has in appearance the structure of falsehood. Only what changes everything is the fact that in bad faith it is from myself that I am hiding the truth. Thus the duality of the deceiver and the deceived does not exist here. Bad faith on the contrary implies in essence the unity of a single consciousness. This does not mean that it can not be conditioned by the Mit-sein like all other phenomena of human reality, but the IHit·sein can call forth bad faith only by presenting itself as a situation which bad faith permits surpassing; bad faith does not come from outside to IIIlman reality. One does not undergo his bad faith; one is not infected with it; it is not a state. 'But consciousness affects itself with bad faith. 'I1lCre must be an original intention and a project of bad faith; this project implies a comprehension of bad faith as such and a pre-reflective apprehension (of) consciousness as affecting itself with bad faith. It follows first that the one to whom the lie is told and the one who lies are one and the same person, which means that I must know in my capacity as deceiver the truth which is hidden from me in my capacity as the one deceived. Better yet I must know the truth very exactly in order to conceal it more carefully-and this not at two different moments, which at a pinch would allow us to re-establish a semblance of duality-but in the unitary structure of a single project. How then can the lie subsist if the duality which conditions it i~suppressed?
To this difficulty is added another which is derived from the total translucency of consciousness. That which affects itself with bad faith must be conscious (of) its bad faith since the being of consciousness is consciousness of being. It appears then that I must be in good faith, at least to the extent that I am conscious of my bad faith. But then this whole psychic system is annihilated. We must agree in fact that if I deliberately and cynically attempt to lie tom

xample I am the impulse to steal this or that book from this bookstall. I am an integral part of the impulse; I bring it to light and I determine myself hand-in-hand with it to commit the theft. But I am not those psychic facts, in so far as I receive them passively and am obliged to resort to hypotheses about their origin and ~heir true meaning, just as the scholar makes conjectures about the nature and essence of an external phenomenon. This theft, for example, which I interpret as an immediate impulse determined by the rarity, the interest, or the pri~e of the volume whicl\ I am going to steal-it is in truth a process derived from self-punishment, which is attached more or less directly to an Oedipus complex. The impulse toward the theft contains a truth which can be reached only by more or less probable hypotheses. The criterion of this truth wiII be the number of conscious psychic facts which it explains; from a more pragmatic point of view it w:Jl be also the success of the psychiatric cure which it allows. Finally the discovery of this truth wiII necessitate the cooperation of the psychoanalyst, who appears as the .mediator between my unconscious .drives and my conscious life. The Other appears as being able to effect the synthesis between the unconscious thesis and the conscious antithesis. I can know myself only through the mediation of the other, which means that I stand in relation to my "id," in the position of the Otller.If I have a little knowledge of psychoanalysis, I can, under circumstances particularly favorable, try to psychoanalyze myself. But this attempt can succeed only if I distrust every kind of intuition, only if I apply to my case from the outside, abstract schemes and rules already learned. As for the results, whether they are obtained by my efforts alone or with the cooperaticm of a technician, theywiII never have the certainty which intuition confers; they will possess simply the always increasing probability of scientific hypotheses. The hypothesis of the Oedipus complex, like the atomic theory, is nothing but an "experimental idea;" as Pierce said, it is not to be distinguished from the totality of experiences which it allows to be realized and the results which it enables us to foresee. Thus psychoanalysis substitutes for the notion of bad faith, the idea of a lie without a liar; it allows me to understand how it is possible for me to be lied to without lying to myself since it places me in the same relation to myself that the Other is in respect to me; it replaces the duality of the deceiver and the deceived, the essential condition of the lie, by that of·the "id" and the "ego." It introduces into my subjectivity the deepest intersubjective structure of the Mit-sein. Can this explanation satisfy us?

Considered more closely the psychoanalytic theory is not as simple as it first appears. It is not accurate to hold that the "id" is presented as a thing in relation to the hypothesis of the psychoanalyst, for a thing is indifferent to the conjectures which we make concerning it, while the "id" on the contrary is sensitive to them when we approach the truth. Freud in fact reports resistance when at the end of the first period the doctor is

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approaching the truth. 111is resistance is objective behavior apprehended from without: the patient shows defiance, refuses to speak, gives fantastic accounts of

his dreams, sometimes even removes himself completely from thc psychoanalytic treatment. It is a fair question to ask what part of himsclf can thus resist. It can not be the "Ego," envisaged as.a psychic totality of the facts of consciousness; this could not suspect that the psychiatrist is approaching the end since the ego's relation to the meaning of its own rcactions is exactly like that of the psychiatrist, himself. At the very most it is possible for the ego to appreciate objectively the degree of probability in the hypotheses set forth, as a witness of the psychoanalysis might be able to do, according to the number of subjective facts which they explain. Furthermore, this probability would appear to the ego to border on certainty, which he could not take offence at since most of the time it is he who by a conscious decision is in pursuit of the psychoanalytic therapy. Are we to say that the patient is disturbed by the daily revelations which the psychoanalyst makes to him and that he seeks to remove himself, at the same time pretending in his own eyes to wish to continue the treatment? In- this case it is no longer possible to resort to tIle unconscious to explain bad faith; it is there in full consciousness, with all its contradictions. But this is not the way that the psychoanalyst means to explain this resistance; for him it is secret and deep, it comes from afar; it has its roots in the very thing which the psychoanalyst is trying to make clear.

Furthermore it is equally impossible to explain the resistance as emanating from the complex which the psychoanalyst wishes to bring to light. The complex as such is rather the collaborator of the psychoanalyst since it aims at expressing itself in clear consciousness, since it plays tricks on the ccnsor and seeks to elude it. The only level on which we can locate the refusal of the subject is that of the censor. It alone can comprehend the questions or the revelations of the psychoanalyst· as approaching more or less ncar to the real drives which it strives to repress-it alone because it alone knows what it is repressing.

If we reject the language and the materialistic mythology of psychoanalysis, we perceive that the censor in order to apply its activity with discernment must know what it is repressing. In fact if we abandon all the metaphors representing the repression as the impact of blind forces, we are compelled to admit that the censor must choose and in order to choose must be aware of so doing. How could it happen otllerwise that the censor allows lawful sexual impulses to pass through, that it permits needs (hunger, thirst, sleep) to be expressed in clear consciousness? And how are we to explain that it can relax its surveillance, that it can even be deceived by the disguises of the instinct? But it is not sufficient that it discern the condemned drives; it must also apprehend them as to be repressed, which implies in .it at the very least an awareness of its activity. In a word, how could the censor discern the impulses needing to be repressed without

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being conscious of discerning them? How can we conceive of a knowledge which is ignorant of itself? To know is to know that one knows, said Alain. Let us say rather: All knowing is consciousness of knowing. Thus the resistance of the patient implies on the level of the censor an awareness of the thing repressed as such, a comprehen

sion of the end toward which the
questions of the psychoanalyst are leading, and an act of synthetic connection by which it compares the truth of the repressed complex to the psychoanalytic hypothesis which aims at it. These various operations in their turn imply that the censor is conscious (of) itself. But what type of self-consciousness can the censor have? It must be the consciousness (of) being conscious of the drive to be repressed, but precisely in order not be conscious of it. What does this mean if not that the censor is in bad faith? Psychoanalysis has not gained anything for us since in order to overcome bad faith, it has established between the unconscious and consciousness an autonomous consciousness in bad faith. The effort to establish a veritable duality and even a trinity (£s, lch, Ueberich expressing themselves through the censor) has resulted in a mere verbal terminology. The very essence of the reflexive idea of hiding something from oneself implies the unity of one and the same psychic mechanism and consequently a double activity in the heart of unity, tending on the one hand to maintain and 10-eate the thing to be concealed and on the other hand to repress and disguise it. Each of the two aspects of this activity is complementary to the other; that is, it implies the other in its being. By separating consciousness from the unconscious by means of the censor, psychoanalysis has not succeeded in dissociating the two phases of the act, since the libido is a blind conatus toward conscious expression and since the conscious phenomenon is a passive, faked result. Psychoanalysis has merely localized this double activity of repulsion and attraction on the level of the censor. Furthermore the problem still remains of accounting for the unity of the total phenomenon (repression of the drive which disguises itself and "passes" in symbolic form), to establish comprehensible connections among its different phases. How can the repressed drive "disguise itself" if it does not include (1) the consciousness of being repressed, (2) the consciousness of having been pushed back because it is what it is, (3) a project of disguise? No mechanistic theory of condensation or of transference can explain these modifications by which the drive itself is affected, for the description of the process of disguise implies a veiled appeal to finality. And similarly how are we to account for the pleasure or the anguish which accompanies the symbolic and conscious satisfaction of the drive if consciousness does not include-beyond the censor-an obscure comprehension of the end to be attained as simultaneously desired and forbidden. By rejecting the conscious unity of the psyche, Freud is obliged to imply everywhere a magic unity linking distant phenomena across obstacles, just as sympathetic magic unites the spellbound person and the wax

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image fashioned in his likeness. The unconscious drive (Trieb) through magic is endowed with the character "repressed" or "condemned," which completely pervades it, colors it, and magically provokes its symbolism. Similarly the conscious phenomenon is entirely colored by its symbolic meaning although it can not apprehend this meaning by itself in clear consciousness.
Aside from its inferiority in principle, the explanation by magic does not avoid the coexistence-on the level of the unconscious, on

that of the
censor, and on that of consciousness-of two contradictory, complementary structures which reciprocally imply and destroy each other. Proponents of the theory have hypostasized and "reified" bad faith; they have not escaped it. This is what has inspired a Viennese psychiatrist, Steckel, to depart from the psychoanalytical tradition and to write in La femme frigide:s "Every time that I have been able to carry my investigations far enough, I have established that the crux of the psychosis was conscious." In addition the cases which he reports in his work bear witness to a pathological bad faith which the Freudian doctrine can not account for. There is the question, for example, of women whom marital infidelity has made frigid; that is, they succeed in hiding from themselves not complexes deeply sunk in half physiological darkness, but acts of conduct which are objectively discoverable, which they can not fail to record at the moment when they perform them. Frequently in fact the husband re\'eals to Steckel that his wife has given objective signs of pleasure, but the woman when questioned will fiercely deny them. Here we find a pattern ot distraction. Admissions which Steckel was able to draw out inform us that these pathologically frigid women apply themselves to becoming distracted in advance from the pleasure which they dread; many for example at the time of the sexual act, turn their thoughts away toward their daily occupations, make up their household accounts. Will anyone speak of an unconscious here? Yet if the frigid woman thus distracts her consciousness from the pleasure which she experiences, it is by no means cynically and in full agreement with herself; it is in order to prove to herself that she is frigid. We have in fact to deal with a phenomenon of bad faith since the efforts taken in order not to be present to the experienced pleasure imply the recognition that the pleasure is experienced; they imply it in order to deny it. But we are no longer on the ground of psychoanlysis. Thus on the one hand the explanation by means of the unconscious, due to the fact that it breaks the psychic unity, can not account for the facts which at fii"st sight it appeared to explain. And on the other hand, there exists an infinity of types of behavior in bad faith which explicitly reject this kind of explanation because their essence implies that they can appear only in the translucency of consciousness. We find that the problem which we had attempted to resolve is still untouched.
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II. PATIERNS OF BAD FAITII

IF we wish to get out of this difficulty, we should examine more closely the patterns of bad faith and attempt a description of them. This description will permit us perhaps to fix more exactly the conditions for the possibility of bad faith; that is, to reply to the question we raised at the outset: "\Vhat must be the being of man if he is to be capable of bad faith?"
Take the example of a woman who has consented to go out with a particular man for the first time. She knows very well the intentions which the man who is speaking to her cherishes regarding her. She knows also that it will be necessary sooner or later for her to make a decision. But she does not want to realize the urgency; she concerns herself only with what is respectful and discreet in the attitude of her companion. She does not apprehend this conduct

as an attempt to achieve what we call "the first
approach;" that is, she does not want to see possibilities of temporal development which his conduct presents. She restricts this behavior to what is in the present; she does not wish to read in the phrases which he addresses to her anything other than their explicit meaning. If he says to her, "I find you so attractivel" she disarms this phrase of its sexual background; she attaches to the conversation and to the behavior of the speaker, the immediate meanings, which she imagines as objective qualities. The man who is speaking to her appears to her sincere and respectful as the table is round or square, as the wall coloring is blue or gray. The qualities thus attached to the person she is listening to are in this way fixed in a permanence like that of things, which is no other than the projection of the strict present of the qualities into the temporal flux. This is because she does not quite know what she wants. She is profoundly aware of the desire which she inspires, but the desire cruel and naked would humiliate and horrify her. Yet she would find no charm in a respect which would be only respect. In order to satisfy her, there must be a feeling which is addressed wholly to her personality-i.e., to her full freedom-and which would be a recognition of her freedom. But at the same time this feeling must be wholly desire; that is, it must address itself to her body as object. This time then she refuses to apprehend the desire for what it is; she does not even give it a name; she recognizes it only to the extent that it transcends itself toward admiration, esteem, respect and that it is wholly absorbed in the more refined forms which it produces, to the extent of no longer figuring anymore as a sort of warmth and density. But then suppose he takes her hand. This act of her companion risks changing the situation by calling for an immediate decision. To leave the hand there is to consent in herself to flirt, to engage herself. To withdraw it is to break the troubled and unstable harmony which gives the hour its charm. The aim is to postpone the moment of decision as long as possible. We know what happens next; the young woman leaves her hand there, but she does not notice that she

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is leaving it. She does not notice because it happens by chance that she is at this moment all intellect. She draws her companion up to the,most lofty regions of sentimental speculation; she speaks of Life, of her life, she shows herself in her essential aspect-a personality, a consciousness. And during this time the divorce of the body from the soul is accomplished; the" hand rests inert between the warm hands of her companion-neither consenting nor resisting-a thing.
We shall say that this woman is in bad faith. But we see immediately that she uses various procedures in order to maintain herself in this bad faith. She has disarmed the actions of her companion by reducing them to being only what they are; that is, to existing in the mode of the in-itself. But she permits herself to enjoy his desire, to the extent that she will apprehend it as not being what it is, will recognize its transcendence, Finally while sensing profoundly the presence of her own body-to the degree of being disturbed perhaps-she realizes herself as not being her own body, and she contemplates it as though from above as a passiv

e object to which
events can happen but which can neither provoke them nor avoid them because all its possibilities are outside of it. What unity do we find in these various aspects of bad faith? It is a certain art of forming contradictory concepts which unite in themselves both an idea and the negation of that idea, The basic concept which is thus engendered, utilizes the double property of the human being, who is at once a facticity and a transcendence, These tw,o aspects of human reality are and ought to be capable of a valid coordination. But bad faith does not wish either to coordinate them nor to surmount them in a synthesis. Bad faith seeks to affirm their identity while preserving their differences. It must affirm facticity as being transcendence and transcendence as being facticity, in such a way that at the instant when a person apprehends the Qne, he can find himself abruptly faced with the other.

We can find the prototype of formulae of bad faith in certain famous expressions which have been rightly conceived to produce their whole effect in a spirit of bad faith. Take for example the title of a work by Jacques Chardonne, Love Is Much More than Love.4 We see here how unity is established between present love in its facticity-"the contact of two skins," sensuality, egoism, Proust's mechanism of jealousy, Adler's battle of the sexes, etc.-and love as transcendence-Mauriac's "river of fire," the longing for the infinite, Plato's eros, Lawrence's deep cosmic intuition, etc. Here we leave facticity to find ourselves suddenly beyond the present and the factual condition of man, beyond the psychological, in the heart of metaphysics. On the other hand, the title of a play by Sarment, I Am Too Great for Myself/ which also presents characters in bad

4 L'amour, c'est beaucoup plus que 1'amour.

II Je suis trap grand pour moi.

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faith, thrQws us first into full transcendence in order suddenly to imprison us within the narrow limits of our factual essence. We will discover this structure again in the famous sentence: "He has become what he was" or in its no less famous opposite: "Eternity at last changes each man into himself."6 It is well understood that these various formulae have only the appearance of bad faith; they have been conceived in this paradoxical form explicitly to shock the mind and discountenance it by an enigma. But it is precisely this appearance which is of concern to us. What counts here is that the formulae do not constitute new, solidly structured ideas; on the contrary, they are formed so as to remain in perpetual disintegration and so that we may slide at any time from naturalistic present to transcendence and vice versa.

We can see the use which bad faith can make of these judgments which all aim at establishing that I am not what I am. If I were only what I am, I could, for example, seriously consider an adverse criticism which someone makes of me, question myself scrupulously, and perhaps be compelled to recognize the truth in it. But thanks to transcendence, I am not subject to all that I am. I do not even have to discuss the justice of the reproach. As Suzanne says to Figaro, "To prove that I am right would be to recognize that I can be wrong." I am on a plane where no reproach can touch me since what I really am is my transcendence. I flee from myself, I escape myself, I leave my tattered garment in the hands of th

e fault-finder. But
the ambiguity necessary for bad faith comes from the fact that I affirm here
that I am my transcendence in the mode of being of a thing. It is only
thus, in fact, that I can feel that I escape all reproaches. It is in the sense
that our young woman purifies the desire of anything humiliating by being
willing to consider it only as pure transcendence, which she avoids even
naming. But hwersely "I Am Too Great for Myself," while showing our
transcendence changed into facticity, is the source of an infinity of excuses
for our failures or our weaknesses. Similarly the young coquette maintains
transcendence to the extent that the respect, the esteem manifested by
the actions of her admirer are already on the plane of the transcendent.
But she arrests this transcendence, she glues it down with all the facticity
of the present; respect is nothing other than respect, it is an arrested sur-
passing which no longer surpasses itself toward anything.
But although this metastable concept of "transcendence-facticity" is
one of the most basic instruments of bad faith, it is not the only one of its
kind. We can equally well use another kind of duplicity derived from hu-
man reality which we will express roughly by saying that its being-far-itself
implies complementarily a being-far-others. Upon anyone of my conducts
it is always possible to converge two looks, mine and that of the Other.
The conduct will not present exactly the same structure in each case. But
611 est dcvenu ce qu'il etait.
Tel qu'en Iui-m~me eutin I'eterniM Ie change.

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as we shall see later, as each look perceives it, there is between these two
aspects of my being, no difference between appearance and being-as if
I were to my self the truth of myself and as if the Other possessed only a
deformed image of me. The equal dignity of being, possessed by my being-
for-others and by my being-for-myself permits a perpetually disintegrating
synthesis and a perpetual game of escape from the for-itself to the for-
others and from the for-others to the for-itself. We have seen also the use
which our young lady made of our being-in-the-midst-of-the-world-i.e.,
of our inert presence as a passive object among other objects-in order
to relieve herself suddenly from the functions of her being-in-the-world-
that is, from the being which causes there to be a world by projecting
itself beyond the world toward its own possibilities. Let us note finally
the confusing syntheses which play on the nihilating ambiguity of these
temporal ekstases, affirming at once that I am what I have been (the
m~n who deliberately arrests himself at one period in his life and refuses
to take into consideration the later changes) and· that I am not what I
have been (the man who in the face of reproaches or rancor dissociates
himself from his p,ast by insisting on his freedom and on his perpetual
re-creation). In all these concepts, which have only a transitive role in the
reasoning and which are eliminated from the conclusion, (like hypochon-
driacs in the calculations of physicians), we find again the same structure.
We have to deal with human reality as a being which is what it is not and
which is not what it is.
But what exactly is necessary in order for these concepts of disintegra-
tion to be able to receive even a pretence of existence, in order for them
to be able to appear for an instant to consc

iousness, even in a process of
evanescence? A quick examination of the idea of sincerity, the antithesis of bad faith, will be very instructive in this connection. Actually sincerity presents itself as a demand and consequently is not a state. Now what is the ideal to be attained in this case? It is necessary that a man be for himself only what he is. But is this not precisely the definition of the in-itself-or if you prefer-the principle of identity? To posit as an ideal the being of things, is this not to assert by the same stroke that this being does not belong to human reality and that the principle of identity, far from being a universal axiom universally applied, is only a synthetic principle enjoying a merely regional universality? Thus in order that the concepts of bad faith can put us under illusion at least for an instant, in order that the candor of "pure hearts" (ef. Gide, Kessel) can have validity for human reality as an ideal, the principle of identity must not represent a constitutive principle of buman reality and human reality must not be necessarily what it is but must be able to be what it is not. What does this mean?
If man is what he is, bad faith is for ever impossible and candor ceascs to be his ideal and becomes instead his being. But is man what he is? And more generally, how can he be what he is when he exists as consciousness

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of being? If candor or sincerity is a universal value, it is evident that the maxim "one must be what one is" does not serve solely as a regulating principle for judgments and concepts by which I express what I am. It posits not merely an ideal of knowing but an ideal of being; it proposes for us an absolute equivalence of being with itself as a prototype of being. In this sense it is necessary that we make ourselves what we are. But what are we then if we have the constant obligation to make ourselves what we are, if our mode of being is having the obligation to be what we are?
Let us consider this waiter in the cafe. His movement is quick and forward, a little too precise, a little too rapid. He comes toward the patrons with a step a little too quick. He bends forward a little too eagerly; his voice,his eyes express an interest a little too solicitous for the order of the customer. Finally there he returns, trying to imitate in his walk the inflexible stiffness of some kind of automaton while carrying his tray with the recklessness of a tight-rope-walker by putting it in a perpetually unstable, perpetually broken equilibrium which he perpetually reestablishes by a light movement of the arm and hand. All his behavior seems to us a game. He applies himself to chaining his movements as if they were mechanisms, the one regulating the other; his gestures and even his voice seem to be mechanisms; he gives himself the quickness and pitiless rapidity of things. He is playing, he is amusing himself. But what is he playing?
We need not watch long before we can explain it: he is playing at being a waiter in a cafe. There is nothing there to surprise us. The game is a kind of marking out and investigation. The child plays with his body in order to explore it, to take inventory of it; the waiter in the cafe plays with his condition in order to realize it. This obligation is not different from that which is imposed on all tradesmen. Their condition is wholly one of ceremony. The public demands of them that they

realize it as a ceremony;
there is the dance of the grocer, of the tailor, of the auctioneer, by which they endeavour to persuade their clientele that they are nothing but a grocer, an auctioneer, a tailor. A grocer who dreams is offensive to the buyer, because such a grocer is not wholly a grocer. Society demands that he limit himself to his function as a grocer, just as the soldier at attention makes himself into a soldier-thing with a direct regard which does not see at all, which is no longer meant to see, since it is the rule and not the interest of the moment which determines the point he must fix his eyes on (the sight "fixed at ten paces"). There are indeed many precautions to imprisona man in what he is, as if we lived in perpetual fear that he might escape from it, that he might break away and suddenly elude his condition.
In a parallel situation, from within,the waiter in the cafe can not be immediately a cafe waiter in the sense that this inkwell is an inkwell, or the glass is a glass. It is by no means that he can not form reflective judgments or concepts concerning his condition. He knows well what it

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"means:" the obligation of getting up at five o'clock, of sweeping the floor of the shop before the restaurant opens, of starting the coffee pot going, etc. He knows the rights which it allows: the right to the tips, the right to belong to a union, etc. But all these concepts, all these judgments refer to the transcendent. It is a matter of abstract .possibilities, of rights and duties conferred on a "person possessing rights." And it is precisely this person who I have to be (if I am the waiter in question) and who I am not. It is not that I do not wish to be this person or that I want this person to be different. But rather there is no common measure between his being and mine. It is a "representation" for others and for myself, which means that I can be he only in representation. But if I represent myself as him, I am not he; I am separated from him as the object from the subject, separated by nothing, but this nothing isolates me from him. I can not be he, I can only play at being him; that is, imagine to myself that I am he. And thereby I affect him with nothingness. In vain do I fulfill the functions of a cafe waiter. I can be he only in the neutralized mode, as the actor is Hamlet, by mechanically making the typical gestures of my state and by aiming at myself as an imaginary cafe waiter through those gestures taken as an "analogue."7 What I attcmpt to realize is a being-in-itself of the cafe waiter, as if it were not just in my power to confer their value and their urgency upon my duties and the rights of my position, as if it were not my free choice to get up each morning at five o'clock or to remain in b~d, even though it meant getting fired.
As if from the very fact that I sustain this role in existence I did not transcend it on every side, as if I did not co'nstitute myself as one beyond my condition. Yet there is no doubt that I am in a sense a cafe waiter-otherwise could I not just as wcll call myself a diplomat or a reporter? But if I am one, this can not be in the mode of being in-itself. 'I am a waiter in the mode of beiJlg what I am IIOt.
Furthermore we are dealing with more than mere social positions; I am never anyone of my attitudes, anyone of my actions. The good speaker is the one who plays at speak

ing, because he can not be speaking. The
attentive pupil who wishes to be attentive, his eyes riveted on the teacher, his ears open wide, so exhausts himself in playing the attentive role that he ends up by no longer hearing anything. Perpetually absent to my body, to my acts, I am despite myself that "divine absence" of which Valery speaks. I can not say either that I am here or that I am not here, in the sense that we say "that box of matches is on the table;" this would be to confuse my "being-in-the-world" with a "being-in the midst of the world." Nor that I am standing, nor that I am seated; this would be to confuse my body with the idiosyncratic totality of which it is only one of the structures. On all sides I escape being and yet-I am. .
But take a mode of being which concerns only myself: I am sad. One
T CE. L'Imaginairc:. Conclusion.

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might think that surely I am the sadness in the mode of being what I am. What is the sadness, however, if not the intentional unity which comes to reassemble and animate the totality of my conduct? It is the meaning of this dull look with which I view the world, of my bowed shoulders, of my lowered head, of the listlessness in my whole body. But at the very moment when I adopt each of these attitudes, do I not know that I shall not be able to hold on to it? Let a stranger suddenly appear and I will lift up my head, I will assume a lively cheerfulness. What will remain of my sadness except that I obligingly promise it an appointment for latcr after the departure of the visitor? Moreover is not this sadness itself a conduct? Is it not consciousness which affects itself with sadness as a magical recourse against a situation too urgent?8 And in this case even, should we not say that being sad means first to make oneself sad? That may be, someone will say, but after all doesn't giving oneself the being of sadness mean to receive this being? It makes no difference from where I receive it. The fact is that a consciousness which affects itself with sadness is sad preciscly for this reason. But it is difficult to comprehend the nature of consciousness; the being-sad is not a ready-made being which I give to myself as I can give this book to my friend. I do not possess the property or affecting myself with being. If I make myself sad, I must continue to make myself sad from beginning to end. I can not treat my sadness as an impulse finally achieved and put it on file without recreating it, nor can I carry it in the manner of an inert body which continues its movement after the initial shock. There is no inertia in consciousness. If I make myself sad, it is becatlse I am not sad-the being of the sadness escapes me by and in the very act by which I affect myself with it. The being-in-itself of sadness perpetually haunts my consciousness (of) being sad, but it is as a value which I can not realize; it stands as a regulative meaning of my sadne:;s, not as its constitutive modality.
Someone may say that my consciousness at least is, whatever may be the object or the state of which it makes itself consciousness. But how do we distinguish my consciousness (of) being sad from sadness? Is it not all one? It is true in a way that my consciousness is; if One means by this that for another it is a part of the totality of being on which judgments can be brought to bear. But it should be noted, as Husserl clearly underslood, that

my consciousness appears originally to the Other as an absence. It is the object always present as the meaning of all my attitudes and all my conduct-and always absent, for it gives itself to the intuition of another as a perpetual question:....-still better, as a perpctual freedom. '\Vhen Pierre looks at me, I know of course that he is looking at me. His eyes, things in the world, are fixed on my body, a thing in the world-that is the objective fact of which I can say: it is. But it is also a fact in the world. The meaning

8 Esquisse crune tMarie des ~motion$. Hennann Paul. In English. The Emotions. Outline of a Theory. Philosophical Library. 1948.

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of this look is not a fact in the world, and this is what makes meuncomfortable. Although I make smiles, promises, threats, nothing can get hold of the approbation, the free judgment which I seek; I know that it is always beyond. I sense it in my very attitude, which is no longer like that of the worker toward the things he uses as instrumen~. My reactions, to the extent that I project myself toward the Other, are no longer for myself but are rather mere presentations; they await being constituted as graceful or uncouth, sincere or insincere, etc., by an apprehension which is always beyond my efforts to provoke, an apprehension which will be provoked by my efforts only if of itself it lends them force (that is, only in so far as it causes itself to be provoked from the outside), which is its own .mediator with the transcedent. Thus the objective fact of the being-in-itself of the consciousness of the Other is posited in order to disappear in negativity and in freedom: consciousness of the Other is as not-being; its being-in-itself "here and now" is not-to-be.

Consciousness of the Other is what it is not.

Furthermore the being of my own consciousness does not appear to me as the consciousnes of the Other. It is because it makes itsclf, since its being is consciousness of being. But this means that making sustains being; consciousness has to be its own being, it is never sustained by being; it sustains being in the heart of subjectivity, which means once again that it is inhabited by being but that it is not being: consciousness is not what it is.

Under these conditions what can be the significance of the ideal of sincerity except as a task impossible to achieve, of whic11 the vt:ry meaning is in contradiction with the structure of my consciousness. To be sincere, we said, is to be what one is. That supposes that I am not originally what I am. But here naturally Kant's "You ought, therefore you can" is implicitly understood. I can become sincere; this is what my duty and my effort to achieve sincerity imply. But we definitely establish that the original structure of "not being what one is" rcnders impossible in advance· all movement toward being in itself or "being what one is." And this impossibility is not hidden from consciousness; on the contrary, it is the very stuff of consciousness; it is the embarrasing constraint which we constantly experience; it is our very incapacity to recognize ourselves, to constitute ourselves as being what we are. It is this necessity which means that, as soon as.we posit ourselves as a certain being, by a legitimate judgment, ba.sed on inner experience or correctly deduced from a priori Ot empirical premises, then by that very positing we surpass this b

eing-
apd that not toward another being but toward emptiness, toward nothing. How then can we blame another for ':lot being sincere or rejoice in our own sincerity since this sincerity appears to us at the same time to be impossible? How can we in conversation, in confession, in introspection, even attempt sincerity since the effort will by its very nature be doomed

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to failure and since at the very time when we announce it we have a prejudicative comprehension of its futility? In introspection I try to determine exactly what I am, to make up my mind to be my true self without delay-even though it means consequently to set about searching for ways to change myself. But what does this mean if not that I am constituting myself as a thing? Shall I determine the ensemble of purposes and motivations which have pushed me to do this or that action? But this is already to postulate a causal determinism which constitutes the flow of my states of consciousness as a succession of physical states. Shall I uncover in myself "drives," even though it be to affirm them in shame? But is this not deliberately to forget that these drives are realized with my consent, that they are not forces of nature but that I lend them their efficacy by a perpetually renewed decision concerning their value. Shall I pass judgment on my character, on my nature? Is this not to veil from myself at that moment what I know only too well, that I thus judge a past to which by definition my present is not subject? The proof of this is that the same man who in sincerity posits that he is what in actuality he was, is indignant at the reproach of another and tries to disarm it by asserting that he can no longer be what he was. We are readily astonished and upset when the penalties of the court affect a man who in his new freedom is no longer the guilty person he was. But at the same time we require of this man that he recognize himself as being this guilty one. What then is sincerity except precisely a phenomenon of bad faith? Have we not shown indeed that in bad faith human reality is constituted as a being which is what it is not and which is not what it is?

Let us take an example: A homosexual frequently has an intolerable feeling of guilt, and his whole existence is determined in relation to this feeling. One will readily foresee that he is in bad faith. In fact it frequently happens that this man, while recognizing his homosexual inclination, while avowing each and every particular misdeed which he has committed, refuses with all his strength to consider himself "a paederast." His case is always "different," peculiar; there enters into it something of a game, of chance, of bad luck; the mistakes are all in the past; they are explained by a certain conception of the beautiful which women can not satisfy; we should see in them the results of a restless search, rather than the manifestations of a deeply rooted tendency, etc., etc. Here is assuredly a man in bad faith who borders On the comic since, acknowledging all the facts which are imputed to him, he refuses to draw from them the conclusion which they impose. His friend, who is his most severe critic, becomes irritated with this duplicity. The critic asks only one thing-and perhaps then he will show himself indulgent: that the guilty one recognize himself as guilty, that the homosexual declare frankly-whether humbly or boastfully m

atters little-"I am a paederast." We ask here: Who is in bad faith?
The homosexual or the champion of sincerity?

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The homosexual recognizes his faults, but he struggles with all his strength against the crushing view that his mistakes constitute for him a destiny. He does not wish to let himself be considered as a thing. He has an obscure but strong feeling that an homosexual is not an homosexual as this table is a table or as this red-haired man is red-haired. It seems to him that he has escaped from each mistake as Soon as he has posited it and recognized it; he even feels that the psychic duration by itself cleanses him from each misdeed, constitutes for him an undetermined future, causes him to be born anew. Is he wrong? Does he not recognize in himself the peculiar, irreducible character of human reality? His attitude includes then an undeniable comprehension of truth. But at the same time he needs this perpetual rebirth, this constant escape in order to live; he must constantly put himself beyond reach in order to avoid the terrible judgment of collectivity. Thus he plays on the word being. He would be right actually if he understood the phrase, "I am not a paederast" in the sense of "I am not what I am." That is, if he declared to himself, "To the extent that a pattern of conduct is defined as the conduct of 'a paederast and to the extent that I have adopted this conduct, I am a paederast. But to the extent that human reality can not be finally defined by patterns of conduct, I am not one." But instead he slides surreptitiously towards a different connotation of the word "being." He understands "not being" in the sense of "not-being-in-itself." He lays elaim to "not being a paederast" in the sense in which this table is not an inkwell. He is in bad faith. But the champion of sincerity is not ignorant of the transcendence of human reality, and he knows how at need to appeal to it for his own advantage. He makes use of it even and brings it up in the present argument. Does he not wish, first in the name of sincerity, then of freedom, that the homosexual reflect on himself and acknowledge himself as an homosexual? Does he not let the other understand that such a confession will win indulgence for him? What does this mean if not that the man who will acknowledge himself as an homosexual will no longer be the same as the homosexual whom he acknowledges beiag and that he will escape. into the region of freedom and of good will? The critic asks the man then to be what he is in order no longer to be what he is. It is the profound meaning of the saying, "A sin confessed is half pardoned." The critic demands of the guilty one that he constitute himself as a thing, precisely in order no longer to treat him as a thing. And this contradiction is constitutive of the demand of sincerity. Who can not see how offensive to the Other and how reassuring for me is a statement such\as, "He's just a paederast," which removes a disturbing freedom ,from a trait and which aims at henceforth constituting all the acts of the Other as consequences following strictly from his essence. That is actually what the critic is demanding of his victim-that he constitute himself as a thing, that he should entrust his freedom to his friend as a fief, in order that

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the friend should return it to him subsequently-like a suzerain

to his
vassal. The champion of sincerity is in bad faith to the degree that in order to reassure himself, he pretends to judge, to the extent that he demands that freedom as freedom. constitute itself as a thing. We have here only one episode in that battle to the death of consciousnesses which Hegel calls "the relation of the master and the slave." A person appeals to another and demands that in the name of his nature as consciousness h~ should radically destroy himself as consciousness, but while making this appeal he leads the other to hope for a rebirth beyond this destruction. Very well, SOmeone wiIl say, but our man is abusing sincerity, playing one side against the other. We should not look for sincerity in the relation of the Mit-scin but rather where it is pure-in the relations of a person with himself. But who can not see that objective sincerity is constituted in the same way? Who can not see that the sincere man constitutes himself as a thing in order to escape the condition of a thing by the same act of sincerity? The man who confesses that he is evil has exchanged his disturbing "frcedom-for-evil" for an inanimate character of evil; he is evil, he clings to himself, he is what he is. But by the same stroke, he escapes from that thing, since it is he who contemplates it, since it depends on him to maintain it under his glance or to let it collapse in an infinity of particular acts. He derives a merit from his sincerity, and the deserving man is not the evil man as he is evil but as he is beyond his evilness. At the same time the evil is disarmed since it is nothing, save on the plane of determinism, and since in confessing it, I posit my freedom in respect to it; my future is virgin; everything is allowed to me.
Thus the essential structure of sincerity does not differ from that of bad faith since the sincere man constitutes himself as what he is in order not to be it. This explains the truth recognized by all that one can fall into bad faith through being sincere. As Valery pointed out, this is the case with Stendhal. Total, constant sincerity as a constant effort to adhere to oneself is by nature a constant effort to dissociate oneself from oneself. A person frees himself from himself by the very act by which he makes himself an object for himself. To draw up a perpetual inventory of what one is means constantly to redeny oneself and to take refuge in a sphere where one is no longer anything but a pure, free regard. The goal of bad faith, as we said, is to put oneself out of reach; it is an escape. Now we see that we must use the same terms to define Sincerity. What does this mean? In the final analysis the goal of sincerity and the goal of bad faith are not so different. To be sure, there is a sincerity which bears on the past and which docs not concern us here; I am sincere if I confess having had this pleasure or that intention. We shall see that if this sincerity is possible, it is because in his fall into thepast, the being of man is constituted as a being-in-itself. But here our concern is only with the sincerity which aims at itself in present immanence. What is its goal? To bring me to confess

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to myself what I am in order that I may finally coincide with my being; in a word, to cause myself to be, in the mode of the in-itself, what I am in the mode of "not being what I am:" Its assumption is that fundamentally I

am already, in the mode of the in-itself, what I have to be. Thus we find at the base of sincerity a continual game of mirror and reflection, a perpetual passage from the being which is what it is, to the being which is not what it is and inversely from the being which is not what it is to the being which is what it is. And what is the goal of bad faith? To cause me to be what I am, in the mode of "not being what one is," or not to be what I am in the mode of "being what one is." We find here the same game of mirrors. In fact in order for me to have an intention of sincerity, I must at the outset simultaneously be and not be what I am. Sincerity does not assign to me a mode of being or a particular quality, but in relation to that quality it aims.at making me pass from one mode. of being to another mode of being. This second mode of being, the ideal of sincerity, I am prevented by nature from attaining; and at the very moment when I struggle to attain it, I have a vague prejudicative comprehension that I shall not attain it. But all the same, in order for me to be able to conceive an intentionin bad faith, I must have such a nature that within my being I escape from my being. If I were sad or cowardly in the way in which this inkwell is an inkwell, the possibility of bad faith could not even be conceived. Not only should I be unable to escape from my being; I could not even imagine that I could escape from it. But if bad faith is possible by virtue of a simple project, it is because so far as my being is concerned, therc is no difference between being and non-being if I am cut off from my project. Bad faith is possible only because sincerity is conscious of missing its goal inevitably, due to its very nature. I can try to apprehend myself as "not being cowardly," when I am so, only on con,dition that the "being cowardly" is itself "in question" at the very moment when it exists, on condition that it is itself one question, that at the very moment whcn I wish to apprehend it, it escapes me on all sides and annihilates itself. The condition under which I can attempt 3n effort in bad faith is that in one sense, I am not this coward which I do not wish to be. But if I were not cowardly in the simple nlode of not-being-what-one-is-not, I would be "in good faith" by declaring that I am not cowardly. Thus this inapprehensible coward is evanescent; in order for me not to be cowardly, I must in SOme way also be cowardly. That does not mean that I must be "a little" cowardly, in the sense that "a little" signifies "to a certain degree cowardly-and not cowardly to a certain degree." No. I must at once both be and not be totally and in all respects a coward. Thus in this case bad faith requires that I should not be what I am; that is, that there be an imponderable difference separating being from non-being in the mode of being of human reality.

But bad faith is not restricted to denying the qualities which I possess,

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to not seeing-Fhe being which I am. It attempts also to constitute myself as being what I am not. It apprehends me positively as courageous when I am not so. And that is possible, once again, only if I am what I am not; that is, if non-being in me does not have being even as non-being.

Of course necessarily I am not courageous; otherwise bad faith would not be bad faith. But in addition my effort in bad faith must include the ontological compre

hension that even in my usual being what I am, I am
not it really and that there is no such difference between the being of
"being-sad," for example-which I am in the mode of not being what I am
-and the "non-being" of not-being-courageous which I wish to hide from
myself. Moreover it is particularly requisite tharthe very negation of being
should be itself the object of a perpetual nihilation, that the very meaning
of "non-being" be perpetually in question in human reality. If I were not
courageous in the way in which this inkwell is not a table; that is, if I
were isolated in my cowardice, propped firmly against it, incapable of
putting it in relation to its opposite, if I wcre not capable of determining
myself as cowardly--":that is, to deny courage to myself and thereby to
escape my cowardice in the very moment that I posit it-if it were not
on principle impossible for me to coincide with my not-being-courageous
as well as with my being-courageous-then any project of bad faith wouid
be prohibited me. Thus in order for-bad faith to be possible, sincerity
itself must be in bad faith. The condition of the possibility for bad
faith is that human reality, in its most immediate being, in the intra-
structure of the pre-reflective cogito, must be what it is not and not be
what it is.

III. THE "FAITH" OF BAD FAITH

WE have indicated for the moment only those conditions which render
bad faith conceivable, the structures of being which permit us to form
concepts of bad faith. We can not limit ourselves to these considerations;
we have not yet distinguished bad faith from falsehood. The two-faced
concepts which we have described would without a doubt be utilized
by a liar to discountenance his questioner, although their two-faced quality
being established on the being of man and not on some empirical circum-
stance, can and ought to be evident to all. The true problem of bad faith
stems evidently from the fact th~t bad faith is faith. It can not be either a
cynical lie or certainty-if certainty is the intuitive possession of the
object. But if we take belief as meaning the adherence of being to its
object when the object is not given or is given indistinctly, then bad
faith is belief; and the essential problem of bad faith is a problem of belief.
How can we believe by bad faith in the concepts which we forge ex-
pressly to persuade ourselves? We must note in fact that the project of

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bad faith must be itself in bad faith. I am not only in bad faith at the end of
my effort when I have constructed my two-faced concepts and when I
have persuaded myself. In truth, I have not persuaded myself; to the extent
that I could be so persuaded, I have always been so. And at the very mo-
ment when I was disposed to put myself in bad faith, I of necessity was
in bad faith with respect to this same disposition. For me to have repre-
sented it to myself as bad faith would have been cynicism; to believe it
sincerely innocent would have been in good faith. The decision to be in
bad faith does not dare to speak its name; it believes itself and does not
believe itself in bad faith; it believes itself and does not believe itself in
good faith. It is this which from the upsurge of bad faith, determines
the later attitude and, as it were, the Weltanschauung of bad faith.
Bad faith does not hold the norms and criteria of truth as they are
accepted by the critical thought of

gOCld faith. What it decides first, in
fact, ,is the nature of truth. With bad faith a truth appears, a method of thinking, a type of being which is like that of objects; the ontological characteristic of the world of bad faith with which the subject suddenly surrounds himself is this: that here being is what it is not, and is not what it is. Consequently a peculiar type of evidence appears; non-persuasive evidence. Bad faith apprehends evidence but it is resigned in advance to not being fulfilled by this evidence, to not being persuaded and transfonned into good faith. It makes itself humble and modest; it is not ignorant, it. says, that faith is decision and that after each intuition, it must decide and wi11 what it is. Thus bad faith in its primitive project and in its coming into the world decides on the exact nature of its requirements. It stands forth in the finn resolution not to demand too much, to count itself satisfied when it is barely persuaded, to force itself in decisions to adhere to uncertain truths. This original project of bad faith is a decision in bad faith on the nature of faith. Let us understand clearly that there is no question of a reflective, voluntary decision, but of a spontaneous determination of our being. One puts oneself in bad faith as one goes to sleep and one is in bad faith as one dreams. Once this mode of being has been realized, it is as difficult to get out of it as to wake oneself up; bad faith is a type of being in the world, like waking or dreaming, which by itself tends to perpetuate itself, although its structure is of the metastable type. But bad faith is conscious of its structure, and it has taken precautions by deciding that the metastable structure is the structure of being and that non-persuasion is the structure of all convictions. It follows that if bad faith is faith and if it includes in its original project its· own negation (it determines itself to be not quite convinced in order to convince itself that I am what I am not), then to start with, a faith which wishes itself to be not quite convinced must be possible. What are the conditions for the possibility of such a faith?
I believe that my friend Pierre feels friendship for me. I believe it in

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good faith. I believe it but I do not have for it any self-evident intuition, for the nature of th.e object does not lend itself to intuition. I believe it; that is, I allow myself to give in to all impulses to trust it; I decide to believe in it, and to maintain myself in this decision; I conduct myself, finally, as if I were certain of it-and all this in the synthetic unity of one and the same attitude. This which I define as good faith is what Hegel would call theimmediate. It is simple faith. Hegel would demonstrate at once that the immediate calls for mediation and that belief by becoming belief for Itself, passes to the state of non-belief. If I believe that my friend Pierre likes me, this means that his friendship appears to me as the meaning of all his acts. Belief is a particular consciousness of the meaning of Pierre's acts. But if I know that I believe, the belief appears to me as pure subjective determination without external correlative. This is what makes the very word "to believe" a term utilized indifferently to indicate the unwavering. firmness of belief ("My God, I believe in you") and its character as disarmed and strictly subje

ctive. ("Is Pierre my friend? I do not know;
I believe so.") But the nature of consciousness is such that in it the mediate and the immediate are one and the same being. To believe is to know that one believes, and to know that one believes is no longer to believe. Thus to believe is not to believe any longer because that is only to believe -this in the unity of one and the same non-thetic self-consciousness. To be sure, we have here forced the description of the phenomenon by designating it with the word to know; non-thetic consciousness is not to know. But it is in its very translucency at the origin of all knowing. Thus the' non-thetic consciousness (of) believing is destructive of belief.
But at the same time the very law of the pre-reflective cogito implies that the being of believing ought to be the consciousness of believing.
Thus belief is a being which questions its own being, which can realize itse1fonly in its destruction, which can manifest itself to itself only by denying itself. It is a being for which to be is to appear· and to appear is to deny itself. To believe is not-to-believe. We see the reason for it; the being of consciousness is to exist by itself, then to make itself be and thereby to pass byond itself. In this sense consciousness. is perpetually escaping itself, belief becomes non-belief, the immediate becomes mediation, the absolute becomes relative, and the relative becomes absolute. The idealof good faith (to believe what one believes) is, like that of sincerity (to be what one is), an ideal of being-in-itself. Every belief is a belief that falls short; one never wholly believes what one believes. Consequently the primitive project of bad faith is only the utilization of this self-destruction of the fact of consciousness. If every belief in good faith is an impossible belief, then there is a place for every impossible belief. My inability to believe that I am courageous will not discourage me since every belief involves not quite believing. I shall define this impossible belief as my belief. To be sure, I shall not be able to hide from myself that I believe

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in order not to believe and that I do not believe in order to believe. But the subtle, total annihilation of bad faith by itself can not surprise me; it exists at the basis of all faith. What is it then? At the moment when I wish to believe myself courageous I know that I am a coward. And this certainly would come to destroy my belief. But first, I am not anymore courageous than cowardly, if we are to understand this in the mode of being of the-in-itself. In the second place, I do not know that I am courageous; such a view of myself can be accompanied only by belief, for it surpasses pure reflective certitude. In the third place, it is very true that bad faith does not succeed in believing what it wishes to believe. But it is precisely as the acceptance of not believing what it believes that it is bad faith. Good faith wishes to flee the "not-believing-what-one-believes" by finding refuge in being. Bad faith flees being by taking refuge in "not-believing-what-one-believes." It has disarmed all beliefs in advance-those which it would like to take hold of and, by the same stroke, the others, those which it wishes to flee. In willing this self-destruction of belief, from which science escapes by searching for evidence, it ruins the beliefs which are oppose

d to it, which reveal themselves as being only belief. Thus we can better understand the original phenomenon of bad faith.

In bad faith there is no cynical lie nor knowing preparation for deceitful concepts. But the first act of bad faith is to flee what it can not flee, to flee what it is. The very project of flight reveals to bad faith an inner disintegration in the heart of being, and it is this disintegration which bad faith wishes to be. In truth, the two immediate .attitudes which we can take in the face of our being are conditioned by the very nature of this being and its immediate relation with the in-itself. Good faith seeks to flee the inner disintegration of my being in the direction of the in-itself which it should be and is not. Bad faith seeks to flee the in-itself by means of the inner disintegration of my being. But it denies this very disintegration as it denies that it is itself bad faith. Bad faith seeks by means of "not-being-what-one-is" to escape from the in-itself which I am not in the mode of being what one is not. It denies itself as bad faith and aims at the in-itself which I am not in the mode of "not-being-what-one-is-not."ll If bad faith is possible, it is because it is an immediate, permanent threat to every project of the human being; it is because consciousness conceals in its being a permanent risk of bad faith. The origin of this risk is the fact that the nature of consciousness simultaneously is to be what it is not and not to be what it is. In the light of these remarks we can now approach the ontological study of consciousness, not as the totality of the human being, but as the instantaneous nucleus of this being.

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9 If it is indifferent whether one is in good or in bad faith, because bad faith reapprehends good faith and slides to the very origin of the project of good faith, that does not mean that we can not radically escape bad faith. But this supposes a self-recovery of being which was previouslycorrupted. This self-recovery we shall call authenticity, the description of which has no place here.

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CHAPTER ONE
Immediate Struaures of the For-Itself

I. PRESENCE TO SELF

NEGATION has referred us to freedom, freedom to bad faith, and bad faith to the being of consciousness, which is the requisite condition for the possibility of bad faith. In the light of the requirements which we have established in the preceding chapters, we must now resume the description which we attempted in the Introduction of this work; that is, we must return to the plane of the pre-reflective cogito. Now the cogito never gives out anything other than what we ask of it. Descartes questioned it concerning its functional aspect-"I doubt, I think." And because he wished to pass without a conducting thread from this functional aspect to existential dialectic, he fell into the error of substance. Husserl, warned by this error, remmned timidly on the plane of functional description.

Due to this fact he never passed beyond the pure description of the appearance as such; he has shut himself up inside the cogito and deserves-in spite of his denial-to be called a phenomenalist rather than a phenomenologist. His phenomenalism at every moment borders on Kantian idealism. Heidegger, wishing to avoid that descriptive phenomenalism which leads to the Megarian, antidialectic isolation of essences, begins with the existential analytic wit

hout going through the cogito. But since the
Dasein has from the start been deprived of the dimension of consciousness, it can never regain this dimension. Heidegger endows human reality with a self-understanding which he defines as an "ekstatic pro-ject" of its own possibilities. It is certainly not my intention to deny the existence of this project. But how could there be an understanding which would not in itself be the consciousness (of) being understanding? This ekstatic character of human reality will lapse into a thing-like, blind in-itself unless it arises from the consciousness of ekstasis. In truth the cogito must be

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our point of departure, but we can say of it, parodying a famous saying, that it leads us only on condition that we get out of it. Our preceding study, which concerned the conditions for the possibility of certain types of conduct, had as its goal only to place us in a position to question the cogito about its being and to furnish us with the dialectic instrument wh~ch would enable us to find in the cogito itself the means of escaping from instantaneity toward the totality of being which constitutes human reality. Let us return now to description of non-thetic self-consciousness; let us examine its results and ask what it means for consciousness that it must necessarily be what it is not and not be what it is.
"The being of consciousness," we said in the Introduction, "is a being such that in its being, its being is in question," This means that the being of consciousness does not coincide with itself in a full equivalence. Such equivalence, which is that of the in-itself, is expressed by this simple formula: being is what it is. In. the in-itself there is. not a particle of being which is not wholly within itself without distance. When being is thus conceived there is not the slightest suspicion of duality in it;this is what we mean when we say that the density of b~ing of the in-itself is infinite. It is a fullness. The principle of identity can lie said to be synthetic not only because it liI~its its scope to a region of definite being, but in particular because it masses within it the infinity of density. "A is A" means that A exists in an infinite compression with an infinite density. Identity is the limiting concept of unification: it is not true that the in-itself has any need of a synthetic unification of its bein/?; at its own extreme limit, unity disappears and passes into identity. Identity is the ideal of "one," and "one" comes into the world by human reality. The in-itself is full of itself, and no more total plenitude can be imagined, no more perfect equivalence of content to container. There is not the slightest emptiness in being, not the tiniest crack through which nothingness might~lip in.
The distinguishing characteristic of consciousness, on the other hand, is that it is a decompression of being. Indeed it is impossible to define it as coincidence with itself. Of this table I can say only that it is purely and simply this table. But I can not limit myself to saying that my belief is belief; my belief is the consciousness (of) belief. It is often said that the act of reflection alters the fact of consciousness on which it is directed. Husser! himself admits that the fact "of being seen" involves a total modification for each Erlebnis. But I believe that I have demonstrated that the first

condition of all reflection is a pre-reflective cogito. This cogito, to be sure, does not posit an .object; it remains within consciousness. But it is nonetheless homologous with the reflective cogito since it appears as the first necessity for non-reflective consciousness to be seen by itself. Originally then the cogito includes this nullifying characteristic of existing f,)r a witness, although the witness for which consciousness exists is itself. 1bus by the sole fact that my belief is apprehended as belief, it is no

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longer only belief; that is, it is already no longer belief; it is troubled be· lief. Thus the ontological judgment "belief is consciousness (of) belief" can under no circumstances be taken as a statement of identity; the subject and the attribute are radically different though still within the in-dissoluble unity of one and the same being.

Very well, someone will say, but at least we must say that consciousness (of) belief is consciousness (of) belief. We rediscover identity and the in-itself on this level. It was only a matter of choosing the appropriate plane on which we should apprehend our object. But that is not true: to affirm that the consciousness (of) belief is consciousness (of) belief is to dis-sociate consciousness from belief, to suppress the parenthesis, and to make belief an object for consciousness; it is to launch abruptly on to the plane of reflectivity. A consciousness (of) belief which would be only consciousness (of) belief would in fact have to assume consciousness (of) itself as consciousness (of) belief. Belief would become a pure transcend-ing and noematic qualification of consciousness; consciousness would be free to determine itSelf as it pleased in the face of that belief. It would resemble that impassive regard which, according to Victor Cousin, con-sciousness casts on psychic phenomena in order to elucidate them one by One. But the analysis of methodical doubt which Husserl attempted has clearly shown the fact that only reflective consciousness can be dissociated from what is posited by the consciousness reflected-on. It is on the re-flective level only that we can attempt an E'II"OX~,I a putting between parentheses, only there that we can refuse what Husserl calls the mit-machen.2 The consciousness (of) belief, while irreparably altering belief, does not distinguish itself from belief; it exists in order to perform the act of faith. Thus we are obliged to admit that the consciousness (of) be· lief is belief, At its origin we have apprehended this double game of ref-erence: consciousness (of) belief is belief and belief is consciousness (of) belief. On no account can we say that consciousness is consciousness or that belief is belief. Each of the terms refers to the other and passes into the other, and yet each term is different from the other. We have seen that neither belief nor pleasure nor joy can exist before being con-scious; consciousness is the measure of their being; yet it is no less true that belief, owing to the very fact that it can exist only as troubled, exists from the start as escaping itself, as shattering the unity of all the concepts in which one can wish to inclose it.

Thus consciousness (of) belief and belief are one and the same being, the characteristic of which is absolute immanence. But as soon as we wish to grasp tllis being, it slips between our fin

gers, and we find ourselves
faced with a pattern of duality, with a game of reflections. For conscious-
1 Correction for box". an obvious rni!lprint. Tr.
2 "To take part in," "to participate," Tr.

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ness is a reflection (reflet), but qua reflection it is exactly the one reflecting (reflechissant), and if we attempt to grasp it as reflecting, it vanishes and we fall back on the reflection. This structure of the reflection-reflecting (rcflet-refletant) has disconcerted philosophers, who have wanted to explain it by an appeal to infinity-either by positing it as an idea-ideae as Spinoza did, who calls it an idea-ideae-ideae, etc., or by defining it in the manner of Hegel as a return upon itself, as the veritable infinite. But the introduction of infinity into consciousness, aside from the fact that it fixes the phenomenon and obscures it, is only an explicative theory expressly designed to reduce the being of consciousness to that of the in-itself. Yet if we accept the objective existence of the reflection-reflecting as it is given, we are obliged to conceive a mode of being different from that of the in-itself, not a unity which contains a duality, not a synthesis which surpasses and lifts the abstract moments of the thesis and of the antithesis, but a duality which is unity, a reflection (reflet) which is its own reflecting (reflection). In fact if we seek to lay hold on the total phenomenon (i.e., the unity of this duality or consciousness (of) belief), we are referred immediately to one of the terms, and this term in turn refers us to the unitary organization of immanence. But if on the contrary we wish to take our point ofdeparture from duality as such and to posit consciousness and belief as a dyad, thep we encounter the idea-ide;le of Spinoza and we miss the prereflective phenomenon which we wished to study. This is because prereflective consciousness is self-consciousness. It is this same notion of self which must be studied, for it defines the very being of consciousness.
Let us note first that the term in-itself, which we have borrowed from tradition to designate the transcending being, is inaccurate. At the limit of coincidence with itself, in fact, the self vanishes to give place to identical being. The self can not be a property of beingcin-itself. By nature it is a reflexive, as syntax sufficiently indicates-in particular the logical rigor of Latin syntax with the strict distinctions imposed by grammar between the uses of ejus and sui. The self refers, but it refers precisely to the subject. It indicates a relation between the subject and himself, and this relation is precisely a duality, but a particular duality since it requires particular verbal symbols. But on the other hand, the self does not designate being either as subject or as predicate. If indeed I consider the "se" in "il s'ennuie,"3 for example, I establish that it opens up to allow the subject himself to appear behind it. It is not the subject, since the subject without relation to himself would be condensed into the identity of the in-itself; neither is it a consistent articulation of the real, since it allows the subject to appear behind it. In faet the self cannot be apprehended as a real existent; the subject can not be self, for coincidence with self, as we have seen, causes the self to disappear. But neither can it not b1 itself
a Literally the "self

" in "he bores himself" (il s'ennuie), a familiar construction in
the many French reflexive verbs. Cf. En~lish "he washes himself." Tr.

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since the self is an indication of the subject himself. The self therefore
represents an ideal distance within the immanence of the subject in rela-
lation to himself, a way of not being his own coincidence, of escaping
identity while positing it as unity-in short, of being in a perpetually
unstable equilibrium between identity as absolute cohesion without a
trace of diversity and unity as a synthesis .of a multiplicity. This is what
we shall call presence to itself. The law of being of the for-itself, as the
ontological foundation of consciousness, is to be itself in the form of
presence to itself.

This presence to itself has often been taken for a plenitude of existence,
and a strong prejudice prevalent among philosophers causes them to at-
tribute to consciousness the highest rank in being. But this postulate can
not be maintained after a more thorough description of the notion of
presence. Actually presence to always implies duality, at least a virtual
separation. The presence of being to itself implies a detachment 011 the
partof being in relation to itself. The coincidence of identity is the veri-
table plenitude of being exactly because in this coincidence there is left
no place for any negativity. Of course the principle of identity can involve
the principle of noncontradiction as Hegel has observed. The being which
is what it is must be able to be the being which is not what it is not. But
in the first place this negation, like all others, comes to the surface of being
through human reality, as we have shown, and not through a dialectic
appropriate just to being. In addition this principle can denote only
the relations of being with the external, exactly because it presides over
the relations of being with what it is not. We are dealing then with a
principle constitutive of external relations such that they can appear to a
human reality present to being-in-itself and engaged in the world. This
principle does not concern the internal relations of being; these relations,
inasmuch as they would posit an otherness, do not exist. The principle of
identity is the negation of every species of relation at the heart of being-
in-itself.

Presence to self, on the contrary, supposes that an impalpable fissure
has slipped into being. If being is present to itself, it is because it is not
wholly itself. Presence is an immediate ueterioration of coincidence, for it
supposes separation. But if we ask ourselves at this point what it is which
separates the subject from himself, we are forced to admit that it· is no-
thing. Ordinarily what separates is a distance in space, a lapse of time, a psy-
chological difference, or simply the individuality of two co-presents-in
short, a qualified reality. But in the case which concerns us, nothing can
separate the consciousness (of) belief from belief, since belief is nothing
other than the consciousness (of) belief. To introduce into the unity of a
pre-reflective cogito a qualified element external to this cogito would be to
shatter its unity, to destroy its translucency; there would then be in con-
sciousness something of which it would not be conscious and which would

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not exist in itself as consciousness. TIle

separation which separates belief
from itself can not be grasped or even conceived in isolation. If we seek
to reveal it, it vanishes. We find belief once more as pure immanence.
But if, on the other hand, we wish to apprehend belief as such, then the
fissure is there, appearing when we do not wish to see it, disappearing as
soon as we seek to contemplate it. This fissure then is the pure negative.
Distance, lapse of time, psychological difference can be apprehended in
themselves and include as such elements of positivity; they have a simple
negative function. But the fissure within consciousness is a nothing except
for the fact that it denies and that it can have being only as we do not see it.
This negative which is the nothingness of being and the nihilating power
both together, is nothingness. Nowhere else can we grasp it in such purity.
Everywhere else in one way or another we must confer on it being-in-itself
as nothingness. But the nothingness which arises in the heart of con-
sciousness is not. It is made-to-be. Belief, for example, is not the con-
tiguity of one being with another being; it is its own presence to itself,
its Own decompression of being. Otherwise the unity of the for-itself would
dissolve into the duality of two in-itselfs." Thus the for-itself must be
its Own nothingness. The being of consciousness qua consciousness is to
exist at a distance from itself as a presence to itself, and this empty dis-
tance which being carries in its being is Nothingness. Thus in order for a
self to exist, it is necessary that the unity of this being include its own
nothingness as the nihilation of identity. For the nothingness which slips
into belief is its nothingness, the nothingness of belief as belief in itself,
as belief blind and full, as "simple faith." The for-itself is the being which
determines itself to exist inasmuch as it can not coincide with itself.
Hence we understand how it was that by questioning the pre-reflective
cogito without any conducting thread, we could not find nothingness any-
where. One does not lind, one does not disclose notbingness in the man-
ner in which one can find, disclose a being. Nothingness is always an else-
where. It is the obligation for the for-itself never to exist except in the form
of an elsewhere in relation to itself, to exist as a being which perpetually
effects in itself a break in being. This break does not refer us elsewhere
to another being; it is only a perpetual reference of self to self, of the reflec-
tion to the reflecting, of the reflecting to the reflection. This reference,
however, does not provoke an infinite movement in the heart of the for-it-
self but is given within the unity of a single act. The infinite movement be-
longs only to the reflective regard which wants to apprehend the phenome-
non as a totality and which is referred from the reflection to the reflecting,
from the reflecting to the reflection without being able to stop. Thus noth-

" Deux en-soi. Ungrammatical as the expression "in-itselfs" admittedly is, it seems to me the most accurate translation. "In-themselves" would have a different meaning, for it would suggest a unity of two examples of being-in-itself, and Same's point here is their duality and isolation from each other. Tr.

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ingness is this hole of being, this fall of the in-itself toward the self, the
fall by which the for-itself is constit

uted. But this nothingness can only
"be made-to-be" if its borrowed existence is correlative with a nihilating act on the part of being. This perpetual act by which the in-itself degenerates into presence to itself we shall call an ontological act. Nothingness is the putting into question of being by being-that is, precisely consciousness or for-self. It is an absolute event which comes to being by means of being and which without having bei~g, is perpetually sustained by being. Since being-in-itself \s isolated in its being by its total positivity no being can produce being ana nothing can happen to being through being-except for nothingness. Nothingness is the peculiar possibility of being and its unique possibility. Yet this original possibility appears only in the absolute act which realizes it. Since nothingness is nothingness of being, it can come to being only through being itself. Of course it comes to being through a particular being, which is human reality. But this being is constituted as human reality inasmuch as this being is nothing but the original project of its own nothingness. Human reality is being in so far as within its being and for its being it is the unique foundation of nothingness at the heart of being.

II. THE FACTICIIT OF THE FOR-ITSELF

YET the for-itself is. It is, we may sa7, even if it is a being which is not what it is and which is what it is not. It is since whatever reefs there may be to cause it to founder..still the project of sincerity is at least conceivable. The for-itself is, in the manner of an event, in the sense in which I can say that Philip II has been, that my friend Pierre is or exists. The for-itself is, in so far as it appears in a condition which it has not chosen, as Pierre is a French bourgeois in 1942, as Schmitt was a Berlin worker in 1870; it is in so far as it is thrown into a world and abandoned in a "situation;" it is as pure contingency inasmuch as for it as for things in the world, as for this wall, this tree, this cup, the original question can be posited: "Why is this being exactly such and not otherwise?" It is in so far as there is in it something of which it is not the foundation-its presence to the world.

Being apprehends itself as not being its own foundation, and this apprehension is at the basis of every cogito. In this connection it is to be noted that it reveals itself immediately to the reflective cogito of Descartes. When Descartes wants to profit from this revelation, he apprehends himself as an imperfect being "since he doubts." But in this imperfect being, he establishes the presence of the idea of perfection. He apprehends then a cleavage between the type of being which he can conceive and the being which he is. It is this cleavage or lack of being which

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is at the origin of the second proof of the existence of God. In fact if we get rid of the scholastic terminology, what remains of this proof? The very clear indication that the being which possesses in itself the idea of perfection can not be its own foundation, for if it were, it would have produced itself in conformance with that idea. In other words, a being which would be its own foundation could not suffer the slightest discrepancy between what it is and what it conceives, for it would produce itself in conformance with its comprehension of being and could conceive only of what it is.

But this a

pprehension of being as :r lack of being in the face of being
is first a comprehension on the part of the cogito of its own contingency. I
think, therefore I am. \Vhat am I? A being which is not its own founda-
tion, which qua being, could be other than it is to the extent that it does
not account for its being. This is that first intuition of our own con-
tingency which Heidegger gives as the first motivation for the passage from
the un-authentic to the autheIltic.~ There is restlessness, an appeal to the
conscience (Rut des Gewissens), a feeling of guilt. In truth I-Ieidcgger's de-
scription shows all too clearly his anxiety to establish an ontological foun-
dation for an Ethics with which he claims not to be concerned, as also to
reconcile his humanism with the religious sense of the transcendent. The
intuition of our contingency is not identical with a feeling of guilt. Never-
theless it is true that in our own apprehension of ourselves, we appear to
ourselves as having the character of an unjustifiable fact.
Earlier, however, we apprehended ourselves as consciousness-that is,
as a "being which exists by itself."o How within the unity of one and the
same upsurge into being, can we be that being which exists by itself as not
being the foundation of its being? Or in other words, since the for-itself-
in so far as it is-is not its own being (i.e., is not the foundation of it),
how can it as for-itself, be the foundation of its own nothingness? The
answer is in the question.
While being is ind~ed the foundation of nothingness as the nihilation
of its own being, that is not the same as saying that it is the foundation of
its being. To found its own being it would have to exist at a distance
from itself, and that would imply a certain nihilation of the being founded
as of the being which founds-a duality which would be unity; here we
should fall back into the case of the for-itself. In short, every effort to
conceive of the idea of a being which would be the foundation of its
being results inevitably in forming that of a being which contingent as
being-in-itself, would be the foundation of its own nothingness. The
act of causation by which God is causa sui is a nihilating act like every
recovery of the self by the self, to the same degree that the original re-
II I have corrected what must surely be a misprint. "From the authentic to the au-
thentic," as the text actually reads, would make no sense. Tr.
41 Cf.Introduction, section III.
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lation of necessity is a return to self, a reflexivity; This original ne-
cessity in turn appears on the foundation of a contingent being, precisely
that being which is in order to be the the cause of itself. Leibniz' effort to
define necessity in terms of possibility-a definition taken up again by
Kant-is undertaken from the point of view of knowledge 'and not from
the point of view of being. The passage from possibility to being such as
Leibniz conceives it (the necessary is a being whose possibility implies its
existence) marks the passage from our ignorance to knowledge. In fact
since possibility precedes existence, it can be possibility only with re-
spect to our thought. It is an external possibility in relation to the being
whose possibility it is, since being unrolls from it like a consequence
from a principle. But we pointed out e~rlier that the notion of possibility
could be considered in

two aspects. We can make of it a subjective indica-
tion. The statement, "It is possible that Pierre is dead," indicates that I am in ignorance concerning Pierre's fate, and in this case it is a witness who decides the possible in the presence of the world. Being has its possibility outside of itself in the pure regard which gauges its chances of being; possibility can indeed be given to us before being; but it is to us that it is given and it is in no way the possibility of this being. The billiard ball which rolls on the table does not possess the possibility of being turned from its path by a fold in the cloth; neither does the possibility of deviation belong to the cloth; it can be established only by a witness synthetically as an external relation. But possibility can also appear to us as an ontological structure· of the real. Then it belongs to certain beings as tlleir possibility; it is the possibility which they are, which they have to be. In this case being sustains its own possibilities in being; it is their foundation, and the necessity of being can not then be derived from its possibility. In a word, God, if he exists, is contingent.

Thus the being of consciousness, since this being is in itself in order to nihilate itself in for-itself, remains contingent; that is, it is not the role of consciousness either to give being to itself or to receive it from others.

In addition to the fact that the ontological proof like the cosmological proof fails to establish a necessary being, the explanation and the foundation of my being-in so far as I am a particular being-can not be sought in necessary being. The premises, "Everything which is contingent must find a foundation in a necessary being. Now I am contingent," mark a desire to find a foundation and do not furnish the explicative link with a real foundation. Such premises could not in any way account for this contingency but only for the abstract idea of contingency in general. Furthermore the question here is one of value, not faeU But while being in-itself is contingent, it recovers itself by degenerating into a for-itself. It is, in order to lose itself in afor-itself. In a word being is and can only be. But 7 I1lis reasoning indeed is explicitly based on the exigencies of reasoll.

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the peculiar possibility of being-that which is revealed in the nihilating act-is of being the foundation of itself as conSCIousness through the sacrificial act which nihilates being. The for-itself is the in-itself losing itself as in-itself in order to found itself as consciousness. Thus consciousness holds within itself its own being-as-consciousness, and since it is its own nihilation, it can refer only to itself; but that which is annihilated8 in consciousness-though we can not call it the foundation of consciousness-is the contingent in-itself. The in-itself can not provide the foundation for anything; if it founds itself, it does so by giving itself the modification of the for-itself. It is the foundation of itself in so far as it is already no longer in-itself, and we encounter here again the origin of every foundation. If being in-itself can be neither its own foundation nor that of other beings, the whole idea of foundation comes into the world through the for-itself. It is not only that the for-itself as a nihilated in-itself is itself given a foundation, but with it foundation appears

for the
first time.
.
~t follows that this in-itself, engulfed and nihilated in the absolute event which is the appearance of the foundation or upsurge of the for-itself, remains at the heart of the for-itself as its original contingency. Consciousness is its own foundation but it remains contingent in order that there may be a consciousness rather than an infinity of pure and simple in-itself. The absolute event or for-itself is contingent in its very being. If I decipher the givens of the pre-reflective cogito, I establish, to be sure, that the for-itself refers to itself. Whatever the for-itself may be, it is this in the mode of consciousness of being. Thirst refers to the consciousness of thirst, which it is, as to its foundation-and conversely. But the totality "reflected -reflecting," if it could be given, would be contingency and in-itself.
But this totality can not be attained, since I can not say either that the consciousness of thirst is consciousness of thirst, or that thirst is thirst. It is there as a nihilated totality, as the evanescent unity of the phenomenon. If I apprehend the phenomenon as plurality, this plurality indicates itself as a total unity, and hence its meaning is its contingency. That is, I can ask myself, "Why am I thirsty? Why am I conscious of this glass? Of this Me?" But as scon as I consider this totality in in-itself, it nihilates itself under my regard. It is not; it is in order not to be, and I return to the for-itself apprehended in its suggestion of duality as the foundation of itself. I am angry because I produce myself as consciousness of anger. Suppress this self-<:ausation which constitutes the being of the for-itself, and you will no longer find anything, not even "anger-in-itself;" for anger exists by nature as for-itself. Thus the for-itself is sustained by a perpetual contingency for which it assumes the responsibility and which it assimilates without ever being able to suppress it. This perpetually evanescent con-
8 Sartre says "annihilated" here, but I feel that he must have meant "nihilated" since be has told us earlier that being cannot be annihilated. Tr.

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tingency of the in-itself which, without ever allowing itself to be apprehended, haunts the for-itself and reattaches it to being-in-itself-this contingency is what we shall call the facticity of the for-itself. It is this facticity which permits us to say that the for-itself is, that it exists, although we can never realize the facticity and although we always apprehend it through the for-itself.
We indicated earlier that we can be nothing without playing at bcing.9 "If I am a cafe waiter," we said, "this can be only in the mode of not being one." And that is true. If I could be a cafe waiter, I should suddenly constitute myself as a contingent block of identity. And that I am not. This contingent being in-itself always escapes me. But in order that I may freely give a meaning to the obligations which my state involves, then in one sense at the heart of the for-itself, as a perpetually evanescent totality, being-in-itself must be given as the evanescent contingency of my situation. This is the result of the fact that while I must play at being a cafe waiter in order to be one, still it would be in vain for me to play at being a diplo. mat or a sailor, for 1 would not be one. This inapprehensible fact of my

condition, this impalpable difference which distinguishes this drama of realization from drama pure and simple is what causes the for·itself, while choosing the meaning of its situation and while constituting itself as the foundation of itself in situation, not to choose its position. This part of my condition is what causes me to apprehend myself simultaneously as totally responsible for my being-inasmuch as I am its foundation-and yet as totally unjustifiable. Without facticity consciousness could choose its attachments to the world in the same way as the souls·in Plato's Republic choose their condition. I could determine myself to "be born a worker" or to "be born a bourgeois." But on the other hand facticity can not constitute me as being a bourgeois or being a workcr. It is not even strictly speaking a resistance of fact since it is only by recovering it in the substructure of the pre-reflective cogito that I confer on it its meaning and its resistance. Facticity is only one indication which I give myself of the being to which I must reunite myself in order to be what I am.

It is impossible to grasp faetidty in its brute nudity, since all that we will find of it is already recovered and freely constructed. The simple fact "of being there," at that table, in that chair is already the pure object of a limiting-concept and as such can not be grasped. Yet it is contained in my "consciousness of being-there," as its full contingcncy, as the nihilated in-itself on the basis of which the for-itself produces itself as consciousness of being there. The for-itself looking deep into itself as the consciousness of being there will never discover anything in itself but motivations; that is, it will be perpetually referred to itself and to its constant freedom. (I am there in order to ?.. etc.) But the contingency which paralyzes these motivations to the same degree as they g Part One, cbapter IT, section ii. "Patterns of Bad Faith." .

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totally found themselves is the facticity of the for-itself. The relation of the for-itself, which is its own foundat~on qua for-itself, to facticity can be correctly termed a factual necessity. It is indeed this factual necessity which Descartes and Husser! seized upon as constituting the evidence of the cogito. The for-itself is necessary in so far as it provides its own foundation. And this is why it is the object reflected by an apodictic intuition. I can not doubt that I am. But in so far as this for-itself as such could also no~ be, it has all the contingency of fact. Just as my nihilating freedom is apprehended in anguish, so the for-itself is conscious of its facticity. It has the feeling of its complete gratuity; it apprehends itself as being there for nothing, as being de trop.

We must not confuse facticity with that Cartesian substance whose attribute is thought. To be sure, thinking substance exists only as it thinks; and since it is a created thing, it participates in the contingency of the ens creatum. But it is. It preserves the character of being-in-itself in its integrity, although the for-itself is its attribute. This is what is called Descartes' substantialist illusion. For us, on the other hand, the appearance of the for-itself or absolute event refers indeed to the effort of an in-itself to found itself; it corresponds to an attempt on the part of being to remove contingency from its being.

But this attempt results in the nihilation
of the in-itself, because the in-itself can not found itself without introducing the self or a reflective, nihilating reference into the absolute identity of its being and consequently degenerating into for-itself. The for-itself corresponds then to an expanding de-structuring of the in-itself, and the in-itself is hihilated and absorbed in its attempt to found itself. Facticity ;s not then a substance of which the for-itself would be the attribute and which would produce thought without exhausting itself in that very production. It simply resides in the for-itself as a memory of being, as its unjustifiable presence in the world. Being-in-itself 'can found 'its nothingness but not its being. In its decompression it nihilates itself in a for-itself which becomes qua for-itself its own foundation; but the contingency which the for-itself has derived from the in-itself remains out of reach. It is what remains of the in-itself in the for-itself as facticity and what causes the for-itself to have only a factual necessity; that is, it is the foundation of its consciousness-of-being or existence, but on no account can it found its presence. Thus consciousness can in no case prevent itself from being and yet it is totally responsible for its being.

III. THE FOR-ITSELF AND THE BEING OF VALUEr

ANY study of human reality must begin with the cogito. But the Cartesian "I think" is conceived in the instantaneous perspective of temporality. Can we find in the heart of the cogito a way of transcending this instantaneity? If human reality were limited to the being of the "I think,"

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it would have only the truth of an instant. And it is indeed true that with Descartes the cogito is an instantaneous totality, since by itself it makes no claim on the future and since an act of continuous "creation" is necessary to make it pass from one instant to another. But can we even conceive of the truth of an instant? Does the cogito not in its own way engage both past and future? Heidegger is so persuaded that the "I think" of Husserl is a trap for larks, fascinating and ensnaring, that he has completely avoided any appeal to consciousness in his description of Dasein. His goal is to show it immediately as care; that is, as escaping itself in the project of self toward the possibilities which it is. It is this projection of the self outside the self which he calls "understanding" (Verstand) and which permits him to establish human reality as being a "revealing-revealed." But this attempt to shownrst the escape from self of the Dasein is going to encounter in turn insurmountable difficulties; we cannot first suppress the dimension "consciousness," not even if it is in order to reestablish it subsequently. Understanding has meaning only if it is consciousness of understanding. My possibility can exist as my possibility only if it is my consciousness which escapes itself toward my possibility. Otherwise the whole system of being and its possibilities will fall into the unconscious-that is into the in-itself. Behold, we are thrown back again towards the cogito. We must make this our point of departure.

Can we extend it without losing the benefits of reflective evidence? What has the description of the for-itself revealed to us?

First we have encountered a nihilation in which the being of the for-itself i

s affected in its being. This revelation of nothingness did not seem to us to pass beyond the limits of the cogito. But let us consider more closely.

The for-itself can not sustain nihilation without determining itself as a lack of being. This means that the nihilation does not coincide with a simple introduction of emptiness into consciousness. An external being has not expelled the in-itself from consciousness; rather the for-itself is perpetually determining itself not to be the in-itself. This means that it can establish itself only in terms of the in-itself and against the in-itself. Thus since the nihilation is the nihilation of being, it represents the original connection between the being of the for-itself and the being of the in-itself. The concrete, real in-itself is wholly present to the heart of consciousness as that which consciousness determines itself not to be. The cogito must nccesarily lead us to discover this total, out-of-reach presence of the in-itself. Of course the faet of this presence will be the very transcendence of the for-itself. But it is precisely the nihilation which is the origin of transcendence conceived as the original bond between the for-itself and the in-itself. Thus we catch a glimpse of a way ~getting out of the cogito. We shall see later indeed that the profound meaning of the cogito is essentially to refer outside itself. But it is not yet time to

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describe this characteristic of the for-itself. What our ontological description has immediately revealed is that this being is the foundation of itself as a lack of being; that is, that it determines its being by means of a being which it is not.

Nevertheless there are many ways of not being and some of them do not touch the inner nature of the being which is not what it is not. If, for example, I say of an inkwell that it is not a bird, the inkwell and the bird remain untouched by the negation. This is an external relation which can be established only by a human reality acting as witness. By contrast, there is a type of negation which establishes an internal relation between what one denies and that concerning which the denial is made.10

Of all internal negations, the one which penetrates most deeply into being, the one which constitutes in its being the being concerning which it makes the denial along with the being which it denies-this negation is lack. This lack does not belong to the nature of the in-itself, which is all positivity. It appears in the world only with the upsurge of human reality. It is only in the human world that there can be lacks. A lack presupposes a trinity:· that which is missing or "the lacking," that which misses what is lacking or "the existing," and a totality which has been broken by the lacking and which would be restored by the synthesis of "the lacking" and "the existing"-this is "the lacked."l1 The being which is released to the intuition of human reality is always that to which some thing is lacking-i.e., the existing. For example, if I say that the moon is not full and that one quarter is lacking, I base this judgment on full intuition of the crescent moon. Thus what is released to intuition is an in-itself which by itself is neither complete nor incomplete but which simply is what it is, without relation with other beings. In order for this in-itself to be grasped as the crescent moon, it is necessary .that

a human reality
surpass the given toward the project of the realized totality-here the disk of the full moon-and return toward the given to constitute it as the crescent moon; that is, .in order to realize it in its being in terms of the totality which becomes its foundation. In this same surpassing the lacking will be posited as that whose synthetic addition to the existing will re-constitute the synthetic totality of the lacked. In this sense the lacking is of the same nature as the existing; it would suffice to reverse the situa-tion in order for it to become the existing to which the lacking is missing, while the existing would become the lacking. This lacking as the comple-

10 Hegelian opposition belongs to this type of negation. But this opposition must it·self be based on an original internal negation; that is, on lack. For example, if the non·essential becomes in its tum the essential, this is because it is experienced as a lack in the heart of the essential.

11 Le manquant, "the lacking," l'existant, "the existing"; le manque, "the lacked." Le manque is "the lack." At times when manque is used as an adjective, I have trans-lated it as "missing," e.g., l'en-soi manque, "the missing in·itself." Tr.

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ment of the existing is determined in its being by the synthetic totality of the lacked. Thus in the human world, the incomplete being which is released to intuition as lacking is constituted in its being by the lacked-, that is, by what it is not. It is the full moon which confers on the cres-cent moon its being as crescent; what-is-not determines what-is. It is in the being of the existing, as the correlate of a human transcendence, to lead outside itself to the being which it is not-as to its meaning.

Human reality by which lack appears in the world must be itself a lack. For lack can come into being only through lack; the in-itself can not be the occasion of lack in the in-itself. In other words, in order for being to be lacking or lacked, it is necessary that a being make itself its own lack; only a being which lacks can surpass being toward the lacked.

The existence of desire as a human fact is sufficient to prove that human reality is a lack. In fact how can we explain desire if we insist on viewing it as a psychic state; that is, as a being whose nature is to be what it is? A being which is what it is, to the degree that it is considered as being what it is, summons nothing to itself in order to complete itself. An incom-plete circle does not call for completion unless it is surpassed by human transcendence. In itself it is complete and perfectly positive as an open curve. A psychic state which existed with the sufficiency of this curve could not possess in addition the slightest "appeal to" something else; it would be itself without any relation to what is not it. In order to constitute it as hunger or thirst, an external transcendence surpassing it toward the ta-tality "satisfied hunger" would be necessary, just as the crescent moon is surpassed toward the full moon.

We will not get out of the difficulty by making desire a conatus con-ceived in the manner of a physical force. For the conatus once again, even if we grant it the efficiency of a cause, can not possess in itself the character of a reaching out toward another state. The conatus as the pra-ducer of states can not be identified with desire as the appe

al from a state.
Neither wiI recourse to psycho-physiological parallelism enable us better to clear away the difficulties. Thirst as an organic phenomenon, as a "physiological" need of water, does not exist. An organism deprivcd of water presents' certain positive phenomena: for example, a certain coagulating thickening of the blood, which provokes in turn certain other phenomena. The ensemble is a positive state of the organism which refers only to itself, exactly as the thickening of a solution from which the water has evaporated can not be considered by itself as the solution's desire of water. If we suppose an exact correspondence between the mental and the physiological, this correspondence can be established only on the basis of ontological identity, as Spinoza has seen. Consequently the being of psychic thirst will be the being in itself of a state, and we are referred once again to a transcendent witness. But then the thirst will be desire for this transcendence but not for itself; it will be desire in the eyes of another.
II,

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If desire is to be able to be d.esire to itself it must necessarily be itself transcendence; that is, it must by nature be an escape from itself toward the desired object. In other words, it must be a lack-but not an object-lack, a lack undergone, created by the surpassing which it is not; it must be its own lack of -. Desire is a lack of being. It is haunted in its inmost being by the being of which it is desire. Thus it bears witness to the existence of lack in the being of human reality. But if human reality is lack, then it is through human reality t.hat the trinity of the eristing, the lacking and the lacked comes into being. What exactly are the three terms of this trinity?
That which plays here the role of the existing is what is released to the cogito as the immediate of the desire; for ey.ampJe, it is this for-itself which we have apprehended as not being what it is and being what it is not.
But how are we to define the lacked?
To answer this question, we must return to the idea of lack and -determine more exactly the bond which unites the existing to thdacking. This bond can notbe one of simple contiguity. If what is lacking is in its very absence still profoundly present at the heart of the existing, it is because the existing and the lacking are at the same moment apprehended and surpassed in the unity of a single totality. And that which constitutes itself as lack can do so only by surpassing itself toward one great broken form. Thus lack is appearance on the ground of a totality. Moreover it matters little whether this totality has been originally given and is now broken (e.g. "The arms of the Venus di MHo are now Jacking") or whether it has never yet been realized. (e.g. "He lacks courage.") Wbat is important is only that the lacking and the existing are given or are apprehended as about to be annihilated in the unity of the totality which is lacked. Everything which is lacking is lacking to -
fOT -. What is given in the unity of
a primitive upsurge is the for, conceived as not yet being or as not being any longer, an absence toward which the curtailed existing surpasses itself or is surpassed and thereby constitutes itself as curtailed. What is the for of human reality?
The for-itself, as the foundation of itself, is the upsurge of the negation. The for-itself founds itself in so far

as it denies in relation to itself a
certain being or a mode of being. What it denies or nihilates, as we know, is being-in-itself. But no m:l.tter what being-in-itself: human reality is before all else its own nothingness. Wh:.>.t it denies or nihilates in relation to itself as for-itself can be only itself. The meaning of human reality as nihilated is constituted by this nihilation and this presence in it of what it nihilates; hence the self-as-being-in-itself is what human reality lacks and what makes its meaning. Since hum:m reality in its primitive relation to itself is not what it is, its relation to itself is not primitive and can derive its meaning only from an original relation which is the nul1 relation or identity. It is the self which would be what it is which allows the for-itself to be

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apprehended as not being what it is; the relation denied in the definition of the for-itself-which as such should be first posited-is a relation (given as perpetually absent) between the for-itself and itself in the mode of identity. The meaning of the subtle confusion by which thirst escapes and is not thirst (in so far as it is consciousness of thirst), is a thirst which would be thirst and which haunts it. What the for-itself lacks is the self- or itself as in-itself.

Nevertheless we must not confuse this missing in-itself (the lacked), with that of facticity. The in-itself of facticity in its failure to found itself is reabsorbed in pure presence in the world on the part of the for-itself. The missing in-itself, on the other hand, is pure absence. Moreover the failure of the act to found the in-itself has caused the for-itself to rise up from the in-itself as the foundation of its own nothingness. But the meaning of the missing act of founding remains as transcendent. The for-itself in its being is failure because it is the foundation only of itself as nothingness. In tmth this failure is its very being, but it has meaning only if the for-itself apprehends itself as failure in the presence of the being which it has failed to be; thllt is, of the being which would be the foundation of its being and no longer merely the foundation of its nothingness-or~ to put it another way, which would be its foundation as coincidence with itself. By nature the cogito refers to the lacking and to the lacked, for the cogito is haunted by being, as Descartes well realized.

Such is the origin of transcendence. Human reality is its own surpassing toward what it lacks; it surpasses itself toward the particular being which it would be if it were what it is. Human reality is not something which exists first in order afterwards to lack this or that; it exists first as lack and in immediate, synthetic connection with what it lacks. Thus the pure event by which human reality rises as a presence in the world is apprehended by itself as its own Jack. In its coming into existence human reality grasps itself as an incomplete being. It apprehends itself as being in so far as it is not, in the presence of the particular totality which it lacks and Whic:~l it is in the form of not being it and which is what it is. Human reality is a perpetual surpassing toward a coincidence with itself which is never given. If the cogito reaches toward being, it is because by its very thmst it surpasses itself toward being by qualifying itself in its being as the being t

o which coincidence with self is lacking in order for it to be
what it is. The cogito is indissolubly linked to being-in-itself, not as a
thought to its object-which would make the in-itself relative-but as a
lack to that which defines its lack. In this sense the second Cartesian proof
is rigorous. Imperfect being surpasses itself toward perfect being; the being
which is the foundation only of its nothingness surpasses itself toward
the being which is the foundation of its being. But the being toward which
human reality surpasses itself is not a transcendent God; it is at the heart
of human reality; it is only human reality itself as totality.
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111is totality is not the pure and simple contingent in-itself of the tran-
scendent. If what consciollsness apprehends as the being toward which it
~urpasses itself were the pure in-itself, it would coincide with the annihi-
lation of consciousness. But consciousness does not surpass itself toward
it annihilation; it does not want to lose itself in the in-itself of identity
at the limit of its surpassing. It is for the for-itself as such that the for-
itself lays claim to being-in-itself.
Thus this perpetually absent being which haunts the for-itself is itself
fixed in the in-itself. It is the impossible synthesis of the for-itself and the
in-itself; it would be its own foundation not as nothingness but as being
and would preserve within it the necessary translucency of consciousness
along with the coincidence with itself of being-in-itself. It would preserve
in it that turning back upon the self which conditions every necessity and
every foundation. But this return to the self would be without distance;
it would not be presence to itself, but identity with itself. In short, this
being would be exactly the self which we have shown can exist only as a
perpetually evanescent relation, but it would be this self as substantial
being. Thus human reality arises as such in the presence of its own to-
tality or self as a lack of that totality. And this totality can not be given
by nature, since it combines in itself the. incompatible characteristics of
the in-itself and the for-itself.
Let no one reproach us with capriciously inventing a being of this kind;
when by a further movement of thought the being and absolute absence
of this totality are hypostasized as transcendence beyond the world, it
takes on the name of God. Is not God a being who is what he is-in that
he is all positivity and the foundation of the world-and at the same time
a being who is not what he is and who is what he is not-in that he is self·
consciousness and the necessary foundation of himself? The being of hu·
man reality is suffering because it rises in being as perpetually haunted by
a totality which it is without being able to be it, precisely because it could
not attain the in-itself without losing itself as for-itself. Human reality
therefore is by nature an unhappy consciousness with no possibility of
surpassing its unhappy state.
But what exactly is the nature of this being toward which unhappy con-
sciousness surpasses itself? Shall we say that it does not exist? Those COn-
tradictions which we discovered in it prove only that it can not be realized.
Nothing can hold out against this self-evident truth: consciousness can
exist only as engaged in this being which surrounds it on all sides and
which paralyzes it with

its phantom presence. Shall we say that it is a
being relative to consciousness? Thjs would be to confuse it with the
object of a thesis. This being is not posited through and before conscious-
ness; there is no consciousness of this being since it haunts non-thetic self·
consciousness. It points to consciousness as the meaning of its being and
yet consciousness is no more conscious of it than of itself. Still it can not

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escape from consciousness; but inasmuch as consciousncss enjoys being a
consciousness (of) being, this being is there. Consciousness does IlDt con-
fer meaning on this being as it does for this inkwell or this pencil; but
without this being, which it is in the form of not being it, consciousness
would not be consciousness-i.e., lack. On the contrary, consciousness
derives for itself its meaning as consciousness from this being. This being
comes into the world along with consciousness, at once in its heart and
outside it; it is absolute transcendence in absolute immancnce. It has no
priority over consciousness, and consciousness has no priority over it. They
form a dyad. Of course this being could not exist without the for-itself,
but neither could the for-itself exist without it. Consciousness in relation
to this being stands in the mode of being this being, for this being is con-
sciousness, but as a being which consciousness can not be. It is conscious-
ness itself, in the heart of consciousness, and yet out of reach, as an
absence, an unrealizable. Its nature is to inelose its own coatradiction
within itself; its relation to the for-itself is a total immanence which is
achieved in total transcendence.
Furthermore this being need not be conceived as present to conscious-
ness with only the abstract characteristics which our study has established.
The concrete consciousness arises in situation, and it is a unique, indi-
vidualized consciousness of this situation and (of) itself in situation. It
is to this concrete consciousness that the self is present, and all the con-
crete characteristics of consciousness have their correlates in the totality of
the self. The self is individual; it is the individual completion of the
self which haunts the for-itself.
A feeling, for example, is a feeling in the presence of a norm; that is,
a feeling of the same type but one which would be what it is. This norm
or totality of the affective self is directly present as a lack suffered in the
very heart of suffering. One suffers and one suffers from not suffering
enough. The suffering of which we speak is never exactly that which
we feel. What we call "noble" or "good" or "true" suffering and what
moves us is the suffering which we read on the faces of others, better yet
in portraits, in the face of a statue, in a tragic mask. It is a suffering which
has being. It is presented to us as a compact, objective whole which did
not await our coming in order to be and which overflows the conscious-
ness which we have of it; it is there in the midst of the world, impenetrable
and dense, like this tree or this stone; it endures; finally it is what it is.
\Ve can speak of it-tlIat suffering there which is expressed by that set of
the mouth, by that frown. It is supported and expressed by the physiog-
nomy but not crcated by it. Suffering is posited upon the physiognomy; it
is beyond passivity as beyond activity, beyond negation as beyond aff

irma-
tion-it is. However it can be only as consciousness of self. 'Ve know well
that this mask does not express the unconscious grimace of a sleeper or
the rictus of a dead man. It refers to possibilities, to :I situation in the

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world. The suffering is the conscious relation to these possibilities, to this
situation, but it is solidified, cast in the bronze of being. And it is as such
that it fascinates us; it stands as a degraded approximation of that suffering-
in-itself which haunts our own suffering. The suffering which I experience,
on the contrary, is never adequate suffering, due to the fact that it nihilates
itself as in itself by the very act by which it founds itself. It escapes as
suffering toward the consciousness of suffering. I can never be surprised
by it, for it is only to the exact degree that I experience it. Its translucency
removes from it all depth. I can not observe it as I observe the suffering
of the statue, since I make my own suffering and since I know it. If I
must suffer, I should prefer that my suffering would seize me and flow over
me like a storm, but instead I must raise it into existence in my free
spontaneity. I should like simultan~ously to be it and to conquer it, but
this enormous, opaque suffering, which should transport me out of my-
self, continues instead to touch me lightly with its wing, and I can not
grasp it. I find only myself, myself who moans, myself who wails, myself
who in order to realize this suffering which I am must play without respite
the drama of suffering. I wring my hands, I cry in order that being-in-it-
selfs, their sounds, their gestures may run through the world, ridden by
the suffering-in-itself which I can not be. Each groan, each facial expres-
sion of the man who suffers aims at sculpturing a statue-in-itself of suffer-
ing. But this statue will never exist save through others and for others. My
suffering suffers from being what it is not and from not being what it is.
At the point of being made one with itself, it escapes, separated from itself
by nothing, by that nothingness of which it is itself the foundation. It is
loquacious because it is not adequate, but its ideal is silence,-the silence
of the statue, of the beaten man who lowers his head and veils his face
without speaking. But with this man too-it is for me that he does not
speak. In himself he chatters incessantly, for the words of the inner lan-
guage are like the outlines of the "self" of suffering. It is for my eyes
that he is "crushed" by suffering; in himself he feels himself responsible
for that grief which he wills even while not wishing it and which he does
not wish even while willing it, that grief which is haunted by a perpetual
absence-the absence of the motionless, mute suffering which is the self,
the concrete, out-of reach totality of the for-itself which suffers, the for
of Human-Reality in suffering. We can see that my suffering never posits
this suffering-in-itself which visits it. My real suffering is not an eHort
to reach to the self. But it can be suffering only as consciousness (of)
not being enough suffering in the presence of that full and absent suffering.
Now we can ascertain more exactly what is the being of the self: it is
value. Value is affected with the double character, which moralists have
very inadequately explained, of both being unconditionally and not being.
Qua value indeed, value

passes this being, its permanence, its purity, its consistency, its identity, its silence, by reclaiming these qualities by virtue of presence to itself. And conversely if we start by considering it as presence to itself, this presence immediately is solidified, fixed in the in-itself. Moreover it is in its being the missing totality toward which a being makes itself be. It arises for a being, not as this being is what it is in full contingency, but as it is the foundation of its own nihilation. In this sense value haunts being as being founds itself but not as being is. Value haunts freedom. This means that the relation of value to the for-itself is very particular: it is the being which has to be in so far as it is the foundation of its nothingness of being. Yet while it has to be this being, this is not because it is under the pressure of an external constraint, nor because value, like the Unmoved Mover of Aristotle, exercises over it an attraction of fact, nor is it because its being has been received; but it is because in its being it makes itself be as having to be this being. In a word the self, the for-itself, and their inter-relation stand within the limits of an unconditioned freedom-in the sense that nothing makes value exist-unless it is that freedom which by the same stroke makes me myself exist-and also within the limits of concrete facticity-since as the foundation of its nothingness, the for-itself can not be the foundation of its being. There is then a total COntingency of being-for-vaIue(which will come up again in connection with morality to paralyze and relativize it) and at the same time a free and absolute necessity.12

Value in its original upsurge is not posited by the for-itself; it is consubstantial with it-to such a degree that there is no consciousness which is not haunted by its value and that human-reality in the broad sense includes both the for-itself and value. If value }Jaunts the for-itself without being posited by it, this is because value is n<11:: the object of a thesis; otherwise the for-itself would have to be a posHional object to itself since value and the for-itself can arise only in the consubstantial unity of a dyad. Thus the for-itself as a non-thetic self-consciousness does not exist in the face of value in the sense that for Leibniz the monad exists "alone in the face of God." Value therefore is not known at this stage since knowledge posits

12 One will perhaps be tempted to translate the trinity under consideration into Hegelian terms and to make of the in-itself, the thesis, of the for-itself the antithesis, and of the in-itself-for-itself or value the synthesis. But it must be noted here that while the For-itself lacks the In-itself, the In-itself does not)zck the For-itsclf. There is then no reciprocity in the opposition. In a word, the For-itself remains non-essential and contingent in relation to the In-itself, and it is this non-essentiality which we earlier called its facticity. In addition, the synthesis or value would indeed be a return, to the thesis, then a return upon itself; but as this is an unrealizable totality. the For-itself is not a moment which em be surpassed. As such its nature approaches mueh nearer to the "ambiguous" realities of Kierkegaard. Furthermore we find TIcre a dOl1hle play of unilaterOII oppositions= the For·itself in one sense lacks the In-itseTf, which does not lack the For·it

self. but in another sense the In-itself lacks its own possibuity (or the lacking For·itself), which in this case does not lack the In-itself.

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the object in the face of consciousness. Value is merely given with the non-thetic translucency of the for-itself, which makes itself be as the consciousness of being. Value is everywhere and nowhere; at the heart of the nihilating relation "reflection-reflecting," it is present and out of reach, and it is simply lived as the concrete meaning of that lack which makes my present being. In order for value to become the object of a thesis, the for-itself which it haunts must also appear before the regard of reflection. Reflective consciousness in fact accomplishes two things by the same stroke; the Erlebnis reflected-on is posited in its nature as lack and value is disengaged as the out-of reach meaning of what is lacked. Thus reflective consciousness can be propcrly called a moral consciousness since it can not arise without at the same moment disclosing values. It is obvious that I remain free in my reflective consciousness to direct my attention on these values or to neglect them-exactly as it depends on me to look more closely at this table, my pen, or my package of tobacco. But whether they are the object of a detailed attention or not, in any case they are. It is' not necessary to conclude, however, that the reflective regard is the only one which can make value appear, nor should we by analogy project the values of our for-itself into the world of transcendence. If the object of intuition is a phenomenon of human reality but transcendent, it is released immediatcly with its value, for the for-itsclf of the Other is not a hidden phenomenon which would be given only as the conclusion of a reasoning by analogy. It manifests itself originally to my for-itself; as we shall see, the presence of the for-itself as for-others is even the necessary condition for the constitution of the for-itself as such. In this upsurge of the for-others, value is given as in the upsurge of the for-itself, although in a different mode of bcing. But we can not treat here the objective encounter with, values in the world since we have not elucidated the nature of the for-others. \Ve shall return to the examination of this question in the third part of this work.

IV. THE FOR-ITSELF AND THE BEING OF POSSIBILITIES

'VE have seen that human reality as for-itself is a lack and that what it lacks is a certain coincidence with itself. Concretely, each particular for-itself (Erlebnis) lacks a certain particular and concrete reality, which if the for-itself were synthetically assimilated with it, would transform the for-itself into itself. It lacks something for something else-as the broken disc of the moon lacks that which would be necessary to complete it and transform it into a full moon. Thus the lacking arises in the process of transcendence and is determined by a return toward the existing in terms of the lacked. The lacking thus defined is transcendent and complementary in relation to the existing. They are then of the same nature. What the

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crescent moon lacks in order to be a full moon is precisely a fragment of moon; what the obtuse angle ABC lacks in order to make two right angles is the acute angle CBD. What the for-itself lacks in order to be mad

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whole with itself is the for-itself. But we are by no means dealing with a strange for-itself; that is, with a for-itself which I am not. In fact since the risen ideal is the coincidence with self, the lacking for-itself is a for-itself which I am. But on the other hand, if I were it in the mode of identity, the ensem1>le would become an in-itself. I am the lacking for-itself in the mode of having to be the for-itself which I am not, in order to identify myself with it in the unity of the self. Thus the original transcendent relation of the for-itself to the self perpetually outlines a project of identification of the for-itself with an absent for-itself which it is and which it lacks. What is given as the peculiar lack of each for-itself and what is strictly defined as lacking to precisely this for-itself and no other is the possibility of the for-itself. The possible rises on the ground of the nihilation of the for-itself. It is not conceived thematically afterwards as a means of reuniting the self. Rather the upsurge of the for·itself as the nihilation of the in-itself and the decompression of being causes possibility to arise as one of the aspects of this decompression of being; that is, as a way of being what one is-at a distance from the self. Thus the for-itself can not appear without being haunted by value and projected toward its own possibles. Yet as soon as it refers us to its possibles, the cogito drives us outside the instant toward that which it is in the mode of not being it.

In order to understand better how human reality both is and is not its own possibilities, we must return to the notion of the possible and attempt to elucidate it.

With the possible as with value there is the greatest difficulty in understanding its being, for it is given as prior to the being of which it is the pure possibility; and yet qua possible, at least, it necessarily must have being. Do we not say, "It is possible that he may come." Since Leibniz the term ~'possible" is usually applied to an event which is not engaged in an existing causal series such that the event can be surely determined and which involves no contradiction either with itself or with the system under consideration. Thus defined the possible is possible only with regard to knowledge since we are not in a position either to affirm or to d~·y the possible confronted.

ence we may take two attitudes in the face of the possible: We can c nsider, as Spinoza did, that possibilities exist only in connection with our ignorance and that they disappear when our ignorance disappears. In this case the possible is only a subjective stage on the road to perfect knowledge; it has only the reality of a psychic mode; as confused or curtailed thought it has a concrete being but not as a property of the world. But it is also permissible, as Leibniz does, to make of the infinity of possibles ob-

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jects of thought for the divine understanding and so confer on them a mode of absolute reality;. this position reserves for the divine will the power to realize the best system among them. In this case, although the monad's chain of perceptions is strictly determined, and although in terms of the very formula of Adam's substance an all-knowing being can establish with certainty Adam's decision, it is not absurd to say: "It is possible that Adam might not pick the apple." This

means only that there exists
by virtue of the thought of the divine understanding another system of co-possibles such that Adam figures there as having not eaten the fruit of the Tree of Knowledge.

But is this conception so different from that of Spinoza? Actually the reality of the possible is uniquely that of the divine thought! This means that it has being as thought which has not been realized. Of course the idea of subjectivity has been here pushed to its limit, for we are dealing 'with a divine consciousness, not mine; and if we have at the outset made a point of confusing subjectivity and finitude, subjectivity disappears when the understanding becomes infinite. Yet the fact remains that the possible is a thought which is only thougllt. Leibniz himself seems to have wished to confer an autonomy and a sort of peculiar weight on possibilities, for several of the metaphysical fragments published by Couturat show us possibles organizing themselves into systems of co-possibles in which the fullest and richest tend by themselves to be realized. But there is here only a suggestion of such a doctrine, and Leibniz has not developed it-doubtless because he could not do so. To give possibles a tendency toward being means either that the possible is already in full being and that it has the same type of being-in the sense that we grant to the bud a tendency to become a flower-or else that the possible in the bosom of the divine understanding is already an idea-force and that the maximum of idea-forces organized in a system automatically releases the divine will. But in the latter case we do not get out of the subjective. If then we define possible as non-contradictory, it can have being only as the thought of a being prior to the real world or prior to the pure consciousness of the / world such as it is. In either case the possible loses its nature as possible and is reabsorbed in the subjective being of the representation.

But this represented-being of the possible can not account for its nature; On the contrary it destroys its nature. In the everyday use which we make of the possible, we can in no way apprehend it either as an aspect of our ignorance or as a non-contradictory structure belonging to a world not realized and at the margin of this world. The possible appears to us as a property of beings. After glancing at the sky I state, "It is possible that it may rain." I do not understand the "possible" here as meaning "without contradiction with the present state of the sky." This possibility belongs to the sky as a threat; it represents a surpassing on the part of these clouds, which I perceive, toward rain. The clouds carry this surpassing within

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themselves, which means not that the surpassing will be realized but only that the structure of being of the cloud is a transcendence toward rain. The possibility here is given as belonging to a particular being for which it is a power. This fact is sufficiently indicated by the way in which we say indifferently of a friend for whom we are waiting, "It is possible that he may come" or "He can come." Thus the possible can not be reduced to a subjective reality. Neither is it prior to the real or to the true. It is a concrete property of already existing realities. In order for the rain to be possible, there must be clouds in the sky. To suppress being in order to establish the possible in i

ts purity is an absurd attempt. The frequently cited
passage from not-being to being via possibility does not correspond to the real. To be sure, the possible state does not exist yet; but it is the possible state of a certain existent which sustains by its being the possibility and the non-being of its future state.

Certainly we are running the risk of letting these few remarks lead us to the Aristotelian "potentiality." This would be to fall from Charybdis to Scylla, to avoid the purely logical conception of possibility only to fall into a magical conception. Being-in-itself can not "be potentiality" or "have potentialities." In itself it is what it is-in the absolute plenitude of its identity. The cloud is not "potential rain;" it is, in itself, a certain quantity of water vapor, which at a given temperature and under a given pressure is strictly what it is. The in-itself is actuality. But we can conceive clearly enough how the scientific attitude in its attempt to dehumanize the world has encountered possibilities as potentialities and has got rid of them by making of them the pure subjective results of our logical calculation and of our ignorance. The first scientific step is correct; the possible comes into the world through human reality. These clouds can change into rain only if I surpass them towards the rain, just as the crescent moon lacks a portion of the disc only if I surpass the crescent towards the full moon. But was it necessary afterwards to make of the possible a simple given of our psychic subjectivity? Just as there can be lack in the world only if it comes to the world through a being which is its own lack, so there can be possibility in the world only if it comes through a being which is for itself in its own possibility.

But to be exact, possibility can;11ot in essence coincide with the pure thought of possibilities. In fact if ppssibility is not first given as an objective structure of beings or of a partiqular being, then thought, however we consider it, can not inclose the possible within it as its thought content. If we consider possibles in the heart of the divine understanding as the content of the divine thought, beheld they become purely and simply concrete representations. Let us admit as a pure hypothesis-although it is impossible to understand how this negative power could come to a being wholly positive-that God has the power to deny; i.e., to bring negative judgments to bear on his representations. Even so we can not under-

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stand how he could transform these representations into possibles. At the very most the result of the negation would be to constitute them as "without real correspondent." But to say that the centaur does not exist is by no means to say that it is possible. Neither affirmation nor negation can confer the character of possibility on a representation. If it is claimed that this character can be given by a synthesis of negation and affirmation, still we must observe that a synthesis is not a sum and that it would be necessary to account for this synthesis as an organic totality provided with its own meaning and not in terms of the elements of which it is a synthesis. Similarly the pure subjective and negative attestation of our ignorance concerning the relation to the real of one of our ideas could not account for the character of possibility in this representation; i

t could
only put us in a state of indifference with respect to the representation and could not confer on it that right over the real which is the fundamental structure of the possible. If it is pointed out that certain tendencies influence me to expect this in preference to that, we shall say that these tendencies, far from explaining transcendence, on the contrary presuppose it; they must already, as we have seen, exist as a lack. Furthermore if the possible is not given in some way, these tendencies will be able to inspire us to hope that my representation may adequately correspond to reality but they will not be able to confer on me a right over the real. In a word the apprehension of the possible as such supposes an original surpassing. Every effort to establish the possible in terms of a subjectivity which would be what is-that is, whicll would close in upon itself-is on principle doomed to failure.

But it is true that the possible is-so to speak-an option on being, and if it is true that the possible can come into the world only through a being which. is its own possibility, this implies for human reality the necessity of being its being in the form of an aption on its being. There is possibility when instead of being purely and simply what I am, I exist as the Right to be what I am. But this very right separates me from what I have the right to be. Property right appears only when someone contests my property, when already in some respect it is no longer mine. The tranquil enjoyment of what I possess is a pure and simple fact, not a right. Thus if possibility is to exist, human reality as itself must necessarily be something other than itself. This possible is that element of the For-itself which by nature escapes it qua For-itself. The possible is a new aspect of the nihilation of the In-itself in For-itself.

If the possible can in fact come into the world only through a being which is its own possibility, this is because the in-itself, being by nature what it is, can not "have" possibilities. The relation of the in-itself to a possibility can be established only externally by a being which stands facing possibilities. The possibility of being stopped by a fold in the cloth belongs neither to the billiard ball which rolls por to the cloth; it can arise

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only in the organization into a system of the ball and the cloth by a being which has a comprehension of possibles. But since this comprehension can neither COme to it from without-i.e., from the in-itself-nor be limited to being only a thought as the subjective mode of consciousness, it must coincide with the objective structure of the being which comprehends its possibles. To comprehend possibility qua possibility or to be its own possibles is one and the same necessity for the being such that in its being, its being is in question. But to be its own possibility-that is, to be defined by it-is precisely to be defined by that part of itself which it is not, is to be defined as an eSC'dpe-from-itself towards --. In short, from the moment that I want to account for my immediate being simply in so far as it is what it is not and is not what it is, I am thrown outside it toward a meaning which is out of reach and which can in no way be confused with immanent subjective representation. Descartes apprehending himself by means of the cogito as doubt cannot hope to define this

doubt as methodi-
cal doubt or even as doubt if he limits himself to what is apprehended by pure instantaneous observation. Doubt can be understood only in terms of the always open possibility that future evidence may "remove" it; it can be grasped as doubt only in so far as it refers to possibilities of the ~1l"OX~13 which are not yet realized but always open.

Strictly speaking, no fact of consciousness is this consciousness. Even if like Husser! we should quite artificially endow this consciousness with intra-structural protentions, these would have in them no way of surpassing the consciousness whose structure they are and hence would pitifully fall back on themselves-like flies bumping their noses on the window without being able to clear the glass. As SOon as we wish to define a consciousness as doubt, perception, thirst, etc., we are referred to the nothingness of what is not yet. Consciousness (of) reading is not consciousness (of) reading this letter or this word or this sentence, or ev~n this paragraph; it is consciousness (of) reading this book, which refers me to all the pages still unread, to all the pages already read, which by definition detaches consciousness from itself. A consciousness which would be consciousness of what it is, would be obliged to spell out each nord.

Concretely, each for-itself is a lack of a certain coincidence" lth itself. This means that it is haunted by the presence of that with which it should coincide in order to be itself. But as this coincidence in Self is always coincidence with Self, the being which the For-itself lacks, the being which would make the For-itself a Self by assimilation with it-this being is still the For-itself. We have seen that the For-itself is a "presence to itself;" what this presence-to-itself lacks can fail to appear to it only as presence-to-itself. The determining relation of the for-itself to its possibility is a nihilating relaxation of the bond of presence-to-itself; this relax-

18 The French text is corrnpt, reading d'x'I. Obviously Sartre intended hox~. Tr.

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ation extends to transcendence since the presence-to-itself which the For-itself lacks is a presence-to-itself which is not. Thus the For-itself in so far as it is not itself is a presence-to-itself which lacks a certain presence-to-itself, and it is as a lack of this presence that it is presence-to-itself.

Every consciousness lacks something for something. But it must be understood that the lack does not come to it from without as in the case of the crescent moon as related to the full moon. The lack of the for-itself is a lack which it is. 'The outline of a presence-to-itself as that which is lacking to the for-itself is what constitutes the being of the for-itself as the foundation of its own nothingness. The possible is an absence constitutive of consciousness in so far as consciousness itself makes itself. Thirst-for example-is never sufficiently thirst inasmuch as it makes itself thirst; it is haunted by the presence of the Self of Thirst-itself. But in so far as it is haunted by this concrete value, it puts itself in question in its being as lacking a certain For-itself which would realize it as satisfied tl1irst and which would confer on it being-in-itself. This lacking For-itself is the Possible. Actually it is not exact to say that a Thirst tends toward its own annihilation as

thirst; there is no consciousness which aims at its own suppression as such. Yet thirst is a lack, as we pointed out earlier. As such it wishes to be satisfied; but this satisfied thirst, which would be realized by synthetic assimilation in an act of coincidence of the For-itself-desire or Thirst with the For-itself-reflection or act of drinking, is not aimed at as the suppression of the thirst. Quite the contrary the aim is the thirst passed on to the plenitude of being, the thirst which grasps and incorporates repletion into itself as the Aristotelian form grasps and transforms matter; it becomes eternal thirst.

This point of view is very late and reflective-like that of the man who drinks to get rid of his thirst, like that of the man who goes to brothels to get rid of his sexual desire. Thirst, sexual desire, in the unreflective and naive state want to enjoy themselves; they seek that coincidence with self which is satisfaction, where thirst knows itself as thirst at the same time that the drinking satisfies it, when by the very fact of its fulfillment it loses its character as lack while making itself be thirst in and through the satisfaction. Thus Epicurus is right and wrong at the same time; in itself indeed desire is an emptiness. But no non-reflective project aims simply at suppressing this void. Desire by itself tends to perpetuate itself; man clings ferociou.sly to his desires. What desire wishes to be is a filled emptiness but one which shapes its repletion as a mould shapes the bronze which has been poured inside it. The possible of the consciousness of thirst is the consciousness of drinking. We know moreover that coincidence with the self is impossible, for the for-itself attained by the realization of the Possible will make itself be as for-itself-that is, with another horizon of possibilities. Hence the constant disappointment which accompanies repletion, the famous: "Is it only this?" which is not directed

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at the concrete pleasure which satisfaction gives but at the evanescence of the coincidence with self. Thereby we catch a glimpse of the origin of temporality since thirst is its possible at the same time that it is not its possible. This nothingness which separates human reality from itself is at the origin of time. But we shall come back to this. What must be noted here is that the For-itself is separated from the Presence-to-itself which it lacks and which is its own possibility, in one sense separated by Nothing and in another sense by the totality of the existent in the world, inasmuch as the For-itself, lacking or possible, is For-itself as a presence to a certain state of the world. In this sense the being beyond which the For-itself projects the coincidence with itself is the world or distance of infinite being beyond which man must be reunited with his possible. We shall use the expression Circuit of selfness (Circuit de ipseite) for the relation of the for-itself with the possible which it is, and "world" for the totality of being in so far as it is traversed by the circuit of selfness.

We are now in a position to elucidate the mode of being of the possible. The possible is the something which the For-itself lacks in order to be itself. Consequently it is not appropriate to say that it is qua possible-unless by being we are to understand the being of an existent which "is made-to-be" in so far as it is

made-not-to-be, or if you prefer, the appear-
ance at a distance of what I am. The possible does not exist as a pure
representation, not even as a denied one, but as a real lack of being which,
qua lack, is beyond being. It has the being of a lack and as lack, it lacks
being. The Possible is not, the possible is possibilized to the exact degree
that the For-itself makes itself be; the possible determines in schematic
outline a location in the nothingness which the For-itself is beyond itself.
Naturally it is not at first thematically posited; it is outlined beyond the
world and gives my present perception its meaning as this is apprehended
in the world in the circuit of selfness. But neither is the Possible ignored
or unconscious; it outlines the limits of the non-thetie self-conscious-
ness as a non-thetic consciousness. The non-reflective consciousness (of)
thirst is apprehended by means of the glass of water as desirable, without
putting the Self in the centripetal position as the end of the desire. But the
possible repletion appears as a non-positional correlate of the non-thetic
self-consciousness on the horizon of the glass-in-the-midst-of-the-world.

V. THE SELF AND THE CIRCUIT OF SELFNESS

IN an article in Recherches PhiIosophiques I attempted to show that
the Ego does not belong to the domain of the for-itself.14 I shall not repeat
here. Let us note only the reason for the transcendence of the Ego: as a

H The article to which Sartre refers is "La transcendance de l'ego, esquisse d'une description phenomenologique," Recherches Philosophiques 6:193&-1937. pp. 85-123. Tr.

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unifying pole of Erlebnisse the Ego is in-itself, not for-itself. If it were
of tIle nature of consciousness, in fact, it would be to itself its own founda-
tion in the translucency of the immediate. But then we would have to say
that is it what it is not and that it is not what it is, and this is by no means
the mode of being of the "I." In fact the consciousness which I have
of the "I" never exhausts it, and consciousness is not what causes it to
come into existence; the "I" is always given as having been there before
consciousness-and at the same time as possessing depths which have to
be revealed gradually. Thus the Ego appears to consciousness as a tran-
scendent in-itself, as an existent in the human world, not as of tIle nature
of consciousness.

Yet we need not conclude that the for-itself is a pure and simple "im-
personal" contemplation. But the Ego is far from being the personalizing
pole of a conscio1!sness which without it would remain in the impersonal
stage; on the contrary, it is consciousness in its fundamental selfness
which under certain conditions allows the appearance of the Ego as the
transcendent phenomenon of that selfness. As we have seen, it is actu-
ally impossible to say of the in-itself that it is itself. It simply is. In this
sense, some will say that the "I," which they wrongly hold to be the
inhabitant of consciousness, is the "Me" of consciousness but not its own
self. Thus throug11 hypostasizing the being of the for-itself which is reflect-
ed-on and making it into an in-itself, these writers fix and destroy the
movement of reflection upon the self; consciousness then would be a pure
return to the Ego as to its self, but the Ego no longer refers to anything.
The reflexive relation has been transformed into a simple centripe

tal
relation, the center moreover, being a nucleus of opacity. "Ve, on the contrary, have shown that the self on principle can not inhabit consciousness. It is, if you like, tIle reason for the infinite movement by which the reflection refers to the reflecting and this again to the reflection; by definition it is an ideal, a limit. What makes it arise as a limit is the nihilating reality of the presence of being to being within the unity of being as a type of being. Thus from its first arising, consciousness by the pure nihilating movement of reflection makes itself personal; for what confers personal existence on a being is not the possession of an Ego-which is only the sign of the personality-but it is the fact that the being exists for itself as a presence to itself.

Now this first reflective movement involves in addition a second or selfncss. In selfness my possible is reflected on my consciousness and determines it as what it is. Selfness represents a degree of nihilation carried further than the pure presence to itself of the pre-reflective cogito-in the sense that the possible which I am is not pure presence to the for-itself as reflection to reflecting, but that it is absent-presence. Due to this fact the existence of reference as a structure of being in the for-itself is still more clearly marked. The for-itself is itself down there,

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beyond its grasp, in the far reaches of its possibilities. This -free necessity of being-down there-what one is in the form of lack constitutes selfness or the second aspect of the person. In fact how can the person be defined if not as a free relation to himself?

As for the world-i.e., the totality of beings as they exist within the compass of the circuit of selfness-this can be only what human reality surpasses toward itself. To borrow Heidegger's definition, the world is "that in terms of which human reality makes known to itself what it is."lli The possible which is my possible is a possible for-itself and as such a presence to the in-itself as consciousness of the in-itself. What I seek in the face of the world is the coincidence with a for-itself which I am and which is consciousness of the world. But this possible which is non-thetically an absent-present to present consciousness is not present as an object of a positional consciousness, for in that case it would be reflected-on. The satisfied thirst which haunts my actual thirst is not consciousness (of) thirst as a satisfied thirst; it is a thetic consciousness of itself-drinking-from-a-glass and a non-positional self-consciousness. It then causes itself to be transcended toward the glass of which it is conscious; and as a correlate of this possible non-thetic consciousness, the glass-drunk-from haunts the full glass as its possible and constitutes it as a glass to be drunk from. Thus the world by nature is mine in so far as it is the correlative in-itself of nothingness; that is, of the necessary obstacle beyond which I find myself as that which I am in th~ form "of having to be it." Without the world there is no selfness, no person; without selfness, without the person, there is no world. But the world's belonging to the person is never posited on the level of the pre-reflective cogito. It would be absurd to say that the world as it is known is known as mine. Yet this quality of "my-ness" in the world is a fugitive structure, always

d of his present,
and if all his modes of being as soon as they appear are destined by nature to a perpetual present, we have radically removed all methods of understanding his original relation to the past. We shall not succeed in constituting the dimension "past" out of elements borrowed exclusively from the present any more than "geneticists" have succeeded in constituting extension from unextended elements.

Popular consciousness has so much trouble in refusing a real existence to the past that alongside the thesis just discussed it admits another conception equally unprecise, according to which the past would have a kind of honorary existence. Being past for an event would mean simply being retired, losing its efficacy without losing its being. Bergson's philosophy has made use of this idea: on going into the past an event does not cease to be; it merely ceases to act and remains "in its place" at its date for eternity. In this way being has been restored to the past, and it is very well done; we even affirm that duration is a multiplicity of interpenetration and that the past is continually organized with the present. But for all that we have not provided any reason for this organization and this interpenetration; we have not explained how the past can "be reborn" to haunt us, in short to exist for us. If it is unconscious, as Bergson claims, and if the unconscious is inactive, how can it weave itself into the woof of our present consciousness? Would it have a force of its own? But then isn't this force present since it acts on the present? How does it emanate from the past as such? Shall we reverse the question, as Husserl does, and show in the present consciousness a game of "retentions," which latch on to the consciousnesses of yesteryear, maintain them at their date, and prevent them from being annihilated? But if Husserl's cogito is first givcn as instantaneous; there is no way to get outside it. We saw in the preceding chapter how protentions2 batter in vain on the window-panes of the present without shattering them. The same goes for retentions. Husserl for the length of his philosophical career was haunted by the idea of transcendence and surpassing. But the philosophical techniques at his disposal, in particular his idealist conception of existence, removed from him any way of accounting for that transcendence; his intentionality is only the caricature of it. Consciousness, as Husserl conceived it, can not in reality transcend itself either toward the world or toward the future or toward the past.

Thus we have gained nothing by conceding being to the past, for by the terms of this concession, the past must be tor us as not-being, Whether the past is, as Bergson and Husserl claim, or is not any longer, as Descartes

2 "Protention" is a forward dimension of consciousness, the opposite of "retention," Tr.

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claims, is hardly of any importance if we are to begin by cutting down all bridges between it and our present.

In fact if we confer a privilege on the present by making it "a presence in the world" we must then attack the problem of the past in the perspective of .intra-mundane being. People consider that we exist first as contemporary with this chair or this table, and they work out the meaning of the temporal by means of the world. But if we thus place ourselves in the midst of the world, we lose all possibilit

y of distinguishing what
no longer is from what is not. Someone may object that what no longer is must at least have been, whereas what is not has no connection of any kind with being. That is true. But the law of being of the intra-mundane instant, as we have seen, can be expressed by the simple words, "Being is," which indicate a massive plenitude of positivities where nothing which is not can be represented in any way whatsoever, not even by an impression, an emptiness, an appeal, or an "hysteresis." Being which is wholly exhausts itself in being; it has nothing to do with what is not, or with what is no longer. No negation, whether radical or subdued in a "no longer," can find a place in this absolute density. Hence the past can exist in its own way, but the bridges are cut. Being has not even "forgotten" its past, for forgetting would still be a form vf connection. The past has slipped away from it like a dream.

Descartes' concept and Bergson's can be dismissed side by side because they are both subject to the ·same objection. Whether it be a question of annihilating the past or of preserving for it the existence of a household god, these authors have considered its condition apart, isolating it from the present. Whatever may be their concept of consciousness, they have conferred on it the existence of the in-itself; they have considered it as being what it is. There is no reason to wonder afterwards that they fail to reconnect the past to the present, for the present thus conceived will reject the past with all its strength. If they had considered the temporal phenomenon in its totality, they would have seen that "my" past is first of all mine; that is, that it exists as the function of a certain being which I am. The past is not nothing; neither is it the present; but at its very source it is bound to a certain present and to a certain future, to both of which it belongs. 111at "myness" of which Clapare~de speaks is not a subjective nuance which comes to shatter the memory; it is an ontological relation which unites the past to the present. My past never appears isolated in its "pastness;" it would be absurd even to imagine that it can exist as such. It is originally the past of this present. It is as such that it must be first elucidated.

I write that Paul in 1920 was a student at the Polytechnic School. Who is it who "was?" Paul evidently, but what Paul? The young man of 19207 But the only tense of the verb "to be" which suits Paul considered in 1920--SO far as the quality of being a Polytechnic student is attributed

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to him-is the present. In so far as he was, we must say of him-"He is." If it is a Paul now become past who was a student at the Polytechnic School, all connection with the present is broken: the man who sustained that qualification, the subject, has remained back there with his attribute in 1920. If we want remembering to remain possible, we must on this hypothesis admit a recollecting synthesis which stems from the present in order to maintain the contact with the past. This is a synthesis impossible to conceive if it is not a mode of original being. Failing such a synthesis, we will have to abandon the past to its superb isolation. Moreover what would such a division in the personality signify? Proust, of course, admits the successive plurality of the Selves but this concept, if we take it literally, makes us fall int

o those insurmountable difficulties which in their
time the Association School came up against.
Someone perhaps will suggest the hypothesis of a permanence in
change: the one who was a pupil at the Polytechnic is this same Paul who
existed in 1920 and who exists at present. It is he then of whom, after hav-
ing said, "He is a pupil at Polytechnic," we say at present, "He is a former
student at the Polytechnic." But this resort to permanence can not get us
out of our difficulty. If nothing comes to tum the flow of the "nows" back-
ward and so constitute the temporal series and permanent characteristics
within this series, then permanence is nothing but a certain instantaneous
content without even the density of each individual "now." It is necessary
that there be a past, and consequently something or someone who was
this past, in order for there to be permanence. Far from helping to consti-
tute time, permanence presupposes it in order to reveal itself and to reveal
change along with it.
We return then to what we caught a glimpse of earlier. If the existential
remanence of being in the form of the past docs not arise originally from
my actual present, if my past of yesterday does not exist as a transcendence
behind my present of today, we have lost all hope of reconnecting the
past with the present. If then I say of Paul that he was once or that he
was for a continued period a student at the Polytechnic, I am speaking
of this same Paul who is at the present time and concerning whom I say
also that he is now forty years old. It is not the adolescent who was at the
Polytechnic. Concerning the latter, for so long as he was, we have to say:
he is. It is the forty-year old who was the student. Actually the thirty-year
old was the student also. But again what would this man of thirty years
be without the man of forty who was he? It is at the extreme limit of
his present that this man of forty "was" a student at the Polyteclmic.
Finally it is the very being of the Erlebnis which has the task of being
a man of forty, a man of thirty, and an adolescent-all in the mode of
having been. Concerning this Erlebnis, we say today that it is; we say also
of the man of forty and of the adolescent in their time that they are; today
they form a part of the past, and the past itself is in the sense that at pres-

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ent it is the past of Paul or of this Erlebnis. Thus the particular tenses of
the perfect indicate beings who all really exist although in diverse modes
of being, but of which the one is and at the same time was the other. The
past is characterized as the past of something or of somebody; one has
a past. It is this instrument, this society, this man who have their past.
There is not first a universal past which would later be particularized in
concrete pasts. On the contrary, it is particular pasts which we discover
first. The true problem-which we shall attack in the following chapter-
will be to find out by what process these individual pasts can be united
so as to form the past.
Someone may object perhaps that we have weighted the scale by choos-
ing an example in which the subject who "was" still exists in the present.
We will cite other cases. For example, I can say of Pierre, who is dead:
"He loved music." In this case, the subject like the attribute is past. There
is no living Pierre in terms of which this past-being can arise. But we
conceive of suc

h a subject. We conceive of him even to the point of recog-
nizing that for Pierre the taste for music has ncver been past. Pierre has
always been contemporary with this taste, which was his taste; his living
personality has not survived it, nor has it survived the personality. Con-
sequently here what is past is Pierre-loving-music. And I can pose the
question which I raised earlier: of whom is this past Pierre the past? It
can not be in relation to a universal Present which is a pure affirmation of
being; it is then the past of my actuality. And in fact Pierre has been
for-me, and I have been for-him. As we shall see, Pierre's existence has
touched my inmost depths; it formed a part of a present "in-the-world,
for-me and for-others" which was my present during Pierre's lifetime-a
present which I have been. Thus concrete objects which have disappeared
are past in so far as they form a part of the concrete past of a survivor.
"The terrible thing about Death," said Malraux, "is that it transforms
life into Destiny." By this we must understand that death reduces the
for-itself-for-others to the state of simple for-othcrs. Today I alone am
responsible for the being of the dead Pierre, I in my freedom. Those
dead who have not been able to be saved and transported to the bounda-
ries of the concrete past of a survivor are not past; they along with their
pasts are annihilated.
There are then beings which "have" pasts. Just now we referred indiffer-
ently to an instrument, a society, a man. Was this right? Can we at the
outset attribute a past to all finite existents or only to certain categories
among them? This can be more easily detcrmined if we examine more
closely this very particular notion-"to have" a past. One cannot "have"
a past as one "has" an automobile or a racing stable. That is, the past can
not be possessed by a present being which remains strictly external to it as
I remain, for example, external to my fountain pen. In short, in the sense
that possession ordinarily expresses an external relation of the possessor

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to the possessed, the expression of possession is inadequate. External re-
lations would hide an impassable abyss between a past and a present which
would then be two factual givens without real communication. Even the
absolute interpenetration of the present by the past, as Bergson conceives
it, does not resolve the difficulty because this interpenetration, which is
the organization of the past with the present, comes ultimately from the
past itself and is only a relation of habitation. The past can indeed be con-
ceived as being in the present, but by making it such we have removed
all ways of presenting this immanence other than like that of a stone at
the bottom of the river. The past indeed can haunt the present but it can
not be the present; it is the present which is its past.
Therefore if we study the relations of the past to the prcsent in
terms of the past, we shall never establish internal relations between them.
Consequently an in-itself, whose present is what it is, can not "have" a
past. The examples cited by Chevallier in support of his thesis, and in
particular the facts of hysteresis, do not allow us to establish any action
by the past of matter upon its present state. There is no one of these
examples, in fact, which can not be explained by the ordinary means of
mechanistic determinism. Of these two nails, ChevaIIi

er tclls us, the
one has just been made and has never been used, the other has been bent, then straightened by strokes of the hammer; they appear absolutely similar. Yet at the first blow the one will sink straight into the wall, and the other will be bent again; this is the action of the past. According to our view, a little bad faith is needed in order to see the action of the past in this example. In place of this unintelligible explanation in terms of being which here is density, we may easily substitute the only possible explanation: the external appearances of these nails are similar, but their present molecular structures perceptibly differ. The present molecular state is at each instant the strict result of the prior molecular state, which for the scientist certainly does not mean that there is a "passage" from one instant to the next within the permanence of the past but merely an irreversible relation between the contents of two instants of physical time. Similarly, to offer as proof of this permanence of the past thc remanence of magnetization in a piece of soft iron is not to prove anything worthwhile. Here we are dealing with a phenomenon which outlives its cause, not with a subsistence of the cause qua cause in tIIe past state. For a long time after the stone which pierced the water has fallen to the bottom of the sea, concentric waves still pass over its surface; here nobody makes an appeal to some sort of action by the past to explain this phenomenon; the mechanism of it is almost visible. It does not seem that the facts of hysteresis or of remanence need any explanation of a different type.
In fact it is very clear that the expression "to have a past," which leads us to suppose a mode of possession in which the possessor can be passive and which as such can without violence be applied to matter,

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should be replaced by the expression "to be" its own past. There is a past only for a present which cannot exist without being its past-back there, behind itself; that is, only those beings have a past which are such that in their being, their past being is in question, those beings who have to be their past. These observations enable us to refuse a priori to grant a past to the in-itself (which does not mean, however, that we must confine it within the present). We shall not thus settle once and for all the question of the pastof living beings. We shall only observe that if it were necessary -which is by no means certain-to grant a past to life, this could be done only after having proved that the being of life is such that it allows a past. In short, it would be necessary first to prove' that living matter is something other than a physica1-<:hemical system. The opposite attempt -that of Chevallier-which consists in putting the strongest emphasis on the past as constitutive of originality in life, is an ~qTEPOil 1rpOTEPOil completely void of meaning. For Human Reality alone the existence of a past is manifest because it has been established that humaI' reality has to be what it is. It is through the for-itself that the past arrives ,in the world because its "I am" is in the form of an I am me.
What then is the meaning of "was"? We see first of all that it is transitive. If I say, "Paul is fatigued," one might perhaps argue that the copula has an ontological value, one might perhaps want to see there only an indication of

inherence. But when we say, "Paul was fatigued," the essential meaning of the "was" leaps to our eyes: the present Paul is actually responsible for having had this fatigue in the past. If he were not sustaining this fatigue with his being, he would not even have forgott~n that state; there would be rather a "no-longer-being" strictly identical with a "not-being." The fatigue would be lost. The present being therefore is the foundation of its own past; and it is the present's character as a foundation which the "was" manifests. But we are not to understand that the present founds the past in the mode of indifference and without being profoundly modified by it. "Was" means that the present being has to be in its being the foundation of its past while being itself this past. What does this mean? How can the present be the past?

The crux of the question lies evidently in the term "was," which, serving as intermediary between the present and the past, is itself neither wholly present nor wholly past. In fact it can be neither the one nor the other since in either case it would be contained inside the tense which would denote its being. The term "was" indicates the ontological leap from the present into the past and represents an original synthesis of these two temporal modes. What must we understand by this synthesis?

I see first that the term "was" is a mode of being. In this sense I am my past. I do not have it; I am it. A remark made by someone concerning an act which I performed yesterday Or a mood which I had does not leave me indifferent; I am hurt or flattered, I protest or I let it pass; I am touched

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to the quick. I do not dissociate myself from my past. Of course, in time I can attempt this dissociation; I can declare that "I am no longer what I was," argue that there has been a change, progress. But this is a matter of a secondary reaction which is given as such. To deny my solidarity o! being with my past at this or that particular point is to affir'll it for the whole of my life. At my limit, at that infinitesimal instant of my death, I shan be no more than my past. It alone will define me. This is what Sophocles wants to express in the Trachiniae when he has Deianeira say, "It is a proverb current for a long time among men that one cannot pass judgment on the life of mortals and say if it has been happy or unhappy, until their death." This is also the meaning of that sentence of Malraux' which we quoted earlier. "Death changes life into Destiny." Finally this is what strikes the Believer when he realizes with terror that at the moment of death the chips are down, there remains not a card to play. Death reunites us with ourselves. Eternity has changed us into ourselves. At the moment of death we are; that is, we are defenceless before the judgments of others. They can decide in truth what we are; ultimately we have no longer any chance of escape from what an all knowing intelligence could do. A last hour repentance is a desperate effort to crack all this being which has slowly congealed and solidified around us, a final leap to dissociate ourselves from what we are. In vain. Death fixes this leap along with the rest; it does no more than to enter into combination with what has preceded it, as one factor among others, as one particular determination which is understood only in terms of the totality. By death the for-itself is changed for

ever into an in-itself in that it has slipped
entirely into the past. Thus the past is the ever growing totality of the
in-itself which we are.
Nevertheless so long as we are not dead, we are not this in-itself in the
mode of identity. We have to be it. Ordinarily a grudge against a man
ceases with his death; this is because .he has been reunited with his past;
he is it without, however, being responsible for it. So long as he lives,
he is the object of my grudge; that is, I reproach him for his past not
only in so far as he is it but in so far as he reassumes it at each in-
stant and sustains it in being, in so far as he is responsible for it. It is not
true that the grudge fixes the man in what he was; otherwise it would
survive death. It is addressed to the living man who in his being is freely
what he was. I am my past and if I were not, my past would not exist
any longer either for me or for anybody. It would no longer have any re-
lation with the present. That certainly does not mean that it would not be
but only that its being would be undiscoverable. I am the one bv whom
my past arrives in this world. But it must be understood that I do not
give being to it. In.other words it does not exist as "my" representation.
It is not because I "represent" my past that it exists. But it is because
I am my past that it enters into the world, and it is in terms of its being-

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in-the-world that I can by applying a particular psychological process
represent it to myself.
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The past is what I have to be, and yet its nature is different from that
of my possibles. The possible, which also I have to be, remains as my
concrete possible, that whose opposite is equally possible-although to a
less degree. The past, on the contrary, is that which is without possibility
of any sort; it is that which has consumed its possibilities. I have to be
that which no longer depends on my being-able-to-be, that which is already
in itself all which it can be. The past which I am, I have to be with no
possibility of not being it. I assume the total responsibility for it as if I
could change it, and yet I can not be anything other than it. We shall see
later that we continually preserve the possibility of changing the meaning
of the past in so far as this is an ex-present which has had a future. But
from the content of the past as such I can remove nothing, and I can add
nothing to it. In other words the past which I was is what it is; it is an
in-itself like the things in the world. The relation of being which I have to
sustain with the past is a relation of the type of the in-itself-that is, an
identification with itself.
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On the other hand I am not my past. I am not it because I was it. The
malice of others always surprises me and makes me indignant. How can
they hate in the person who I am now that person who I was? The wis-
dom of antiquity has always ins·isted on this fact: I can make no pronounce-
ment on myself which has not already become false at the moment when
I pronounce it. Hegel did not disdain to employ this argument. Whatever
I am doing, whatever lam saying-at the moment when I wish to be it,
already I was doing it, I was saying it. But let us examine this aphorism
more carefully. It amounts to saying that every judgment which I make
concerning myself is already fa1se when I make it; that is, that I have be-
come something else. But what are we to unders

tand by this something
else? If we understand by it a mode of human reality which would enjoy the same existential type as that to which we refuse present existence, this amounts to declaring that we have committed an error in attributing a predicate to the subject and that there remains another predicate which could be attributed; it would only have been necessary to aim at it in the immediate future. In the same way a hunter who aims at a bird there where he sees it misses it because the bird is no longer at that place when the bullet arrives there. He will hit the bird if, on the contrary, he aims a little in advance at a point where the flying bird has not yet arrived. If the bird is no longer at this place, it is because it is already at another. At all events it is somewhere. But we shall see that this Eleatic concept of motion is profoundly erroneous; if we can say that the arrow is at A, B, etc., then motion really is a succession of points at rest. Similarly if we conceive that there has been an infinitesimal instant no longer existing at which I was what I already no longer am, then we are constituting the "me" out of

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a series of fixed states which succeed each other like images from a magic lantern. If I am not what I pronounced myself to be, this is not because of a slight cleavage between judicative thought and being, not because of a retardation betwcen the judgment and the fact, but because on principle in my immediate bcing in the presence of my present, I am not it.
In short the reason why 1 am not what I was is not that there is a change,· a becoming conceived as a passage to heterogeneity taking place in the homogeneity of being; on the contrary, a becoming is possible there only because on principle my being and my modes of being are heterogeneous. The explanation of the world by means of becoming, conceived as a synthesis of being and of non-being, is easily given. But it must be noted that being in becoming could be this synthesis only if it were so to itself in an act which would establish its own nothingness. If already I am no longer what I was, it is still necessary that I have to be so in the unity of a nihilating synthesis which I myself sustain in being; otherwise I would have no relation of any sort with what I am no longer, and my full positivity would be exclusive of the non-being essential to becoming. Becoming can not be a given, a mode of immediate being for being; if we conceive of such a being, then being and non-being would be only juxtaposed in its heart, and no imposed or external structure could melt them into each other. The bond between being and non-being can be only internal. It is within being qua being that non-being must arise, and within non-being that being must spring up; and this rclation can not be a fact, a natural law, but an upsurge of the being which is its own nothingness of being.
If then I am not my own past, this can not be in the original mode of becoming; the truth is that I have to be it in order not to be it and I have not to be it in order to be it. This ought to clarify for us the nature of the mode "was'~: if I am not what I was, it is not because I have already changed, which would supposc a time already given, but because I am related to my being in the mode of an internal bond of non-being.
Thus it is in so far as I am my past that I can not-be it; it is even this very

necessity of being my past which is the only possible foundation of the fact that I am not it. Otherwise at each instant, I should neither be it nor not be it save in the eyes of a strictly extcrnal witness who, moreover, would himself, have to be his past in the mode of non-being.

These remarks can show us that there is something inexact in that scepticism of Heraclitean origin which insists solely on the fact that I already no longer am what I say I am. Of course, no matter what someone says that 1 am, I am not it. But it is incorrect to affirm that I am already no longcr it, for I have never been it if we mean here "being in itself." On the other hand, neither docs it follow that I am making an error in saying that I am it, since it is very necessary that I be it in order not to be it: I am it in the mode of "was."

Thus whatever I can be said to be in the sense of being-in-itself with a

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full, compact density (he is quick-tempered, he is a civil servant, he is dissatisfied) is always my past. It is in the past that I am what I am. But on the other hand, that heavy plenitude of being is behind me; there is an absolute distance which cuts it from me and makes it fall out of my reach, without contact, without connections. If I was happy or if I have been happy, that means that I am not happy. But it does not mean that I am unhappy, but simply that I can be happy only in the past. It is not because I have a past that I thus carry my being behind me; rather the past is precisely and only that ontological structure which obliges me to be what I am from behind. This is the meaning of the "was." By definition the for-itself exists with the obligation of assuming its being, and it can be nothing except for itself. It can assume its being only by a ·recovery of that being, which puts it at a distance from that being. By the very affirmation that I am in the mode of the in-itself, I escape that affirmation, for in its very nature it implies a negation. Thus the for·itself is always beyond that which it is by the very fact that it is it for-itself and that it has to be it. B4t at the same time the being which lives behind it is indeed its being, and not another being. Thus we understand the meaning of the "was," which merely characterizes the type of being of the for-itself-i.e., the relation of the for-itself to its being. The past is the in-itself which I am, but I am this in-itself as surpassed.

It remains for us to study the specific way in which the for-itself "was" its own past. Now we know that the for-itself appears in the original act by which the in-itself nihilates itself in order to found itself. The for-itself is its own foundation in so far as it makes itself the failure of the in-itself to be its own foundation. But for all that the for-itself has not succeeded in freeing itself from the in-itself. The surpassed in-itself lives on and haunts the for-itself as its original contingency. The for-itself can never reach the in-itself nor apprehend itself as being this or that, but neither can it prevent itself from being what it is-at a distance from itself.

This contingency of the for-itself, this weight surpassed and preserved in the very surpassing-this is Facticity. But it is also the past. "Facticity" and "Past" are two words to indicate one and the same thing. The Past, in fact, like Facticity, is the invulnerable contingency of t

he in-itself
which I pave to be without any possibility of not being it. It is the inevita-
bility of the necessity of fact, not by virtue of necessity but by virtue of
fact. It is the being of fact, which can not determine the content of my
motivations but which paralyzes them with its contingency because they
can neither suppress it nor change it; it is what they necessarily carry with
them in order to modify it, what they preserve in order to flee it, what
they have to be in their very effort not to be it; it is that in terms of which
they make themselves what they are. It is this being which is responsible
for the fact that each instant I am not a diplomat or a sailor, that I am a
professor, al~hough I can only play this being as a role and although I can

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never be united with it. If I can not reenter into the past, it is not because
some magical power puts it beyond my reach but simply because it is in-
itself and because I am for-myself. The past is what I am without being
able to live it. The past is substance. In this sense the Cartesian cogito
ought to be formulated rather: "I think; therefore I was."
What deceives us is the apparent homogeneity of the past and the pres-
ent. For that shame which I experienced yesterday was part of the for-
itself when I experienced if. We believe then that it has remained for-itself
today; we wrongly conclude that if I can not reenter it, this is because
it no longer exists. But we must reverse the relation in order to reach the
truth. Between past and present there is an absolute heterogeneity; and
if I can not enter the past, it is because the past is. The only way by which I
could be it is for me myself to become in-itself in order to lose myself in it
in the form of identification; this by definition is denied me. In fact that
shame which I experienced yesterday and which was shame for itself is
always shame in the present, and its essence can still be described as for-
itself. But its being is no longer for itself since it no longer exists as re-
flection-reflecting. Though capable of description as for-itself, it simply is.
The past is given as a for-itself become in-itself. That shame, so long as I
live it, is not what it is. Now that I was it, I can say: it was shame. It has
become what it was-behind me. It has the pennanence and the constancy
of the in-itself; it is at its date for eternity; it has the total adherence of the
in-itself to itself.
In one sense then the past, which is at the same time for-itself and
in-itself, resembles value or self, which we described in the preceding
chapter; for it represents a certain synthesis of the being which is what it is
not and is not what it is-with the being which is what it is. It is in this
sense that we. can speak of the evanescent value of the past. Hence arises
the fact that memory presents to us the being which we were, accom-
panied by a plenitude of being which confers on it a sort of poetry. That
grief which we had-although fixed in the past-does not cease to present
the meaning of a for-itself, and yet it exists in itself with the silent fixity of
the grief of another, of the grief of a statue. It no longer needs to appear
before itself ill order to make itself exist. On the contrary it is its character
of for-itself; far from being the mode of being of its being, it becomes
simply one way of being, a quality. Psychologists because they contem-
plate

d the psychic state in the past have claimed that consciousness was a quality which could affect the psychic state or not without modifying it in its being. The past psychic first is; and then it is for itself-just as Pierre is blond, as that tree is an oak.

But precisely for this reason the past which resembles value is not value. In value the for-itself becomes itself by surpassing and by founding its being; there is a recovery of the in-itself by the self. As a result, the COntingency of being gives way to necessity. The past on the contrary is

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at the start in-itself. The for-itself is sustained in being by the in-itself; its raison d'etre is no longer being for-itself. It has become in-itself, and as a result it appears to' us in its pure contingency. There is no reason for our past to be this or that; it appears in the totality of its series as the pure fact for which we must account qua fact, as the gratuitous. In short, it is value reversed-the for-itself recovered by the in-itself and fixed by it, penetrated and blinded by the full density of the in-itself, thickened by the in-itself to the point of no longer being able to exist as a reflection for the reflecting nor as the reflecting for the reflection, but simply as an in-itself indication of the dyad reflecting-reflection. This is why the past can, if need be, be the object aimed at by a for-itself which wants to realize value and flee the anguish which comes to it from the perpetual absence of the self. But in essence it is radically distinct from value; it is precisely the indicative from which no imperative can be deduced; it is the unique fact for each for-itself, the contingent and unalterable fact which I was.

Thus the Past is a For-itself reapprehended and inundated by the In-itself. How can this happen? We have described the meaning of being-past for an event and of having a past for a human reality. We have seen that the Past is an ontological law of the For-itself; that is, everything which can be a For-itself must be it back there behind itself, out of reach. It is in this sense that we can accept the statement of Hegel: "Wesen ist was gewesen ist." My essence is in the past; the past is the law of its being. But we have not explained why a concrete event of the For-itself becomes past. How does a For-itself which was its past become the Past which a new For-itself has to be? The passage to the past is a modification of being. What is this modification? In order to understand this we must first apprehend the relation of the present For-itself to being. Thus as we might have foreseen, the study of the Past refers us to that of the Present.

B. THE PRESENT

IN contrast to the Past which is in-itself, the Present is for-itself. What is its being? There is a peculiar paradox in the Present: On the one hand, we willingly define it as being; what is present is-in contrast to the future which is not yet and to the past which is no longer. But on the other hand, a rigorous analysis which would attempt to rid the present of all which is not it-i.e., of the past and of the immediate future-would find that nothing remained but an infinitesimal instant. As Husserl remarks in his Essays on the Inner Consciousness of Time, the ideal limit of a division pushed to infinity is a nothingness. Thus each time that we approach the study of human reality from a new point of view we redis-

cover that indissoluble dyad, Being and Nothingness.
What is the fundamental meaning of the Present? It is clear that what

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exists in the present is distinguished from all other existence by the characteristic of presence. At rollcall the soldier or the pupil replies "Present!" in the sense of adsum. Present is opposed to absent as well as to past. Thus the meaning of present is presence to --. It is appropriate then to ask ourselves to what the present is presence and who or what is present. That will doubtless enable us to elucidate subsequently the very being of the present.
My present is to be present. Present to what? To this table, to this room, to Paris, to the world, in short to being-in-itself. But can we say conversely that being-in-itself is present to me and to the being-in-itself which it is not? If that were so, the present would be a reciprocal relation of presences. But it is easy to see that it is nothing of the sort. Presence to-- is an internal relation between the being which is present and the beings to which it is present. In any case it can not be a matter of a simple external relation of contiguity. Presence to -- indicates existence outside oneself near to --. Anything which can be present to -- must be such in its being thatthere is in it a relation of being with other beings. I can be present to this chair only if I am united to it in an ontological relation of synthesis, only if I am there in the being of the chair as not being the chair. A being which is present to -- can not be at rest "in-itself;" the in-itself cannot be present any more than it can be Past. It simply is. There can be no question of any kind of simultaneity between one in-itself and another in-itself except from the point of view of a being which would be co-present with two in-itselfs and which would have in it the power of presence. The Present therefore can be only the presence of the For-itself to being-in-itself. And this presence can not be the effect of an accident, of a concomitance: on the contrary it is presupposed by all concomitance, and it must be an ontological structure of the For-itself. This table must be present to that chair in a world which human reality haunts as a presence. In other words one cannot conceive of a type of existent which would be first For-itself in order subsequently to be present to being.
But the For-itself makes itself presence to being by making itself be For-itself, and it ceases to be presence by ceasing to be for-itself. The For-itself is defined as presence to being.
To what being does the For-itself make itself presence? The answer is clear: the For-itself is presence to all of being-in-itself. Or rather the presence of the For-itself is what makes being-in-itself exist as a totality. For by this very mode of presence to being qua being, every possibility is removed whereby the For-itself. might be more present to one privileged being than to all other beings. Even though the facticity of its existence causes it to be there rather than elsewhere, being there is not the same as being present. Being tl1ere determines only the perspective by which presence to the totality of the in-itself is realized. By means of the there the For-itself causes beings to be for one and the same presence. Beings are

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revealed as co-present in a world where the For-its

elf unites them with its
own blood by that t0tal ekstatic sacrifice of the self which is called presence. "Before" the sacrifice of the For-itself it would have been impossible to say that beings existed either together or separated. But the For-itself is the being by which the present enters into the world; the beings of the world are co-present, in fact, just in so far as one and the same for-itself is at the same time present to all of them. Thus for the in-itselfs what we ordinarily call Present is sharply distinguished from their being although it is nothing more than their being. For their Present means only their co-presence in so far as a For-itself is present to them.

We know now what is present and to what the present is present. But what is presence?

We have seen that this can not be the pure co-existence of two existents, conceived as a simple relation of exteriority, for that would require a third term to establish the co-existence. This third term exists in the case of the co-existence of things in the midst of the world; it is the For-itself which establishes this co-existence by making itself co-present to all. But in .the case of the Presence of the For-itself to being-in-itself, there can not be a third term. No witness-not even God-could establish that presence; even the For-itself can know it only if the presence already is. Nevertheless presence can not be in the mode of the in-itself. This means that originally the For-itself is presence to being in so far as the For-itself is to itself its own witness of co-existence. How are we to understand this? We know that the For-itself is the being which exists in the form of a witness of its being. Now the For-itself is present to being if it 's intentionally directed outside itself upon that being. And it must adhere to being as closely as is possible without identification. This adherence, as we shall see in the next chapter, is realistic, due to the fact that the For-itself realizes its birth in an original bond with being; it is a witness to itself of itself as not being that being. Due to this fact it is outside that being, upon being and within being as not being that being.

In addition we can deduce the following conclusions as to the meaning of Presence: Presence to a being implies that one is bound to that being by an internal bond; otherwise no connection between Present and being would be possible. But this internal bond is a negative bond and denies, as related to the present being, that one is the being to which one is present. If this were not so, the internal bond would dissolve into pure and simple identification. Thus the For-itself's Presence to being implies that the For-itself is a witness of itself in the presence of being as not being that being; presence to being is the presence of the For-itself in so far as the For-itself is not. For the negation rests not on a difference in mode of being which would distinguish the For-itself from being but on a difference of being. This can be expressed briefly by saying that the Present is not.

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What is meant by this non-being of the Present and of the For-itself?

To grasp this we mu~t return to the For-itself, to its mode of existing, and outline briefly a description of its ontological relation to being. Concerning the For-itself as such we should never say, "It is" in the sense that we say, for example, "It is nine o

'clock;" that is, in the sense of the
total equivalence of being with itself which posits and suppresses the self and which gives the external aspect of passivity. For the For-itself has the existence of an appearance coupled with a witness of a reflection which refers to a reflecting without there being any object of which the reflection would be the reflection. The For-itself does not have being because its being is always at a distance: its being is there in the reflecting, if,you consider appearance, which is appearance or reflection only for the reflecting; it is there in the reflection if you consider the reflecting, which is no longer in itself anything more than a pure function of reflecting tIlis reflection. Furthermore in itself the For-itself is not being, for it makes itself be explicitly for-itself as not being being. It is consciousness of -- as the internal negation of -'-. The structure at the basis of intentionality and of selfness is the negation, which is the internal relation of the For-itself to the thing. The For-itself constitutes itself outside in rerms of the thing as the negation of that thing; thus its first relation with being-in-itself is negation. It "is" in the mode of the For-itself; that is, as a separated existent inasmuch as it reveals itself as not being being. It doubly escapes being, by an internal disintegration and by express negation. The present is precisely this negation of being, this escape from being inasmuch as being is there as that from which one escapes. The For-itself is present to being in the form of flight; the Present is a perpetual flight in the face of being. Thus we have precisely defined the fundamental meaning of the Present: the, Present is not. The present instant emanates from a realistic and reifying conception of the For-itself; it is this conception which leads us to denote the For-itself according to the mode of that which is and that to which it is present-for example, of that hand on the face of the clock. In this sense it would be absurd to say that it is nine o'clock for the For-itself, but the For-itself can be present to a hand pointed at nine o'clock. What we falsely call the Present is the being to which the present is presence. It is impossible to grasp the Present in the form of an instant, for the instant would be the moment when the present is. But the present is not; it makes itself present in the form of flight.
But the present is not only the For-itself's non-being making itself present. As For-itself it has its being outside of it, before and behind. Behind, it 1t'aS its past; and before, it will be its future. It is a flight outside of co-present being and from the being which it was toward the being which it will be. At present it is not what it is (past) and it is what it is not (future). Here then we are referred to the Future.

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C. THE FUTURE

LET us note first that the in-itself can neither be future nor contain a part of the future. The full moon is future only when I regard this crescent moon as "in the world" which is revealed to human reality: it is only by human reality that the Future arrives in the world. In itself this quarter of the moon is what it is. Nothing in it is potentiality. It is actuality. The future, like the past, does not exist as a phenomenon of that original temporality of being-in-itself. The future of the in-itself, i

f it existed, would
exist in-itself, cut off from being-like the past. Even if we should admit with Laplace a total determinism which allewed us to foresee a future state, still it would be necessary that this future circumstance be outlined on a preliminary revelation of the future as such, on a being-to-come of the world-or else time is an illusion and chronology disguises a strictly logical order of deducibility. If the future is pre-outlined on the horizon of the world, this can be only by a being which is its own future; that is, which is to-come for itself, whose being is constituted by a coming-to-itself of its own being. Here again we discover ekstatic structures analogous to those which we have described for the Past. Only a being which has to be its being instead of simply being it can have a future. But what exactly is meant by "being its future?" And what type of being does the future possess? We must abandon at the start the idea that the future exists as representation."-In the first place the future is seldom "represented." When it is, then as Heidegger says, it is thematized and ceases to be my future in order to become the indifferent object of my representation. Finally, if it were represented, it could not be the "content" of my representation, for content, if there were any, would have to be present. Someone may say that this present content will be animated by a "futurizing" intention. That does not make sense. Even if that intention existed, either it would itself of necessity be present-and then the problem of the future is not capable of any solution; or else the intention transcends the present in the future, and then the being of this intention is to-come, and it is necessary to recognize in the future a being different from the simple percipi. Moreover if the For-itself were limited within its present, how could it represent the future to itself? How could it have either knowledge of it or presentiment? No fabricated idea could furnish an equivalent for it. Once we have confined the Present to the Present, it is evident that we will never get out of it. It would be of no use to describe the Present as "pregnant with the future." Either this expression means nothing, or it denotes an actual efficacy in the present, or it indicates the law of being of the For-itself as that which is its future to itself-and in this last case it only points out what must be
" i.e., in the imagination. Tr.

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described and explained. The For-itself can not be "pregnant with the future" nor "expectant of the future," nor can it be "a knowledge of the future" except on the basis of an original and prejudicative relation of itself to itself. We can not conceive for the For-itself the slightest possibility of a thematic foresight, not even that of determined states in a scientific universe, unless it is the being which comes to itself in terms of the future, the being which makes itself exist as having its being outside itself in the future.
Let us take a simple example. This position which I quickly assume on the tennis court has meaning only through the movement which I shall make immediately afterward with my racket in order to return the ball over the net. But I am not obeying the "clear representation" of the future motion nor the "firm will" to accomplish it. Representations and volitions are idols invented by the psychologists. It is

the future motion
which, without even being thematically posited, hovers inthe background
of the positions which I adopt, so as to clarify them, to link them, and to
modify them. At one throw, as I am there on the court and returning
the ball, I exist first as a lack to myself, and the intermediary positions
which I adopt are only ways of uniting myself with that future state so as
to merge with it; each position has meaning only through that future state.
There is in my consciousness no moment which is not similarly defined
III
by an internal relation to a future; when I write, when I smoke, when I
drink, when I rest, the meaning of my conscious states is always at a dis-
tance, down there, outside. In this sense Heidegger is right in saying that
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the Dascin is "always infinitely more than it would be if we limited it to
its pure present." Better yet, this limitation would be impossible, for we
would then be making the Present into an In-itself. Thus finality is
rightly said tO,be causality reversed-that is, the efficacy of the future state.
But too often people have forgotten to take this formula literally.
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We must not understand by the future a "now" which is not yet. If
we did so, we should fall back into the in-itself, and even worse we should
have to envisage time as a given and static container. The future is what
I have to be in so far as I can not be it. Let us recall that the For-itself
makes itself present before being as not being this being and as having
been its own being in the past. This presence is flight. We are not dealing
here with a belated presence at rest near being but with an escape outside
of being towards --. And this flight is two-fold, for in fleeing the being
which it is not, Presence flees the being which it was. Toward what is it
fleeing? We must not forget that in so far as it makes itself present to being
in order to flee it the For-itself is a lack. The possible is that which the
For-itself lacks in order to be itself or, if you prefer, the appearance of what
I am-at a distance. Thus we grasp the meaning of the flight which is
Presence; it is a flight toward its being; that is, toward the self which it
will be by coincidence with what it lacks. The Future is the lack which

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wrenches it as lack away from the in~tself of Presence. If Presence did not
lack anything, it would fall back illito being and would lose presence to
being and acquire in exchange the isolation of complete identity. It is lack
as such which permits it to be presence. Because ,Presence is outside of
itself toward something lacking which is beyond the world, it can be
outside itself as presence to an in-itself which it is not.
The Future is the determining. being which the For-itself has to be
beyond being. There is a Future because the For-itself has to be its being
instead of simply being it. This being which the For-itself has to be can
not be in the mode of the co-present in-itselfs; for in that case it would
be without being made-to-be; we could not then imagine it as a com-
pletely defined state to which presence alone would be lacking, as Kant
says that existence adds nothing more to the object of the concept. But
this being would no longer be able to exist, for in that case the For-itself
would be only a given. This being is because the For-itself makcs itself
be by perpetually apprehending itself for itself as unachieved in

relation
to it. It is this which at a distance haunts the dyad reflection-reflecting and which causes the reflection to be apprehended by the reflecting (and conversely) as a Not-yet. But it is necessary that this lacking be given in the unity of a single upsurge with the For-itself which lacks; otherwise there would be nothing in relation to which the For-itself might apprehend itself as not-yet. The Future is revealed to the For-itself as that which the For-itself is not yet, inasmuch as the For-itself constitutes itself non-thetically for itself as a not-yet in the perspective of this revelation, and inasmuch as it makes itself be as a project of itsclf outside the Present toward that which it is not yet. To be sure, the Future can not be without this revelation. This revelation itself requires being revealed to itself; that is, it requires the revelation of the For-itself to itself, for otherwise the ensemble revelation-revealed would fall into the unconscious-i.e., into the In-itself. Thus only a being which is its own rcvealed to itself \ -that is, whose being is in question for itself-can have a Future. But conversely such a being can be for itself only in the perspective of a Not-yet, for it apprehends itself as a nothingness-that is, as a being whose complement of being is at a distance from itself. At a distance means beyond being. Thus everything which the For-itself is beyond being is the Future.
What is the meaning of this "beyond?" In order to understand it we must note that the Future has one essential characteristic of the For-itself: it is presence (future) to being. And it is Presence of this particular For-itself, of the For-itself for which it is the future. When I say, "I shall be happy," it is this present For-itself which will be happy; it is the actual ErIebnis with all which it was and which it drags behind it. It will be happy as presence to being; that is, as future Presence of the For-itself to a co-future being. So that what has been given me as the meaning of the pres-

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ent For-itself is ordinarily the co-future being in so far as it wiI be revealed to the future for-itself as that to which this For-itself wiI be present. For the For-itself is the thetic consciousness of the world in the form of .presence and non-thetic self-consciousness. Thus what is ordinarily revealed to consciousness is the future world without consciousness' being aware that it is the world in so far as it wiI appear to a consciousness, the world in so far as it is posited as future by the presence of a For-itself to come. This world has meaning as future only in so far as I am present to it as another who I will be, in another position, physical, emotional, social, etc. Yet it is this which is at the end of my present For-itself and beyond being-in-itself, and this is the reason why we have a tendency first to present the future as a state of the world and to make it appear subsequently on the ground of the world. If I write, I am conscious ot the words as written and as about to be written. The words alone seem to be the future which awaits me. But the very fact that they appear as to be written implies that writing, as a non-thetic self-consciousness, is the possibility which I am. Thus the Future as the future presence of a For-itself to a being drags being-in-itself along with it into the future. This being to which the For-itself w

iII be present is the meaning of the in-itself
co-present with the present For-itself, as the future is the meaning of the For-itself. The Future is presence to a co-future being because the For-itsclf can exist only outside itsclf at the side of being and because the future is a future For-itself. But thus through the Future a particular future arrives in the World; that is, the For-itself is its meaning as Presence to being which is beyond being. Through the For-itself, a Beyond of being is revealed next to which the For-itself has to be what it is. As the saying goes, "I must become what I was;" but I must become what I was-in a world that has become and in a world that has become from tIle standpoint of what it is. This means that I give to the world its own possibilities in terms of the state which I apprehend on it. Determinism appears on the ground of the futurizing project of myself. Thus the future wiI be distinguished from the imaginary, where similarly I am what I am not, where similarly I find my meaning in a being which I have to be but where this For-itself which I have to be emerges on the ground of the nihilation of the world, apart from the world of being.
But the Future is not solely the presence of the For-itself to a being situated beyond being. It is something which waits for the For-itself which I am. This something is myself. WIlen I say that I wiI be happy, we understand that it is the present "I," dragging its Past after it, who wiI be happy. Thus the Future is "I" in as much as I await myself as presence to a being bcyond being. I project myself toward the Future in order to merge therc with that which I lack; that is, with that which if synthetically added to my Present would make me be what I am. Thus what the For-itsclf has to bc as presence to being beyond being is its own possibil-

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ity. The Future is the ideal point where the sudden infinite compression of facticity (Past), of the For-itself (Present), and of its possible (a particular Future) will at last cause the Self to arise as the existence in-itself of the For-itself. The project of the For-itself toward the future which it is is a project toward the In-itself. In this sense the For-itself has to be its future because it can be the foundation of what it is only before itself and beyond being. It is the very nature of the For-itself that it must be "an always future hollow." For this reason it will never have become, in the Present, what it had to be, in the Future. The entire future of the present For-itself falls into the Past as the future along with this For-itself itself. It will. be the past future of a particular For-itself or a former future. This future is not realized. What is realized is a For-itself which is designated by the Future and which is constituted in connection with this future. For example, my final position on the tennis court has determined on the ground of the future all my intennediary positions, and finally it has been reunited with an ultimate position identical with what it was in the future as the meaning of my movements. But, precisely, this "reuniting" is purely ideal; it is not really operative. The future does not allow itself to be rejoined; it slides into the Past as a bygone future, and the Present For-itself in all its facticity is revealed as the foundation of its own nothingness and once again as the lack

of a new future. Hence
comes that ontological disillusion which awaits the For-itself at each emergence into the future. "Under the Empire how beautiful was the Republic!" Even if my present is strictly identical in its content with the future toward which I projected myself beyond being, it is not this present toward which I was projecting myself; for I was projecting myself toward the future qua future-that is, as the point of the reuniting of my being, as the place of the upsurge of the Self.

Now we are better able to raise the question of the being of the Future since this Future which I have to be is simply my possibility of presence to being beyond being. In this sense the Future is strictly opposed to the Past. The Past is, to be sure, the being which ram outside of myself, but it is the being which I am without the possibility of not being it. Il1is is what we have defined as being its past behind itself. The being of the Future which I have to be, on the contrary, is such that I can only be it; for my freedom gnaws at its being from below. This means that the Future constitutes the meaning of my present For-itself, as the proj,cct of. its possibility,. but that it in no way predetermines my For-itself which is to-come, since the For-itself is always abandoned to the nihilating obligation of being the foundation of its nothingness. The Future can)only effect a pre-outline of the limits within which the For-itself will make itself be as a Bight making itself present to being in the direction of another future. The future is what I would be if I were not free and what I

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can have to be only because I am free. It appears on the horizon to announce to me what I am from the standpoint of what I shall be. ("\\That are you doing? I am in the process of tacking up this tapestry, of hanging this picture on the wall"). Yet at the same time by its nature as a future present-for-itself, it is disarmed; for the For-itself which will be, will be in the mode of determining itself to be, and the Future, then become a past future as a pre-outline of this for-itself, will be able only as the past to influence it to be what it makes itself be. In a word, I am my Future in the constant perspective of the possibility of not being it. Hence that anguish which we have described above which springs from the fact that I am not sufficiently that Future which I have to be and which gives its meaning to my present: it is because I am a being whose meaning is always problematic. In vain would the For-itself long to be enchained to its Possibility, as to the being which it is outside itself but which it is surely outside itself. TIle For-itself can never be its Future except problematieally, for it is separated from it by. a Nothingness which it is. In short the For-itself is free, and its Freedom is to itself its own limit. To be free is to be condemned to be free. Thus the Future qua Future does not have to be. It is not in itself, and neither is it in the mode of being of the For-itself since it is the meaning of the For-itself. The Future is not, it is possibiIized.

The Future is the continual possibilization of possibles-as the meaning of the present For-itself in so far as this meaning is problematic and as such radically escapes the present For-itself.

The Future thus defined does not correspond to a homogeneous. and chronologically ordered succession o

f moments to come. To be sure, there
is a hierarchy of my possibles. But this hierarchy does not correspond to
the order of-universal Temporality such as will be established on the bases
of original Temporality. I am an infinity of possibilities, for the meaning
of the For-itself is complex and cannot be contained in one formula. But
a particular possibility may be more determinant for the meaning of the
present For-itself than another which is nearer in universal time. For
example, the possibility of going at two o'clock to see a friend whom I
have not seen for two years-this is truly a possible which I am. But the
nearer possibilities-the possibilities of going there in a taxi, by bus, by
subway, on foot-all these at present remain undertermined. I am not
anyone of these possibilities. Also there are gaps in the series of my possibi.
lities. In the order of knowledge the gaps will be filled by the constitution
of an homogeneous time without lacuna; in the order of action they will
be fined by the will-that is, by rational, thematizing choice in terms of
my possibles, and of possibilities which are not and will never be my
possibilities and which I will realize in the mode of total indifference in
order to be reunited with a possible which I am.

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II. THE ONTOLOGY OF TEMPORALITY

A. STATIC TEMPORALITY

OUR phenomenological description of the three temporal ekstases should
enable us at present to approach temporality as a total structure organiz-
ing within it secondary ekstatic structures. But this new study must be
made from two different points of view.

Temporality is often considered as an indefinable. Everybody admits
however that it is before all else a succession. And succession in turn can
be defin.ed as an order in which the ordering principle is the relation be·
fore-after. A multiplicity ordered in terms of before and after is a temporal
multiplicity. It is appropriate therefore to begin by considering the con-
stitution and the requirements of the terms before and after. This is what
we shall call the static temporal since these notions of before and after
can be considered in a strictly ordinal arrangement independent of change
prpper. But time is not only a fixed order for a determined mUltiplicity;
observing temporality more closely we establish the fact of succession;
that is, the fact that a particular after becomes a before, that the Present
becomes past and the future a former-future. This may well be the sub-
ject of our second investigation under the name of the dynamic
temporal. It is of course in the dynamic temporal that we will have to
look for the secret of the static constitution of time. But it is preferable
to divide up the difficulties. Indeed in a sense we can say that the static
temporal can be considered separately as a certain formal structure of
temporality-what Kant calls the order of time-and that the dynamic
corresponds to the material flow or-using Kantian terminology-to the
course of time. It will be to our advantage therefore to consider separately
first this order and then this course.

The order "before-after" is defined first of all by irreversibility. We call
such a series successive when we can consider the terms only One at a time
and only in one direction. But precisely because the tenns of the series
are revealed one at a time and because each is exclusive of the others,
some people have wanted

to see in the before and the after forms of
separation. Actually time does separate me, for example, from the realiza·
tion of my desires. If I am obliged to wait for that realization, it is because
it is located after other events. Without the succession of the "after," I
would be immediately what I wish to be; there would no longer be any
distance between the present me and the later me, nor any separation
between dream and action. Novelists and poets have insisted On time's
power to separate, and they have emphasized likewise an accompanying
idea, which however springs from the 9ynamic temporal-that every
"now" is destined to become a "formerly." Time gnaws and wears away;

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it separates; it flies. And by virtue of separation-by separating man from
his pain or from the object of his pain-time cures.
"Let time do it," said the King to Don Roderigo. In general people
have been struck with the necessity for all being to be divided up into an
infinite dispersion of alters which succeed each other. Even the perma-
nents, even this table, which remains invariable while I change, must
spread out and refract its being in the temporal dispersion. Time separates
me from myself, from what I have been, fwm what I wish to be, from what
I wish to do, from things, and from others. It is time which is chosen as
the practical measure of distance; this town is half an hour away, that one
an hour; it will take three days to finish this work, etc. It results from these
premises that a temporal vision of the world and of man wiII dissolve into
a crumbling of befores and afters. The unity of this crumbling, the tem-
poral atom, wiII be the instant, which has its place before certain deter-
mined instants and after other instants without admitting either before
or after inside its own form. The instant is indivisible and non-temporal
since temporality is succession, but the world dissolves into an infinite
dust of instants. And it is a problem for Descartes, for example, to learn
how there can be a passage from one instant to another instant; for the
instants are juxtaposed-i.e., separated by nothing and yet without com-
munication. Similarly Proust asks how his Self can pass from one instant
to another; how, for example, he discovers after a night's sleep precisely
the Self of the day before rather than some other one. More radically,
the empiricists after having denied the permanence of the Self try in vain
to establish a semblance of transversal unity across the instants of psychic
life. Thus when we consider in isolation the dissolving power of temporal-
ity, we are forced to admit that the fact of having existed at a given in-
stant does not constitute a right to exist at the following instant, not even
a mortgage or option on the future. The problem is then to explain how
there is a world-i.e., connected changes and permanences in time.
Yet temporality is not solely nor even primarily separation. \Ve can
account for this by considering more precisely the notion of before and
after. A, let us say, is after B. Now we have established an express relation
of order between A and B which supposes therefore their unification
at the heart of this very order. Even if there had been no other relation
between A and B than this, it would stiII be sufficient to assure their
connection, for it would allow thought to go from one to the other and to
unite them in a judgment of success

ion. If, then, time is separation, it is
at least a separation of a special type-a division which reunites. So far so good, somebody wiIl say, but this unifying relation is preeminently an external relation. When the Association School wanted to establish that the mind's impressions were held together only by purely·external bonds, did they not finally reduce all associative connections to the relation of before-after, conceived as simple "contiguity"?

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Of course. But has not Kant shown that the unity of experience and hence the unification of temporal change are required in order for the slightest bond of empirical association to be even conceivable? Let us consider the association theory more carefully. It is accompanied by a
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monistic conception to the effect that being is everywhere being-in-itself. Each impression on the mind is in itself what it is; it is isolated in its present plenitude and does not allow any trace of the future or any lack. Hume, when he issued his famous challenge, was concerned with establishing this law, which he claimed to derive from experience: one can at will examine any impression, strong or weak; one will never find anything in it but itself so that any connection with ap antecedent or a consequent, no matter how constant it may be, remains unintelligible.
Let us suppose a temporal content A existing as a being in-itself and a temporal content B, posterior to the first and existing in the same mode -that is, in the self-inclusion of identity. It should be remarked first that this self-identity obliges thcm to exist each without any separation from itself, without even a temporal separation, whether in eternity or in the instant-and eternity and the instant are here equivalent since the instant, not being defined internally in connection with before-after, is non-temporal. One may ask how under these circumstances the state A can be prior to the state B. It would be of no use to reply that it is not states which are prior or post but the instants which contain them, for on this theory the instants are in-itse1ts, like the states. But the priority of A over B supposes in the very nature of A (instant or state) an incompleteness which points toward B. If A is prior to B, then A receives this determination in B. Otherwise neither the upsurge nor the annihilation of B isolated in its instant can confer on A isolated in its instant the slightest particular quality. In a word, if A is to be prior to B, it must be, in its very being, in B as A's future. Conversely, B, if it is to be posterior to A must linger behind itself in A, which will confer on B its sense of posteriority. If then we grant a priori being in-itself to A and to B, it is impossible to establish between them the slightest connection of succ.ession. That connection in fact would be a purely external relation and as such would necessarily hang in midair, deprived of any substratum, without power to get any hold on either A or B-in a sort of non-temporal nothingness.
There remains the possibility that this relation before-after can exist only for a witness who establishes it. The difficulty is that if this witness can be simultaneously in A and in B, it is because he is himself temporal, and the problem will be raised anew for him. Or rather, on the contrary, he can transcend time by a gift of temporal ubiquity which is equivalent to
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itselfs
isolated each at its own place and date. How can we unify them? Are we dealing with a real unification? In this case either we are merely playing with words--and the unification will have no hold on the two in-itselfs isolated in their respective self-identity and completeness; or else it will be necessary to constitute a unity of a new type-namely, ekstatic unity in which each state will be outside itself, down there in order to be before or after the other. But this would necessitate shattering their being, expanding it, in a word temporalizing it, and would not merely bring them together. But how will the non-temporal unity of the "I think" as the simple faculty of thought be capable of effecting this decompression of being? Shall we say that the unification is potential; that is, that beyond impressions we have projected a type of unity roughly comparable to Husserl's noema? But how will a non-temporal which has to unite non-temporals conceive a unification of the type of the succession? And if as will then have to be admitted, the esse of time is a percipi, how is the percipitur constituted? In a word, how could a being with' a-temporal structure apprehend as temporals (or intend as such) in-itselfs isolated in their non-temporality? Thus inasmuch as temporality is at once a form of separation and a form of synthesis, it does not allow itself either to be derived from a non-temporal or to be imposed from without upon non-temporals.
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Leibniz in reaction against Descartes, and Bergson in reaction against Kant have in turn tried to see in temporality only a pure relation of immanence and cohesion. Leibniz considers that the problem of the passage from one instant to another and its solution, continuous creation, are a false problem and a useless solution. According to him Descartes forgot the continuity of time. By asserting the continuity of time, we forbid ourselves to conceive of time in the form of instants; and if there is no longer an instant, there is no longer any relation of before-after between instants. Time is a vast continuity of flow to which no original element existing in-itself may be assigned.
Leibniz has forgotten that before-after is also a form which separates. If time is a given continuity with an undeniable tendency to separate, one can raise Descartes' question in another form: what is the origin of the cohesive power of continuity? Of course there are primary elements juxtaposed in a continuum. But this is precisely because there is at the start a unification. It is because I draw a straight line, as Kant says, that the straight line, realized in the unity of a single act, is something other than an infinite series of points. Who then draws time? In short this continuity is a fact which must be accounted for. It cannot be a solution. We may recall here the famous definition of Poincare: a series a, b, c, is continuous when we can write a=b, b=c, a+c. This definition is excellent in that it gives us a foreshadowing of a type of being which is what iUs not and
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which is not what it is. By virtue of the axiom, a=c, by virtue of continuity itself, a+c. Thus a is and is not equivalent to c. And b, equal to a gnd equal to c is different from itself inasmuch as a is not equal to c. But this ingenious definition rests on a mere playing with words such as we confronted in the view of the in-itself. And whi

le it furnishes us with a type of being
which at the same time is and is not, it does not furnish us with either its principles or its foundation. Everything still remains to be done. In the study of temporality in particular, we realize well what service continuity can render us by putting in between the instant a and the instant c, no matter how close together they are, an intermediary b, such that, according to the formula a=b, b=c, atC; in this case b is at once indistinguishable from a and indistinguishable from c, which are perfectly distinct one from the other. It is b which will realize the relation before-after, it is b which will be before itself inasmuch as it is indistinguishable from a and from c. All very good! But how can such a being exist? Whence comes its ekstatic nature? How does it happen that the division which is outlined in it is not achieved? Why does it not explode into two terms, one of which would dissolve into a and the other in c? How can we fail to see that there is here a problem concerning its unity? Perhaps a deeper examination of the conditions of the possibilities of this being would have shown us that only the For-itself could thus exist in the ekstatic unity of self.
But this examination has not been attempted, and temporal cohesion, with Leibniz, hides after all the cohesion through absolute immanence of logic-i.e., identity. But if the chronological order is continuous, it could Hot "symbolize" with the order of identity, for the continuous is not compatible with the identical.
Similarly Bergson with his duration, which is a melodic organization and mUltiplicity, of interpenetration, does not appear to see that an organization of multiplicity presupposes an organizing act. He is right in contrast to Descartes when he suppresses'the instant; but Kant was right rather than Bergson in claiming that there is no given synthesis. This Past of Bergson's, which clings to the present and even penetrates it, is scarcely morc than a rhetorical figure. It shows wcB the difficulties which Bergson cncountered in his theory of memory. For if the Past, as he maintains, is inactive, it can only remain behind and will never come to penetrate the present in the form of memory unless a present being has undertaken to exist as well ekstatically in the Past. Of course, with Bergson, it is indeed one and the same being which endures. But that makes one realize all the more the need for ontological elucidations. Flir we do not know finally if it is the being which endures or if it is duration which is being. And if duration is being, then Bergson must tell us what is the ontological structure of duration; and if, on the contrary, it is being which endures, he must show us what it is in being which permits it to endure.
What can we conclude as the result of this discussion?· First of all this:

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temporality is a dissolving force but it is at the center of a unifying act; it is less a real multiplicity-which could not subsequently receive an'y unity and which consequently would not even exist as a multiplicity-than a quasi-multiplicity, a foreshadowing of dissociation in the heart of unity.
We need not try to consider either one of these two aspects separately. If we first posit temporal unity, we risk no longer being able to understand anything about irreversible succession as the meaniug of this unity, and if we conside

r the disintegrating succession as the original character of time,
we risk no longer being able to understand that there is one time. If then
there is no priority of unity over multiplicity, nor of multiplicity over
unity, it is necessary to conceive of temporality as a unity which multiplies
itself; that is, temporality can be only a relation of being at the heart of
this same being. We can not picture it as a container whose being would
be given, for this would be to renounce forever the hope of understanding
how this being in itself can be broken up into multiplicity or how the in-
itself of the containing minima or instants can be reunited within the
unity of one time. Temporality is not. Only a being of a certain structure
of being can be temporal in the unity of its being. The before and after
are intelligible, as we have observed, onlyas an internal relation. It is there
in the after that the before causes itself to be determined as before and
conversely. In short the before is intelligible only if it is the being which is',
before itself. This means that temporality can only indicate the mode of
being of a being which is itself outside itself. Temporality must have
the structure of selfness. Indeed it is only because the self in itsbeiIilgis
there outside itself that it can be before or after itself, that there can be in'
general any before and after. Temporality exists only as the.intra-structure
of a being which has to be its own being; that is, as the intra-structure of a
For-itself. Not that the For-itself has an ontological priority over tem-
porality. But Temporality is the being of the For-itself in so far as the
For-itself has to be its being ekstatically. Temporality is not, but the
For-itself temporalizes itself by existing.
Conversely our phenomenological study of the Past, the Present, and
the Future allows us to demonstrate that the For-itself can not be except
in temporal form.
The For-itself rising into being as the nihilation of the In-itself consti-
tutes itself simultaneously in all the possible dimensions of nihilation.
From whatever point of view it is considered, it is the being which holds
to itself by a single thread, or more precisely it is the being which by being
causes all the possible dimensions of its nihilation to exist. In the ancient
world the profound cohesion and dispersion of the Jewish people was des-
ignated by the term "Diaspora." It is this word which will serve to des-
ignate the mode of being of tne For-itself; it is diasporatic. Being-in-itself
has only one dimension of being, but the appearance· of nothingness as .'
that which is made-ta-be at the heart of being complicates the existentiaL
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structure by causing the.appearance of the ontological mirage of the Self.
We shall see later that reflection, transcendence, being-in-the-world, and
being-for-others represent several dimensions of nihilation or, if you prefer,
several original relations of being with the self. Thus nothingness intro-
duces quasi-multiplicity into the heart of being. This quasi-multiplicity is
the foundation of all intra-mundane multiplicities, for a multiplicity sup-
poses an 'original unity at the heart of which the multiplicity is outlined.
In this sense it is not true, as Myerson elaims, that the diverse creates a
scandal and that the responsibility for this scandal rests with the real. The
in-itself is not diversity; it i

s not multiplicity; and in order for it to receive
multiplicity as the characteristic of its being-in-the-midst-of-the-world, a being must arise which is simultaneously present to each in-itself isolated in its own identity. It is through human reality that multiplicity comes into the world; it is the quasi-multiplicity at the heart of being-for-itself which causes number to be revealed in the world.

But what is the meaning of these multiple dimensions or quasi-multiples of the For-itself? They are various relations to its being. When something simply is what it is, it has only one way of being its being. But the moment that something is no longer its being, then various ways of being it while not being it arise simultaneously. The For-itself-if we stick to the primary ekstases (those which both indicate the original meaning of the ni":1ilation and represent the least nihUation)-can and must at the same tin e fulfill these three requirements: (1) to not-be what it is, (2) to be what: t is not, (3) to be what it is not and to not-be what it is-within the unity of a perpetual referring. Here we are dealing with three ekstatic dimensions; the meaning of the ekstasis is distance from self. It is impossible to conceive of a consciousness which would not exist in these three dimensions. And if the cogito discovers one of them first, that does not mean that this dimension is first but only that it is most easily diselosed. But by itself alone it is unse1bstandig and it immediately allows the other dimensions to be seen. The For-itself is a being which must simultaneously exist in all its dimensions. Here distance, conceived as distance from the self, is nothing real, nothing which is in a general way as in-itself; it is simply the nothing, the nothingness which "is made-to-be" as separation. Each dimension is the For-itself's way of projecting itself vainly toward the Self, of being what it is beyond a nothingness, a different way of being this fall of being, this frustration of being which the For-itself has to be. Let us consider these dimensions one by one.

In the first dimension the For-itself has to be its being, behind itself, as that which it is without being the foundation of it. Its being is there, opposite it, but a nothingness separates it from its being, the nothingness of facticity. The For-itself as the foundation of its nothingness-and as such necessary-is separated from its original contingency in that it can neither get rid of it nor merge with it. It is for itself but in the mode of the irreme-

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diable and the gratuitous. Its being is for it, for it is not for this being, because such a reciprocity of reflection-reflecting would cause the original contingency of what is to disappear. Precisely because the For-itself apprehends itself in the form of being, it is at a distance-like a game of reflection-reflecting which slips into the in-itself and in which it is no longer the reflection which makes the reflecting exist nor the reflecting which makes the reflection exist. This being, because of the very fact that the For-itself has to be it, gives itself as something which is irretrievable precisely because the For-itself can not found it in the mode reflection-reflecting but only as it founds the connection between this being and itself. The For-itself does not found the being of this being but only the fact that this being c

an be given.
We are dealing here with an unconditional necessity: whatever the For-itself under consideration may be, it is in one certain sense; it is since it cail be named, since certain characteristics may be affirmed or denied COncerning it. But in so far as it is For-itself, it is never what it is. What it is is behiqd it as the perpetual surpassed. It is precisely this surpassed facticity which we call the Past. The Past then is a necessary structure of the For-itself; for the For-itself can exist only as a nihilating surpassing, and this surpassing implies something surpassed. Consequently it is impossible at any particular moment when we consider a For-itself, to apprehend it as not-yet-having a Past. We need not believe that the For-itself exists first and arises in the world in the absolute newness of a being without a past and that it then gradually constitutes a past for itself. But whatever may be the circumstances under which the For-itself arises in the world, it comes to the world in the ekstatic unity of a relation with its Past; there is no absolute beginning which without ever having a past would become past. Since the For-itself, qua For-itself, has to be its past, it comes into the world with a Past.
These few remarks may permit us to view in a somewhat different light the problem of birth. Actually it seems shocking that consciousness "appears" at a certain. moment, that it comes "to inhabit" the tmbryo, il~ short that there is a moment when the living being in formation is without consciousness and a moment when a consciousness without a past is suddenly imprisoned in it. But the shock will cease if it appears that there can be no consciousness without a past. This does not mean, however, that every consciousness supposes a prior consciousness fixed in the In-itself. The relation of the present For-itself to the For-itself become In-itself hides from us the primitive relation of Pastness, which is a relation between the For-itself and the pure In-itself. In fact it is as the nihiIation of the In-itself that the For-itself arises in the world, and it is by this absolute event that the Past as such is constituted as the original, nihilating relation between the For-itself and the In-itself. What originally constitutes the being of the For-itsdf is this relation to a being which is

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not consciousness, which exists in the total night of identity, and which the For-itself is nevertheless obliged to be, outside and behind itself. The For-itself, which can in no case be reduced to this being represents an absolute newness in relation to it, but the For-itself feels a profound solidarity of being with it and indicates this by the word before. The In-itself is what the For-itself was before. In this sense we can e~sily conceive that our past appears to us bounded by a fine, smooth wire, which would become actual if consciousness could spring up in the world before having a past, but which, on the contrary, is lost in a progressive obscuration back to that darkness which is nevertheless still ourselves. We can conceive of the ontological meaning of this shocking solidarity with the foetus, a solidarity which we neither deny nor understand. For finally this foetus was me; it represents the factual limit for my memory but not the theareticallimit of my past.
There is a metaphysical problem concerning birth in that I can be anxio

us to know how I happen to have been born from that particular embryo; and this problem is perhaps insoluble. But it is not an ontological problem; we do not have to ask why there can be a birth of consciousness, for consciousness can appear to itself only as a nihilation of in-itself -i.e., as being already born. Birth as an ekstatic relation of being to the In-self which it is not and as the a priori constitution of pastness is a law of being for the For-itself. To be For-itself is to be born. But one should not next raise metapllysical questions concerning the In-itself from which the For-itself was born, questions such as: "How was there an In-itself before the birth of the For-itself? How was the For-itself born from this In-itself rather than .from another?" Etc. All these questions fail to. take into account the fact that it is through the For-itself that the Past in general can exist. If there is a Before, it is because the For-itself has arisen in the world, and it is from the standpoint of the For-itself that the past can be established. To the extent that the In-itself is made co-present with the For-itself, a world appears instead of isolated examples of In-itself. And in this world it is possible to effect a designation and to say this object, that object. In this sense, inasmuch as the For-itself in its coming into being causes a world of co-presences to exist, it causes also the appearance of its "before" as a co-present to the in-itselfs in a world or, if you prefer, in a state of the world which has passed.

Thus in a sense the For-itself appears as being bam from the world, for the In-itself from which it is born is in the midst of the world, as a co-present past among co-present pasts; into the world and in terms of the world a For-itself arises which did not exist before and which has been born. But in another sense it is the For-itself which causes the existence of a before in general and the existence in this before of co-presents united in the unity of one past world and such that one can designate one or the other among them as this object. There is not first one universal time

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where a For-itself suddenly appears not yet having a Past. Rather it is in terms of birth as the original and a priori law of being for the For-itself that there is revealed a world with a universal time in which we can designate a moment when the For-itself was not yet and a moment when it appeared, beings from which the For-itself was not born and a being from which it was born. Birth is the upsurge of the absolute relation of Pastness as the ekstatic being of the For-itself in the In-itself. Through birth a Past appears in the world. We shall return to this. Here it is sufficient to note that consciousness or for-itself is a being which rises to being beyond an unalterable which it is and that this unalterable, inasmuch as it is behind the For-itself in the midst of the world, is the Past.

The Past as the unalterable being which I have to be without any possibility of not being it does not enter into the unity "reflection-reflecting" of the Erlebnis; it is outside. Yet neither does it exist as that of which there is consciousness in the sense, for example, that the perceived chair is that of which there is perceptive consciousness. In the case of the perception of the chair, there is a thesis-that is, the apprehension and affirmat

ionof the chair as the in-itself which consciousness is not. What consciousness has to be in the mode of being of the For-itself i~ not-being-the-chair. For its "not-being-the-chair" is, as we shall see, in the form of the consciousness (of) not-being (i.e., the appearance of not-being) for a witness who is there only to bear witness to this not-being. The negation then is explicit and constitutes the bond of being between the perceived object and the for-itself. The For-itself is nothing more than this translucent Nothing which is the negation of the thing perceived. But although the Past is outside, the connection here is not of the same type, for the For-itself gives itself as being the Past. Due to this fact there can not be a thesis of the Past, for one can posit only what one is not. Thus in the perception of the object the For-itself acknowledges itself to itself as not being the object, while in the unveiling of the Past, the For-itself acknowledges itself as being the Past and is separated from it only by its nature as For-itself, which can be nothing. Thus the Past is not made a thesis, and yet the Past is not immanent in the For-itself. It haunts the For-itself at the very moment that the For-itself acknowledges itself as not being this or that partjcular thing. The Past is not the object of the regard of the For-itself. This translucent regard is directed to itself beyond the thing, toward the future. The Past as a thing which one is without positing it, as that which haunts without being observed, is behind the For-itself, outside the thematic field which is before the For-itself as that which it iHuminates. The Past is "posited opposite" the For-itself and assumed as that which the For-itself has to be without being able either to affirm or deny or thematize or absorb it.

To be sure, the Past can be the object of a thesis for me, and indeed it is often thematized. But then it is the object of an explicit investigation,

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and in this case the For-itself affirms itself as not being this Past which it posits. The Past is nb longer behind; it does not cease being past, but I myself cease to be the Past. In the primary mode I was my Past without knowing it (but by no means not without being conscious of it); in the secondary mode I know my past but I no longer was it. Someone may ask how,I can be conscious of my Past if it is not in the thetic mode. Yet the Past is there constantly. It is the very meaning of the object which I look at and which I have already seen, of the familiar faces which surround me. It is the origin of this movement which presently follows and which I would not be able to call circular if I were not myself-in the Past-the witness of its beginning. It is the origin and springboard of all my actions; it is that constantly given density of the world which allows me to orient myself and to get my bearings. It is myself in so far as I aim at myself as a person (there is also a structure to-come of the Ego). In short, the Past is my contingent and gratuitous bond with the world and with myself inasmuch as I constantly live it as a total renunciation. The psyclrologists call it empirical knowledge (savoir). But in addition to the fact that by this term they "psychologize" it, they thus remove any method of accounting for it. For empirical knowledge is everywhere and conditions everything, even memory; in a word,

intellectual memory presupposes
knowledge. And what is their empirical knowledge-if we are to understand by it a present fact-if it is not an intellectual memory? This supple, insinuating, changing knowledge which makes the woof of all our thoughts and which is composed of a thousand empty indications, a thousand designations which point behind us, without image, without words, without thesis-this is my concrete Past inasmuch as I was it as the unalterable background-depth of all my thoughts and all my feelings.
In its second dimension of nihilation, the For-itself apprehends itself as a certain lack. It is this lack and it is also the lacking, for it has to be what it is. To drink or to be drinking means never to have finished drinking, to have still to be drinking beyond the drinking which I am. And when "I have finished drinking," I have drunk: the ensemble slips into the past. While actually drinking, I am then this drinking which I have to be and which I am not; every designation of myself if it is to be heavy and full, if it is to have the density of the self-identical-every such designation escapes me into the past. If it reaches me in the Present, it is because it divides itself into the Not-yet; it is because it designates me as an unachieved totality which can not be achieved. This Not-yet is gnawed by the nihilating freedom of the For-itself. It is not only being-at-a-distance; it is the whittling down of being. Here the For-itself, which was in advance of itself in the first dimension of nihilation, is now behind itself. Before itself, behind itself: never itself. This is the very meaning of the two ekstases Past and Future, and this is why value in itself is by nature self-repose, non-temporalityI The eternity which man is seeking is not the infinity of

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duration, of that vain pursuit after the self for which I am myself responsible; man seeks a repose in self, the atemporality of the absolute coincidence with himself.
Finally, in the third dimension, the For-itself, dispersed in the perpetual game of reflected-reflecting,~ escapes itself in the unity of one and the the same flight. Here being is everywhere and nowhere: wherever one tries to seize it, it is there before one, it has escaped. It is this game of musical chairs at the heart of the For-itself which is Presence to being.8
As Present, Past, Future-all at the same time-the For-itself dispersing its being in three dimensions is temporal due to the very fact that it nihilatcs itself. No one of these dimensions has any ontological priority over the other; none of them can exist without the other two. Yet in spite of all this, it is best to put the accent on the present ekstasis and not on the future ekstasis as Heidegger does: for it is as a revelation to itself that the For-itself is its Past, as that which it has-to-be-for-itself in a nihilating surpassing; and it is as a revelation to itself that it is a lack and that it is haunted by its future-that is, by that which it is for itself down there at a distance. The Present is not ontologically "prior" to the Past and to the Future; it is conditioned by them as much as it conditions them, but it is the mould of indispensible non-being for the total synthetic form of Temporality.
Thus Temporality is not a universal time containing all beings and in particular human realities. Neither is it a law of developmen

t which is
imposed on being from without. Nor is it being. But it is the intra-structure of the being which is its own nihilation-that is, the mode ot being peculiar to being-for-itself. The For-itself is the being which has to be its being in the diasporatic form of Temporality.

B. THE DYNAMIC OF TEMPORALITY

THE fact that the upsurge of the For-itself is necessarily effected according to the three dimensions of Temporality teaches us nothing concerning the problem of duration, which falls under the heading of the dynamic of time. At first approach the problem appears twofold. Why does the For-itself undergo that modification of its being which makes it become Past? And why does a new For-itself arisc ex nihiIo to become the Present of this Past?

This problem has for a long time been disguised by a conception of the human being as an in-it~elf. His the sinew of Kant's refutation of Berkeley's idealism and a favorite argument of Leibniz that change by itself

II Possibly an error for the "reflection-reflecting," which Sartre has used elsewhere. Tr.

8 I find it impossible to transfer the exact meaning from French to English. Chassecroise, literally a dancing expression, is equivalent to "set to partners:: From it derives the meaning of a futile rearrangement of personnel.

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implies permanence. Consequently if we suppose a certain non-temporal permanence which remains across time, temporality is reduced to bcing no more than the measure and order of change. Without change there is no temporality since time could not get any hold on the permanent and the identical. Moreover if as with Leibniz change itself is given as the logical explanation of a relation of conelusions to premises-that is, asthe development of the attributes of a permanent subject-then there is no longer any real temporality.

But this conception is based on. several errors. First of all, the subsistence of a permanent element apart from something which changes can not allow change to be constituted as such except in the eyes of a witness who would be himself united with that which changes and with that which remains. In a word the unity of change and the permanent is necessary for the constihltion of change as such. But this same term unity, which Leibniz and Kant have misused, does not signify very much here. What is meant by this unity of disparate elements? Is it only a purely external attachment? Then it has no meaning. It must be a unity of being. But such a unity of being amounts to requiring that the permanent be that which changes; and hence the unity is at the start ekstatic and refers to the For-itself inasmuch as the For-itself is essentially ekstatic being; in addition the unity prevents permanence and change from existing each as in-itself. 'Vhat is not said is that permanence and change are taken here as phenomena and have only a relative being; the In-itself is not opposed to phenomena as the noumcnon is. A phenomenon is in-itself, according to the very terms of our definition, when it is what it is, even if it is in relation with a subject or another phenomenon. Moreover the appearance of relation as determining the phenomena in connection with each other supposes an,tecedently the upsurge of an ekstatic being which can be what it is not in order to establish the "elsewhere" and relation in general. Moreover resorting to permanence in order to furnish th

e foundation
for change is completely useless. What Kant and Leibniz want to show is that an absolute change is no longer strictly speaking change since it is no longer based on anything which changes-or in relation to which there is change. But in fact if what changes is its former state in the past mode, this is sufficient to make permancnce superfluous. In this case change can be absolute; we can be dealing with a metamorphosis which touches all of being; it will be constituted as change in relation to a prior state just as it will be in the Past in the mode of was. Since tl:is link with the past replaces the pseudo-necessity of permanence, the problem of duration can and ought to be posited in relation to absolute changes. Moreover there is no other kind even "in the world." Up to a certain threshold changes are non-existent; past this threshold, they extend to the total form-as the experiments of the Gestalt school have shown
In addition when we are dealing with human reality, what is necessary

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is pure and absolute change, which can very well be in addition a change with nothing which changes and which is actual duration. Even if we admitted, for example, that the simple consciousness of a For-itself was the absolutely empty presence of this For-itself to a permanent In-itself, still the very existence of the consciousness would imply temporality since it would have to be without change what it is in the form of "having been it." There would be then not eternity but the constant necc~sity for the pr~sent For-itself to become the Past of a new Present and that by virtue of the very being of consciousness. And if someone should tell us that this perpetual recovery of the Present in the Past by a new Present implies an inner change in the For-itself, we should reply that then it is the temporality of the For-itself which is the foundation of the change and not the change which furnishes the foundation for temporality. Nothing can hide the following problems which at first seem insoluble: Why does the ·Present become the Past? What is this new Present which then springs forth? Where does it come from, and why does it arise? We must note that as is shown by our hypothesis of an "empty" consciousness, the question here is not the necessity for a pennanence to cascade from instant to instant while remaining materially a permanence. The real question is the necessity for being, whatever it may be, to metamorphose itself completely at once-fonn and content, to sink into the past and to thrust itself forward at the same time ex nihilo toward the future.
But are these really two problems? Let us look more closely. The Present could not pass except by becoming the before of a For-itself which constitutes itself as the after of that Present. There is then only one phenomenon: the upsurge of a new Present which is making-past the Present which it was, and the Making-Past of a Present involving the appearance of a For-itself for which this Present is going to become Past. The phenomenon of temporal becoming is a global modification since a Past which would be the Past of nothing would no longer be a Past and since a Present must be necessarily the Present of this Past. This metamorphosis, moreover, affects not only the pure Present; the former Past and Future are equally affected. The Past of the Present which has undergone'the modification

of Pastness, becomes the Past of a Past-or a Plu-
perfect. So far as the Pluperfect is concerned, the heterogeneity of the Present and the Past is now suddenly suppressed since what made the Present distinct as such from the Past has now become Past. In the course of the metamorphosis the Present remains the Present of this Past, but it becomes the past Present of this Past. That means first that this present is homogeneous with the series of the Past which extends from it all the way back to its birth, second that this present is no longer its Past in the form of having to be it but in the mode of having had to be it. The connection between Past and Pluperfect is a connection which is
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in the mode of the In-itself, and it appears on the foundation of the present For-itself. It is this which holds the series of the Past and pluperfects welded into a single block.
The Future, on the other hand, although equally affected by the metamorphosis, does not cease to be future-that is, to remain outside the For-i.tself, in advance, beyond being-but it becomes the future of a past or a former future. It can enter into two kinds of relations with the new Present according to whether we are dealing with the immediate Future or the far Future. In the first case the Present is given as being this Future in relation to the Past: "What I was waiting for-here it is."
It is the Present of its Past in the mode of the former Future of this Past. But at the same time that it is For-itself as the Future of this Past, it realizes itself as For-itself, therefore as not being what the Future promised to be. There is a split: the Present becomes the Former Future of the Past while denying that it is this Future. And the original Future is not realized; it is no longer future in relation to the Present, but it does not cease to be future in relation to the Past. It becomes the unrealizable co-present of the Present and preserves a total ideality. "Is this what I was waiting for?" It remains a future ideally co-present with the Present, as the unrealized Future of the Past of this Present.
When the Future is far removed, it remains future in relation to the new Present; but if the Present does not constitute itself as the lack of this Future, then this Future loses its character as possibility~ In this case the former Future becomes an indifferent possible in relation to the new Present and not its Possible. In this sense it no longer possibilizes itself but qua possible it receives being-in-itself. It becomes a given Possible; that is, a Possible which is in-itself for a For-itself become In-itself. Yesterday itwas possible-as my Possible-that I should leave next Monday for the country. Today this Possible is no longer my Possible; it remains the thematized object of my contemplation and has become the always future Possible which I have been. But its only bond with my Present is that I have to be in the mode of "was" this Present become Past for which this possible has not ceased being a possible-beyond my Present. But Future and past Present are solidified in the In-itself on the foundation of my Present. Thus the Future in the course of the temporal process, passes to the in-itself without ever losing its character as Future. In so far as it is not achieved by the Present, it becomes simply a given Future. When it is achieved, it is affected with the quality of i

deality; but
this ideality is ideality in-itself, for it presents itself as a given lack of a given past and not as the lacking which a present For-itself has to be in the mode of not being. When the Future is surpassed, it remains forever on the margin of the series of Pasts as a former Future-a former Future of a particular Past become Pluperfect, an ideal given Future as co-present to a Present become Past.

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We have yet to examine the metamorphosis of the present For-itself into the Past with .the accompanying upsurge of a new Present. It would be an error to believe that the former Present is abolished and that there arises a Present in-itself which retains an image of the vanished Present. In one sense it would almost be correct to reverse our terms in order to find the truth, for the making-past of the ex-present is a passage to the in-itself while the appearance of a new present is the nihilation of that in-itself. The Present is not a new In-itself; it is what it is not, that which is beyond being; it is that of which we can say "it is" only in the Past. The Past is not abolished; it is that which has become what it was; it is the Being of the Present. Finally, as we have sufficiently demonstrated, the relation of the Present to the Past is a relation of being, not of representation..
Consequently the first characteristic which strikes us is the reapprehension of the For-itself by Being, as if the ·For-itself no longer had the strength to sustain its own nothingness. That deep fissure which the For-itself has to be is filled up; the Nothingness which must "be made-to-be" ceases to be, is expelled with the result that Being-For-itself, made past, becomes a quality of the In-itself. If I have experienced a particular sadness in the past, it exists no longer in so far as I have made myself experience it. This sadness no longer has the exact measure of being which can be enjoyed by an appearance which makes itself its own witness. It is because it has been; being comes to it, so to speak, as an external necessity. The Past is a fatality in reverse. The For-itself can make itself what it wishes, but it can not escape from the necessity of being irremediably -for a new For-itself-what it has wished to be. Hence the Past is a For-itself which has ceased to be a transcending presence to the In-itself. Now become an in-itself, it has fallen into the midst of the world. What I have to be I am as a presence to the world which I am not but which I was; I was it in the midst of the world, just as things are, by virtue of existing within-the-world. Nevertheless this world in which the For-itself has to be what it was can not be the same as that to which it is actually present. Thus is constituted the Past of the For-itself as the past presence to a past state of the world. Even if the world has undergone no variation while the For-itself "passed" from the Present to the Past, it is at least apprehended as having undergone the same formal change which we describec earlier as taking place at the heart of being-for-itself. This is a change which is only a reflection of the true internal change of consciousness. In other words, the For-itself falling into the Past as an ex-presence-to-being becomes in-itself, becomes a being "in-the-midst-of-the-world," and the world is retained in the past dimension as that in the midst of which the past For

lly the ensemble becomes a made totality, the future and the past restrict the for-itself and constitute given limits for it. The ensemble as temporarily which is, is petrified around a solid nucleus, which is the present instant of the for-itself, and the problem is then indeed to explain how from this instant can arise another instant with its own cortege of past and future. We have escaped instantaneity in the sense that the instant would be the only in-itself reality limited by a nothingness of the future and a nothingness of the past, but we have fallen back into it by :mplicity admitting a succession of temporal·totalities of which each one would be centered around an instant. In a word, we have endowed the instant with ekstatic dimensions, but we have not thereby suppressed it, which means that we cause temporal totality to be supported by the non-temporal. Time, if it is, becomes again merely a dream.

But change belongs naturally to the for-itself inasmuch as'this for-itself is spontaneity. A spontaneity of which we can say: it is. Or simply: This spontaneity should be allowed to define itself; this means both that it is the foundation not only of its nothingness of being but also of its being and that simultaneously being recaptures it to fix it in the given. A spontaneity which posits itself qua spontaneity is obliged by the same stroke to refuse what it posits; otherwise its being would become an acquisition and it would be perpetuated in being as the result of being acquired. Yet this refusal itself is an acquisition which it must refuse lest it be ensnared in an inert prolongation of its existence. Someone may say that these ideas of prolongation and of acquisition already suppose temporality, and that is true. But this is because spontaneity itself constitutes the acquisition by the refusal and the refusal by the acquisition, for spontaneity can not be without temporalizing itself. Its peculiar nature is not to profit from the acquisition which it constitutes by realizing itself as spontaneity. It is impossible otherwise to conceive of spontaneity wi~h-out contracting it within an instant and thereby fixing it in in,;Jtself; that is, without supposing a transcendent time. It would be in vain to object that we cannot think of anything except in temporal form and that our account begs the question since we temporalize being in order to make time spring from it a little afterwards. It would be useless to remind us of the passages in the Critique where Kant shows that a non-telJlporal spontaneity is inconceivable but not contradictory. It seems to us, On the contrary, that a spontaneity which would not escape from itself and which would not escape from that very escape, of which we could say, "It is this," and which would allow itself to be inclosed in an unchangeable denomination-it seems that such a spontaneity would be precisely a contradiction

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and that it would ultimately be the equivalent of a particular affirmative essence, the eternal subject which is never a predicate. Moreover it is precisely its character as spontaneity which constitutes the very irreversibility of its evasions since from the moment of its appearance it is in order to refuse itself and since the order "positing-refusing" can not be rever~ed. The very positing is achieved in a refusing without ever attaining to an affirmative plenitude; otherwise it would

be exhausted in an
instantaneous in-itself, and it is only because it is refused that it passes to being in the totality of its accomplishment. The unitary series of "acquisitions-refused" has in addition an ontological priority over change, for change is simply the relation of the material contents of the series. But we have shown that the very irreversibility of temporalization7 is necessary to the completely empty and a priori form of a spontaneity.
I have prcsented this thesis by using the concept of spontaneity which seemed to me more familiar to my readers. But we can now take up these ideas again in the perspective of the for-itself and with our own termi-·nology. A for-itself which did not endure would remain o/course a negation of the transcendent in-itself and a nihilation of its own being in the form of the "reflection-reflecting." But this nihilation would become a given; that is, it would acquire the contingency of the in-itself, and the For-itself would cease to be the foundation of its own nothingness; it would no longer be as having to be, but in the nihilating unity of the dyad reflection-reflecting, it would be. The flight of the for-itself is the refusal of contingency by the very act which constitutes the for-itself as being the foundation of its nothingness. But this flight establishes· in contingency exactly what is fled: the for-itself which has been fled is left at its place. It can not be annihilated since I am it, but neither can it any longer be as the foundation of its own nothingness since it can be this ouly in flight. It is accomplished. What applies to the for-itself as presence to -- is also naturally appropriate as well to the totality of tern-poralization. This totality never is achieved; it is a totality which is refused and which flees from itself. It is the wrenching away from self within the unity of a single upsurge, an inapprehensible totality which at the moment when it gives itself is already beyond this gift of self.
Thus the time of consciousness is human reality which temporalizes itself as the totality which is to itself its own incompletion; it is nothingness slipping into a totality as a detotalizing ferment. This totality which runs after itself and refuses itself at the same time, which can find in itself no limit to its surpassing because it is its own surpassing and because it surpasses itself toward itself, can under no circumstance exist within the limits of an instant. There is never an instant at which wc can assert that the for-itself is, precisely because the for-itself never is. Temporality, on the contrary, temporalizes itself entirely as the refusal of the instant.
7 Correction for temporization, an obvious misprint. Tr.

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III. ORIGINAL TEMPORALITY AND PSYCHIC TEMPORALITY: REFLECTION

THE for-itself endures in the fonn of a non-thetic consciousness (of) enduring. But I can "feel the time which flows" and apprehend myself as a unity of succession. In this case I am conscious of enduring. This coIYsciousness is thetic and strongly resembles a knowledge just as duration which is temporalized under my regard is roughly like an object of knowledge. \Vhat relation can exist between original temporality and this psychic temporality which I encounter as soon as I apprehend myself "in process of enduring"? This problem brings us immediately to another problem, for the consciousn

ess of duration is a consciousness of a con-
sciousness which endures; consequently to posit the question of the nature and laws of this thetic consciousness of duration amounts to positing that of the nature and the laws of reflection. In fact temporality in the form of psychic duration belongs to reflection, and all the processes of psychic duration belong to the consciousness reflected-qn.
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Before asking how a psychic duration can be constituted as the immanent object of reflection, we must try to answer this preliminary question: how is reflection possible for a being which can be only in the past? Reflection is given by Descartes and by Husser! as a type of privileged intuition because it apprehends consciousness in an act of present and instantaneous immanence. Will it keep its certitude if the being which it has to know is past in relation to it? And since all our ontology has its foundation in a reflective experience, does it not risk losing all its laws? Yetis it actually the past being which should make the object of reflective consciousness? If the process of reflection itself is a for-itself, ought it to be limited to an existence and certitude which are instantaneous? We can decide these questions only if we return to the reflective phenomenon and determine its structure.
Reflection is the for-itself conscious of itself. As the for-itself is already a non-thetic self-consciousness, we are accustomed to represent reflection as a new consciousness, abruptly appearing, directed on the consciousness reflected-on, and living in symbiosis with it. One recalls here the old idea ideae of Spinoza.
But aside from the fact that it is difficult to explain the upsurge ex nihilo of the reflective consciousness, it is completely impossible in this way to account for its absolute unity with the consciousness reflected-on, a unity which alone renders conceivable the laws and the certainty of the reflective intuition. We cannot here indeed say that the esse of that which is reflected-on is a percipi since its being is such that it does not need to be perceived in order to exist. And its primary relation with reflection can not be the unitary relation of a representation to a thinking subject. If the known existent is to have the same rank of being as the knowing existent,

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then, in short, it is in the perspective of naive realism that we must describe the relation of these two existents. But in this case we are going to encounter the major difficulty of realism: how can two completely isolated independents, provided with that sufficiency of being which the Germans call Selbstiindigkeit, enter into relation with each other, and in particular how qm they enter into that type of internal relation which we call knowledge? If first we conceive of reflection as an autonomous consciousness, we shall never be able to reunite it later with the consciousness reflected-on. They wiII always be two, and if-to suppose the impossible-the reflective consciousness could be consciousness of the consciousness reflected-on, there could be only an external connection between the two consciousness; at most we could imagine that reflection isolated in itself possesses an image of the consciousness reflected-on, and we would then fall back into idealism. Reflective knowledge, and in particular the cogito would lose their certainty and would obtain in exchange only a c

ertain probability,
scarcely definable. It is agreed then that reflection must be united to that which is reflected-on by a bond of being, that the reflective consciousness must be the consciousness reflected-on.
But on the other hand, there can be no question here of a total identification of the reflective with that reflected-on, for this would suddenly suppress the phenomenon of reflection by allowing only the phantom dyad "the-reflection-reflecting"8 to subsist. Here once again we meet that type of being which defines the for-itself: reflection-if it is to be apodietie evidence-demands that the reflective be that which is reflected-on.
But to the extent that reflection is knowledge, the reflected-on must necessarily be the object for the reflective; and this implies a separation of being. Thus it is necessary that the reflective simultaneously be and not be the reflected~on. We have already discovered this ontological structure at the heart of the for-itself. But then it did not have at all the same me<1hing. In fact it supposed in the two terms "reflected and reflecting" a radical Unse1bstandigkeit on the part of the suggested duality; that is, such an inability on the part of the terms to be posited separately that the duality remained perpetually evanescent and each term, while positing·

8 The translator encounters a difficulty here owing to the fact that the English word "reflection" has two different meanings which are perfectly distinct in French. In discussing the dyad "reflection-reflecting," Sartre uses reflet-refletant. Here "reflcc:tion" means that which is reflected-like an image-and easily suggests to Sartre the idea of a game with mirrors. In the present section, however, the subject of discussion is reflexion, which mean the process of mental reflection in general and in particular introspection. As a feeble attempt to prevent confusion, I am in this section using the article with reflet, the "reflection" in the dyad, and in some cases I am giving the French as well.
A similar but less insoluble difficulty occurs with words deriving;frorn reflechir (to reflect in the sense of reflexion) andrefleter to reflect an image). ,To distinguish these I am using the English expression "reflect-on" where mental action is involved. "Reflective" also indicate~ the mental process of reflection. Tr.

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itself for the other, became the other. But in the case of reflection, the case is slightly different since "the reflection-reflecting," which is reflected-on exists for a "reflection-reflecting" which is reflective. In other words, the reflected-on is an appearance for the reflective without thereby ceasing to be witness (of) itself, and the reflective is witness of the reflected-on without thereby ceasing to be an appearance to itself. It is even in so far as it is reflected in itself (se reflete en soi) that the reflected-on is an appearance for the reflective, and the reflective can be witness only in so far as it is consciousness (of) being so; that is, to the exact extent that this witness, which it is, is a reflection (reflet) for a reflecting which it is also. Reflected-on and reflective· therefore each tend to the Selbstandigkeit, and the nothing which separates them dividt'.5 them more profoundly than the nothingness of the for-itself separates the reflection (reflet) from the reflecting.
Yet we must note two things: (1)

can have its being as witness only in and through the appearance; that is, it is profoundly affected in its being by its reflectivity and consequently can never achieve the Se1bstandigkeit at which it aims, since it derives its being from its function and its function from the for-itself reflected-on.
(2) The reflected-on is profoundly altered by reflection (reflexion) in this sense that it is self-consciousness as the consciousness reflected-on of this or that transcendent phenomenon. The reflected-on knows itself observed. It may best be compared-to use a concrete example-to a man who is writing, bent over a table, and who while writing knows that he is observed by somebody who stands behind him. The reflected-on has then, in a way, already a consciousness (of) itself as having an outside or rather the suggestion of an outside; that is, it makes himself an object for --, so that its meaning as reflected-on is inseparable from the reflective and exists over there at a distance from itself in the consciousness which reflects on it. In this sense the reflected-on does not possess Selbstandigkeit any more than the reflective itself.
Husserl tells us that the reflected-on "gives itself as having been there before reflection." But we must not be deceived here; the Selbstandigkeit of the not-reflected-on qua not-reflected-on in relation to all possible reflection does not pass into the phenomenon of reflection, for the phenomenon loses its character as not reflected-on. For a consciousness, to become reflected-on means to undergo a profound modification of its being and precisely to lose the Selbstandigkeit which it possessed as the quasi-totality "the reflected-reflecting." Finally, to the extent tIlat a nothingness separates the reflected-on from the reflective, this nothingness, which cannot derive its being from itself, must "be made-to-be." Let us understand by this that only a unitary structure of being can he its own nothingness in the form of having to be it. In fact neither the reflective nor the reflected-on can issue this separating nothingness. But
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reflection is one being, just like the unreflective for-itself, not an addition of being; it is a being wl1ich has to be its own nothingness. It is not the appearance of a new consciousness directed on the for-itself but an intrastructural modification which the for-itself realizes in itself; in a word it is the for-itself which makes itself exist in the mode reflective-reflected-on, instea<;l- of being simply in the mode of the dyad reflection-reflecting; furthermore, this new mode of being allows the mode of the reflection-reflecting to subsist as a primary inner structure. The one who is reflecting on me is not some sort of non-temporal regard but myself, myself who am enduring engaged in the circuit of my selfness, in danger in the world, with my historicity. This historicity and this being-in-the-world and this circuit of selfness-these the for-itself which I am lives in the mode of the reflective dissociation (dcdoub1cment).
As we have seen, the reflective is separated from the reflected-on by a nothingness. Thus the phenomenon of reflection is a nihilation of the for-itself, a nihilation which does not come to it from without but which it has to be. Where is the origin of this further nihilation? What can be its motivation?
In the upsurge of t

he for-itself as presence to being, there is an original
dispersion: the for-itself is lost outside, next to the in-itself, and in the
three temporal ekstases. It is outside of itself, and in its inmost heart
this being-for-itself is ekstatic since it must look for its being elsewhere-
in the reflecting (refletant) if it makes itself a reflection (reaet), in the
reflection if it posits itself as reflecting. The upsurge of the for-itself con-
firms the failure of the in-itself, which has not been able to be its own
foundation. Reflection (reflexion) remains for the for-itself a permanent
possibility, an attempt to recover being. By reflection the for-itself, which
has lost itself outside itself, attempts to put itself inside its own being.
Reflection is a second effort by the for-itself to found itself; that is, to be
for itself what it is. Indeed if the quasi-dyad the reflection-reflecting were
gathered up into a totality for a witness which-would be itself, it would
be in its own eyes what it is. The goal in short is to overtake that being
which flees itself while being what it is in the mode of not-being and which
flows on while being its own flow, which escapes between its own fingers;
the goal is to make of it a given, a given which finally is what it is; the
problem is to gather together in the unity of one regard this unachieved
totality which is unachieved only because it is to itself its own non-achieve-
ment, to escape from the sphere of the perpetual reference which has to
be a reference to itself, and-precisely because it has escaped from the
chains of this reference-to make it be as a seen reference-that is, as a ref-
erence which is what it is.
But at the same time it is necessary that this being which recovers itself
and establishes itself as a given-that is, which confers on itself the con-
tingency of being in order to preserve it while founding it-this must

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itself be that which it recovers and founds, that which it preserves from the
ekstatic scattering. The motivation of reflection (reflexion) consists in a
double attempt, simultaneously an objectivation and an interiorization.
To be to itself as an object-in-itself in the absolute unity of interioriza-
tion-that is what the being-of-reflection has to be.'
This effort to be to itself its own foundation, to recover and to domi-
nate within itself its own flight, finally to be that flight instead of tern-
poralizing it as the flight which is fled-this effort inevitably results in
failure; and it is precisely this failure which is reflection. In fact it is itself
the being which has to recover the being which is lost, and it must be this
recovery in the mode of being which is its own; that is, in the mode of
the for-itself, therefore of flight. It is qua for-itself that the for-itself will
try to be what it is or, if you prefer, it will be for itself what it is-for-itself.
Thus reflection or the attempt to recover the for-itself by a turning back
On itself results in the appearance of the for-itself for the for-itself. The
being which wants to find a foundation in being is itself the foundation
only of its own nothingness. 'I)1e ensemble consequently 'remains a ni-
hilated in-itself. At the same time the turning back of being on itself can
only cause the appearance of a distance between what turns back and that
on which it turns. This turning back upon the self is a wrenching awa

y
from self in order to return to it. It is this turning back which effects the appearance of reflective nothingness. For the necessary structure of the for-itself requires that its being can be recovered only by a being which itself exists in the form of for-itself.9 Thus the being which effects the recovery must be constituted in the mode of the for-itself, and the being which is to be recovered must exist as for-itself. And these two beings must be the same being. But exactly in so far as this being recovers itself, it causes an absolute distance to exist between itself and itself-in the unity of being. This phenomenon of reflection is a permanent possibility of the for-itself because reflective scissiparity exists potentially in the for-itself which is reflected-on; it suffices in fact that the reflecting for-itself (reflCtant) posit itself for it as a witness of the reflection (reflet) and that the for-itself (the reflection) posit itself for it as a reflection of this reflecting. Thus reflection (reflexion) as the effort of a for-itself to recover a for-itself which it is in. the mode of non-being is a stage of nihilation intermediate between the pure and simple existence of the for-itself and existence for-otI1ers; it is an act on the part of a for-itself to recover a for-itself which it is not in the mode of non-being.lO

9 The French says "without the form of," which makes no sense and must s~rely be a misprint. Tr.

10 We find here again that "division of the equal to itself" which Hegel makes the peculiar trait of consciousness. But this division instead of leading to a higher integra. tion, as in the Phenomenology of Mind only makes deeper and more irremediable the nothingness which separates consciousness from itself. Consciousness is Hegelian, but it is Hegel's greatest illusion.

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Can reflection thus described be limited in its laws and its scope by the fact that the for-itself temporalizes itself? We think not.

We must distinguish two kinds of reflection if we wish to grasp there-flective phenomenon in its relations with temporality: reflection can be either pure or impure. Pure reflection, the simple presence of the re-flectiv~.for-itself to the for-itself reflected-on, is at once the original form of reflection and its ideal form; it is that on whose foundation impure reflection appears, it is that also which is never first given; and it is that which must be won by a sort of katharsis. Impure or accessory reflection, of which we will speak later, includes pure reflection but surpasses it and makes further claims.

What are the evident claims and rights of pure reflection? Evidently the reflective is the reflected-on. Outside of that we should have no means of legitimizing reflection. But the reflective is the reflected-on in complete immanence although in the form of "not-being-in-itself." It is this which well demonstrates the fact that the reflected-on is not wholly an object but a quasi-object for reflection. Actually the consciousness reflected-on is not 'presented yet as something outside reflection-that is, as a being on which one can "take a point of view," in relation to which one can realize a withdrawal, increase or diminish the distance which separates one from it. In order for the consciousness reflected-on to be "viewed from without" and in order for reflection to be able to orient itself in relation to it, i

t would be necessary that the reflective should not be the reflected-on in the mode of not being what it is not: this scissiparity will be realized only in existence for-others.

Reflection is a knowledge; of that there is no doubt. It is provided with a positional character; it affirms the consciousness reflected-on. But every affirmation, aS,we shall soon see, is conditioned by a negation: to affirm this object is simultaneously to deny that I am this object. To know is to make oneself other. Now the reflective can not make itself wholly other than the reflected-on since it is-in-order-to-be the reflected-on. Its affirmation is stopped halfway because its negation is not entirely realized. It does not then detach itself completely from the reflected-on, and it can not grasp the reflected-on "from a point of view." Its knowledge is a totality; it is a lightning intuition without relief, without point of departure, and without point of arrival. Everything is given at once in a s9rt of absolute proximity. What we ordinarily call knowing supposes leliefs, levels, an order, a hierarchy. Even mathematical essences are re~aled to us with an orientation in relation to other truths, to certain consequences; they are never disclosed with all their characteristics at once. But the reflection which delivers the reflected-on to us, not as a given but as the being which we have to be, in indistinction without a point of view, is a knowledge overflowing itself and without explanation. At the same time it is. never surprised by itself; it does not teach us anything but only posit!>.

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In the knowledge of a transcendent object indeed there is a revelation of the object, and the object revealed can deceive or surprise us. But in the reflective revelation there is a positing of a being whose being was already a revelation. Reflection is limited to making this revelation exist for itself; the revealed being is not revealed as a given but with the character of the "already revealed." Reflection is a recognition rather than knowledge. It implies as the original motivation of the recovery a pre-reflective comprehension of what it wishes to recover.

But if the reflective is the reflected-on, if this unity of being founds and limits the laws of reflection, it should be added that the reflected-on, itself, is its past and its future. There is then no doubt that although the totality of the reflected-on, which the reflective is in the mode of non-being, perpetually overflows the reflective, still the reflective extends its apodictic laws to that very totality which it is. Thus the reflective achievement of Descartes, the cogito, must not be limited to the infinitesimal instant. Moreover this conclusion could be drawn from the factthat thought is an act which engages the past and shapes its outline by the future. I doubt therefore that I am, said Descartes. But what would remain of methodical doubt if it could be limited to the instant? A suspension of judgment, perhaps. But a suspension of judgment is not a doubt; it is only a necessary structure of doubt. In order for doubt to exist, it is necessary that this suspension be motivated by an insufficiency of reasons for affirming or for denying-which refers to the past-and that it be maintained deliberately until the intervention of new elements-which is already a project of the future. Doubt appears on the foundat

ion of a pre-ontological compre-
hension of knowing and of requirements concerning truth. This com-
prehension and these requirements, which give all its meaning to doubt,
engage the totality of human reality and its being in the world; they sup-
pose the existence of an object of knowledge and of doubt-that is, of
a transcendent permanence in universal time. It is then a related conduct
which doubts the object, a conduct which represents one of the modes of
the being-in-the-world of human reality. To discover oneself doubting
is already to be ahead of oneself in the future, which conceals the end,
the cessation, and the meaning of this doubt, and to be behind oneself
in the past, which conceals the constituent motivations of the doubt and
its stages of development, and to be outside of oneself in the world as
presence to the object which one doubts.
These same observations would apply to any reflective statement: I
read, I dream, I perceive, I act. Either they should lead us to refuse to grant
apodictic evidence to reflection, and then the original knowledge which
I have of myself would melt into mere probability and my very existence
is only a probability (for my being-in-the-instant is not a being)-or else
we must extend the laws of reflection to human totality-i.e., to the past,
to the future, to presence, to the object. But if we have observed accu-
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rately, reflection is the for-itself which seeks to recover itself as a totality
in perpetual incompletion. It is the affirmation of the revelation of the
being which is to itself its own revelation. As the for-itself temporalizes
itself, there are these results: (1) Reflection, as the mode of being of
the for-itself, must be as temporalization, and it is itself its past and its
future- (2) By nature reflection extends its laws and its certitude to the
possibilities which I am and to the past which I was. The reflective is not
the apprehension of an instantaneous reflected-on, but neither is it itself
instantaneity. This does not mean that the reflective knows with its fu-
ture the future of. the reflected-on and with its past the past of the con·
sciousness to be known. On the contrary it is by means of the future and
the past that the reflective and the reflected-on are distinguished within
the unity of their being. The future of the reflective in f;lct, is the ensemble
of its own possibilities which the reflective has to be qua reflective. As
such it could not include a consciousness of the future reflected-on.
The same remarks would be valid for the reflective past although this is
founded ultimately in the past of the original for-itself. But if reflection
derives its meaning from its future and its past, it is already as a fleeing
presence to a flight,ekstatically the whole length of this flight. In other
words the for-itself, which makes itself exist in the mode of the reflective
dissociation, as for-itself derives its meaning from its possibilities and
from its future. In this sense reflection is a diasporatic phenomenon; but
as a presence to itself, the for-itself is a presence present to all its ekstatic
dimensions.
It remains to explain, someone may say, how this reflection, which you
are claiming to be apodictic, can make so many errors with respect to just
that past which you give it the capacity to know. I reply that it is free from
any error to ~he exact extent that it apprehends t

he pastas that which
haunts the present in non-theT:latic form. When I say, "I read,I doubt, I
I hope, etc." as we have shown, 1 reach beyond my present toward the past.
Now I cannot in any of these cases be mistaken. The apodictic nature of
reflection allows no doubt in so far as it apprehends the past exactly as
it is for the consciousness reflected-on which has to be it. On the other
hand, I can make many an error when recalling to myself in the reo
flective mode my past feelings or my past ideas; this is because I am on the
plane of memory. At that moment Ino longer am my past but I am
thematizing it. We are then no longer dealing with the reflective act.
Thus reflection is consciousness of tIle three ekstatic dimensions. It
is a. non-thetic consciousness (of) flow and a thetic consciousness of
duration. For reflection the past and the present of the reflected-on are
set in existence as quasi-outside in this sense: that they are not only held
in the unity of a-for-itself which exhausts their being in having to be it
but also for a for-itself which is scparated from them by a nothingness;
they are for a for-itself which, while existing with them in the unity of a

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being, does not have to be their being. Through reflection also the flow
reaches toward being as an "outside" outlined in immanence. But pure
reflectionstiIl discovers temporality only in its own original non-substan-
tiality, in ·its refusal to be in-itself. It discovers possibles qua possibles,
lightened by the freedom of the for-itself. It reveals the present as tran-
scendent; and if the past appears to it as in-itself, still the past is on the
foundation of presence. Finally reflection discovers the for-itself in its
detotalized totality as the incomparable individuality which reflection
itself is in the mode of having to be it. It discovers the for-itself as the
"reflected-on, par excellence," the being which is always only as itself and
which is always this "self" at a distance from itself, in the future, in the
past, in the world. Reflection therefore apprehends temporality and re-
veals it as the unique and incomparable mode of being of a selfness-that
is, as historicity.
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But the psychological duration which we know and which we daily
make use of as successions of organized temporal forms is the opposite
of historicity. It is in fact the concrete fabric of the psychicl1nities of. the
flow. This joy, for example, is an organized form which appears after a
sadness, and before that there was that humiliation which I experienced
yesterday. Relations of before and after are commonly established between
these unities of flow, qualities, states, acts; and these are the unities which
can be used for dating. Thus the reflective consciousness of man-in-the-
world in his daily existence is found in the face of psychic objects which
are what they are, which appear in the continuous woof of our temporality
like the designs and motifs on a tapestry, and which succeed each other
in the manner of things in the world in universal time; that is, by re-
placing each other without entering into any relation other than the purely
external relations of succession.
We speak of a joy which I have or which I had; we say that it is my
joy as if I were its support and as if it were detached from me as the finite \
modes of Spinoza are detached from the ground of the attribute. We even
say that

I experience this joy as if it came to imprint itself like a seal on the texture of my temporalization; or better yet, as if the presence in me of these feelings, of these ideas, of these states were a sort of visitation. We can not call it an illusion-this psychic duration constituted by the concrete flow of autonomous organizations; that is, in short, by the succession of psychic facts, of facts of consciousness. Indeed it is their reality which is the object of psychology. Practically it is on the level of psychic fact that concrete relations between men are established-claims, jealousies, grudges, suggestions, struggles, ruses, etc. Yet it is not conceivable that the unreflective for-itself, which historicizes itself11 in its upsurge, should be itself these qualities, these states, and these acts. Its

11 i.e., places itself in history or makes itself a history. Sartre uses s'historialise, which.bears the':samerelation to French that·"historicizes itself" bears to English. Tr.

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unity of being would dissolve into a multiplicity of existents external to one another, the ontological problem oftemporality would reappear, and this time we would have removed all methods of resolving it; for while it is possible for the for-itself to be its own past, it would be absurd to require of my joy that it be the sadness which preceded it, even in the mode of "non-being."

Psychologists give a degraded representation of this ekstatic existence when they affirm that psychic facts are relative to one another and that the thunder clap heard after a long silence is apprehended as "thunder-clap-after-a-Iong-silence." This observation is well made, but thcy have prevented themselves from explaining this relativity in succession since they have removed from it all ontological foundation. In fact if we apprehend the for-itself in its historicity, psychic duration vanishes and states, qualities, and acts disappear to give place to being-for-itself as such, which is only as the unique individuality from which the process of historization cannot be scparated..It is this which flows, which calls to itself from the ground of the future, and which is heavy with the past which it was; it is this which historicizes its selfness, and we know that it is-in the primary or unreflective mode-a consciousness of the world and not of self. Thus qualities and states could not be beings in its being (in the sense that the unity of the flow of joy would be "contained" or "made" by consciousness). There exist only the internal, non-positional colorations of it; these are nothing other than itself qua for-itself, and they can not be apprehended outside of it.

Here we are then in the presence of two temporalities: the original temporality of which we are the temporalization, and psychic temporality which simultaneously appears as incompatible with the mode of being of our being, and as an inter-subjective reality, the object of scicnce, the goal of human acts (in the sense, for example, that I do everything possible to "make Annie love me," to "endow her with love for me").

This psychic temporality, which is evidently derived, can not stem directly from original temporality; the latter constitutes nothing other than itself. As for psychic tcmporality, it is incapable of constituting itself, for it is only a successive order of facts. Morcover psychic temporality could not appe

ar to the unreflective for-itself, which is pure ekstatic presence
to the world. Psychic temporality revcnls itself to reflection, and reflection
must constitute it. But how can reflection constitute it if reflection is the
pure and simple discovery of the historicity which it is?
Here we must distinguish between pure reflection and impure or con-
stituent reflection, for it is impure reflection which constitutes the suc-
cession of psychic facts or psyche. \Vhat is given first in daily life is impure
or constituent reflection although this includes pure reflection as its origi-
nal structure. But pure reflection can be attained only as the result of a
modification which it effects on itself and which is in the form of a kathar-

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sis. This is not the place to describe the motivation and the structure
of this katharsis. What matters to us is the description of impure reflee-·
tion inasmuch as it constitutes and reveals psychic temporality.
Reflection, as we have seen, is a type of being in which the for-itself is
in order to be to itself what it is. Reflection is not then.a capricious upsurge
into the pure indifference of being, but it arises in the perspective of a for.
We have seen here that the for-itself is the being which in its being is the
foundation of a for. The meaning of reflection is then its being-for. Spe-
cifically the reflective is the reflected-on nihilating itself for12 recovering it-
self. In this sense the reflective in so far as it has to be the reflected-on,
escapes from the for-itself which it is as reflective in the form of "having
to be it." But if it were only in order to be the reflected-on which it has
to be, it would escape from the for-itself in order to rediscover it; every-
where and in whatever manner it affects itself, the for-itself is condemned
to be-for-itself. In fact, it is here that pure reflection is discovered.
But impure reflection, which is the first spontaneous (but not the
original) reflective movement, is-in-order-to-be the reflected-on as in-it-
self. Its motivation is within it in the twofold movement, which we have
already described, of interiorization and of objectivation: to apprehend
the reflected-on as in-itself in order to make itself be that in-itself which
is apprehended. Impure reflection then is the apprehension of the reflect-
ed-on as such only in a circuit of selfness in which reflection stands in
immediate relation with an in-itself which it has to be. But on the other
hand, this in-itself which reflection has to be is the reflected-on in so
far as the reflective tries to apprehend it as being in-itself. This means
that three forms exist in impure reflection: the reflective, the reflected-on,
and an in-itself which the reflective has to be in so far as this in-itself would
be the reflected-on, an in-itself which is nothing other than the For of the
reflective phenomenon. This in-itself is pre-outlined behind the for-itself
-reflected-on, by a reflection (reflexion) which traverses the reflected-on
in order to recover it and to found it; it is like the projection into the in-
itself on the part of the for-itself reflected-on-as a meaning: its being
is not to be but to be-made-to-be, like nothingness. It is the reflected-on as
a pure object for the reflective, as soon as reflection adopts a point of
view on the reflective, as soon as it gets out of that lightning intuition
without re

lief in which the reflected-on is given without a point of
view for the reflective, as soon as its posits itself as not being the reo
flected-on, and as soon as it determines what the-reflected-on is, then
reflection effects the appearance of an in-itself capable of being·'deter-
mined, qualified, behind the reflected-on. This transcendent in-itself or
shadow cast by the reflected-on onto being is what the reflective has to be
in so far as it is that which the reflected-on is.
12 Etre-pour. In French the pour can mean either for or in order to, both of which
are implied in ~tre-pour. Tr.

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Yet this in-itself should not be confused with the value of the reflected-
on, which is given to reflection in a total, undifferentiated intuition-nor
with the value which haunts the reflective as a non-thetic absence and as
the For of reflective consciousness in so far as it is a non-positional self-
consciousness. This in-itself is the necessary object of all reflection. In
order·that it may arise, it is enough that reflection confront the reflected-
on as object. It is the very decision by which reflection determines itself
to consider the reflected-on as object which causes the in-itself to appear
as the transcend~nt objectivation of the reflected-on. The act by which
reflection determines itself to take the reflected-on as object is itself (1)
a positing of the reflective as not being the reflt::cted-on, (2) the adoption
of a point of view in relation to the reflected-on. Moreover in reality these
two moments make or.ly one since the concrete negation which the re-
flective makes itsc-lf be in relation to the reflected-on manifests itself
precisely in and through the fact of taking a point of view. The objectivat-
ing act, as we see, lies in the strict extensions of the reflective dissociation
since this dissociation is made by the deepening of the nothingness which
separates the reflection (reflet) from the reflecting (refletant). The ob-
jectivation recovers the reflective movement as not being the reflected-
on in order that the reflected-on may appear as an object for the reflective.
However this reflection is in bad faith. To be sure, it appears to cut the
bond which unites the reflected-on to the reflective, and it seems to de-
clare that the reflective is not the reflected-on in the mode of not being
what one is not, at a time when in the original reflective upsurge, the
reflective is not the reflected-on in the mode of what one is. But this is
only in order to recover subsequently the affirmatiorl of identity and to
affirm concerning this in-itself that "I am it." In a word, reflection is in
bad faith in so b.r as it constitutes itself as the revelation of tIle object
which I rnake-to-be-rne. But in the second place this more radical nihila-
tion is not a real, metaphysical event. The real event, the third process
of nihilation is the for-others. Impure reflection is an abortive effort
on the part of the for-itself to be another while remaining itself. The
transcendent object which appeared behind the for-itself-reflected-on
is the only being of which the reflective can say-in this sense-that it is
not it. But it is a mere shadow of being. It is made-to-be and the reflective
has to be it in order not to be it. It is this shadow of being, the necessary
and constant correlate of impure reflection that the psychologist studies
under the name of psychic fact. A psyc

hic fact is then the 'shadow of the
reflected-on inasmuch as the reflective has to be it ekstatically in the mode of non-being. Thus reflection is impure when it gives itself as an "intuition of the for-itself in in-itself." What is revealed to it is not the temporal and non-substantial historicity of the reflected-on; beyond this reflected-on it is the very substantiality of the organized forms of the flow. The unity of these virtual beings is called the psychic life or psyche, a virtual

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and transcendent in-itself which underlies the temporalization of the for-itself. Pure reflection is never anything but a quasi-knowledge; but there can be a reflective knowledge of the Psyche alone. Naturally we will rediscover in each psychic object the characteristics of the real reflected-on but degraded in the In-itself. A brief a priori description of the Psyche will enable us to account for this In-itself.

(1) By Psyche we understand the Ego, its states, its qualities, and its acts. The Ego with the double grammatical form of "I" and "Me" represents our person as a transcendent psychic unity. We have described it elsewhere. It is as the Ego that we are subjects in fact and subjects in theory, act' 'e and passive, voluntary agents, possible objects of a judgment cor.c.:ning value of responsibility.

The qualities of the Ego represent the ensemble of virtues, latent traits, potentialities which constitute our character and our habits (in the sense of the Greek Uts). The Ego is a "quality" of being angry, industrious, jealous, ambitious, sensual, etc. But we must recognize also qualities of another sort which have their origin in our history and which we. call acquired traits: I can be "showing my age," tired, bitter, declining, progressing; I can appear as "having acquired assurance as the result of a success" or on the contrary as "having little by little contracted the tastes, the habits, the sexuality of an invalid" (following a long illness).

States-in contrast with qualities which exist "potentially"-give themselves as actually existing. Hate, .love, jealousy are states. An illness, in so far as it is apprehended by the patient as a psycho-physiological rcality, is a state. In the same way a number of characteristics which are externally attached to my person can, in so far as I live them, become states. Absence (in relation to a definite person), exile, dishonor, triumph are states. We can see what distinguishes the quality from the state: After my anger yesterday, my "irascibility" survives as a simple latent disposition to become angry. On the contrary, after Pierre's action and the resentment whiCh I felt because of it, my hate survives as an actual reality although my thought may be currently occupied with another object. A quality furthermore is an innate or acquired disposition which contributes to qualify my personality. The state, on the contraly, is much more accidental and'contingent; it is something which happens to me. There exist however intermediates between states and qualities: for example, the hatred of Pozzo di Borgo for Napoleon although existing in fact and representing an affective, contingent relation between Pozzo and Napoleon the First, was constitutive of the person Pozzo.

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By acts we must understand the whole synthetic activity of the person; that is, every disposition of means as related t

presence exists, it is enough to call to mind cases in our own personal experience when we have tried to recall a dead love or a certain intellectual atmosphere which we had lived at an earlier date. On such occasions we had plainly a consciousness of aiming in emptiness at these various objects. We could form particular concepts of them, attempt a literary description of them, but we knew that they were not there. Similarly there are intermittent periods for a living love during which we know that we love but we do not feel it. These "intermittences in the heart" have been very well described by Proust. In contrast, it is possible to grasp a love in fullness, to contemplate it. But for that is necessary a particular mode of being on the part of the For-itself reflected-on. I. can apprehend my friendship for Pierre, but it is througll my sympathy, which at the moment has become the object reflected-on by a reflective consciousness. In short, the only way to make-present these qualities, these states, or these acts is to apprehend them across a consciousness reflected-on of which they are the objectivation, the shadow cast onto the in-itself.

But this possibility of making-present a love proves better than any ~ argument the transcendence of the psychic. When I abruptly discover, \ when I see my love, I apprehend at the same stroke that· it stands before my consciousness. I can take points of view regarding it, can judge , it; I am not engaged in it as the reflective is in the reflected-on. Due to this very fact I apprehend it as not being of the nature of the For-itself. It is infinitely heavier, more opaque, more solid than that absolute transparency. That is why the evidence with which the psychic gives itself to the intuition of impure reflection is not apodictic. There is a cleavage between the future of the For-itself reflected-on, which is constantly eaten away and lightened by my freedom, and the dense and menacing future of my love, a cleavage which gives to it precisely its meaning as love. If I did not apprehend in the psychic object a love with its future arrested, would it still be love? Would it not rather fall under the heading of caprice? And does not even the caprice engage the future to the extent that it is given as going to remain caprice and never to be changed into love? Thus the always nihilated future of the For-itself prevents all determination in-itself within the For-itself as the For-itself which loves or which hates; and the shadow projected by the For-itself reflected-on possesses naturally a degraded future in in-itself, one which forms an integral part of it in determining its meaning. But in correlation with the continual nihilation of Futures reflected-on, the organized psychic ensemble with its future remains only probable. And we need not understand by that an external quality which would come from a relation with my knowledge and which could be transformed if need be into certainty, but rather an ontological characteristic.

(4) The psychic object, being the shadow cast by the For-itself reflected-on, possesses in degraded form the characteristics of consciousness. In \

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particular it appears as an unachieved and probable totality there where the For-itself makes itself exist in the diasporatic unity of adetotalized totality. This means tliat the Psychic. apprehended across the threeek-static dimen

sions of temporality, appears as constituted by the synthesis of a Past, a Present, and a Future. A love, an enterprise is the organized unityrof these three dimensions. In fact. it is not enough to say that a love "has" a future as if the future were external to the object which it characterizes; the future makes a part of the organized form of the flow of "love," ,for love is given its meaning as love by its being in the future. But due to the fact that the psychic object is in-itself, its present can not be flight, nor can its future be pure possibility. In these forms of flow there is an' essential priority of the Past, which is what the For-itself was and which already presupposes the transformation of the For-itself into In-itself. The reflective projects a psychic object provided with the three temporal dimensions, but it constitutes these three dimensions solely out of what the reflected-on was. The Future is already; otherwise how could my love be love? Only it is not get given; it is a "now" which is not yet revealed. It loses then its character as a possibility which-I-have-to-be; my love, my joy do not have to be their future, for they are it in the tranquil indifference of juxtaposition, just as this fountain pen is at once a pen and-below-a cap. The Present similarly is apprehended in its real quality of being-there. Only this being-there is constituted in having been-there. The Present is already wholly constituted and armed from head to foot; it is a "now" which the instant brings and carries away like a costume ready made; it is a card which comes out of the game and returns to it. The passage of a "now" from the future to the present and from the present to the past does not cause it to undergo any modification since in any case, future or not, it is already past. This fact is well illustrated.by the naive way in which psychologists take recourse in the unconscious in order to distinguish the three "nows" of the psychic: they call present the "now" which is present to the consciousness. Those which have passed into the. future have exactly the same characteristics, but they wait in the limbo of the unconscious; and if we take them in that undifferentiated environment, it is impossible to distinguish past from future among them. A memory which survives in the unconscious is a past "now" and at the same time, inasmuch as it awaits being evoked, it is a future "now." Thus the psychic form is not to-be; it is already made; it is already complete, past, present, future, in the mode has been. The "nows" which compose it have only to undergo one by one-before returning into the past-the baptism of consciousness.

The resultis that the psychic form contains two co-existing contradictory modalities of being since it is already made and appears in the co· hesive unity of an organism and siJree at the same time it can exist only through a succession of "nows," each one of which tends to be isolated

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in an in-itself. This joy, for example, passes from one instant to another because its future exists already as a terminal result and the given meaning of its development,'not as that which it has to be, but as that which it "has been" already in the future.·

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Actually this inner cohesion of the psyche is nothing other than the unity of being of the For-itself hypostasized in the in-itself. A hate has no parts; it is not a sum of

attitudes and of states of consciousness,
but it gives itself through the attitudes and states of consciousness as the temporal unity-without parts-of their appearances. But the unity of being in the For-itself is explained by the ekstatic character of its being; it has to be in full spontaneity what it will be. The psychic, on the contrary, "ismade-to-be." This means that it is by itself incapable of determining itself in existence. It is sustained in the face of the reflective by a sortof inertia; and psychologists have often insisted on its "pathological" character. It is in this sense that Descartes can speak of the "passions of the souL" Although the psychic is not on the same plane of being as the existents of the world, this inertia enables the psychic to be apprehended as related to these existents. A love is given as "aroused" by the loved object. Consequently the total cohesion of the psychic form becomes unintelligible since it does not have to be this cohesion, since it is not its own synthesis, since its unity has the character of a given. To the extent that a hatred is a given succession of "nows," all completely formed and inert, we find in it the germ of an infinite divisibility. And yet this divisibility is disguised, denied in so far as the psychic is the objectivation of the ontological unity of the For-itself. Hence there is a sort of magic cohesion between the successive "nows" of the hatred, which give themselves as parts only in order later to deny their exteriority.
The ambiguity is brought to light in Bergson's theory of the consciousness which endures and which is a "multiplicity of interpenetration." What Bergson is touching on here is the psychic state, not consciousness conceived as For-itself. Actually what is the meaning of "interpenetration?" On the theory of divisibility, it cannot be absence. If there is to be interpenetration, it is necessary that there be parts which interpenetrate each other. But these parts, which theoretically ought to fall back into their isolation, flow one into the other by a magic and totally unexplained cohesion; and this total fusion at present defies analysis. Bergson does not dream of establishing this property of the psychic On an absolute structure of the For-itself. He establishes it as a given, a simple "intuition" which reveals to him that the psychic is an interiorized multiplicity.
Its character as something inert, as a passive datum is accentuated by the fact that it exists without being for a consciousness, either thetic or non·thetic. It is without consciousness (of) being since a natural attitude man completely fails to recognize it and has to have recourse to intuition in order to apprehend it. Thus an object in the world is able to exist without

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being seen and to reveal itself after the event when we have forged the necessary instruments to disclose it. The characteristics of psychic duration for Bergson are a pure contingent fact of experience; they are so be. cause we find them so-that is all. Thus psychic temporality is an inert datum, closely akin to Bergson's duration, which undergoes its intimate cohesion without effecting it, which is perpetually temporalized without temporalizing itself, in which the irrational and magic interpenetration of elements that are not united by an ekstatic relation of being can be compared only to sympathetic magic acting from a

distance-an inter-
penetration which hides a multiplicity o~ already forrried "nows." These chlracteristics do not result from any erro~ on the part of psychologists or from a lack of knowledge; they are constitutive of psychic temporality, which is the hypostasis of original temporality. The absolute unity of the psychic is indeed the projection of the ontological, ekstatic unity of the, for-itself. But since this projection is made in the in-itself which is what it is in the distanceless proximity of self-identity, the ekstatic unity parcels itself out in an infinity of "nows" which are what they are and which, precisely for this reason, tend to isolate themselves in their self-identity. Thus participating simultaneously in the in-itself and in the for-itself, psychic temporality conceals a contradiction which is never overcome. This should not surprise us. Since psychic temporality is the product of impure reflection, it is natural that it is made-to-be what it is not and that it is not what it is made-to-be.

Following this analysis we may now find more meaningful an examination of the inter-relations of psychic forms at the heart of psychic time. Let us note first of all that it is interpenetration which governs the connection between feelings, for example, at the heart of a complex psychic fonn. Everybody knows those feelings of affection "tinted" with envy, those hates "penetrated" despite all by admiration, those romantic friendships which novelists have often described. There is certainly interpenetration as SOon as we apprehend a friendship tinted with envy like a cup of coffee clouded with cream. Admittedly this comparison is gross. Nevertheless it is certain that the amorous friendship is not given as a simple specification of the genus friendship, as the isosceles triangle is a specification of the genus triangle. The friendship is given as wholly penetrated by total love, and yet it is not love; it "does not make itself" love, for then it would lose its autonomy as friendship. But it constitutes itself as an inert object in-itself which language can scarcely name, where love, autonomous and in-itself, is magically extended through all the friendship just as the foot is extended through all the sea in the Stoic lTu'YXVlT,~.H

But psychic processes imply also the action from a distance of prior forms on posterior forms. We cannot conceive of this action at a distance in the mode of simple causality found, for example, in classical mechan-

14 Correction for Sartre's UPYXUUlS Tr.

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ics, which supposes the totally inert existence of a moving body enclosed in the instant. Neither can we allow the mode of physical causality conceived in the manner of John Stuart Mill, which is defined by the constant and unconditioned succession of two states where the being of each one is exclusive of the other. Inasmuch as the psychic is the objectivation of the for-itself, it possesses ~ degraded spontaneity which is grasped as the internal, given quality of\the form of the psychic and which is inseparable from its cohesive force.. This spontaneity can not therefore be given strictly as produced by the prior form. But on the other hand, neither can the spontaneity determine itself in existence since it is apprehended only as one determination among others of a given existent. It follows that the prior form has to effect from a distance the

birth of a form of the same
'> nature which is organized spontaneously as a form of flow. We are not
,dealing here with being which has to be its future and its past, but only
with successions of past, present, and future forms which all exist in the
mode of "having-been," and which at a distance influence one another.
This influence will be manifested either by penetration or by motivation.
If it is by penetration, the reflective apprehends as a single object two
psychic objects which had at first been given separately. The result is a
new psychic object, each characteristic of which will be the synthesis of
the prior two, though this object is unintelligible in itself and gives itself
simultaneously as all one and all the other without there being any altera-
tion in either. In motivation, on the contrary, the two objects remain each
at its own place. But since a psychic object is an organized form and a mul-
tiplicity of interpenetration, it can act only simultaneously as one whole
on another whole object. The result is a total action at a distance by
means of a magic influence of one on the other. For example, my humili-
ation of yesterday is the total motive for my mood this morning, etc.
The fact that this action at a distance is totally magic and irrational
proves better than any analysis the futility of attempts on the part of
intellectualistic psychologists to remain on the level of the psychic and
yet deduce this action to an inteUigible causality by means of an intellec-
tual analysis. It is thus that Proust by means of intellectualistic distinctions
is perpetually trying to find bonds of rational causality between psychic
states in the temporal succession of these states. But at the end of the
analysis he can offer us only results such as the following:
As soon as Swann could picture (Odette) to himself without revul-
sion, as soon as he thought again of the kindness in her smile, and as
as soon as the desire to take her away from everyone else was no longer
added to his love by jealousy, that love became again a taste for the
sensations which Odette's person gave him, for the pleasure which he
felt in admiring as a spectacle or in questioning as a phenomenon the
lifting up of one of her glances, the formation of one of her smiles,

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the utterance of an intonation of her voice. And this pleasure dif-
ferent from all others had ended by creating in him a need ot her,
which she alone could assuage by her presence or her letters..?. Thus
by the very chemistry ot his affiiction, after having created jealousy
out ot his love, he began to manufacture tenderness, pity for Odette.15
This passage is obviously concerned with the psychic. We see feelings
which, individualized and separated by nature, are here acting one on the
other. But Proust is trying to clarify their actions and to classify them
in the hope that he may thereby make understandable the fluctuations
which Swann experiences. Proust does not limit himself to describing the
conclusions which he himself has been able to make (e.g., the transition
through "oscillation" from hate-filled jealousy to tender love); he wants
to explain these findings.
What are the results of this analysis? Is the unintelligibility of the psy-
chic removed? It is easy to see thJt on the contrary tllis somewhat arbi-
trary reduction of the great psychic forms to more simple elements ac-
centuates the magic irrationali

ty of the inter-relations which psychic ob-
jects support. How does jealousy "add" to love the "desire to take her
away from everyone else?" And how does this desire once added to love
(always the image of the cloud of cream "added" to the coffee) prevent
it from becoming again "a taste for the sensations which Odette's
person gave him?" And how can the pleasure create a need? And how does
love manufacture that jealousy which in return will add to love the
desire to take Odette away from everyone else? And how when freed
from this desire, is it going to manufacture tenderness anew? Proust here
attempts to constitute a symbolic cllemistry, but the chemical images
which he uses are capable only of disguising the motivations and irrational
acts. It is an attempt to draw us toward a mechanistic interpretation of
the psychic which,. without being any more intelligible, would com-
pletely distort its nature. And yet Proust cannot keep from showing us
between the estranged states almost interhuman relations (to create, to
manufacture, to add), which would almost allow us to suppose that these
psychic objects are animated agents. In his descriptions the intellectualis-
tic analysis shows its limitations at every instant; it can effect its dis-
tinctions and its classifications only superficially and on the basis of total
irrationality. It is necessary to give up trying to reduce the irrational ele-
ment in psychic causality. This causality is a degradation of the ekstatic
for-itself, which is its own being at a distance from itself, its degradation
into magic, into an in-itself which is what it is at its own place. Magic
action through influence at a distance is the necessary result of this re-
laxation of the bonds of being. The psychologist must describe these ir-
rational bonds and take them as an original given of the psychic world.
15 Du cdte de chez Swann, 378 edition, II, p. 82.. My italics.
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Thus the reflective consciousness is constituted. as consciousness of
duration, and hence psychic duration appears to consciousness. This
psychic temporality as a projection into the in-itself of original temporality
is a virtual being whose phantom flow does not cease to accompany the
ekstatic temporalization of the for-itself in so far as this is apprehended by
reflection. But psychic temporality disappears completely if the for-itself
remains on the un-reflective level or if impure reflection purifies itself.
Psychic temporality is similar in this respect to original temporality-in
that itappears as a mode of being of concrete objects and not as a limit
or a pre-established rule. Psychic time is only the connected bringing to-
gether of temporal objects. But its essential difference from original tem-
porality is that it is while original temporality temporalizes itself. As such
psychic time can be constituted only with the past, and the future can
be only as a past which will come after the present past; that is, the empty
form before-after is hypostasized, and it orders the relations betwc~n ob-
jects equally past.
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At the same time this psychic duration which can not· be by itself
must perpetually be made-to-be. Perpetually oscillating between the mul-
tiplicity of juxtaposition and the absolute cohesion of the ekstatic for-
itself, this temporality is composed of "nows" which have been, which
remain at the place which has been assigned to them, but

which influence
each other at a distance in their totality; it is this which renders it comparable to the magic duration of Bergson's philosophy. As soon as we enter on the plane of impure reflection-that is, of the reflection which seeks to determine the being which I am-an entire world appears which peoples this temporality. This world, a virtual presence, the probable object of my reflective intention, is the psychic world or the psyche. In one sense, its existence is purely ideal; in another it is, since it is-made-to-be, since it is revealed to consciousness. It is "my shadow;" it is what is revealed to me when I wish to see myself. In addition this phantom world exists as a real situation of the for-itself, for it can be that in terms of which the for-itself determines itself to be what it has to be. For example, I shall not go to this or that person's house "because of" the antipathy which I feel toward him. Or I decide on this or that action by taking into consideration my hate or my love. Or I refuse to discuss politics because I know my quick temper and I can not risk becoming irritated. Along with that transcendent world which is lodged in the infinite becoming of pre-historic indifference there is constituted precisely as a virtual unity of being that temporality which is called "inner" or "qualitative," which is the objectivation in in-itself of original temporality. In this inner temporality we find the first outline of an "outside;" the for-itself sees itself almost as bestowing an outside on its own eyes, but this outside is purely virtual. We shall see later how being-for-others realizes the suggestion of this "outside."

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CHAPTER THREE

Transcendence

IN order to arrive at as complete a description as possible of the for-itself we chose as a guiding thread the examination of negative attitudes. As we have seen, all questions which we can pose and the replies which can be made to them are conditioned by the permanent possibility of non-being, outside us and within. Our original goal, however, was not only to discover the negative structures of the for-itself. In the Introduction we encountered a problem, and it is this problem which we have wished to resolve: what is the original relation of human reality to the being of phenomena or being-in-itself? In the Introduction indeed we were obliged to reject both the realist solution and the idealist solution. It appeared to us both that transcendent being could not act on consciousness and that consciousness could not "construct" the transcendent by objectivizing elements borrowed from its subjectivity. Consequently we concluded that the original relation to being could not be an extcrnal relation which would unite two substances originally isolated. "The relation of the regions of being is a primitive upsurge," we said, "and it forms a part of the very structure of these beings." The concrete is revealed to us as the synthetic totality of which consciousness, like the phenomenon, constitutes only the articulations.

But although in one sense consciousness considered in isolation is an abstraction, and although phenomena-even the phenomenon of being -are similarly abstract in so far as they cannot exist as phenomena without appearing to a consciousness, nevertheless the being of phenomena as in an in-itself which is what it is can not be considered as an abstraction. In order to be, it need

s only itself; it refers only to itself. On the other
hand, our description of the for-itself has shown us how this on the contrary, is removed as far as possible from a substance and from the in-itself; we have seen that it is its own nothingness and that it can exist only in the ontological unity of its ekstases. Therefore while the relation of the for-itself to the in-itself is originally constitutive of the very being which is put into the relation, we should not understand that this relation

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is constitutive of the in-itself but rather of the for-itself. It is in the for-itself alone that we must look for the key to that relation to being which we call, for example, knowing. The for-itself is responsible in its being for its relation with the in-itself, or if you prefer, it produces itself originally on the foundation of a relation to the in-itself. This is what we already anticipated when we defined consciousness as "a being such that in its being, its being is in question in so far as this being implies a being other than itself." But since formulating this definition we have acquired new knowledge. In particular we have grasped the profound meaning of the for-itself as the foundation of its own nothingness. Is it not time now to utilize this knowledge to determine at:Id explain that ekstatic relation of the for-itself to the in-itself on the foundation of which knowing and acting in general can appear? Are we not in a position now to reply to our original question? In order to be non-thetic self-consciousness, consciousness must be a thetic consciousness of something, as we have noted. But what we have studied hitherto is the for-itself as the original mode of being of non-thetic self-consciousness. Are we not therefore bound to describe the relations of the for-itself with the in-itself inasmuch as these are constitutive of the very being of the for-itself? Are we not able at present to find the answer to questions of the followinb type: Since the in-itself is what it is, how and why does the being of the for-itself have to be a knowledge of the in-itself? And what in general is knowledge?

I. KNOWLEDGE AS A TYPE OF RELATION BETWEEN THE FOR-ITSELF AND THE IN-ITSELF

THERE is only intuitive knowledge. Deduction and discursive argument, incorrectly called examples of knowing, are only instruments which lead to intuition. When intuition is reached, methods utilized to attain it are effaced before it; in cases where it is not attained, reason and argument remain as indicating signs which point toward an intuition beyond reach; finally if it has been attained but is not a present mode of my consciousness, the precepts which I use remain as the resul.ts of operations formerly effected, like what Descartes called the "memories of ideas." If someone asks for a definition of intuition, Husserl will reply, in agreement with the majority of philosophers, that it is the presence of the thing (Sache) "in person" to consciousness. Knowledge therefore is of the type of being which we described in the preceding chapter under the title of "presence to --." But we have established that the in-itself can never by itself be presence. Being-present, in fact, is an ekstatic mode of being of the for-itself. We are then compelled to reverse the terms of our definition: intuition is the presence of consciousness to the thing. Therefore we mu

n to found this "not" which origi-
nally qualified the external world. Actually neither the connection of representation, nor the necessity of certain subjective ensembles, nor temporal irreversibility, nor an appeal to infinity could serve to constitute the object as such (that is, to serve as·foundation for a further negation which would separate out the non-ego and oppose it to me as such) if this negation were not given first and if it were not the a priori foundation of all experience.

The thing, before all comparison, before all construction, is that which is present to consciousness as not being consciousness. The original relation of presence as the foundation of knowledge is negative. But as negation comes to the world by means of the for-itself, and as the thing is what it is in the absolute indifference of identity, it can not be the thing which is posited as not being the for-itself. Negation comes from the for-itself. We should not conceive this negation as a type of judgment which would bear.on the thing itself and drny concerning it that it is the. for-itself; this type of negation could be conceived only if the for-itself were a substance already fully formed, and even in that case it could emanate only as a third being establishing from outside a negative relation between two beings. But by the original negation the for-itself constitutes itself as not being the thing. Consequently the definition of consciousness which we gave earlier can be formulated in the perspective of the for-itself as follows: "The for-itself is a being such that in its being, its being is in question in so far as this being is essentially a certain way of not being a being which it posits simultaneously as other than itself."

Knowledge appears then as a mode of being. Knowing is neither a relation established after the event between two beings, nor is it an activity of one of these two beings, nor is it a quality of a property or a virtue. It is the very being of the for-itself in so far as this is presence to-; that is, in so far as the for-itself has to be its being by making itself not to be a certain being to which it is present. This means that the for-itself can be only in the mode of a reflection (reflet) causing itself to be reflected as not being a certain being. The "something" which must qualify the reflected in order that the dyad "the-reflection-reflecting" may not dissolve in nothingness is pure negation. The reflected causes itself to be qualified outside next to a certain being as not being that being. This is precisely what we mean by "to be consciousness of something."

But we must define more precisely what we understand by this original negation. Actually·we should distinguish two types of negation: external negation and internal negation. The first appears as a purely external bond established between· two beings by a witness. When I say, for example, "A cup is not an inkwell," it is very evident that the foundation

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of this negation is neither in the cup nor in the inkwelJ.1 Both of these objects am what they are, and that is all. The negation stands as a categorical and ideal connection which I establish between them without modifying them in any way whatsoever, without enriching them or impoverishing them with the slightest quality; they are not even ever so slightly grazed by this negative synthesis. As it serves neither to

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them nor to constitute them, it remains strictly external. But we can already guess the meaning of the other type of negation if we consider such expressions as "I am not rich" or "I am not handsome." Pronounced with a certain melancholy, they do not mean only that the speaker is denied a certain quality but that the denial itself comes to influence the· inner structure of the positive being who has been denied the quality. When I say, "I am not handsome," I do not limit myself to denying with respect to myself taken as wholly concrete, a certain virtue which due to this fact passes into nothingness while I keep intact the positive totality of my being (as when I say, "The vase is not white, it is gray"- "The inkwell is not on the table, it is on the mantelpiece"). I intend to indicate that "not being handsome" is a certain negative virtue of my being. It characterizes me within; as negative it is a real quality of myself- that of not being handsome-and this negative quality will explain my melancholy as well as, for example, my failures in the world.

By an internal negation we understand such a relation between two beings that the one which is denied to the other qualifies the other at the heart of its essence-by absence. The negation becomes then a bond of essential being since at least one of the beings on which it depends is such that it points toward the other, that it carries the other in its heart as an absence. Nevertheless it is clear that this type of negation can not be applied to being-in-itself. By nature it belongs to the for-itself. Only the for-itself can be determined in its being by a being which it is not. And if the internal negation can appear in the world-as when we say of a pearl that it is false, of a fruit that it is not ripe, of an egg that it is not fresh, etc.-it is by the for-itself that it comes into the world-like negation in general. Knowing belongs to the for-itself alone, for the reason that only the for-itself can appear to itself as not being what it knows. And as here appearance and being are one-since the for-itself has to be its appearance -we must conclude that the for-itself includes within its being the being of the object which it is not inasmuch as the for-itself puts its own being into question as not being the being of the object:

Here we must rid ourselves of an illusion which maybe fonnulated as follows: in order to constitute myself as not being a particular being, I must have ahead of time in some manner or other a knowledge of this being; for I can not judge the differences between myself and a being

1 Sartre's text reads "the foundation of this negation is neither in the table norin the inkwell," The "table" is surely an error. Tr,

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of which I know nothing. It is true, of course, that in our empirical exist: ence we can not know how we differ from a Japanese or an Englishman, from a worker or an employer until we have some notion of these different beings. But these empirical distinctions can not serve as a basis for us here, for we are undertaking the study of an ontological relation which must render all experience possible and which aims at establishing how in general an object can exist for consciousness. It is not possible then for m~ to have any experience of an object as an object which is not me until I constitute it as an object. On the contrary, what makes all experi

ence possible is an a priori upsurge of the object for the subject-
or since the upsurge is the -original fact of the for-itself, an original upsurge
of the for-itself as presence to the object which it is not. What we should
do then is to invert the terms of the preceding formula and formulate it
thus: the fundamental relation by which the for-itself has to be as not be-
ing this particular object to which it is present is the foundation of all
knowledge of this being. But we must describe this primary relation more
exactly if we want to make it understandable.
The germ of truth remaining in the statement of the intellectualist
illusion denounced in the preceding paragraph is the observation that I
can not determine myself not to be an object which is originally severed
from all connection with me. I can not deny that I am a particular being
if I am at a distance from that being. If I conceive of a being entirely
closed in on itself, this being in itself will be solely that which it is, and
due to this fact there will be no room in it for either negation or knowledge.
It is in fact in terms of the being which it is not that a being can make
known to itself what it is not. This means in the case of an internal nega-
tion that it is within and upon the being which it is not that the for-
itself appears as not being what it is not. In this 'sense the internal nega-
tion is a concrete ontological bond. We are not dealing here with one of
those empirical negations in which the qualities denied are distinguished
first by their absence or even by their non-being. In the internal negation
the for-itself collapscs on what it denies. The qualities denied are pre-
cisely those. to which the for-itself is most present; it is from them that
it derives its negative force and perpetually renews it. In this sense it is
necessary to see the denied qualities as a constitutive factor of the being
of the for.itself, for the for-itself must be there outside itself upon them;
it must be they in order to deny that it is they. In short the term-of-origin
of the internal negation is the in-itself, the thing which is there, and out-
side of it there is nothing except an emptiness, a nothingness which is
distinguished from the thing only by a pure negation for which this thing
furnishes the very content. The difficulty encountered by materialism in
deriving knowledge from the object stems from the fact that materialism
wants to produce a substance in terms of another substance. But this
difficulty can not hinder us, for we affirm that there is nothing outside
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the in-itself except a reflection (reflet) of that nothing which is itself
polarized and defined by the in-itself inasmuch as it is precisely the noth-
ingness of this in-itself, the individualized nothing which is nothing only
because it is not the in-itself. Thus in this ekstatic relation which is con-
stitutive of the internal negation and of knowledge, it is the in-itself "in
person" which is the concrete pole in its plenitude, and the for-itself
is nothing other than the emptiness in which the in-itself is detached.
The for-itself is outside itself in the in-itself since it causes itself to be
defined by what it is not; the first bond between the in-itself and the
for-itself is therefore a bond of being. But this bond is neither a lack nor
an absence. In the case of absence indeed I make myself determined by a
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eing which I am not and which does not exist or which is not there; that is, what determines me is like a hollow in the middle of what I shall call my empirical plenitude. On the other hand, in knowledge, taken as a bond of ontological being, the being which I am not represents the absolute plenitude of the in-itself. And I, on the contrary, am the nothingness, the absence which determines itself in existence from the standpoint of this fullness. This means that in that type of being which we call knowing, the only being which can be encountered and which is perpetually there is the known. The knower is pot; he is not apprehensible. He is nothing other than that which brings it about that there is a being-there on the part of the known, a presence-for by itself the known is neither present nor absent, it simply is. But this presence of the known is presence to nothing, since the knower is the pure reflection of a non-being; the presence appears then across the total translucency of the knower known, an absolute presence..

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A psychological and empirical exemplification of this original relation is furnished us in the case of fascination. In fascination, which represents the immediate fact of knowing, the knower is absolutely nothing but a pure negation; he does not find or recover himself anywhcrc-he is not. The only qualification which he can support is that he is not precisely this particular fascinating object. In fascination there is nothing more than a gigantic object in a desert world. Yet the fascinated intuition is in no way a fusion with the object. In fact the condition necessary for the existence of fascination is that the object be raised in absolute relief on a background of emptiness; that is, I am precisely the immediate negation of the object and nothing but that.

We find this same pure negation at the basis of those pantheistic intuitions which Rousseau has several times describ?'d as concrete psychic events in his history. He claims that on those occasions he melted into the universe, that the world alone was suddenly found present as an absolute presence and unconditioned totality. And certainly we can understand this total, isolated presence of the world, its pure "being-there;" certainly we admit freely that at this privileged moment thcre was nothing

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else but the world. But this does not mean, as Rousseau claims, that there was a fusion of conscio,usness with the world. Such a fusion would signify the solidification of the for-itself in in-itself, and at the same stroke, the disappearance of the world and of the in-itself as presence. It is true that in the pantheistic intention there is no longer anything but the world-save for that which causes the in-itself to be present as the world; that is, a pure negation which is a non-thetic self-consciousness as negation. Precisely because knowledge is not absence but presence, there is nothing which separates the knower from the known.

Intuition has often been defined as the immediate presence of the known to the knower, but it is seldom that anyone has reflected on the requirements of the notion of the immediate. Immediacy is the absence of any mediator; that is obvious, for otherwise the mediator alone would be known and not what is mediated. But if we can not posit any intermediary, we must at the same time reject both continuity and disco

n-
tinuity as a type of presence of the knower to the known. In fact we shall not admit that there is any continuity of the knower with the known, for it supposes an intermediary term which would be at once knower and known, which suppresses the autonomy of the knower in the face of the known while engaging the being of the knower in the being of the known. Then the structure of the object disappears since the object must be absolutely denied by the for-itself as the being of the for-itself. But neither can we consider the original relation of the for-itself to the in-itself as a relation of discontinuity. To be sure, the separation between two discontinuous elements is an emptiness-i.e., a nothing-but it is a realizt:d nothing,-i.e., in-itself. This substantialized nothing is as such a non-conductive density; it destroys the immediacy of presence, for it has qua nothing become something. The presence of the for-itself to the in-itself can be expressed neither in terms of continuity nor in terms of discontinuity, for it is pure denied identity.

To make this clearer, let us employ a comparison. When two curves are tangential to one another, they offer a type of presence without intermediaries. Nevertheless the eye grasps only a single line for the length of their tangency. Moreover if the two curves were hidden so that one could see only the length A B where they are tangential to each other, it would be impossible to distinguish them. Actually what separates them is nothing; there is neither continuity nor discontinuity but pure identity. Now suddenly uncover the two figures and we apprehend them once again as being two throughout all their length. This situation derives not from an abrupt factual separation which would suddenly be realized between them but from the fact that the two movements by which we draw the two curves so as to perceive them include each one a negation as a constituting act. Thus what separates the two curves at the very spot of their tangency is notlling, not even a distance; it is a pure negativity .....

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as the counterpart of a constituting synthesis. Such an image will enable us to understand better the relation of immediacy which originally unites the knower to the known.

Ordinarily indeed it happens that a negation depends on a "something" which exists before the negation and constitutes its matter. For example, if I say that the inkwell is not the table, then table and inkwell are objects already constituted whose being in-itself wiII be the support of the negative judgment. But in the case of the relation "knower-known," there is nothing on the side of the knower which can provide a support for the negation; no difference, no principle of distinction "is there" to separate in.itself the knower from the known. But in the total indistinction of being, there is nothing but a negation which does not even exist but which has to be, which does not even posit itself as a negation. Consequently knowledge and finally the knower himself are nothing except the fact "that there is" being, that being in-itself gives itself and raises itself in relief on the ground of this nothing. In this sense we can call knowledge the pure solitude of the known. It is enough to say that the original phenomenon of knowledge adds nothing to being and creates nothing. It does not enrich being, for knowledge is pure negativity. It

only brings
it about that there is being. But this fact "that there is" being is not an inner determination of being-which is what it is-but of negativity. In this sense every revelation of a positive characteristic of being is the counterpart of an ontological determination as pure negativity in the being of the for-itself.

For example, as we shall see later, the revelation of the spatiality of being is One with the non-positional apprehension by the for-itself of itself as, unextended. And the unextended character of the for-itself is not a positive, mysterious virtue of spirituality which is hiding under a negative denomination; it is a natural ekstatic relation, for it is by and in the extension of the transcendent in-itself that the for-itself makes itself known to itself and realizes its own non-extension. The for-itself can not be first unextended in order later to enter into relation with an extended being, for no matter how we consider it, the concept of the unextended makes no sense by itself; it is nothing but the negation of the extended. If we could suppress-to imagine an impossibility-the extension of the revealed determinations of the in-itself, then the for-itself would remain aspatial; it would be neither extended nor unextended, and it could not possibly be characterized in any way whatsoever so far as extension is concerned. In this sense extension is a transcendent determination which the for-itself has to apprehend to the exact degree that it denies itself as .extended. That is why the term which seems best. to indicate this inner relation between knowing and being is the word realize, which we used earlier in its double ontological and gnostic meaning. I realize a project in so far as I give it being, but lalso realize my situation in so far as

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I live it and make it be with my being. I "realize" the scope of a catastrophe, the difficulty of an undertaking. To know is to realize in both senses of the term. It is to cause being "to be there" while having to be the reflected negation of this being. The real is realization. We shall define tranS'cendence as that inner and realizing negation which reveals the in-itself while determining the being of the for-itself.

II. DETERMINATION AS NEGATION

To what being is the for-itself presence? Let us note immediately that the question is badly phrased. Being is what it is; it can not possess in itself the determination "this one" to answer the question "which?" In short the question has meaning only if it is posited in a world. Consequently the for-itself can not be present to this being rather than to that since it is the presence of the for-itself which causes the existence of a "this" rather than a "that." Our examples; however, have shown us a for-itself denying concretely that it is a particular being. This situation arises from the fact that we: described the relation of knowledge before hringing to light its structure ofnegativity. In this sense, by the very factthat it was revealed in examples, that negativity was already secondary. Negativity as original transcendence is not determined in terms of a this; it causes a this to exist.

The original presence of the for-itself is presence to being. Shall we say then that it is presence to all being? That would be to fall back into our former error. For totality can COme to being only by the for-itself. A totality in

deed supposes an internal relation of being between the terms of a quasi-multiplicity in the same way that a multiplicity supposes-in order to be this multiplicity-an inner totalizing relation among its elements. In this sense addition itself is a synthetic act. Totality can come to beings only by a being which has to be its own totality in their presence. This is precisely the case with the for-itself, a detotalized totality which temporalizes itself in a perpetual incompleteness. It is the for-itself in its presence to being which causes there to be an all of being. We must understand indeed that this particular being can be called this only on the ground of the presence of all being. That does not mean that one being needs all being in order to exist but that the for-itself realizes itself as a realizing presence to this being on the original ground of a realizing presence to all. But conversely since totality is an internal ontological relation of "thises," it can be revealed only in and thrpugh the individual "thises." That means that the for-itself as a realizing presence to all being realizes itself as a realizing presence to the "thises," and as a realizing presence to the "thises" it realizes itself as a realizing presence- to all being.· In other words, the presence of the for-itself to the world can be realized only by its presence to one or several particular things, and conversely its presence to a particu-

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lar thing can be realized only on the ground of a presence to the world. Perception is articulated only on the ontological foundation of presence to the world, and the world is revealed concretely as the ground of each individual perception. It remains to explain how the upsurge of the for-itself in being can bring it about that there is an all and "thises."

The presence of the for-itself to being as totality comes from the fact that the for-itself has to be-in the mode of being what it is not and of not being what it is··its own totality as a detotalized totality. In so far as the for-itself makes itself be in the unity of a single upsurge as all whic;h is not being, being stands before it as all which the for-itself is not. The original negation, in fact, is a radical negation. The for-itself, which stands before being as its own totality, is itself the whole of the negation and hence is the negation of the whole. Thus the achieved totality of the world is revealed as constitutive of the being of the unachieved totality by which the being of totality comes into being. It is through the world that the for-itself makes itself known to itself as a totality detotalized, which means that by its very upsurge the for-itself is a revelation of being as a totality inasmuch as the for-itself has to be its own totality in the detotalized mode. Thus the very meaning of the for-itself is outside in being, but it is through the for-itself that the meaning of being appears. This totalization of being adds nothing to being; it is nothing but the manner in which being is revealed as not being the for-itself, the manner in which there is being. It appears outside the tor-itself, beyond all reach, as that which determines the for-itself in its being. But the fact of revealing being as a totality does not touch being any more than the fact of counting two cups on the table touches the existence or nature of either of them. Yet it is no

ta purely
subjective modification of the for-itself since it causes all subjectivity to be possible. But if the for-itself is to be the nothingness whereby "there is" being,then being can exist originally only as totality. Thus knowledge is the world. To use Heidegger's expression, the world and outside of that-nothing. But this "nothing" is not originally that in which human reality emerges. This nothing is human reality itself as the radical negation by means of which the world is revealed. Of course the very apprehension of the world as totality causes the appearance alongside the world of a nothingness which sustains and encompasses this totality. In fact this nothingness as the absolute nothing which is left outside the totality even determines the totality. This is why the totalization adds nothing to being, for it is only the result of the appearance of nothingness as the limit of being. But this nothingness is not anything except human reality apprehending itself as excluded from being and perpetually beyond being, in commerce with nothing. It amounts to the same thing whether we say, human reality is that by which being is revealed as totality-or, human reality is that which causes there to be nothing outside of being. This nothing is the possibility for there to be a beyond-the-world such that
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(1) this possibility reveals being as a world and (2) human reality has to be this possibility. As such, this nothing constitutes-along with the original presence to being-the circuit of selfness.
But human reality makes itself the unachieved totality of negations only in so far as it reaches beyond a concrete negation which it has to be as actual presence to being. If it were in fact a pure consciousness (of) being a syncretic and undifferentiated negation, it could not determine itself and therefore could not bea concrete totality, although detotalized, of its determinations. It is a totality only to the extent that through all its other negations it escapes the concrete negation which it is at present. Its being can be its own totality only to the extent that it is a surpassing toward the whole which it has to be, beyond the partial structure which it is. Otherwise it would simply be what it is and could in nO way be considered as either a totality or a non-totality. In the sense then that a partial negative structure must appear on the ground of the undifferentiated negations which I am-and of which it forms a part-I make known to myself by means of being-in-itself a certain concrete reality which I have to not-be. The "this" is the being which I at present am not, in so far as it appears on the ground of the totality of being. This is what I at present am not inasmuch as I have to be nothing of being: it is what is revealed on the undifferentiated ground of being, to make known to me the concrete negation which I have to be on the totalizing ground of my negations.
This original relation between the all and the "this" is at the source of the relation between figure and ground which the "Gestalt theory" has brought to light. The "this" always appears on a ground; that is, on the undifferentiated totality of being inasmuch as the For-itself is the radical and syncretic negation of it. Yet it can always dissolve again into this undifferentiated totality when another "this" arises. But the appearance of the "this" or of the fig

ure on the ground, since it is the correlate
of the appearance of my Own concrete negation on the syncretic ground
of a radical negation, implies that I both am and am not that total nega-
tion or, if you prefer, that I am it in the mode of "non-being" and that
I am not it in the mode of being. It is indeed only in this way that the
present negationwiI appear on the ground of the radical negation which
it is. Otherwise indeed the present negation would be entirely cut off or
else it would be dissolved in the radical negation. The appearance of the
this on the all is correlative with a certain way which the For-itself
has of being the negation of itself. There is a this because I am not yet
my future negations and because I am no longer my past negations. The
revelation of the this supposes that the "accent is put" on a certain nega-
tion accompanied by the withdrawal of the others in the syncretic dis-
appearance into the ground; that is, that the for-itself can exist only as a
negation which is constituted on the withdrawal into totality of the
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radical negativity. The For-itself is not the world, spatiality, permanence,
matter, in short the in-itself in general, but its manner of not-being-them
is to have to not-be this table, this glass, this room on the total ground of
negativity. The this supposes then a negation of the negation-but a
negation which has to be the radical negation which it denies, which does
not cease reattaching itself to it by an ontological thread, and which re-
mains ready to dissolve in the radical negation at the upsurge of another
"this." In this sense the "this" is revealed as "this" by "a withdrawal into
the ground of the world" on the part of all the other "thises;" its deter-
mination, which is the origin of all determinations, is a negation.
We must understand that this negation-seen from the point of view
of the "this"-is wholly ideal. It adds nothing to being and subtracts noth-
ing from it. The-being confronted as "this" is what it is and does not cease
being it; it does not become. As such it can not be outside of itself in the
whole as a structure of the whole, nor can it be outside of itself in the
whole so as to deny its identity with the whole. Negation can come to the
this only through a being which has to be simultaneously presence to the
whole of being and to the this-that is, through an ekstatic being. Since
it leaves the this intact as being in itself, since it does not effect a real
synthesis of all the thises in totality, the negation constitutive of the
this is a negation of the external type; the relation of the "this" to the
whole is a relation of externality. Thus we see that determination appears
as an external negation correlative with the radical and ekstatic internal
negation which I am. This is the explanation of the ambiguous character
of the world, which is revealed simultaneously as a synthetic totality and
as a purely additive collection of all the "thises." In so far as the world is a
totality which is revealed as that on which the For-itself has to be radically
its own nothingness, the world is presented as a syncretism of undifferen-
tiation. But in so far as this radical nihilation is always beyond a concrete
and present nihilation, the world appears always ready to open like a box
to allow the appearance of one or several "thises" which already were
(there in the heart of the undif

ferentiation of the ground) what they are
now as a differentiated figure. When we are gradually approaching a landscape which was given in great masses, we see objects appear which are given as having been there already, as elements in a discontinuous collection of "thises";in the same way, in the experiments of the Gestalt school, the continuous background suddenly when apprehended as figure bursts into a multiplicity of discontinuous elements. Thus the world, as the correlate of a detotalized totality, appears as an evanescent totality in the sense that it is never a real synthesis but an ideal limitation-by nothing-of a collection of thises.
Thus the continuous as a formal quality of the ground allows the discontinuous to appear as a type of external relation between the this and the totality. It is precisely this perpetual evanescence of the totality into

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collection, of the continuous into the discontinuous that defines space. Space can not be a being. It is a moving relation between beings which' are unrelated. It is the total independence of the in-itsclfs, as it is revealed to a being which is presence to "all" the in-itself as the independence of each one in relation to the others. It is the unique way in which beings can be revealed as having no relation, can be thus revealed to the being through which relation carnes into the world; that is, space is pure extcriority. Since this exteriority cannot belong to any one of the thises considered and since in addition a purely local negativity is self-destructive, it can neither be by itself nor "be made-to-be." The spatializing being is the For-itself as co-present to the whole and to the "this." Space is not the world, but it is the instability of the world apprehended as totality, inasmuch as the world can always disintegrate into external multiplicity. Space is neither the ground nor the figure but the ideality of the ground inasmuch as it can always disintegrate into figures; it is neither the continuous nor the discontinuous, but the permanent passage from continuous to discontinuous. The existence of space is the proof that the For-itseTf by causing being "to be there" adds nothing to being. Space is the ideality of the synthesis. In this sense it is at once totality to the extent that it derives its origin from the world, and at the same time nothing inasmuch as it results in the pullulation of thethises. Space does not allow itself to be apprehended by concrete intuition for it is not, but it is continuously spatialized. It depends on temporality and appears in temporality since it can come into the world only through a being whose mode of being is temporalization; for space is the way in which this being loses itself ekstatically in order to realize being. The spatial characteristic of the this is not added synthetically to the this but is only the "place" of the this; that is, its relation of exteriority to the ground inasmuch as this relation can collapse into a multiplicity of external relations with other thises when the ground itself disintegrates into a multiplicity of figures. In this sense it would be useless to conceive of space as a form imposed on phenomena by the a priori structure of our sensibility. Space can not be a form, for it is nothing; it is, on the contrary, the indication that nothing except the negation-and this still as a type of external relat

ion which leaves intact
what it unites-can come to the in-itself through the For-itself. As for
the For-itself, if it is not space, this is because it apprehends itself pre-
cisely as not being being-in-itself in so far as the in-itself is revealed to it
in the mode of exteriority which we call extension. It is precisely by
denying exteriority in itself and apprehending itself as ekstatic that the
For-itself spatializes space. The relation between the For-itself and the in-
itself is not one of juxtaposition or indifferent exteriority. Its relation
with the in-itself, which is the foundation of all relations, is the internal
negation, and it is through this that being-in-itself continues in indifferent
exteriority in relation to other beings existing in a world. When the ex-

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teriority of indifference is hypostasized as a substance existing in and
through itself-which can be effected only at a lower stage of knowledge
-it is made the object of a type of particular study under the title of
geometry and becomes a pure specification of the abstract theory of mul-
tiplicities.
It remains to determine what type of being the external negation pos-
sesses since this comes to the world by the For-itself. We know that it does
not belong to the this. This newspaper does not deny concerning itself
that it is the table on which it is lying; for in that case the newspaper
would be ekstatically outside itself and in the table which it denies, and
its relation to the table would be an internal negation; it would thereby
cease even to be in-itself and would become for-itself. The determinative
relation of the this therefore can belong neither to the this nor to the
that; it enfolds them without touching them, without conferring on them
the slightest trace of new character; it leaves them for what they are. In
this sense we can modify the famous statement of Spinoza, "Omnis deter-
minatio est negatio," which Hegel declared to possess infinite riehes;
and we will claim rather that every determination which does not belong
to the being which has to be its own determinations is an ideal negation.
Moreover it would be inconceivable that it should be otherwise. Even
if following an empirical-critical psychologism, we were to consider things
as purely subjective contents, we still could not conceive that the sub-
ject would realize internal synthetic negations among these contents with-
out being them in a radical ekstatic immanence which would remOve
all hope of any passage to objectivity.
With even more reason we can not imagine that the For-itself effects
distorting synthetic negations among transcendents which it is not. In
this sense the external negation constitutive of the "this" can not appear
as an objective characteristic of the thing, if we understand by objective
that which by nature belongs to the in-itself-or that which in one way
or another really constitutes the object as it is. But we must not conclude
from this that the external negation has subjective existence like the pure
mode of being of the For-itself. The type of existence of the For-itself is
a pure internal negation; the existence in it of an external negation would
be destructive of its very existence. Consequently the external negation
can not be a way of disposing and of classifying phenomena which would
exist only as subjective phantoms, nor can it "subiectivize" being in so far
as

its revelation is constitutive of the For-itself. Its very exteriority there-
force requires that it remain "in the air," exterior to the For-itself as well as
to the In-itself. On the other hand, precisely because it is exteriority, it
can not be by itself; it refuses all supports, it is by nature unselbstandig,
and yet it can not be referred to any substance. It is a nothing. In fact
it is because the inkwell is not the table-nor the pipe nor the glass-that
we can apprehend it as an inkwell. And yet if I say, "The inkwell is not the

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table," I am thinking nothing. Thus deteimination is a nothing which
does not belong as an internal structure either to the thing or to conscious-
ness, but its being is to-be-summoned by the For-itself across a system of
internal negations in which the in-itself is revealed in its indifference to all
that is not itself. In so far as the For-itself makes itself known to itself by
the In-itself, which it is not-in the mode of internal negation, the indiffer-
ence of the In-itself as the indifference which the For-itself has to not-be
is revealed in the world as determination.

III. QUALITY AND QUANTITY, POTENTIALITY, INSTRUMENTALITY

QUALITY is nothing other than the being of the this when it is considered
apart from all external relation with the world or with other thises. Too
often quality has been conceived as a simple subjective determination,
and its quality-of-being has then been confused with the subjectivity of
the psychic. The problem has then appeared to be especially to explain
the constitution of an object-pole conceived as the transcendent unity
of qualities. We have shown that this problem is insoluble. A quality
does not objectivate itself if it is subjective. Supposing that we had pro-
jected the unity of an object-pole beyond qualities, at most each one of
them would be given directly as the subjective effect of the action of
things upon us. But the yellow of the lemon is not a subjective mode
of apprehending the lemon; it is the lemon. And it is not true either that
the object X appears as the empty form which holds together disparate
qualities. In fact the lemon is extended throughout its qualities, and each
of its qualities is extended throughout each of the others. It. is the sour-
ness of the lemon which is yellow, it is the yellow of the lemon which is
sour. We eat the color of a cake, and the taste of this cake is the instrument
which reveals its shape and its color to what we may call the alimentary
intuition. Conversely if I poke my finger into a jar of jam, the sticky
coldness of that jam is the revelation to my fingers of its sugary taste. The
fluidity, the tepidity, the bluish color, the undulating restlessness of the
water in a pool are given at one stroke, each quality through the others;
and it is this total interpenetration which we call the this. This fact has
been clearly shown by the experiences of painters, especially of Cezanne.
Husserl is wrong in believing that a synthetic necessity unconditionally
unites color and form; it is the form which is color and light. If the painter
wants to vary anyone of these factors, the others change as well, not
because they are linked by some sort of law but because at bottom they
are one and the same being.

In this sense every quality of being is all of being; the quality is the
presence of the absolute contingency of being, its ind

through my closed eyelids is already a light-being. This will appear obvious if one reflects on the fact that quality is. As a being which is what it is, it can indeed appear to a subjectivity, but it can not be inserted in the woof of that subjectivity which is what it is not and which is not what it is. To say that a quality is a quality-being is not to endo,w it with a mysterious support analogous to substance; it is simply to observe that its mode of being is radically different from the mode of the being "for-itself." TIle being of whiteness or of sourness indeed could in no way be apprehended as ekstatic.

If someone should ask now how it happens that the "this" has qualities we should reply that actually the tbis is released as a totality on the ground of the world and that it is given as an undifferentiated unity. It is the for-itself which can deny itself from various points of view when confronting the this and which reveals the quality as a new this on the ground of the thing. For each negating act by which the freedom of the For-itself spontaneously constitutes its being, there is a corresponding total revelation of being "in profile." This profile is nothing but a relation of the thing to the For-itself, a relation realized by the For-itself. It is the absolute determination of negativity, for it is not enough that the for-itself by an original negation should not be being nor that it should not be this being; in order for its determination as the nothingness of being to be full, the for-itself must realize itself as a certain unique manner of not being this being.

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This absolute determination, which is the determination of quality as a profile of the "this," belongs to the freedom of the For-itself. It is not; it is as "to-be." Anyone may see this for himself by considering how the revelation of one quality of the thing appears always as a factual grntuity grnsped across a freedom. While I can not make this orange peel cease being green, it is I who am responsible for my apprehending it as a rough green or a green roughness. But the relation figure-ground here is rather different from that of the this to the world. For instead of the figure's appearing on an undifferentiated ground, it is wholly penetrated by the ground; it holds the ground within it as its own undifferentiated density. I apprehend the peel as green; its "brightness-roughness" is revealed as an inner undifferentiated ground and plenitude of being for the green. There is no abstraction here in the sense that abstraction separates what is united, for being always appears entire in its profile. But the realization of being conditions the abstraction, for the abstraction is not the apprehension of a quality "in midair" but of a this-quality where the undifferentiation of the inner ground tends toward absolute equilibrium. The green abstracted does not lose its density of being-<>therwise it would be nothing more than a subjective mode of the for-itself-but the brightness, the shape, the roughness, etc., which are given across it dissolve in the nihilating equilibrium of pure and sinlple massiveness. Abstraction, however,

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is a phenomenon of presence to being since abstract being preserves its transcendence. But it can be realized only as a presence to being beyond being; it is,asnrpassing. This presence to being can be realized only on the level of possibil

ity and in so far as the For-itself has to be its own
possibilities. The abstract is revealed as the meaning which quality has
to be as co-present to the presence of a for-itself to-come. Thus the abstract
green is the meaning-to-come of the concrete this in so far as it reveals
itself to me through its profile "green-brightness-roughness." The green
is the peculiar possibility of this profile in so far as it is revealed across the
possibilities which I am; that is, in so far as it is made-to-be. But this
brings us to instrumentality and the temporality of the world. We shall
return to this point. For the moment it is sufficient to say that the ab-
stract haunts the concrete as a possibility fixed in the in-itself, which
the concrete has to be. Whatever our perception may be, as the original
contact with being, the abstract is always there but to-come; I apprehend
it in the future with my future. It is correlative with the peculiar pos-
sibility of my present concrete negation as the possibility of being no
more than this negation. The abstract is the meaning of this in so far as
it reveals itself in the future across my possibility of fixing in in-itself the
negation which I have to be.
If someone should remind us here of the classic difficulties regarding
abstraction, we should reply that they stem from the fact that the con-
stitution of the ','this" and the act of abstraction are taken as distinct. It
is certain that if the this does not include its own abstractions, there is no
possibility of deriving them from it afterward. But it is in the very con-
stitution of the this as tllis that the abstraction operates as the revelation
in profile of my future. The For-itself is an "abstractor," not because it
could realize a psychological operation of abstraction but because it rises
as a presence to being with a future-that is, a beyond being. In itself
being is neither concrete nor abstract nor present nor future: it is what it is.
'Yet the abstraction does not enrich being; it is only the revelation of a
nothingness of being beyond being. But we challenge anyone to formulate
the classic objections to abstraction without deriving them implicitly from
the considcration of being as a this.
The original relation of the tllises to one another can be neither interac-
tion nor causality nor even the upsurge on the same ground of the world.
If we suppose that the For-itself is present to one this, the other thises
exist at the same time "in the world" but by virtue of being undiffer-
entiated; they constitute the ground on which the this confronted is raised
in relief. In order to establish any relation whatsoever between one this
and another this, it is necessary that the second this be revealed rising
up on the ground of the world on the occasion of an express negation
which the For"itself has to be. But at the same time each this must be
held at a distancdromthe other as not being the other by a negation of
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BEING AND NOTHINGNESS
a purely external type. Thus the original relation of this to that is an ex-
ternal negation. That appears as not being this. And the external nega-
tion IS revealed to the For-itself as a transcendent; it is outside, it is
in-itself. How are we to understand it?
The appearance of the tllis-that can be produced first only as totality.
The primary relation here is the unity of a totality capable of disintegra-
tion; the For-itself is det

ermined en bloc to not-be "this-that" on the
ground of the world. The "this-that" is my whole room in so far as I am present to it. This concrete negation will not then disappear with the disintegration of the concrete mass into this and that. On the contrary it is the very condition of the disintegration. But on this. ground of presence and by means of this ground of presence, being effects the appearance of its indifferent exteriority. This exteriority is revealed to me in the fact that the negation which I am is a unity-multiplicity rather than an undifferentiated totality. My negative upsurge into being is parceled out into independent negations which have no connection other than that they are negations which I have to be; that is, they derive tlleir inner unity from me and not from being. I am present to that table, to those chairs, and as such I constitute myself synthetically as a polyvalent negation; but this purely inner negation, in so far as it is a negation of being is paralyzed with zones of nothingness; it is nihilated by virtue of negation, it is negation detotalized. Across these striations of nothingness which I have to be as my own nothingness of negation, appears the indifference of being. But this indifference I have to realize by this nothingness of ncgation which I have to be, not in so far as I am originally present to the "this" but in so far as I am also present to the "that." It is in and by my presence to the table that I realize the indifference of the chair (which presently I also have to not-be) as an absence of a springboard, an arrest of my impulse toward non-being, a breakdown in the circuit. "That" appears alongside "this," in the heart of a total revelation, as that from which I can in nO way profit so as to determine myself to not-be "this."

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Thus cleavage comes from being, but there is cleavage and separation only through the presence of the For-itself to all of being. The negation of the unity of the negations in so far as it is a revelation of the indifference of being and in so far as it apprehends the indifference of the "this",.with regard to the "that" and the "that" with regard to the "this," is a revelation of the original relation of the thises in an external negation. The "this" is not "that." This external negation within the unity of a totality capable of disintegration is expressed by the word "and." "111is is not that" is written "this and that." The external negation has the double character of being-in-itself and of being pure ideality. It is in-itself in that it does not in any way belong to the For-itself; the For-itself discovers the indifference of being as exteriority across the absolute interiority of its own negation (since in aesthetic intuition I apprehend an imaginary

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object). Moreover we are not dealing with a negation which being has to be; this negation does not belong to any of the thises considered; it purely and simply is. It is what it is. But at the same time it is by no means a characteristic of the this, by no means one of its qualities. It is even totally independent of the thises, precisely because it does not belong to anyone of them. For the indifference of being is nothing; we can not think it or even perceive it. It means simply that annihilation or the variations of the that can engage the this in nothing; in this sense it is only a nothingness in-itself

separating the thises, and this nothingness is the only mode in which consciousness can realize the cohesion of identity which characterizes being.

This ideal nothingness in-itself is quantity. Quantity in fact is pure exteriority; it does not depend on the terms added but is only the affirmation of their independence. To ~ount is to make an ideal distinction inside a totality capable of disintegration and already given. The number obtained by the addition does not belong to any of the thises counted nor to the totality capable of disintegration-in so far as this is revealed as totality. If there are three men talking opposite me, it is not as I apprehend them first as a "group in conversation" that I count them; and the fact of counting them as three leaves the concrete unity of their group perfectly intact. Being a "group of three" is not a concrete property of the group. Neither is it a property of its members. We can not say of anyone of them that he is three nor even that he is a third-for the quality of third is only a reflection of the freedom of the for-itself which is counting; each One of the men can be a third, but no one of them is it. The relation of quantity is therefore a relation in-itself but a purely negative and external relation. It is precisely because it does not belong either to things or to totalities that it is isolated and detached from the surface of the world as a reflection (reflet) of nothingness cast on being. As a purely exterior relation between the thises, quantity is itself exterior to them and finally exterior to itself. It is the inapprehensible indifference of being-which can appear only if there is being and which, although belonging to being, can come to it only from a for-itself, inasmuch as this indifference can be revealed only by the exteriorization to infinity of a relation of exteriority which must be exterior to being and to itself. Thus space and quantity are only one and the same type of negation. By the sole fact that this and that are revealed as having no relation to me who am my own relation, space and quantity come into the WOrld; for each one of them is the relation of things which are unrelated or, if you prefer, the nothingness of relation apprehended as a relation by the being which is its own relation. From this we can see that what Husserl calls categories (unity-multiplicity-relation of the whole to the part-more and less-arGund-beside-following-first, second, etc.--one, two, three, etc.-within and without.;.....etc.)-these are only the ideal mixing of things

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which leaves them wholly intact, without either enriching or impoverish~ing them by one iota; they merely indicate the infinite diversity of ways in which the freedom of the for-itself can realize the indifference of being.

We have treated the problem of the original relation of the for-itself to being as if the for-itself were a simple, instantaneous consciousness such as can be revealed to the Cartesian cogito. In truth we have already encountered the escape from self on the part of the for-itself inasmuch as this is the necessary condition for the appearance of the tllises and of abstractions. But the ekstatic character of the for-itself was still only implicit. While we have had to proceed in this way for the sake of clarity in exposition, we should not thereby conclude that being is revealed to a being which wou

ld be first presence in order afterwards to constitute
itself a future. But being-in-itself is revealed to a being which arises as
about-to-come to itself. This means that the negation which the for-it-
self makes itself be in the presence of being has an ekstatic dimension of
the future; it is in so far as I am not what I am (an ekstatic relation to my
own possibilities) that I have to not-be being-in-itself as the revealing
realization of the this. 111at means that I am presence to the "this" in the
incompleteness of a totality detotalized. What consequence is there here
for the revelation of the this?
Since lam always beyond what I am, about-to-come to myself, the
"this" to which I am present appears to me as something which I surpass
toward myself. The perceived is originally the surpassed; it is like a con-
ductor in the circuit of selfness, and it appears within the limits of this
circuit. To the extent that I make myself be the negation of the this, I
flee this negation in the direction of a complementary negation; and the
fusion of the two would effect the appearance of the in-itself which I am.
There is a bond of being between the negation of the this and the second
possible negation; the second is not just any negation but is precisely the
complementary negation of my presence to the thing. But since the for-
itself constitutes itself qua presence, as a non-positional self-consciousness,
it makes known to itself, outside itself, through being, what it is not.
It recovers its being outside in the mode "the-reflection-reflecting."
The complementary negation which the for-itself is as its own possibility
is then a negation-presence; that is, the for-itself has to be it as a non-
thetic self-consciousness and as a thetic consciousness of being-beyond-
being.
Being-beyond-being is bound to the present tIlis, not by any kind of
external relation but by a precise bond of complementarity which stands
in exact correlation with the relation of the for-itself to its future. First of
all, the tbis is revealed in the negation of a being which makes itself to
not-be this, not by virtue of simple presence, but as a negation which is
about-to-come to itself, which is its own possibility beyond its present.
This possibility which haunts pure presence as its meaning out of reach

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and as that which it lacks in order to be in-itself exists first as a projection
of the present negation by virtue of engagement. Every negation in fact
which would not have beyond itself in the future the meaning of an
engagement as a possibility which comes to it and toward which it flees
itself, would lose all its significance as negation. \\That the for-itself denies,
it denies "with the dimension of a future." It involves either an external
negation (this is not that, that chair is not a table) or an internal negation
bearing On itself. To say that "this is not that" is to posit the exteriority
ofthe "this" in relation to the "that," whether for now and for the future
or in the strict "now"; -but in the latter c~se the negation has a provisory
character which constitutes the future as pure exteriority in relation to
the present determination "this and that." In both cases the meaning
comes to the negation in terms of the future; all negation is ekstatic. In
so far as the for-itself denies itself in the future, the this concerning which
it makes itself a negation is revealed as

coming to itself from the future.
The possibility that .consciousness exists non-thetically as consciousness (of) being able not to not-be this is revealed as the potentiality of the this of being what it is. The first potentiality of the object, as the correlate of. the engagement, an ontological structure of the negation, is permanence, which perpetually comes to it on the ground of the future. The revelation of the table as table requires a permanence of table which comes to it from the future and which is not a purely eSbblished given, but a potentiality. This permanence moreover does not come to the table from a future located in temporal infinity. Infinite time does not yet exist. The table is not revealed as having the possibility of being a table indefinitely. The time concerned here is neither finite nor infinite; potentiality merely causes the dimension of the future to appear.
\Vhen we speak of the meaning-to-come of the negation, we refer to that which the negation of the for-itself lacks in order to become a negation in itself. In this sense the negation is, in the future, the precisions of the present negation. It is in the future that there is revealed the exact meaning of what I have to not-be as a correlate of the exact negation which I have to be. The polymorphic negation of the this, where the green is formed by a totality "roughness-light," gets its meaning only if it has to be the negation of the green; that is, of a being-green, the ground of which tends toward the equilibrium of undifferentiation. In a word, the absent-meaning of my polymorphic negation is a negation confined by a green more purely green on an undifferentiated ground. Thus the pure green comes to the "green-roughness-light" on the ground of the future as its meaning. We apprehend here the meaning of what we have called abstraction. The existent does not possess its essence as a present quality. It is even the negation of essence; the green never is green. But the essence comes from the ground of the future to the existent,as a

8 Used in the technical sense of "detennination" or "giving an exact meaning." Tr.

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meaning which is never given and which forever haunts it. It is the pure correlate of the pure ideality of my negation. In this sense there is no such thing as an operation of abstraction if we mean by that a psychological affirmative act of selection effected by a constituted mind. Far from abstracting certain qualities in terms of things, we must on the contrary view abstraction as the original mode of being of the for-itself, necessary in order that there may be, in general, things and a world. The abstract is a st~cture of the world and is necessary for the upsurge of the concrete; the concrete is concrete only in so far as it leans in the direction of its abstraction, that it makes itself known by the abstraction which it is. The being of the for-itself is revealing-abstracting. We see that from this point of view permanence and the abstract are only one. If the table has qua table a potentiality of permanence, this is to the exact degree that it has to be a table. Permanence is pure possibility for a this to be consistent with its essence.
We have seen in Part Two of this work that the relation between the possible which I am and the present which I am fleeing is the same as the relation between the lacking and the one which lacks wh

at is lacking. The
ideal fusion of the lacking with the one which lacks what is lacking is an unrealizable totality which haunts the for-itself and constitutes its very being as a nothingness of being. This ideal we called the in-itself-for-itself or value. But on the unreflective level this value is not grasped thetically by the for-itself; it is only a condition of being. If our conclusions are accurate, this perpetual indication of an unrealizable fusion must appear not as a structure of the unreflective consciousness but as a transcendent indication of an ideal structure of the object. This structure can be easily revealed; correlative with the indication of a fusion of the polymorphic negation with the abstract negation which is its meaning, there is to be revealed a transcendent and ideal indication-that of a fusion of the existing th.is with its essence to-come. Thus fusion must be such that the abstract is the foundation of the concrete and that simultaneously the concrete is the foundation of the abstract. In other words, the concrete "flesh and blood" existence must be the essence, and the essence must itself be produced as a total concretion; that is, it must have the full richness of the concrete without however allowing us to discover in it any thing other than itself in its total purity. Or if you prefer, the form must be to itself-and totally-its own matter. And conversely the matter must be produced as absolute form.
This perpetually indicated but impossible fusion of essence and existence does not belong either to the present or the future, it indicates rather the fusion of past, present, and future, and it presents itself as a synthesis to be effected of temporal totality. It is value as transcendence; it is what we call beauty. Beauty therefore represents an ideal state of the world, correlative with an ideal realization of the for-itself; in this realiza-

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tion the essence and the existence of things are revealed as identity to a being who, in this very revelation, would be merged with himself in the absolute unity of the in-itself. This is precisely because the beautiful is not only a transcendent synthesis to be effected but because it can be realized only in and through a totalization of ourselves. This is precisely why we desire the beautiful and why we apprehend the universe as lacking the beautiful to the extent that we ourselves apprehend ourselves as a lack. But the beautiful is no more a potentiality of thing! than the in-itself-for-itself is a peculiar possibility of the for-itself. It haunts the world as an unrealizable. To the extent that man realizes the beautiful in the world, he realizes it in the imaginary mode. This means that in the aesthetic intuition, I apprehend an imaginary object across an imaginary realization of myself as a totality in-itself and for-itself. Ordinarily the beautiful, like value, is not thematically made explicit as a value-out-of-reath-of-the-world. It is implicitly apprehended on things as an absence; it is revealed implicitly across the imperfection of the world.
'J'hese original potentialities are not the only ones which characterize the this. To the extent that the for-itself has to be its being beyond its present, it is the revelation of a qualified beyond-being, which comes to the "this" on the ground of being. In so far as the for-itself is beyond the crescent moon, nex

t to a being-beyond-being which is the future full
moon the full moon becomes the potentiality of the crescent moon.
In so far as the for-itself is beyond the bud, next to the flower, the flower is a potentiality of the bud. The revelation of these new potentialities implies an original relation to the past. It is in the past that the connection between the crescent moon and the full moon, between the bud and the flower is gradually discovered. The past of the for-itself stands as empirical knowledge for the for-itself. But this knowledge does not remain as an inert given. It is behind the for-itself, of course, unrecognizable as such and out of reach. But in the ekstatic unity of its being, it is in terms of this past that the for-itself makes known to itself what it is in the future. My wisdom (savoir) as regards the moon escapes me as a thematic knowledge (connaissance). But I am it, and my way of being is-at least .in certain cases-to cause what I no longer am to come to me in the form of what I am not yet. This negation of the this-which I have been-I am in two ways: in the mode of not being any longer and of not being yet. I am beyond the crescent moon as the possibility of a radical negation of the moon as a full disk; and correlative with the· return of my future negation toward my presence, the fuII moon comes back toward the crescent" in order to determine it in this as a negation; the full moon is what the crescent lacks; it is the lack of the full moon which makes the crescent a crescent. Thus within the unity of the same ontological negation, I attribute the dimension of the future to the crescent as crescent-in the form of permanence and essence-and I constitute it as the crescent moon

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by the determiJ;ling return toward it of what it lacks. Thus is constituted the scale of possiblities which reaches from permanence to potencies. Human-reality by surpassing itself in the .direction of its own possibility of negation, makes itself that by which negation through surpassing comes into the world. It is through human reality that lack comes to things in the form of "potency," of "incompletion," of "suspension," of "potentiality."
Nevertheless the transcendent being of lack can not have the nature of ekstatic lack in immanence. Let us look at it more carefully. The in-itself does not have to be its own potentiality in the mode of not-yet. The revelation of the in-itself is originally a· revelation of the self-identity of indifference. The in-itself is what it is without any ekstatic dispersion of its being. It does not have to be its permanence or its essence or that which it lacks as I have to be my future. My upsurge into the world causes potentialities to arise correlatively. But these potentialities are fixed in their very arising; they are eaten away by exteriority. We shall discover here again that double aspect of the transcendent which in' its very .ambiguity has given birth to space: a totality which is dispersed in relations of exteriority. Potentiality on the ground of the future turns back on. the this to determine it, but the relation between the this as in-itself and its potentiality is an external relation. The crescent moon is determined as lacking or deprived of-in relation to the full moon. But at the same time the crescent is revealed as being fully what it is-that concrete sign in the sky, which n

eeds nothing in order to be what it is.
The same is true for this bud or for this match, which is what it is, for which its meaning as being-a-match remains exterior, which can of course burst into flame but which at present is this piece of white wood with a black tip. The potentialities of the tllis, while strictly connected with it, are present as in-itselfs and are in a state of indifference in relation to it. This inkwell can be broken, thrown against the marble of the fireplace where it will be shattered. But this potentiality is entirely cut off from it, for it is only the transcendent correlate of my possibility of throwing the inkwell against the marble of the fireplace. In itself the inkwell is neither breakable nor unbreakable; it is.
That does not mean that I can consider a this as outside all potentiality; from the mere fact that I am my own future, the this is revealed as provided with potentialities. To apprehend the match as a piece of white wood with a black tip is not to strip it of all potentiality but simply to confer on it new ones (a new permanence-a new essence). In order for the this to be entirely deprived of potentialities, it would be necessary that I be a pure presence, which is inconceivable. But the this has various potentialities which are equivalents-that is, in a state of equivalence in relation to it. This is because it does. not have to be them. In addition my possibilities do not exist but are possibilized because they are

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eaten away from within by my freedom; that is, whatever my possible may be, its opposite is equally possible. I can shatter this inkwell but I can just as well put it in a drawer. I can aim at the full mOOn beyond the crescent moon, but I can just as well insist on the permanence of the crescent as such. Consequently the inkwell is found to be provided with equivalent possibilities: to be put in a drawer, to be shattered. This crescen t moon can be an open curve in the sky or a disk held in suspense. Those potentialities which refer back to the this without being made to be by it and without having to be-those we shall call probabilities to indicate that they exist in the mode of being of the in-itself. We cannot say that my possibles are; they are possibilized. But probabilities are not "probabilized," they are each one in itself as probable. In this sense the inkwell is, but its being-an-inkwell is a probable; for the inkwell's having-to-be-an-inkwell is a pure appearance which is founded immediately on a relation of exteriority.
These potentialities or probabilities, which are the meaning of being beyond being, are in-itselfs beyond being, and precisely for this reason they are nothings. The essence of the inkwell is made-to-be as a correlate of the possible negation of the for-itself, but it is not the inkwell and it is not being. In so far as this essence is in-itself, it is a negation hypostasized and reified; that is, it is a nothing, it belongs to the shell of nothingness which encases and determines the world. The for-itself reveals the inkwell as an inkwell. But this revelation is made beyond the being of the inkwell, in that future which is not; all the potentialities of being, from permanence to qualified potentialities, are defined as that which being is not yet without ever truly having to be them. Here again knowledge adds nothing to being and removes nothing from it; know

ledge adorns
it with no new quality. It causes being to-be-there by surpassing it toward a nothingness which enters into only negative exterior relations with it. This character of pure nothingness in potentiality results in efforts on the part of science, which aims at establishing relations of simple exteriority, radically to suppress the potential (essence and potencies). But on the other hand the necessity of potentiality as a meaningful structure of perception appears clearly enough so that we need not insist on it here: Scientific knowledge, in fact, can neither overcome nor suppress the potentializing structure of perception. On the contrary science must presuppose it.
.
We have attempted to show how the presence of the for-itself to being reveals being as a thing, arid for the sake of clarity in exposition we have had to show successively the various structures of the thing: the this and spatiality, permanence, essence and potentialities. It is evident, however, that this successive account does not correspond to a real priority of certain of these moments over others: the upsurge of the for-itself causes the thing to be revealed with the totality of its structures. Further-

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more there is not one of these structures which does not i~ply all the others. The this does not have even logical priority over essence. On the contrary the tllis presupposes essence, and conversely essence is the essence of this. Similarly the this as the being-of-a-quality can appear only on the ground of the world, but the world is a collection of thises; the disintegrating relation of the world to the thises, of the thises to the world is spatiality. There is therefore no substantial form here, no principle of unity to stand behind the modes of appearance of the phenomenon; everything is given at one stroke without any primacy. For the same reasons, it would be incorrect to conceive of any kind of primacy as concerns the representative. Our descriptions h;tve led us to put in relief the thing in the world, and because of this fact we might be tempted to believe that the world and the thing are revealed to the for-itself in a sort of contemplative intuition. This, however, would be an intuition after the event such that objects would be arranged one in relation to another in a practical order of instrumentality. Such an error will be avoided if we are willing to maintain that the world appears inside· the circuit of selfness. It is this which separates the for-itself from itself or-to employ an expression of Heidegger's-it is this in terms of which human reality makes known to itself what it is.
This project toward self on the part of the for-itself, which constitutes selfness, is in no way a contemplative repose. It is a lack, as we have said, but not a given lack. It is a lack which has to be to itself its own lack. It must be understood that an established lack or a lack in-itself vanishes into exteriority, as we have pointed out in preceding passages. But a being which constitutes itself as lack can determine itself only there upon that which it lacks and which it is-in short, by a perpetual wrenching away from self toward the self which it has to be. This means that lack can be to itself its own lack only as a refused lack: the only truly inner connection between that which lacks -- and that which is lacking is the refusal.
In fact to t

he extent that the being which lacks -- is not what it lacks,
we apprehend in it a negation. But if this negation is not to slip away into
pure exteriority-and along with it all possibility of negation in general
-its foundation must be in the necessity for the being which lacks --
to be that which it lacks. Thus the foundation of the negation is negation
of negation. But this negation-foundation is no more a given than the lack
of which it is an essential moment; it is as having to be. The for-itself in
the phantom unity "the-reflection-reflecting" makes itself be its own lack;
that is, its projects itself toward its lack by refusing it. It is only as·a lack
to be suppressed that lack can be internal for the for-itself, and the for-
itself can realize its own lack only by having to be it; that is, by being a
project towards its suppression. Thus the relation of the for-itself to
its future is never static nor given; the future comes to the present of the
for-itself in order to determine it in its heart inasmuch as the fOI-itself is

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already there at the future as its suppression. The for-itself can be a lack
here only if it is there a suppression of the lack, but a suppression which
it has to be in the mode of non-being. It is this original relation which sub-
sequenlly allows the empirical establishment of particular lacks as lacks
suffered or endured. It is in general the foundation of affectivity; it is
this also which some will try to explain psychologically by installing within
the psyche those idols and those phantoms which we call drives or
appetites. These drives or these forces, which by violence are inserted
i'lto the psyche, are not understandable in themselves, for they are given
by the psychologist as in-itself existents; that is, their very character as
force is contradicted by their inner repose of indifference, and their unity
is dispersed in a pure relation of exteriority. We can apprehend them only
as the result of projecting into the in-itself a relation of immanent being
of the for-itself to itself and this ontological relation is precisely lack.
But this lack can not be grasped thetically and known by the unre-
flective consciousness (nor does it appear to the impure, accessory reflec-
tion which apprehends it as a psychic object-i.e., as a drive or as a feeling).
It is accessible only to the purifying reflection, with which we are not here
concerned. On the level of consciousness of the world this lack can ap-
pear only in projection, as a transcendent and ideal\haracteristic. In
fact while that which the for-itself lacks is the ideal presence to a being-
beyond-being, the being-beyond-being is originally apprehended as the
lacking-to-being. Thus the world is revealed as haunted by absences to be
realized, and each this appears with a cortege of absences which point to it
and determine it. These absences are not basically different from potential-
ities. But it is easier to grasp their meaning Thus the absences indicate
the tllis as this, and conversely th~ this points toward the absences. Since
each absence is being-beyond-being-i.e., an absent-in-itself-cach this
points toward another state of its being or toward other beings. But of
course this organization of indicative complexes is fixed and petrified in
in-itself; hence all these mute and petrified indications, which fall back
into the indifference of isolation at the same time

that they arise, resemble
the fixed, stony smile in the empty eyes of a statue.
The absences which appear behind things do not appear as absences to be made present by things. Neither can we say that they are revealed as to be realized by me since the "me" is a transcendent structure of the psyche and appears only to the reflective consciousness. They are pure demands which rise as "voids to be filled" in the middle of the circuit of selfness. Their character as "voids to be filled by the for-itself" is manifested to the unreflective consciousness by a direct and personal urgency which is lived as such without being referred to somebody or thematized. It is in and through the very fact of living them as claims that there is revealed what in an earlier chapter we called their selfness. They are tasks, and this world is a world of tasks. In relation to the tasks, the tllis which

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they indicate is both "the this of these tasks"-that is, the unique in-itself which is determined by them and which they indicate as being able to fulliIl them-and that which does not have to be these tasks since it exists in the absolute unity of identity. This connection in isolation, this inert relation within the dynamic is what we call the relation of means to end. It is a being-for which is degraded, laminated by exteriority, a being-for whose transcendent ideality can be conceived only as a correlate of the being-for which the for-itself has to be.
The thing, in so far as it both rests in the quiet beatitude of indifference and yet points beyond it to tasks to be performed which make known to it what it has to be, is an instrument or utensil. The original relation between things, that which appears on the foundation of the quantitative relation of the tllises, is the relation of instrumentality. This instrumentality is not subsequent to or subordinate to the structures already indicated: in one sense it presupposes them; in another it is presupposed by them. The thing is not first a thing in order to be subsequently an instrument; neither is it first an instrument in order to be revealed subsequently as a thing. It is an instrumental-thing. It is true, nevertheless, that the further research of the scientist will reveal it as purely a thing-i.e., stripped of all instrumentality. But this is because the scientist is concerned only with establishing purely exterior relations. Moreover the result of tlJis scientific research is that the thing itself, deprived of aU instrumentality, finally disappears into absolute exteriority. We can see to what extent we must correct Heic;legger's definition: to be sure, the world appears in the circuit of selfness; but since the circuit is non-thetic, the making known of what I am can not be thetic either. To be in the world is not to escape from the world toward oneself but to escape from the world toward a beyond-the-world which is the future world. What the world makes known to me is only "worldly." It follows that if the infinite reference of instruments never refers to a for-itself which I am, then the totality of instruments is the exact correlate of my possibilities; and as I am my possibilities, the order of instruments in the world is the image of my possibilities projected in the in-itself; i.e., the image of what lam. But I can never decipher this worldly image; I adapt myself to it in and through action, bu

t a reflective scissiparity would be required in order for
me to be able to be an object to myself.
It is not then through unauthenticity that human reality loses itself
in the world. For human reality, bcing-in-the-world means radically to
lose oneself in the world through the very revelation which causes there
to be a world-that is, to be referred without respite, without even the
possibility of "a purpose for which" from instrument to instrument with no
recourse save the reflective revolution. It would be useless to object that
the chain of "for whats" is suspended from the "for whoms" (Worum-
willen). Of course the Worumwillen refers us to a structure of being which

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we have not yet elucidated; namely, the for-others. And the "for whom"
constantly appears behind the instruments. But this "for whom," whose
constitution is different from the "for what" does not break the chain.
It is simply one of the links; when it is confronted in the perspective of
instrumentality, it does not allow an escape from the in-itself. To be sure
these workclothes are for the worker. But they are for the worker so that he
can fix the roof without getting dirty. And why shouldn't he get dirty?
In order not to spend most of his salary for clothes. This salary is allotted
him as the minimum quantity of money which will enable him to support
himself; and he "supports" himself so as to be able to apply his capacities
for work at repairing roor' And why should he repair the roof? So that it
will not rain in the offic where employees are working at book-keeping.
Etc. This does not mea that we should always think of the Other as
an instrument of a part~ular type, but merely that when we consider
the Other in terms of he world, we do not escape even so from the
infinite regress of instru ental complexes.
Thus to the extent th~t the for-itself is its own lack as a refusal correlac
tive with its impulse t ward self, being is revealed to the for-itself on
the ground of the worl as an instrumental-thing, and the world rises as
the undifferentiated gr und of indicative complexes of instrumentality.
The ensemble of thes references is void of meaning but in this sense-
that the possibility of ositing the problem of meaning on this level does
not exist. We work to ive and we live to work. The question of the mean-
ing of the totality "life-work"-="Why do I work, I who am living? Why
live if it is in order to work?"-this can be posited only on the reflective
level since it implies a self-discovery on the part of the for-itself.
It remains to explain how as a correlate of the pure negation which
I am, instrumentality can arise in the world. How does it happen that I
am not a barren, indefinitely repeated negation of the this as pure this?
If I am nothing but the pure nothingness which I have to be, how can
this negation reveal a plurality of tasks which are my image? In order to
answer this question we must recall that the for-itself is not purely and
simply a future which comcs to the present. It has to be also its past in
the form of "was." The ekstatic contradiction in the three temporal di-
mensions is such that while the for-itself is a being which by means of its
future makes known to itself the meaning of what it was, it is also in the
same upsurge a being which has to bc its wi1I-be within the perspectives of
a certain "was" which it is fleeing. In this sense we must always look

for
the meaning of a temporal dimension elsewhere, in another dimension.
This is what we have caned the diaspora, for the unity of diasporatic being
is not a pure given appurtenance; it is the necessity of realizing the dias-
pora by making itself conditioned there outside within the unity of the
self.
Therefore the negation which I am and which reveals the "this" has to

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be in the mode of "was." This pure negation which as simple presence
is not, has its being behind it, as past or facticity. As such we must recog-
nize that it is never a negation without roots. On the contrary, it is a
qualified negation-if by that we understand that it drags its qualification
behind it as the being which it has to not-be in the form of "was." The
negation arises as a non-thetic negation of the-past in the mode of internal
determination in so far as it makes itself a thetic negation of the tbis.
The upsurge is effected in the unity of a double "being for," since the
negation effects its existence in the mode of the-reflection-reflecting, as
the negation of tbe tbis, in order to escape from the past which it is; it
escapes from the past in order to disengage itself from the tbis by fleeing
it in its being toward the future. This is what we shall call the point of view
which the for-itself has on the world. This point of view, comparable to
facticity, is the ekstatic qualification of the negation as the original reo
lation to the in-itself. On the other hand, as we have seen, everything that
is for-itself is so in the mode of "was" as an ekstatic appurtenance of the
world. It is not in the future that I rediscover my presence since .the
future releases the world to me as correlative with a consciousness to-<:ome.
Rather my being appears to me in the past, although non-thematically,
within the compass of being-in-itself; that is, in relief in the midst of the
world. Of course this being is still consciousness of --, that is, a for-it-
self; but it is a for-itself fixed in in-itself, and consequently while a con·
sciousness of the world, it is fallen into the midst of the world. The mean-
ing of realism, of naturalism, and of materialism lies in the past; these
three philosophies are descriptions of the past as if it were present.
The for-itself is then a double flight from the world; it escapes its own
being-in-the-midst-of-the-world as a presence to a world which it is fleeing.
The possible is the free end of the flight. The for-itself can not flee to-
ward a transcendent which it is not, but only toward a transcendent which
it is. It is this fact which removes all possibility of surcease from this
perpetual Bight. If I may use a down-to-earth image for the sake of
. making my thought clearer, picture an ass drawing behind him a cart.
He attempts to get hold of a carrot which has been fastened at the end of
a stick which in turn has been tied to the shaft of the cart. Every effort
on the part of the ass to seize the carrot results in advancing the whole
apparatus and the cart itself, which always remains at the same distance
from the ass. Thus we run after a possible which our very running causes
to appear, which is nothing but our running itself, and which thereby is
by definition out of reach. We run toward ourselves and we are-due to
this very fact-the being which can not be reunited with itself. In one
sense the running is void of meaning since the goal is

is revealed as a being to-be-realized in so far
as this being is correlative with the possible-being which l1ack. The glass
of water appears as .about-to-be-drunk; that is, as the correlate of a thirst
grasped non-thetically and its very being as about to be satisfied. But
these descriptions, which all imply a relation to the future of the world,
will be clearer if we at present explain how the time of the world or
universal time is revealed to consciousness on the ground of the original
negation.

IV. THE TIME OF THE" WORLD

UNIVERSAL time comes into the world through the For-itself. The in-itself is not adapted to temporality precisely because it is in-itself and because temporality is the mode of unitary being in a being which is perpetually at a distance from itself for itself. The For-itself, on the contrary, is temporality, but it is not consciousness of temporality except when it produces itself in the relation "reflective-reflected-on." In· the unreflective mode the for-itself discovers temporality on being-that is, outside. Universal temporality is objective.

A. THE PAST

THE "this" does not appear as a present which later wiI have to become past and which before that was future. This inkwell the moment I perceive it already exists in the three temporal dimensions. In so far as I apprehend it as permanence-i.e., as essence-it is already in the future although I am not present to it in my actual presence but as about-to-come-to-myself. By the same token, I can not apprehend it except as having already been there in the world inasmuch as I was already there myself as presence. In this sense there exists no "synthesis of recognition" if we mean by that a progressive operation of identification which by successive organization of the "nows" would confer a duration on the thing perceived. The For-itself directs the explosion of its temporality against the whole length of the revealed in-itself as though against the length of an immense and monotonous wall of which it can not see the end.
I am that original negation which I have to be in the mode of not-yet and of already, beside the being which is what it is. If then we suppose a consciousness arising in a motionless world beside a unique being which is unchangeably what it is, this beingwill be revealed with a pastand a future of immutability which wiI necessitate no "operation" of a synthesis and which will be one with its very revelation. The operation would be necessary only if the For-itself had to retain and to constitute its own past by the same stroke. But due to the mere fact that the in-itself is its

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own past as also its own future, the revelation of the in-itself can only be temporalized. The "this" is revealed temporally not because it would be refracted across an a priori form of inner meaning but because it is revealed to a revelation of which the very being is te:nporalization. Nevertheless the a-temporality of being is represented in its very revelation; in so far as it is grasped through and in a temporality which temporalizes itself, the this appears originally as temporal; but in so far as it is what it is, it refuses to be its own temporality and merely reflects time. In addition it reflects the internal ekstatic relation-which is at the source of temporality-as a purely objective relation of exteriority. Permanence, as a compromise between non-temporal identity

and the ekstatic unity of temporalization,
will appear therefore as the pure slipping by of in-itself instants, little nothingnesses separated one from another and reunited by a relation of simple exteriority on the surface of a being which preserves an a-temporal immutability. It is not true therefore that the non-temporality of being escapes us; on the contrary, it is given in time, it provides the foundation for the mode of being of universal time.
In so far then as the For-itself "was',' what it is, the instrument or thing appears to it as having been already there. The For-itself can be presence to the this only as a presence which was; all perception is in-itself, and without any "operation" it is a recollection. Now what is revealed across the ekstatic unity of Past and Present is an identical being. It is not apprehended as being the same as the past and the present but as being it. Temporality is only a tool of vision. Yet this it which it is, the "this" already was. Thus the this appears as having a past. But it refuses to be this past; it only has it. Temporality in so far as it is grasped objectively is therefore a pure phantom, for it does not give itself as the temporality of the For-itself nO,r ;IS the temporality which the in-itself has to be. At the same time the transcendent Past, since it is in-itself by virtue of transcendence, can not be as that which the Present has to be; the Past is isolated in ,a phantom of Selbstandigkeit. And as each moment of the past isa "having-been Present," this isolation is pursued to the very interior of the Past. Consequently the unchangeable this is revealed across a flickering and an infinite parcelling out of phantom in-itselfs. This is how that glass or that table is revealed to me,. They do not endure; they are. Time flows over them.
Of course someone will object that I merely fail to see changes in the glass or table. But this is to introduce very inappropriately a scientific point of view. Such a point of view, which nothing justifies, is contradicted by our' very perccption. The pipe, the pencil, all these beings which are released entire in each one of their "profiles" and whose permanence is wholly indifferent to the multiplicity of profiles, are transcendent to all temporality even though they are revealed in temporality. The "thing" exists straightway as a "form;" that is, a whole which is not

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affected by any of the superficial parasitic variations which we can see on it. Each this is revealed with a law of being which determines its threshold, its level of change where it will cease to be what it is in order simply not to be. This law of being, which expresses "permanence," is an immediately revealed structure of the essence of the "this;" it determines a limit-of-potentiality in the "this"-that of disappearing from the world. We shall return to this point. Thus the For-itself apprehends temporality on being, as a pure reflection which plays on the surface of being without any possibility of modifying being. The scientist will fix this absolute, spectral, nihilating quality of time in a concept under the name of homogeneity. But the transcendent apprehension on the in-itself of the ekstatic unity of the temporalizing For-itself is effected as the apprehension of an empty form of temporal unity without any being which founds that unity by being it. Thus on the plane of

Present-Past, there appears that
curious unity -of the absolute dispersion which is external temporality. Here each before and each after is an "in-itself" isolated from others by its indifferent exteriority, and here these instants are reunited 'in the unity of one and the same being. And this common being or Time is nothing other than the very dispersion, conceived as necessity and substantiality. This contradictory nature could appear only on the double foundation of the For-itself and the In-itself. From this standpoint in so far as scientific reflection aims at hypostasizing the relation of exteriority, being will be conceived-i.e., thought of in emptiness-not as ~ transcendence aimed at across time but as a content which passes from instant into instant. Better yet it will be conceived as a multiplicity of contents, external to one another, and strictly resembling one another.

So far our description of universal temporality has been attempted under the hypothesis that nothing may come from being save its non-temporal immutability. But something does COme from being: what, fot lack of a better term, we shall call abolitions and apparitions. These apparitions and abolitions ought to be the object of a purely metaphysical elucidation, not an ontological one, for we can conceive of their necessity neither from the standpoint of the structures of being of the For-itself nor of those of the In-itself. Their existence is that of a contingent and metaphysical fact. We do not know exactly what comes from being in the phenomenon of apparition since this phenomenon is already the fact of a temporalized "this." Yet experience teaches us that there are various upsurges and annihilations of the "this." Moreover since we know that perception reveals the In-itself and outside the In-itself nothing, we can consider the in-itself as the· foundation of these upsurges and of these annihilations. In addition we see clearly that the principle of identity as the law of being of the in-itself requires that the abolition and the apparition be totally exterior to the in-itself which has appeared or been abolished, for otherwise the in-itself would at the same time both be and not

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be. The abolition can not be that falling away from being which is an end. Only the For-itself can know its falling away because it is to its itself its own end. Being, a quasi-affirmation in which the affirming is coated over by the affirmed, exists without any innedinitude in the peculiar tension of its "self-affirmation," Its "until then" is totally external to it. Thus the abolition does not involve the necessity of an after, which can be manifested only in a world and for an in-itself, but a quasi-after. This quasi-after can be expressed thus: being-in-itself can not effect the mediation between itself and its nothingness. Similarly apparitions are not adventures of the appearing being. That friority over itself which "adventure" would suppose can be found only in the For-itself, for which both apparition and end are inner adventures. Being is what it is. It is without "putting itself into being," without childhood or youth. ';hat which has appeared is not a novelty to itself; it is from the start being without any relation to a "before" which it would have to be as pure absence. Here again we find a quasi-succession; i.e., on the part of that which has appeared, there is

a complete exteriority in relation to its nothingness.
But in order for this absolute exteriority to be given in the form of the "there is," there must be already a world; that is, the upsurge of a For-itself. The absolute exteriority of the In-itself in relation to the In-itself is responsible for the fact that even the very nothingness which is the quasi-before of the apparition or the quasi-after of the abolition can find no place in the plenitude of being. It is only within the unity of a world and on the ground of a world that there can appear a tllis which was not or that there can be revealed that relation-of-absencc-of-rclation which is exteriority. The nothingness of being, which is priority in relation to an "appeared" which "was not," can come only retrospectively to a world by a For-itself which is its own nothingness and its own priority. Thus the upsurge and the annihilation of the this are ambiguous phenomena; here again what comes to being by the For-itself is a pure nothingness, the not-being-yet and the not-being-any-longer. The being which we are considering is not the foundation of it, nor the world as a totality apprehended before or after. On the other hand, in so far as the upsurge is revealed in the world by a For-itself which is its own before and its Own after, the apparition is given first as an adventure; we apprehend the tlJis, which has appeared as being already there in the world, as its own absence inasmuch as we ourselves were already present to a world from which it was absent. Thus the thing can arise from its own nothingness. Here, however, we are not dealing with a conceptual view of the mind but with an original structure of perception. The experiments of the Gestalt School show clearly that pure apparition is always grasped as a dynamic upsurge; the appearance comes on the run to being, on the ground of nothingness. At the same time we have here the origin of the "principle of causality." The ideal of causality is not the negation of the "appeared" as such, as

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someone like Meyerson would make it, nor is it the assigning of a permanent bond of exteriprity between two phenomena. The first causality is the apprehension of the "appeared" before it appears, as being already there in its own nothingness so as to prepare its apparition. Causality is simply the first apprehension of the temporality of the "appeared" as an ekstatic mode of being. But the adventurous character of the event, as the ekstatic constitution of the apparition, disintegrates in the very perception; t~;. b~fo~e at.Id the after ~re fi~ed in its nothi.ngness-in-itself, the "?f-peared In Its indIfferent self-IdentIty; the non-bemg of the "appeared'; In that prior instant is revealed as an indifferent plenitude of the being existing at that instant; the relation of causality disintegrates into apure relation of exteriority between· the "thises" prior to the "appeared" and the "appeared" its~f. Thus the ambiguity of apparition and of abolition comes from the fact that they are given, like the world, like space, like potentiality and instrumentality, like universal time itself in the form of totalities in perpetual disintegration.
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Such then is the past of the world-made of homogeneous instants connected one with another by a purely external relation. By means of its Past, the For-itself founds itself in the In-itself. In the Pas

t the For-itself,
now become In-itself, is revealed as being in the midst of the world:
it is; has lost its transcendence. And due to this fact its being is made
past in time; there is no difference between the Past of the For-itself and
the past of the world which was co-present with it except that the For-
itself has to be its own past. Thus there is only one Past, which is the past
of being or the objective Past in which I was. My past is past in the world,
belonging to the totality of past being, which I am, which I flee. This
means that there is a coincidence for one of the temporal dimensions be-
tween the ekstatic temporality which I have to be. and the time of the
world as a pure given nothingness. It is through the past that I belong to
universal temporality; it is through the present and the future that I es-
cape from it.

B. THE PRESENT

THE Present of the For-itself is presence to being, and as 'Such it is not.
But it is a revelation of being. The being which appears to Presence is
given as being in the Present. That is why the present is given paradoxi-
cally as not being at the moment when it is experienced and as being the
unique measure of Being in so far as it is revealed as being what it is in
the Present. Not that being does not extend beyond the present, but this
superabundance of being can be grasped only through the instrument
of apprehension which is the Past-that is, as that which is no longer. Thus
this book on my table is in the present and it was (identical with itself)

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in the Past. Thus the Present is revealed through original temporality as
universal being, and at the same time it is nothing-nothing more than
being; it is a slipping-past alongside being, pure nothingness.

The preceding observations would seem to indicate that nothing comes
from being to the present except its being. But this would be to forget
that being is revealed to the For-itself either as immobile or as in motion,
and that the two notions of motion and rest are in a dialectical relation.
Now motion can not be derived ontologically from the nature of the For-
itself nor from its fundamental relation to the In-itself, nor from what we
can discover originally in the phenomenon of Being. A world without mo-
tion would be conceivable. To be sure, we can not imagine the possibility
of a world without change, except by virtue of g purely formal possibility,
but change is not motion. Change is alteration of the quality of the this;
it is produced, as we have seen, in a block by the upsurge or disintegration
of a form. Motion, on the contrary, supposes the permanence of the
quiddity. If a this were to be transferred from one place to another and
during this transfer were to undergo a radical alteration of its being, this
alteration would negate the motion since there would no longer be any-
thing which was in motion. Motion is pure change of place affecting a
this which remains otherwise unaltered as is shown clearly enough by our
assumption of the homogeneity of space. Since motion could not be de-
duced from any essential characteristic of existents in presence, it was
denied by the Eleatic ontology; it compelled Descartes in his ontology
to take refuge in the famous "snap of the finger." Motion has the exact
value of a fact; it participates wholly in the complete contingency of being
and must be accepted as a given. Of course we shall soon see that a For-
itse

In a world, if motion is an accident
of being, motion and rest are indistinguishable. The arguments which are usually opposed to the most famous of the Eleatic paradoxes, that of Achilles and the Tortoise, have no bearing here. What good is it to object that the Eleatics have reckoned on the infinite division of space without equally taking into account that of time? The question here concerns neither position nor the instant, but being. We approach a correct conception of the problem when we reply to the Eleatics that they have considered not motion but the space which supports motion. But we are not limiting ourselves to pointing out the question without resolving it. What must be the being of the moving body in order for its quiddity to remain unchanged while in its being the moving body is distinct from a being at rest?
If we try to clarify our objections to Zeno's arguments, we establish that they originate in a certain naive conception of motion. We admit that

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the arrow "passes" at AB, but it does not seem to us that to pass a place is the equivalent of remaining there-i.e., of being there. Yet in this view we are guilty of serious confusion, for we consider that the moving object only passes AB (i.e., it never is there) and at the same time w.e continue to take for granted that in itself it is. Consequently the arrow simultaneously would be in itself and would not be at AB. This is the origin of the Eleatic Paradox: how could the arrow not be at AB since at AB it is? In other words in order to avoid the Eleatic paradox we must renounce the generally admitted postulate according to which being in motion preserves its being-in-itself. Merely to pass at AB is a being-of-passage. What does it mean to pass? It is simultaneousJy to be at a place and not to be there. At no moment can it be said that the being of the passage is here, without running the risk of abruptly stopping it there, but neither can it be said that it is riot, or that it is not there, or that it is elsewhere. Its relation with the place is not a relation of occupation. But we have seen earlier that the location of a "this" at rest was its relation of exteriority to the ground inasmuch as this relation can collapse into a multiplicity of external relations with other "thises" when the ground itself disintegrates into a multiplicity of figures.' The foundation of space
II .
is therefore the reciprocal exteriority which comes to being through the For-itself and whose origin is the fact that being is what it is. In a word it is being which defines its place by revealing itself to a For-itself as indifferent to other beings. This indifference is nothing but its very identity, its absence from ekstatic reality as it is apprehended by a For-itself which
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is already presence to other "thises."
By the very fact therefore that the this is what it is, it occupies a place, it is in a place-that is, it is put into relation by the For-itself with other
I,
thisesas having no relation with them. Space is the nothingness of rela-
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tion apprehended as relation by the being which is its own relation. The fact of passing by a place, instead of being there, can therefore be interpreted only in terms of being. This means that since place is founded by being, being is no longer sufficient to found its place. It merely outlines it; its relations of exteriority with other "thises" can

not be established by
the For-itself because the latter must establish those relations in terms of
:11
a "this" which is. However these relations could not be annihilated be-
cause the being in terms of which they are established is not a pure
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nothingness. The very "now" in which they are established is already
exterior to them; that is, simultaneously with their revelation, there are
already revealed new relations of exteriority of which the "this" considered
is the foundation and which are externallv related to the first. But this
continuous exteriority of spatial relations ~hich define the place of being
can find its foundation only in the fact that the this considered is exterior
to itself. In fact to say that the this passes by a place means that it is already
4 Ch. Three, secfion II.
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no longer there when it is still there; that is, in relation to itself it is not in
an ekstatic relation of being but in a pure relation of exteriority. Thus
there is "place" in so far as the "this" is revealed as exterior to other
"thises." And there is a passage at this place in.so far as being is. no lPnger
caught up in this exteriority but on the contrary is already exterior to it.
Thus motion is the being of a being which is exterior to itself. The only
metaphysical question which is posited on the occasion of motion is that
of exteriority to self. What should we understand by that?
In motion being changes into nothing when it passes from A to B. This
means that its quality, in so far as it represents the being which is revealed
as this to the For-itself, is not transformed into another quality. Motion
is in no way similar to becoming; it does not change the essence of the
quality; neither does it actualize the quality. The quality remains exactly
what it is; but its mode of being is changed. This red ball which rolls on
the billiard table does not cease to be red, but the ball is not this red which
it is in the same way now as it was the red when at rest. The red remains
suspended between abolition and permanence. In fact in so far as it is
already at B, it is exterior to what it was at A and there is an annihilation
of the red; but in so far as it rediscovers itself at C, beyond B, it is exterior
to that very annihilation. Thus through abolition it escapes being, and
through being it escapes abolition.
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Therefore a category of "thises" is encountered in the world which
have the peculiar property of never being without thereby becoming
nothingnesses. The only relation whieh the For-itself can originally appre-
hend on these thises is the relation of exteriority to self. For since the
exteriority is nothing, a being must exist which is to itself its own re-
lation in order that there may be "exteriority to self." In short it is impos-
sible for us to define in the pure terms of the In-itself what is revealed to a
For-itself as exteriority-to-self. That exteriority can be discovered only by
a being which is already to itself over there what it is here-that is, a con-
sciousness. This exteriority-to-seIf, which appears as a pure disorder of
being-that is, as the impossibility which exists for certain "thises" simul-
taneously to be themselves and to be their own nothingness-this must
be indicated by something which exists as a nothing in the world; that
is, as a substantiated nothing. Since exteriority-to-self is in no way
ekstatic, the rela

tion of the moving body to itself is a pure relation of
indifference and can be revealed only to a witness. It is an abolition which
can not be completed and an apparition which can not be completed.
This nothing which measures and signifies exteriority-to-self is the tra-
jectory, as the constitution of exteriority in the unity of a single being.
The trajectory is the line which is described-that is, an abrupt appear-
ance of synthetic unity in space, a counterfeit which collapses immediately
into the infinite multiplicity of exteriority. When the this is at rest,
space is: when it is in motion space is engendered or becomes. The

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trajectory never is, since it is nothing; it vanishes immediately into purely
external relations between different places; that is, in the simple exteriority
of indifference or spatiality. Motion has no more of being; it is the least-
being of a being which can neither arrive nor be abolished nor wholly be.
Motion is the upsurge of the exteriority of indifference at the very heart
of the in-itself. This pure vacillation of being is a contingent venture of
being. The For-itself can apprehend it only across the temporal ekstasis
and in an ekstatic permanent identification of the moving body with it-
self. This identification does not suppose any operation and in particular
no "synthesis of recognition;" for the For-itself it is only the unity of ek-
static being of the Past with the Present. Thus the temporal identification
of the moving body with itself across the constant ,positing of its own ex-
teriority causes the trajectory to reveal itself-that is, to cause space to arise
in the form of an evanescent becoming. By motion space is engendered
in time; motion extends the line as traced from externality to self. The
line vanishes at the same time as motion, and this phantom of the
temporal unity of space is founded continuously in non-temporal space-
that is, in the pure multiplicity of dispersion which is without becoming.
The For-itself in the present is presence to being. But the eternal iden-
tity of the permanent does not allow apprehending this presence as a
reflection (reflet) on things since in permanence nothing comes to dif-
ferentiate what is from what was. The present dimension of universal
time would therefore be inapprehensible if there were no motion. It is
motioa which in the pure present determines universal time. First because
universal time is revealed as present vacillation; already in the past it is no
longer anything but an evanescent line, like the wake of a ship which fades
away; in the future it is not at all, for it is unable to be its own project. It
is like the steady progression of a lizard on the wall. Moreover its being
has the inapprehensible ambiguity of the instant, for one could not say
either that it is or that it is not; in addition it no sooner appears than it is
already surpassed and exterior to itself.
Therefore universal time corresponds perfectly to the Present of the
For-itself: the exteriority to self of the being which can neither be or not
be returns to the For-itself an image-projected on the level of the In-
itself-of a being which has to be what it is not and to not-be what it is.
The whole difference lies in that which separates exteriority-to-self-
where being is not in order to be its own exteriority, but "is to-
be," rather, through the identification of an ekstatic witness-from

the
pure temporalizing ekstasis where being has to be what it is not. The
For-itself makes its present known to itself through that which moves;
it is its own present in simultaneity with actual motion; it is motion which
will be charged with realizing universal time, in so far as the For-
itself makes known to itself its own present through the present of the
moving body. This realization will give importance to the reciprocal ex-
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teriority of instants since the present of the moving body is defined-
because of the very nature of motion-as exteriority to its own past and
exteriority to that exteriority. The infinite division of time is founded in
that absolute exteriority.

C. THE FUTURE

THE original future is the possibility of that presence which I have to be
beyond the real to an in-itself which is beyond the real in-itself. My future
involves as a future co-presence the outline of a future world, and as we
have seen, it is this future world which is revealed to the For-itself which
I will be; it is not the true possibilities of the For-itself, for only the re-
flective regard can know these. Since my possibles are the meaning of
what I am and arise straightway as a beyond the in-itself to which I am
presence, the future of the in-itself which is revealed to my future is in
direct, strict connection with the real to which I am presence. The future
of the in-itself is the present in-itself modified, for my future is nothing
other than my possibilities of presence to an in-itself which I will have
modified. Thus the future of the world is revealed to my future. It is made
from the scale of possibilities which runs from simple permanence and
the pure essence of the thing on up to potencies. As soon as I fix the essence
of the thing, as soon as I apprehend it as table or inkwell, I am already
there in the future: first because its essence can only be a co-presence to
my further possibility of not-being-any-more-than-this-negation, and
second because the permanence and the very instrumentality of the table
or inkwell refer us to the future. We have sufficiently developed these
observations in preceding sections so that we need not dwell on them here.
What we wish to point out is only that everything, from the moment of
its appearance as an instrumental-thing, immediately houses certain of
its structures and properties in the future.

From the moment of the appearance of the world and of the "thises"
there exists a universal future. Yet we have aoted earlier that every future
"state" of the world remains strange to it in the full reciprocal exteriority
of indifference:There are certain futures in the world which are defincd by
chance and become autonomous probables, which are not probabilized
but which are as probables, as fully constituted nows, with their content
well determined but not yet realized. These futures belongto each "this"
or collection of "thises," but they are outside.

What than is the universal future? We must view it as the abstract con-
text of that hierarchy of equivalents which are the futures, a container
of reciprocal exteriorities which is itself exteriority, a sum of in-itselfs
which is itself in-itself. That is, whatever may be the probable which is to
prevail, there is and there will be a future. But due to this very fact, that
future, indifferent and external to the present and composed of "nows,"

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each one indifferent to the others and reunited by the substantiated relation of before-after (,in so far as this relation, emptied of its ekstatic character has no longer anything but the meaning of an external negation)- this future is a series of empty containers reunited with one another in the unity of dispersion. In this sense the future sometimes appears as an urgency and a threat in so far as I strictly tie the future of a this to its present by the project of my own possibilities beyond the co-present. But sometimes this threat disintegrates into pure exteriority, and I no longer apprehend the future except under the aspect of a pure formal container, indifferent to what fills it and homogeneous with space, as a simple law of exteriority. And finally sometimes the future is discovered as a nothingness in-itself, inasmuch as it is pure dispersion beyond being.
Thus the temporal dimensions, across which the non-temporal this is given to us with its very a-temporality, assume new qualities when they appear on the object: being-in-itself, objectivity, the exteriority of indifference, absolute dispersion. Time, in so far as it is revealed to an ekstatic temporality which temporalizes itself, is everywhere a self-transcendence and a referring of the before to the after and of the after to the before. But this self-transcendence in so far as it causes itself to be apprehended on the in-itself, does not have to be it; it is made-to-be in it. The cohesion of Timeis a pure phantom, the objective reflection (reflet) of the ekstatic project of the For-itself towards itself and the cohesion in motion of human Reality. But this cohesion has no raison d'etre. If Time is considered by itself, it immediately dissolves into an absolute multiplicity of instants which considered separately lose all temporal nature and are reduced purely and simply to the total a-temporality of the this. Thus Time is pure nothingness in-itself, which can seem to have a being only by the very act in which the For-itself overleaps it in order to utilize it. 111is being, however,. is that of a particular figure which is raised on the undifferentiated ground of time and which we call the lapse of time. In fact our first apprehension of objective time is practical: it is while being my possibilities beyond co-present being that I discover objective time as the worldly correlate of nothingness which separates me from my possible. From this point of view time appears as a finite, organized form in the heart of an indefinite dispersion. The lapse of time is the result of a compression of time at the heart of an absolute decompression, and it is the project of ourselves. toward our possibilities which realizes the compression. This compression of time is certainly a form of dispersion and of separation, for it expresses in the world the distance which separates me from myself. But on the other hand, since I project myself toward a possible only across,;m organized series of dependent possibles which are what I have to be in order to --, and since their non-thematic and non-positional revelation is given in the non-positional revelation of the major possible toward which I project myself, time is revealed to me as an ab-

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jective, temporal form, as an organized echeloning of probabilities. This objective form or lapse is like the tra

jectory of my act.
Thus time appears through trajectories. But just as spatial trajectories decompose and collapse into pure static spatiality,. so the temporal trajectory collapses as soon as it is not simply lived as that which objectively implies our expectation of ourselves. In fact the probables which are revealed to me tend naturally to be isolated as in-itself probables and to occupy a strictly separated fraction of objective time. Then the lapse of time disappears, and time is revealed as the shimmer of nothingness on the surface of a strictly a-temporal being.

v. KNOWLEDGE

THIS rapid outline of the revelation of the world to the For-itself enables us now to form certain conclusions. We shall grant to idealism that the being of the For-itself is knoweldge of being, but we must add that this knowledge has being. The identity of the being of the For-itself and of knowledge does not come from the fact that knowledge is the measure of being but from the fact that the For-itself makes known to itself what it is, through the in-itself; that is, from the fact that in its being it is a relation to being. Knowledge is nothing other than the presence of being to the For-itself, and the For-itself is only the nothing which realizes that presence. Thus knowledge is by nature ekstatic being, and because of that fact it is confused with the ekstatic being of the For-itself. The For-itself does not exist in order subsequently to know; neither can we say that it exists only in so far as it knows or is known, for this would be to make being vanish into an infinity regulate8 by particular bits of knowledge. Knowing is an absolute and primitive event; it is the absolute upsurge of the For-itself in the midst of being and beyond being, in terms of the being which it is not and as the negation of that being and a self nihilation. In a word, by a radical reversal of the idealist position, knowledge is reabsorbed in being. It is neither an attribute nor a function nor an accident of being; but there is only being. From this point of view it appears necessary to abandon the idealist position entirely, and in particular it becomes possible to hold that the relation of the For-itself to the In-itself is a fundamental ontological relation. At the end of this book we shall even be able to consider this articulation of the For-itself in relation to the In-itself as the perpetually moving outline of a quasi-totality which we can call Being. From the point of view of this totality the upsurge of the For-itself is not only the absolute event for the For-itself; it is also something which happens to the In-itself, the only possible adventure of the In-itself. In fact everything happens as if the For-itself by its very nihilation constituted itself as "consciousness of --"; that is, as if by its very transcendence it escaped that law of the In-itself in which the

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affinnation is pasted over by the affirmed. The For-itself by its self-negation becomes the affirmation of the In-itself. The intentional affirmation is like the reverse of the internal negation; there can be affirmation only by a being which is its own nothingness and of a being which is not the affirming being. But then in the quasi-totality of Being, affinnation happens to the In-itself; it is theeadventure of the In-itself to be aflirmed. This affirmation which could not be effected as the affinnat

ion of self by the In-
itself without destroying its being-in-itself, happens to the In-itself as the affirmation is realized by the For-itself. The affirmation is like a passive ekstasis of the In-itself which leaves the in-itself unchanged yet which is achieved in the in-itself and from the standpoint of the in-itself. All this happens as if the For-itself had a Passion to lose itself in order that the affirmation "world" might come to the In-itself. Of course this affirmation exists only for the For-itself; it is the For-itself itself and disappears with it. But it is not in.the For-itself, for it is an ekstasis. If the For-itself is one of its terms (the affirming), then the other term, the In-itself, is really present in it. The world'which I discover exists outside on being.
To realism, on the other hand, we shall grant that it is being which is present to consciousness in knowledge and that the For-itself adds nothing to the In-itself except the very fact that there is In-itself; that is, the affirmative negation. Indeed we have undertaken the task of showing that the world and the instrumental-thing, space and quantity, and universal time are all pure hypostasized nothingnesses which in no way modify the pure being which is revealed through them. In this sense everything is given, everything is present to me without distance and in its complete reality. Nothing of what I see comes from me; there is nothing outside what I see or what I could see. Being is evcrywhere around me; it scems that I can touch it, grasp it; representation, as a psychic event, is a pure invention of philosophers. But from this being which "invests me" on every side and from which nothing separates me, I am separated precisely by nothing; and this nothing because it is nothingness is impassable. "There is" being because I am the negation of being, and worldliness, spatiality, quantity, instrumentality, temporality-all come into being only because I am the negation of being. These add nothing to being but are the pure, nihilated conditions of the "there is"; they only cause the "there is" to be realized. But these conditions which are nothing separate me more radically from being than prismatic distortions, across which I might still hope to discover being. To say that there is being is nothing, and yet it is to effect a total metamorphosis-since there is being only for a For-itself. It is not in its own quality that being is relative to the For-itself, nor in its being, and thereby we escape from Kantian relativism. Being is relative to the for-itself in its "being there" since the For-itself in its internal negation affinns what can not be affinned, knows being such as it is when the "such as it is" can not belong to being. In this sense I!"

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the For-itself is immediate presence to being, and yet at the same time it slips in as an infinite distance between itself and being. This is because knowing has for its ideal being-what-one-knows and for its original structure not-being-what-is-known. Worldliness, spatiality, etc., only cause this not-being to be expressed. Thus I rediscover myself everywhere between myself and being as the nothing which is not being.
The world is human. We can see the very particular position of consciousness: being is everywhere, opposite me, around me; it weighs down on me, it besieges me, and I am perpetually referred from bein

g to being;
that table which is there is being and nothing more; that rock, that tree, that landscape-being and nothing else. I want to grasp this being and I no longer find anything but myself. This is because knowledge, intermediate between being and non-being, refers me to absolute being if I want to make knowledge subjective and refers me to myself when I think to grasp the absolute. The very meaning of knowledge is what it is not and is not what it is; for in order to know being such as it is, it would be nec~ssary to·be that being. But there is this "such as it is" only because I am noUhe being which I know; and if I should become it, then the "such as it is" would vanish and could no longer even be thought. We are not dealing here either with scepticism-which supposes precisely that the such as it is belongs to being-nor with relativism. Knowledge puts us in the presence of the absolute, and there is a truth of knowledge. But this truth, although releasing to us nothing more and nothing less than the absolute, remains strictly human.
Perhaps some may be surprised that we have treated the problem of knowing without raising the question of the body and the senses or even Once referring to it. It is not my purpose to misunderstand or to ignore the role of the body. But what is important above all else, in ontology as elsewhere, is to observe strict order in discussion. Now the body, whatever may be its function, appears first as the known. We can not therefore refer knowledge back to it or discuss it before we have defined knowing, nor can we derive knowing in its fundamental structure from the body in any way or manner whatsoever. Furthermore the body-our body-has for its peculiar characteristic the fact that it is essentially that which is known by the OtllCr. What I know is the body of another, and the essential facts which I know concerning my own body come from the way in which others see it. Thus the nature of my body refers me to the existence of others and to my being-for-others. I discover with it for human reality another mode of existence as fundamental as being-for-itself, and this I shall call being-for-others.1f I want to describe in an exhaustive manner the relation of man to being, I must now attempt the study of this new structure of my being-the For-others. Within one and the same upsurge the being of human reality must be for-itself-for-others.

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CHAPTER ONE
The Existence of Others
I. THE PROBLEM
WE have described human reality from the standpoint of negating conduct and from the standpoint of the cogito. Following this lead we have discovered that human realityis-for-itself. Is this all that it is? Without going outside our attitude of reflective description, we can encounter modes of consciousness which seem, even while themselves remaining strictly in for-itself, to point to a radically different type of ontological structure. This ontological structure is mine; it is in relation to myself as subject that I am concerned about myself, and yet this concern (for-myself) reveals to me a being which is my being without being-for-me. Consider for example shame. Here we are dealing with a mode of consciousness which has a structure identical with all those which we have previously described. It is a non-positional self-consciousness, conscious (of) itself as shame; as such, it is an example of what the Germans c

all
'·ErIebnis, and it is accessible to reflection. In addition its structure is intentional; it is a shameful apprehension of something and this something is me. I am ashamed of what I am. Shame therefore realizes an intimate relation of myself to myself. Through shame I have discovered an aspect of my being. Yet although certain complex forms derived from shame can appear on the reflective plane, shame is not originally a phenomenon of . reflection. In,fact no"matter, what results one· can obtain in -solitude by the religious practice of shame, it is in its primary structure shame before somebody. I have just made an awkward or vulgar gesture. This gesture clings to me; I neither judge it nor blame it. I simply live it. I realize it in the mode of for-itself. But now suddenly I raise my head. Somebody was there and has seen me. Suddenly I realize the vulgarity of my gesture, and I am ashamed. It is certain that my shame is not reflective, for the presence of another in my consciousness, even as a cata-

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lyst, is incompatible with the reflective attitude; in the field of my reflection I can never meet with anything but the consciousness which is mine. But the Other is the indispensable mediator between myself and me. I am ashamed of myself as I appear to the Other.
By the mere appearance of the Other, I am put in the position of passing judgment on myself as on an object, for it is as an object that I appear to the Other. Yet this object which has appeared to the Other is not an empty image in the mind of another. Such an image in fact, would be imputable wholly to the Other and so could not "touch" me. I could feel irritation, or anger before it as before a bad portrait of myself which gives to my expression an ugliness or basen~s which I do not have, but I could not be touched to the quick. Shame is by nature recognition. I recognize that I am as the Other sees me. There is however no question of a comparison between what I am for myself and what I am for the Other as if I found in myself, in the mode of being of the For-itself, an equivalent of what I am for the Other. In the first place this comparison is not encountered in us as the result of a concrete psychic operation. Shame is an immediate shudder which runs through me from head to foot without any discursive preparation. In addition the comparison is impossible; I am unable to bring about any relation between what I am in the intimacy of the For-Itself, without distance, without recoil, without perspective, and this unjustifiable being-in-itself which I am for the Other. There is no standard here, no table of correlation. Moreover the very notion of vulgarity implies an inter-monad relation. Nobody can be vulgar all alone1
Thus the Other has not only revealed to me what I was; he has established me in a new type of being which can support new qualifications. This being was not in me potentially before the appearance of the Other, for it could not have found any place in the For-itself. Even if some power had been pleased to endow me with a body wholly constituted before it should be for-others, .still my vulgarity and my awkwardness could not lodge there potentially; for they are meanings and as such they surpass the body and at the same time refer to a witness capable of understanding them and to the totality of my human reality. But this new being which appears

for the other does not reside in the Other; I am responsible for
it as is shown very well by the education system which consists in making
children ashamed of what they are.
Thus shame is shame of oneself before the Other; these two structures
are inseparable. But at the same time I need the Other in order to realize
fully all the structures of my being. The For-itself refers to the For-others.
Therefore if we wish to grasp in its totality the relation of man's being to
being-in-itself, we can not be satisfied with the descriptions outlined in
the earlier chapters of this work. We must answer two far more formid-

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2.2.3
THE EXISTENCE OF OTHERS
able questions: first that of the existence of the Other, then that of the
relation of my being to the being of the Other.
II. THE REEF OF"SOLIPSISM
IT is strange that the problem of Others has never truly disturbed the
realists. To the ext~nt that the realist takes everything as given, doubtless
it seems to him that the Other is given. In the midst of the real what is
more real than the Other? The Other is a thinking substance of the same
essence as I am, a substance which will not disappear into primary and
secondary qualities, and whose essential structure I find in myself. Yet
for all that realism attempts to account for knowledge by au action of
the world upon the thinking substance, it has not been concerned with
establishing an immediate reciprocal action of thinking substances upon
each other. It is through the mediae)' of the world that they communicate.
My body as a thing in the world and the Other's body are the necessary
intermediaries between the Other's consciousness and mine. The Other's
soul is therefore separated from mine by all the distance which separates
first my soul from my body, then my body from the Other's body, and
finally the Other's body from his soul. And if it is as yet not certain that
the relation of the For-itself to the body is an external relation (we shall
have to deal with this problem later), at least it is evident that the rela-
tion of my body to the Other's body is a relation of pure, indifferent
exteriority. If the souls are separated by their bodies, they are distinct
as this inkwcll is distinct from this book; that is, we can not conceive of
the immediate presence of the one in the other. And even if we admit that
my soul can be immediately present in the Other's body, I still have to
overcome all the density of a body before I touch his soul. Therefore if
realism bases its certitude upon the presence "in person" of the spatial-
temporal thing in my consciousness, it can not lay claim to the same
evidence for the reality of the Other's soul since by this very admission,
the Other's soul docs not give itself "in person" to mine. It is an absence,
a meaning; the body points to it without delivering it. In short, in a phi-
losophy based on intuition, there is provided no intuition of the soul of
the Other. But if we are not to make a mere play on words, this means
that rC'dlism provides no place for the intuition of the Other. It would be
of no use to say that at least the Other's body is given to us and that this
body is a certain presence of the Other or of a part of the Other. It is true
that the body belongs to the totality which we cali "human reality" as one
of its structures. But to be exact the body is the body of a man only in so
far as its exists in the indissoluble unity of th

is totality"just as the organ
is a living organ only in the totality of the organism. Realism in taking this position and presenting us with a body not enveloped in human totality

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but apart, like a stone or a tree or a piece of wax, has killed the body as surely as the physiologist who with his scalpel separates a piece of flesh from the totality of the living being. It is not the Other's body which is present to the realist intuition but a body, a body which doubtless has particular aspects and a particular ~~LS but which belongs nevertheless to the great class of bodies. If it is true that for a spiritual realism, the soul is easier to know than the body, still the body will be easier to know than the Other's soul.

To tell the truth, the realist is not much concerned with this problem; that is because he takes the existence of others as certain. This is why the realistic and positivistic psychology of the nineteenth century, taking for granted the existence of my fellow-man, occupied itself exclusively with establis~ing the ways by which I know this existence and read upon the body th~ nuances of a consciousness which is strange to me. The body, it will be said, is an object whose ~~LS demands a particular interpretation. The hypothesis which gives the best account of its behavior is that of a consciousness which is analogous to my own consciousness and whose various emotions the body reflects. It remains to explain how we arrive at this hypothesis. We will be told at one time that it is by analogy with what I know of myself and again that it is experience which teaches us, for example, to interpret the sullden reddening of a face as the forewarning of blows and angry cries. It will be freely admitted that this procedure can only give us a probable knowledge. It remains always possiblel that the Other is only a body. If animals are machines, why shouldn't the man whom I see pass in the street be one? What I apprehend on this face is nothing but the effect of certain muscular contractions, and they in turn are only the effect of a nervous impulse of which I know the course. Why not reduce the ensemble of thcse reactions to simple or conditioned reo flexes? But the majority of psychologists remain convinced of the existence of the Other as a total reality of the same structure as their own. For them the existence of others is certain, and the knowledge which we have of them is probable. We can see here the sophistry of realism. Actually we ought to reverse the terms of this proposition and recognize that if the Other is accessible to us only by means of the knowledge which we have of him, and it this knowledge is only conjectural, thcn the existence of the Other is only conjectural, and it is the role of critical reflection to determine its exact degree of probability. Thus by a curious reversal, the realist because he has posited the reality of the external world, is forced to return to idealism when he confronts the existence of others. If the body is a real object really acting on thinking substance, the Other becomes a pure representation, whose esse is a simple percipi; that is, one whose existence is measured by the knowledge which we have of it. The more recent

1 The French reads probable, which I feel certain must be an error. Tr.

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theories of Einfiihlung, of sympathy, and

of forms serve only tb perfect
the description of our ways of making the Other present, but they do not put the debate on its true ground: that is, the Other is first perceived or he appears in experience as a particular form before all habitude; and in the absence of any analogous inference the fact remains that the object, signifying and perceived, the expressive form refer purely and simply to a human totality whose existence remains purely and simply conjectural.
If realism thus refers us to idealism, is it not advisable to adopt immediately the perspective of critical idealism? Since the Other is "my representation," is it not better to question this representation at the heart of a system which reduces the ensemble of objects to a connected grouping of representations and which measures all existence by the knowledge which I have of it?
We shall, however, find little help in the Kantians. In fact they, preoccupied with establishing the universal laws of subjectivity which are the same for all, never dealt with the question of persons. The subject is only the common essence of these persons; it would no more allow us to detcrmine the multiplicity of persons than the essence of man, in Spinoza's system, permits one to determine that of concrete men. At first then it seems that Kant placed the problem of others among those matters which were not within the province of his critique. However let us look more closely. The Other as such is given in our experience; he is an object and a particular object. Kant adopted the point of view of the pure subject in order to determine the conditions of possibility not only for an object in general but for the various categories of objects: the physical object, the mathematical object, the beautiful or ugly object, and the one which presents teleological characteristics. In this connection Kant has been criticized for lacunas in his work, and some-following Dilthey, for example"':""have wished to establish the conditions of possibility for the historical object-i.e., to attempt a critique of historical reason. Similarly if it is true that the Other represents a particular type of object which is discovered to our experience, then it is necessary even within the perspective of a rigorous Kantianism to ask how the knowledge of the Other is possible; that is, to establish the conditions of possibility for the experience involving others.
Actually it would be completely erroneous to put the problem of the Other and that of noumenal realities on the same footing. Of course, if certain "Others" exist and if they are similar to me, the question of their intelligible existence can be posed for them as that of my noumenal existence is posed for me; to be sure also, the same reply will be valid for them and for me: this noumenal existence can only be thought, not conceived. But when I aim at the Other in my daily experience, it is by no means a noumenal reality that I am aiming at; neither do I apprehend or aim at my intelligible reality when I obtain knowledge of my emotions

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or of my empirical thoughts. The Other is a phenomenon which refers to other phenomena...-to a phenomenon-of-anger which the Other feels toward me, to a series of thoughts which appear to him as phenomena of his inner sense. What I aim at in the Other is nothing more than what I find in myself. But these phenomena are radical

ly distinct from all other
phenomena.
In the first place the appearance of the Other in my experience is manifested by the presence of organized forms such as gestures and expression, acts and conducts. These organized forms refer to an organizing unity which on principle is located outside of our experience. The Other's anger in so far as it appears to his inner sense and is by nature refused to my apperception, gives the meaning and is perhaps the cause of the series of phenomena which I apprehend in my experience under the name of expression or gestures. The Other as the synthetic unity of his experiences and as both will and passion comes to organize my experience. It is not a question of the pure and simple action of an unknowable noumenon upon my sensibility but of the constitution of connected groups of phenomena within the field of my experience by a being who is not me. These phenomena, unhi<e all others, do not refer to possible experiences but to experiences which on principle are outside my experience and belong to a system which is inaccessible to me. But on the other hand, the condition of possibility for all experience is that the subject organize his impressions into a conn~cted system. Thus we find in things "only what we have put into them." The Other therefore can not without contradiction appear to us as organizing our experience; there would be in this an over-determination of the phenomenon.
Can we make use of causality here? This question is well designed to show the ambiguous character of the Other in a Kantian philosophy. Causality could in fact link only phenomena to each other. But to be exact, the anger which the Other feels is one phenomenon, and the furious expression which I perceive is another and different phenomenon. Can there be a causal connection between them? This would conform to their phenomenal nature, and in this sense I am not prevented from considering the redness of Paul's face as the effect of his anger; this is a part of my ordinary affirmation. But on the other hand, causality has meaning only if it linksthe phenomena of one and the same experience and contributes to constituting that experience. Can it serve as a bridge between two experiences which are radically separated? Here we must note that· by using causality in this capacity I shall make it lose its nature as an ideal unification of empirical appearances. Kantian causality is a unification of the moments of my time in the form of irreversibility. Now are we to admit that it will unify my time with that of the Other? What temporal relation is to be established between the decision to express himself, which is a phenomenon appearing in the woof of the Other's experience, and the

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expression which is a phenomenon of my experience? Is it simultaneity? Succession? But how can an instant of my time be in a relation of simultaneity or of succession with an instant in the Other's time? Even if a preestablished harmonyi-which is, however, incomprehensible in a Kantian perspective) could effect a correspondence of instant with instant in the two times considered, they would still remain two times unrelated since for each of them the unifying synthesis of moments is an act of the subject. The universality of time with Kant is only the universality of a concept; it means' only that each temporality must possess a definite
struc

ture, that the conditions of possibility for a temporal experience are valid for all temporalities. But this identity of temporal essence does not prevent the incommunicable diversity of times any more than the identity of the essence of man prevents the incommunicable diversity of human consciousnesses. Thus since a relation between consciousnesses is by nature unthinkable, the concept of the Other can not constitute our experience; it must be placed along with teleological concepts among the regulative concepts. The Other therefore belongs to the category of "as if." The Other is an a priori hypothesis with no justification save the unity which it permits to operate in our experience, an hypothesis which can not be thought without contradiction. It is possible, so far as the pure exercise of knowledge is concerned, to conceive of the action of an intelligible reality on our sensibility, but it is not even thinkable that a phenomenon whose reality is strictly relative to its appearance in the Other's experience should reaIly act on a phenomenon of my experience. Even if we admitted that the action of an intelligible reality should be exerted simultaneously on my experience and on that of the Other (in the sense that the intelligible reality would affect the Other to the, same degree. that it would affect me), it would still remain radically impossible to establish or even to postulate a parallelism and a table of correlation between two systems which are spontaneously constituted.2 But on the other hand does the quality of a regulative concept really fit the concept of the Other? It is not a question of establishing a stronger unity between the phenomena of my experience in the manner of a purely formal concept which would only allow the discovery of details in the objects ~hich appear to me. It is not a question of a kind of a priori hypothesis not extending beyond the field of my experience but inspiring new investigation within the very limits of this field. The perception of the Other-as-object refers to a coherent system of representations, and this system is not mine. This means that in my experience the Other is not a phenomenon which refers to my experience but that on principle he refers himself to phenomena located outside of all experience which is

2 Even if we agreed to adopt the Kalltian metaphysics of nature and the catalogue of principles which Kant has drawn up, it would be possible to conceive of radically dif. ferent types of physics based on these principles.

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possible for me. Of course the concept of the Other allows discoveries and predictions within the heart of my system of representations, a contraction in the web of phenomena: thanks to the hypothesis of Others I can anticipate this gesture as coming from that expression. But this concept is not presented as being like those scientific notions (imaginary ones, for example) Or like instruments which intervene in the course of a physical calculation, which are not presented in the empirical statement of the problelp and which are eliminated from the results. The concept of the Other is not purely instrumental. Far from the concepts existing in order to serve to unify phenomena, the trut.h is that certain categories of phenomena seem to exist only for the concept of the Other.

The existence of a system of meanings and experiences radically dis-

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tinct from

my own is the fixed skeletal framework indicated by diverse series of phenomena in their very flow. This framework, which on principle is external to my experience, is gradually filled in. We can never apprehend the relation of that Other to me and he is never given, but gradually we constitute him as a concrete object. He is not the instrument which serves to predict an event in my experience, but there are events in my experience which serve to constitute the Other qua Other; that is, as a .system of representations out of reach, as a concrete and knowable object. What I constantly aim at across my experiences are the Other's feelings, the Other's ideas, the Other's volitions, the Other's character. This is because the Other is not only the one whom I see but the one who sees me. I aim at the Other in so far as he is a connected system of experiences out of reach in which I figure as one object among others. But to the extent that I strive to determine the concrete nature of this system of representations and the place which I occupy there as an object, I radically transcend the field of my experience. I am concerned with a series of phenomena which on principle can never be accessible to my intuition, and consequently I exceed the lawful limits of my knowledge. I seek to bind together experiences which will never be my experiences, and consequently this work of construction and unification can in no way serve for the unification of my own experience. To the extent that the Other is, an absence he escapes nature. Therefore the Othcr can not be described as a regulative concept. Of course Ideas like the World,for example, also on principle escape my experience, but at least they are referred back to it and have meaning only through it. The Other, on the contrary, is presented in a certain sense as the radical negation of my experience, since he is the one for whom I am not subject but object. Therefore as the subject of. knowledge I strive to determine as object the subject who denies my character as subject and who himself determines me as object.

Thus the Other within the perspective of idealism can be considered neither as a constitutive concept nor as a regulative concept of my knowl-

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edge. He is conceived as real, and yet I can not conceive of his real relation to me. I construct him as object, and yet he is never released by intuition. I posit him as subject, and yet it is as the object of my thoughts that I consider him. There remain then only two solutions for the idealist: either to get rid of the concept of the Other completely and prove that he is useless to the constitution of my experience, or to affirm the real existence of the Other-that is, to posit a real, extra-empirical communication between consciousnesses.

The first solution is known by the name of solipsism. Yet if it is formulated in conformity with its denomination as the affirmation of my ontological solitude, it is a pure metaphysical hypothesis, perfectly unjustified and gratuiolls; for it amounts to saying that outside of me nothing exists and so it goes beyond the limits of the field of my experience. But if it is presented more modestly as a refusal to leave the solid ground of experience and as a positive attempt not to make use of the concept of the Other, then it is perfectly logical; it remains on the level of critical positivism, and alth6ughi

t is opposed to the deepest inclinations of our
being, it derives its justification from the contradictions of the notion of Others considered in the idealist perspective. A psychology which wants to be exact and objective, like the "behaviorism," of Watson, is really only solipsism as a wo.rking hypothesis. It will not try to deny within the field of my experience the presence of objects which we shall call "psychic beings" but will merely practice a sort of hroXTl3 with respect to the existence of systems of representations organized by a subject and located outside my experience.

Confronted with this solution, Kant and the majority of post-Kantians continue to affirm the existence of the Other. But they can refer only to common sense or to our deep-rooted tendencies to justify their affirmation. We know that Schopenhauer speaks of the solipsist as "a madman shut up up in an impregnable blockhouse." What a confession of impotence! It is in fact by this position with regard to the existence of the Other that we suddenly explode the structure of idealism and fall back into a metaphysical realism. First of ~ll by positing a plurality of closed systems which can communicate only through the outside, we implicitly re-establish the notion of substance. Of course these systems are non-substantial since they are systems of representation. But their reciprocal· exteriority is an exteriorityin itself; it is without being known; we do not even apprehend the effects with any certainty since the solipsist hypothesis remains always possible. We are not limited to positing this nothingness in-itself as an absolute fact; indeed it is not relative to our knowledge of the Other; rather it conditions our knowledge of the Other. Therefore even. if consciousnesses are only pure· conceptual connections of phenomena, even if the rule of their existence is the percipere and the percipi, S Correction for b·ox". Tr.

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the fact still remains that the multiplicity of these relational systems is a multiplicity in-itself and that it immediately transforms them each one into a system in-itself: In addition, if I posit the notion that my experience of the Other's anger /has as a correlate in another system a subjective experience of anger, I reinstate the system of the true image which Kant was especially concerned to get rid of. To be sure, we are dealing with a relation of agreement between the two phenomena-the anger perceived in the gestures and signs and the anger apprehended as a phenomenal reality of inner sense-and not with a relation between a phenomenon and a thing-in-itself. But the fact remains that the criterion of truth here is the conformity of thought to its object, not the agreement of representations with each other. In fact precisely because all recourse to the noumenon is here removed, the phenomenon of the anger felt is to that of the anger established as the objective real is to its image. The problem is indeed one of adequate representation since there is a real and a mode of apprehension of this real. If we were dealing with the problem of my own anger, I could in fact consider its subjective manifestations and its physiological objectively discernible manifestations as two series of the effects of a single cause without having one of the series represent the truth of the anger or its reality and the' other only its effect or its image.

But if one
of the series of the phenomena resides in the Other and the other series in me, then the one series functions as the reality of the other series, and the realist scheme of truth is the only one which can be applied here. Thus we abandoned the realist solution of the problem only because it necessarily resulted in idealism; we deliberately placed ourselves within the idealist perspective and thereby gained nothing because, conversely, to the extent that idealism rejects the solipsistic hypothesis, it results in a dogmatic and totally unjustified realism. Let us see if we can understand this abrupt inversion of doctrines and if we can derive from this paradox some information which will facilitate a correct position with respect to the question.

At the origin of the problem of the existence of others, there is a fundamental presupposition: others are the Other, that is the self which is not myself. Therefore we grasp here a negation as the constitutive structure of the being-of-others. The presupposition common to both idealism and realism is that the constituting negation is an external negation. The Other is the one who is not me and the one who I am not. This not indicates a nothingness as a given element of separation between the Other and myself. Between the Other and myself there is a nothingness of separation. This nothingness does not derive its origin from myself nor from the Other, nor is it a reciprocal relation between the Other and myself. On the contrary, as a primary absence of relation, it is originally the foundation of all relation between the Other and me. This is because the Other appears to me empirically on the occasion of the perception

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of a body, and this body is an in-itself external to my body; the type of relation which unites and separates these two bodies is a spatial relation, the relation of things which have no relation among themselves, pure exteriority in so far as it is given. The realist who believes that he apprehends the Other through his body considers therefore that he is separated from the Other as one body from another body, which means that the ontological meaning of the negation contained in the judgment, "I am not Paul," is of the same type as that of the negation contained in the judgment, "The table is not the chair." Thus since the separation of consciousnesses is attributable to the bodies, there is a sort of original space between diverse consciousnesses; that is, precisely a given nothingness, an absolute distance passively experienced. Idealism, to be sure, reduces my body and the Other's body to objective systems of representation. For Schopenhauer my body is nothing but the "immediate object." But this view does not thereby suppress the absolute distance between consciousnesses. A total system of representations-i.e., each monad-can be limited only by itselbnd so can not enter into relation with what is not it. The knowing subject can neither limit another subject nor cause itself to be limited by another subject. It is isolated by its positive plenitude, and consequently between itself and another equally isolated system there is preserved a spatial separation as the very type of exteriority. Thus it is still space which implicitly separates my consciousness from the Other's. Even so it must be added that the idealist without being aware of it is resorting to a "thi

rd man" in order to effect the appearance of this
external negation. For as we have seen, every external relation inasmuch as it is not constituted by its very terms, requires a witness to posit it. Thus for the idealist as for the realist One conelusion is imposed: due to the fact that the Other is revealed to us in a spatial world, we are separated from the Other by a real or ideal space.

This presupposition entails a serious consequence: jf my relation to the Other must in fact be in the mode of indifferent exteriority, then I can not in my being be affected by either the upsurge or the abolition of the Other any more than an In-itself can be affected by the apparition or the disappearance of another In-itself. Consequently since the Other can not act on my being by means of his being, the only way that he can reveal himself to me is by appearing as an object to my knowledge. But it must be understood by this that I must constitute the Other as the unification which my spontaneity imposes upon a diversity of impressions; that is, that I am the one who constitutes the Other in the field of his experience. Therefore the Other can be for me only an image in spite of the fact that the whole theory of knowledge which I have erected aims at rejecting this notion of image. Only a witness external both to myself and to the Other could compare the image with the model and decide whether it is a true one. Moreover this witness in order to be authorized

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could not in turn maintain a relation of exteriority with both the Other and myself, for otherwise he would know us only by images. Within the ekstatic unity of his being, he would have to be simultaneously here upon me as the internal negation of myself and over there upon the Other as the internal negation of the Other.

Thus the recourse to God, which we find in Leibniz, is purely and simply a recourse to the negation of interiority; it is concealed in the theological notion of creation: God at the same time is and is not both myself and the Other since he creates us. He must of necessity be myself in'order to apprehend my reality without intermediary and with apodictic evidence, and yet it is necessary that he not be me in order that he may preserve his impartiality as witness and be able over there both to be and not be the Other. The image of creation is the most adequate here since in the creative act I look into the very heart of what I create-for what I create is me-and yet what I create opposes itself to me by closing in on itself in an affirmation of objectivity. Thus the spatializing presupposition does not leave us any choice: it must either resort to God or fall into a probabilism which leaves the door open to solipsism.

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\ . But this conception of a God who is his creatures makes us fall into a new dilemma: this is the difficulty presented by the problem of substances in post-Cartesian thought. If God is I and if he is the Other, then what guarantees my own existence? If creation is held to be continuous, I remain always suspended between a distinct existence and a pantheistic fusion with the Creator Being. If Creation is an original act and if I am shut up against God, then nothing any longer guarantees my existence to God; he is now united to me only by a relation of exteriority, as the sculptor is related to the finished statue, and once again he can know me only throu

gh images. Under these conditions the notion of God while revealing to us the internal negation as the only possible connection between consciousnesses, shows the concept's total inadequacy: God is neither necessary nor sufficient as a gurantee of the Other's existence. Furthermore God's existence as the intermediary between me and the Other already presupposes the presence of the Other to me in an internal connection; for God, being endowed with the essential qualities of a Mind, appears as the quintessence of the Other, and he must be able to maintain an internal connection with myself in order for a real foundation of the Other's existence to be valid for me. It seems therefore that a positive theory of the Other's existence must be able simultaneously to avoid solipsism and to dispense with a recourse to God if it envisages my original relation to the Other as an internal negation; that is, as a negation which posits the original distinction between the Other and myself as being such that it determines me by means of the Other and determines the Other by means of me. Is it possible to look at the question from this point of view?

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III. HUSSERL, HEGEL, HEIDEGGER

THE philosophy of the nineteenth and twentieth centuries seems to have understood that once myself and the Other are considered as two separate substances, we cannot escape solipsism; any union of these substances must in fact be held to be impossible. That is why the examination of modern theories reveals to us an attempt to seize at the very heart of the consciousness a fundamental, transcending connection with the Other which would be constitutive of each consciousness in its very upsurge. But while this philosophy appears to abandon the postulate of the external negation, it nevertheless preserves its essential consequence; that is, the affirmation that my fundamental connection with the Other is realized through knowledge.

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When Husserl in his Cartesian Meditations and in Formal and Transcendental Logic attempts to refute solipsism, hcbelieves that he can succced by showing that a referral to the Other is the indispensible condition for the constitution of a world. Without going into the details of his theory, we shall limit ourselves to" indicating his general position. For Husserl the world as it is revealed to consciousness is inter-monadic. The Other is present in it not only as a particular concrete and empirical appearance but as a permanent condition of its unity and of its richness. Whether I consider this table or this tree or this bare wall in solitude or with companions, the Other is always there as a layer of constitutive meanings which belong to the very object which I consider; in short, he is the veritable guarantee of the object's objectivity. And since our psychophysical self is contemporary with the world, forms a part of the world, and falls with the world under the impact of the phenomenological reduction, the Other appears as necessary to the very constitution of this self. If I am to doubt the existence of my friend Pierre or of others in general, then inasmuch as this existence is on principle outside my experience, I must of necessity doubt also my concrete being, my empirical reality as a professor having this or that tendency, these habits, this particular character. There is no privilege for my self: my empirical Ego and the Other's

empirical Ego appear in the world at the same time. The general meaning of "Others" is necessary to the constitution of each one of these "Egos."Thus each object far from being constituted as for Kant, by a simple relation to the subject, appears in my concrete experience as polyvalent; it is given originally as possessing systems of reference to an indefinite plurality of consciousnesses; it is on the table, on the wall that the Other is revealed to me as that to which the object under consideration is perpetually refcrred-as well as on the occasion of the concrete appearances of Pierre or Paul.

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To be sure, these views show progress over the classical positions. It is undeniable that the instrumental-thing from the moment of its dis-

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covery refers to a plurality of For-itselfs. We shall have to return to this point. It is also certain that the meaning of "the Other" can not come from the experience nor from a reasoning by analogy effected on the occasion of the experience; on the contrary, it is in the light of the concept of the Other that the experience is interpreted. Does that mean that the concept of the Other is a priori? This we shall attempt to determine later. But in spite of these undeniable advantages Husserl's theory does not seem to us perceptibly different from Kant's. This is due to the fact that while my empirical Ego is not any more sure than the Other's, Husserl has retained the transcendental subject, which is radically distinct from the Ego and which strongly resembles the Kantian subject. Now what ought to be demonstrated is that it is not the parallelism of the empirical "Egos" which throws doubt on the person but that of the transcendental subjects. This is because actually the Other is never that empirical person who is encountered in my experience; he is the transcendental subject to whom this person by nature refers. Thus the true problem is that of the connection of transcendental subjects who are beyond experience. If SOmeone replies that from the start the transcendental subject refers to other subjects for the constitution of the noematic whole, it is easy to reply that it refers to them as to meanings. The Other here would be a kind of supplementary category which would allow a world to be constituted, not a real being existing beyond this world. Of course the "category" of the Other implies in its very meaning a reference from the other side of the world to a subject, but this reference could be only hypothetical. It has the pure value of the content of a unifying concept; it is valid in and for the world. Its laws are limited to the world, and the Other is by nature outside the world. Furthermore Husserl has removed the very possibility of understanding what can be meant by the extra-mundane being of the Other since he defines being as the simple indication of an infinite series of operations to be effected. There could be no better way to measure being by knowledge. Now even admitting that knowledge in general measures being, the Other's being is measured in its reality by the knowledge which the Other has of himself, not by that which I have of him. What I must attain is the Other, not as I obtain knowledge of him, but as he obtains knowledge of himself-which is impossible. This would in fact suppose the internal identification of myself with the Other. Thus we find here again that distinct

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On principle between the Other and myself which does not stem from the exteriority of our bodies but from the simple fact that each of us exists in interiority and that a knowledge valid for interiority can be effected only in interiority which on principle excludes all knowledge of the Other as he knows himself-i.e., as he is. Moreover Husserl understood this since he says that "the Other" as he is revealed to our concrete experience is an absence. But within Husserl's philosophy, at least, how can one

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have a full intuition of an absence? The Other is the object of empty intentions, the Other on principle refuses himself to us and flees. The only reality which remains is therefore that of my intention; the Other is the empty noema which corresponds to my directing toward the Other, to the extent that he appears concretely in my experience. He is an ensemble of operations of unification and of the constitution of my experience so that he appears as a transcendental concept. Husserl replies to the solipsist that the Other's existence is as sure as that of the world, and Husserl includes in the world my psycho-physical existence. But the solipsist says the same thing: it is as sure, he will say, but no more sure. The existence of the world is measured, he will add, by the knowledge which I have of it; the case will not be otherwise for the existence of the Other.
Formerly I believed that I could escape solipsism by refuting Husserl's concept of the existence of the Transcendental "Ego."· At that time I thought that since I had emptied my consciousness of its subject, nothing !emained there which was privileged as compared to the Other. But actually although I am still persuaded that the hypothesis of a transcendental subject is useless and disastrous, abandoning it does not help one bit to solve the question of the existence of Others. Even if outside the empirical Ego there is nothing other than the consciousness of that Ego -that is, a transcendental field without a subject-the fact remains that my affirmation of the Other demands and requires the existence beyond the world of a similar transcendental field. Consequently the only way to escape solipsism would be here again to prove that my transcendental consciousness is in its very being, affected by the extra-mundane existence of other consciousnesses of the same type. Because Husserl has reduced being to a series of meanings, the only connection which he has been able to establish between my being and that of the Other is a connection of knowledge. Therefore Husserl can not escape solipsism any more than Kant could.
If now instead of observing the rules of chronological succession, we are guided by those of a sort of non-temporal dialectic, we shall find that in the solution which Hegel gives to the problem in the first volume of The Phenomenology of Mind, he has made significant progress over Husser!. Here the appearance of the Other is indispensable not to the constitution of the world and of my empirical "Ego" but to the very existence of my consciousness as self-consciousness. In fact as self-consciousness, the Self itself apprehends itself. The equation "Myself = myself" or "I am I" is precisely the expression of this fact. At first this self-consciousness is pure self-identity, pure existence for itself. It has certitude of itself, but this certitude still lacks tru

th. In fact this certitude would be true
only to the extent that its own existence for itself appeared to it as an
independent object. Thus self-consciousness is first a syncretic relation
? "La transcendance de l'Ego," Recherches philosophiques, 1937.

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without truth between a subject and an object, an object, which is not
yet objectified and which is this subject himself. Since the impulse of this
consciousness is to realize its concept by becoming conscious of itself
in all respects, it tends to make itself valid externally by giving itself
objectivity and manifest existence. It is concerned with making the "I am
I" explicit and producing itself as an object in order to attain the ultimate
stage of development. This state in another sense is naturally the prime
mover for the becoming of consciousness; it is self-consciousness in gen-
eral, which is recognized in other self-consciousnesses and which .is
identical with them and with itself. The mediator is the Other. The
Other appears along with myself since self-consciousness is identical with
itself by means of the exclusion of every Other. Thus the primary fact is
the plurality of consciousnesses, and this plurality is realized in the form
of a double, reciprocal relation of exclusion. Here we are then in the pres-
ence of that connection by means of an internal negation which was
demanded earlier. No external nothingness in-itself separates my con-
sciousness from the Other's consciousness; it is by the very fact of being
me that I exclude the Other. The Other is the one who excludes me by
being himself, the one whom I exclude by being myself. Consciousnesses
are directly supported by one another in a reciprocal imbrication of
their being.
This position allows us at the same time to define the way in which
the Other appears to me: he is the one who is other than I; therefore
he is given as a non-essential object with a character of negativity. But
this Other is also a self-consciousness. As such he appears to me as an
ordinary object immersed in the being of life. Similarly it is thus that I
appear to the Other: as a concrete, sensible, immediate existence. Here
Hegel takes his stand on the ground not of a univocal relation which goes
from me (apprehended by the cogito) to the Other, but of the reciprocal
relation which he defines as "the self-apprehension of the one in the
other." In fact it is only in so far as each man is opposed to the Other
that he is absolutely for himself. Opposite the Other and confronting
the Other, each one asserts his right of being individual. Thus the
cogito itself can not be a point of departure for philosophy; in fact it can
be born only in consequence of my appearance for myself as an individual,
and this appearance is conditioned by the recognition of the Other. The
problem of the Other should not be posited in terms of the cogito; on
the contrary, the existence of the Other renders the cogito possible as
the abstract moment when the self is apprehended as an object. Thus the
"moment" which Hegel calls being for tIle Other is a necessary stage of
the development of self-consciousness; the road of interiority passes
through the Other. But the Other is of interest to me only to the extent
that he is another Me, a Me-object for Me, and conversely to the extent
that he reflects my Me-i.e., is, in so far as I am an object for him. Due

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to the fact that I must. necessarily be an object for myself only over there in the Other, I must obtain from the Other the recognition of my being. But if another consciousness must mediate between my consciousness for itself and itself, then the being-for-itself of my consciousness-and consequently its being in general-depends on the Other. As I appear. to the Other, so I am. Moreover since the Other is such as he appears to me and since my being depends upon the Other, the way in which I appear-that is, the moment of the development of my self-consciousness-depends on the way in which the Other appears to me. The value of the Other's recognition of me depends on the value of my recognition of the Other. In this sense to the extent that the Other apprehends me as bound to a body and immersed in life, I am myself only an Other. In order to make myself recognized by the Other, I must risk my own life. To risk one's life, in fact, is to reveal oneself as not-bound to the objective form or to any determined existence-as not-bound to life.

But at the same time I pursue the death of the Other. This means that I wish to cause myself to be mediated by an Other who is only other-that is, by a dependent consciousness whose essential characteristic is to exist only for another. This will be accomplished at the very moment when I risk my life, for in the struggle against the other I have made an abstraction of my sensible being by risking it. On the other hand, the Other prefers life and freedom even while showing that he has not been able to posit himself as not-bound to the objective form. Therefore he remains bound to external things in general; he appears to me and he appears to himself asnon-essential. He is the Slave I am the Master; for him it is I who am essence. Thus there appears the famous "Master-Slave" relation which so profoundly influenced Marx. We need not here enter into its details. It is sufficient to observe that the Slave is the Truth of the Master. But this unilateral recognition is unequal and insufficient, for the truth of his self-certitude for the Master is a non-essential consciousness; therefore the Master is not certain of being for himself as truth. In order to attain this truth there is necessary "a moment in which the master does for himself what he does as regards the Other and when the slave does as regards the Other what he does for himself."11 At this moment there will appear a self-consciousness in general which is recognized in other self-consciousnesses and which is identical with them and with itself.

Thus Hegel's brilliant intuition is to make me depend on the Other in my being. I am, he said, a being for-itself which is for-itself only through another. Therefore the Other penetrates me to the heart. I can not doubt him without doubting myself since "self-consciousness is. real only in so far as itrecognizes its echo (and its reflection) in another."8 Since the very

,II PMnom~nologiede l'Esprit, p. 1t8. EditionCosson.

8 Propedeutik, p. 20, first edition 0 ,the complete works. .

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doubt implies a consciousness which exists for itself, the Other's existence conditions my attempt to doubt it just as in the work of Descartes my existence conditions systematic doubt. Thus solipsism seems to be put out of the picture once and for all. By proceeding from Husserl to Hegel, we ha

ve realized immense progress: first the negation which consti-
tutes the Other is direct, internal, and reciprocal; second, it calls each
consciousness to account and pierces it to the deepest part of its being;
the problem is posited on the level of inner being, of the universal and
transcendental "I;" finally in my essential being I depend on the essen-
tial being of the Other, and instead of holding that my being-for-myself
is opposed to my being-for-others, I find that being-for-others appears as
a necessary condition for my being-for-myself.
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Yet in spite of the wide scope of this solution, in spite of the richness
and profundity of the detailed insights with which the theory of the
Master and the Slave is filled to overflowing, can we be satisfied with it?
To be sure, Hegel has posed the question of the being of conscious-
nesses. It is being-for-itself and being-for-others which he is studying, and
he holds that each consciousness includes the reality of the other. Never-
theless it is certain that this ontological problem remains everywhere
formulated in terms of knowledge. The mainspring of the conflict of con-
sciousnesses is the effort of each one to transform his self-eertitude into
truth. And we know that this truth can be attained only in so far as my
consciousness becomes as object for the Other at the same time as the
Other becomes an object for my consciousness. Thus when idealism asks,
"How can the Other be an object for me?" Hegel while remaining on the
same ground as idealism replies: if there is in truth a Me for whom the
Otller is an object, this is because there is an Other for whom the Me is
object. Knowledge here is still the measure of being, and Hegel does not
even conceive of the possibility of a being-for-others which is not finally
reducible to a "being-as-object." Thus a universal self-consciousness which
seeks to disengage itself through all these dialectical phases is by its own
admission reducible to a purely empty formula-the "I am I." Yet Hegel
writes, "This proposition regarding self-consciousness is void of all con-
tent."7 And in another place he says "[It is] the process of absolute
abstraction which consists in surpassing all immediate existence and
which res' It:; in the purely negative being of consciousness identical with
itself."
TI.~· hmiting term of this dialectical conflict, universal self-con-
SciOUSD"'S, is not enriched in the midst of its avatars; it is on the contrary
entire!~' Jmuded. It is no more than the "I know that another knows me
as me." Of course this is because for idealism absolute being and knowl·
edge are identical. But what does this identification involve?
To begin with, this "I am I," a pure, universal form of identity, has
nothing in common with the concrete consciousness which we have at-
7 Plopedeuti1c, p. 20, fint edition of the complete works.
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tempted to describe in our Introduction. There we established that the
being of self-consciousness could not be defined in terms of knowledge.
Knowledge begins with reflection (reflexion) but the game of "the-re-
flection (reflet)-reflecting" is not a subject-object dyad, not even implic-
itly. Its being does not depend on any transcendent consciousness; rather
its mode of being is precisely to be in question for itself. We showed
subsequently in the first chapter of Part Two that the relation of the re-
flection to the reflec

ting was in no way a relation of identity and could
not be reduced to the "Me =Me" or to the "I am I" of Hegel. The reflection does not make itself be the reflecting; we are dealing here with a being which nihilates itself in its being and which seeks in vain to dissolve into itself as a self. If it is true that this description is the only one which allows us to understand the original fact of consciousness, then we must judge that Hegel has not succeeded in accounting for this abstract doubling of the Me which he gives as equivalent to self-consciousness. Finally we succeeded in getting rid of the pure unreflective consciousness 6f the transcendental "I" which obscured it and we showed that selfness, the foundation of personal existence, was altogether different from an Ego or from a reference of the Ego to itself. There can be, therefore, no question of defining consciousness in terms of a transcendental ego-ology. In short, consciousness is a concrete being sui generis, not an abstract, unjustifiable relation of identity. It is selfness and not the seat of an opaque, useless Ego. Its being is capable of being reached by a tramcendental reflection, and there is a truth of consciousness which does not depend on the Other; rather the very being of consciousness, since it is independent of knowledge, pre-exists its truth. On this plane as for naive realism, being measures truth; for the truth of a refl.ective intuition is measured by its conformity to being: consciousness was there before it was known. Therefore if consciousness is affirmed in the face of the Other, it is because it lays claim to a recognition of its being and not of an abstract truth. In fact it would be ill conceived to think that the ardent and perilous conflict between master and slave had for its sole stake the recognition of a formula as barren and abstract as the "I am 1." Moreover there would be a deception in this very conflict since the end finally attained would be universal self-consciousness, "the intuition of the existing self by the self." Here as everywhere we ought to oppose to Hegel Kierkegaard, who represents the claims of the individual as such. The individual claims his achievement as an individual, the recognition of his concrete being, and of the objective specification of a universal structure. Of course the rights which I demand from the Other posit the universality of self; respect of persons demands the recognition of my person as universal. But it is my concrete and individual being which flows into this universal and fills it; it is for that being-there that I demand rights. The particular is here the support and foundation of the universal; the universal in this

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case could have no meaning if it did not exist for the purpose of the individual.

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This identification of being and knowledge results in a large number of errors or impossibilities. We shall consider them here under two headings; that is we shall marshal against Hegel a twofold charge of optimism. In the first place Hegel appears to us to be guilty of an epistemological optimism. It seems to him that the truth of self-consciousness can appear; that is, that an objective agreement can be realized between consciousnesses-by authority of the Other's recognition of me and my recognition of the Other. This recognition can be simultaneous and reciprocal: "I know that the Other

knows me as himself." It produces actually and
in truth the universality of self-consciousness. But the correct statement
of the problem of Others renders this passage to the universal impossible.
If the Other can in fact refer my "self" to me, then at least at the end of
. the dialectical evolution there must be a common measure between what
I am for him, what he is for me, what I am for myself, what he is for him-
self. Of course this homogeneity does not exist at the start; Hegel agrees to
this. The relation "Master-Slave" is not reciprocal. But Hegel affirms that
the reciprocity must be capable of being established. Here at the outset he
is creating a confusion-so easy that it seems voluntary-between being-
an-object and life. The Other, he says appears to me as an object. Now
the object is Myself in the Other. When Hegel wants to define this
object-state more exactly, he distinguishes in it three elements: "This
self-apprehension by one in the other is: (1) The abstract moment of
self-identity. (2) Each one, however, has also this particularity, that he
manifests himself to the Other as an external object, as an immediately
concrete and sensible existence. (3) Each one is absolutely for himself
and individual as opposed to the other."8
We see that the abstract moment of self-identity is given in the knowl-
edge of the Other. It is given with two other moments of the total
structure. But-a curious thing in a philosopher of Synthesis-Hegel did
not ask if these three elements did not react on one another in such away
as to constitute a new form resistant to analysis. He defines his point of
view in the Phenomenology of Mind when he declares that the Other
appears first as non-essential (this is the sense of the third moment cited
above) and as a "consciousness immersed in the being of life." But here
we are dealing with a pure co-existence of the abstract moment and of
life. It is sufficient therefore that I or the Other risk our life in order that
in the very act of offering oneself to danger, we realize the analytical separa-
tion of life and consciousness: "What the Other is for each consciousness,
each consciousness is for the Other; each consciousness in turn accom-
plishes in itself by means of its own activity and by means of the activity
8 Propedeutil, p. 18.

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of the Other, that pure abstraction of being for itself; .. To present oneself
as a pure abstraction of self-consciousness is to reveal oneself as a pure
negation of one's opjective form, to reveal oneself as not-bound to any
determined existence; ... it is to reveal oneself as not-bound to. life."9
Of course Hegel will say later that by the experience of risk and of the
danger of death, self-consciousness learns that life is as essential to it as
pure self-consciousness; but this is from a totally different point of view,
and the fact still remains that I can always separate, in the Other, the
pure truth of self-consciousness from his life. Thus the slave apprehends
the self-consciousness of the master; he is its truth although, as we have
seen, this truth is still not adequate.lO
But is it the same thing to say that the Other on principle appears to
me as an object and to say that he appears to me as bound to a particular
existence, as immersed in life? If we remain on the level of pure, logical
hypotheses, we shall note first that the Other can in fact be given to a
consc

iousness in the form of an object without that object's being precisely bound to that" contingent object which we call a living body. In fact our experience presents us only with conscious, living individuals, but in theory it must be remarked that the Other is an object for me because he is the Other and not because he appears on the occasion of a body-object; otherwise we should fall back into the illusion of space which we discussed above. Thus what is essential to the Other qua Other is objectivity and not life. Moreover Hegel took this logical affirmation as his poin~ of departure.

But if it is true that the connection between a consciousness and life does not distort the nature of the "abstract moment of self-consciousness" which remains there, immersed, always capable of being discovered, is the case the same for objectivity? In other words, since we know that a consciousness is before being known, then is not a known consciousness wholly modified by the very fact that it is kno'Yn? Is "to appear as an object for a consciousness" still "to be consciousness"? It is easy to reply to this question: the very being of self-consciousness is such that in its being, its being is in question; this means that it is pure interiority. It is perpetually a reference to a se1f which it has to be. Its being is defined by this: that it is this being in the mode of being what it is not and of not being what it is. Its being, therefore, is the radical exclusion of all objectivity. I am the one who can not be an object for myself, the one who can not even conceive for myself of existence in the form of an object (save on the plane of the reflective dissociation-but we have seen that reflection is the drama of the being who can not be an object for himself). This is not because of the lack of detachment or because of an intellectual

8 Phenomenology of Mind. Ibid.

10 Idem.

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prejudice or of a limit imposed on my knowledge, but because objectivity demands an explicit negation: the object is what I make myself not-be whereas I myself am what I make myself be. I pursue myself everywhere, I can not escape myself, I reapprehend myself from behind. Even if I could attempt to make myself an object, I would already be myself at the heart of that object which I am; and at the very center of that object I should have to be the subject who is looking at it. Moreover this is what Hegel hinted at when he said that the Other's existence is necessary in order for me to be an object for myself. But by holding that self-consciousness is expressed by the "I am I"-i.e., by identifying it with self-knowledge-he failcd to derive the consequences of his first affirmations; for he introduced into consciousness something like an object existing potentially to be disengaged without change by the Other. But if to be an object is precisely not-to-be-me, then the fact of being an object for a consciousness radically modifies consciousness not in what it is for itself but in its appearance to the Other. The Other's consciousness is what I can simply contemplate and what because of this fact appears to me as being a pure given instead of being what has to be me. It is what is released to me in universal time (i.e. in the original dispersion of moments) instead of appearing to me within the unity of its own temporalization. For the only consciousness which can appear to me in

its own temporalization is mine,
and it can do so only by renouncing all objectivity. In short the for-itself as for-itself can not be known by the Other. The object which I apprehend under the name of the Other appears to me in a radically other form. The Other is not a for-itself as he appears to me; I do not appear to myself as I am for-the-Otller. I am incapable of apprehending for myself the self which I am for the Other, just as I am incapable of apprehending on the basis of the Otllcr-as-object which appears to me, what the Other is for himself. How thcn could we establish a universal concept subsuming under the name of self-consciousness, my consciousness for myself and (of) myself and my knowledge of the Other. But this is not all.
According to Hegel the Other is an object, and I apprehend myself as an objcct in the Other. But the one of these affirmations destroys the other. In order for me to be able to appear to myself as an object in the Other, I would have to apprehend the Other as subject; that is, to apprehend him in his interiority. But in so far as the Other appears to me as object, my objectivity for him can not appear to me. Of course I apprehend that the Other-as-object refers to me by means of intentions and acts, but due to the very fact that he is an object, the Other-as-a-mirror is clouded and no longer reflects anything. 'TIlese intentions and these acts are things in the world and are apprehended in the Time of the World; they are established and contemplated, their meaning is an object for me. Thus I can only appear to mys~lf as a transcendent quality to which the Other's acts and intentions refer; but since the Other's objectivity destroys

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my objectivity for him, it is as an internal subject that I apprehend myself as being that to which those intentions and those acts refer. It must be understood that this apprehension of myself by myself is in pure terms of consciousness, not of knowledge; by having to be what I am in form of an ekstatic self-consciousness, I apprehend the Other as an object pointing to me. Thus Hegel's optimism results in failure: between the Other-as-object and Me-as-subject there is no common measure, no more than between self-<:onsciousness and consciousness of the Other. I can not know myself in the Other if the Other is first an object for me; neither can I apprehend the Other in his true being-that is, in his subjectivity. No universal knowledge can be derived from the relation of consciousnesses. This is what we shall call their ontological separation.
But there is in Hegel another and more fundamental form of optimism. This may be called an ontological optimism. For Hegel indeed truth is truth of the \Vhole. And he places himself at the vantage point of truth-i.e., of the \Vhole-to consider the problem of the Other. Thus when Hegelian monism considers the relation of consciousnesses, it does not put itself in any particular consciousness. Although the \Vhole is to be realized, it is already there as the truth of all which is true. Thus when Hegel writes that every consciousness, since it is identical with itself, is other than the Other, he has established himself in the whole, outside consciousnesses, and he considers them from the point of view of the Absolute. For individual consciousnesses are moments in the whole, moments which by themselves are unse1bstandig, and the

whole is a media-
tor between consciousnesses. Hence is derived an ontological optimism parallel to the epistemological optimism: plurality can and must be surpassed toward the totality. But if Hegel can assert the reality of this surpassing, it is because he has already given it to himself at the outset. In fact he has forgotten his own consciousness; he is the \Vhole, and consequently if he so easily resolves the problem of particular consciousnesses it is because for him there never has been any real problem in this connection. Actually he does not raise the question of the relation between his own· consciousness and that of the Other. By effecting completely the abstraction of his own, he studies purely and simply the relation between the consciousnesses of others-i.e. the relation of consciousnesses which are already for him objects whose nature according to him, is precisely that of being a particular type of object,-the subject-object. These sonsciousnesses from the totalitarian point of view which he has adoptedare strictly equivalent to each other although each of them is separate9Jrom the rest by a particular privilege.
But if Hegel has forgotten himself, we can not forget Hegel. This means that we are referred back to the cogito. In fact, if, as we have established, the being of my consciousness is strictly irreducible to knowledge, then I can not transcend my being toward a reciprocal and universal relation
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in which I could see my being and that of others as equivalent. On the contrary, I must establish myself in my being and posit the problem of the Other in terms of my being. In a word the sole point of departure is the interiority of the cogito. We must understand by this that each one must be able by starting out from his own interiority, to rediscover the Other's being as a transcendence which conditions the very being of that interiority. This of necessity implies that the multiplicity of consciousnesses is on principle unsurpassable, for I can undoubtedly transcend myself toward a Whole, but I can not establish myself in this Whole so as to contemplate" myself and to contemplate the Other. No logical or epistemological optimism can cover the scandal of the plurality of consciousnesses. If Hegel believed that it could, this is because he never grasped the nature of that particular dimension of heing which is self-consciousness. The task which an ontology can lay down for itself is to describe this scandal and to found it in the very nature of being, but ontology is powerless to overcome it. It is possible-as we shall see better later-that we may be able to refute solipsism and show that the Other's existence is both evident and certain for us. But even if we could succeed in making the Other's existence share in the apodictic certainty of the cogito-i.e., of my own existence-we should not thereby "surpass" the Other toward any inter-monad totality. So long as consciousnesses exist, the separation and conflict of consciousesses will remain; we shall simply have discovered their foundation and their true terrain.
What has this long criticism accomplished for us? Simply this: if we are to refute solipsism, then my relation to the Other is first and fundamentally a relation of being to being, not of knowledge to knowledge. We have seen Husserl's failure when on this particular level he measures b

eing by
knowledge, and Hegel's when he identifies knowledge and being. But we have equally recognized that Hegel, although his vision is obscured by the postulate of absolute idealism, has been able to put the discussion on its true plane.

In Sein und Zeit Heidegger seems to have profited by study of his predecessors and to have been deeply impressed with this twofold necessity: (1) the relation between "human-realities" must be a relation of being; (2) this relation must cause "human-realities" to depend on one another in their essential being. At least his theory fulfills these two requirements. In his abrupt, rather barbaric fashion of cutting Gordian knots rather than trying to untie them, he gives in answer to the question posited a pure and simple definition. He has discovered several moments-inseparable except by abstraction-in "being-in-the-world," which characterizes human reality. These moments are "world," "being-in," and "being." He has described the world as "that by which human reality makes known to itself what it is;" "being-in" he has defined as Befind-

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lichkeit and Verstand.n We have still to speak of being; that is, the mode in which human reality is its being-in-the world. Being, Heidegger tells us, is the Mit-Sein-that is, "being-with." Thus human-reality the characteristic of being is that human-reality is its being with others. This does not come about by chance. I do not exist first in order that subsequently a contingency should make me encounter the Other. The question here is of an essential structure of my being. But this structure is not established from outside and from a totalitarian point of view as it was with Hegel.

To be sure, Heidegger does not take his departure from the cogito in the Cartesian sense of the discovery of consciousness by itself; but the human-reality which is revealed to him and for which he seeks to fix the structures in concepts is his own. "Dasein ist je meines," he writes. It is by making explicit the preontological comprehension which I have of myself that I apprehend being-with-others as an essential characteristic of my being. In short I discover the transcendental relation to the Other as.constituting my own being, just as I have discovered that being-in-the-world measures my human-reality. Henceforth the problem of the Other is a false problem. The Other is no longer first a particular existence which I encounter in the world-and which could not be indispensable to my own existence since I existed before encountering it. The Other is the ex-centric limit which contributes to the constitution of my being.

He is the test of my being inasmuch as he throws me outside of myself toward structures which at once both escape me and define me; it is this test which originally reveals the Other to me.

Let us observe in addition that the type of connection with the Other has changed. With realism, idealism, Husserl, Hegel, the type of relation between consciousnesses was being-for; the Other appeared to me and even constituted me in so far as he was for me or I was for him. The problem was the mutual recognition of consciousnesses brought face to face which appeared in the world and which confronted each other. "To-be-with" has an altogether different meaning; "with" does not intend the reciprocal relation of recognition and of conflict which would result from the appearance of a

human-reality other than mine in tIle midst of the
world. It expresses rather a sort of ontological solidarity for the exploitation of this world. The Other is not originally bound to me as an ontic reality appearing in the midst of the world among "instruments" as a type of particular object; in that case he would be already degraded, and the relation uniting him to me could never take on reciprocity. The Other is not an object. In his connection with me he remains a human-reality; the being by which he determines me in my being is his pure being apprehended as "being-in-the-world." And we know that the "in" must be understood in the sense of colo, habito, not of insum; to-be-in-the-world is to haunt the world, not to be ensnared in it; and it is in my "being-in-the
11 Roughly, BefindIich1:eit is "finitude" and Verstand "comprehension." Tr.
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world" that the Other detennines me. Our relation is not a frontal opposition but rather an oblique interdependence. In so far as I make a world exist as a complex of instruments which I use for the ends of my human reality, I cause myself to be detennined in my being by a 1>eing who makes the world exist as a complex of instruments for the ends of his reality. Moreover it is not necessary to understand this being-with as a pure concomitance which is passively received by my being. For Heidegger, to be is to be one's own possibilities; that is, to make oneself be. lt is then a mode of being which I make myself be. And it is very true that I am responsible for my being-for the Other in so far as I realize him freely in authenticity or in unauthenticity. It is in complete freedom and by an original choice that, for example, I realize my being-with in the anonymous fonn of "they." And if I am asked how my "being-with" can exist for-myself, I must reply that through the world I make known to myself what I am. In particular when I am in the unauthentic mode of the "they," the world refers to me a sort of impersonal reflection of my unauthentic possibilities in the fonn of instruments and complexes of instruments which belong to "everybody" and which belong to me in so far as I am "everybody:" ready-made clothes, common means of transportation, parks, gardens, public places, shelters made for anyone who may take shelter there, etc. Thus I make myself known as anybody by means of the indicative complex of instr.uments which indicate me as a Worumwillen. The unauthentic state-which is my ordinary state in so far as I have not realized my conversion to authenticity-reveals to me my "being-with," not as the relation of one unique personality with other personalities equally unique, not as the mutual connection of "most irreplaceable beings," but as a total interchangeability of the terms of the relation. The determination of the tenns is still lacking; I am not opposed to the Other, for I am not "me;" instead we have the social unity of the they. To posit the problem on the level of the incommunicability of individual subject was to commit an VI1TEpOII
7rp6TEPOII,12 to stand the world on its
head. Authenticity and individuality have to be earned: I shall be my own authenticity only if under the influence of the call of conscience (Ruf des Gewissens) I launch out toward death with a resolute-decision (Entschlossenl1eit) as toward my own most peculiar possibility. At this moment I reveal myself to

myself in authenticity, and I raise others along
with myself toward the authentic.
The empirical image which may best symbolize Heidegger's intuition
is not that of a conflict but rather a crew. The original relation of the
Other and my consciousness is not the you and me; it is the we. Heideg-
ger's being-with is not the clear and distinct position of an individual
confronting another individual; it is not knowledge. It is the mute exist-
12 Correction for wnpov 1rp6~'1po", obviously a misprint. Tr.

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ence in common of One member of the crew with his fellows, that
existence which the rhythm of the oars or the regular movements of
the coxswain will render sensible to the rowers and which will be made
manifest to them by the common goal to be attained, the boat or the
yacht to be overtaken, and the entire world (spectators, performance,
etc.) which is profiled on the horizon. It is on the common ground of this
co-existence that the abrupt revelation of my "being-unto-death" will
suddenly make me stand out in an absolute "common solitude" while at
the same time it raises the others to that solitude.
This time we have indeed been given wnat we asked for: a being which
in its own being implies the Other's being. And yet we can not consider
ourselves satisfied. First of all, Heidegger's theory offers us the indication
of the solution to be found rather than that solution itself. Even if we
should without reservation accept his substitution of "being-with" for
"being-for," it would still remain for us a simple affirmation without
foundation. Undoubtedly we shall encounter certain empirical states of
our being-in particular that to which the Germans give the untranslatable
name Stimmung13-which seem to reveal a co-existence of consciousnesses
rather than a relation of opposition. But it is precisely this co-existence
which must be explained. Why does it become the unique foundation
of our being? Why is it the fundamental type of our relation with others?
Why did Heidegger believe that he was authorized to pass from this
empirical and ontic establishment of being-with to a position claiming
co-existence as the ontological structure of my "being-in-the-world?" And
what type of being does this co-existence have? To what extent is the
negation which makes the Other an other and which constitutes him as
non-essential maintained? If we suppress it entirely, are we not going
to fall into a monism? And if we are to preserve it as an essential struc-
ture of the relation to the Other, then what modification must it undergo
in order to lose the character of opposition which it had in being-for-others
and acquire this character as a connection which creates solidarity and
which is the very structure of being-with? And how shall we be able to
pass from there to the concrete experience of the Other in the world, as
when from my window I see a man walking in the street? To be sure
it is tempting to conceive of myself as standing out on the undifferentiated
ground of the human by means of the impulse of my freedom, by the
choice of my unique possibilities- and perhaps this conception holds an
important element of truth. But in this form at least such a view gives
rise to serious objections.
First of all, the ontological point of view joins here with the abstract
view of the Kantian subject. To say that human reality (even if it is my
human reality) "is-with"

by means of its ontological structure is to say

13 Literally "pitch" or "tuning." Perhaps the nearest English equivalent is "sympa. thy" in its original Greek sense of feeling or experiencing with someone. Tr.

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that it is-with by nature-that is, in an essential and universal capacity. Even if this affinnation were proved, it would not enable us to explain any concrete being-with. In other words, the ontological co-existence which appears as the structure of "being-in-the-world" can in no way serve as a foundation to an ontic being-with, such as, for example, the co-existence which appears in my friendship with Pierre or in the couple which Annie and I make. In fact it would be necessary to show that "being-with-Pierre" or "being-with-Annie" is a structure constitutive of my con-create-being. But this is impossible from the point of view which Heidegger has adopted. The Other in the relation "with," taken on the ontological level, can not in fact be concretely detennined any more than the directly confronted human-reality of which it is the alter ego; it is an abstract term and hence unse1bstandig, and it does not contain the power of becoming that Other-Pierre or Annie. Thus the relation of the Mit-Sein can be of absolutely no use to us in resolving the psychological, concrete problem of the recognition of the Other. There are two.incommunicable levels and two problems which demand separate solutions.

It may be said that this is only one of the difficulties which Heidegger encounters in passing in general from the ontological level to the ontic level, in passing from "being-in-the-world" in general to my relation with this particular instrument, in passing from my being-unto-<leath, which makes of my death my most essential possibility, to this "ontic" death which I shall experience by encountering this or that external existent. But this difficulty can be disguised; if need be, in all other cases since, for example, it is human reality which causes the existence of a world in which a threat of death to human reality is hidden. Better yet, if the world is, it is because it is "mortal" in the sense in which we say that a wound is mortal. But the impossibility of passing from one level to the other bursts forth when we meet the problem of the Other. In fact even if in the ekstatic upsurge of its being-in-the-world, human reality makes a world exist, one can not, for all that, say that its being-with causes another human reality to rise up. Of course I am the being by whom "there is" (es gibt) being. But are we to say that I am the being by whom "there is" another human-reality? If we understand by that that I am the being for whom there is for me another human reality, this is a pure and simple truism. If we mean that I am the being by whom there are in general Others, we fall back into solipsism. In fact this human reality "with whom" I am is itself "in-the-world-with-me"; it is the free foundation of a world. (How does this make it my world? We can not deduce from the being-with an identity of the worlds "in which" the human realities are.) Human reality is its own possibilities. It is then for itself without having to wait for me to make its being exist in the form of the "there is." Thus I can constitute a world as "mortal," but I can not constitute a human-reality as a concrete being which is its own possibilities. My being-with,

d the existence
of concrete beings which are similar to us and which as such escape our experience, which even as they are being constituted do not arise from our a priori. He seems to escape isolation because he takes the "outside of self' sometimes as being "outside..of-self-toward-self" and sometimes as "outside-self-in-others." But the second interpretation of "outside-of-self," which Heidegger surreptitiously slides in through his devious reasoning, is strictly incompatible with the first. Human-reality at the very heart of its ekstases remains alone. It is here that we can derive a new and valid insight as the result of our critical examination ofHeidegger's teaching: Human-reality remains alone because the Other's existence has the nature of a contingent and irreducible fact. We encounter the Other; we do not constitute him. And if this fact still appeal's to us in the form of a necessity, yet it does not belong with those "conditions of the possibility of our experience" or-if you prefer-with ontological necessity. If the Other's existence is a necessity, it is a "contingent necessity;" that is, it is of'the same type as the factual necessity which is imposed on the cogito. If the Other is to be capable of being given to us, it is by means of a direct apprehension which leaves to the encounter its character as facticity, just as the cogito itself leaves all its facticity to my own thought, a facticity which nevertheless shares in the apodicity of the cogito itself-i.e., in its indubitability.
This long exposition of doctrine will not therefore have been useless if it enables us to formulate the necessary and sufficient conditions under which a theory of the existence of others can be valid.
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(1) Such a theory can not offer a new proof of the existenc,: of others, or an argument better than any other against solipsism. Actuauy if solipsism is to be rejected, this can not be because it is impossible or, if you prefer, because nobody is truly ltolipsistic. The Other's existence will always be subject to doubt, at least if one doubts the Other only in words and abstractly, in the same way that without really being able to conceive of it, I can write, "I doubt my own existence." In short the Other's existence can not be a probability. Probability can concern only objects which appear in our experience and from which new effects can appear. in our experience. There is probability only if a validation or invalidation of it is at every moment possible. Thus since the Other on principle and in its "For-itself" is outside my experience, the probability of his existence as Anotl1er Self can never be either validated or invalidated; it can be neither believed nor disbelieved, it can not even be measured; it loses therefore its very' being as probability and becomes a pure fictional conjecture. In the same way M. Lalandea has effectively shown that an hypothesis con-
a us theories de l'inductioD et de l'ezperimeutatiOD.

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cerning the existence of living beings on the planet Mars will remain purely conjectural with no chance of being either true or false so long as we do not have at our disposal instruments or scientific theories enabling us to produce facts validating or invalidating this hypothesis.
But the structure of the Other is on principle such that no new experiment will ever be able to be conceived, that no new theory will come

to validate
or invalidate the hypothesis of his existence, that no instrument will come to reveal new facts inspiring me to affirm or to reject this hypothesis. Therefore if the Other is not immediately present to me, and if his existence is not as sure as my own, all conjecture concerning him is entirely lacking in meaning. But if I do not conjecture about the Other, then, precisely, I affirm him. A theory of the Other's existence must therefore simply question me in my being, must make clear and preci~ the meaning of that affirmation; in particular, far from inventing a proof, it must make explicit the very foundation of that certainty. In other words Descartes has not proved his existence. Actually I have always known that I existed, I have never ceased to practice the cogito. Similarly my resistance to solipsism-which is as lively as any I should offer to an attempt to doubt the cogito-proves that I have always known that the Other existed, that I have always had a total though implicit comprellension of his existence, that this "pre-ontological" comprehension comprises a surer and deeper understanding of the nature of the Other and the relation of his being to my being than' all the theories which have been built around it. If the Other's existence is not a vain conjecture, a pure fiction, this is because there is a sort of cogito concerning it. It is this cogito which we must bring to light by specifying its structure:; and determining its scope and its laws.

(2) On the other hand, Hegel's failure has shown us that the only point of departure possible is the Cartesian cogito. Moreover the cogito alone establishes us on the ground of that factual necessity which is the necessity of the Other's existence. Thus what for lack of a better term we called the cogito of the Other's existence is merged with my 'own cogito. The cogito examined once again, must throw me outside it and onto the Other, just as it threw JOe outside upon the In-itself; and this must be done not by revealing to me an a priori structure of myself which would point toward an equally a priori Other but by disclosing to me the concrete, indubitable presence of a particular. 'concrete Other. just as it has already revealed to me my own incomparable, contingent but necessarJ, and conereteexistence. Thus we must ask the For-itself to deliver to us the For-others; we must ask absolute immanence to throw us into absolute transcen:dence. In my own inmost depths I must find not reasons. for believing that the Other exists but the Other himself as not being me.

(3) What the· cogito must reveal to us is not the-Other-as-object. For

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II
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a long time now it must have been obvious that what is called an object is said to be probable. If the Other is an object for me, he refers me to probability. But probability is founded solely on the infinite congruity of our representations. Since the Other is neither a representation nor a system of representations nor a necessary unity of our representations, he can not be probable: he can not at first be an object. Therefore if he is for us, this can be neither as a constitutive factor of our knowledge of the world nor as a constitutive factor of our knowledge of the self, but as one who "interests" our being, and that not as he contributes a priori to constitute our being but as he interests it concretely and "ontically" in the

empirical circumstances of our facticity.
(4) If we attempt somehow regarding the Other what Descartes attempted to do for God with that extraordinary "proof by the idea of perfection" which is wholly animated by the intuition of transcendence, then for our apprehension of the Other qua Other we are compelled to reject a certain type of negation which we have called an external negation. The Other must appear to the cogito as not being 'me. This negation can be conceived in two ways: either it is a pure, external negation, and it will separate the Other from myself as one substance from another substance-and in this case all apprehension ofthe Other is by definition impossible; or else it will be an internal negation, which means a synthetic, active connection of the two terms, each one of which constitutes itself by denying that it is the other. This negative relation will therefore be reciprocal and will possess a two fold interiority: This means first that the multiplicity of "Others" will not be a collection but a totality (in this sense we admit that Hegel is right) since each Other finds his being in the Other.1G It also means that this Totality is such that it is on principle impossible for us to adopt "the point of view of the whole." In fact we have seen that no abstract concept of consciousness can result from the comparison of my being-for-myself with my object-state for the Other. Furthermore this totality-like that of the For-itself-is a detotalized totality; for since existence-for-others is a radical refusal of the Other, no totalitarian and unifying synthesis of "Others" is possible.
It is in the light of these few observations that we in turn shall now attack the question of The Other.

IV. THE LOOK

THIS woman whom I see coming toward me, this man who is passing by in the street, this beggar whom I hear calling before mywindow, all are for me objects-of that there is no doubt. Thus it is true that at least one

111 Chaque autrui trouve son ~re en I'autre.

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of the modalities of the Other's presence to me is object-ness. But we have seen that if this relation of object-ness is the fundamental relation between the Other and myself, then the Other's existence remains purely conjectural. Now it is not only conjectural but probable that this voice which I hear is that of a man and not a song on a phonograph; it is infinitely probable that the passerby whom I see is a man and not a perfected robot. This means that without going beyond the limits of probability and indeed because of this very probability, my apprehension of the Other as an object essentially refers me to a fundamental apprehension of the Other in which he will not be revealed to me as an object but as a "presence in person." In short, if the Other is to be a probable object and not a dream of an object, then his object-ness must of necessity refer not to an original solitude beyond my reach, but to a fundamental connection in which the Other is manifested in some way other than through the knowledge which I have of him. The classical theories are right in considering that every perceived human organism refers to something and that this to which it refers is the foundation and guarantee of its probability. Their mistake lies in believing that this reference indicates a separate existence, a consciousness which would be behind its perceptible manifestations

as the noumenon is behind the Kantian Empfindung.
Whether or not this consciousness exists in a separate state, the face which I see does not refer to it; it is not this consciousness which is the truth of the probable object which I perceive. In actual fact the reference to a twin upsurge in which the Other is presence for me is to a "being-in-a-pair-with-the-Other," and this is given outside of knowledge proper even if the latter be conceived as an obscure and unexpressible form on the order of intuition. In other words, the problem of Others has generally been treated as if the primary relation by which the Other is discovered is object-ness; that is, as if the Other were first revealed-dil~ctly or in-"directly-to our perception. But since this perception by its very nature refers to something other than to itself and since it can refer neither to an infinite series of appearances of the same type-as in idealism the perception of the table or of the chair does-nor to an isolated entity located on principle outside my reach, its essence must be to refer to a primary relation between my consciousness and the Other's. This relation, in which the Other must be given to me directly as a subject although in connection with me, is the fundamental relation, the very type of my being-for-others.
Nevertheless the reference here cannot be to any mystic or ineffable experience. It is in the reality of everyday life that the Other appears to us, and his probability refers to everyday reality. The problem is precisely this: there is in everyday reality an original relation to the Other which can be constantly pointed to and which consequently can be revealed to me outside all reference to a religious or mystic unknowable. In order

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to understand it I must question more exactly this ordinary appearance of the Other in the field of my perception; since this appearance refers to that fundamental relation, the appearance must be capable of revealing to us, at least as a reality aimed at, the relation to which it refers.
I am in a public park. Not far away there is a lawn and along the edge of that lawn there are benches. A man passes by those benches. I see this man; I apprehend him as an object and at the same time as a man. What does this signify? What do I mean when I assert that this object is a man?
If I were to think of him as being only a puppet, I should apply to him the categories which I ordinarily use to group temporal-spatial "things." That is, I should apprehend him as being "beside" the benches, two yards and twenty inches from the lawn, as exercising a certain pressure on the ground, etc. His relation with other objects would be of the purely additive type; this means that I could have him disappear without the relations of the other objects around him being perceptibly changed. In short, no new relation would appear through him 'between those things in my universe: grouped and synthesized from my point of view into instrumental complexes, they would from his disintegrate into mul· tiplicities of indifferent relations. Perceiving him as a man, on the other hand, is not to apprehend an additive relation between the chair and him; it is to register an organization without distance of the things in my universe around that privileged object. To be sure, the lawn remains two yards and twenty inches away from him, but it is

also as a lawn bound
to him in a relation which at once both transcends distance and contains it. Instead of the two terms of the distance being indifferent, interchangeable, and in a reciprocal relation, the distance is unfolded starting from the man whom I see and extending up to the lawn as the synthetic upsurge of a univocal relation. We are dealing with a relation which is without parts, given at one stroke, inside of which there unfolds a spatiality , which is not my spatiality; for instead of a grouping toward me of the objects, there is now an orientation which flees from me.
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Of course this relation without distance and without parts is in no way that original relation of the Other to me which I am seeking. In the first place, it concerns only the man and the things in the world. In addition it is still an object of knowledge; I shall express it, for example, by saying that this man sees the lawn, or that in spite of the prohibiting sign he is preparing to walk on the grass, etc. Finally it still retains a pure character of probability: First, it is probable that this object is a man. Second, even granted that he is a man, it remains only probable that he sees the lawn at the moment that I perceive him; it is possible that he is. dreaming of some project without exactly being aware of what is around him, or that he is blind, etc., etc. Nevertheless this new relation of the object-man to the object-lawn has a particular character; it is simul·

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taneouslygiven to me as a whole, since it is there in the world as an object which I can know (it is, in fact, an objective relation which I express by saying: Pierre has glanced at this watch, Jean has looked out the window, etc.), and at the same time it entirely escapes me. To the eXtent that the man-as-object is the fundamental term of this relation, to the extent that the relation reaches toward him, it escapes me, I can not put myself at the center of it. The distance which unfolds between the lawn and the man across the synthetic upsurge of this primary relation is a negation of the distance which I establish-as a pure type of external negation-between these two objects. The distance appears as a pure disintegration of the relations which I apprehend between the objects of my universe. It is not I who realize this disintegration; it appears to me as a relation which I aim at emptily across the distances which I originally established between things. It stands as a background of things, a background which on principle escapes me and which is conferred on them from without. Thus the appcarance among the objects of my uni-.versc of an element 6f disintegration in that universe is what I mean by the appearance of a man in my universe.
The Other is first the permanent flight of things toward a goal which I apprehend as an object at a certain distance from me but which escapes me inasmuch as it unfolds about itself its own distances. Moreover this disintegration grows by degrees; if there exists between the lawn and the Othcr a relation which is without distance and which creates distance, then there exists necessarily a relation bctween the Other and the statue which stands on a pedestal in the middle of the lawn, and a relation between the Other and the big chestnut trees which border the walk; there is a total space which is grouped around the Other, and this space is made w

ith. my space; there is a regrouping in which I take part but which. escapes me, a regrouping of all the objects which people my universe. nlis regrouping does not,stop there. The grass is something qualified; it is this green grass which exists for the Other; in this sense the very quality ofthe object, its deep, raw green is in direct relation to this man. This green turns toward the Othcr a face which escapes me. I apprehend the relation of the grecn to the Other as an objective relation, but I can not apprehend the green as it appears to the Other. Thus suddenly an object has appeared which has stolen the world from me. Everything is in placc; everything still exists for me; but everything is traversed by an invisible flight and fixed in the direction of a new object. The appearance of . the Other in the world corresponds therefore to a fixed sliding of the whole univcrse, to a decentralization of the world which undermines the centralization which I am simultaneously effecting.

But the Other is still an object tor me. He belongs to my distances; the man is there, twenty paces from· me, he is turning his back on me. As such he is again two yards, twenty inches from the lawn, six yards

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from the statue; hence the disintegration of my universe is contained within the limits of this same universe;. we are not dealing here with a flight of the world toward nothingness or outside itself. Rather it appears that the world has a kind of drain hole in the middle of its being and that it is perpetually flowing off through this hole. The univ~rse, the flow, and the drain hole are all once again recovered, reapprehended, and fixed as an object. All this is there tor me as a partial structure of the world, even though the total disintegration of the universe is involved. Moreover these disintegrations may often be contained within more narrow limits. There, for example, is a man who is reading while he walks. The disintegration of the universe which he represents is purely virtual; he has ears which do not hear, eyes which see nothing except his book. Between his book and him I apprehend an undeniable relation without distance of the same type as that which earlier connected the walker with the grass. But this time the form has closed in on itself. There is a full object for me to grasp. In the midst of the world I can say "man-reading" as I could say "cold stone," "fine rain." I apprehend a closed "Gestalt"· in which the reading forms the essential quality; for the rest, it remains blind and mute, lets itself be known and perceived as a pure and simple temporal-spatial thing, and seemS to be related to the rest of the world by a purely indifferent externality. The quality "man-reading" as the relation of the man to the book is simply a little particular crack in my universe. At the heart of this solid, visible form he makes himself a particular emptying. The form is massive only in appearance; its peculiar meaning is to be-in the midst of my universe, at ten paces from me, at the heart of that massivity-a closely consolidated and localized flight.

None of this enables us to leave the level on which the Other is an object. At most we are dealing with a particular type of objectivity akin to that which Husserl designated by the term absence without, however, his noting that the Other is defined not as the absence of a consciousness in relatio

n to the body which I see but by the absence of the world which I perceive, an absence discovered at the very heart of my perception of this world. On this level the Other is an object in the world, an object which can be defined by the world. But this relation of flight and of absence on the part of the world in relation to me is only probable. If it is this which defines the objectivity of the Other, then to what original presence of the Other does it refer? At present we can give this answer: if the Other-as-object is defined in connection with the world, as the object which sees what I see, then my fundamental connection with the Other-as-subject must be able to be referred back to my permanent possibility of being seen by the Other. It is in and through the revelation of my being-as-object for the Other that I must be able to apprehend the presence of his being-as-subject. For just as the Other is a probable object for me-as-subject, so I can discover myself in the process of becoming

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a probable object for only a certain subject. This revelation can not derive from the fact that my universe is an object for tIle Other-as-object, as if the Other's look after having wandered over the lawn and the surrounding objects came following a definite path to place itself on me. I have observed that I can not be an object for an object. A radical conversion of the Other is necessary if he is to escape objectivity. Therefore I can not consider the look which the Other directs on me as one of the possible manifestations of his objective being; the Other can not look at me as he looks at the grass. Furthermore my objectivity can not itself derive for me from the objectivity of the world since I am precisely the one by whom there is a world; that is, the one who on principle can not be an object for himself.

Thus this relation which I call "being-seen-by-another," far from being merely one of the relations signified by the word man, represents an irreducible fact which can not be deduced either from the essence of the Other-as-object, or from my being-as-subject. On the contrary, if the concept of the Other-as-object is to have any meaning, this can be only as the result of the conversion and the degradation of that original relation. In a word, my apprehension of the Other in the world as probably being a man refers to my permanent possibility of being-seen-by-him; that is, to the permanent possibility that a subject who sees me may be substituted for the object seen by me. "Being-seen-by-the-Other" is the truth of "seeing-the-Other." Thus the notion of the Other can not under any circumstances aim at a solitary, extra-mundane consciousness which I can not even think. The man is defined by his relation to the world and by his relation to myself. He is that object in the world which determines an internal flow of the universe, an intcrnal hemorrhage. He is the subject who is revealed to me in that flight of myself toward objectivation. But the original relation of myself to the Other is not only an absent truth aimed at across the concrete presence of an object in my universe; it is also a concrete, daily relation which at each instant I experience. At each instant the Other is looking at me. It is easy therefore for us to attempt with concrete examples to describe this fundamental connection which must form the basis of any theory concernin

g the Other. If the
Other is on principle the one WllO looks at me, then we must be able
to explain the meaning of the Other's look.
Every look directed toward me is manifested in connection with the
appearance of a sensible form in our perceptive field, but contrary to what
might be expected, it is not connected with any determined form. Of
course what most·often manifests a look is the convergence of two ocular
globes in my direction. But the look will be given just as well on occasion
when there is a rustling of branches, or the sound of a footstep followed
by silence, or the slight opening of a slmtter, or a light movement of a
curtain. During an attack men who are crawling through the brush appre-

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hend as a look to be avoided, not two eyes, but a white farm-house which
is outlined against the sky at't:he top of a little hill. It is obvious that
the object thus constituted still manifests the look as being probable. It
is only probable that behind the bush which has just moved there is some-
one hiding who is watching me. But this probability need not detain us
for the moment; we shall return to this point later. What is important
first is to define the look in itself. Now the bush, the farmhouse are not
the look; they only represent the eye, for the eye is not at first apprehended
as a sensible organ of vision but as the support for the look. They never
refer therefore to the actual eye ofthe watcher hidden behind the curtain,
behind a window in the farmhouse. In themselves they are already eyes.
On the other hand neither is the look one quality among others of the ob-
ject which functions as an eye, nor is it the total form of that object, nor
a "worldly" relation which is established between that object and me.
On the contrary, far from perceiving the look on the objects which mani-
fest it, my apprehension of a look turned toward me appears on the ground
of .the destruction of the eyes which "look at me." If I apprehend the
look, I cease to perceive. the eyes; they are there, they remain in the
field of my perception as pure presentations, but I do not make any use
of them; they are neutralized, put out of play; they are no longer the ob-
ject of a thesis but remain in that state of "disconnection"1G in which
the world is put by a consciousness practicing the phenomenologicalre-
duction prescribed by HusserI. It is never when eyes are looking at you
that you can find them beautiful or ugly, that you can remark on their
color. The Other's look hides his eyes; he seems to go in front of them.
This illusion stems from the fact that eyes as objects of my perception re-
main at a precise distance which unfolds from me to them (in a word,
I am present to the eyes without distance, but they are distant from the
place where I "find myself") whereas the look is upon me without distance
while at the same time it holds me at a distance-that is, its immediate
presence to me unfolds a distance which removes me from it. I can not
therefore direct my attention on the look without at the same stroke
causing my perception to decompose and pass into the background. There
is produced here something analogous to what I attempted to show else-
where in connection with the subject of the imagination.n We can not,
I said then, perceive and imagine simultaneously; it must be either one
or the other. I should willingly say here: we can not perceive the world
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d at the same time apprehend a look fastened upon us; it must be either one or the other. This is because to perceive is to look at, and to apprehend a look is not to apprehend a look-as-object in the world (unless the look is not directed upon us); it is to be conscious of being looked at.

16 Literally, "put out of circuit" (mise lJOrs circuit). Tr.

17 L'Imaginaire. N.R.F., 1940. In English, The Psychology of the Imagination. Philosophical Library, 1948.

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The look which the eyes manifest, no matter what kind of eyes they are is a pure reference to myself. What I apprehend immediately when I hear the branches crackling behind me is not that tIlere is someone there; it is that I am vulnerable, that I have a body which can be hurt, that I occupy a place and that I can not in any case escape from the space in which I am without defense-in short, that I am seen. Thus the look is first an intermediary which refers from me to myself. What is the nature of this intermediary? What. does being seen mean for me?

Let us imagine that moved by jealousy, curiosity, or vice I have just glued my ear to the door and looked through a keyhole. I am alone and on the level of a non-thetic self-consciousness. This means first of all that there is no self to inhabit my consciousness, nothing therefore to which I can refer my acts in order to qualify them. They are in no way known; I am my acts and hence they carry in themselves their whole justification. I am a pure consciousness of things, and things, caught up in the circuit of my selfness, offer to me their potentialities as the proof of my non-thetic consciousness (of) my own possibilities. This means that behind that door a spectacle is presented as "to be seen," a conversation as "to be heard." The door, the keyhole are at once both instruments and obstacles; they are presented as "to be handled with care;" the keyhole is given as "to be looked through close by and a little to one side," etc. Hence from this moment "I do what I have to do." No transcending view comes to confer upon my acts the character of a given on which a judgment can be brought to bear. My consciousness sticks to my acts, it is my acts; and my acts are commanded only by the ends to be attained and by the instruments to be employed. My attitude, for example, has no "outside"; it is a pure process of relating the instrument (the keyhole) to the end.tone attained (the spectacle to be seen), a pure mode of losing myself in the world, of causing myself to be drunk in by things as ink is by a blotter in order that an instrumental-complex oriented toward an end may be synthetically detached on the ground of the world. The order is the reverse of causal order. It is the end to be attained which organizes all the moments which precede it. The end justifies the means; the means do not exist for themselves and outside the end.

Moreover the ensemble exists only in relation to a free project of my possibilities. Jealousy, as the possibility which I 'am, organizes this instrumental complex by transcending it toward itself. But I am this jealousy; I do not know it. If I contemplated it instead of making it, then only the worldly complex of instrumentality could teach it to me. This ensemble in the world with its double and inverted detennination (there is a spectacle to be seen behind the door only because I am jealous, but my jealousy is n

hus I do not aim at
the Other as an object nor at my Ego as an object for myself; I do not
even direct an empty intention toward that Ego as toward an object pre-
sently out of my reach. In fact it is separated from me by a nothingness
which I can not fill since I apprehend it as not being for me and since
on principle it exists for the Other. Therefore I do not aim at it as if
it could someday be given me but on the contrary in so far as it on principle
flees from me and will never belong to me. Nevertheless I am that Ego;
I do not reject it as a strange image, but it is present to me as a self which
I am without knowing it; for I discover it in shame and, in other instances,
in pride. It is shame or pride which revealS to me the Other's look and
myself at the end of that look. It is the shame or pride which makes
me live, not know the situation of being looked at.
Now, shame, as we noted at the beginning of this chapter, is shame
of self; it is the recognition of the fact that I am indeed that object
which the Other is looking at and judging. I can be ashamed only as my
freedom escapes me in order to become a given object. Thus originally
the bond between my unreflective consciousness and my Ego, which is
being looked at, is a bond not of knowing but of being. Beyond any
knowledge which I can have, I am this self which another knows. And
this self which I am-this I am in a world which the Other has made alien
to me, for the Other's look embraces my being and correlatively the walls,
the door, the keyhole. All these instrumental-things in the midst of which
I am, now turn toward the Other a face which on principle escapes me.
Thus I am my Ego for the Other in the midst of a world which flow3 to-
ward the Other. Earlier we were able to call this internal hemorrhage the
flow of my world toward the Other-as-object. This was because the flow of
blood was trapped and localized by the very fact that I fixed as an object
in my world that Other toward which this world was bleeding. Thus not
a drop of blood was lost; all was recovered, surrounded, localized although
in a being which I could not penetrate. Here on the contrary the flight
is without limit; it is lost externally; the world flows out of the world and
I flow outside myself. The Other's look makes me be beyond my being
in this world and puts me in the midst of the world which is at once this
world and beyond this world. What sort of relations can I enter into with
this being which I am and which shame reveals to me?
In the first place there is a relation of being. I am this being. I do not
for an instant think of denying it; my shame is a confession. I shall be
able later to use bad faith so as to hide it from myself, but bad faith is
also a confession since it is an effort to flee the being which I am. But I
am this being, neither in the mode of "having to be" nor in that of "was;"
I do not found it in its being; I can not produce it directly. But neither
is it theindirect, strict effect of my acts as when my shadow on the ground
or my reflection in the mirror is moved in correlation with the gestures

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which I make. This being which I am preserves a certain indetermination,
a certain unpredictability. And these new characteristics do not come
only from the fact that I can not know the Other; they stem also and
especially from the fact that the. Other is free. Or to be exact and to
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everse the terms, the Other's freedom is revealed to me across the uneasy indetermination of the being which I am for him. Thus this being is not my possible; it is not always in question at the heart of my freedom. On the contrary, it is the limit of my freedom, its "backstage" in the sense thatwe speak of "behind the scenes." It is given to me as a burden which I carry without ever being able to turn back to know it, without even being able to realize its weight. If it is comparable to my shadow, it is like a shadow which is projected on a moving and unpredictable material such that no table of reference can be provided for calculating the distortions resulting from these movements. Yet we still have to do with my being and not with an image of my being. We are dealing with my being as it is written in and by the'Other's freedom. Everything takes place as if I had a dimension of being from which I was separated by a radical nothingness; and this nothingness is the Other's freedom. The Other has to make my being-for-him be in so far as he has to be his being. Thus each of my free conducts engages me in a new environment where the very stuff of my being is the unpredictable freedom of another. Yet by my very shame I claim as mine that freedom of another. I affirm a profound unity of consciousnesses, not that harmony of monads which has sometimes been taken as a guarantee of objectivity but a unity of being; for I accept and wish that others should confer upon me a being which I recognize.

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Shame reveals to me that I am this being, not in the mode of "was" or of "having to be" but in-itself. When I am alone, I can not realize my "being-seated;" at most it can be said that I simultaneously both am it and am not it. But in order for me to be what I am, it suffices merely that the Other look at me. It is not for myself, to be sure; I myself shall never succeed at realizing this being-seated which I grasp in the Other's look. I shall remain forever a consciousness. But it is for the Other. Once more the nihilating escape of the for-itself is fixed, once more the in-itself closes in upon the for-itself. But once more this metamorphosis is effected at a distance. For the Other I am seated as this inkwell is on the table; for the Other, I am leaning over the keyhole as this tree is bent by the wind. Thus for the Other I have stripped myself of my transcendence. This is because my transcendence becomes for whoever makes himself a witness of it (i.e., determines himself as not being my transcendence) a purely established transcendence, a given-transcendence; that is, it acquires a nature by. the sole fact that the Other confers on it an outside. This is accomplished, not by. any distortion or by a refraction which the Other would impose on my transcendence through his categories, but by

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his very being. If there is an Other, whatever or whoever he'may be; whatever may be his relations with me, and without his acting upon me in any way except by the pure upsurge of his being-then I have an outside, I have a nature. My original fall is the existence of the Other. Shame-like pride-is the apprehension of myself as a nature although that very nature escapes me and is unknowable as such. Strictly speaking, it is not that I perceive myself losing my freedom in order to become a thing, but my nature is-over there, outside my lived freedom-as a gi

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attribute of this being which I am for the Other.
I grasp the Other's look at the very center of my act as the solidification and alienation of my own possibilities. In fear or in 3nxious or prudent anticipation, I perceive that these possibilities which I am and which are the condition of my transcendence are given also to another, given as about to be transcended in tum by his own possibilities. The Other as a look is only that-my transcendence transcended. Of course I still am my possibilities in the mode of non-thetic consciousness (of) these possi. bilities. But at the same time the look alienates them from me. Hitherto I grasped these possibilities thetically on the world and in the world in the form of the potentialities of instruments: the dark comer in the hallway referred to me the possibility of hiding-as a simple potential quality of its shadow, as the invitation of its darkness. This quality or instrumentality of the object belonged to it alone and was given as an objective, ideal property marking its real belonging to that complex which we have called situation. But with the Other's look a new organization of complexes comes to superimpose itself on the first. To apprehend myself as seen is, in f:lct, to apprehend myself as seen in the world and from the standpoint of the world. The look does notcarveme out in the universe; it comes to search for me at the heart of my situation and grasps me only in irresolvable relations with instruments. If I am seen as seated, 1 must be seen as "seated-on-a-chair," if I am grasped as bent over, it is as "bent-over-the-keyhole," etc. But suddenly the alienation of myself, which is the act of being-looked-at, involves the alienation of 'the world which I or- ' gariize. I am seen as seated on this chair with the result that I do not see it at all, that it is impossible for me to see it, that it escapes me so as' to organize itself into a new and differently oriented complex-with other relations and other distances in the midst of other objects which similarly have for me a secret face.
Thus I, who in so far as I am my possibles, am what I am not and am not what I am-behold now I am somebody! And the one who I am-and who on principle escapes me-I am he in the midst of'the world in so far as he escapes me. Due to this fact my relation to an object or the potenti~ ality of an'object decomposes under the Other's look and appears to me in the world as my possibility of utilizing the object, but only as this possibility on principle escapes me; that is, in so far as it is surpassed by

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the Other toward his own possibilities. For example, the potentiality of the dark corner becomes a given possibility of hiding in the comer by the sole fact that the OtherI8 can pass beyond it toward his possibility of illuminating the corner with his flashlight. This possibility is there, and I apprehend it but as absent, as in the Other; I apprehend it through my anguish and through my decision to give up that hiding place which is "too risky." Thus my possibilities are present to my unreflective con- sciousness in so far as the Other is watching me. If I see him ready for anything, his hand in his pocket where he has a weapon, his finger placed on the electric bell and ready "at the slightest movement on my part" to call the police, I apprehend my possibilities from outside and through him atthe same time tha

t I am my possibilities, somewhat as we objec-
tively apprehend our thought through language at the same time that we
think it in order to express it in language. This inclination to run away,
which dominates me and carries me along and which I am-this I read
in the Other's watchful look and in that other look-the gun pointed at
me. The Other apprehends this inclination in me in so far as he has .an-
ticipated it and is already prepared for it. He apprehends it in me in so far
as he surpasses it and disarms it. But I do not grasp the actual surpassing; I
grasp simply the death of my possibility. A subtle death: for my possibility
of hiding still remains my possibility; inasmuch as I am it, itstill lives; and
the dark corner does not cease to signal me, to refer its potentiality to me.
But if instrumentality is defined as the fact oJ "being able to be surpassed
towards --," then my very possibility becomes an instrumentality. My
possibility of hiding in the corner becomes the fact that the Other can
surpass it toward his possibility of pulling me out of concealment, of
identifying me, of arresting me. For the Other my possibility is at once an
obstacle and a means as all instruments are. It is an obstacle, for it will
compel him to certain new acts (to advance toward me, to turn on his
flashlight). It is a means, for once I am discovered in this cul-de-sac, I "am
caught." In other words every act performed against the Other can on
principle be for the Other an instrument which will serve him against me.
And I grasi> the Other not in the clear vision of what he can make out of
my act but in a fear which lives all my possibilities as ambivalent. The
Other is the hidden death of my possibilities in so far as I live that death
as hidden in the midst of the world. The connection between my possi-
bility and the instrument is no more than between two instruments
which are adjusted to each other outside in view of an end which escapes
me. Both the obscurity of the dark corner and my possibility of hiding
there are surpassed by the Other when, before I have been able to make
a move to take refuge there, he throws the light on the corner.. Thus in
the shock which seizes me when I apprehend the Other's look, this hap-
18 The French has l'auteur, "the author," which I feel sure must be a misprint for
l'autrui, "the Other," Tr.
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pens-that suddenly I experience a subtle alienation of all my possibilities,
which are now associated with objects of the world, far from me in the
midst of the world.
Two important consequences result. The first is that my possibility
becomes a probability which is outside me. In so far as the Other grasps
it as eaten away by a freedom which he is not, in so far as he makes himself
a witness of it and calculates its results, it is a pure indetennination in
the game of possib:-:s, and it is precisely thus that I guess at it. Later
when we are in direct connection witlYthe Other by language and when
we gradually learn what he thinks of us, this is the thing which will be
able at once to fascinate us and fill us with horror.
"I swear to you that I will do it."
"Maybe so. You tell me so. I want to believe you. It is indeed possible
that you will do it."
The sense of this dialogue implies that the Other is originally placed
before my freedom as before a given property of indetermination and
before my possibles as before my prob

ables. This is because originally
J perceive myself to be over there for the Other, and this phantom-out-
line of my being touches me to the heart. For in shame and anger and
fear I do not cease to assume myself as such. Yet I assume myself in
blindness since I do not know what I assume. I simply am it.
On the other hand, the ensemble "instrument-possibility," made up
of myself confronting the instrument, appears to me as surpassed and
organized into a world by the Other. With the Other's look the "situa-
tion" escapes me. To use an everyday expression which better expresses
our thought, I am no longer master of the situation. Or more exactly,
I remain master of it, but it has one real dimension by which it escapes
me, by which unforeseen reversals cause it to be otherwise than it appears
for me. To be sure it can happen that in strict solitude I perform an
act whose consequences are completely opposed to my anticipations and
to my desires; for example I gently draw toward me a small platform hold-
ing this fragile vase, but this movement results in tipping over a bronze
statuette which breaks the vase into a thousand pieces. Here, however,
there is nothing which I could not have foreseen if I had been more
careful, if I had observed the arrangement of the objects, etc.-,nothing
which on principle escapes me. The appearance of the Other, on the
contrary, causes the appearance in the situation of an aspect which I did
not wish, of which I am not master, and which on principle escapes me
since it is for the Other. This is what Gide has appropriately called "the
devil's part." It is the unpredictable but still real reverse side.
It is this unpredictability which Kafka's art attempts to describe in
The Trial and The Castle. In one sense everything which K. and the
Surveyor are doing belongs strictly to them in their own right, and in so
far as they act upon the world the r~sults conform strictly to anticipa-

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tions; they are· successful acts. But at the same time the truth of these
acts constantly escapes .them; the acts have on principle a meaning which
is their true meaning and which neither K. nor the Surveyor willever
know. Without doubt Kafka is trying here to express the transcendence
of the divine; it is for the divine that the human act is constituted in
truth. But God here is only the concept of the Other pushed to the limit.
We shall return to this point. That gloomy, evanescent atmosphere of·
TIle Trial, that ignorance which, however, is lived as ignorance, that total
opacity which can only be felt as a presentiment across a total translucency
-this is nothing but the description of our being-in-the-midst-of-the-
world-for-others.
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In this way therefore the situation in and through its surpassing for the
Other is fixed and organized around me into a form, in the sense in which
the Gestaltists use that term. A given synthesis is there of which I am
the essential structure, and this synthesis at once possesses both ekstatic
cohesion and the character of the in-itself. My bond with those people
who are speaking and whom I am watching is suddenly given outside me
as an unknowable substratum of the bond which I· myself establish. In
particular my own look or my connection without distance with these
people is stripped of its transcendence by the very fact that it is a look-
looked-at. I am fixing the people Whom I see into objects; I am i

n relation
to them as the Other is in relation to me. In looking at them I measure
my power. But if the Other sees them and sees me, then my look loses
its power; it can not transform those people into objects for tIle Other
since they are already the objects of his look. My look simply manifests
a relation in the midst of the world, a relation of myself-as-object to the
object-looked-at-something like the attraction which two masses exert
over ~>ne another at a distance. On the one hand, the objects are ordered
around this look: the distance between me and those looked at exists
at present, but it is contracted, circumscribed, and compressed by my
look so that the ensemble "distance-objects" is like a ground on which
the look is detached in the manner of a "this" on the ground of
the world. On the other hand, my attitudes are ordered around the look
and are given as a series of means employed in order to "maintain" the
look. In this· sense I constitute an organized whole which is the look,
I am a look-as-object; that is, an instrumental complex which is endowed
with an inner finality and which can dispose itself in a relation of means
and end in order to realize a presence to a particular otller object beyond
the distance. But the distance is given to me. In so far as I am looked at,
I do not unfold tlle distance, I am limited to clearing it. The Other's
look confers spatiality upon me. To apprehend oneself as looked-at is to
apprehend oneself as a spatializing-spatialized.
But the Other's look is not only apprehended as spatializing; it is also
temporalizing. The appearance of the Other's look is manifested for me

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through an Erlebnis which was on principle impossible for me to get in
solitude-that of simultaneity. A world for a single for-itself could not
comprehend simultaneity but only co-presences, for the for-itself is lost
outside itself everywhere in the world, and it links all beings by the unity
of its single presence. But simultaneity supposes the temporal·connec-
tion of two existents which are not bound by any other relation. Two
existents which exercise a reciprocal action on one another are not simul-
taneous because they belong to the same system. Simultaneity therefore
does not belong to the existents of the world, it supposes the co-presence
to the world of two presents considered .as presences-to. Pierre's presence
to the world is simultaneous with my presence. In this sense the original
phenomenon of simultaneity is the fact that this glass is for Paul at the
same time that it is for me. This supposes therefore a foundation for all
simultaneity which must of necessity be the presence of an Other who is
temporalized by my own temporalization. But to be exact, in so far as the
other temporalizes himself, he temporalizes me with him; in so far as he
launches out toward his own time, I appear to him in universal time.
The Other's look in so far as I apprehend it comes to give to my time- a
new dimension. My presence, in so far as it is a present grasped by an-
other as my present, has an outside; this presence which m<tkes-itself-pres-
entfor me is alienated for me in a present to which the Other makes
himself present. I am thrown into the universal present in so _far as the
Other makes himself be a presence to me. But the universal present in
which I come to take my place is a pure alienation of my universal present;

physical time flows toward a pure and free temporalization which I am not; what is outlined on the horizon of that simultaneity which I live is an absolute temporalization from which lam separated by a nothingness. .As a temporal-spatial object in the world, as an essential structure. ola temporal-spatial situation in the world, I offer myself to the Other's.appraisal. This also I apprehend by the pure exercise ofthe cogito. To be looked at is to apprehend oneself as the unknown object of unknowable appraisals-in particular, of value judgments. But at the same time that in shame or pride I recognize the justice of these appraisals, Ido not cease to take them for what they. are-a free surpassing of the given toward possibilities. A judgment is the transcendental act of a free being. Thus being-seen constitutes me as a defenseless being for a freedom which is not my freedom. It is. in this sense that we can consider ourselves as "slaves" in ,so far as we appear to the Other. But this slavery is not a historical result-capable of being surmounted-of a life ,in the abstract form of consciousness. I am a slave to the degree that my being is dependent at the center of a freedom which is not mine and which is the very condition of my being. In so far as I am the object of values which come to qualify me without my being able to act on this qualification or even. to know it, I am enslaved. By the same. token in so far as I .am

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the instrument of possibilities which are not my possibilities, whose pure presence beyond my being I can not even glimpse, and which deny my transcendence in order to constitute me as a means to ends of which I am ignorant-I am in danger. This danger is not an accident but the permanent structure of my being-for-others..

This brings us to the end of our description. Yet before we can make use of it to discover just what the Other is, we must note that this description has been worked out entirely on the level of the cogito. We have only made explicit the meaning of those subjective reactions to the Other's look which are fear (the feeling of being in danger before the Other's freedom), pride, or shame (the feeling of being finally what I am but elsewhere, over there for the Other), the recognition of my slavery (the feeling of the alienation of all my possibilities). In addition this specification is not merely a conceptual fixing of bits of knowledge more or less obscure. Let each one refer to his own experience. There is no one who has not at some time been surprised in an attitude which was guilty or simply ridiculous. The abrupt modification then experienced was in no way provoked by the irruption of knowledge. It is rather in itself a solidification and an abrupt stratification of myself which leaves intact my possibilities and my structures "for-myself," but which suddenly pushes me into a new dimension of existence-the dimension of the unrevealed. Thus the appearance of the look is apprehended by me as the upsurge of an ekstatic relation of being, of which one term is the "me" as for-itself which is what it is not and which is not what it is, and of which other term is still the "me" but outside my reach, outside my action, outside my knowledge. This term, since it is directly connected with the infinite possibilities of a free Other, is itself an infinite and inexhaustible synthesis of unrevealed properti

es. Through the Other's look I live my-
self as fixed in the midst of the world, as in danger, as irremediable. But I know neither what I am nor what is my place in the world, not what face this world in which I am turns toward the Other.
Now at last we can make precise the meaning of this upsurge of the Other in and through his look. The Other is in no way given to us as an object. The objectivation of the Other would be the collapse of his be-
ing-as-a-look. Furthermore as we have seen, the Other's look is the disap-
pearance of the Other's eyes as objects which manifest the look. The Other can not even be the object aimed at emptily at the horizon of my be-
ing for the Other. The objectivation of the Other, as we shall see, is a de-
fence on the part of my being which, precisely by conferring on the Other a being for-me, frees me from my being-for the Other. In the phenomenon of the look, the Other is on principle that which can not be an object.
At the same time we see that he can not be a limiting term of that relation of myself to myself which makes me arise for myself as the unrevealed. Neither can the Other be the goal of my attention; if in the upsurge of

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the Other's look, I paid attention to the look or to the Other, this could be only as to objects, for attention is an intentional direction toward objects. But it is not necessary to conclude that the Other is an abstract condition, a conceptual structure of the ekstatic relation; there is here in fact no object really thought, of which the Other could be a universal, formal structure. The Other is, to be sure, the condition of my being-un-
levealed. But he is the concrete, particular condition of it. He is not engaged in my being in the midst of the world as one of its integral parts since he is precisely that which transcends this world in the midst of which I am as non-revealed; as such he can therefore be neither an object nor the formal, constituent element of an object. He can not appear to me, as we have seen, as a unifying or regulative category of my experience since he comes to me through an encounter. Then what is the Other?
In the first place, he is the being toward whom I do not turn myatten-
tion. He is the one who looks at me and at whom I am not yet looking, the one who delivers me to myself as unrevealed but without revealing l}imself, the one who is present to me as directing at me but never as the object of my direction; he is the concrete pole (though out of reach) of my flight, of the alienation of my possibles, and of the flow of the world toward another world which is the same world and yet lacks all communication with it. But he can not be distinct from this same alienation and flow; he is the meaning and the direction of them; he haunts this flow not as a real or categorial element but as a presence which is fixed and made part of the world if I attempt to "make-it-present" and which is never more present, more urgent than when I am not aware of it. For example if I am wholJy engulfed in my shame, the Other is the immense, invisible presence which supports this shame and embraces it on evcry side; he is the supporting environment of my being-unrevealed.
Let us sce what it is which the Other manifests as unrevealable across my lived experience of the unrevealed.
First, the Otller's look as the nccessarf condition of my objectivity is the destruction of all

objectivity for me. The Other's look touches me
across the world and is not only a transformation of myself but a total metamorphosis of the world. I am looked-at in a world which is looked-at. In particular the Other's look, which is a look-looking and not a look-looked-at, denies my distances from objects and unfolds its own distances. This look of the Other is given immediately as that by which distance comes to the world at the hcart of a presence without distance. I withdraw; I am stripped of my distanceless presence to my world, and I am providcd with a distancc from the Other. There I am fifteen paces from the door, six yards from the window. But the Othcr comes searching for me so as to constitute me at a certain distance from him. As the Other constitutes me as at six yards from him, it is necessary that he be present to me without distance. Thus within the very experience of my

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distance from things and from the Other, I experience the distance1ess presence of the Oth((r to me.
Anyone may recognize in this abstract description that immediate and burning presence-of the Other's look which has so often filled him with shame. In other words, in so far as I experience myself as looked-at, there is realized for me a trans-mundane presence of the Other. The Other looks at me not as he is "in the midst of" my world but as he comes toward the world and toward me from all his transendence; when he looks at me, he is separated from me by no distance, by no object of the world-whether real or ideal-by no body in the world, but the sale fact of his nature as Other. Thus the appearance of the Other's look is not an appearance in the world-neither in "mine" nor in the "Other's"-and the relation which unites me to the Other cannot be a relation of exteriority inside the world. By the Other's look I effect the concrete proof that there is a "beyond the world." The Other is present to me without any intermediary as a transcendence which is not mine. But this presence is not reciprocal. All of the world's density is necessary in order that Lmay myself be present to the Other. An omnipresent and inapprehensible transcendence, posited upon me without intermediary as I am my being-unreveakd, a transcendence separated from me by the infinity of being, as I am plunged by this look into the heart of a world complete with its distances and its instruments-such is the Other's look when first I experience it as a look.
Furthermore by fixing my possibilities the Other reveals to me the impossibility of my being an object except for another freedom. I can not be an object for myself, forI am what I am; thrown back on its own resources, the reflective effort toward a dissociation results in failure; I am always reapprehended by myself. And when I naively assume that it is possible for me to be an objective being without being responsible for it, I thereby implicitly suppose the Other's existence; for how could I be an object if not for a subject. Thus for me the Other is first the being for whom I am an object; that is, the being through whom I gain my abjectness. If I am to be able to conceive of even one of my properties in the objective mode, then the Other is already given. He is giv~n not as a being of my universe but as a pure subject. Thus this pure subject which by definition 1am unable to know-i.e., to posit as object-is always there out

of reach and without distance whenever I try to grasp myself as object. In experiencing the look, in experiencing myself as an unrevealed object-ness, I experience the inapprehensible subjectivity of the Other directly and with my being.

At the same time I experience the Other's infinite freedom. It is for and by means of a freedom and only for and by means of it that my possibles can be limited and fixed. A material obstacle. can not fix my possibilities; it is only the occasion for my projecting myself toward other

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possibles and can not confer upon them an outside. To remain at home because it is raining and to remain at home because one has been forbidden to go out are by no means the same thing. In the first case I myself detennine to stay inside in consideration of the consequences of my acts; I surpass the obstacle "rain" toward myself and I make an instrument of it. In the second case it is my very possibilities of going out of or staying inside which are presented to me as surpassed and fixed and which a freedom simultaneously foresees and prevents. It is not mere caprice which causes us often to do very naturally and without annoyance what would irritate us if another commanded it. This is because the order and the prohibition cause us to experience the Other's freedom across our own slavery. Thus in the look the death of my possibilities causes me to experience the Other's freedom. This death is realized only at the heart of that freedom; I am inaccessible to myself and yet myself, thrown, abandoned at the heart of the Other's freedom. In connection with this experience my belonging to universal time can appear to me only as contained and realized by an autonomous temporalization; only a· for-itself which temporalizes itself can throw me into time.

Thus through the look I experience the Other concretely as a free, conscious subject who causes there to be a world by temporalizing him5elf toward his own possibilities. That subject's presence without intermediary is the necessary condition of all thought which I would attempt to form concerning myself. The Other is that "myself" from which nothing separates me, absolutely nothing except his pure and total freedom; that is, that indetermination of himself which he has to be for and through himself.

We know enough at present to attempt to explain that unshakable resistance which common sense has always opposed to the solipsistic argument. This resistance indeed is based on the fact that the Other is given to me as a concrete evident presence which I can in no way derive from myself and which can in no way be placed in doubt nor made the object of a phenomenological reduction or of any other E7rOX~.19 ..

If someone looks at me, I am conscious of being an object. But this t 'lnseiousness can be produced only in and through the existence of the Other. In this respect.Hegei was right. However tl13t other consciousness and that other freedom are never' given to me; for if they were, they would be' known and would therefore be an object, which would cause me to cease being an object. Neither can I derive the concept or the representation of them from my own background. First because I do not "conceive" them nor "represent" them to myself; expressions like these would refer us again to "knowing," which on principle is removed from ~onsideration. In addition this concrete

proof of freedom which I
can effect by myself is the proof of my freedom; every concrete appre-
hension of a consciousness is consciousness (of) my consciousness; the
19 Correction for ir6x~. Tr.

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very notion of consciousness makes reference only to my possible con~~
sciousnesses. Indeed we established in our Introduction that the erist-
ence of freedom and of consciousness precedes and conditions their es-
sence; consequently these essences can subsume only concrete exemplifica-
tions of my consciousness or of my freedom. In the third place the Other's
freedom and consciousness can not be categories serving for the unification
of my representations. To be sure, as Husserl has shown, the ontological
structure of "my" world demands that it be also a world for others.
But to the extent that the Other confers a particular type of objec-
tivity on the objects of my world, this is because he is already in this
world in the capacity of an object. If it is correct that Pierre, who is reading
before me, gives a particular type of objectivity to the face of the book
which is turned toward him, then this objectivity is conferred on a face
which on principle I can see (although as we have said, it escapes me in
so far as it is read), on a face which belongs to the world where I am and,
which consequently by a magic bond is connected beyond distance to
Pierre-as-object. Under these conditions the concept of the Other ca'n in
fact be fixed as an empty form and employed constantly as a reinforce-
ment of objectivity for the world which is mine. But the Other's presence
in his look-looking can not contribute to reinforce the world, for on the
contrary it undoes the world by the very fact that it causes the world to
escape me. The escape of the world from me when it is relative and when
it is an escape toward the Other-as-object, reinforces objectivity. The
escape of the world and of my self from me when it is absolute and
when it is effected toward a freedom which is not mine, is a dissolution of
my knowledge. The world disintegrates in order to be reintegrated over
there as a world; but this disintegration is not given to me; I can not
know it nor even think it. The presence to me qf the Other-as-a-look
is therefore neither a knowledge nor a projection of my being nor a form
of unification nor a category. It is and I can not derive it from me.
At the same time I can not make it fall beneath the stroke of the phe-
nomenological
~1I'Ox~. The latter indeed has for its goal putting the world
within brackets so as to reveal transcendental consciousness in its absolute
reality. Whether in general this operation is possible or not is something
which is not for us to decide here. But in the case which concerns us the
Other can not be put out of consideration since as a look-looking he de-
finitely does not belong to the world. I am ashamed of myself before the
Other, we said. The phenomenological reduction must result in remov-
ing from consideration the object of shame in order better to make shame
itself stand out in its absolute subjectivity. But the Other is not the
object of the shame; the object is my act or my situation in the world.
They alone can be strictly "reduced." The Other is not even an objective
condition of my shame. Yet he is as the very.being of it. Shame is the
revelation of the Other not in the way in which a consciousness reveals

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an object but in the way in which one moment of consciousness implies on the side another moment as its motivation. If we should have attained pure consciousness by rileans of the eogito, and if this pure consciousness were only a consciousness (of being) shame, the Other's consciousness would still haunt it as an inapprehensible presence and would thereby escape all reduction. This demonstrates sufficiently that it is not in the world that the Other is first to be sought but at the side of consciousness as a consciousness in which and by which consciousness makes itself be what it is. Just as my consciousness apprehended by the cogito bears indubitable witness of itself.and of its own existence, so certain particular consciousncsses-for example, "shame-consciousness"-bear indubitable witness to the eogito both of themselves and of the existence of the Other. But, sOmeone may object, is this not simply because of the Other's look as meaning of my objectivity-for-myself. If so, we shall fall back into solipsism; when I integrate myself as an object in the concrete system of representations, the meaning of this objectivation would be projected out· side me and hypostasized as the Other.

.But we must note the following:

(1) My object-ness for myself is in no way a specification of Hegel's leh bin leh. We are not dealing with a formal identity, and my being-as-object or being-for-others is profoundly different from my being-for-myself. In fact the notion of objectivity, as we observed in Part One, requires an explicit negation. The object is that which is not my consciousness; consequently it is that which does not have the characteristics of consciousness since the only existent which has for me the characteristics of consciousness is the consciousness which is mine. Thus the Me-as-objcct-for-myself is a Me which is not Me; that is, which does not have the characteristics of consciousness. It is a degraded consciousness; objectivation IS a radical metamorphosis. Even if I could see myself clearly and distinctly as an object, what I should see would not be the adequate representation of what I am in myself and for myself, of that "incomparable monster preferable to all," as Malraux puts it, but the apprehension of my bcing-outside-:nyseIf, for the Other; that is, the objective apprehen· sion of my being-other, which is radically different from my being-for-myself, and which does not refer to myself at all.

To apprehend myself as evil, for example, could not be to refer myself to what I am for myself, for I am not and can not be evil for myself for two reasons. In the first place, I am not evil any morc than I am a civil servant or a physician. In fact I am in the mode of not being what I am and of being what I am not. The qualification "evil," on the contrary, characterizes me as an in-itself. In the second place, if I were to be evil for myself, I should of necessity be so in the mode of having to be so and would have to apprehend myself and will myself as evil. But this would mean that I must discover myself as willing what appe;1rs to myself

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as the opposite of my Good and precisely because it is the Evil or the opposite of my Good. It is therefore expressly necessary that I will the contrary of what I desire at one and the same moment and in the same relation; that is, I would have to

hate myself precisely as I am myself. If
on the level of the for-itself I am to realize fully this essence of evil, it would be necessary for me to assume myself as evil; that is, I would have to approve myself by the same act which makes me blame myself. We can see that this notion of evil can in no way derive its origin from me in so far as I am Me. It would be in vain for me to push the ekstasis to its extreme limits or to effect a detachment from self which would constitute me for myself; I sllall never succeed in confetring evil on myself or even in conceiving it for myself if I am thrown on my own resources.
This is because I am my own detachment, I am my own nothingness; simply because I am my own mediator between Me and Me, all objectivity disappears. I can not be this nothingness which separates me ·from me-as-object, for there must of necessity be a presentation to me of· the object which I am. Thus I can not confer on myself any quality without mediation or an objectifying power which is not my own power and which I can neither pretend nor forge. Of course this has been said before; it was said a long time ago that the Other teaches me who I am. But the same people who uphold this thesis affirm on the other hand that I derive the concept of the Other from myself by reflecting on my own powers and by projection or analogy. Therefore they remain at the center of a vicious circle from which they can not get out. Actually the Other can not be the meaning of my objectivity; he is the concrete, transcending condition of it. This is because such qualities as "evil," "jealous," "sympathetic" or "antipathetic" and the like are not empty imaginings; when I use them to qualify the Other, I am well aware that I want to touch him in his being. Yet I can not live them as my own realities. If the Other confers them on me, they are admitted by what I am for-myself; when the Other describes my character, I do not "recognize" myself and yet I know that "it is me." I accept the responsibility for this stranger who is presented to me, but he does not cease to be a stranger. This is because he is neither a simple unification of my subjective representations, not a "Me" which I am in the sense of the Icll bin Icll, nor an empty image which the Other makes of me for himself and for which he alone bears the responsibility. This Me, which is not to be compared to the Me which I have to be, is still Me but metamorphosed by a new setting and adapted to that setting; it is a being, my being but with entirely new dimensions of being and new modalities. It is Me separated from Me by an impassible nothingness, for I am this me but I am not this nothingness which separates me from myself. It is the Me which I am by an ultimate ekstasis which transcends all my ekstases since it is not the ekstasis which I have to be. My being for-others is a fall through absolute emptiness toward

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objectivity. And since this fall is an alienation, I can not make myself be for myself as an object; for in no case can I ever alienate myself from myself.
(2) Furthermore the Other does not constitute me as an object for myself but for llim. In other words he does not serve as a regulative or constitutive concept for the pieces of knowledge which I may have of myself. Therefore the Other's presence does not cause me-as-object to "appear." I apprehend nothing but an escape fro

m myself toward --.
Even when language has revealed that the Other considers me evil or jealous, I shall never have a concrete intuition ofmy evil or of my jealousy. These will never be more than fleeting notions whose very nature will be to escape me. I shall not apprehend my evil, but in relation to this or that particular act I shall escape myself, I shall feel my alienation or my flow towards ... a being which I shall only be able to think emptily as evil and which nevertheless I shall feel that I am, which I shall live at a distance through shame or fear.
Thus myself-as-object is neither knowledge nor a unity of knowledge but an uneasiness,a lived wrenching away from the ekstatic unity of the for-itself, a limit which I can not reach and which yet I am. The Other through whom this Me comes to me is neither knowledge nor category but the fact of the presence of a strange freedom. In fact my wrenching away from myself and the upsurge of the Other's freedom are one; I can feel them and live them only as an ensemble; I cannot even try to conceive of one without the other. The fact of the Other is incontestable and touches me to the heart. I realize him through uneasiness; through him I am perpetually in danger in a world which is this world and which nevertheless I can only glimpse. The Other does not appear to me as a being who is. constituted first so as to encounter me later; he appears as a being who arises in an original relation of being with me and whose indubitability and factual necessity are those of my own consciousness.
A number of difficulties remain. In particular there is the fact that through shame we confer on the Other an indubitable presence. Now as we have seen, it is only probable that the Other is looking at me. That farm at the top of the hill seems to be looking at the commandos, and it is certain that the house is occupied by the enemy. But it is not certain that the enemy soldiers are at present watching 'through the windows. It is not certain that the man whose footstep I hear behind me is looking at me; his face could be turned away, his look fixed on the ground or on a book. Finally in general it is not sure that those' eyes which are fixed on me are eyes; they could be only "artificial ones" resembling real eyes.
In short must we not say that in tum the look becomes probable because of the fact that r can constantly believe that I am looked-at without actually being so? As a result does not our certainty of the Other's existence take on a purely hypothetical character?

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The difficulty can be expressed in these tenns: On the occasion of certain appearances in the world which seem to me to manifest a look, I apprehend in myself a certain "being-looked-at" with its own structures which refer me to the Other's real existence. But it is possible that I am mistaken; perhaps the objects of the world which I took for eyes were not eyes; perhaps it was only the wind which shook the bush behind me; in short perhaps these concrete objects did not really manifest a look.
In this case what becomes of my certainty that I am looked-at? My shame was in fact shame before somebody. But nobody is there. Does it not thereby becOIJle shame before nobody? Since it has posited somebody where there was nobody, does it not become a false shame?
This difficulty should not deter us for long, and we should not even have mentioned

it except that actually it can help us in our investigation by
indicating more purely the nature of our being-for-others. There is indeed
a confusion here between two distinct orders of knowledge and two types
of being which can not be compared. We have always known that the
object-in-the-world can be only probable. This is due to its very character
as object. It is probable that the passerby is a man; if he turns his eyes
toward me, then although I immediately experience and with certainty
the fact of being-looked-at, I can not make this certainty pass into my
experience of the Other-as-object. In fact it reveals to me only the Other-
as-subject, a transcending presence to the world and the real condition of
my being-as-object. In every causal state, therefore, it is impossible
to transfer my certainty of the Other-as-subject to the Other-as-object
which was the occasion of that certainty, and conversely it is impossible
to invalidate the evidence of the appearance of the Other-as-subject by
pointing to the constitutional probability of the Other-as-object. Better
yet, the look, as we have shown, appears on the ground of the destruc-
tion of the object which manifests it. If this gross and ugly passerby shuf-
Jing along toward me suddenly looks at me, then there is nothing left of
his ugliness, his obesity, and his shuffling. During the time that I feel my-
self looked-at he is a pure mediating freedom between myself and me. The
fact of being-looked-at can not therefore depend on the object which
manifests the look. Since my shame as an Erlebnis which is reflectively
apprehensible is a witness for the Other for the same reason as it is its
Own witness, I am not going to put it in question on the occasion of an
object of the world which can on principle be placed in doubt. 111is
would amount to doubting my own existence, for the perceptions which
I have of my own body (when I see my hand, for example) are subject
to error. Therefore if the act of being-looked-at,. in its pure form, is not
bound to the Other's body any more than in the pure realization of the
cogito my consciousness of being a consciousness is not bound to my own
body, then we must consider the appearance of certain objects in the field
of my experience-in particular the convergence of the Other's eyes in
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my direction-as a pure monition, as the pure occasion of realizing my
being-looked-at. In the same way for a Platonist the contradictions of the
sensible world are the occasion of effecting a philosophical conversion.
In a word what is certain is that I am looked-at: what is only probable is
that the look is bound to this or that intra-mundane presence. Moreover
there is nothing here to surprise us since as we have seen, it is never eyes
which look at us; it is the Other-as-subject.
Nevertheless, someone will say, the fact remains that I can discover
that I have been mistaken. Here I am bent over the keyhole; suddenly
I hear a footstep. I shudder as a wave of shame sweeps over me. Some-
body has seen me. I straighten up. My eyes run over the deserted corridor.
It was a false alarm. I breathe a sigh of relief. Do we not have here an
experience which is self-destructive?
Let us look more carefully. Is it actually my being-as-object for the
Other which has been revealed as an error? By no means. The Other's
existence is so far from being placed in doubt that this false ala

rm can
very well result in making me give up my enterprise. If, on the other hand, I persevere in it, I shall feel my heart beat fast, and I shall detect the slightest noise, the slightest creaking of the stairs. Far from disappearing with my first alarm, the Other is present everywhere, below me, above me, in the neighboring rooms, and I continue to feel profoundly my being-for-others. It is even possible that my shame may not disappear; it is my red face as I bend over the keyhole. I do not cease to experience my being-for-others; 'my possibilities do not cease to "die," nor do the distances cease to unfold toward me in terms of the stairway where somebody "could" be, in terms of this dark corner where a human presence "could" hide. Better yet, if I tremble at the slightest noise, if each creak announces to me a look, this is because I am already in the state of being-looked-at. What then is it which falsely appeared and which was self-destructive when I discovered the false alarm? It is not the Other-as-subject, nor is it his presence to me. It is the Other's facticity; that is, the contingent connection between the Other and an object-being in my world. Thus what is doubtful is not the Other himself. It is the Other's being-there; i.e., that concrete, historical event which we can express by the words, "There is someone in this room." .

These observations may enable us to proceed further. The Other's presence in the world can not be derived analytically from the presence of the Other-as-subject to me, for this original presence is transcendent-i.e., being-beyond-the-world. I believed that the Other was present in the room, but I was mistaken. He was not there. He was "absent." What then is absence?

If we take the expression "absence" in its empirical and everyday usage, it is clear that I do not use it to indicate just any kind of "not-being-there." In the first place, if I do not find my package of tobacco in its usual spot,

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I do not say that it is absent even though I could declare that it "ought to be there." This is because the place of a material object or of an instrument, even though sometimes it may be precisely assigned, does not derive from the nature of the object or instrument. To be exact, its nature can barely bestow on it a location but it is through me that the place of an instrument is realized. Human-reality is the being which causes a place to come to objects. Human reality alone, in so far as it is its own possibilities, can originally take a place. On the other hand I shall not say that Aga-Khan or the Sultan of Morocco is absent from this apartment, but I say that Pierre, who usually lives here, is absent for a quarter of an hour. In short, absence is defined as a mode of being of human-reality in relation to locations and places which it has itself determined by its presence. Absence is not a nothingness of connections with a place; on the contrary, I determine Pierre in relation to a determined place by declaring that he is absent from it. Finally I shall not speak of Pierre's absence in relation to a natural location even if he often passes by there. On the other hand, I shall be able to lament his absence from a picnic which "took place" in apart of the country where he has never been. Pierre's absence is defined in relation to a place where he might himself determine himself to be, but this plac

e itself is delimited as a place, not by the site nor even by the solitary relations of the location to Pierre himself, but by the presence of other human-realities. It is in relation to otller people that Pierre is absent. Absence is Pierre's concrete mode of being in relation to Therese; it is a bond between human-realities, not between human-reality and the world. It is in relation to Therese that Pierre is absent from this location. Absence therefore is a bond of being between~o 9r several human-realities which necessitates a fundamental presence ofthese realities one to another and which, moreover, is only one of the particular concretizations of this presence. For Pierre to be absent in relation to Therese is a particular way of his being present. In fact absence has meaning only if all the relations of Pierre with Therese are preserved: he loves her, he is her husband, he supports her, etc. In particular, absence supposes the maintenance of the concrete existence of Pierre: death is not an absence. Due to this fact the distance from Pierre to Therese in no way changes the fundamental fact of their reciprocal presence. In fact if we consider this presence from the point of view of Pierre, we see that it means either that Therese is existing in the midst of the world as the-Other-as-object, or else that he feels that he exists ·for Therese as for the-Other-as-subject. In the first case the distance is made contingent and signifies nothing in relation to the fundamental fact that Pierre is the one by whom "there is" a world as a Totality and that Pierre is present without distance to this world as the one through whom the distance exists. In the second case Pierre feels himself existing for Therese without distance: she is at a distance from him to the extent that she is removed

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and unfolds a distance between her and him; the entire world separates him from her. But for her he is without distance inasmuch as he is an object in the world. which she makes come into being. Consequently in each case removal can not modify these essential relations. Whether the distance is small or great, between Pierre-as-obiect and Therese-as-subject, between Therese-as-objectandPierre-ahilu,ect there is the infinite density of a world. Between Pierre-as-subject and Therese-as-object, and again between Therese-as-subject and Pierre-as-object there is no distance at all. Thus the empirical concepts of absence and of presence are two specifictions of a fundamental presence of Pierre to Therese and of Therese to Pierre. They are only different ways of expressing the presence and have meaning only through it. At London, in the East Indies, in America, on a desert island, Pierre is present to Therese who remains in Paris; he will cease to be present to her only athis death.

This is because a being is not situated in relation to locations by means of degrees of longitude and latitude. He is situated in a human space-between "the Guermantes way" and "Swann's way," and it is the immediate presence of Swann and of the Duchesse de Guermantes which allows the unfolding of the "hodological"20 space in which he is situated. Now this presence has a location in transcendence; it is the presence-to-me in transcendence of my cousin in Morocco which allows me to enfold between him and me this road which situates-me-in-the-world and which can be called the road

to Morocco. This road, indeed, is nothing but
the distance between the Other-as-object which I could perceive in
connection· with my "being-for" the Other-as-subject who is present to
me without distance. Thus I am situated by the infinite diversity of the
roads which lead me to the object of my world in correlation with the
immediate presence of transcendent subjects. And as the world is given
to me all at once with all its beings, these roads represent only the en-
semble of instrumental complexes which allow me to cause an Other-as-
object to appear as a "this" on the ground of the world, an Other-as-object
who is already implicitly and really contained there.
But these remarks can be generalized; it is not only Pierre, Rene, Lucien,
who are absent or present in relation to me on the ground of original
presence, for they are not alone in contributing to situate me; I am situated
also-as a European in relation to Asiatics, or to Negroes, as an old·man in
relation to the young, as a judge in relation to delinquents, asa bour-
geois in relation to workers, etc. In short it is in relation· to every living
man that every human reality is present or absent on t!?-e ground of an
original presence. This original presence can have meaning only as a being-
20 An expression borrowed from Lewin and explained by Sartre in the Emotions, pp. 57 and 65. It refers to a map or spatial organization of our environment in terms of our acts and needs. "The Guerrnantes way" and "Swann's way" are references to Proust's Remembrance of Things Past. Tr.
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looked-at or as a being-looking-at; that is, according to whether the Other
is an object for me or whether I myself am an object-for-the-Other. Being-
for-others is a constant fact of my human reality, and I grasp it with its
factual necessity in every thought, however slight, which I fonn concern-
ing myself. Wherever I go, whatever I do, I only succeed in changing
the distances between me and the Other-as-object, only avail myself of
paths toward the Other. To withdraw, to approach, to discover this partic-
ular Other-as-object is only to effect empirical variations on the funda-
mental theme of my being-for-others. The Other is present to me every-
where as the one through whom I become an object. Hence I can indeed
be mistaken concerning the empirical presence of an Other-as-object
whom I happen to encounter on my path. I can indeed believe that it is
Annie who is coming toward me on the road and discover that it is an un-
known person; the fundamental presence of Annie to me is not thereby
changed. I can indeed believe that it is a man who is watching me in the
half light and discover that it is a trunk of a tree which I took for a human
being; my fundamental presence to all men, the presence of all men to my-
self is not thereby altered. For the appearance of a man as an object in the
field of my experience is not what informs me that there are men. My
certainty of the Other's existence is independent of these experiences and
is, on the contrary, that which makes them possible.
What appears to me then about which I can be mistaken is not the
Other nor the real, concrete bond between the Other and Me; it is a this
which can represent a man-as-object as well as not represent one. What is
only probable is the distance and the real proximity of the Other; that is,
his character as an object and his belonging to th

e world which I cause to
be revealed are not doubtful inasmuch as I make an Other appear by my very upsurge. However this objectivity dissolves in the world as the result of the Other's being "an Other somewhere in the world." The Other-as-object is certain as an appearance correlative with the recovery of my subjectivity, but it is never certain that the Other is that object. Similarly the fundamental fact, my being-as-object for a subject is accompanied by evidence of the same type as reflective evidence, but the case is not the same for the fact that at this precise moment and for a particular Other, I am detached as "this" on the ground of the world rather than remaining drowned in the indistinction of the ground. It is indubitable that at present I exist as an object for some German or other. But do I exist as a Frenchman, as a Parisian in the indifferentiation of these collectivities or in my capacity as this Parisian around whom the Parisian population and the French collectivity are suddenly organized to serve for him as ground? On this point I shall never obtain anything but bits of probable knowledge although they can be infinitely probable.
We are able now to apprehend the nature of the look. In every look there is the appeamnce of an Other-as-object as a concrete and probable

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presence in my perceptive field; on the occasion of certain attitudes of that Other I determine myself to apprehend-through shame, anguish, etc. -my being-looked-at. This "being-looked-at" is presented as the pure probability that I am at present this concrete this-a probability which can derive its meaning and its very nature as probable, only from a fundamental certainty that the Other is always present to me inasmuch as I am always for-others. The proof of my condition as man, as an object for all other living men, as thrown in the arena beneath millions of looks and escaping myself millions of times-this proof I realize concretely on the occasion of the upsurge of an object into my universe if this object indicates to me that I am probably an object at present functioning as a differentiated this for a consciousness. The proof is the ensemble of the phenomenon which we call the look. Each look makes us prove concretely -and in the indubitable eertainty of the cogito-that we exist for all living men; that is, that there are (some) consciousnesses for whom I exist. We put "some" between parentheses to indicate that the Other-as-subject present to me in this look is not given in the form of plurality any more than as unity (save in its concrete relation to one particular Other·as-object). Plurality, in fact, belongs only to objects; it comes into being through the appearance of a world-making For-itself. Being-looked-at, by causing (some) subjects to arise for us, puts us in the presence of an unnumbered reality.
By contrast, as soon as I look at those who are looking at me, the other consciousnesses are isolated in multiplicity. On the other hand if I turn away from the look as the occasion of concrete proof and seek to think emptily of the infinite indistinction of the human presence and to unify it under the concept of the infinite subject which is never an object, then I obtain a purely formal notion which refers to an infinite series of mystic experiences of the presence of the Other, the notion of God as the omnipresent, infinite subject

for whom I exist. But these two ob-
jectivations, the concrete, enumerating objectivation and the unifying, abstract objectivation, both lack proved reality-that is, the prenumerical presence of the Other.

These few remarks will become more concrete if we recall an experience familiar to everybody: if we happen to appear "in public" to act in a play or to give a lecture, we never lose sight of the fact that we are looked at, and we execute the ensemble of acts which we have come to perform in the presence of the look; better yet we attempt to constitute a being and an ensemble of objects for this look. While we are speaking, attentive only to thc ideas which we wish to develop, the Other's presence remains undifferentiated. It would be false to unify it under the headings class, audience, etc. In fact we are not conscious of a concrete and individualized being with a collective consciousness; these are images which will be able to serve after the event to translate our experience and which will

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more than half betray it. But neither do we apprehend a plurallook. It is a matter rather of an intangible reality, fleeting and omnipresent, which realizes the unrevealed Me confronting us and which collaborates with I us in the production of this Me which escapes ~s. I,f on the other hand, I want to verify that my. thought has been well understood and if in turn I look at the audience, then I shall suddenly see heads and eyes appear. When objectivized the prenumerical reality of the Other is decomposed and pluralized. But the look has disappeared as well. It is for this prenumerical concrete reality that we ought to reserve the term "they" rather than for human reality's state of unauthenticity. Wherever I am, they are perpetually looking at me. The they can never be apprehended as an object, for it immediately disintegrates.

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Thus the look has set us on the track of our being-far-others and has revealed to us the indubitable existence of this Other for whom we are. But it can not lead us any further. What we must examine next is the fundamentalrelation of the Me to the Other as he has been revealed to us. Or if you prefer, we must at present make explicit and fix' thematically everything which is included within the limits of this original relation and ask what is the being of this being-far-others.

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There is one consideration which may be drawn from the preceding remarks and which will be of help to us. This is the fact that being-for-others is not an ontological structure of the For-itself. We can not think of deriving being-for-others from a' being-far-itself as one would derive a consequence from a principle, nor conversely can we think of deriving being-far-itself from being-for-others. Of course Our human-reality must of necessity be simultaneously for-itself and for-others, but our present investigation does not aim at constituting an anthropology. It would perhaps not be impossible to conceive of a For-itself which would be wholly free from all For-others and which would exist without even suspecting the possibility of being an object. But this For-itself simply would not be "man." What the cogito reveals to us here is just factual necessity: it is found-and this is indisputable-that our being along with its being-far-itself is also for-others; the being which is revealed to the reflective consciousness is for-itself-for-

others. The Cartesian cogito only
makes an affirmation of the absolute truth of a fact-that of my existence.
In the same way the cogito a little expanded as we are using it here, reveals
to us as a fact the existence of the Other and my existence for the Other.
That is all we can say. It is also true that my being-for.others as the up-
surge of my consciousness into being has the character of an absolutc
event. Since this event is at once an historization-for I temporalize
myself as presence to others-and a condition of all history, we shall call
it a prehistoric historization. It is as a prehistoric temporalization of
simultaneity that we shall consider it here. By prehistoric we do not
mean that it is in a time prior to history-which would not make sense-

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but that it is a part of that original temporalization which historicizes'it-
self while making history possible; It is as fact-as a primary and perpetual
fact-not as an essential necessity that we shall study being-for-others.
We have seen previously the difference which separates the internal
type of negation from the external negation. In particular we have noted
that the foundation of all knowledge of a determined being is the origi-
nal relation by which in its very upsurge the For-itself has to be as not be-
ing this being. The negation which the For-itself thus realizes is an in-
ternal negation; the For-itself realizes it in its full freedom. Better yet,
.the for-itself is this negation in so far as it chooses itself'as finitude. But
the negation binds the For-itself indissolubly to the being which it is not,
and we have been able to state that the For-itself includes in its being the
being of the object which it is not, inasmuch as its being is in question
as not being this being.
These observations are applicable without any essential change to the
primary relation of the For-itself with the Other. If in general there is an
Other, it is necessary above all that I be the one who is not· the Other;
and it is in this very negation effected by me upon myself that I make
myself be and that the Other arises a.s the Other. This negation which
constitutes my being and which, as Hegel said, makes me appear as the
Same confronting the Other, constitutes me on the ground of a non-thctic
selfness as "Myself." We need not understand by this that a Self comes to
dwell in our consciousness but that selfness is reinforced by arising
as a negation of another selfness and that this reinforcement is positively
apprehended as the continuous choice of selfness by itself as the same
selfness and as this very selfness. A for-itself which would have to be a
self without being itself would be conceivable. The For-itself which I am
simply has to be what it is in the form of a refusal of the Other; that is, as
itself. Thus by utilizing the formulae applied to the knowledge of the
Not-me in general, we can say that the. For-itself as itself includes the
being of the Other in its being in so far as its being. is in question as not
being the Other. In other words, in order for a consciousness to be able
to not-be the Other and therefore in order that there may be an Other
without making this non-being, which is the .condition of the self of con-
sciousness, become purely and simply the object of the establishment of
a "third man" as witness, two things are necessary: consciousness must
have to be itself and

must spontaneously have to be this non-being;
consciousness must freely disengage itself from the Other and wrench itself away by choosing itself as a nothingness which is. simply Other than the Other and thereby must be reunited in "itself." This very detachment, which is the being of the For-itself, causes there to. be' an Other. This does not mean that it gives being to the Other but simply that it gives to the Other its being-other or the essential condition of the "there is." It is evident that for the For-itself the mode. of being-what-is-not-the-

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Other is wholly paralyzed by Nothingness; the For-itself is what is not the Other in the nihilating mode of "the-reflection-reflecting." The not-being-the-Other is never given but perpetually chosen in a perpetual resurrection: consciousness can not-be the Other only in so far as it is consciousness (of) itself as not being the Other. Thus the internal negation, here as in the case of presence to the world, is a unitary bond of being. It is necessary that the Other be present to consciousness in every part and even that it penetrate consciousness completely in order that consciousness precisely by being nothing may escape that Other who threatens to ensnare it. If consciousness were abruptly to be something, the distinction between itself and the Other would disappear at the heart of a total undifferentiation.
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This description, however, allows an essential addition which will radically modify its implications. When consciousness realized itself as not being a particular this in the world, the negative relation was not reciprocal. The this confronted did not make itself not-be consciousness; it was determined in and through consciousness not to be consciousness; its relation to consciousness remained that of pure indifferent exteriority. This is because the "this" preserved its nature as in-itself, and it was as in-itself that it was revealed to consciousness in the very negation by which the For-itself made itself be by denying that it was in-itself. But with regard to the Other, on the contrary, the internal negative relation is a relation of reciprocity. The being which consciousness has to not-be is defined as a being which has to not-be this consciousness. This is because at the time of the perception of the this in the world, consciousness differed from the this not only by its own individuality but also in its mode of being. It was For-itself confronting the In-itself. In the upsurge of the Other, however, consciousness is in no way different from the Other so far as its mode of being is concerned. The Other is what consciousness is. The Other is For-itself and consciousness, and he refers to possibles which are his possibles; he is himself by excluding the Other. There can be no question of viewing this opposition to the Other in terms of a pure numerical determination. We do not have two or several consciousnesses here; numbering supposes an external witness and is the pure and simple establishment of exteriority. There can bean Other for the For-itself only in a spontaneous and prenumerical negation. The Other exists for consciousness only as a refused self. But precisely because the Other is a self, he can himself be refused for and through me only insofar as it is his self which refuses me. I can neither apprehend nor conceive of a consciousness which does not appre

hend me. The only consciousness which exists
without apprehending me or refusing me and which I myself can conceive
is not a consciousness isolated somewhere outside the world; it is my
own. Thus the Other whom I recognize in order to refuse to be him is
before all else the one for whom my For-itself is. Not only do I make my-
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self not-be this other being by denying that he is me, I make myself not-
be a being who is making himself not-be me.
This double negation, however, is in a sense self-destructive. One of
two things happens: Either I make myself not-be a certain being, and
then he is an object for me and I lose my object-ness for him; in this case
the Other ceases to be the Other-Me-that is, the subject who makes me
be an object by refusing to be me. Or else this being is indeed the Other
and makes himself not-be me, in which case I become an object for him
and he loses his own object-ness. Thus originally the Other is the Not-
Me-not-object. Whatever may be the further steps in the dialectic of the
Other, if the Other is to be at the start the Other, then on principle he
can not be revealed in the same upsurge by which I deny being him. In
this sense my fundamental negation can not be direct, for there is nothing
on which it can be brought to bear. What I refuse to be can be nothing
but this refusal to be the Me by means of which the Other is making me
an object. Or, if you prefer, I refuse my refused Me; I determine myself
as.Myself by means of the refusal of the Me-refused; I posit this refused
Me as an alienated-Me in the same upsurge in which I wrench myself
away from the Other. But I thereby recognize and affirm not only the
Other but the existence of my Self-for-others. Indeed this is because I
can not not·be the Other unless I assume my being-as-object for the
Other. The disappearance of the alienated Me would involve the disap-
pearance of the Other through the collapse of Myself. I escape the Other
by leaving him with my alienated Me in his hands. But as I choose my-
self as a tearing away from the Other, I assume and recognize as mine
this alienated Me. My wrenching away from the Other-that is, my Self
-is by its essential structure an assumption as mine of this Me which the
Other refuses; we can even say that it is only that.
Thus this Me which has been alienated and refused is simultaneously
my bond with the Other and the symbol of our absolute separation. In
fact to the extent that I am The One who makes there be an Other
by means of the affirmation of my selfness, the Me-as-object is mine and
I claim it; for the separation of the Other and of myself is never given;
I am perpetually responsible for it in my being. But in so far as the Other
is co-responsible for our original separation, this Me escapes me since it
is what the Other makes himself not-be. Thus I claim as mine and for me
a Me which escapes me. And since I make myself not-be the Other, in so
far as the Other is a spontaneity identical with mine, it is precisely as Me-
escaping-myself that I claim this Me-as-object. This Me-as-object is the
Me Wllich I am to the exact extent that it escapes me; in fact I should re-
fuse it as mine if it could coincide with myself in a pure selfness.
Thus my being-for-others-i.e., my Me-as-object-is not an image cut
off from me and growing in a strange consciousness. It is a perfectly real
being, my being as the condition of

er mean is
conceivable between them.
In view.of this presence of the Other-as-subject to me in and through my assumed object-ness, we can see that my making an object out of the Other must be the second moment in my relation to him. In fact the Other's presence beyond my unrevealed limit can serve as motivation for my reapprehension of myself as a free selfness. To the extent that I deny that I am the Other and as the Other is first manifested, he can be manifested only as the Other; that is, as a subject beyond my limit, as the one who limits me. In fact nothing can limit me except the Other. Therefore he appears as the one who in his full freedom and in his free projection toward his possibles puts me out of play and strips me of my transcendences by refusing to "join in" (in the sense of the German mit-machen) . Thus at first I must grasp only that one of the two negations for which I am not responsible, the one which does not come to me through myself. But in the very apprehension of this negation there arises the consciousness (of) myself as myself; that is, I can obtain an cxpiicit self-consciousness inasmuch as I am also responsible for a negation of the Other which is my own possibility. This is the process of making explicit the second negation, the one which proceeds from me to the Other. In truth it was already there buthidden by the other negation since it was lost in order to make the other appear. But the other negation is the reason for the appearance of the new one; for if there is an Other who puts me out of play by positing my transcendence as purely contemplated, this is because I wrench myself away from the Other by assuming my limit. TIle consciousness (of) this wrenching away ot the consciousness of (being) the same in relation to the Other is the consciousness (of) my free spontaneity. By this very wrenching away which puts the Other in possession of my limit, I am already putting the Other out of play. Therefore in so far as I am conscious (of) myself as of one of my free possibilities and in so far as I project myself toward myself in order to rc:!lize this selfness, to that extent I am responsible for the existence of the Other. It is I who by the very affirmation of my free spontaneity cause there to be an Other and not simply an infinite reference of consciousness to itself. TIle Other then finds himself put out of play; he is now what it depends on me to not-be, and thereby his transcendence is no longer a transcendence which transcends me toward himself but a purely contemplatcd transcendence, simply a given circuit of selfness. Since I can not realize both negations at once, the new negation, although it has the other negation for its motivation, in tum disguises it. The Other appears to me as a degraded presence. This is because the Other and I are in fact co-responsible for the Other's existence, but it is by two negations such that I can not experience the one without immediately disguising the second. Thus the

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Other becomes now what I limit in my very projection toward not-being-the-Other.
Naturally it is necessary to realize here that the motivation of this passage is of the affective order. For example, nothing would prevent me from remaining fascinated by this Unrevealed with its beyond if I did not realize this Unrevealed specific-.illy in fear, in shame, or in pride. It is precisely the

affective character of these motivations which accounts for the empirical contingency of these changes in point of view. But these feelings themselves are nothing more than our way of affectively experiencing our being-for-others. Fear in fact implies that I appear to myself as threatened bf virtue of my being a presence in the world, not in my capacity as a For-itself which causes a world to exist. It is the object which I am which is in danger in the world and which as such, because of its indissoluble unity of being with the being which I have to be, can involve in its own ruin the ruin of the For-itself which I have to be. Fear is therefore the discovery of my being-as-object on the occasion of the appearance of another object in my perceptive field. It refers to the origin of all fear, which is the fearful discovery of my pure and simple object-state in so far as it is surpassed and transcended by possibles which are not my possibles. It is by thrusting myself toward my possibles that I shall escape fear to the extent that, I shall consider my object-ness as non-essential. This can happen only if I apprehend myself as being responsible for the Other's being. The Other becomes then that which I make myself not-be, and his possibilities are possibilities which I refuse and which I can simply contemplate-hence dead-possibilities. Therefore I surpass my present possibilities in so far as I consider them as always able to be surpassed by the Other's possibilities, but I also surpass the Other's possibilities by con· sidering them from the point of view of the only quality which he has which is not his own possibility-his very character as Other inasmuch as I cause there to be an Other. I surpass the Other's possibilities by Considering them as possibilities of surpassing me which I can always surpass toward new possibilities. Thus by one and the same stroke I have regained my being-for-itself through my consciousness (of) myself as a perpetual center of infinite possibilities, and I have transformed the ~'s; possibilities into dead-possibilities by affecting them all with the charact . of "not-lived-by-me"-that is as simply given.

Similarly shame is only the original feeling of having my being outside, engaged in another being and as such without any defense, illuminated by the absolute light which emanates from a pure subject. Shame is the consciousness of being irremediably what I always was: "in suspense"-that is, in the mode of the "not-yet" or of the "already-no-longer." Pure shame is not a feeling of being this or that guilty object but in general of being an object; that is, of recognizing myself in this degraded, fixed, and dependent being which I am for the Other. Shame is the feeling of an

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original fall, not because of the fact that I may have committed this or that particular fault but simply that I have "fallen" into the world in the midst of things and that I need the mediation of the Other in order to be what I am.

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Modesty and in particular the fear of being surprised in a state of nakedness are only a symbolic specification of original shame; the body symbolizes here our defenseless state as objects. To put on clothes is to hide one's object-state; it is to claim the right of seeing without being seen; that is, to be pure subject. This is why the Biblical symbol of the fall after the original sin is the f

act that Adam and Eve "know that they are naked." ,
The reaction to shame will consist exactly in apprehending as an object
the one who apprehended my own object-state.
In fact from the moment that the Other appears to me as an object,
his subjectivity becomes a simple property of the object considered. It is
degraded and is defined as "an ensemble of objective properties which
on principle elude m~:' The-Other-as-Object "has" a subjectivity as this
hollow box has "an inside." In this way I recover myself, for I can not be
an object for an object. I certainly do not deny that the Other remains
connected with me "inside him," but the consciousness which he has of
me, since it is consciousness-as-an-object, appears to me as pure interiority
without efficacy. It is just one property among others of that "inside,"
something comparable to a sensitized plate in the closed compartment of
a camera. In so far as I make there be an Other, I apprehend myself as
the free source of the knowledge which the Other has of me, and the Other
appears to me as affected in his being by that knowledge which he has of
my being inasmuch as I have affected him with the character of Other.
This knowledge takes on then a subjective character in the new sense of
"relative;" that is, it remains in the subject-as-object as a quality rela-
tive to the being-other with which I have affected him. It no longer
touches me; it is an image of me in him. Thus subjectivity is degraded
into interiority, free consciousness into a pure absence of principles, possi-,
bilities into properties, and the knowledge by which the Other touches
me in my being, into a pure image of me in the Other's "consciousness."
Shame motivates the reaction which surpasses and overcomes the shame
inasmuch as the reaction incloses within it an implicit and non-thematized
comprehension of being-able-to-be-an-object on the part of the subject
for whom I am an object. This implicit comprehension is nothing other
than the consciousness (of) my "being-myself;" that is, of my selfness
reinforced. In fact in the structure which expresses the experience "I am
ashamed of myself," shame supposes a me-as-object for the Other but
also a selfness which is ashamed and which is imperfectly expressed by the
"I" of the formula. Thus shame is a unitary apprehension with three
dimensions: "I am ashamed of myself before the Other."
If anyone of these dimensions disappears, the shame disappears as

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well. If, however, I conceive of the "they" as a subject before whom I
am ashamed, then it can not become an object without being scattered
into a plurality of Others; and if I posit it as the absolute unity of the sub-
ject which can in no way become an object, I thereby pcsit the eternity
of my being-as-object and so perpetuate my shame. This is shame before
God; that is, the recognition of my being-an-object before a subject which
can never become an object. By the same stroke I realize my object-state
in the absolute and hypostasize it. The position of God is accompanied
by a reificationof my object-ness. Or better yet, I posit my being-an-object-
for-God as more real than my For-itself; I exist alienated and I cause my-
self to learn from outside what I must be. This is the origin of fear
before God. Black masses, desecration of the host, demonic associations,
etc., are so many attempts to confer the character of object on the a

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solute Subject. In desiring Evil for Evil's sake I attempt to contemplate the divine transcendence-for which Good is the peculiar possibility-as a purely given transcendence and one which I transcend toward Evil. Then I "make God suffer," I "irritate him," etc. These attempts, which imply the absolute recognition of God as a subject who can not be an object, carry their own contradiction within them and are always failures.

Pride does not exclude original shame. In fact it is on the ground of fundamental shame or shame of being an object that pride is built. It is an ambiguous feeling. In pride I recognize the Other as the subject through whom my being gets its object-state, but I recognize as well that I myself am also responsible for my object-ness. I emphasize my responsibility and I assume it. In one sense therefore pride is at first resignation; in order to be proud of being that, I must of necessity first resign myself to being only that. We are therefore dealing with a primary reaction to shame, and it is already a reaction of flight and of bad faith; for without ceasing to hold the Other as a subject, I try to apprehend myself as affecting the Other by my object-state. In short there are two authentic attitudes: that by which I recognize the Other as the subject through whom I get my object-ness-this is shame; and that by which I apprehend myself as the free object by which the Other gets his being-other-this is arrogance or the affirmation of my freedom confronting the Other-as-object. But pride-or. vanity-is a feeling without equilibrium, and it is in bad faith. In vanity I attempt in my capacity as Object to act upon the Other. I take this beauty or this strength or this intelligence whi~h he confers on me-in so far as he constitutes me as an object-and I attempt to make use of it in a return shock so as to affect him passively with a feeling of admiration or of love. But at the same time I demand that this feeling as the sanction of my being-as-object should be entertained by the Other in his capacity as subject-i.e., as a freedom. This is, in fact, the only way of conferring an absolute object-ness on my strength or on. my beauty. Thus the feeling which I demand from the other carries with-
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in itself its own contradiction since I must affect the Other with it in so far as he is free. The feeling is entertained in the mode of bad faith, and its internal development leads it to disintegration. In fact as I play my assumed role of my being-as-object, I attempt to recover it as an object. Since the Other is the key to it, I attempt to lay hold of the Other so that he may release to me the secret of my being. Thus vanity impels me to get hold of the Other and to constitute him as an object in order to burrow into the heart of this object to discover there my own object-state. But this is to kaI the hen that laY3 the golden eggs. By constituting the Other as object, I constitute myself as an imaglf at the heart of the Other-as-object; hence the disillusion of vanity. In that image which I wanted to grasp in order to recover it and merge it with my own being, I no longer recognize l'.1yselL I mustwilly-nilly impute the image to the Other as one of his own subjective properties. Freed in spite of myself from my object-state, I. remain alone confronting the Other-as-object in my unqualifiable selfness which I have to be

forever without relief.
Shame, fear, and pride are my original reactions; they are only various ways by which I recognize the Other as a subject beyond reach, and they include within them a comprehension of my selfness which can and must serve as my motivation for constituting the Other as an object.
This Other-as-object who suddenly appears to me does not remain a purely objective abstraction. He rises before me with his particular meanings. He is not only the object which possesses freedom as a property, as a transcended transcendence. He is also "angry" or "juyful," or "attentive;" he is "amiable" or "disagreeable;" he is "greedy," "quick-tempered," etc.
This is because while apprehending myself as myself, I make the Other-as-object exist in the midst of the world. I recognize his transcendence, but I recognize it not as a transcendence transcending, but as a transcendence transcended. It appears therefore as a surpassing of instruments toward ends to the exact extent that in my unitary projection of myself I surpass these ends, these instruments, and the Other's surpassing of the instruments, toward ends. This is because I never apprehend myself abstractly as the pure possibility of being myself, but I live my selfness in its concrete projection toward this or that particular end. I exist only as engaged.21 and I am conscious (of) being only as engaged. Thus I apprehend the Other-as-object only in a concrete and engaged surpassing of his transcendence. But conversely the Other's engagement, which is his mode of being, appears to me, in so far as it is transcended by my transcendence, as a real engagement, as a taking root. In short, so far

21 Somewhat unhappy I have decided to use the English words "engage" and "engagement" for Sartre's engager and engagement simply because there is no one English word which conveys all the meaning of the French. In F!ench engagel includes the ideas of "commitment," of "involvement," of "immersion," and even of "entering," as well as the English seese of "engagement." Tr.

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as I exist for-myself, my "engagement" in a situation must be understood in the sense in which we say: "I am engaged to a particular person, I am engaged to return that money," etc. It is this engagement which characterizes the Other-as-subject since he is another self like me. But when I grasp the Other as an object, his objectivized engagement is degraded and becomes an engagement-as-object in the sense in which we say, "The knife is deeply engaged in the wound." Or, "The army was engaged in a narrow pass." It must be understood that the being-in-the-midst-of-the-world which comes to the Other through me is a real being.
It is not at all a purely subjective necessity which makes me know him as existing in the midst of the world. Yet on the other hand the Other did not by himself lose himself in the world. I make him lose himself in the world which is mine by the sole fact that he is for me the one who I have to not-be; that is, by the sole fact that I hold him outside myself as a purely contemplated reality surpassed toward my own ends. Thus objectivity is not the pure refraction of the Other across my consciousness; it comes through me to the Other as a real qualification:' I make. the Other be in the midst of the world.
Therefore what I apprehend as real characteristics of the Other is a being-in-situation. In fact

I organize him in the midst of the world in so far as he organizes the world toward himself; I apprehend him as the objective unity of instruments and of obstacles. In Part Two of this work we explained that the totality of instruments is the exact correlate of my possibilities.22 Since I am my possibilities, the order of instruments in the world is the image of my possibilities projected into the in-itself; that is, the image of what I am. But this mundane image I can never decipher; I adapt myself to it in and through action. The Other inasmuch as he is a subject is found similarly engaged in his image. On the other hand, in so far as I grasp him as object, it is this mundane image which leaps to my eyes. The Other becomes the instrument which is defined by his relation with all other instruments; he is an order of my instruments which is included in the order which I impose on these instruments.

To apprehend the Other is to apprehend this enclave-order and to refer it back to a central aDsence or "interiority;" it is to define this absence as a fixed flow of the objects of my world toward a definite object of· my universe. And the meaning of this flow is furnished to me by those objects themselves. The arrangement of the hammer and nails, of the chisel and marble, the arrangement which I surpass without being its foundation defines the meaning of this internal hemorrhage in the world.

Thus the world announces the Other to me in his totality and as a totality. To be sure, the announcement remains ambiguous. But this is because I grasp the order of the world toward the Other as an undifferentiated totality on the ground of which certain explicit structures appear.

22 Part Two, ch. III, Section iii.

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If I could make explicit all the instrumental complexes as they are turned toward the Other (that is, if I could grasp not only the place which the hammer and the nails occupy in this complex of instrumentality but also the street, the city, the nation, etc.), I should have defined explicitly and totally the being of the Other as object. If I am mistaken concerning an intention of the Other, this is not because I refer his gesture to a subjectivity beyond reach; this subjectivity in itself and by itself has no common measure with the gesture, for it is transcendence for itself, an unsurpassable transcendence. But I am mistaken because I organize the entire world around this gesture differently than it is organized in fact. Thus by the sole fact that the Other appears as object, he is given to me on principle as. a totality; he is extended across the whole world as a mundane power for the synthetic organi7..ation of this world. I can not make this synthetic organization explicit any more than I can make the world itself explicit in so far as it is my world. The difference between the Other-as-subject-i.e., between the Other such as he is for-himself-and the Other-as-object is not a difference between the whole and the part or between the hidden and the revealed. The Other-as-object is on principle a whole co-extensive with subjective totality; nothing is hidden and in so far as objects refer to other objects, I can increase indefinitely my knowledge of the Other by indefinitely making explicit his relations with other instruments in the world. The ideal of knowledge of the Other remains the exhaustive specification of the meani

ng of the flow of the world. The
difference of principle between the Other-as-object and the Other-as-subject stems solely from this fact: that the Other-as-subjcct can in no way be known nor even conceived as such. There is no problem of the knowledge of the Other-as-subject, and the objects of the world do not refer to. his subjectivity; they refer only to his object-state in the world .as the meaning-surpassed toward my selfness-of the intra-mundane flow.

Thus the Other's presence to me as the one who produces my object-state is experienced as a subject-totality. If I turn .toward this presence in order to grasp it, I apprehend the Other once more as totality: an object-totality coextensive with the totality of the world. This apprehension is made all of a sudden; it is from the standpoint of the entire world that! arrive at the Other-as-object. But it is never anything but particular relations which come out in relief like figures on the ground of the world. Around this man whom I do not know and who is reading in the subway, the entire world is present. It is not his body only-as an object in the world-which defines him in his being; it is his identity card, it is the direction of the particular train which he has boarded, it is the ring which he wears on his finger. Not as the result of the signs of what he is-this notion of a sign, in fact, would refer us to a subjectivity which I can not even conceive and in which he is precisely nothing; strictly speaking,

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since he is what he is not and is not what he is-but by virtue of real characteristics of his being. Yet if I know that he is in the midst of the world, in France, in Paris, in the process of reading, still for lack of seeing his identity card, I can only suppose that he is a foreigner (which means: to suppose that he is subject to special regulations, that he figures on some official register, that I must speak to him in Dutch, or in Italian in order to obtain from him this or that particular gesture, that the international post directs toward him by this or that route letters bearing this or that stamp, etc.). Yet this identity card is on principle given to me in the midst of the world. It does not escape me-from the moment that it was created, it has been set to existing for me. It exists in an implicit state like each point of the circle which I see as a completed form. And it would be necessary to change the present totality of my relations to the world in order to make the identity card appear as an explicit this on the ground 'of the universe. In the same way the anger of the Other-as-object as it is manifested to me across his cries, his stamping, and his threatening gesures is not the sign of a subjective and hidden anger; it refers to nothing except to other gestures and to other cries. It defines the Other, it is the Other. To be sure, I can be mistaken and can take for true anger what is only a pretended irritation. But it is only in relation to other gestures and to other objectively apprehensible acts that I can be mistaken. I am mistaken if I apprehend the motion of his hand as a real intention to hit me. That is, I am mistaken if I interpret it as the function of an objectively discernible gesture which will not take place. Ina word the anger objectively apprehended is a disposition of the world around an intra-mundane presence-absence.

Does this mean tha

t w~ must grant that the Behaviorists are right?
Certainly not. For although the Behaviorists interpret man in terms of his situation, they have lost sight of his characteristiC principle, which is transcendence-transcended. In fact if the Other is the object which can not be limited to himself, he is also the object which is understood only in terms of his end. Of course the hammer and the saw are not understood any differently. Both are apprehended through their function; that is, through their end. But this is exactly because they are already human. I can understand them only in so far as they refer me to an instrumental· organization in which the Other is the center, only in so far as they form a part of a complex wholly transcended toward an end which I in turn transcend. If then we can compare the Other to a machine, this is because the machine as a human fact presents already the trace of a transcend-'ence-transcended, just as the looms in a mill are explained only by the fabrics which they produce. The Behaviorist point of. view must be reo versed,and this reversal, moreover, will leave the Other's objectivity intact. For that which first of all is objectivc--,..what we shall callsignification after the fashion of French and English psychologists, intention according to .-

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the Phenomenologists, transcendence with Heidegger,or form with the Gestalt School-this is the fact that the Other can be defined only by a total organization of the world and that he is the key to this organization. If therefore I return from the world to the Other in order to define him, this is not because the world would make me understand the Other but because the Other-as-object is nothing but a center of autonomous and intra-mundane reference in my world.
Thus the objective fear which we can apprehend when we perceive the Other-as-object is not the ensemble of the physiological manifestations of disorder which we see or which we measure with sphygmograph or a stethoscope. Fear isa flight; it is a fainting. These phenomena themselves are not released to us as a pure series of movements but as transcendence-transcended: the flight or the fainting is not only that desperate running through the brush, nor that heavy fall on the stones of the road; it is the total upheaval of the instrumental-organization which had the Other for its center. This soldier who is fleeing formerly had the Other-as-enemy at the point of his gun. The distance from him to the enemy was measured by the trajectory of his bullet, and I too could apprehend and transcend that distance as a distance organized round the "soldier" as center. But behold now he throws his gun in the ditch and is trying to save himself. Immediately the presence of the enemy surrounds him and presses in upon him; the enemy, who had been held at a distance by the trajectory of the bullets, leaps upon him at the very instant when the trajectory collapses; at the same time that land in the background, which he was defending and against which he was leaning as against a wall, suddenly opens fan-wise and becomes the foreground, the welcoming horizon toward which he is fleeing for refuge. All this I establish objectively, and it is precisely,this which I apprehend as fear. Fear is nothing but' a magical conduct tending by incantation to suppress the frightening objects which we are unable to keep at a dista

nce.23 It is precisely through its results that
we apprehend fear, for it is given to us as a new type of internal hemorrhage in the world-the passage from the world to a type of magical existence.
We must be careful however to remember that the Other is a qualified object for me only to the extent that I can be one for him. Therefore he will be objectivized as a non-individualized portion of the "they" or as purely "absent" represented by his letters and his written accounts of himself or as tIlis man present in fact, according to whether I shall have been myself an element for him o~ the "they" or a "dear absent one" or a concrete "this man." What decides in each case the type of objectivation of the Other and of his qualitics is both.mysituation in the world and his situation; that is, the instrumental complexes which we have each organized and the various thises which appear to each· one of us on the
23 Cf. The Emotions.

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ground of the world. All this naturally brings us to facticity. It is my facticity and the Other's facticity which decide whether the Other can see me and whether I can see this particular Other. But the problem of facticity is beyond the scope of this general exposition. We shall consider it in the course of the next chapter.
Thus I make proof of the Other's presence as a quasi-totality of subjects in my being-an-object-for-Others, and on the ground of this totality I can experience more particularly the presence of a concrete subject without however being able to specify it as that particular Other. My defensive reaction to my object-state will cause the Other to appear before me in the capacity of tIlis or that object. As such he will appear to me as a "this-one;" that is, his subjective quasi-totality is degraded and becomes a totality-as-object co-extensive with the totality of the World. This totality is revealed to me without reference to the Other's subjectivity. The relation of the Other-as-subject to the Other-as-object is in no way comparable to-that which we usually establish, for example, between ~he physical object and the object of perception. The Other-as-object is· revealed to me for what he is, he refers only to himself. The Other-as-object is simply such as he appears to me on the plane of object-ness in general and in his being-as-object; it is not even conceivable that I should refer back any knowledge which I have of him to his subjectivity such as I experience it on the occasion of the look. The Other-as-object is only an object, but my apprehension of him includes the comprehension of the fact that I could always and on principle produce from him another experience by placing myself on another plane of being. This comprehension is constituted On the one hand by the empirical knowledge of my past experience -which is moreover as we have seen, the pure past (out of reach and what I have to be) of this experience, and on. the other hand it is constituted by an implicit apprehension of the dialectic of the Other. The Other is at present what I make myself not-be. But although for the instant I am rid of him and escape him, there remains around him the permanent possibility that he may make himself other. Nevertheless this possibility, foreseen in the embarrassment and constraint which forms the specific quality of my attitude confronting the Other-as-object, is strictly speaking inconceiva

ble: first because I can not conceive of a possibility
which is not my possibility nor can I apprehend transcendence except by
transcending it-that is, by grasping it as a transcendence-transcended;
secondly because this anticipated possibility is not the possibility of the
Other-as-object-the possibilities of the Other-as-object are dead-possi-
bilities which refer to other objective aspects of the Other. The peculiar
possibility of apprehending myself as an object is the possibility belonging
to the Other-as-subject and hence is not for a me a living possibility; it is
an absolute possibility-which derives its source only from itself-that
on the ground of the total annihilation of the Other-as-object, there may
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occur the upsurge of anOther-as-subject which I shall experience across my
objectivity-for-him.
Thus the Other-as-object is an explosive instrument which I handle
with care because I foresee around him the permanent possibility that
they are going to make it explode and that with this explosion I shall
suddenly experience the flight of the world away from me and the aliena-
tion of my being. Therefore my constant concern is to contain the Other
within his objectivity, and my relations with the Other-as-object are
essentially made up of ruses designed to make him remain an object.
But one look on the part of the Other is sufficient to make all these
schemes collapse and to make me experienceonce more the transfiguration
of tIIe' Other. Thus I am referred from transfiguration to degradation and
from degradation to transfiguration without ever being able either to gct a
total view of the ensemble of thes~ two modes of being on the part of
the Other-for each of them is self-sufficient and refers only to itself-or
to hold firmly to either one of them-for each has its own instability and
collapses in order fOf the other to rise from its ruins. Only the dead can
be perpetually objects without every becoming, subjects-for to die is not
to lose one's objectivity in the midst of the world; all the dead are there
in the world around us. But to die is to lose all possibility of revealing
oneself as subject to an Other. '
At this point in our investigation now we have elucidated the essential
structures of being-for-others, there is an obvious temptation to raise the
metaphysical question: "Why are there Others?" As we have seen, the
existence of Others is not a consequence which can derive from the
ontological structure of the for-itself. It is a primary event, to be sure, but
of a metapl1ysical order; that is, it results from the contingency of being.
The question "why" is essentially connected with these metaphysical
existences.
We know very well that the answer to the "why" can only refer us to
an original contingency, but still it is necessary to prove that the meta-
physical phenomenon which we are considering is an irreducible contin-
gency. In this sense ontology appears to us capable of being defined as the
specification of the structures of being of the existent taken as a totality,
and we shall define metaphysics rather as raising the question of the exist-
ence of the existent. This is why in view of the absolute contingency of
the existent, we are convinced that any metaphysics must conclude with a
"that is"-i.e., in a direct intuition of that contingency.
Is it possible to posit the question of the existence of Others? I

s this
existence an irreducible fact, or is it to be derived from a fundamental contingency? Such are the preliminary questions which we can in turn pose to the metaphysician who questions us concerning the existence of Others.
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Let us examine more closely the possibility of the metaphysical ques-

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tion. What appears to us first is the fact that thebeing-for-others represents the third ekstasis of the for-itself. The first ekstasis is indeed the tridimensional projection on the part of the for-itself toward a being which it has to be in the mode of non-being. It represents the first fissure, the nihilation which the for-itself has to be, the wrenching away on the part of the for-itself from everything which it is, and this wrenching away is constitutive of its being. The second ekstasis or reflective ekstasis is the wrenching away from this very wrenching away. The reflective scissiparity corresponds to a vain attempt to take a point of view on the nihilation which the for-itself has to be, in order that this nihilation as a simply given phenomenon may be a nihilation which is. But at the same time reflection wants to recover this wrenching away, which it attempts to contemplate as a pure given, by affirming concerning itself that it is this nihilationwhich is. This is a flagrant contradiction: in order to be able to apprehend my transcendence, I should have to transcend it. But my own transcendence can only transcend. I am my own transcendence; I can not make use of it so as to constitute it as a transcendence-transcended. I am condemned to be forever my own nihilation. In short reflection (reflexion) is the reflected-on.
The reflective nihilation, however, is pushed further than that of the pure for-itself as a simple self-consciousness. In self-consciousness, in fact, the two terms of the dyad "reflected-reflecting" (reflete-refletant) were so incapable of presenting themselves separately that the duality remained perpetually evanescent and each term while positing itself for the other became the other. But with reflection the case is different since the "reflection-reflecting" which is reflected-on exists for a "reflection-reflecting" which is reflective. Reflected-on and reflective, therefore, each tend toward independence, and the nothing which separates them tends to divide them more profoundly than the nothingness which the For-itself has to be separates the reflection from the reflecting. Yet neither the reflective nor the reflected-on can secrete this separating nothingness, for in that case reflection (reflexion) would be an autonomous for-itself coming to direct itself on the reflected-on, which would be to suppose an external negation as the preliminary condition of an internal negation. There can be no reflection if it is not entirely a being, a being which has to be its own nothingness.
Thus the reflective ekstasis is found on the path to a more radical ekstasis-the being-for-others. The final term of the nihilation, the ideal . pole should be in fact the external negation-that is, a scissiparity in-itself or the spatial exteriority of indifference. In relation to this external negation the three .ekstases are ranked in the order which we have just presented, but the goal is never acilieved. It remains on principle ideal; in fact the for-itself-without running the risk of ceasing by the same stroke to be-f

which this totality would project itself. By its effort to be self-consciousness the totality-for-itself would be constituted in the face of the self as a self-as-consciousness which has to not-be the self of which it is consciousness. Conversely the self-as-object in order to be would have to experience itself as made-to-be by and for a consciousness which it has to not-be if it wishes to be. Thus would be born the schism of the for-others, and this dichotomic division would be repeated to infinity in order to constitute a plurality of consciousnesses as fragments of a radical explosion. "There would be" numerous Others as the result of a failure the reverse of the reflective failure. In reflection in fact if I do not succeed in apprehending myself as an object but only as a quasi-object, this is because I am the object which I wish to grasp; I have to be the nothingness which separates me from myself. I can escape my selfness neither by taking a point of view on myself (for thus I do not succeed in realizing myself as being) nor by apprehending myself in the form of the "there is" (here the recovery fails because the recoverer is to himself the recovered). In the case of being-for-others, on the contrary, the scissiparity is pushed 'further; the (reflection-reflecting) reflected is radically distinct from the (reflection-reflecting) reflecting and thereby can be an object for it. But this time the recovery fails because the recovered is not the one recovering. Thus the totality which is not what it is but which is what it is not, would-as the result of a radical attempt at wrenching away from self-everywhere produce its being as an "elsewhere." The scattering of being-in-itself of a shattered totality, always elsewhere, always at a distance, never in itself, but always maintained in being by the perpetual explosion of this totality -such would be the being of others and of myself as other.

But on the other hand, simultaneously with my negation of myself"the Other denies concerning himself that Ile is me. These two negations are equally indispensible to being-for-others, and they can not be reunited by any synthesis. This is not because an external nothingness would have separated them at the start but rather because the in-itself would recapture each one in relation to the other by the mere fact that each one is not the other without having to not-be the other. There is here a kind of limit of the for-itself which stems from the for-itself itself but which qua limit is independent of the for-itself. We rediscover something like facticity and we can not conceive how the totality of which we were speaking earlier would have been able at the very heart of the most radical wrenching away to produce in its being a nothingness which it in no way has to be. In fact it seems that this nothingness has slipped into this totality in order to shatter it just as in the atomism of Leucippus non-being slips into the Parmenidean totality of being and makes it explode into atoms. Therefore it represents the negation of any synthetic totality in terms of which one might claim to understand the plurality of consciousnesses. Of course it is inapprehensible since it is produced neither by the Other

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nor by myself, nor by any intermediary, for we have established that consciousnesses experience one another without intermediary. Of course

where we directed our sight, we encountered as the object of our description only a pure and simple internal negation. Yet it is there in the irreducible fact that there is a duality of negations. It is not, to be sure, the foundation of the multiplicity of consciousnesses, for if it existed before this multiplicity, it would make all being-for others impossible. On the contrary, we must conceive of it as the expression of this multiplicity; it appears with this multiplicity. But since there is nothing which can found it, neither a particular consciousness nor a totality exploding into consciousnesses, it appears as a pure, irreducible contingency. It is the fact that my denial that I am the Other is not sufficient to make the OtIler exist, but that the Other must simultaneously with my Own negation deny that he is me. This is the facticity of being-for-others.

Thus we arrive at this contradictory conclusion: being-for-others can be only if it is made-to-be by a totality which is lost so that being-for-others may arise, a position which would lead us to postulate the existence and directing power of the mind. But on the other hand, this being-for-others can exist only if it involves an inapprehensible and external non·being which no totality, not even the mind, can produce or found. In one sense the existence of a plurality of consciousnesses can not be a primary fact and it refers us to an original fact of a wrenching away from self, a fact of the mind. Thus the question "Why is there a plurality of consciousnesses?" could receive an answer. But in another sense the facticity of this plurality seems to be irreducible; and if the mind is considered from the standpoint of the fact of the plurality, it vanishes. Then the metaphysical question no longer has meaning; we have encountered a fundamental contingency, and we can answer only by "So it is." Thus the original ekstasis is deepened; it appears that we can not make it a part of nothingness. The for-itself has appeared to us as a being which exists in so far as it is not what it is and is what it is not. The ekstatic totality of the mind is not simply a totality detotalized; it appears to us as a shattered being concerning which we can neither say that it exists or that it does not exist. Thus our description has enabled us to satisfy the preliminary conditions which we have posited for any theory about the existence of the Other. The multiplicity of consciousnesses appears to us as a synthesis and not as a col1ection, but it is a synthesis whose totality is inconceivable.

Is this to say that the antinomic character of the totality is itself an irreducible? Or from a higher point of view can we make it disappear? Ought we to posit that the mind is the being which is and is not just as we posited that the for-itself is what it is not and is not what it is? The question has no meaning. It is supposing that it is possible for us to take a point of view on the totality; that is, to consider it from outside. But

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this is impossible precisely because I exist as myself on the foundation of this totality and to the extent that I am engaged in it. No consciousness, not even God's, can "see the underside"-that is, apprehend the totality as such. For if God is consciousness, he is integrated in the totality. And if by his nature, he is a being beyond consciousness (thatJs, an in-itself which wo

s that I referred it back to
being mine; it was much more my property than my being.
It is true that I see and touch my legs and my hands. Moreover nothing prevents me from imagining an arrangement of the sense organs such that a living being could see one of his eyes while the eye which was seen was directing its glance upon the world. But it is to be noted that in this case again I am the Other in relation to my eye. I apprehend it as a sense organ constituted in the world in a particular way, but I can not "see the seeing;" that is, I can not apprehend it in the process of revealing an aspect of the world to me. Either it is a thing among other things, or else it is that by which things are revealed to me. But it can not be both at the same time. Similarly I see my hand touching objects, but do not know it in its act of touching them. This is the fundamental reason why that famous "sensation of effort" of Maine de Biran does not really exist. For my hand reveals to me the resistance of objects, their hardness or softness, but not itself. Thus I see my hand only in the way that I see this inkwell. I unfold a distance between it and me, and this distance comes to integrate itself in the distances which I establish among all the objects of the world.
When a doctor takes my wounded leg and looks at it while I, half raised up on my bed, watch him do it, there is no essential difference between the visual perception which I have of the doctor's body and that which I have of my own leg. Better yet, they are distinguished only as different structures of a single global perception; there is no essential difference between the doctor's perception of my leg and my own present perception of it. Of course when I touch my leg with my finger, I realize that my leg is touched. But this phenomenon of double sensation is not essential: cold, a shot of morphine, can make it disappear. This shows that we are dealing with two essentially different orders of reality. To touch and to be touched, to feel that one is touching and to feel that one is touched-these . are two species of phenomena which it is useless to try to reunite by the term "double sensation." In fact they are radically distinct, and they exist on two incommunicable levels. Moreover when I touch my leg or when I see it, I surpass it toward my own possibilities. It is, for example, in order to pull on my trousers or to change a dressing on my wound. Of course I can at the same time arrange my leg in such a way that I can more conveniently "work" on it. But this does not change the fact that I transcend it toward the pure possibility of "curing myself" and that consequently I am present to it without its being me and without my being it. What I cause to exist here is the thing "leg;" it is not the leg as the possibility which I am of walking, running, or of playing football.
IThus to the extent that my body indicates my possibilities in the world, seeing my body or touching it is to transform these possibilities
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of mine into dead-possibilities. This metamorphosis must necessarily involve a complete thisness with regard to the body as a living possibility of running, of dancing, etc. Of course, the discovery of my body as an object is indeed a revelation of its being. But the being which is thus revealed to me is its being-for-others. That this confusion may lead to absurdities can be clearly seen

in co.nnection with the famous problem of "inverted vision." We know the question posed by the physiologists: "How can we set upright the objects which are painted upside down on our retina?" We know as well the answer of the philosophers: "There is no problem. An object is upright or inverted in relation to the rest of the universe. To perceive the whole universe inverted means nothing, for it would have to be inverted in relation to something." But what particularly interests us is the origin of this false problem. It is the fact that people have wanted to link my consciousness of objects to the body of the Other. Here are the candle, the crystalline lens, the inverted image on the screen of the retina. But to be exact, the retina enters here into a physical system; it is a screen and only that; the crystalline lens is a Jells and only a lens; both are homogeneous in their being with the candle which completes the system. Therefore we have deliberately chosen the physical point of view-i.e., the point of view of the outside, of exteriority-in order to study the problem of vision; we have considered a dead eye in the midst of the visible world in order to account for the visibility of this world. Consequently, how how can we be surprised later when consciousness, which is absolute interiority, refuses to allow itself to be bound to this object? The relations which I establish between the Other's body and the external object are really existing relations, but they have for their being the being of the for-others; they suppose a center of intra-mundane flow in which knowledge is a magic property of space, "action at a distance." From the start they are placed in the perspective of the Other-as-object.

If then we wish to reflect on the nature of the body, it is necessary to establish an order of our reflections which conforms to the order of being: we can not continue to confuse the ontological levels, and we must in succession examine the body first as being-for-itself and then as being-for-others. And in order to avoid such absurdities as "inverted vision," we must keep constantly in mind the idea that since these two aspects of the body are on different and incommunicable levels of being, they can not be reduced to one another. Being-for-itself must be wholly body and it must be wholly consciousness; it can not be united with a body. Similarly being-for-others is wholly body; there are no "psychic phenomena" there to be united with the body. There is nothing behind the body. But the body is wholly "psychic." We must now proceed to study these two modes of being which we find for the body.

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I. THE BODY AS BEING-FaR-ITSELF

FACTICITY

. IT appears at first glance that the preceding observations are opposed to the givens of the Cartesian cogito. "The soul is easier to know than the body," said Descartes. Thereby he intended to make a radical distinction between the facts of thought, which are accessible to reflection, and the facts of the body, the knowledge of which must be guaranteed by divine Providence. It appears at first that reflection reveals to us only pure facts of consciousness. Of course on this level we encounter phenomena which appear to include within themselves SOme connection with the body; "physical" pain, the uncomfortable, pleasure, etc. But these phenomena are no less pure facts of consciousness. There is a t

endency therefore to
make signs out of them, affections of consciousness occasioned by the body, without realizing that one has thereby irremediably ~riven the body out of consciousness and that no bond will ever be ab.le to reunite this body, which is already a body-for-others, with the consciousness which, it is claimed, makes the body· manifest.
Furthermore we ought not to take this as our point of departure but rather our primary relation to the in-itself: our being-in-the-world. We know that there is not a for-itself on tht: one hand and a world on the other as two closed entities·for which we must subsequently seek SOme explanation asto how they communicate. The for-itself is a relation to the world. The for-itself, by denying that it is being, makes there be a world, and by surpassing this negation toward its own possibilities it reveals the "thises" as instrumental-things.
But when we say that the for-itself is-in-the-world, that consciousness is consciousness of the world, we must be careful t<> remember that the world exists confronting consciousness as an indefinite multiplicity of reciprocal relations which consciousness surveys without perspective and contemplates without a point of view. For me this glass is to the left of the decanter and a little behind it; for Pierre, it is to the right and a little in front. It is not even conceivable that a consciousness could survey the world ill such a way that the glass should be simultaneously given to it at the right and at the left of the decanter, in front of it and behind it. This is by no mcans the consequence of a strict application of the principle of identity but because this fusion of right and left, of before and behind, would result in the total disappearance of "thises" at the heart of a primitive indistinction. Similarly if the table leg hides the designs in the rug from· my sight, this is not the result of some finitude and some imperfection in my visual organs, but it is because a rug which would not be hidden by the table, a rug which would not be either under it or above it or to one side of it, would not have any relation of any kind with the table and would no longer belong to the "world" in which there is
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the table. The in-itself which is made manifest in the form of the this would return to its indifferent self-identity. Even space as a purely external relation would disappear. The constitution of space as a multiplicity of reciprocal relations can be effected only from the abstract point of view of science; it can not be lived, it can not even be represented. The triangle which I trace on the blackboard so as to help me in abstract reasoning is necessarily to the right of the circle tangent to one of its sides, necessarily to the extent that it is on the blackboard. And my effort is to surpass the concrete characteristics of the figure traced in chalk by not including its relation to me in my calculations any more than the thickness of the lines or the imperfection of the drawing.
Thus by the mere fact that there is a world, this world can not exist without a univocal orientation in relation to me. Idealism has rightly insisted on the fact that relation makes the world. But since idealism took its position on the ground of Newtonian science, it conceived this relation as a relation of reciprocity~ Thus it attained only abstract concepts of pure exter

iotity, of action and reaction, etc., and due to this very fact it missed the world and succeeded only in making explicit the limiting concept of absolute objectivity. This concept in short amounted to that of a "desert world"or: of "a wodd without men;" that is, to a contradiction, since it is through human reality that there is a world. Thus the concept of objectivity, which aimed at replacing the in-itself of dogmatic truth by a pure relation of reciprocal.agreement between representations, is self-destructive if pushed to the limit.

Moreover the progress of science has led to rejecting this notion of absolute objectivity. What Broglie is led to call "experience" is a system of univocal relations from which the observer is not excluded. If microphysics can reintegrate the observer into the heart of the scientific system, this is not byvirtue of pure subjectivity-this notion would have no more meaning than that of pure objectivity-but as an original relation to the world, as a place, as that toward which all envisaged relations are oriented. Thus, for example, Heysenberg's principle of indeterminacy can not be considered either as an invalidation or a validation of the determinist postulate. Instead of being a pure connection between things, it includes within itself the original relation of man to things and his place in the world. This is sufficiently demonstrated, for example, by the fact that we cannot make the dimensions of bodies in motion increase in proportionate quantities without changing their relative speed. If I examine the movement of one body toward another first with the naked eye and then with the microscope, it will appear to me a hundred times faster in the second case; for although the body in motion approaches no closer to the body toward which it is moving, it has in the same time traversed a space a hundred times as large. Thus the notion of speed no longer means anything unless it is speed in relation to given dimensions of a body in motion.

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But it is we ourselves who decide these dimensions by our very upsurge into the world and it is very necessary that we decide them, for otherwise they would not be at all. Thus they are relative not to the knowledge which we get of them but to our primary engagement at the heart of the world.

This fact is expressed perfectly by the theory of relativity: an observer placed at the heart of a system can not determine by any experiment whether the system is at rest or in motion. But this relativity is not a "relativism;" it has nothing to do with knowledge; better yet, it implies the dogmatic postulate according to which knowledge releases to us what is. The relativity of modern s.cience aims at being. Man and the world are relative beings, and the principle of their being is the relation. It follows that the first relation proceeds from human-reality to the world. To COme into existence, for me, is to unfold my distances from things and thereby to cause things "to be there." But consequently things are precisely "things-which-exist-at-a-distance-from-me." Thus the world refers to me that univocal relation which is my being and by which I cause it to be revealed.

The point of view of pure knowledge is contradictory; there is only the point of view of engaged knowledge. This amounts to saying that knowledge and action are only two abstract aspects of an original, concre

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tion. The real space of the world is the space which Lewin calls "hodo-
logical." A pure knowledge in fact would be a knowledge without a point
of view; therefore a knowledge of the world but on principle located out-
side the world. But this makes no sense; the knowing being would be
only knowledge since he would be defined by his object and since his
object would disappear in the total indistinction of reciprocal relations.
Thus knowledge can be only an engaged upsurge in a determined point
of view which one is. For human reality, to be is to-be-there; that is, "there
in that chair," "there at that table," "there at the top of that mountain,
with these dimensions, this orientation, etc." It is an ontological necessity.
This point must be well understood. For this necessity appears between
two contingencies; on the one hand, while it is necessary that I be in the
form of being-there, still it is altogether contingent that I be, for I am not
the foundation of my being; on the other hand, while it is necessary that
I be engaged in this or that point of view, it is contingent that it should
be precisely in this view to the exclusion of all others. This twofold con-
tingency which embraces a necessity we have called the facticity of the
for-itself. We have described it in Part Two. We showed there that the
nihilated in-itself, engulfed in the absolute event which is the appearance
of the foundation or the upsurge of the for-itself, remains at the heart of·
the for-itself as its original contingency. Thus the for-itself is supported
by a perpetual contingency for which it becomes responsible and which
it assimilates without ever being able to suppress it. Nowhere can the
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for-itself find this contingency anywhere within itself; nor can the for-itself
anywhere apprehend an4 know it-not even by the reflective cogito. The
for-itself forever surpasses this contingency toward its Own possibilities,
and it encounters in itself only the nothingness which it has to be. Yet
facticity does not cease to haunt the for-itself, and it is facticity which
causes me to apprehend myself simultaneously as totally responsible for
my being and as totally unjustifiable.
But the world refers to me the image of this unjustifiability in the
form of the synthetic unity of its univocal relations to me. It is absolutely
necessary that the world appear to me in order. And in this sense this
order is me; it is that image of me which we described in the last chapter
of Part Two. But it is wholly contingent that it should be this order.
Thus it appears as the necessary and totally unjustifiable arrangement of
the totality of being. This absolutely necessary and totally unjustifiable
order of the things of the world, this order which is myself in so far as I
am neither the foundation of my being nor the foundation of a particular
being-this order is the body as it is on the level of the for-itself. In this
sense we could define the body as the contingent form which is assumed
by the necessity of my contingency. The body is nothing other than the
for-itself; it is not an in-itself in the for-itself, for in that case it would
solidify everything. But it is the fact that the for-itself is not its own foun-
dation, and this fact is expressed by the necessity of existing as an engaged,
contingent being among other contingent beings. As such the body is not
distinct from the situatio

n of the for-itself since for the for-itself, to exist
and to be situated are one and the same; on the other hand the body is
identified with the whole world inasmuch as the world is the total situation
of the for-itself and the measure of its existence.
But a situation is not a pure contingent given. Quite the contrary, it
is revealed only to the extent that the for-itself surpasses it toward itself.
Consequently the body-for-itself is never a given which I can know. It is
there everywhere as the surpassed; it exists only in so far as I escape it by
nihilating myself. The body is what I nihilate. It is the in-itself which is
surpassed by the nihilating for-itself and which reapprchends the for-it-
self in this very surpassing. It is the fact that I am my own motivation
without being my own foundation, the fact that I am nothing without
having to be what I am and yet in so far as I have to be what I am, I am
without having to be. In one sense therefore the body is a necessary
characteristic of the for-itself; it is not true that the body is the product
of an arbitrary decision on the part of a demiurge nor that the union of
soul and body is the contingent bringing together of two substances rad-
ically distinct. On the contrary, the very nature of the for-itself demands
that it be body; that is, that, its nihilating escape from being should be
made in the form of an engagement in the world. Yet in another sense the
body manifests my contingency; we can even say that it is only this con-

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tingency. The Cartesian rationalists were right in being struck with this
characteristic; in fact it represents the individualization of my engagemept
in the world. And Plato was not wrong either in taking the body as that
which individualizes the soul. Yet it would be in vain to suppose that the
soul can detach itself from this individualization by separating itself
from the body at death or by pure thought, for the soul is the body inas-
much as the for-itself is its own individualization.
We shall understand the bearing of these remarks better if we try to
apply them to the problem of sense knowledge.
The problem of sense knowledge is raised on the occasion of the appear-
ance in the midst of the world of certain objects which we ca11 the senses.
First we established that the Other IJad eyes; later as physiologists dissected
cadavers, they learned the structure of these objects; they distinguished
the cornea from the crysta11ine lens and the lens from the retina. They
established that the object, crysta11ine lens, was classed in a family of
particular objeets-Ienses-and that they could apply to the object of their
study those jaws of geometric optics which concern lenses. More precise
dissections effected progressively as surgical instruments were perfected,
have taught us that a bundle of nerves leave the retina and end up in the
brain. With the microscope we have examined the nerves of cadavers and
have determined exactly their trajectory, their point of departure, and
their point of arrival. The totality of these pieces of knowledge concerned
therefore a certain spatial object called the eye; they implied the existence
of space and of the world. In addition they implied that we could see
this eye, and touch it; that is, we are ourselves provided with a sensible
point of view on things. Finally between our knowledge of the eye and the
eye itself are inter

posed all our technical knowledge (the art of making
our scalpels, our lancets) and our scientific skills (e.g., geometric optics, which enables us to construct and use microscopes). In short, between me and the eye which I dissect there is interposed the whole world such as I make it appear by my very upsurge. Later a more thorough examination has enabled us to establish the existence of various nerve endings on the surface of our body. We have even succeeded in acting separately on certain of these endings and performing experiments on living subjects. We then found ourselves in the presence of two objects in the world: on the one hand the stimulant; on the other hand, the sensitive cell or the free nerve ending which we stimulated. The stimulant was a physieal-chemical object, an electric current, a mechanical or chemical agent whose properties we knew with precision and which we could vary in intensity or in duration in a definite way. Therefore we were dealing with two mundane objects, and their intra-mundane relation could be established by our own senses or by means of instruments. The knowledge of this relation once again supposed a whole system of scientific and technical skills, in short, the existence of a world and our original upsurge into the ---.

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world. Our empirical information enabled us. furthermore, to conceive a relation between "the inside" of the Other-as-obiect and the ensemble of these objective establishments. We learned in fact that by acting on certain senses we "provoked a modification" in the Other's consciousness. We learned this through language-that is, through the meaningful and objective reactions of the Other. A physical object (the stimulant), a physiological object (sense), a psychic object (the Other), objective manifestations of meaning (language): such are the terms of the objective relation which we wished to establish. But not one of them could enable us to get out of the world of objects.

On occasion I have served as subject for the research work of physiologists or psychologists. If I volunteered for som.e experiment of this kind, I found myself suddenly in a laboratory where I perceived a more or less illuminated screen, or else felt tiny electric shocks, or I was brushed by an object which I could not exactly determine but whose global presence I grasped as in the midst of the world and over against me. Not for an instant was I isolated from the world; all these events happened for me in a laboratory in the middle of Paris, in the south building of the Sorbonne. I remained in the Other's presence, and the very meaning of the experiment demanded that I could communicate with him through language. From time to time the experimenter asked me if the screen appeared to me more or less illuminated, if the pressure exerted on my hand seemed to me stronger or weaker, and I replied; that is, I gave objective information concerning things which appeared in the midst of my world. Sometimes an inept experimenter asked me if "my sensation of light was stronger or weaker, more or less intense." Since I was in the midst of objects and in the process of observing these objects, his phrase would have had no meaning for me if I had not long since learned to use the expression "sensation of light" for objective light as it appeared to me in the world at a given instant. I replied therefore that the sensati

on of light was, for
example, less intense, but I meant by this that the screen was in my opinion less illuminated. Since I actually apprehended the screen as less illuminated, the phrase "in my opinion" corresponded to nothing real except to an attempt not to confuse the objectivity of the world-for-me with a stricter objectivity, which is the result of experimental measures and of the agreement of minds with each other. What I could know in each case was a certain object which the experimenter observed during this time and which was my visual organ or certain tactile endings. ll1ere-fore the result obtained at the end of the experiment could be only the relating of two series of objects: those which were revealed to me during the experiment and those which were revealed during the same period to the experimenter. The illumination of the screen belonged to my world; my eyes as objective organs belonged to the world of the experimenter. The connection of these two series was held to be like a bridge between

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two worlds; under no circumstances could it be a table of correlation be· tween the subjective and the objective.
Why indeed should we use the term "subjectivity" for the ensemble of luminous or heavy or odorous objects such as they appeared to me in this laboratory at Paris on a day in February, etc. And if despite all we are to consider this ensemble as subjective, then why should we recognize ob-jectivity in the system of objects which were revealed simultaneously to the experimenter, in this laboratory, this same day in February? We do not have two weights or two measures here; we do not encounter anywhere anything which is given as purely'fe1t,as experienced for me without objectivation. Here as always I am conscious of the world, and on the ground/of the world I am conscious of certain transcendent objects. As always I surpass what is revealed to me toward the possibility which I have to be-for example, toward that of replying correctly to the experi-menter and of enabling the experiment to succeed. Of course these com-parisons can give certain objective results: for example, I c~n establish that the warm water appears cold to me when I put my hand in it after having first plunged my hand b hot water. But this establishment which we pompously call "the law·of relativity of sensations" has nothing to do with sensations. Actually we are dealing with a quality of the object which is revealed to me: the warm water is cold when I submerge my heated hand in it. A comparison of this objective quality of the water to equally objective information which the thermometer gives me simply reveals to me a contradiction. This contradiction motivates on my part a free choice of true objectivity. I shall give the name subjectivity to the objectivity which I have not chosen. As for the reasons for the "relativity of sensations," a further examination will reveal them to me in certain objective, synthetic structures which I shall call forms (Gestalt). The Milller-Lyers illusion, the relativity of the senses, etc., are so many names given to objective laws concerning the structures of these forms. These laws teach us nothing about appearances, but they concern synthetic structures. I intervene here only to the extent that my upsurge into the world gives birth to this putting into relation of objects with each other. As such they are revealed as fo

rms. Scientific objectivity consists in con-
sidering the structures separately by isolating them from the whole;
hence they appear with other characteristics. But in no case do we get
out of an existing world. In the same way we might show that what is
called the "threshold of sensation" or the specificity of the senses is re-
ferred back to pure determinations of objects as such.
Yet some have claimed that this objective relation of the stimulant
to the sense organ is itself surpassed toward a relation of the objective
(stimulant-sense organ) to the subjective (pure sensation) and that this
subjective is defined by the action exercised on us by the stimulant through
the intermediary of the sense organ. The sense organ appears to us to be
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affected by the stimulant; the protoplasmic and physical-chemictll modifi-
cations which appear in the sense organ are not actually produced by-that
organ; they come to it from the outside. At least we assert this in
order to remain faithful to the principle of inertia which constitutes all
nature as exteriority. Therefore when we establish a correlation between
the objective system (stimulant-sensory organ) which we presently per-
ceive, and the subjective system which for us is the ensemble of the in-
ternal properties of the other-object, then we are compelled to admit that
the new modality which has just appeared in this subjectivity in connec-
tion with the stimulation of the sense is also produced by something
other than itself. If it were produced spontaneously~ in fact, it would
immediately be cut off from all connection with the organ stimulated, or
if you prefer, the relation which could be established between them
would be anything whatsoever. Therefore we shall conceive of an objec.
tive unity corresponding to even the tiniest and shortest of perceptible
stimulations, and we.shall call it sensation. We shall endow this unity with
inertia; that is, it will be pure exteriority since, conceived in terms of the
"this," it will participate in the exteriority of the in-itself. This exteriority
which is projected into the heart of the sensation touches it almost in its
very existence; its reason for being and the occasion of its existence are
outside of it. It is therefore an exteriority to itself. At the same time its
raison d'etre does not reside in any "internal" fact of the same nature as
it but in a real object (the stimulant) and in the change which affects an-
other real object (the sense organ). Nevertheless as it remains inconceiva-
ble that a certain being existing on a certain level of being and incapable
of being supported in being by itself alone can be determined to exist by
an existent standing on a plane of being which is radically distinct, I
must in order to support the sensation and in order to furnish it with
being; conceive of an environment which is homogeneous with it and con-
stituted likewise in exteriority. This environment I call mind or sometimes
even consciousness. But I conceive of this consciousness as an Other's
consciousness-that is, as an object. Nonetheless as the relations which I
wish to establish between the sense organ and the sensation must be
universal, I posit that the consciousness thus conceived must be also
my consciousness, not for the other but in itself. Thus I have determined
a sort of internal space in which certain figures called sensations are formed
On the occas

ion of external stimulations. Since this space is pure passiv-
ity, I declare that it suffers its sensations. But I do not thereby mean only
that it is the internal environment which serves as matrix for them. I am
inspired at present with a biological vision of the world which I borrow
for my objective conception of the sensory organ considered, and I claim
that this,internal space lives its sensation. Thus life is a magical connection
which I establish between a passive environment and a passive mode of
this environment. -The mind does not produce its own sensations and

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hence they remain exterior to it; but on the other hand, it appropriates
them to itself by living them. The unity of the "lived" and the "living"
is no longer indeed a spatial juxtaposition nor a relation of content to
container; it isa magical inherence. The mind is its own sensations while
remaining distinct from them. Thus sensation becomes a particular type
of object-inert, passive, and simply lived. Behold us now obliged to
bestow on it absolute subjectivity. But the word "subjectivity" must be
correctly understood. It does not mean here the belonging to a subject;
that is, to a selfness which spontaneously motivates itself. The subjecti-
vity of the psychologist is of an entirely different sort; on the conb:ary,
it manifests inertia and the absence of all transcendence. That is subjective
which can not get out of itself. And precisely to the extent that sensation,
since it is pure exteriority, can be only an impression in the mind, precisely
, to the extent that it is only itself, only this figure which is formed by an
eddy in psychic space, it is not transcendence; it is purely and simply
that which is suffered, the simple determination of our receptivity. It is
subjectivity because it is neither presentative nor representative. The.sub-
jective quality of the Other-as-object is purely and simply a closed box.
Sensation is inside the box.
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Such is the notion of sensation. We can see its absurdity. First oiall,
it is pure fiction. It does not correspond to anything which I experience
in myself or with regard to the Other. We have apprehended only the
objective universe; all our personal determinations suppose the world
and arise as relations to the world. Sensation supposes that man is already
in the world since he is provided with sense organs, and it appears in
him as the pure cessation of his relations with the world. At the same
time this pure "subjectivity" is given as the necessary basis on which all
these transcendent relations which its appearance bas just caused to dis-
appear will have to be reconstructed. Thus we meet with these three
moments of thought:
(1) In order to establish sensation we must proceed on the basis of a
certain realism; thus we take as valid our perception of the Other, the
Other's senses, and inductive instruments.
(2) But on the level of sensation all this realism disappears; sensation,
a modification which one suffers, gives us information only about our-
selves; it belongs with the "lived."
(3) Nevertheless it is sensation which I give as the basis of my knowl-
edge of the external world. This basis could not be the foundation of a
real contactwith things; it does not allow us to conceive of .an intentional
structure of the mind.
We are to use the term objectivity not for an immediate connection
with being but for certa

that its presence is a visible presence and that I am conscious
that it is present to me as visible-that is, I am conscious (of) seeing it.
But at the same time that sight is knowledge of the inkwell, sight slips
away from all knowledge; there is no knowledge of sight. Even reflection
will not give us this knowledge. My reflective consciousness will give to
me indeed a knowledge of my reflected-on consciousness of the inkwell
but not that of a sensory activity. It is in this sense that we must take the
famous statement of Auguste Comte: "The eye can not see itself." It
would be admissible, indeed, that another organic structure, a contingent
arrangement of our visual apparatus would enable a third eye to see our
two eyes while they were seeing. Can I not see and touch my hand while
it is touching? But then I shall be assuming the point of view of the
Other with regard to my senses. I should be seeing eyes-as-objects; I can
not see the eye seeing; I can not touch my hand as it is touching. Thus
any sense in so far as it is-for-me is an inapprehensible; it is not the
infinite collection of my sensations.since I never encounter anything but
objects in the world. On the other hand if I assume a reflective point of
view on my consciousness, I shall encounter my consciousness of this or
that thing-in-the-world, not my visual or tactile sense; finally if I can see
or touch my sense organs, I have the revelation of pure objects in the
world, not of a revealing or constructive activity. Nevertheless the senses
are there. There is sight, touch, hearing.
On the other hand, if I consider the system of seen objects which
appear to me, I establish that they are not presented to me in just any
order; they are oriented. Therefore since a sense can not be defined either
by an apprehensible act or by a succession of lived states, it remains for
us to attempt to define it by its objects. If sight is not the sum of visual
sensations, can it not be the system of seen objects? In this case it is
necessary to return to that idea of orientation which we indicated· earlier
and to attempt to grasp its significance.
In the first place let us note that orientation is a constitutive structure
of the thing. The object appears on the ground of the world and mani-
fests itself in a relation of exteriority with other "thises" which have just
appeared. Thus its revelation implies the complementary constitution
of an undifferentiated ground which is the total perceptive field or the
world. The formal structure of this relation of the figure to the ground is
therefore necessary. In a word, the existence of a visual or tactile or audi-
tory field is a necessity; silence, for example, is the resonant field of un-
differentiated noises in which the particular sound on which we focused is
swallowed up. But the material connection of a particular "this" to the
ground is both chosen and given. It is chosen in so far as the upsurge of
the for-itself is an explicit and internal negation of a particular "this" on
the ground of the world: I look at the cup or the inkwell. It is given in
the sense that my choice operates in terms of an original distribution of
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the thises which manifests the very facticity of my upsurge. It is necessary
that the book appear to me on the right or on the left side of the table.
But it is contingent that the book appears to me specifically on the lef

t,
and finally I am free to look at the book on the table or at the table supporting the book. It is this contingency' between the necessity and the freedom of my choice that we call sense. It means that an object must always appear to me all at once-it is the cube, the inkwell, the cup which I see-but that this appearance always takes place in a particular perspective which expresses its relations to the ground of the world and to other thises. It is always the note of the violin which I hear. But it is necessary that I hear it through a door or by the open window or in a concert hall. Otherwise the object would no longer be in the midst of the world and would no longer be manifested to an existent-rising-up-in-the-world.
On the other hand while it is very true that all the thisescan not appear at once on the ground of the world and that the appearance of certain among them results in the fusion of certain others with the ground, while it is true that each this can manifest itself only in one way at a time although there exists for it an infinity of ways of appearing, still these rules of appearance should not be considered as subjective and psychological. They are strictly objective and derive from the nature of things. If the inkwell hides a portion of the table from me, this does not stem from the nature of my senses but from the nature of the inkwell and of light.
If the object gets smaller when moving away, we must not explain this by some kind of illusion in the observer but by the strictly external laws of perspective. Thus by these objective laws a strictly objective center of reference is defined.
For example, in a perspective scheme the eye is the point toward which all the objective lines converge. Thus the perceptive field refers to a center objectively defined by that reference and located in the very "field which is oriented around it. Only we do not see this center as the structure of the perceptive field considered; we are the center. Thus the order of the objects in the world perpetually refers to uS the image of an object which on principle can not be an object for us since it is what we have to be. The structure of the world demands that we can not see' without being visible. The intra-mundane references can be made only to objects in the world, and the seen world perpetually defines a visible object to which its perspectives and its arrangements refer. This object appears in the midst of the world and at the same time as the world. It is always given as an addition to some grouping of objects since it is defined by the orientation of these objects; without it there would be no orientation since all orientations would be equivalent. It is the contingent upsurge of one orientation among the infinite possibilities of orienting the WOrld; it is this orientation raised to the absolute. But on this level this object exists for us only in the capaCity of an abstraCt indication; it is what

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everything indicates tome and what on principle I can not apprehend since it is what I am. In fact what I am can not on principle be an object for me inasmuch as I am it. The object which the things of the world indicate and which they include in their radius is for itself and on principle a non-object. But the upsurge of my being, by unfolding distances in terms of a center, by the very act of this unfolding determines an

object which is
itself in SO far as it causes itself to be indicated by the world; and I could have no intuition of it as object because I am it, I who am presence to myself as the being which is its own nothingness. Thus my being-in-the-world, by the sole fact that it realizes a world, causes itself to be indicated to itself as a being-in-the-midst-of-the-world by the world which it realizes. The case could not be otherwise, for my being has no other way of entering into contact with the world except to be in the world. It would be impossible for me to realize a world in which I was not and which would be for me a pure object of a surveying contemplation. But on the contrary it is necessary that I lose myself in the world in order for the world to exist and for me to be able to transcend it. Thus to say that I have entered into the world, "come to the world," or that there is a world, or that I have a body is one and the same thing. In this sense my body is everywhere-in the world; it is over there in the fact that the lamp-post hides the bush which grows along the path, as well in the fact that the roof up there is above the windows of the sixth floor or in the fact that a passing car swerves from right to left behind the truck or that the woman who is crossin~ the street appears smaller than the man who is sitting on the sidewalk in front of the cafe. My body is co-extensive with the world, spread across all things, and at the same time it is condensed into this single point which all things indicate and which I am without being able to know it. This explanation should allow us to understand the meaning of the senses.

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A sense is not given before sensible objects. For is it not capable indeed of appearing as an object to the Other? Neither is it given after sensible objects; for in that case it would be necessary to suppose a world of incommunicable images, simple copies of reality the mechanism of whose appearance was inconceivable. The senses are contemporaneous with objects; they are things "in person" as they are revealed to us in perspective. They represent simply an objective rule of this revelation. Thus sight does not produce visual sensations; neither is it affected by light rays. It is the collection of all visible objects in so far as their objective and reciprocal relations all refer to certain chosen sizes-submitted to all at once-as measures, and to a certain center of perspective. From this point of view the senses must in no way be identified with subjectivity. In fact all variations which can be registered in a perceptive field are objective variations. In particular, the fact that one can cut off vision by "closing the eyelids" is an external fact which does not refer to the subjectivity

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of the apperception. The eyelid, in fact, is merely one object perceived among other objects, an object which hides other objects from me as the result of its objective relation with them. No longer to see the objects in my rOOm because I have closed my eyes is to see the curtain of my eyelids. Jn the same way if I put my gloves on the tablecloth, then no longer to see a particular design in the cloth is precisely to see the gloves. Similarly the accidents which affect a sense belong to the province of objects. "I see yellow" because I have jaundice or because I am wearing yellow glasses. In each case the reason for the phenomenon is

not found in a sub-
jective modification of the sense nor even in an organic chage but in an
objective relation between objects in the world; in each case I see
"through" something, and the truth of my vision is objective. Finally if in
one way or another the center of visual reference is destroyed (since de-
struction can come only from the development of the world according to
its own laws-i.e., expressing in a certain way my facticity), visible objects
are not by the same stroke annihilated. They continue to exist for me,
but they exist without any center of reference, as a visible totality without
the appearance of any particular this; that is, they exist in the absolute rec-
iprocity of their relations. Thus it is the upsurge of the for-itself in the
world which by the same stroke causes the world to exist as the totality
of things and causes senses to exist as the objective mode in which the
qualities of things are presented. What is fundamental is my relation to
the world, and this relation at once defines the world and the senses
according to the point of view which is adopted. Blindness, Daltonism,
myopia originally represent the way in which there is a world for me; that
is, they define my visual sense in so far as this is the facticity of my up-
surge. This is why I can know and objectively define my senses but
only emptily, ,in tenns of the world; all that is necessary is that my rational
and universalizing thought should prolong in the abstract the indications
which things give to myself about my sense and that it reconstitute
the sense in terms of these signs as the historian reconstitutes an historical '
personality according to the evidence indicating it. But in this case I have
reconstructcd the world on the ground of pure rationality by abstract-
ing myself from the world through thought. I survey the world without
attaching myself to it; I place myself in an attitude of absolute objectivity,
and cach sense becomes one object among objects, a center of relative
reference and one which itself supposes co-ordinates. But thercby I estab-
lish in thought the absolute equivalence of all centers of reference. I
dcstroy the world's quality of bcing a world-without my even being aware
of it. Thus the world by perpetually indicating the senses which I am and
by inviting me to reconstitute it impels me to eliminate the personal
equation which I am by reinstating in the world the center of mundane
reference in relation to which the world is arranged. But by the same
stroke I escape-through abstract thought-from the senses which I am;

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that is, I cut my bonds with the world. I place myself in a state of simple
surveying, and the world disappears in the absolute equivalence of its
infinite possible relations. The senses indeed are our being-in-the-world
in so far as we have to be it in the form of being-in-the-l1}idst-of-the-world.
These observations can be generalized; they can be applied in toto to
my body inasmuch as it is the total center of reference which things
indicate. In particular our body is not only what has long been called
"the seat of the five senses;" it is also the instrument and the end of
our actions. It is impossible to distinguish "sensation" from "action"
even if we use the terms of classical psychology: this is what we had in
mind when we made the observation that reality is presented to us neither
as a t

hing nor as an instrument but as an instrumental-thing. This is why for our study of the body as a center of action we shall be able to take as a guiding thread the reasoning which has served us to reveal the true nature of the senses.

As soon as we fonnulate the problem of action, we risk falling into a confusion with grave consequences. When I take this pen and plunge it into the inkwell I am acting. But if I look at Pierre who at that same in-.stant is drawing up a chair to the table, I establish also that he is acting. Thus there is here a very distinct risk of committing the mistake which we denounced a propos of the senses; that is, of interpreting my action as it is-for-me in terms of the Other's action. This is because the only action which I can know at the same time that it is taking place is the action of Pierre. I see his gesture and at the same time I determine his goal: he is drawing a chair up to the table in order to be able to sit down near the table and to write the letter which he told me he wished to write. Thus I can apprehend all the intermediate positions of the chair and of the body which mOves it as instrumental organizations; they are ways to arrive at one pursued end. The Other's body appears to me here as one instrument in the midst of other instruments, not only as a tool to make tools but also as a tool to manage tools, in a word as a tool-machine. If I interpret the role of my body in relation to my action, in the light of the knowledge I have gained of the Other's body, I shall then consider myself as dis-posing of a certain instrument which I can dispose of at my whim and which in tum will dispose of other instruments all functioning toward a certain end which I pursue.

Thus we are brought back to the classical distinction between the soul and the body; the soul utilizes the tool which is the body. The parallel with the theory of sensation is perfect. We have seen indeed that the latter started from the knowledge of the Other's senses and that subse-quently it endowed me with senses exactly similar to the sensible organs which I perceived in the Other. We have seen also the difficulty which such a theory immediately encountered: this is because I then perceive the world and particularly the Other's sense organs through my own

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sense, a distorting organ, a refracting environment which can give me no information on its own affections. Thus the consequences of the theory ruin the objectivity of the very principle which has served to establish them. The theory of action, since it has an analogous structure, encounters analogous difficulties. In fact if I start with the Other's body, I apprehend it as an instrument and in so far as I myself make use of it as an instrument. I can utilize it in order to arrive at ends which I could not attain alone; I command its acts tluough orders or supplications; I can also provoke its act by my own acts. At the same time I must take precautions with respect to a tool which is particularly delicate and dangerous to handle. In relation to it I stand in the complex attitude of the worker with respect to his tool-machine when simultaneously he directs its movements and avoids being caught by it. Once again in order to utilize the Other's body to my best interests I need an instrument which is my own body just as in order to perceive the Other's sense organs I need other sense organs which a

re my own. Therefore if I conceive of my body in the image of the Other's body, it is an instrument in the world which I must handle delicately and which is like a key to the handling of other tools. But my relations with this privileged instrument can themselves be only technical, and I need an instrument in order to handle this instrument-which refers us to infinity. Thus if I conceive of my sense organs as like those of the Other, they require a sense organ in order to perceive them; and if I apprehend my body as an instrument like the Other's body, it demands an instrument to manage it; and if we refuse to conceive of this appeal to infinity, then we must of necessity admit that paradox of a physical instrument 11andled by a soul, which, as we know, causes us to fall into inextricable aporias.

Let us see 'whether we can attempt here as with the problem of sensations to restore to the body its nature-for-us. Objects are revealed to us at the heart of a complex of instrumentality in which they occupy a determined place. This place is not defined by pure spatial co-ordinates but in relation to axes of practical reference. "The glass is on the coffee table;" this means that we must be careful not to upset the glass if we move the table. The package of tobacco is on the mantle piece; this means tJ~at we must clear a distance of three yards if we want to go from the pIpe to the tobacco while avoiding certain obstacles-end tables, footstools, etc.-which are placed between the mantle piece and the table.

In this sense perception is in no way to be distinguished from the practical organization of existents into a world. Each instrument refers to other instruments, to those which are its keys and to those for which it is the key. But these references could not be grasped by a purely contemplative consciousness. For such a consciousness the hammer would not refer to the nails but would be alongside them; furthermore the expression "alongside" loses all meaning if it does not outline a path which goes from the

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hammer to the nail and which must be cleared. The space which is originally revealed to me is hodological space; it is furrowed with paths and highways; it is instrumental and it is the location of tools. Thus the world from the moment of the upsurge of my For-itself is revealed as the indication of acts to be performed; these acts refer to other acts, and those to others, and so on. It is to be noted however that if from this point of view perception and action are indistinguishable, action is nevertheless presented as a future efficacy which surpasses and transcends the pure and simple perceived. Since the perceived is that to which my For-itself is presence, it is revealed to me as co-presence; it is immediate contact, present adherence, it brushes lightly over me. But as such it is offered without my being able at present to grasp it. The thing perceived is full of promises; it touches me lightly in passing, and each of the properties which it promises to reveal to me,· each surrender silently consented to, each meaningful reference to other objects engages the future.

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Thus I am in the presence of things which are only promises beyond an ineffable presence which I can not possess and which is the pure "being-there" of things; that is, the "mine," my facticity, my body. The cup is there on the saucer; it is presently

given to me with its bottom side which
is there, which everything indicates but which I do not see. And if I wish
to see the bottom side-i.e., to make it explicit, to make it "appear-on-
the·bottom-of-the-cup"-it is necessary for me to grasp the cup by the
handle and tum it upside down. The bottom of the cup is at the end
of my projects, and it amounts to the same thing whether I say that the
other structures of the cup indicate it as an indispensable element of the
cup or that they indicate it to me as the action which will best appropriate
the cup for me with its meaning. Thus the world as the correlate of the
possibilities which I am appears from the moment of my upsurge as the
enOrmous skeletal outline of all my possible actions. Perception is natu-
rally surpassed toward action; better yet, it can be revealed only in and
through projects of action. The world is revealed as an "always future
hollow," for we are always future to ourselves.1
Yet it must be noted that this future of the world which is thus revealed
to us is strictly objective. The instrumental-things indicate other instru-
ments or objective ways of making use of them: the nail is "to be pounded
in" this way or that, the hammer is "to be held by the handle," the cup is
"to be picked up by its handle," etc. All these properties of things are
immediately revealed, and the Latin gerundives perfectly translate them.
Of course they are correlates of non-thetic projects which we are, but
they are revealed only as structures of the world: potentialities, absences,
instrumentalities. Thus the world appears to me as objectively articulated;
1 "Creux toujours futur." There is a suggestion here of a mould to be filled but, of
course, with no idea of a determined future. Tr.
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it never refers to a creative subjectivity but to an infinity of instrumental
complexes.
Nevertheless while each instrument refers to another instrument and
this to another, all end up by indicating an instrument which stands as
the key for all. This center of reference is necessary, for otherwise all the
in~trumentalities would become equivalent and the world would vanish
due to the total undifferentiation of gerundives. Carthage is "de1enda"
for the Romans but "servanda" for the Carthaginians. Without relation
to its centers Carthage is no longer anything; it falls into the indifference
of the in-itself, for the two gerundives annihilate each other. Nevertheless
we must of necessity see that the key is never given to me but only
indicated by a sort of gap.2 What I objectively apprehend in action is a
world of instruments which encroach On one another, and each of them as
it is apprehended in the very act by which I adapt myself to it and surpass
it, refers to another instrument which must enable me to utilize this one.
In this sense the nail refers to the hammer and the hammer refers to the
hand and the arm which utilizes it. But it is only to the extent that I cause
the nails to be pounded in by the Other that the hand and the arm be-
come in turn instruments which I utilize and which I surpass toward their
potentiality. In this case the Other's hand refers me to the instrument
which will allow me to utilize this hand (to threats-promises-salary, etc.)
The first term is present everywhere but it is only indicated. I do not
apprehend my hand in the act of writing but only the pen which is writing;
this means that I us

e my pen in order to form letters but not my hand
in order to hold the pen. I am not in relation to my hand in the same utilizing attitude as I am in relation to the pen; I am my hand. That is, my hand is the arresting of references and their ultimate end. The hand is only the utilization of the pen. In this sense the hand is at once the unknowable and non-utilizable term which the last instrument of the series indicates ("book to be read-characters to be formed on the paper-pen") and at the same time the orientation of the entire series (the printed book itself refers back to the hand). But I can apprehend it-at least in so far as it is acting-only as the perpetual, evanescent reference of the whole series. Thus in a duel with swords or with quarter-staffs, it is the quarter-staff which I watch with my eyes and which I handle. In the act of writing it is the point of the pen which I look at in synthetic combination with the line or the square marked on the sheet of paper. But my hand has vanished; it is lost in the complex system of instrumentality in order that\this system may exist. It is simply the meaning and the orientation of the system.
Thus, it seems, we find ourselves before a double and contradictory necessity: since every instrument is utilizable and even apprehensible only by means of another instrument, the universe is an indefinite, ob-
2 Indiquee en creux; literally, "indicated in a hollow (or mould)." Tr.

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jective reference from tool to tool. In this sense the structure of the world implies that we can insert ourselves into the field of instrumentality only by being ourselves an instrument, that we can not act without being acted on. Yet on the other hand, an instrumental complex can be revealed only by the determination of a cardinal meaning of this complex, and this determination is itself practical and active-to pound a nail, to sow seed. In this case the very existence of the complex immediately refers to a center. Thus this center is at once a tool objectively defined by the instrumental field which refers to it and at the same time the tool which we can not utilize since we should thus be referred to infinity. We do not use this instrument, for we are it. It is given to us in no other way than by the instrumental order of the world, by hodological space, by the univocal or reciprocal relations of machines, but it can not be given to my action. I do not have to adapt myself to it nor to adapt another tool to it, but it is my very adaptation to tools, the adaptation which I am~
This is why if we reject the analogical reconstruction of my body according to the' body of the Other, there remain two ways of apprehending the body: First, it is known and objectively defined in terms of the world but emptily; for this view. it is enough that rationalizing thought reconstitute the instrument which I am from the standpoint of the indications which are given by the instruments which I utilize. In this case, however, the fundamental tool becomes a relative center of reference which itself supposes other tools to utilize it. By the same stroke the instrumentality of the world disappears, for in order to be revealed it needs a reference to an absolute center of instrumentality; the world of action becomes the world acted upon of classical science; consciousness surveys a universe of exteriority and can no l

onger in any way enter into the world. Secondly
the body is given concretely and fully as the very arr~ngement of things in so far as the For-itself surpasses it towards a new arrangement. In this case the body is present in every action although invisible, for the act reveals the hammer and the nails, the brake and the change of speed, not the foot which brakes or the hand which hammers. The body is lived and not known. This explains why the famous "sensation of effort" by which Maine de Biran attempted to reply to Hume's challenge is a psychological myth. We never have any sensation of our effort, but neither do we have peripheral sensations from the muscles, bones, tendons, or skin, which have been suggested to replace the sensation of effort. We perceive the resistance of things. What I perceive when I want to lift this glass to my mouth is not my ·effort but the heaviness of the glass-that is, its resistance to entering into an instrumental complex which I have made appear in the world.
Bachelarcl rightly reproaches phenomenology for not sufficiently taking into accooot what he calls the "coefficient of adversity" in objects.8 The
3 Bachdard, L'Eau et les Rbes, 1942. Editions Jose Corti.

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accusation j;j just and applies to Heidegger's transcendence' as well as to Husserl's intentionality. But we must understand that the instrumentality is primary: it is in relation to an original instrumental complex that things reveal their resistance a:nd their adversity. The bolt is revealed as too big to be screwed into the nut; the pedestal too fragile to support the weight which I want to hold up, the stone too heavy to be lifted up to the top of the wall, etc. Other objects will appear as threatening to an instrumental complex already established-the storm and the hail threatening to the harvest, the phyloxera to the vine, the fire to the house. Thus step by step and across the instrumental complexes already established, their threat will extend to the cenler of reference which all these instruments indicate, and in turn it will indicate this center through them. In this sense every means is simultaneously favorable and adverse but within the limits of the fundamental project realized by the upsurge of the For-itself in the world. Thus my body is indicated originally by instrumental complexes and secondarily by destructive devices. I live my body in danger as regards menacing machines as for manageable instruments. My body is everywhere: the bomb which destroys my house also damages my body in so far as the house was already an indication of my body. This is why my body always extends across the tool which it utilizes: it is at the end of the cane on which I lean and against the earth; it is at the end of the telescope which shows me the stars; it is on the chair, in the whole house; for it is my adaptation to these tools.
Thus at the end of this account sensation and action are rejoined and become one. We have given up the idea of first endowing ourselves with a body in order to study second the way in which we apprehend or modify the world through the body. Instead we have laid down as the foundation of the revelation of the body as such our original relation to the world-that is, our very upsurge into the midst of being. Far from the body being first for us and revealing things to us, it is the instrumental-things which in their original appearanc

e indicate our body to us. The body is
not a screen between things and ourselves; it manifests only the individual-
ity and the contingency of our original relation to instrumental-things. In
this sense we defined the senses and the sense organs in general as our
being-in-the-world in so far as we have to be it in the form of being-in-the-
midst-of-the-world. Similarly we can define action as our being-in-the-
world in so far as we have to be it in the form of being-an-instrument-in-
the-midst-of-the-world. But if I am in the midst of the world, this is be-
cause I have caused the world to-be-there by transcending being toward
myself. And if I am an instrument in the world, this is because I have
caused instruments in general to-be-there by the projection of myself
toward my possibles. It is only in a world that there can be a body, and a
primary relation is indispensible in order that this world may exist. In
One sense the body is what I immediately am. In another sense I am

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"III"""""
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BEING AND NOTHINGNESS
separated from it by the infinite density of the world; it is given to me
by a reflux of the world toward my facticity, and the condition of this
reflux of the world toward my facticity is a perpetual surpassing,~
We are now able to define our body's nature-for-us. The preceding ob-
servations have allowed us to conclude that the body is perpetually the
surpassed. The body as a sensible center of reference is that beyond which
I am in so far as I am immediately present to the glass or to the table or
to the distant tree which I perceive. Perception, in fact, can be accom-
plished only at the very place where the object is perceived and without
distance. But at the same time it unfolds the distances, and that in rela-
tion to which the perceived object indicates its distance as an absolute
property of its being is the body. Similarly as an instrumental center of
instrumental complexes the body can be only the surpassed; it is that
which I surpass toward a new combination of complexes and which I shall
perpetually have to surpass whatever may be the instrumental combina-
tion at which I arrive; for every combination from the moment that my
surpassing fixes it in its being indicates the body as the center of reference
for its own fixed immobility. Thus the body, since it is surpassed, is the
Past. It is the immediate presence to the For-itself of "sensible" things
in so far' as this presence indicates a center of reference a:nd is already
surpassed either toward the appearance of a new this or toward a new com-
bination of instrumental-things. In each project of the For-itself, in each
perception the body is there; it is the immediate Past in so far as it still
touches on the Present which flees it. This means that it is at once a
point of view and a point of departure-a point of view, a point of de-
parture which I am and which at the same time I surpass toward what
I have to be.
This point of view which is perpetually surpassed and which is perpetu-
ally reborn at the heart of the surpassing, this point 'of departure which
J do not cease to leave and which is myself remaining behind me-this
is the necessity of my contingency. It is doubly necessary. First it is neces-
sary because it is the continual reapprehension of the For-itself by the In-
itself and the ontological fact that the For-itself can be only as the being
which is not its own foundation. To have a body is

to be the foundation
of ~>ne's own nothingness and not to be the foundation of one's being; I am my body to the extent that I am; I am not my body to the extent that J am not what I am. It is by my nihilation that I escape it. But I do not thereby make an object of it, for what I am is what I perpetually escape. The body is necessary again as the obstacle to be surpassed in order to be in the world; that is, the obstacle which I am to myself. In this sense it is not different from the absolute order of the world, this order which J cause to arrive in being by surpassing it toward a being-to-come, toward being-beyond-being. We can clearly grasp the unity of these two necessities: being-for-itself is to surpass the world and to cause there to be a
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world by surpassing it. But to surpass the world is not to survey it but to be engaged in it in order to emerge from it; it is necessary always that a particular perspective of surpassing be effected. In this sense finitude is the necessary condition of the original project of the For-itself. The necessary condition for me to be what I am not and to not-be what I am-beyond a world which I cause to come into being-this condition is that at the heart of the infinite pursuit which I am there should be perpetually an inapprehensible given. This given which I am without having to be it--except in the mode of non-being-this I can neither grasp nor know, for it is everywhere recovered and surpassed, utilized for my assumed projects. On the other hand everything indicates it to me, every transcendent outlines it in a sort of hollow by its very transcendence without my ever being able to turn back on that which it indicates since I am the being indicated. In particular we must not understand the indicated-given as a pure center of reference of a static order of instrumental-things. On the contrary their dynamic order, whether it depends on my action or not, refers to it according to rules, and thereby the center of reference is defined in its change as in its identity. The case could not be otherwise since it is by denying that I am being that I make the world come into being and since it is from the !>tandpoint of my past-i.e., in projecting myself beyond my own being-that I can deny that I am this or that particular being. From this point of view the body-i.e., this inapprehensible given-is a necessary condition of my action. In fact if the ends which I pursue could be attained by a purely arbitrary wish, if it were sufficient to hope in order to obtain, and if definite rules did not determine the use of instruments, I could never distinguish within me desire from will, nor dream from act, nor the possible from the real. No project of myself would be possible since it would be enough to conceive of it in order to realize it. Consequently my being-for-myself would be annihilated in the indistinction of present and future. A phenomenology of action would in fact show that the act supposes a break in continuity between the simp!e conception and the realization-that is, between a universal and abstrao::t thought such as "A carburetor must not be clogged" and a technical and concrete thought directed upon tllis particular carburetor as it appears to me with its absolute dimensions and its absolute position. The condition of this technical thought, which is not distinguished from the act which it directs, is

my finitude, my contingency, finally my facticity.
Now, to be exact, I am in fact in so far as I have a past, and this immediate past refers to the primary in-itself on the nihilation of which I arise through birtll. Thus the body as facticity is the past as it refers originally to a birth; that is, to the primary nihilation which causes me to arise from the In-itself which I am in fact without having to be it. Birth, the past, contingency, the necessity of a point of view, the factual condition for all possible action on the world-such is the body, such it is for me.
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It is therefore in no way a contingent addition to my soul; on the contrary it is a permanent structure of my being and the permanent condition of possibility for my consciousness as consciousness of the world and as a transcendent project toward my future. From this point of view we must recognize both that it is altogether contingent and absurd that I am a cripple, the son of a civil servant or of a laborer, irritable and lazy, and that it is nevertheless necessary that I be that orelsesomethingelse,French or German or English, etc., a proletarian or bourgeois or aristocrat, etc., weak and sickly or vigorous, irritable or of amiable disposition-precisely because I can not survey the world without the world disappearing. My birth as it conditions the way in which objects are revealed to me (objects of luxury or of basic necessity are more or less accessible, certain social realities appear to me as forbidden, there are barriers and obstacles in my hodological space); my race as it is indicated by the Other's attitude with regard to me (these attitudes are revealed as scornful or admiring, as trusting or distrusting); my class as it is disclosed by the revelation of the social community to which I belong inasmuch as the places which I frequent refer to it; my nationality; my physiological structure as instruments imply it by the very way in which they are revealed as resistant or docile and by their very coefficient of adversity; my character; my past, as everything which I have experienced is indicated as my point of view on the world by the world itself: all this in so far as I surpass it in the synthetic unity of my being-in-the-world is my body as the necessary condition of the existence of a world and ~s the contingent realization of this condition.
Now at last we can grasp clearly the definition which we gave earlier of the body in its being-for-us: the body is the contingent form which is taken up by the necessity of my contingency. We can never apprehend this contingency as such in so far as our body is for us; for we are a choice, and for us, to be is to choose ourselves. Even this disability from which I suffer I have assumed by the very fact that I live; I surpass it toward my own projects, I make of it the necessary obstacle for my being, and I can not be crippled without choosing myself as crippled. This means that I choose the way in which I constitute my disability (as "unbearable," "humiliating," "to be hidden," "to be revealed to all," "an object of pride," "the justification for my failures," etc.). But this inapprehensible body is precisely the necessity that there be a choice, that I do not exist all at once. In this sense my finitude is the condition of my freedom, for there is no freedom without choice; and in the same way that the body cond

itions
consciousness as pure consciousness of the world, it renders consciousness possible even in its very freedom.
It remains for us to arrive at a conception of what the body is for me; for precisely because the body is inapprehensible, it does not belong to the objects in the wOrld-i.e., to those objects which I know and which
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I utilize. Yet on the other hand since I can be nothing without being the consciousness of what I am, the body must necessarily be in some way given to my consciousness. In one sense, to be sure, the body is what is indicated by all the instruments which I grasp, and I apprehend the body without knowing it in the very indications which I perceive on the instruments. But if we limit ourselves to this observation, we shall not be able to distinguish, for example, between the body and the telescope through which the astronomer looks at the planets. In fact if we define the body as a contingent point of view on the world, we must recognize that the· notion of a point of view supposes a double relation: a relation with the things on which the body is a point of view and a relation with the observer for whom the body is a point of view. When we are dealing with the body-as-a-point-of-view, this second relation is radically different from the first; it is not truly distinct when we are dealing with a point of view in the world (spectacles, a look-out point, a magnifying glass, etc.) which is an objective instrument distinct from the body. A traveler contemplating the landscape from a belvedere sees the belvedere as well as the landscape; he sees the trees between the columns of the belvedere, the roof of the belvedere hides the sky from him, etc. Nevertheless the "distance" between him and the belvedere is by definition less great than that between his eyes and the panorama. The point of view can approach the body to the point of almost being dissolved in it, as we see, for example in the case of glasses, pince-nez, monocles, etc., which become, so to speak, a supplementary sense organ. At its extreme limit-if we conceive of an absolute point of view-the distance between it and the one for whom it is a point of view is annihilated. This means that it would become impossible to withdraw in order to "give oneself plenty of room" and to constitute a new point of view on the point of view. It is precisely this fact, as we have seen, which characterizes the body. It is the instrument which I can not use in the way I use any other instrument, the point of view on which I can no longer take a point of view. This is why on the' top of that hill which I call a "good viewpoint," I take a point of view at the very instant when I look at the valley, and this point of view on the point of view is my body~ But I can not take a point of view on my body without a reference to infinity. Therefore the body can not be for me transcendent and known; the spontaneous, unreflective consciousness is no longer the consciousness of the body. It would be best to say, using "exist" as a transitive verb-that consciousness exists its body. Thus the relation between the body-as-point-of-view and things is an ob;ective relation, and the relation of consciousness to the body is an existential relation.
What do we mean by an existential relation?
First of all, it is evident that consciousness can exist its body only as consciousness. Therefore my body is

hat Baldwin incorrectly calls "emotional
abstracts." Baldwin has indeed established that we can realize affectively within us certain emotions without feeling them concretely. For example, if someone tells me of a particular painful event which has just darkened the life of Pierre, I shall exclaim, "How he must have suffered!" I do not know this suffering and I do not actually feel it. These intermediaries between pure knowledge and true affection Baldwin calls "abstracts." But the mechanism of such an abstraction remains very obscure. Who abstracts? If following M. Laporte's definition we say that to abstract is to think of structures in isolation which can not exist separately, it is necessary either that we identify emotional abstracts with pure abstract concepts of emotions or else that we recognize that these abstracts can exist as such as real modalities of consciousness. In actuality these so-called "emotional abstracts" are empty intentions, pure projects of emotion. That is, we direct ourselves towards pain and shame, we strain toward them, consciousness transcends itself-but emptily. Grief is there, objective and transcendent, but it lacks concrete existence. It would be better to give to these insubstantial significations the name of affective images. Their importance of artistic creation and psychological understanding is undeniable. But the important thing here is the fact that what separates them from real shame, for example, is the absence of the quality of being lived.

There exist therefore pure affective qualities which are surpassed and transcended by affective projects. We shall not make of them as Scheler did, some kind of "hyle" borne upon the flux of consciousness. For us it is simply a matter of the way in which consciousness exists its contingency; it is the very texture of consciousness in so far as it surpasses this texture toward its own possibilities; it is the manner in which consciousness exists spontaneously and in the non-thetic mode, that which it constitutes thetically but implicitly as a point of view on the world. This can be pure grief, but it can also be a mood, an affective, non-thetic tonality, the pure agreeable, the pure disagreeable. In a general way, it is what is called coenesthesia. This "coenesthesia" rarely appears without being surpassed toward the world by a transcendent project on the part of the For-itself; as such it can only with difficulty be studied in isolation. Yet there exist some privileged experiences in which it can be apprehended in its purity, in particular what we call "physical" pain. Therefore we shall now examine this experience in order to fix conceptually the structures of the consciousness (of) the body.

My eyes are hurting but I should finish reading a philosophical work this evening. I am reading. The object of my consciousness is the book and across the book the truths which it points out. The body is in no way apprehended for itself; it is a point of view and a point of departure.

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The words slip by one after the other before me; I make them slip by; those at the bottom of the page which I have not yet read still belong to a relative ground or "the-page-as-ground" which is organized upon the "book-as-ground" and on the absolute ground or ground of the world. But from the ground of their indistinction they are calling to me; they already possess the chara

cter of a friable totality; they are given as "to be made to slip by under my sight." In all this the body is given only implicitly; the movement of my eyes belongs only to an observer's glance. For myself I apprehend thetically only this fixed upsurge of the words one after the other. Yet the succession of the words in objective time. is given and known through my own temporalization. Their motionless movement is given across a "movement" of my consciousness; and this "movement" of consciousness, a pure metaphor which designates a temporal progression, is for me exactly the movement of my eyes. It is impossible for me to distinguish the movement of my eyes from the synthetic progression of my states of consciousness without resorting to the point of view of the Other. Yet at the very moment that I am reading my eyes hurt. Let us note first that this pain can itself be indicated by objects of the world; i.e., by the book which I read. It is with more difficulty that the words are detached from the undifferentiated ground which they constitute; they may tremble, quiver; their meaning may be derived only with effort, the sentences which I have just read twice, three times may be given as "not understood," as "to be re-read." But these same indications can be lacking -for example, in the case when my reading "absorbs me" and when I "forget" my pain (which does not mean that it has disappeared since if I happen to gain knowledge of it in a later reRcctive act, it will be given as having always been there). In any case this is not what interests us; we are looking for the way in which consciousness exists its pain. But at the start someone will ask, how is the pain given as pain in the eyes? Is there not there an intentional reference to a transcendent object, to my body precisely in so far as it exists outside in the world? It is undeniable that pain contains information about itself; it is impossible to confuse pain in the eyes with pain in the finger or the stomach. Nevertheless pain is totally void of intentionality. It must be understood that if pain is given as pain "in the eyes," there is no mysterious "local sign" there nor any knowledge either. Pain is precisely the eyes in so far as consciousness "exists them." As such it is distinguished from other pain by its very existence, not by a criterion nor by anything added on. To be sure, the expression pain in the eyes supposes a whole constitutive work which we shall have to describe. But at this stage in the argument, there is not as yet any reason to consider this, for it is not made. Pain is not considered from a reflective point of view; it is not referred back to a body-for-others. It .is the-eyes-as-pain or vision-as-pain; it is not distinguished from my way

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of apprehending transcendent words. We ourselves have called it pain in the eyes for the sake of clarity; but it is not named in consciousness, for it is not known. Pain in the eyes is distinguished from other possible pains inexpressibly and by its very being.

This pain however does not exist anywhere among the actual objects of the universe. It is not to the right or to the left of the book nor among the truths which are revealed through the book nor in my body-as-object (the body which the other sees and which I can always partially touch and partially see), nor in my body-as-a-point-of-view as the latter is implicitly indica

ted by the world. Neither must we say that the pain is an "overprint" or that it is like a harmony "superimposed" on the things which I see. Those are images which have no meaning. Pain then is not in space. But neither does it belong to objective time; it temporalizes itself, and it is in and through this temporalization that the time of the world can appear. What then is this pain? Simply the translucent matter of consciousness, its being-there, its attachment to the world, in short the peculiar contingency of the act of reading. The pain exists beyond all attention and all knowledge since it slips into each act of attention and of knowledge, since it is this very act in so far as the act is without being the foundation of its being.

Yet even on this plane of pure being, pain as a contingent attachment to the world can be existed non-thetically by consciousness only if it is surpassed. Pain-consciousness is an internal negation of the world; but at the same time it exists its pain-i.e., itself-as a wrenching away from self. Pure pain as the simple "lived" can not be reached; it belongs to the category of indefinables and indescribables which are what they are. But pain-consciousness is a project toward a further consciousness which would be empty of all pain; that is, to a consciousness whose contexture, whose being-there would be not painful. This lateral escape, this wrenching away from self which characterizes pain-consciousness does not for all that constitutes pain as a psychic object. It is a non-thebe project of the For-itself; we apprehend it only through the world. For example, it is given in the way in which the book appears as "about to be read in a hurried, jerky rhythm" where the words press against each other in. an infernal, fixed round, where the whole universe is pierced with anxiety. In addition-and this is the unique character of corporal existence-the inexpressible which one wishes to flee is rediscovered at the heart of this very wrenching away; it is this which is going to constitute the consciousnesses which surpass it; it is the very contingency and the being of the flight which wishes to flee it. Nowhere else shall we come closer to touching that nihilation of the In-itself by the For-itself and that apprehension of the For-itself by the In-itself which nourishes the very nihilation.

. Granted, someone may say. But you are weighting the scales by choos-Ing a case where pain is speCifically pain in a functioning organ, pain in

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the eye while it is looking, in the hand while it is grasping. But I can suffer from a wound in my finger while I am reading. In this case it would be difficult to maintain that my pain is the very contingency of my "act of reading."

Let us note first that no matter how absorbed I am in my reading, I do not for all that cease making the world corne into being. Better yet, my reading is an act which implies in its very nature the existence of the world as a ne~essary ground. This certainly does not mean that I have a weaker consciousness of the world but that I am conscious of it as a ground. I do not lose sight of the colors, the movements which surround me, I do not· cease to hear sounds; they are simply lost in the undifferentiated totality which serves as the background for my reading. Correlatively my body does not cease to be indicated by the world as the total point of view on m

undane totality, but it is the world as ground which
indicates it. Thus my body does not cease to be existed in totality as it
is the total contingency of my consciousness. It is what the totality of the
world as ground indicates, and at the same time it is the totality which I
exist affectively in connection with the objective apprehension of the
world. But to the extent that a particular this detaches itself as figure on
the ground of the world, it correlatively points toward a functional specifi-
cation of the corporal totality, and by the same stroke my consciousness
exists a corporal form which arises on the body-as-totality which it exists.
The book is read, and to the extent that I exist and that I surpass the
contingency of vision-or if you prefer of reading-the eyes appear as
figure on the ground of the corporal totality. On this plane of existence
the eyes certainly are not the sensory organ seen by the Other but rather
the very contexture of my consciousness of seeing inasmuch as this con-
sciousness is a structure of my larger consciousness. of the world. To be
conscious is always to be conscious of the world, and the world and
body are always present to my consciousness although in different ways.
But this total consciousness of the world is consciousness of the world
as ground for a particular this; thus just as consciousness specifies itself
in its very act of nihilation, there is the presence of a particular structure
of the body on the total ground of corporeality. When I am in the pro-
cess of reading, I do not cease to be a body seated in a particular arm
chair three yards from the window under given conditions of pressure
and temperature. And I do not cease to exist this pain in my left index
finger any more than I cease to exist my body in general. However I
exist the pain in such a way that it disappears in the ground of corporeality
as a structure subordinated to the corporal totality. The pain is neither
absent nor unconscious; it simply forms a part of that distance-less exist-
ence of positional consciousness for itself. If a little later I turn the pages
of the book, the pain in my finger, without becoming thereby an object
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of knowledge, will pass to the rank of existed contingency as a figure
on a new organization of my body as the total ground of contingency.
Moreover these statements are in agreement with the empirical observa-
tion that this is because it is easier when reading to "be distracted" from a
pain in the finger or in the lower back then from pain in the eyes. For pain
in the eyes is precisely my reading, and the words which I read refer me
to it every instant, whereas the pain in my finger or back is the apprehen-
sion of the world as ground and hence is itself lost as a partial structure
in the body as the fundamental apprehension of the ground of the world.
But now suppose that I suddenly cease to read and am at present ab-
sorbed in apprehending my pain. This means that I direct a reflective
consciousness on my present consciousness or consciousness-as-vision.
Thus the actual texture of my consciousness reflected-on-in particular
my pain-is apprehended and posited by my reflective consciousness. \Ve
must recall here what we said concerning reflcction: it iJ a total grasp with-
out a point of view; it is a knowledge which overflows itself and which
tends to be objectivized, to project the known at a dist

ance so as to be
able to contemplate it and to think it. The first movement of reflection is therefore to transcend the pure quality of consciousness in pain toward a pain-as-object. Thus if we restrict ourselves to what we have called an accessory reflection, reflection tends to make of pain something psychic. The psychic object apprehended through pain is iIlness.4. This object has all the characteristics of pain, but it is transcendent and passive. It is a reality which has its own time, not the time of the external universe nor that of consciousness, but psychic time. The psychic object can then support evaluations and various determinations. As such it is distinct even from consciousness and appears through it; it remains permanent while consciousness develops, and it is this very permanence which is the condition of the opacity and the passivity of illness. But on the other hand, this illness in so far as it is apprehended through consciousness has all the characteristics of unity, interiority, and spontaneity which consciousness possesses-but in degraded form. This degradation confers psychic individuality upon it. That is, first of all, the illness has an absolute cohesion without parts. In addition it has its own duration since it is outside consciousness and possesses a past and a future. But this duration which is only the projection of the original temporali7..ation, is a multiplicity of interpenetration. The illness is "penetrating," "caressing," etc. And these characteristics aim only at rendering the way in which this illness is outlined in duration; they are melodic qualitics. A pain which is given in twinges followed by lulls is not apprehended by reflection as the

4. In this passage the reader should bear in mind that Sartre uses the word mal, which can refer both to a specific disease or to evil in general. Both ideas are involved in his discussion. Tr.

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pure alteration of painful and non-painful consciousnesses. For organizing reflection the brief respites are a part of the illness just as silences are a part of a melody. The ensemble constitutes the rhytllm and the behavior of the illness. But at the same time that it is a passive object, illness as it is seen through an absolute spontaneity which is consciousness, is a projection of this spontaneity into the In-itself. As a passive spontaneity it is magical; it is given as extending itself, as entirely the master of its temporal form. It appears and disappears differently than spatial-temporal objects. If I no longer see the table, this is because I have turned my head, but if I no longer feel my illness, it is because it "has left." In fact there is produced here a phenomenon analogous to that which psychologists of form call the stroboscopic illusion. The disappearance of the illness by frustrating the projects of the reflective for-itself is given as a movement of withdrawal, almost as will. There is an animism of illness; it is given as a living thing which has its form, its own duration, its habits. The sick maintain sort of intimacy with it. When it appears, it is not as a new phenomenon; it is, the sick man will say, "my afternoon crisis." Thus reflection does not join together the moments of the same crisis, but passing over an entire day it links the crises together. Nevertheless this synthesis of recognition has a special character; it does not aim a

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constituting an object which would remain existing even when it would not be given to consciousness (in the manner of a hate which remains "dormant" or stays "in the unconscious"). In fact when the illness goes away it disappears for good. "Nothing is left of it." But the curious consequence follows that when the illness reappears, it rises up in its very passivity by a sort of spontaneous generation. For example, one can feel its "gentle overtures." It is "coming back again." "This is it." Thus the first pains just like the rest are not apprehended for themselves as a simple, bare texture of the consciousness reflected-on; they are the "announcements" of the illness or rather the illness itself which is born slowly -like a locomotive which gradually gets under way. On the other hand it is very necessary to understand that I constitute the illness with the pain. This does not mean that I apprehend the illness as the cause of the pain but rather that each concrete pain is like a note in a melody: it is at once the whole melody and a "moment" in the melody. Across each pain I apprehend the entire illness and yet it transcends them all, for it is the synthetic tot~lity~all the pains, the theme which is developed by them and through t~. ~ut the matter of the illness does not resemble that of a melody. In the first place it is something purely lived; there is no distance between the consciousness reflected-on and the pain nor between the reflective consciousness and the consciousness reflected-on. The result is that the illness is transcendent but without distance. It is outside my consciousness as a synthetic totality and already close to being elsewhere. But
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on the other hand it is in my consciousness, it fastens on to consciousness with all its teeth, penetrates consciousness with all its notes; and these teetIl, these notes are my consciousness.
What has become of the body on this level? There has been, we noted, a sort of scission from the moment of the reflective projection: for the unreflective consciousness pain was the body; for the reflective consciousness the illness is distinct from the body, it has its own form, it comes and goes. On the reflective level where we are taking our position-i.e., before the intervelJ.tion of the for-others-the body is not explicitly and thematically given to consciousness. The reflective consciousness is consciousness of the illness. However while the illness has a form which is peculiar to it and a melodic rhythm which confers on it a transcending individuality, it adheres to the for-itself by means of its matter since it is revealed through the pain and as the unity of all my pains of the same type. The illness is mine in this sense that I give to it its matter. I apprehend it as sustained and nourished by a certain passive environment in which the passivity is precisely the projection into the in-itself of the contingent facticity of the pains. It is my passivity. This passive environment is not apprehended for itself except as the matter of the statue is apprehended when I p~rceive its form, and yet it is there. The iIlness feeds on this passivity and magically derives new strength from it just as Antaeus was nourished by the earth. It is my body on a new plane of existence; that is, as the pure noematic correlat~ of a reflective consciousness. We shall call it a psychic body

. It is not yet known in any way, for
the reflection which seeks to apprehend the pain-consciousness is not yet cognitive. This consciousness is affectivity in its original upsurge. It apprehends the illness as an object but as an affective object. One directs oneself first toward one's pain so as to hate it, to endure it with patience, to apprehend it as unbearable, sometimes to love it, to rejoice in it (if it foretells a release, a cure), to evaluate it in some way. Naturally it is the illness which is evaluated or rather which rises up as the necessary correlate of the evaluation. The illness is therefore not known; it is suffered, and similarly the body is revealed by the illness and is likewise suffered by consciousness. In order to add cognitive structures to the body as it has been given to reflection, we will have to rcsort to the Other. We can not discuss this point at present, for it is necessary first to bring to light the structures of the body-for-others.

At present, however, we can note that this psychic body since it is the projection on the plane of the in-itself of the intra-contexture of consciousness, provides the implicit matter of all the phenomena of the psyche. Just as the original body was existed by each consciousness as its own contingency, so the psychic body is suffered as the contingency of hate or of love, of acts and qualities, but this contingency has a new character.

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In so far as it was existed by consciousness it was the recapture of COnsciousness by the in-itself;.-in so far as it is suffered by reflection in the illness or the hate or the enterprise, it is pro;ected into the in-itself. Hence it represents the tendency of each psychic object beyond its magical cohesion to be parcelled out in exteriority; it represents beyond the magical relations which unite psychic objects to each other, the tendency of each one of them to be isolated in an insularity of indifference. It is therefore a sort of implicit space supporting the melodic duration of the psychic. In so far as the body is the contingent and indifferent matter of all our psychic events, the body determines a psychic space. This space has neither high nor low, neither left nor right; it is without parts in as much as the magical cohesion of the psychic comes to combat its tendency towards a division in indifference. This is nonetheless a real characteristic of the psyche-not that theps)iche is united to a body but that under its melodic organization the body is its substance and its perpetual condition of possibility. It is this which appears as soon as we name th~ psychic. It is this which is at the basis of the mechanistic and chemical metaphors whch we use to classify and to explain the events of the psyche. It is this which we aim at and which we form into images (image-making consciousnesses) which we produce in order to aim at absent feelings and make them present. It is this, finally, which motivates and to some degree justifies psychological theories like that of the unconscious, problems like that of the preservation of memories.

It goes without saying that we have chosen physical pain for the sake of an example and that there are thousands of other ways, themselves contingent, to exist our contingency. In particular we must note that when no pain, no specific satisfaction or dissatisfaction is "existed" by conscious

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ness, the for-itself does not thereby cease to project itself beyond a contingency which is pure and so to speak unqualified. Consciousness does not cease "to have" a body. Coenesthetic affectivity is then a pure, non-positional apprehension of a contingency without color, a pure apprehension of the self as a factual existence. This perpetual apprehension on the part of my for-itself of an insipid taste which I cannot place, which accompanies me even in my efforts to get away from it, and which is my taste-this is what we have described elsewhere under the name of Nausea. A dull and inescapable nausea perpetually reveals my body to my consciousness. Sometimes we look for the pleasant or for physical pain to free ourselves from this nausea; but as soon as the pain and the pleasure are existed by consciousness, they in turn manifest its facticity and its contingency; and it is on the ground of this nausea that they are revealed. We must not take the term nausea as a metaphor derived from our physiological disgust. On the contrary, we must realize that it is on the foundation of this nausea that all concrete and empirical nauseas (nausea
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caused by spoiled meat, fresh blood, excrement, etc.) are produced and make us vomit.

II. THE BODY-FaR-OTHERS

WE have just described the being of my body for-me. On this ontological plane my body is such as we have described it and it is only that. It would be useless to look there for traces of a physiological organ, of an anatomical and spatial constitution. Either it is the center of reference indicated emptily by the instrumental-objects of the world or else it is the contingency which the for-itself exists. More exactly, these two modes of being are complementary. But the body knows the same avatars as the for-itself; it has other planes of existence. It exists also for-others. We must now study it in this new ontological perspective. To study the way in which my body appears to the Other or the way in which the Other's body appears to me amounts to the same thing. In fact we have established that the structures of my being-for-the-Other are identical to those of the Other's being-for-me. It is then in terms of the Other's being-for-me that-for the sake of convenience-we shall establish the nature of the body-for-others (that is, of the Other's body).

We showed in the preceding chapter that the body is not that which first manifests the Other to me. In fact if the fundamental relation of my being to that of the Other were reduced to the relation of my body to the Other's body, it would be a purely external relation. But my connection with the Other is inconceivable if it is not an internal negation. I must apprehend the Other first as the one for whom I exist as an object; the reapprehension of my selfness causes the Other to appear as an object in a second moment of prehistoric historization. The appearance of the Other's body is not therefore the primary encounter; on the contrary, it is only one episode in my relations with the Other and in particular in what we have described as making an object of the Other. Or if you prefer, the Other exists for me first and I apprehend him in his body subsequently. The Other's body is for me a secondary structure.

In the fundamental phenomenon of making an object of the Other, he appears to me as a transcendence-transcended. That is, by the m

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fact that I project myself toward my possibilities, I surpass and transcend the Other's transcendence. It is put out of play; it is a transcendence-as-object. I apprehend this transcendence in the world, and originally, as a certain arrangement of the instrumental-things of my world inasmuch as they indicate in addition a secondary center of reference which is in the midst of the world and which is not me. These indications-unlike the indications which indicate me-are not constitutive of the indicating thing; they are lateral properties of the object. The Other, as we have

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seen, can not be a constitutive concept of the world. These indications all have therefore an original contingency and the character of an event. But the center of reference which thev indicate is indeed the Other as a transcendence simply contemplated or transcended. The secondary arrangement of objects refers me to the Other as to the organizer or to the beneficiary of this arrangement, in short to an instrument which disposes of instruments in view of an end which it itself produces. But in turn I surpass this end and utilize it; it is in the midst of the world and I can make use of it for my own ends. Thus the Other is at first indicated by things as an' instrument. Things also indicate me too as an instrument, and I am a body precisely in so far as I make myself be indicated by things. Therefore it is the Other-as-body whom things indicate by their lateral and secondary arrangements. The fact is that I actually do not know instruments which do not refer secondarily to the Other's body. Earlier we pointed out that I could not take any point of view on my body in so far as it was designated by things. The body is, in fact, the point of view on which I can take no point of view, the instrument which I can not utilize in the way I utilize any other instrument. When by means of universalizing thought I tried to think of my body emptily as a pure instrument in the midst of the world, the immediate result was the collapse of the world as such. On the other hand, because of the mere fact that! am not the Other, his body appears to me originally as a point of view on which I can take a point of view, an instrument which I can utilize with other instruments. The Other's body is .indicated by the round of instrumental-things, but in turn it indicates other objects; finally it is integrated with my world, and it indicates my body. Thus the Other's body is radically different from my body-for-me; it is the tool which I am not and which I utilize (or which resists me, which amounts to the same thing). It is presented to me originally with a certain objective coefficient of utility and of adversity. The Other's body is therefore the Other himself as a transcendence-instrument.

These same remarks apply to the Other's body as the synthetic en-. semble of sense organs. We do not discover in and through the Other's body the possibility which the Other has of knowing us. This is revealed fundamentally in and through my being-as-object for the Other; that is, if: is the essential structure of our original relation with the Other. And in this original relation the flight of my world toward the Other is equally given. By the reapprehension of my selfness I transcend the Other's transcendence inasmuch as this transcendence is the permanent possibility of apprehending myself as an

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objects-which-he-sees. Thus it is an outline complete with all its parts, and this outline is an outline-of-an-object; an object can come at every instant to fill the outline with content. But still the master of the house "is not there." He is elsewhere; he is absent.

Now we have seen that absence is a structure of being-there. To be absent is to-be-elsewhere-in-my-world; it is to be already given for me. As soon as I receive a letter from my cousin in Africa, his being-elsewhere is concretely given to me by the very indications of this letter, and this being-elsewhere is a being-somewhere; it is already his body. We can in no other way explain why a mere letter from a beloved woman sensually affects her lover; all the body of the beloved is present as an absence in these lines and on this paper. But since the being-elsewhere is a being-there in relation to a concrete ensemble of instrumental-things in a concrete situation, it is already facticity and contingency. It is not only the encounter which I had yesterday with Pierre which defines his contingencyand mine; his absence yesterday similarly defined our contingencies and our facticities. And this facticity of the absent is implicitly given in these instrumental-things which indicate it; his abrupt appearance does not add anything. Thus the Other's body is hisiacticity as an instrument and as a synthesis of sense organs as it is revealed to my facticity. It is given to me as soon as the Other exists for me in the world; the presence or absence of the Other changes nothing.

But look! Now Pierre appears. He is entering my room. This appearance changes nothing in the fundamental structure of my relation to him; it is contingency but so was his absence contingency. Objects indicate him to me: the door which he pushes indicates a human presence when it opens before him, the same with the chair when he sits down, etc. But the objects did not cease to indicate him during his absence. Of course I exist for him, he speaks to me. But I existed equally yesterday when he sent me that telegram, which is now on my table, to tell me of his coming. Yet there is something new. This is the fact that he appears at present on the ground of the world as a this which I can look at, apprehend, and utilize directly. What does this mean? First of all, the facticity of the Other-that is, the contingency of his being-is now explicit instead of being implicitly contained in the lateral indications of instrumental-things. This facticity is precisely what the Other exists-in and through his for-itself; it is what the other perpetually lives in nausea as a non-positional apprehension of a contingency which he is, as a pure apprehension of self as a factual existence. In a word, it is his coenesthesia. The Other's appearance is the revelation of the taste of his being as an immediate existence. I, however, do not grasp this taste as he does. Nausea for him is not knowledge; it is the non-thetic apprehension of the contingency which he is. It is the surpassing of this contingency toward the unique possibilities of the for-itself. It is an existed contingency, <l contingency

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sub"l'litted to and refused. It is this same contingency, and no other, which I presently grasp. But I am not this contingency. I surpass it toward my own possibilities, but this surpassing is the t

ranscendence of an Other.
It is given to me in entirety and without appeal; it is irremediable. The Other's for-itself wrenches itself away from this contingency and perpetually surpasses it. But in so far as I transcend the Other's transcendence, I fix it. It is no longer a resource against facticity; quite the contrary, it participates in turn in facticity, it emanates from facticity. Thus nothing comes to interpose itself between the Other's pure contingency as a taste lor himself and my consciousness. Indeed I apprehend this taste as it is existed. However, from the very fact of my otherness, this taste appears as a known and given this in the midst of the world. This body of the Other is given to me as the pure in-itself of his being-an in-itself among in-itselfs and one which I surpass toward my possibilities. This body of the Other is revealed therefore with two equally contingent characteristics: it is here and could be elsewhere; that is, instrumental-things could be arranged otherwise in relation to it, could indicate it otherwise; the distance between the chair and this body could be different; the body is like this and could be otherwise-i.e., I grasp its original contingency in the form of an objective and contingent configuration. But in reality these two characteristics are only one. The second only makes the first present, only makes it explicit for me. This body of the Other is the pure fact of the Other's presence in my world as a being-there which is expressed by a being-as-this. Thus the Other's very existence as the Other-for-me implies that he is revealed as a tool possessing the property of knowing and that this property of knowing is bound to some objective existence. This is what we shall call the necessity for the Other to be contingent for me.
From the moment that there is an Other, it must be concluded that he is an instrument provided with certain sense organs. But these considerations only serve to show the abstract necessity for the Other to have a body. This body of the Other as I encounter it is the revelation as object-for-me of the contingent form assumed by the necessity of this contingency. Every Other must have sense organs but not necessarily these sense organs, not any particular face and finally not this face. But face, sense organs, presence-all that is nothing but the/contingent form of the Other's necessity to exist himself as belonging to a race, a class, an environment, etc., in so far as this contingent form is surpassed by a transcendence which does not have to exist it. What for the Other is his taste of himself becomes for me the Other's flesh. The flesh is the pure contingency of presence. It is ordinarily hidden by clothes, make~up, the cut of the hair or beard, the expression, etc. But in the course of long acquaintance with a person there always comes an instant when all these disguises are thrown off and when I find myself in the presence of the pure contingency of his presence. In this case I achieve in the face or the other

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parts of a body the pure intuition of the flesh. This intuition is not only knowledge; it is the affective apprehension of an absolute contingency, and this apprehension is a particular type of nausea.
The Other's body is then the facticity of transcendence transcended as it refers to my facticity. I never apprehend the Other as body '.'<ith

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at the same time in a non-explicit manner apprehending my body as the center of reference indicated by the Other. But all the same we can not perceive the Other's body as flesh, as if it were an isolated object having purely external relations with other thises. That is true only for a corpse. The Other's body as flesh is immediately given as the center of reference in a situation which is synthetically organized around it, and it is inseparable from this situation. Therefore we should not ask how the Other's body can be first body for me and subsequently enter into a situation. The Other is originally given to me as a body in situation. Therefore there is not, for example, first a body and later action. But the body is the objective contingency of the Other's action. Thus once again, we find on another plane an ontological necessity which we pointed out in connection with the existence of my body for me: the contingency of the for-itself, we said, can be existed only in and through a transcendence; it is the reapprehension-perpetually surpassed and perpetually reapprehending-of the for-itself, the reapprehension of the for-itself by the in-itself on the ground of the primary nihilation. Similarly here the Other's body as flesh can not be inserted into a situation preliminarily defined. The Other's body is precisely that in terms of which there is a situation. Here also it can exist only in and through a transcendence. Now, however, this transcendence is at the start transcended; it is itself an object. Thus Pierre's body is not first a hand which could subsequently take hold of this glass; such a conception would tend to put the corpse at the origin of the livin~ body. But his body is the complex hand-glass, since the flesh of the hand marks the original contingency of this complex.
Far from the relation of the body to objects being a problem, we never apprehend the body outside this relation. Thus the Other's body is meaningful. Meaning is nothing other than a fixed movement of transcendence. A body is a body as this mass of flesh which it is is defined by the table which the body looks at, the chair in which it sits, the pavement on which it walks, etc. But to proceed further, there could be no question of exhausting the meanings which constitute the body-by means of reference to concerted actions, to the rational utilization of instrumental-complexes. The body is the totality of meaningful relations to the world. In this sense it is defined also by reference to the air which it breathes, to the water which it drinks, to the food which it eats. The body in fact could not appear without sustaining meaningful relations with the totality of what is. Like action, life is a transcended transcendence and a meaning. There is no difference in nature between action and life conceived

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as a totality. Life represents the ensemble of meanings which are transcended toward objects which are not posited as thises on the ground of the world. Life is the Other's body-as-ground in contrast to the body-as-figure inasmuch as this body-as-ground can be apprehended, not by the Other's for-itself and as something implicit and non-positional, but precisely, explicitly, and objectively by me. His body appears then as a meaningful figure on the ground of the universe but without ceasing to be a ground for the Other and precisely as a ground. But here

we should make
an important distinction: the Other's body actually appears "to my body."
This means that there is a facticity in my point of view on the Other.
In this sense we must not confuse my possibility of apprehending an
organ (an arm, a hand) on the ground of the corporal totality and, on
the other hand, my explicit apprehension of the Other's body or of certain
structures of this body in so far as they are lived by the Other as the body-
as-ground. It is only in the second case that we apprehend the Other as
life. In the first instance it can happen that we apprehend as ground that
which is figure for him. When I look at his hand, the rest of his body
is united into ground. But it is perhaps his forehead or his thorax which
for hiin exists non-thetically as figure on a ground in which his arms and
his hands are dissolved.
The result, of course, is that the being of the Other's body is for me a
synthetic totality. This means: (1) I can never apprehend the Other's
body except in terms of a total situation which indicates it. (2) I can not
perceive any organ of the Other's body in isolation, and I always cause
each single organ to be indicated to me in terms of the totality of the
flesh or of life. Thus my perception of the Other's body is radically differ-
ent from my perception of things.
(1) 'i'he other moves within limits which appear in immediate connec-
tion with his movements and which are the terms within which I cause
the meaning of these movements to be indicated to myself. These limits
are both spatial and temporal. Spatially it is the glass placed at a distance
from Pierre which is the meaning of his actual gesture. Thus in my per-
ception of the ensemble "table-glass-bottle, etc.," I go to the movement of
the arm in order to make known to myself what it is. If the arm is visible
and if the glass is hidden, I perceive Pierre's movement in terms of the
pure idea of situation and in terms of the goal aimed at emptily beyond
the objects which hide the glass from me, and this is the meaning of the
gesture.
Pierre's gesture which is revealed to me in the present I always appre-
hend temporally from the standpoint of the future goals toward which
he is reaching. Thus I make known to myself the present of the body
by means of its future and still more generally, by means of the future
of the world. \Ve shall never be alble to understand anything about the
psychological problem of the perception of the Other's body if we do

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not grasp first this essential truth-that the Other's body is perceived
wholly differently than other bodies: for in order to perceive it we always
mOve to it from what is outside of it, in space and in time; we apprehend
its gesture "against the current" by a sort of inversion of time and space.
To perceive the Other is to make known to oneself what he is by means of
the world.
(2) I never perceive an arm raised alongside a motionless body. I per-
ceive Pierre-who-raises-his-hand. This does not mean that by an act of judg-
ment I relate the movement of the hand to a "consciousness" which
instigated it; rather I can apprehend the movement of the hand or of the
arm only as a temporal structure of the whole body. Here it is the whole
which determines the order and the movement of its parts. In order to
prove that we are dealing here with an original perception of the Other's
body, we need only recall the horror

we feel if we happen to see an arm
which looks "as if it did not belong to any body," or we may recall anyone of those rapid perceptions in which we see, for example, a hand (the arm of which is hidden) crawl like a spider up the length of the doorway. In such cases there is a disintegration of the body, and this disintegration is apprehended as extraordinary. In addition, we know the positive proofs the Gestalt psychology has often advanced. It comes as a shock when a photograph registers an enormous enlargement of Pierre's hands as he holds them forward (because the camera grasps them in their own dimension and without synthetic connection with the corporal totality), for we perceive that these same hands appear without enlargement if we look at them with the naked eye. In this sense the body appears within the limits of the situation as a synthetic totality of life and action.
Following these observations, it is evident that Pierre's body is in no way to be distinguished from Pierre-for-me. The Other's body with its various meanings exists only for me: to be an object-for-others or to-be-a-body are two ontological modalities which are strictly equivalent expressions of the being-for-others on the part of the for-itself. Thus the meanings do not refer to a mysterious psychism; they are this psychism in so far as it is a transcendence-transcended. Of course there is a psychic cryptography; certain phenomena are "hidden." But this certainly does not mean that the meanings refer to something "beyond the body." They refer to the world and to themselves. In particular these emotional manifestations or, more generally, the phenomena erroneously called the phenomena of expression, by no means indicate to us a hidden affection lived by some psychism which would be the immaterial object of the research of the psychologist. These frowns, this redness, this stammering, this slight trembling of the hands, these downcast looks which seem at once timid and threatening-these do not express anger; they are the anger.
But this point must be clearly understood. In itself a clenched fist is nothing and means nothing. But also we never perceive a clenched fist. We
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perceive a man who in a certain situation clenches his fist. This meaningful act considered in connection with the past and with possibles and understood in terms of the synthetic totality "body in situation" is the anger.
It refers to nothing other than to actions in the world (to strike, insult,etc.); that is, to new meaningful attitudes of the body. We can not get away from the fact that the "psychic object" is entirely released to perception and is inconceivable outside corporeal structures.
If this fact has not been taken into account hitherto or if those who have supported it, like the Behaviorists, have not themselves very well understood what they wanted to say and have shocked the world with their pronouncements, this is because people too readily believe that all . perceptions are of the same kind. Actually perception must release to us immediately the spatial-temporal object. Its fundamental structure is the internal negation, and it releases to me the object as it is, not as an empty image of some reality beyond reach. But precisely for this reason a new structure of perception corresponds to each type of reality. The body is the psychic object pat excellence-tIle only psychic object. B

ut if we con-
sider that the body is a transcended transcendence, then the perception
of it can not by nature be of the same type as that of inanimate objects.
We must not understand by this that the perception is progressively en-
riched but that originally it is of another structure. Thus it is not neces-
sary to resort to habit or reason by analogy in order to explain how we
understand expressive conduct. This conduct is originally released to per-
ception as understandable; its meaning is part of its being just as the
color of the paper is part of the being of the paper. It is therefore no
more necessary to refer to other conduct in order to understand a parti-
cular conduct than to refer to the color of the table, or of another paper
or of foliage,in order to perceive the color of the folio which is placed
before me.1S
The· Other's body, however, is given to us immediately as what the
Other is. In this sense we apprehend it as that which is perpetually sur-
passed toward an end by each particular meaning. Take for example a man
who is walking. From the start I understand his walking in terms of a
spatial-temporal ensemble (alley-street-sidewalk-shops-cars, etc.) in which
certain structures represent the meaning-to-come of the walking. I per-
ceive this walking by going from the future to the present-although the
future in which there is a question belongs to universal time and is a pure
"now" which is not yet. The walking itself, a pure, inapprehensible, and
nihilating becoming is the present. But this present is a.surpassing to-
ward a future goal on the part of something which is walking; beyond the
pure and inapprehensible present of the movement of the arm we attempt
to grasp the substratum of the movement. This substratum, which we
IS If Sartre did not intend to pun on the words feuillage and feuiIle, then I apologize
for my feeble attempt with "foliage" and "folio." Tr?
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never apprehend as it is except in the corpse, is yet always there as the
surpassed, the past. When I speak of an arm-in-motion, I consider this ann
which was at rest as the substance of the motion. We pointed out in Part
Two that such a conception can not be supported. What mOves cannot
be the motionless arm; motion is a disorder of being. !tis nonetheless
true that the psychic movement refers to two limits-the future terminus
of its result, and the past terminus-the motionless organ which it alters
and surpasses. I perceive the movement-of-the-arm as a perpetual, inappre-
hensible reference toward a past-being. This past-being (the arm, the leg,
the whole body at rest) I do not see at all; I can never catch sight of it
except through the movement which surpasses it and to which I am a
presence-just as one gets a glimpse of a pebble at the bottom of the
stream through the movement of the water. Yet this immobility of
being which is always surpassed and never realized, to which I perpetually
refer in order to say what is in motion-this is pure facticity, pure flesh,
the pure in-itself as the past of a transcended transcendence which is
perpetually being made past.
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This pure in-itself, which exists only by virtue of being surpassed
and in and through this surpassing, falls to the level of the corpse if it
ceases to be simultaneously revealed and -hidden by the transcendence-
transcended. As a corpse-i.e., as the pure past of a life, as simply the re-
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ains-it is still truly understandable only in terms of the surpassing which no longer surpasses it: it is that whic11 has been surpassed toward situations perpetually renewed. On the other hand, in so far as it appears at present as a pure in-itself, it exists in relation to other "thises" in the simple relation of indifferent exteriority: the corpse is no longer in situation. At the same time it collapses into itself in a multiplicity of sustaining beings, each maintaining purely external relations with the others. The study of exteriority, which always implies facticity since this exteriority is never percepible except on the corpse, is anatomy. The synthetic reconstitution of the living person from the standpoint of corpses, is physiology. From the outset physiology is condemned to understand nothing of life since it conceives life simply as a particular modality of death, since it sees the infinite divisibility of the corpse as primary, and since it does not know the synthetic unity of the "surpassing towards" for which infinite divisibility is the pure and simple past. Even the study of life in the living person, even vivisection, even the study of the life of protoplasm, even embryology or the study of the egg can not rediscover life; the organ which is observed is living, but it is not established in the synthetic unity of a particular life; it is understood in terms of anatomy-i.e., in terms of death. There is therefore an enormous error in believing that the Other's body, which is originally revealed to us, is the body of anatomical-physiology. The fault here is as serious as that of confusing our senses "for ourselves" with our sensory organs for others. The Other's body is the
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facticity of the transcendence-transcended as this facticity is perpetually a birt11; that is, as it refers to the indifferent exteriority of an in-itself perpetually surpassed..

These considerations enable us to explain what is called character. It should be noted in fact that character has distinct existence only in the capacity of an object of knowledge for the Other. Consciousness does not know its own character-unless in determining itself reflectively from the standpoint of another's point of view. It exists its character in pure indistinction non-thematically and non-thetically in the proof which it effects of its own contingency and in the nihilation by which it recognizes and surpasses its facticity. This is why pure introspective self-description does not give us character. Proust's hero "does not have" a directly apprehensible character; he is presented first as being conscious of himself as an ensemble of general reactions common to all men ("mechanisms" of passion, emotions, a certain order of memories, etc.) in which each man can recognize himself. This is because these reactions belong to the general "nature" of the psychic. If (as Abraham attempted in his book on Proust) we succeed in, determining the character of Proust's hero (for example, his weakness, his passivity, his particular way of linking love and money), thi~ is because we are interpreting brute givens. We adopt an external point of view regarding them; we compare them and we attempt to disengage from them permanent, objective relations. But this necessitates detachment. So long as the reader using the usual optic process of reading identifies himself with the hero of the novel,

the charac-
ter of "Marcel" escapes him; better yet it does not exist on this level. It appears only if I break the complicity which unites me to the writer, only if I consider the book no longer as a confidant but as a confidence, still better as a document. This character exists therefore only on the plane of the for-others, and that is the reason why the teachings and the descriptions of "psychological realists" (that is, those French authors who have undertaken an objective, social psychology) are never rediscovered in the lived experience of the subject.

But if character is essentially for others, it can not be distinguished from the body as we have described it. To suppose, for example, that temperament is the cause of character, that the "sanguine temperament" is the cause of irascibility is to posit character as a psychic entity presenting nIl the aspects of objectivity and yet subjective and suffered by the subject. Actually the Other's irascibility is known from the outside and is from the start transcended by my transcendence. In this sense it is not to be distinguished from the "sanguine temperament.HIn both instances we apprehend the apoplectic redness, the same corporeal aspects, but we transcend these givens differentlyaccording to our projects. We shall be dealing with temperament if we consider this redness. as the manifestation of the body-as-ground; that is, by cutting all that binds it to the situation.

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If we try to understand it in terms of the corpse, we shall be able to conduct a physiological and medical study of it. If on the contrary, we consider it by approaching it in terms of the global situation, it will be anger itself or again a promise of anger, or rather an anger in promise-that is, a permanent relation with instrumental-things, a potentiality. Between temperament and character there is therefore only a difference of principle, and character is identical with the body. This is what justifies the attempts of numerous authors to instate a physiognomy as the basis of the studies of character and in particular the fine research of Kretschmer on character and the structure of the body. The character of the Other, in fact, is immediately given to intuition as a synthetic ensemble. This does not mean that we can immediately describe it. It would take time to make the differentiated structures appear, to make explicit certain givens which we have immediately apprehended ..ffectively, to transform the global indistinction which is the Other's body into organized form. We can be deceived. It is permissible also to resort to general and discursive knowledge.(laws empirically or statistically established in connection with other subjects) in order to interpret what we see. But in any case the problem will be only to make explicit and to organize the content of our first intuition in terms of foresight and action. This is without a doubt what is meant by people who insist that "first impressions are not mistaken." In fact from the moment of the first encounter the Other is given entirely and immediately without any veil or mystery. Here to learn is to understand, to develop, and to appreciate.

Nevertheless as the Other is thus given, he is given in what he is. Character is not different from facticity-that is, from original contingency. We apprehend the Other as free, and we have demonstrated above that fr

eedom is an objective quality of the Other as the unconditioned power of modifying situations. This power is not to be distinguished from that which originally constitutes the Other and which is the power to make a situation exist in general. In fact, to be able to modify a situation is precisely to make a situation exist. The Other's objective freedom is only transcendence-transcended; it is, as we have established, freedom-as-object. In this sense the Other appears as the one who must be understood from the standpoint of a situation perpetually modified. This is why his body is always the past. In this sense the Other's character is released to us as the surpassed. Even irascibility as the promise of anger is always a surpassed promise. Thus character is given as the Other's facticity as it is accessible to my intuition but also in so far as it is only in order to be surpassed. In this sense to ((get angry" is already to surpass the irascibility by the very fact that one consents to it; it is to give irascibility a meaning. Anger will appear therefore as the recovery of irascibility by freedom-as-object. This does not mean that we are hereby referred to a subjectivity but only that what we transcend here is not only the Other's facticity but
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his transcendence, not his being (i.e., his past) but his present and his future. Although the Other's anger appears to me always as a free-anger (which is evident by the very fact that I pass judgmcnt on it) I can always transcend it-i.e., stir it up or calm it down; better yet it is by transcending it and only by transcending it that I apprehend it. Thus since the body is the facticity of the transcendence-transcended, it is always the body-which-points-beyond-itself; it is at once in space (it is the situation) and in time (it is freedom-as-object). The body for-others is thc magic object par exceIlence. Thus the Other's body is always "a body-more-than-body" because the Other is given to me totally and without intermediary in the perpetual surpassing of its facticity. But this surpassing does not refer me to a subjectivity; it is the objective fact that the body-whether it be as organism, as character, or as tool-never appears to me without surroundings, and that the body must be determined in terms of these surroundings. The Other's body must not be confused with his objectivity. The Other's objectivity is his transcendence as transcended. The body is the facticity of this transcendence. But the Other's corporeality and objectivity are strictly inseparable.

III. THE THIRD ONTOLOGICAL DIMENSION OF THE BODY

I exist my body: this is its first dimension of being. My body is utilized and known by the Other: this is its second dimension. But in so far as I am for others, the Other is revealed to me as the subject for whom I am an object. Even there the question, as we have seen, is of my fundamental relation with the Other. I exist therefore for myself as known by the Other-in particular in my very facticity. I exist for myself as a body known by the Other. This is the third ontological dimension of my body. This is what we are going to study next; with it we shall have exhausted the question of the body's modes of being.

With the appearance of the Other's look I experience the revelation of my being-as-object; that is, of my transcendence as transcended. A me-as-object is revealed to me as an unknowab

le being, as the flight into an
Other which I am with full responsibility. But while I can not know nor even conceive of this "Me" in .its reality, at least I am not without apprehending certain of its formal structures. In particular· I feel myself touched by the Other in my factual existence; it is my being-there-for-others for which I am responsible. This being-there is precisely the body. Thus the encounter with the Other does not only touch me in my transcendence: in and through the transcendence which the Other surpasses, the facticity which my transcendence nihilates and transcends exists for the Other; and to the extent that I am conscious of existing for the Other I apprehend my own facticity, not only in its non-thetic nihilation, not

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only in the existent, but in its flight towards a being-in-the-midst-of-the-world. The shock of the encounter with the Other is for me a revelation in emptiness of the existence of my body outside as an in-itself for the Other. Thus my body is not given merely as that which is purely and simply lived; rather this "lived experience"becomes-in and through the contingent, absolute fact of the Other's existence-extended outside in a dimension of flight which escapes me. My body's depth of being is for me this perpetual "outside" of my most intimate "inside."
To the extent that the Other's omnipresence is the fundamental fact, the objectivity of my being-there is a constant dimension of my facticity; I exist my contingency in so far as I surpass it toward my possibles and in so far as it surreptitiously flees me toward an irremediable. My body is there not only as the point of view which I am but again as a point of view on which are actually brought to bear points of view which I could never take; my body escapes me on all sides. This means first that this ensemble of senses, which themselves can not be apprehended, is given as apprehepded elsewhere and by others. This apprehension which is'thus emptily manifested does not have the character of an ontological necessity; its existence can not be derived even from my facticity, but it is an evident and absolute fact. It has the character of a factual necessity. Since my facticity is pure contingency and is revealed to me non-thetically as a factual necessity, the being-for-others of this facticity comes to increase the contingency of this facticity, which is lost and flees from me in an infinity of contingency which escapes me. Thus at the very moment when I live my senses as this inner point of view on which I can take no point of view, their being-for-others haunts me: they are. For the Other, my senses are as this table or as this tree is for me. They are in the midst of a world; they are in and through the absolute flow of my world toward the Other. Thus the relativity of my senses, which I can not think abstractly without destroying my world, is at the same time perpetually made present tome through the Other's existence; but it is a pure and inapprehensible appresentation.
In the same way my body is for me the instrument which I am and which can not be utilized by any instrument. But to the extent that the Other in the original encounter transcends my being-there toward his possibilities, this instrument which I am is made-present to me as an instrument submerged in an infinite instrumental series, although I can in no way view this serie

s by "surveying" it. My body as alienated escapes me toward a being-a-tool-among-tools, toward a being-a-sense-organ-apprehended-by-sense-organs, and this is accompanied by an alienating destruction and a concrete collapse of my world which flows toward the Other and which the Other will reapprehend in his world. When, for example, a doctor listens to my breathing, I perceive his ear. To the extent that the objects of the world indicate me as an absolute center of reference,

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this perceived ear indicates certain structures as forms which I exist on my body-as-a-ground. These structures-in the same upsurge with my being-belong with the purely lived; they are that which I exist and which I nihilate. Thus we have here in the first place the original connection between designation and the lived. The things perceived designate that which I subjectively exist. But I apprehend-on the collapse of the sense object "ear"-the doctor as listening to the sounds in my body, feeling my body with his body, and immediately the lived-designated becomes designated as a thing outside my subjectivity, in the midst of a Norld which is not mine. My body is designated as alienated.

The experience of my alienation is made in and through affective structures such as, for example, shyness.6 To "feel oneself blushing," to "feel oneself sweating," etc., are inaccurate expressions which the shy person uses to describe his state; what he really means is that he is vividly and constantly conscious of his body not as it is for him but as it is for the Other. This constant uneasiness, which is the apprehension of my body's alienation as irremediable, can determine psychoses such as ereutophobia (a pathological fear of blushing); these are nothing but the horrified metaphysical apprehension of the existence of my body for the Others. We often say that the shy man is "embarrassed by his own body." Actually this expression is incorrect; I can not be embarrassed by my own body as I exist it. It is my body as it is for the Other which may embarrass me. Yet there too the expression is not a happy one, for I can be embarrassed only by a concrete thing which is presented inside my universe and which hinders me as I try to use other tools. Here the embarrassment is more subtle, for what constrains me is absent. I never encounter my body-for-the-Other as an obstacle; on the contrary, it is because the body is never there, because it remains inapprehensible that it can be constraining. I seek to. reach it, to master it, by making use of it as an instrument-since it is also given as an instrument in a world-in order to give it the form and the attitude which are appropriate. But it is on principle out of reach, and all the acts which I perform in order to appropriate it to myself escape me in turn and are fixed at a distance from me as my body-for-the-Other. Thus I forever act "blindly," shoot at a venture without ever knowing the results of my shooting. This is why the effort of the shy man after he has recognized the uselessness of these attempts will be to suppress his body-for-the-Other. When he longs "not to have a body anymore," to be "invisible," etc., it is not his body-far-himself which he wants to annihilate, but this inapprehensible dimension of the body-alienated.

The explanation here is that we in fact attribute to the body-far-the-Other as much reality as to the body-far-us.

utive of the psychic body. In short, so
far as we suffer our body reflectively we constitute it as a quasi-object by
means of an accessory reflection-thus observation COmes .from our·
selves. But as soon as we know the body-i.e., as soon as we apprehend
it in a purely cognitive intuition-we constitute it by that very intuition
with the Other's knowledge (i.e., as it would never be for us by itself).
The knowable structures of our psychic body therefore simply indicate
emptily its perpetual alienation. Instead of living this alienation we consti-
tute it emptily by surpassing the lived facticity toward this quasi-object
which is the psychic·body and by once again surpassing this quasi-object
which is suffered toward characters of being which on principle can not
be given to me and which are simply signified.
Let us return, for example, to our description of "physical" pain. We
have seen how reflection while "suffering" physical pain constitutes it
as Illness. But we had to stop midway in our description because we
lacked the means to l?roceed further. Now, however, we' can pursue the
point. The Illness which I suffer I can aim at in its In-itself; that is, pre-
cisely in its being-for-others. At this moment I know it; that is, I aim at
it in its dimension of being which escapes me, at the face which it turns
toward Others, and my aim is impregnated with the wisdom which lan-
guage has brought to me;-i.e., I utilize instrumental concepts which
corne to me from the Other, and which I should in no case have been
able to form by myself or think of directing upon my body. It is by
means of the Other's concepts that I know my body. But it follows that
even in reflection I assume the Other's point of view on my body; I try
to apprehend it as if I were the Other in relation to it. It is evident that
the categories which I then apply to the Illness constitute it emptily; that
is, in a dimens.ion which escapes me. Why speak then of intuition? It is
because despite all, the body which is suffered serves as a nucleus, as
matter for the alienating means which surpass it. The body is this
IIIness which escapes me toward new characteristics which I establish as
limits and empty schemata of organization. It is thus, for example, that
my IIIness, suffered as psychic, will appear to me reflectively as sickness in
my stomach. Let us understand, of course, that pain "in the stomach" is
the stomach itself as painfully lived. As such before the intervention of
the alienating, cognitive stratum, the pain is neither a local sign nor iden-
tification. Gastralgia is the stomach present to consciousness as the pure
quality of pain. As we have seen, the Illness as such is distinguished from
all other pain and from any other illness-and by itself without an intel-
lectual operation of identification or of discrimination. At this level, how
ever, "the stomach" is an inexpressible; it can be neither named nor
thought. It is only this suffered figure which is raised on the ground of the
body-existed. Objectivating empirical knowledge, which presently sur-
passes the Illness suffered toward the stomach named, is the knowing of a

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certain objective nature possessed by the stomach. I know that it has the
shape ofabagpipe, that is is a sack, that it produces juices, and enzymes,
that it is inclosed by a muscular tunica with smooth fibres, etc. I can also
know-because a physician h

as told me-that the stomach has an ulcer,
and, again I can more or less clearly picture the ulcer to myself. I can imagine it as a redness, a slight internal putrescence; I can conceive of it by means of analogy with abscesses, fever blisters, pus, canker sores, etc. All this on principle stems from bits of knowledge which I have acquired from Others or from such knowledge as Others have of me. In any case all this can constitute my Illness, not as I enjoy possession of it, but as it escapes me. The stomach and the ulcer become directions of flight, perspectives of alienation from the object which I possess.

At this point a new layer of existence appears: we have surpassed the lived pain toward the suffered illness; now we surpass the illness toward the Disease.1 The Disease as psychic is of course very different from the disease known and described by the physician; it is a state. There is no question here of bacteria or of lesions in tissue, but of a synthetic form of destruction. This form on principle escapes' me; at times it is revealed to the Other by the "twinges" of pain, by the "crises" of my Illness, but the rest of the time it remains out of reach without disappearing. It is then objectively discernible for Others. Others have informed me of it, Others can diagnose it; it is present for Others even though I am not conscious of it. Its true nature is therefore a pure and simple being-for-others. When I am not suffering, I speak of it, I conduct myself with respect to it as with respect to an object which on principle is out of reach, for which others are the depositories. If I have hepatitis, I avoid drinking wine so as not to arouse pains in my liver. But my precise goal-not to arouse pains in my liver-is in no way distinct from that other goal-to obey the prohibitions of the physician who revealed'the pain to me. Thus another is responsible for my disease.

Yet this object which comes to me through others preserves characteristics of a degraded spontaneity deriving from the fact that I apprehend it through my Illness. It is not our intention to describe this new object nor to dwell on its characteristics-its magical spontaneity, its destructive finality, its evil potentiality-on its familiarity with me, and on its concrete relations with my being (for it is before all else, my disease). Wewish only to point out that in the disease itself the body is a given: by the very fact that it was the support of the Illness, it is at present the substance of the disease, that which is destroyed by the disease, that acrosS which this destructive form is extended. Thus the injured stomach is

1 Sartre in this and in the earlier related passage is contrasting three things-pain, illness, disease. "Pain" refers to the specific aches and twinges, "illness" to the familiar recurrent pattern of these, "disease" to a totality which includes along with pain and illness the cause of them both and which can be diagnosed and named by the physician. The French words are douleur, mal, and maladie. Tr.

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present through the gastralgia as the very matter out of which this gastralgia is made. The stomach is there; it is present to intuition and I apprehend it with its characteristics through the suffered pain. I grasp it as that which is gnawed at, as a "sack in the shape of a bagpipe," etc. I do not see it, to be sure, but I know that it is my pain. Hence t

he phenomena
which are incorrectly called "endoscopy." In reality the pain itself tells me nothing about my stomach-contrary to what Sollier claims. But in and by means of the pain, my practical knowledge of it constitutes a stomach-for-others, which appears to me as a concrete and definite absence with exactly those objective characteristics which I have been able to know in it. But on principle the object thus defined stands as the pole of alienation of mypain; itis, on principle, that which I am without having to be it and without being able to transcend it toward anything else. Thus in the same way that a being-for-others haunts my facticity (which is non-thetically lived), so a being-an-object-for-others haunts-as a dimension of escape from my psychic body-the facticity constituted as a quasi-object for an accessory reflection. In the same way pure nausea can be surpassed toward a dimension of alienation; it will then present to me my body-for-others in its "shape," its "bearing," its physiognomy;" it will be. given then as disgust with my face, disgust with my too-white flesh, with my too-grim expression, etc. But we must reverse the terms. I am not disgusted by all this. Nausea is all this as non-thetically existed. My knowledge extends my nausea toward that which it is for others. For it is the Other who grasps my nausea, precisely as flesh and with the nauseous character of all flesh. We have not with these observations exhausted the description of the appearances ormy body. It remains to describe what we shall call an aberrant type of appearance. In actuality I can see my hands, touch my back, smell the odor of my sweat. In this case my hand, for example, appears to me as one object among other objects. It is no longer indicated by the environment as a center of reference. It is organized with the environment, and like it indicates my body as a center of reference. It forms a part of the world. In the same way my hand is no longer the instrument which I can not handle along with other instruments; on the con~ trary, it forms a part of the utensils which I discover in the midst of the world; I can utilize it by means of my other hand-for example, when I hold an almond or walnut in my left fist and then pound it with my right hand. My hand is then integrated with the infinite system of utensils-utilized. There is nothing in this new type of appearance which should disturb us or. make us retract the preceding statements. Nevertheless this type of appearance must bementioned. It can be easily explained on condition that we put it in it~ proper place in the order of the appearances of the body; that is, on condition that we examine it last and as a "curiosity" of our constitution. This appearance of my hand means simply that in certain well-defined cases we can adopt with regard to our own

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body the Other's point of view or, if you like, that our own body can appear to us as the body of the Other. Scholars who have made this appearance serve as a basis for a general theory of the body have radically reversed the terms of the problem and have shown themselves up as understanding nothing about the question. We must realize that this possibility of seeing our body is a pure factual given, absolutely contingent. It can be deduced neither from the necessity on the part of the for-itself "to have" a body nor from the factual

structures of the body-for-others. One could easily
conceive of bodies which could not take any view on themselves; it even
appears that this is the case for certain insects which, although provided
with a differentiated nervous system and with sense organs, can not
employ this system and these organs to know each other. We are dealing
therefore with a particularity of structure which we must mention without
attempting to deduce it. To have hands, to have hands which can touch
each other-these are two facts which are on the same plane of. contin-
gency and which as such fall in the province of either pure anatomical
description or metaphysics. We can not take them for the foundation of
a study of corporeality.
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We must note in addition that this appearance of the body does not
give us the body as it acts and perceives but only as it is acted on and per-
ceived. In short, as we remarked at the beginning of this chapter, it would
be possible to conceive ofa system of visual organs such that it would allow
one eye to see the other. But the seen eye would be seen as a thing, not as a
being of reference. Similarly the hand which I grasp with my other hand
is not apprehended as a hand which is grasping but as an apprehensible
object. Thus the nature of our body for us entirely escapes us to the
extent that we can take upon it the Other's point of view. Moreover
it must be noted that even if the arrangement of sense organs allows us
to see the body as it appears to the Other, this appearance of the body as
an instrumental-thing is very late in the child; it is in any case later than
the consciousness (of) the body proper and of the world as a complex of
instrumentality; it is later than the perception of the body of the Other.
The child has known for a long time how to grasp, to draw toward him-
self, to push away, and to hold on to something before he first learns to
pick up his hand and to look at it. Frequent observation has shown that
the child of two months does not see his hand as his hand. He looks at
it, and if it is outside his visual field, he turns his head and seeks his hand
with his eyes as if it did not depend on him to bring the hand back within
his sight. It is by a series of psychological operations and of syntheses of
identification and recognition that the child will succeed in establishing
tables of reference. between the body-existed and the body-seen. Again
it is necessary that the child begin the learning process with the Other's
body. Thus the perception of my body is placed chronologically after the
perception of the body of the Other.
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Considered at its proper place and time and in its original contingency,
this appearance of the body does not seem to be capable of giving rise to
new problems. The body is the instrument which I am. It is my facticity
of being "in-the-midst-of-the-world" in so far as I surpass this facticity
toward my being-in-the-world. It is, of course, radically impossible for me
to take a global point of view on this facticity, for then I should cease to
be it. But why is it so astonishing that certain structures of my body, with-
out ceasing to be a center of reference for the objects of the world, are
ordered from a radically different point of view as compared with other
objects in such a way that along with the objects they point to one of my
sense organs as a partial center of reference raising itsel

elf which would be
to itself its own foundation. Thus the for-itself is both a flight and a pursuit; it flees the in-itself and at the same time pursues it. The for-itself is a pursued-pursuing. But in order to lessen the danger of a psychological interpretation of the preceding remarks, let us note that the for-itself is not first in order to attempt later to attain being; in short we must not conceive of it as an existent which would be provided with tendencies as this glass is provided with certain particular qualities. This pursuing flight is not given which is added on to the being of the for-itself. The for-itself is this very flight. The flight is not to be distinguished from the original nihilation. To say that the for-itself is a pursued-pursuing, or that it is in the mode of having to be its being, or that it is not what it is and is what it is not-each of these statements is saying the same thing. The for-itself is not the in-itself and can not be it. But it is a relation to the in-itself. It is even the sole relation possible to the in-itself. Cut off on every side by the in-itself, the for-itself can not escape it because the for-itself is nothing and it is separated from the in-itself by nothing. The for-itself is the foundation of all negativity and of all relation. The for-itself is relation.
Such being the case, the upsurge of the Other touches the for-itself in its very heart. By the Other and for the Other the pursuing flight is fixed in in-itself. Already the in-itself was progressively recapturing it; already it was at once a radical negation of fact, an absolute positing of value and yet wholly paralyzed with facticity. But at least it was escaping by temporalization; at least its character as a totality detotalized conferred on it a perpetual "elsewhere." Now it is this very totality which the Other makes appear before him and which he transcends toward his own "elsewhere." It is this totality which is totalized. For the Other I am irremediably what I am, and my very freedom is a given characteristic of my being. Thus the in-self recaptures me at the threshold of the future and fixes me wholly in my very flight, which becomes a flight foreseen and contemplated, a given flight. But this fixed flight is never the flight which lam for myself; it is fixed outside. The objectivity of my flight I experience as an alienation which I can neither transcend nor know. Yet by the sole fact that I experience it and that it confers on my flight that in-itself which it flees, I must turn back toward it and assume attitudes with respect to it.
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CONCRETE RELATIONS WITH OTHERS
Such is the origin of my concrete relations with the Other; they are wholly governed by my attitudes with respect to the object which I am for the Other. And as the Other's existence reveals to me the being which I am without my being able either to appropriate that being or even to conceive it, this existence will motivate two opposed attitudes : First-The Other looks at me and as such he holds the secret of my being, he knows what I am. Thus the profound meaning of my being is outside of me, imprisoned in an absence. The Other has the advantage over me. Therefore in so far as I am fleeing the in-itself which I am without founding it, I can attempt to deny that being which is conferred on me from outside; that is, I can tum back upon the Other so as

to make an object
out of him in tum since the Other's object-ness destroys my object-ness for him. But on the other hand, in so far as the Other as freedom is the foundation of my being-in-itself, I can seek to recover that freedom and to possess it without removing from it its character as freedom. In fact if I could identify myself with that freedom which is the foundation of my being-in-itself, I should be to myself my Own foundation. To transcend the Other's transcendence, or, on the contrary, to incorporate that transcendence within me without removing from it its character as transcendence-such are the two primitive attitudes which I assume confronting the Other. Here again we must understand the words exactly. It is not true that I first am and then later "seek" to make an object of the Other or to assimilate him; but to the extent that the upsurge of my being is an upsurge in the presence of the Other, to the extent that I am a pursuing flight and a pursued-pursuing, I am-at the very root of my being-the project of assimilating and making an object of the Other. I am the proof of the Other. That is 'the original fact. But this proof of the Other is in itself an attitude toward the Other; that is, I can not be in the presence of the Other without being that "in-the-presence" in the form of having to be it. Thus again we are describing the for-itself's structures of being although the Other's presence in the world is an absolute and self-evident fact, but a contingent fact-that is, a fact impossible to deduce from the ontological structures of the for-itself.
These two attempts which I am are opposed to one another. Each attempt is the death of the other; that is, the failure of the one motivates the adoption of the other. Thus there is no dialectic for my relations toward the Other but rather a circle-although each attempt is enriched by the failure of the other. Thus we shall study each one in turn. But it should be noted that at the very core of the one the other remains always present, precisely because neither of the two can be held without contradiction. Better yet, each of them is in the other and endangers the death of the other. Thus we can never get outside the circle. We must not forget these facts as we approach .the study of these fundamental attitudes toward the Other. Since these attitudes are produced and destroyed in

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a cirele, it is as arbitrary to begin with the One as with the other. Nevertheless since it is necessary to choose, we shall consider first the conduct in which the for-itself tries to assimilate the Other's freedom.

1. FIRST ATTITUDE TOWARD OTHERS: LOVE, LANGUAGE, MASOCHISM

EVERYTHING which may be said of me in my relations with the Other applies to him as well. While I attempt to free myself from the hold of the Other, the Other is trying to free himself from mine; while I seek to enslave the Other, the Other seeks to enslave me. We are by no means dealing with unilateral relations with an object-in-itself, but with reciprocal and moving relations. The following descriptions of concrete behavior must therefore be envisaged within the perspective of conflict. Conflict is the original meaning of being-for-others.
If we start with the first revelation of the Other as a]oDk, we must recognize that we experience our inapprehensible being-for-others in the form of a possession. I am possessed by

the Other; the Other's look fash-
ions my body in its nakedness, causes it to be born, sculptures it, pro-
duces it as it is, sees it as I shall never see it. The Other holds a secret-
the secret of what I am. He makes me be and thereby he possess me, and
this possession .is nothing other than the consciousness of possessing
me. I in the recognition of my object-state have proof· that he has this
consciousness. By virtue of consciousness the Other is for me simultane-
ously the one who has stolen my being from me and the one who causes
"there to be" a being which is my being. Thus I have a comprehension
of this ontological structure: I am responsible for my being-for-others, but
I am not the foundation of it. It appears to me therefore in the form of
a contingent given for which I am nevertheless responsible; the Other
founds my being in so far as this being is in the form of the "there is."
But he is not responsible for my being although he founds it in complete.
freedom-in and by means of his free transcendence. Thus to the extent
that I am revealed to myself as responsible for my being, I Jay claim to
this being which I am; that is, I wish to recover it, or, more exactly, I am
the project of the recovery of my being. I want to stretch out my hand
and grab hold of this being which is presented to me as my being but at a
distance-likethe dinner of Tantalus; I want to found it by my very free-
dom. For if in one sense my being-as-objectis an unbearable contingency
and the pure "possession" of myself by another, still in another sense
this being stands as the indication of what I should be obliged to recover
and found in order to be the foundation of myself. But this is conceivable
only if I assimilate the Other's freedom. Thus my project of recovering
myself is fundamentally a project of absorbing the Other.

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Nevertheless this project must leave the Other's nature intact. Two
consequences result: (1) I do not thereby cease to assert the Other-that
is, to deny concerning myself that I am the Other. Since the Other is
the foundation of my being, he could not be dissolved in me without my
being-for-others disappearing. Therefore' if I project the realization of
unity with the Other, this means that I project my assimilation of the
Other's Otherness as my own possibility. In fact the problem for me is
to make myself be by acquiring the possibility of taking the Other's
point of view on myself. It is not a matter of acquiring a pure, abstract
faculty of knowledge. It is not the pure category of the Other which I
project appropriating to myself. This category is not conceived nor even
conceivable. But on the occasion of concrete experience with the Other,
an experience suffered and realized, it is this concrete Other as an absolute
reality whom in his otherness I wish to incorporate into myself. (2) The
Other whom I wish to assimilate is by no means the Other-as-object. Or,
if you prefer,my project of incorporating the Other in no way corresponds
to'a recapturing of my for-itself as myself and to a surpassing of the
Other's transcendence toward my own possibilitics. For me it is not a
question of obliterating my object-state by making an object of the Other,
which would amount to releasing myself from my being-for-others. Quite
the contrary, I want to assimilate the Other as the Other-Iooking-at-me,
and this project of assimilation include

s an augmented rccognition of my
being-looked-at. In short, in order to maintain before me the Other's free-
dom which is looking at me, I identify myself totally with my being-
looked-at. And since my being-as-object is the only possible relation be-
tween me and the Other, it is this being-as-object which alone can serve
me as an instrument to effect my assimilation of the other freedom.
Thus as a,reaction to the failure of the third ekstasis, the for-itself wishes
to be identified with the Other's freedom as founding its own being-in-
itself. To be other to oneself-the ideal always aimed at concretely in
the fonn of being this Other to oneself-is the primary value of my re-
lations with the Other. This means that my being-for-others is haunted
by the indication of an absolute-being which would be itself as other and
other as itself and which by freely giving to itself its being-itself as other
and its being-other as itself, would be the very being of the ontological
proof-that is, God. This ideal can not be realized without my surmount-
ing the original contingency of my relations to the Other; that is, by
overcoming the fact that there is no relation of internal negativity be-
tween the negation by which the Other is made other than I and the
negation by which I am made other than the Other. We have seen that
this contingency isinsunnountable; it is the fact of my relations with the
Other, just as my body is the fact of my being-in-the-world. Unity with
the Other is therefore in fact unrealizable. It is also unrealizable in theory,
for the assimilation of the for-itself and the Other in a single transcend-
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ence would necessarily involve the disappearance of the characteristic of
otherness in the Other. Thus the condition on which I project the identi·
fication of myself with the Other is that I persist in denying that I am the
Other. Finally.this project of unification is the source of conRict since
while I experience myself as an object for the Other and while I project
assimilating him in and by means of this experience, the Other appre-
hends me as an object in the midst of the world and does not project
identifying me with himself. It would therefore be necessary-since being-
for-others includes a double internal negation-to act upon the internal
negation by which the Other transcends my transcendence and makes me
exist for the Other; that is, to act upon the Other's freedom.
This unrealizable ideal which haunts my project of myself in the pres-
ence of the Other is not to be identified with love in so far as love is an
enterprise; i.e., an organic ensemble of projects toward my own possi.
bilities. But it is the ideal of love, its motivation and its end, its unique
value. Love as the primitive relation to the Other is the ensemble of the
projects by which I aim at reayzing this value.
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These projects put me in 9irect connection with the Other's freedom.
It is in this sense that love is,a conflict. We have observed that the Other's
freedom is the foundation~of my being. But precisely because I exist by
means of the Other's freedom, I have no security; I am in danger in this
freedom. It moulds my being and makes me be, it confers values upon me
and removes them from me; and my being r~ceives from it a perpetual
passive escape from self. Irresponsible and beyond reach, this protean
freedom in which I have engaged myself can

in tum engage me in a
thousand different ways of being. My project of recovering my being can be realized only if I get hold of this freedom and reduce it to being a freedom subject to my freedom. At the same time it is the only way in which I can act on the free negation of interiority by which the Other constitutes me as an Other; that is the only way in which I can prepare the way for a future identification of the Other with me. This will be clearer perhaps if we study the problem from a purely psychological aspect. Why does the lover want to be loved? If Love were in fact a pure desire for physical possession, it could in many cases be easily satisfied. Proust's hero, for example, who installs his mistress in his home, who can see her and possess her at any hour of the day, who has been able to make her completely dependent on him ecc:omically, ought to be free from worry. Yet we know that he is, on fie l..'Ontrary, continually gnawed by anxiety. Through her consciousncs Albertine escapes Marcel even when he is at her side, and that is why he knows relief only when he gazes on her while she sleeps. It is certain then that the lover wishes to capture a "consciousness." But why does he wish it? And how?
The notion of "ownership," by which love is so often explained, is not actually primary. Why should I want to ~ppropriate the Other if it were
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not precisely that the pther makes me be? But this implies precisely a certain mode of appropriation; it is the Other's freedom as such that we want to get hold of. Not because of a desire for power. The tyrant scorns love, he is content with fear. If he seeks t-o win the love of his subjects, it is for political reasons; and if he finds a more economical way to enslave them, he adopts it immediately. On the other hand, the man who wants to be loved does not desire the enslavement of the beloved. He is not bent on becoming the object of passion which flows forth mechanically. He does not want to possess an automaton, and if we want to humiliate him, we need only try to persuade him that the beloved's passion is the result of a psychological determinism. The lover will then feel that both his love and his being are cheapened. If Tristan and Isolde fall madly in love because of a love potion, they are less interesting. The total enslavement of the beloved kills the love of the lover. The end is sur· passed; if the beloved is transformed into an automaton, the lover finds himself alone. Thus the lover does not desire to possess the beloved as one possesses a thing; he demands a special type of appropriation. He wants to possess a freedom as freedom.
On the other hand, the lover can not be satisfied with that superior form of freedom which is a free and voluntary engagement. \\Tho would be content with a love given as pure loyalty to a sworn oath? \\Tho would be satisfied with the words, "I love you because I have freely engaged myself to love you and because I do not wish to go back on my word." Thus the lover demands a pledge, yet is irritated by a pledge. He wants to be loved by a freedom but demands that this freedom as freedom should no long~r be free. He wishes that the Other's freedom should determine itself to become love-and this not only at the beginning of the affair but at each instant-and at the same time he wants this freedom to be captured by i

tself, to turn back upon itself, as in madness, as in a dream, so as to will its own captivity. This captivity must be a resignation that is both free and yet chained in our hands. In love it is not a determinism of the passions which we desire in the Other nor a freedom beyond reach; it is a freedom which plays the role of a determinism of the passions and which is caught in its own role. For himself the lover does not demand that he be the cause of this radical modification of freedom but that he be the unique and privileged occasion of it. In fact he could not want to be the cause of it without immediately submerging the beloved in the midst of the world as a tool which can be transcended. That is not the essence of love. On the contrary, in Love the Lover wants to be. "the whole World" for the beloved. This means that he puts himself onthe side of the world; he is the one who assumes and symbolizes the world; he is a this which includes all other thises. He is and consents to be an object. But On the other hand, he wants to be the object in which the Other's freedom consents to lose itself, the obj.ect in which the Other consents to
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find his being and his raison d'ctre as his second facticity-the object-limit of transcendence,. that toward which the Other's transcendence transcends all other objects but which it can in no way transcend. And everywhere he desires the circle of the Other's freedom; that is, at each instant as the Other's freedom accepts this limit to his transcendence, this acceptance is already present as the motivation of the acceptance considered. It is in the capacity of an end already chosen that the lover wishes to be chosen as an end. This allows us to grasp what basically the lover demands of the beloved; he does not want to act on the Other's freedom but to exist a priori as the objective limit of this freedom; that is, to be given at one stroke along with it and in its very upsu!ge as the limit which the freedom must accept in order to be free. By this very fact, what he demands is a liming, a gluing down of the Other's freedom by itself; thi~ limit of structure is in fact a given, and the very appearance of the given as the limit of freedom means that the freedom makes itself exist within the given by being its own prohibition against surpassing it. This prohibition is envisaged by the lover simultaneously as something lived-that is, something suffered (in a word, as a facticity) and as some· thing freely consented to. It must be freely consented to since it must be effected only with the upsurge of a freedom which chooses itself as free-dom. But it must be only what is lived since it must be an impossibility always present, a. facticity which surges back to the heart of the Other's freedom. This is expressed psychologically by the demand that the free decision to love me, which the beloved formerly has taken, must slip in as a magically determining motivation within his present free engage-ment.

Now we can grasp the meaning of this demand: the facticity which is to be a factual limit for the Other in my demand to be loved and which is to result in being his own facticity-this is my facticity. It is in so far as I am the object which the Other makes come into being that I must be the, inherent limit to his very transcendence. Thus the Other by his up-surge into being makes me be as unsurpassable

and absolute, not as a
nihilating For-itself but as a being-for-others-in-the-midst-of-the-world.
Thus to want to be loved is to infect the Other with one's own facticity;
it is to wish to compel him to recreate you perpetually as the condition
of a freedom which submits itself and which is engaged; it is to wish both
that freedom found fact and that fact have pre-eminence over freedom. If
this end could be attained, it would result in the first place in my being
secure within the Other's consciousness. First because the motive of my
uneasiness and my shame is the fact that I apprehend and experience my-
self in my being-for-others as that which can always be surpassed towards
something else, that which is the pure object of a value judgment,
a pure means, a pure tool. My uneasiness stems from the fact that I assume
necessarily and freely that being which another makes me be in an absolute
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freedom. "God knows what I am for himlGod knows what he thinks of
me!" This means "God knows what he makes me be." I am haunted by
this being which I fear to encounter someday at the turn of a path, this
being which is so strange to me and which is yet my being and which I
know that I shall never encounter in spite of all my efforts to do so. But if
the Other loves me then I become the unsurpassable, which means that
I must be the absolute end. In this sense I am saved from instrumentality.
My existence in the midst of the world becomes the exact correlate of
my transcendence-for-myself since my independence is absolutely safe-
guarded. The object which the Other must make me be is an object-
transcendence, an absolute center of reference around which all the instru-
mental-things of the world are ordered as pure means. At the same time,
as the absolute limit of freedom-i.e., of the absolute source of all values
-I am protected against any eventual devalorization. I am the absolute
value. To the extent that I assume my being-for-others, I assume myself
as value. Thus to want to he loved is to want to be placed beyond the
whole system of values posited by the Other and to be the condition
of all valorization and the objective foundation of all values. This demand
is the usual theme of lovers'conversations, whether as in La Porte Etroite,
the woman who wants to be loved identifies herself with an ascetic moral-
ity of self-surpassing and wishes to embody the ideal limit of this sur-
passing-or as more usually happens, the woman in love demands that
the beloved in his acts should sacrifice traditional morality for her and is
anxious to know whether the beloved would betray his friends for her,
"would steal for her," "would kill for her," etc.
From this point of view, my being must escape the look of the be-
loved, or rather it must be the object of a look with another structure. I
must no longer be seen on the ground of the world as a "this" among
other "thises," but the world must be revealed in terms of, me. In fact
to the extent that the upsurge of freedom makes a world exist, I must be,
as the limiting-condition of this upsurge, the very condition of the upsurge
of a world. I must be the one whose function is to make trees and water
exist, to'make cities and fields and other men exist, in order to give them
later to the Other who arranges them into a world, just as. the mother in
matrilineal communities receives titles and the fam

ily name not to keep
them herself but to transfer them immediately to her children. In one sense if I am to be loved, I am the object through whose procuration the world will exist for the Other; in another sense I am the world. Instead of being a "this" detaching itself on the ground of the world, I am the ground-as-object on which the world detaches itself. Thus I am reassured; the Other's look no longer paralyzes me with finitude. It no longer fixes my being in what I am. I can no longer be looked at as ugly, as small, as cowardly, since these characteristics necessarily represent a factual limitation of my being and an apprehension of my finitude as finitude. To be

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sure, my possibles remain transcended possibilities, dead~possibilities; but I possess all possibles. I am all the dead-possibilities in the world; hence I cease to be the being who is understood from the standpoint of other beings or of its acts. In the loving intuition which I demand, I am to be given as an absolute totality in terms of which all its peculiar acts and all beings are to be understood. One could say, slightly modifying a famous pronouncement of the Stoics, that "the beloved can fail in three ways."1 The ideal of the sage and the ideal of the man who wants to be loved actually coincide in this that both want to be an object-as-totality accessible to a global intuition which will apprehend the beloved's or the sage's actions in the world as partial structures which are interpreted in terms of the totality. Just as wisdom is proposed as a state to be attained by an absolute metamorphosis, so the Other's freedom must be absolutely metamorphosed in order to. allow me to attain the state of being loved. Up to this point our description would fall into line with Hegel's famous description of the Master and Slave relation. What the Hegelian Master is for the Slave, the lover wants to be for the beloved. But the analogy stops here, for with Hegel the master demands the Slave's freedom only laterally and, so to speak, implicitly, while the lover wants the beloved's freedom first and foremost. In this sense if I am to be loved by the Other, this means that I am to be freely chosen as beloved. As we know, in the current terminology of love, the beloved is often called the chosen one. But this choice must not be relative and contingent. The lover is irritated and feels himself cheapened when he thinks that the beloved has chosen him from among others. "Then if I had not come into a certain city, if I had not visited the home of so and so, you would never have known me, you wouldn't have loved me?" This thought grieves the lover; his love becomes one love among others and is limited by the beloved's facticity and by his own facticity as well as by the contingency of encounters. It becomes love in the world, an object which presupposes the world and which in turn can exist for others. What he is demanding he expresses by the awkward and vitiate~ phrases of "fatalism." He says, "We were made for each other," or again he uses the expression "soul mate." But we must translate all this. The lover knows very well that "being made for each other" refers to an original choice. This choice can be God's, since he is the being who is absolute choice, but God here represents only the farthest possible limit of the demand for an absolute. Actually what the lover dema

nds is that the beloved should make of him
an absolute choice. This means that the beloved's being-in-the-world
must be a being-as-loving. The upsurge of the beloved must be the be-
loved's free choice of the lover. And since the Other is the foundation
of my being-as-object, I demand of him that the free upsurge of his being
should have his choice of me as his unique and absolute end; that is, that
1 Literally, "can tumble three times." Tr.

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he should choose to be for the sake of founding my object-state and my
facticity.
Thus my facticity is saved. It is no longer this. unthinkable and insur-
mountable given which I am fleeing; it is that for which the Other freely
makes himself exist; it is as an end which he has given to himself. I have
infected him with my facticity, but as it is in the form of freedom that
he has been infected with it, he refers it back to me as a facticity taken
up and consented to. ,He is the foundation of it in order that it may be
his end. By means of this love I then have a different apprehension of my
alienation and of my own facticity. My facticity-as for-others-is no
longer a fact but a right. My existence is because it is given a name. I
am because I give myself away. These beloved veins on my hands exist
-beneficently. How good I am to have eyes, hair, eyebrows and to lavish
them away tirelessly in an overflow of generosity to this tireless desire
which the Other freely makes himself be. Whereas before being loved
we were uneasy about that unjustified, unjustifiable protuberance which
was our existence, whereas we felt ourselves "de trop," we now feel that
our existence is taken up and willed even in its tiniest details by an
absolute freedom which at the same time our existence conditions and
which we ourselves 'will with our freedom. This is the basis for the joy of
love when there is joy: we feel that our existence is justified.
By the same token if the beloved can love us, he is wholly ready to be
assimilated by our freedom; for this being-loved which we desire is already
the ontological proof applied to our being-for-others. Our objective es-
sense implies the existence of the Other,and conversely it is the Other's
freedom which founds our essence. If we could manage to interiorize the
whole system, we should be our own foundation.
Such then is the real goal of the lover in so far as his love is an enterprise
-i.e., a project of himself. This project is going to provoke a conflict. The
beloved in fact apprehends the lover as one Other-as-object among others;
that is, he perceives the lover on the ground of the world, transcends him,
and utilizes him. The beloved is a look. He can not therefore employ his
transcendence to fix an ultimate limit to his surpassings, nor can he
employ his freedom to captivate itself. The beloved can not will to love.
Therefore the lover must seduce the beloved, and his love can in no way
be distinguished from the enterprise of seduction. In seduction I do
not try to reveal my subjectivity to the Other. Moreover I could do so
only by looking at the other; but by this look I should cause the Other's
subjectivity to disappear, and it is exactly this which I want to assimilate.
To seduce is to risk assuming my object-state completely for the Other;
it is to put myself beneath his look and to make him look at me; it is to
risk the danger of being-seen in orde

in this sense only-that Heidegger is right In declaring that I am what I say.2 Language is not an instinct of the constituted human creature, nor is it an invention of our subjectivity. But neither does it need to be referred to the pure "being-outside-of-self" of the Dasein. It forms part of the human condition; it is originally the proof which a for-itself can make of its being-for-others, and finally it is the surpassing of this proof and the utilization of it toward possibilities which are my possibilities; that is, toward my possibilities of being this or that for the Other. Language is therefore not distinct from the recognition of the Other's existence. The Other's upsurge confronting me as a look makes language arise as the condition of my being. This primitive language is not necessarily seduction; we shall see other forms of it. Moreover we have noted that there is another primitive attitude confronting the Other and that the two succeed each other in a circle, each implying the other. But conversely seduction does not· presuppose any earlier form of language; it is the complete realization.of language. This means that language can be reo vealed entirely and at· one stroke by seduction as a primitive mode of being of expression. Of course by language we mean all the phenomena of expression and not the articulated word, which is a derived and secondary mode whose appearance can be made the object of an historical study. Especially in seduction language does not aim at giving to be known but at causing to experience.

But in this first attempt to find a fascinating language I proceed blindly since I am guided only by the abstract and empty form of my object-state for the Other. I can not even conceive what effect my gestures and attitudes will have since they wiI always be taken up and founded by a freedom which will surpass them and since they can have a meaning only if this freedom confers one on them. Thus the "meaning" of my expressions always escapes me. I never know exactly if I signify what I wish to signify nor even if I am signifying anything. It would be necessary that at the precise instant I should read in the Other what on principle is inconceivable. For lack of knowing what I actually express for the Other, I constitute my language as an incomplete phenomenon of flight outside myself. As soon as I express myself, I can only guess at the meaning of what I express-i.e., the meaning of what I am-since in this perspective to express and to be are one. The Other is always there, present and experienced as the one who gives to language

2 This fonnulation of Heidegger's position is that of A. de Waehlens. La philosopflie de Martin Heidegger. Louvain, 1942, p. 99. C/. also Heidcgger's text, which he quotes: "Diese Bezeugung meint nicht hier einen nachtriiglichen und bci her laufendcn Ausdruck des Menschseins, sonder sie macht das Dasein des Menschen mit usw. (Holderlin und das Wesen der Dichtung, p. 6.)

("This affinnation does not mean here an additional and supplementary expression of human existence, but it does in the process make plain the existence of man." Douglas Scott's translation. Existence and Being, Chicago: Henry Regnery. 1949, p. 297,)

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its meaning. Each expression, each gesture, each word is on my side a concrete proof of the alienating reality of the Other. It is

only the
psychopath who can say, "someone has stolen my thought"-as in cases of psychoses of influence, for example.8 The very fact of expression is a stealing of thought since thought needs the cooperation of an alienating freedom in order to be constituted as an object. That is why this first aspect of language-in so far as it is I who employ it for the Other-is sacred. The sacred object is an object which is in the world and which points to a transcendence beyond the world. Language reveals to me the freedom (the transcendence) of the one who listens to me in silence. But at the same moment I remain for the Other a meaningful object-that which I have always been. There is no path which departing from my object-state can lead the Other to my transcendence. Attitudes, expressions, and words can only indicate to him other attitudes, other expressions, and other words. Thus language remains for him a simple property of a magical object-and this magical object itself. It is an action at a distance whose effect the Other exactly knows. Thus the word is sacred when I employ it and magic when the Other hears it. Thus I do not know my language any more than I know my body for the Other. I can not hear myself speak nor see myself smile. The problem of language is exactly parallel to the problem of bodies, and the description which is valid in one case is valid in the other.

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Fascination, however, even if it were to produce a state of being-fascinated in the Other could not by itself succeed in producing love. We can be fascinated by an orator, by an actor, by a tightrope-walker, but this does not mean that we love him. To be sure we cannot take our eyes off him, but he is still raised on the ground of the world, and fascination does not posit the fascinating object as the ultimate term of the transcendence. Quite the contrary, fascination is transcendence. When then will the beloved become in turn the lover?

The answer is easy: when the beloved projects being loved. By himself the Other-as-object never has enough strength to produce love. If love has for its ideal the appropriation of the Other qua Other (i.e., as a subjectivity which is looking at an object) this ideal can be projected only in terms of my encounter with the Other-as-subject, not with the Other-as-object. If the Other tries to seduce me by means of his object-state, then seduction can bestow upon the Other only the character of a precious object "to be possessed." Seduction will perhaps determine me to risk much to conquer the Other-as-object, but this desire to appropriate an object in the midst of the world should not be confused with love. Love therefore can be born in the beloved only from the proof which

8 Furthennore the psychosis of influence, like the majority of psychoses, is a special experience translated by myths, of a great metaphysical fact-here the fact of alienation. Even a madman in his own way realizes the human condition.

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he makes of his alienation and his flight toward the Other. Still the beloved, if such is the case, will be transformed into a lover only if he projects being loved; that is, if what he wishes to overcome is not a body but the Other's subjectivity as such. In fact the only way that he could conceive to realize this appropriation is to make himself be loved. Thus it seems that to love is in essence the project of making

onsciousness-under the ideal standard of the value "love;"
that is, in a fusion of consciousnesses in which each of them would preserve his otherness in order to found the other. This state of affairs is due to the fact that consciousnesses are separated by an insurmountable nothingness, a nothingness which is both the internal negation of the one by the other and a factual nothingness between the two internal negations. Love is a contradictory effort to surmount the factual negation while preserving the internal negation. I demand that the Other love me and I do everything possible to realize my project; but if the Other loves me, he radically deceives me by his very love. I demanded of him that he should found my being as a privileged object by maintaining himself as pure subjectivity confronting me; and as soon as he loves me he experiences me as subject and is swallowed up in his objectivity confronting my subjectivity.
The problem of my being-for-others remains therefore without solution. The lovers remain each one for himself in a total subjectivity; nothing comes to relieve them of their duty to make themselves exist each one for himself; nothing comes to relieve their contingency nor to save them from facticity. At least each one has succeeded in escaping danger from the Other's freedom---:but altogether differently than he expected. He escapes not because the Other makes him be as the object-limit of his transcendence but because the Other experiences him as subjectivity and wishes to experience him only as such. Again the gain is perpetually compromised. At the start, each of the consciousnesses can at any moment free itself from its chains and suddenly comtemplate the other as an object. Then the spell is broken; the Other becomes one mean among means. He is indeed an object for-others as the lover desires but an object-as-tool, a perpetually transcended object. The illusion, the game of mirrors which makes the concrete reality of love, suddenly ceases. Later in the experience of love each consciousness seeks to shelter its being-for-others in the Other's freedom. This supposes that the Other is beyond the world as pure subjectivity, as the absolute by which the world comes into being. But it suffices that the lovers should be looked at together by a third person in order for each one to experience not only his own objectivation but that of the other as well. Immediately the Otheris no

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longer for me the absolute transcendence which founds me in my beiog; he is a transcendence-transcended, not by me but by another. My original relation to him-i.e., my relation of being the beloved for mylover, is fixed as a dead-possibility. It is no longer the experienced relation between a limiting object of all transcendence and the freedom which founds it; it is a love-as-object which is wholly alienated toward the third. Such is the true reason why lovers seek solitude. It is because the appearance of a third person, whoever he may be, is the destruction of their love. But factual solitude (e.g. we are alone in my room) is by no means a theoretical solitude. Even if nobody sees us, we exist for all consciousnesses and we are conscious of existing for all. The result is that love as a fundamental mode of being-for-others holds in its being-for-others the seed of its own destruction.
We have just defined the tr

come again the foundation of itself.
Masochism, like sadism, is the assumption of guilt.1t I am guilty due to the very fact that I am an object, I am guilty toward myself since I consent to my absolute alienation. I am guilty toward the Other, for I furnish him with the occasion of being guilty-that is, of radically missing my freedom as such. Masochism is an attempt not to fascinate the Other by means of my objectivity but to cause myself to be fascinated by my
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objectivity-for-others; that is, to cause myself to be constituted as an object by the Other in such a way that I non-thetically apprehend my subjectivity as a nothing in the presence of the in-itself which I represent to the Other's eyes. Masochism is characterized as a species of vertigo, vertigo not before a precipice of rock and earth but before the abyss of the Other's subjectivity.
But masochism is and must be itself a failure. In order to cause myself to be fascinated by my self-as-object, I should necessarily have to be able to realize the intuitive apprehension of this object such as it is for the Other, a thing which is on principle impossible. Thus I am far from being able to be fascinated by this alienated Me, which remains on principle inapprehensible. It is useless for the masochist to get down on his knees, to show himself in ridiculous positions, to cause himself to be used as a simple lifeless instrument. It is for the Other that he will be obscene or simply passive, for the Other that he will undergo these postures; for himself he is forever condemned to give them to himself. It is in and through his transcendence that he disposes of himself as a being to be transcended. The more he tries to taste his objectivity, the more he will be submerged by the consciousness of .his subjectivity-hence his anguish.
I Cf. following section.
S Cf. following section.

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Even the masochist who pays a woman to whip him is treating her as an instrument and by this very fact posits himself in transcendence in relation to her.
TIIUS the masochist ultimately treats the Other as an object and transcends him toward his own objectivity. Recall, for example, the tribulations of Sacher Masoch, who in order to make himself scorned, insulted, reduced to a humiliating position, was obliged to make use of the great love which women bore toward him; that is, to act upon them just in so far as they experienced themselves as an object for him. Thus in every way the masochist's objectivity escapes him, and it can even happen-in fact usually does happen-that in seeking to apprehend his own objectivity he finds the Other's objectivity, which in spite of himself frees his own subjectivity. Masochism therefore is on principle a failure. This should not surprise us if we realize that masochism is a "vice" and that vice is, on principle, the love of failure. But this is not the place to describe the structures peculiar to vice. It is sufficient here to point out that masochism is a perpetual effort to annihilate the subject's subjectivity by causing it to be assimilated by the Other; this effort is accompanied by the exhausting and delicious consciousness of failure so that finally it is the failure itself which the subject ultimately seeks as his principal goaJ.T

II. SECOND ATTITUDE TOWARD OTHERS: INDIFFERENCE, DESIRE, HATE, SADISM

THE failure of the first attitude toward the

Other can be the occasion
for my assuming the second. But of course neither of the two is really first; each of them is a fundamental reaction to being-for-others as an original situation. It can happen therefore that due to the very impossibility of my identifying myself with the Other's consciousness through the intermediacy of my object-ness for him, I am led to tum deliberately ,toward the Other and look at him. In this case to look at the Other's look is to posit oneself in one's own freedom and to attempt on the ground of this freedom to confront the Other's freedom. The meaning of the conflict thus sought would be to bring out into the open the struggle of two freedoms confronted as freedoms. But this intention must be immediately disappointed, for by the sole fact that I assert myself in my freedom confronting the Other, I make the Other a transcendence-transcended-that is, an object. It is the story of that failure which we are about to investigate. We can grasp its general pattern. I direct my look upon the Other who is looking at me. But a look can riot be looked

7 Consistent with this description, there is at least one fonn of exhibitionism which ought to be classed among masochistic attitudes. For example, when Rousseau exhibits to the washerwomen "not the obscene object but the ridiculous object." Ct. Confessiolls, ch. Ill.

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at. As soon as I look in the direction of the look it disappears, and I no longer see anything but eyes. At this instant the Other becomes a being which I possess and which recognizes my freedom. It seems that my goal has been achieved since I possess the being who has the key to my object-state and since I can cause him to make proof of my freedom in a thousand different ways. But in reality the whole structure has collapsed, for the being which remains within my hands is an Other-as-object. As such he has lost the key to my being-as-object, and he possesses a pure and simple image of me which is nothing but one of its objective affects and which no longer touches me. !fhe experiences the effects of my freedom, if I can act upon his being in a thousand different ways and transcend his possibilities with all my possibilities, this is only in so far as he is an object in the world and as such is outside the state of recognizing my freedom. My disappointment is complete since I seel(to appropriate the Other's freedom and perceive suddenly that I can act upon the Other only in so far as this freedom has collapsed beneath my look. This disappointment will be the result of my further attempts to seek again for the Other's freedom across the object which he is for me and to find privileged attitudes or conduct which would appropriate this freedom across a total appropriation of the Other's body. These attempts, as one may suspect, are on principle doomed to failure.

But it can happen also that "to look at the look" is my original reaction to my being-for-others. This means that in my upsurge into the world, I can choose myself as looking at the Other's look and can build my subjectivity upon the collapse of the subjectivity of the Other. It is this attitude which we shall call indifference toward others. Then we are dealing with a kind of blindness with respect to others. But the term "blindness" must not lead us astray. I do not suffer this blindness as a state. I am my own blindness

This is because my funda-
mental project toward the Other-whatever may be the attitude which I
assume-is twofold: first there is the problem of protecting myself
against the danger which is incurred by my being-outside-in-the-Other's-
freedom, and second there is the problem of utilizing the Other in order
finally to totalize the detotalized totality which I am, so as to close the
open circle, and finally to be my own foundation. But on the one hand
the Other's disappearance as look throws me back into my unjustifia-
ble subjectivity and reduces my being to this perpetual pursued-pursuit
toward an inapprehensible In-itself-for-itself. Without the Other I appre-
hend fully and nakedly this terrible necessity of being free which is my
lot; that is, the fact that I can not put the responsibility for making-myself-
be off onto anyone but myself even though I have not chosen to be and

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although I have been born. On the other hand although the blindness
toward the Other doe~ in appearance release me from the fear of being
in danger in the Other's freedom, it includes despite all an implicit
comprehension of this freedom. It therefore places me at the extreme
degree of objectivity at the very moment when I can believe myself to be
an absolute anel unique subjectivity since I am seen without being able
to experience the fact that I am seen and without being able by means of
the same experience to defend myself against my "being-seen." I am
possessed without being able to turn toward the one who possesses me.
In making direct proof of the Other as a look, I defend myself by putting
the Other to the test, and the possibility remains for me to transform
the Other into an object. But if the Other is an object for me while
he is looking at me, then I am in danger without knowing it. Thus my
blindness is anxiety because it is accompanied by the consciousness of a
"wandering and inapprehensible" look, and I am in danger of its alien-
ating me behind my back. This uneasiness can occasion a new attempt to
get possession of the Other's freedom. But this will mean that I am
going to turn back upon the Other-as-object which has been merely
brushing against me and attempt now to utilize him as an instrument in
order to touch his freedom. But precisely because I address myself to
the object "Other" I can not ask him to account for his transcendence,
and since I am myself on the level where I make an object of the Other,
I can not even conceive of what I wish to appropriate. Thus I am in an
irritating and contradictory attitude with respect to this object which I
an considering: not only can I not obtain from him what I wish, but
in addition this quest provokes a disappearance of the practical knowledge
pertaining to what I wish. I engage myself in a desperate pursuit of the
Other's freedom and midway I find myself engaged in a pursuit which
has lost its meaning. All my efforts to bring back 'meaning to the pursuit
result only in making me lose it further and provoking my bewilderment
and my uneasiness-just as when I attempt to recover the memory of'ot
dream and this memory melts between my fingers leaving me with a
vague,and irritating impression of a total knowledge but with no object,
or just as when I attempt to make explicit the content of a false recollec-
tion and the very explanation causes it to melt away in translucency.
My original attempt to get hold o

f the Other's free subjectivity through
his objectivity-for-me is sexual desire. Perhaps it will come as a surprise
to see a phenomenon which is usually classified among "psycho-physiologi-
cal reactions" now mentioned on the level of primary attitudes which
manifest our original mode of realizing Being-for-Others. For the majority
of psychologists indeed, desire, as a fact of consciousness, is in strict corre-
lation with the nature of our sexual organs, and it is only in connection
with an elaborate study of these that sexual desire can be understood.
But since the differentiated structure of the body (mammalian, vivipa-
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rous, etc.) and consequently the particular sexual structure (uterus, Fal- .
lopian tubes~ ovaries, etc.) are in the domain of absolute contingency
and in no way derive from the ontology of "consciousness" or of the
"Dasein," it seems the the same must be true for sexual desire. Just as
the sex organs are a contingent and particular formation of our body, so
the desire which corresponds to them would be a contingent modality of
our psychic life; that is, it would be described only on the level of an
empirical psychology based on biology. This is indicated sufficiently by
the term sex instinct, which is reserved for desire and all the psychic
structures which refer to it. The term "instinct" always in fact qualifies
contingent formations of psychic life which ,have the double character
of being co-extensive with all the duration of this life-or in any case
of not deriving from our "history"-and of nevertheless not being such
that they can not be deduced as belonging to the very essence of the
psychic. This is why existential philosophies have not believed it neces-
sary to concern themselves with sexuality. Heidegger, in particular, does
not make the slightest allusion to it in his existential analytic with the
result that his "Dasein" appears to us as asexual. Of course one may
consider that it is contingent for "human reality" to be specified as
"masculine" or "feminine"; of course one may say that the problem of
sexual differentiation has nothing to do with that of Existence (Existenz)
since man and woman equally exist.
These reasons are not wholly convincing. That sexual differentiation
lies witHin the domain of facticity we accept without reservation. But
does this mean that the For-itself is sexual "accidentally," by the pure
contingency of having this particular body? Can we admit that this tre-
mendous' matter 'of the sexual life comes as a kind of addition to the
human condition? Yet it appears at first glance that desire and its opposite,
sexual repulsion, are fundamental structures of being-for-others. It is
evident that if sexuality derives its origin from sex as a physiological and-
contingent determination of man, it can not be indispensable to the
being of the For-Others. But do we not have the right to ask whether
the problem is not perchance of the same order as that which we en-
countered apropos of sensations and sense organs? Man, it is said, is a
sexual being because he possesses a sex. And if the reverse were true? If
sex were only the instrument and, so to speak, the image of a fundamental
sexuality? If man possessed a sex only because he is originally and funda-
mentally a sexual being as a being who exists in the world in relation
with other men? Infantile sexuality precedes the physio

logical maturation
of the sex organs. Men who have become eunuchs do not thereby cease to feel desire. Nor do many old men. The fact of being able to make use of a sex organ fit to fertilize and to procure enjoyment represents only one phase and one aspect of our sexual life. There is one mode of sexuality "with the possibility of satisfaction," and the developed sex represents

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and makes concrete this possibility. But there are other modes of sexuality of the type which can not get satisfaction, and if we take these modes into account we are fO,rced to recognize that sexuality appears with birth and disappears only with death. Moreover neither the tumescence of the penis nor any other physiological phenomenon can ever explain Or provoke sexual desire-no more than the vaso-eonstriction or the dilation of the pupils (or the simple consciousness of these physiological modifications) will be able to explain or to provoke fear. In one case as in the other although the body plays an important role, we must-in order to understand it-refer to being-in-the-world and to being-for-others. I desire a human being, not an insect or a mollusk, and I desire him (or her) as he is and as I am in situation in the world and as he is an Other for me and as I am an Other for him.

The fundamental problem of sexuality can therefore be formulated thus: is sexuality a contingent accident bound to our physiological nature, or is it a necessary structure of being-for-itsclf-for-others? From the sole fact that the question can be posited in these terms, we see that we must go back to ontology to decide it. Moreover ontology can decide this question only by determining and fixing the meaning of sexual existence for-the-Other. To have sex means-in accordance with the description of the body which we attempted in the preceding chapter-to exist sexually for an Other who exists sexually for me. And it must be well understood that at first this Other is not necessarily for me-nor I for him-a heterosexual existent but only a being who has sex. Considered from the point of view of the For-itself, this apprehension of the Other's sexuality could not be the pure disinterested contemplation of his primary or secondary sexual characteristics. My first apprehension of the Other as having sex docs not come when I conclude from the distribution of his hair, from the coarseness of his hands, the sound of his voice, his strength that he is of the masculine sex. We are dealing there with derived conclusions which refer to an original state. The first apprehension of the Other's sexuality in so far as it is lived and suffered can be only desire; it is by desiring the Other (or by discovering myself as incapable of desiring him) or by apprehending his desire for me that I discover his being-sexed. Desire reveals to me simultaneously my being-sexed and his being sexed, my body as sex and his body. Here therefore in order to decide the nature and ontological position of sex we are referred to the study of desire. What therefore is desire?

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And first, desire of what?

We must abandon straight off the idea that desire is the desire of pleasure or the desire for the cessation of a pain. For we can not see how the subject could get out of this state of immanence so as to "attach" his desire to an object. Every subjectivist and immanentist theory will fail to explain how we d

the standpoint of the body that I appre-
hend the ann as an arm. The body is as much present, as adherent to
the ann which I see as the designs of the rug, which are hidden by the
feet of the table, are present and adherent to those designs which I see.
And my desire is not mistaken; it is addressed not to a sum of physi-
ological elements but to a total form-better yet, to a form in situation.
A particular attitude, as we shall see later, does much to provoke desire.
Now along with the attitude the surroundings are given and finally the
world. But here suddenly we are at the opposite pole from a simple
physiological prtJritus; desire posits the world and desires the body in
terms of the world and the beautiful hand in terms of the body. There
follows exactly the procedure which we described in the preceding chap-
ter, that by which we apprehended the Other's body from the standpoint
of his situation in the world. Moreover there is nothing in this which
should surprise us since desire is nothing but one of the great forms
which can be assumed by the revelation of the Other's body. Yet precisely
for this reas()n we do not desire the body as a purely material object;
a purely material object is not in situation. Thus this organic totality which
is immediately present to desire is desirable only in so far as it reveals
not only life but also an appropriate consciousness. Nevertheless, as we
shall see, the Other's being-in-situation which desire reveals is of an
entirely original type. Furthermore the consciousness here considered
is still only one property of the desired object; that is, it is nothing but
the sense of flow of the objects in the world, precisely in so far as this
flow is cut off, localized, and made a palt of my world. To be sure, one
can desire a woman who is asleep, but one desires her in so far as this
sleep appears on the ground of consciousness. Consciousness therefore
remains always at the horizon of the desired body; it makes the meaning
and the unity of the body. A living body as an organic totality in situation
with consciousness at the horizon: such is the object to which desire
is addressed. What does desire wish from this object? 'Ve can not deter-
mine this until we have answered a preliminary question:. Who is the
one who desires?
The answer is clear. I am the one who desires, and desire is a particular
mode of my subjectivity. Desire is consciousness since it can be only
as a non-positional consciousness of itself. Nevertheless we need not hold
that the desiring consciousness differs from the cognitive consciousness,
for example, only in the nature of its object. For the For-itself, to choose
itself as desire is not to produce a desire while remaining indifferent and
unchanged-as the Stoic cause produces its effect. TIle For-itself puts
itself on a certain plane of existence which is not the same, for example,
as that of a For-itself which chooses itself as a metaphysical being. Every
consciousness, as we have seen, supports a certain relation with its own
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facticity. But this relation can vary from one mode of consciousness to
another. The facticity of a pain-consciousness, for example, is a facticity
discovered in a perpetnal flight. The case is not the same for the facticity
of dcsire. 111e man who desires exists his body in a particular mode and
thereby places himself on a partic

ular level of existence. In fact everyone
will agrce that desire is not only longing, a clear and translucent longing which directs itself through our body toward a certain object. Desire is defined as trouble. The notion of "trouble" can help us better to determine the nature of desire. We contrast troubled water with transparent water, a troubled look with a clear look. Troubled water remains water; it preserves the fluidity and the essential characteristics of water; but its translucency is "troubled" by an inapprehensible presence which makes one with it, which is everywhere and nowhere, and which is given as a dogging of the water by itself. To be sure, we can explain the troubled quality by the presence of fine solid particles suspended in the liquid, but this explanation is that of the scientist. Our original apprehension of the troubled watcr is given us as changed by the presence of an invisible something which is not itself distinguished and which is manifested as a pure factual resistance. If the desiring consciousness is troubled, it is because it is analogous to the troubled water.
To make this analogy precise, we should compare sexual desire with another form of desire-for example, with hunger. Hunger, like sexual dcsire, supposes a certain state of the body, defined here as the impoverishment of the blood, abundant salivary secretion, contractions of the tunica, etc. These various phenomena are described and classified from the point of view of the Other. For the For-itself they are manifested as pure facticity. But this facticity does not compromise the nature of the For-itself" for the For-itself immediately flees it toward its possibles; that is, toward a certain state of satisfied-hunger which, as we have pointed out in Part Two, is the In-itself-for-itself of hunger. Thus hunger is a pure surpassing of corporal facticity; and to the extent that the For-itself becomes conscious of this facticity in a non-thetic form, the For-itself becomes conscious of it as a surpassed facticity. The body here is indeed the past, the passed-beyond. In sexual desire, to be sure, we can find that structure common to all appetites-a state of the body. The Other can note various physiological modifications (the erection of the penis, the turgescence of the nipples of the breasts, changes in the circulatory system, rise in temperature, etc.) The desiring consciousness exists this facticity; it is in terms of this facticity- we could even say through it- that the desired body appears as desirable. Nevertheless if we limited ourselves to this description, sexual desire would appear as a distinct and clear desire, comparable to the desire of eating and drinking. It would be a pure flight from facticity toward other possibles. Now everyone is aware that there is a great abyss between sexual desire and other appetites. We

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all know the famous saying, "Make love to a pretty woman when you want her just as you would drink a glass of cold water when you are thirsty." We know also how unsatisfactory and even shocking this statement is to the mind. This is because when we do desire a woman, we do not keep ourselves wholly outside the desire; the desire compromises me; I am the accomplice of my desire. Or rather the desire has fallen wholly into complicity with the body. Let any man consult his own experience; he knows how consciousness is clogg

ed, so to speak, by sexual desire;
it seems that one is invaded by facticity, that one ceases to flee it and that one slides toward a passive consent to the desire. At other moments it seems that facticity invades consciousness in its very flight and renders consciousness opaque to itself. It is like a yeasty tumescence of fact.
The expressions which we use to designate desire sufficiently show its specificity. We say that it takes hold of you, that it overwhelms you, that it paralyzes you. Can one imagine emfl.loying the same words to designate hunger? Can one think of a hunger which "would overwhelm" one? Strictly speaking, this would be meaningful only when applied to impressions of emptiness. But, on the contrary, even the feeblest desire is already overwhelming. One can not hold it at a distance as one can with hunger and "think of something else" while keeping desire as an undifferentiated tonality of non-thetic consciousness which would be desire and which would serve as a sign of the body-as-ground. But desire is consent to desire. The heavy, fainting consciousness slides toward a languor comparable to sleep. Every one has been able to observe the appearance of desire in another. Suddenly the man who desires becomes a heavy tranquillity which is frightening; his eyes are fixed and appear half-closed, his mOvements are stamped with a heavy and sticky sweetness; many seem to be falling asleep. And when one "struggles against.desire," it is precisely this languor which one resists. If one succeeds in resisting it, the desire before disappearing will become wholly distinct and clear, like hunger. And then there will be "an awakening." One will feel that one is lucid but with heavy head and beating heart. Naturally all these descriptions are inexact; they show rather the way in which we interpret desire. However they indicate the primary fact of desire: in desire consciousness chooses to exist its facticity on another plane. It no longer flees it; it attempts to subordinate itself to its own contingency-as it apprehends another body-i.e., another contingency-as desirable. In this sense desire is not only the revelation of the Other's body but the revelation of my own body. And this, not in so far as this body is an instrument or a point of view, but in so far as it is pure facticity; that is, a simple contingent form of the necessity of my contingency. I feel my skin and my muscles and my breath, and I feel them not in order to transcend them toward something as in emotion or appetite but as a living and inert datum, not simply as the pliable and discrete instrument of my action upon the
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world but as a pas$ion by which I am engaged in the world and in danger in the world. The For-itself is not this contingency; it continues to exist but it experiences the vertigo of its own body. Or, if you prefer, this vertigo is precisely its way of existing its body. The non-thetic consciousness allows itself to go over to the body, wishes to be the body and to be only body. In desire the body instead of being only the contingency which the For-itself flees toward possibles which are peculiar to it, becomes at the same time the most immediate possible of the For-itself. Desire is not only the desire of the Other's body; it is-within the unity of a single act- the non-thetically lived project of being swallowed up

in the body. Thus the final state of sexual desire can be swooning as the final stage of consent to the body. It is in this sense that desire can be called the desire of one body for another body. It is in t:ct an appetite directed toward the Other's body, and it is lived as the vertigo of the For-itself before its own body. The being which desires is consciousness making itself body..

But granted that desire is a consciousness which makes itself body in order to appropriate the Other's body apprehended as an organic totality in situation with consciousness on the horizon-what then is the meaning of desire? That is, why does consciousness make itself body-or vainly attempt to do so-and what does it expect from the object of its desire? The answer is easy if we realize that in desire I make myself flesh in the presence of the Other in order to appropriate the Other's flesh. This means that it is not merely a question of my grasping the Other's shoulders or thighs or of my drawing a body over against me: it is necessary as well for me to apprehend them with this particular instrument which is the body as it produces a clogging of consciousness. In this sense when I grasp these shoulders, it can be said not only that my body is a means for touching the shoulders but that the Other's shoulders are a means for my discovering my body as the fascinating revelation of facticity-that is, as flesh. Thus desire is the desire to appropriate a body as this appropriation reveals to me my body as flesh. But this body which I wish to appropriate, I wish to appropriate as f1.esh: Now at first the Other's body is not flesh for me; it appears as a synthetic fonn in action. As we have seen, we can not perceive the Other's body as pure flesh; that is, in the form of an isolated object maintaining external relations with other thises. The Other's body is originally a body in situation; flesh on the contrary, appears as the pure contingency of presence. Ordinarily it is hidden by cosmetics, clothing, etc.; in particular it is hidden by movements. Nothing is less "in the flesh" than a dancer even though she is nude. Desire is an attempt to strip the body of its movements as of its clothing and to make it exist as pure flesh; it is an attempt to incarnate the Other's body.

It is in this sense that the caress is an appropriation of the Other's

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body. It is evident that if caresses were only a stroking or brushing of the surface, there could be no relation between them and the powerful desire which they claim to fulfill; they would remain on the surface like looks and could not appropriate the Other for me. We know well the deceptiveness of that famous expression, "The contact of two epidermises." The caress does not want simple contact; it seems that man alone can reduce the caress to a contact, and then he loses its unique meaning. This is because the caress is not a simple stroking; it is a shapIng. In caressing the Other I cause her8 flesh to be born beneath my caress, under my fingers. The caress is the ensemble of those rituals which incarnate the Other. But, someone will object, was the Other not already incarnated? To be precise, no. The Other's flesh did not exist explicitly for me since I grasped the Other's body in situation; neither did it exist for her since she transcended it toward her possibilities and toward the object. The ca

ress causes the Other to be born as flesh for me and for
herself. And by flesh we do not mean a part of the body such as the
dermis, the connective tissues or, specifically, epidermis; neither need we
assume that the body will be "at rest" or dozing although often it is
thus that its flesh is best revealed. But the caress reveals the flesh by
stripping the body of its action, by cutting it off from the possibilities
which surround it; the caress is designed to uncover the web of inertia
beneath the action-i.e., the pure "being-there"-which sustains it. For
example, by clasping the Other's hand and caressing it, I discover under-
neath the act of clasping, which this hand is at first, an extension of
flesh and bone which can be grasped; and similarly my look: caresses when
it discovers underneath this leaping which is at first the dancer's legs,
the curved extension of the thighs. Thus the caress is in no way distinct
from the desire: to caress with the eyes and to desire are one and the same.
Desire is expressed by the caress as thought is by language. The caress
reveals the Other's flesh as flesh to myself and to the Other. But it re-
veals this flesh in a very special way. To take hold of the Other reveals
to her her inertia and her passivity as a transcendence-transcended; but
this is not to caress her. In the caress it is not my body as a synthetic
form in action which caresses the Other; it is my body as flesh which
causes the Other's flesh to be born. The caress is designed to cause the
Other's body to be born, through pleasure, for the Other-and for myself
-as a touched passivity in such a way that my body is made flesh in order
to touch the Other's body with its own passivity; that is, by caressing
itself with the Other's body rather than by caressing her. This is why
amorous gestures have a language which could almost be said to be
studied; it is not a question so much of taking hold of a part of the Other's
body as of placing one's own body against the Other's body. Not so much
8 The pronouns in French are masculine because they refer to autrui (the Other)
which may stand for either man or woman but which, grammatically, is masculine. The
feminine sounds more natural in English. Tr.
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to push or to touch in the active sense but to place against. It seems that
I lift my own arm as an inanimate object and that I place it against the
flank of the desired woman, that my fingers which I run over her arm are
inert at the end of my hand. Thus the revelation of the Other's flesh is
made through my Own flesh; in desire and in the caress which expresses de-
sire, I incarnate myself in order to realize the incarnation of the Other. The
caress by realizing the Other's incarnation reveals to me my own incarna-
tion; that is, I make myself flesh in order to impel the Other to realize
for-herself and for me her own flesh, and my caresses cause my flesh to
be born for me in so far as it is for the Other flesh causing her to be born as
flesh. I make her enjoy my flesh through her flesh in order to compel
her to feel herself flesh. And so possession truly appears as a double recip-
rocal incarnation. Thus in desire there is an attempt at the incarnation of
consciousness (this is what we called earlier the clogging of consciousness,
a troubled consciousness, etc.) in order to realize the incarnation of the
Other.
I~remains to deteiminewhat i

s the motive of desire-or if you prefer,
its meaning. For anyone who has so far followed the descriptions which we have here attempted will have understood long before this that for the For-itself, to be is to choose its way of being on the ground of the absolute contingency of its being-there. Desire therefore does· not come to consciousness as heat comes to the piece of iron which I hold near the flame. Consciousness chooses itself as desire. For this, of course, there must be a motive; I do not desire just anything at any time. But as we showed in Part One of this book, the motive is raised in terms of the past, and consciousness by turning back upon it, confers on the motive its weight and its value. There is therefore no difference between the choice of the. motive of the desire and the meaning of the upsurge-in the three ekstatic dimensions of duration-of a consciousness which makes itself desiring. This desire-like emotions or the imagining attitude or in general all the attitudes of the For-itself-has a meaning which constitutes it and surpasses it. The description which we have just attempted would hold no interest if it did not lead us to pose a further question: why does consciousness nihilate itself in the form of desire? One or two preliminary observations will help us in replying to this question. In the first place we must note that the desiring consciousness does not desire its object on the ground of a world which is unchanged. In other words, it is not a question of causing the desirable to appear as a certain "this" on the ground of a world which would preserve its instrumental relations with us and its organization in complexes of instrumentality. The same is true of desire as of emotion. We have pointed out elsewhere that emotion is not the apprehension of an exciting object in an unchanged world; rather since itcorresponds to a global modification of consciousness and of its relations to the world, emotion ex-

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presses itself by means of a radical alteration of the world.9 Similarly sexual desire is a radical modification of the For-itself; since the For-itself makes itself be on IInother plane of being, it determines itself to exist its body differently, to make itself be clogged by its facticity. Correlatively the world must come into being for the For-itself in a new way. There is a world of desire. If my body is no longer felt as the instrument which can not be utilized by any instrument-i.e., as the synthetic organization of my acts in the world-if it is lived as flesh, then it is as a reference to my flesh that I apprehend the objects in the world. This means that I make myself passive in relation to them and that they are revealed to me from the point of view of this passivity, in it and through it (for passivity is the body, and the body does not cease to be a point of view J. Objects then become the transcendent ensemble which reveals my incarnation to me. A contact with them is a caress; that is, my perception is not the utilization of the object and the surpassing of the present in view of an end, but to perceive an object when I am in the desiring attitude is to caress myself with it. Thus I am sensitive not so much' to the fonn of the object and to its instrumentality, as to its matter (gritty, smooth, tepid, greasy, rough, etc.). In my desiring perception I discover something like a flesh o

f objects. My shirt rubs against my skin, and I feel it. What is ordinarily for me an object most remote becomes the immediately sensible; the warmth of air, the breath of the wind, the rays of sunshine, etc.; all are present to me in a certain way, as posited upon me without distance and revealing my flesh by means of their flesh. From this point of view desire is not only the clogging of a consciousness by its facticity; it is correlatively the ensnarement of a body by the world. The world is made ensnaring; consciousness is engulfed in a body which is engulfed in the world.10 Thus the ideal which is proposed here is being-in-the-midst-of-the-world; the For-itself attempts to realize a being-in-the-midst-of-the-world as the ultimate project of its being-in-the-world; that is why sensual pleasure is so often linked with death-which is also a metamorphosis or "being-in-the-midst-of-the-world." There is, for example, the theme of "pseudo-death" so abundantly treated in all literatures.

But desire is not first nor primarily a relation to the world. The world here appears only as the ground for explicit relations with the Other. Usually it is on the occasion of the Other's presence that the world is revealed as the world of desire. Accessorily it can be revealed as such on the occasion of the absence of a particular Other or even on occasion

9 Cf. The Emotions.

10 Naturally it is necessary to take into account here as everywhere the coefficient of adversity in things. These objects are not only "caressing." But within the general perspective of the caress; they can appear also as "anti-caresses"; that is, with a rudeness, : cacophony, a harshness which-precisely because we are in the state of desire--offen. us in a way that is unbearable.

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of the absence of all Others. But we have already observed that absence is a concrete existential relation between the Other and me, which appears on the original ground of Being-for-others~ I can, of course, by discovering my body in solitude, abruptly realize myself as flesh, "suffocate" with desire, and experience the world as "suffocating." But this solitary desire is an appeal to either a particular Other or the presence of the undifferentiated Other. I desire to be revealed as flesh by means of and for another flesh. I try to cast a spell over the Other and make him appear; and the world of desire indicates by a sort of prepared space the Other whom I am calling. Thus desire is by no means a physiological accident, an itching of our flesh which may fortuitously direct us on the Other's flesh. Quite the contrary, in order for my flesh to exist and for the Other's flesh to exist, consciousness must necessarily be preliminarily shaped in the mould of desire. This desire is a primitive mode of our relations with the Other which constitutes the Other as desirable flesh on the ground of a world of desire.

We are now in a position to make explicit the profound meaning of desire. In the primordial reaction to the Other's look I constitute myself as a look. But if I look at his look in order to defend myself against the Other's freedom and to transcend it as freedom, then both the freedom and the look of the Other collapse. I see eyes; I see a being-in-the-midst-of-the-world. Henceforth the Other escapes me. I should like to act upon his freedom,. to appropriate it, or at least, to make

the Other's
freedom recognize my freedom. But this freedom is death; it is no longer absolutely in the world in which I encounter the Other-as-object, for his characteristic is to be transcendent to the world. To be sure, I can grasp the Other, grab hold of him, knock him down. I can, providing I have the power, -compel him to perform this or that act, to say certain words. But everything happens as if I wished to get hold of a man who runs away and leaves only his coat in my hands. It is the coat, it is the outer shell which I possess. I shall never get hold of more than a body, a psychic object in the midst of the world. And although all the acts of this body can be interpreted in terms of freedom, I have completely lost the key to this interpretation; I can act only upon a facticity. If I have preserved my awareness of a transcendent freedom in the Other, this awareness provokes me to no purpose by indicating a reality which is on principle beyond my reach and by revealing to me every instant the fact that I am missing it, that everything which I do is done "blindly" and takes on a meaning elsewhere in a sphere of existence from which I am on principle excluded. I can make the Other beg for mercy or ask my pardon, but I shall always be ignorant of what this submission means for and in the Other's freedom.
Moreover at the same time my awareness is altered; I lose the exact comprehension of being-looked-at, which is, as we know, the only way

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in which I can make proof of the Other's freedom. Thus I am engaged in an enterprise the meaning of which I have forgotten. I am dismayed confronting this Other as I see him and touch him but am at a loss as to what to do with him. It is exactly as if I had preserved the vague memory of a certain Beyond which is beyond what I see and what I touch, a Beyond concerning which I know that this is precisely what I want to appropriate. It is now that I make myself desire. Desire is an attitude aiming at enchantment. Since I can grasp the Other only in his objective facticity, the problem is to ensnare his freedom within this facticity.
It is necessary that he be "caught" in it as the cream is caught up by a person skimming milk. So the Other's For-itself must come to play on the surface of his body, and be extended all through his body; and by touching this body I should finally touch the Other's free subjectivity.
This is the true meaning of the word possession. It is certain that I want to possess the Ot1ler's body, but I want to possess it in so far as it is itself a "possessed"; that is, in so far as the Other's consciousness is identified with his body. Such is the impossible ideal of desire: to possess the Other's transcendence as pure transcendence and at the same time as body, to reduce the Other to his simple facticity because he is then in .the midst of my world but to bring it about that this facticity is a perpetual appresentation of his nihilating transcendence.
But in truth the Other's facticity (his pure being-there) can not be given to my intuition without a profound modification of my own unique being. In so far as I surpass my personal facticity toward my own possibilities, so far as I exist my facticity in an impulse of flight, I surpass as well not only the Other's facticity but also the pure existence of tIlings. In my very upsurge I cause them to emerge in instrume

ntal existence;
their pure and simple being is hidden by the complexity of indicative references which constitute their manageability and their instrumentality.
To pick up a fountain pen is already to surpass my being-there toward the possibility of writing, but it is also to surpass the pen as a simple existent toward its potentiality and once again to surpass this potentiality toward certain future existents which are the "words-about-to-be-formed" and finally the "book-about-to-be-written." l1lis is why the being of existents is ordinarily veiled by their function. The same is true for the being of the Other. If the Other appears to me as a servant, as an employee, as a civil servant, or simply as the passerby whom I must avoid or as this voice which is speaking in the next room and which I try to understand (or on the other hand, which I want to forget because it "keeps me from sleeping"), it is not only the Other's extramundane transcendence which escapes me but also his "being-there" as a pure contingent existence in the midst of the world. This is because it is exactly in so far as I treat him as a servant, or as an·office clerk, that I surpass his potentialities (transcendence-transcended, dead-possibilities) by the very project by

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which I surpass and nihilate my own facticity. If I want to return to his simple presence and taste it as presence, it is necessary for me to reduce myself to my own presence. Every surpassing of my being-there is in fact a surpassing of the Other's being-there. And if the world is around me as the situation which I surpass toward myself, then I apprehend the Other in terms of his situation; that is, already as a center of reference.
Of course .the desired Other must also be apprehended in situation: I desire a woman in tIle world, standing near a table, lying naked on a bed, or seated at my side. But if the desire flows back from the situation upon the being who is in situation, it is in order to dissolve the situation and to corrode the Other's relations in the world. The movement of desire which goes from the surrounding "environment" to the desired person is an isolating movement which destroys the environment and cuts off the person in question in order to effect the emergence of his pure facticity. But this is pOSSible only if each object which refers me to the person is ifixed in its pure contingency at the same time that it indicates him to)me; consequently this return movement to the Other's being is a movement of return to ffiyself as pure being-there. I destroy my possibilities in order to destroy those of the world and to constitute the world as a "world of desire"; that is, as a destructured world which has lost its meaning, a world in which things jut out like fragments of pure matter, like brute qualities" Since the For-itself is a choice, this is possible only if I project myself toward a new possibility: that of being "absorbed by my body as ink is by a blotter," that of b~ing reduced to my pure being-there. This project, inasmuch as it is not simply conceived and thematically posited but rather lived-that is, inasmuch as its realization is not distinct from its conception-is "disturbance" or "trouble." Indeed we must not understand the preceding descriptions as meaning that I . deliberately put myself in a state of disturbance with the purpose of rediscovering the Othe

r's pure "being-there." Desire is a lived project
which does not suppose any preliminary deliberation but which includes
within itself its meaning and its interpretation. As soon as I throw myself
toward the Other's facticity, as soon as I wish ttl push aside his acts and
his functions so as to touch him in his flesh, I incarnate myself, for I
can neither wish nor even conceive of the incarnation of the Other except
in and by means of my own incarnation. Even the empty outline of a
desire (as when one absentmindedly "undresses a woman with one's
look") is an empty outline of troubled disturbance, for I desire only with
my trouble, and I disrobe the Other only by disrobing myself; I fore-
shadow and outline the Other's flesh only by outlining my own flesh.
But my incarnation is not only the preliminary condition of the appear-
ance of the Other as flesh to my eyes. My goal is to cause him to be in-
carnated as flesh in his own eyes. It is necessary that I drag him onto the
level of pure facticity; he must be reduced for himself to being only flesh.
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Thus Jshall be reassured as to the permanent possibilities of a transcend-
ence which can at any instant transcend me on all sides. This transcend-
ence will be no more than this; it will remain inclosed within the limits
of an object; in addition and because of this very fact, I shall be able to
touch it, feel it, possess it. Thus the other meaning of my incarnation-
that is, of my troubled disturbance-is that it is a magical language. I
make myself flesh so as to fascinate the Other by my nakedness and to
provoke in her the desire for my flesh-exactly because this desire will
be nothing else in the Other but an incarnation similar to mine. Thus
desire is an invitation to desire. It is my flesh alone which knows how to
find the road to the Other's flesh, and I lay my flesh next to her flesh so
as to awaken her to the meaning of flesh. In the caress when I slowly
lay my inert hand against the Other's flank, I am making that flank
feel my flesh, and this can be achieved only if it renders itself inert. The
shiver of pleasure which it feels is precisely the awakening of its conscious-
ness as flesh. If I extend my hand, remove it, or clasp it, then it becomes
again body in action; but by the same stroke I make my hand disappear
as flesh; To let it run indifferently over the length of her body, to reduce
my hand to a soft brushing almost stripped of meaning, to a pure exist-
ence, to a pure matter, slightly silky, slightly satiny, slightly rough-this
is to gi"e up for oneself being the one WllO establishes references and
unfolds distances; it is to be made pure mucous membranc. At this mo-
ment the communion of desire is realized; each consciousness by incarnat-
ing itself has realized the incarnation of the other; each one's disturbance
has caused disturbance to be born in the Other and is thereby so much
enriched. By each caress I experience my own flesh and the Other's flesh
through my flesh, and I am conscious that this flesh which I feel and
appropriate through my flesh is flesh-realized-by-the~Othcr. It is' not by
chance that desire while aiming at the body as a whole attains it especially
through masses of flesh which are very little differentiated, grossly nerve-
less, hardly capable of spontaneous movement, through breasts, buttocks,
thighs, stomach: these form a sort of image of pure facticity. T

his is why
also the true caress is the contact of two bodies in their mostly fleshy parts, the contact of stomachs and breasts; the caressing hand is too delicate, too much like a perfected instrument. But the full pressing together of the flesh of two people against one another is the true goal of desire. Nevertheless desire is itself doomed to failure. As we have seen, coitus, which ordinarily terminates desire, is not its essential goal. To be sure, several elements of our sexual structure are the necessary expression of the nature of desire, in particular the erection of the penis and the clitoris. This is nothing else in fact but the affirmation of the flesh by the flesh. Therefore it is absolutely necessary that it should not be accomplished voluntarily; that is, that we can not use it as an instrument but that we are dealing with a biological and autonomous phenomenon whose autono-
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mous and involuntary expression accompanies and signifies the submerging of consciousness in the body. It must be clearly understood that no fine, prehensile organ provided with striated muscles can be a sex organ, a sex. If sex were to appear as an organ, it could be only one manifestation of the vegetative life. But contingency reappears if we consider that there are sexes and particular sexes. Consider especially the penetration of the female by the male. This does, to be sure, conform to that radical incarnation which desire wishes to be. (We may in fact observe the organic passivity of sex in coitus. It is the whole body whir:h advances and withdraws, which carries sex forward or withdraws it. Hands help to introduce the penis; the penis itself appears as an instrument which one manages, which one makes penetrate, which one withdraws, which One utilizes. And similarly the opening and the lubrication of the vagina can not be obtained voluntarily.) Yet coitus remains a perfectly contingent modality of our sexual life. It is as much a pure contingency as sexual pleasure proper. In truth the ensnarement of consciousness in the body normally has its own peculiar result-that is, a sort of particular ecstasy in which consciousness is no more than consciousness (of) the body and consequently a reflective consciousness ot corporeality. Pleasure in fact-like too keen a pain-motivates the appearance of reflective consciousness which is "attention to pleasure."
But pleasure is the death and the failure of desire. It is the death of desire because it is not only its fulfillment but its limit and its end. This, moreover, is only an organic contingency: it happens that the incarnation is manifested by erection and that the erection ceases with ejaculation. But iIi addition pleasure closes the sluice to desire because it motivates the appearance of a reflective consciousness ot pleasure, whose object becomes a reflective enjoyment; that is, it is attention to the incarnation of the For-itself which is reflected-on and by the same token it is forgetful of the Other's incarnation. Here we are no longer within the province of contingency. Of course it remains contingent that the passage to the fascinated reflection· should be effected on the occasion of that particular mode of incarnation which is pleasure (although there are numerous cases of passage to the reflective without the intervention of pleasure), but there is a permanent danger for desire in

so far as it is an attempt at
incarnation. This is because consciousness by incarnating itself loses sight of the Other's incarnation, and its own incarnation absorbs it to the point of becoming the ultimate goal. In this case the pleasure of caressing is transformed into the pleasure of being caressed; what the For-itself demands is to feel within it its own body expanding to the point of nausea. Immediately there is a rupture of contact and desire misses its goal. It happens very often that this failure of desire motivates a passage to masochism; that is, consciousness apprehending itself in its facticity demands to be apprehended and transcended as body-for-the-Other by
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means of the Other's consciousness. In this case the Other-as-object collapses, the Other-as-look appears, and my consciousness is a consciousness swooning in its flesh beneath the Other's look.
Yet conversely desire stands at the origin of its own failure"inasmuch as it is a desire of taking and of appropriating. It is not enough merely that troubled disturbance should effect the Other's incarnation; desire is the desire to appropriate this incarnated consciousness. Therefore desire is naturally continued not by caresses but by acts of taking and of penetration. The caress has for its goal only to impregnate the Other's body with consciousness and freedom. Now it is necessary to take this saturated body, to seize it, to enter into it. But by the very fact that I now attempt to seize the Other's body, to pull it toward me, to grab hold of it, to bite it, my own body ceases to be flesh and becomes again the synthetic instrument which 1 am. And by the same token the Other ceases to be an incarnation; she becomes once more an instrument in the midst of the world which I apprehend in terms of its situation. Her consciousness, which played on the surface of her flesh and which I tried to taste with my flesh ,11 disappears under my sight; she remains no more than an object with object-images inside her. At the same time my disturbance disappears. This does not mean that I cease to desire but that desire has lost its matter; it has become abstract; it is a desire to handle and to take. I insist on taking the Other's body but my very insistence makes my incarnation disappear. At present I surpass my body anew toward my own possibilities (here the possibility of taking), and similarly the Other's body which is surpassed toward its potentialities falls from the level of flesh to the level of pure object. This situation brings about the rupture of that reciprocity of incarnation which was precisely the unique goal of desire. The Other may remain troubled; she may remain flesh for herself, and I can understand it. But it is a flesh which I no longer apprehend through my flesh, a flesh which is no longer anything but the property of an Other-as-object and not the incarnation of an Other-as-consciousness. Thus I am body (a synthetic totality in situation) confronting a flesh. I find myself in almost the same situation as that from which I tried to escape by means of desire; that is, I want the Other to count as a transcendence by my attempt to utilize her as an object, and precisely because she is all object she escapes me with all her transcendence. Once again I have even lost the precise comprehension of what I seek and yet I am engaged in the search. I take and

discover myself in the process
of taking, but what I take in my hands is something else than what I
wanted to take. I feel this and I suffer from it but without being capable
of saying what I wanted to take; for along with my troubled disturbance
the very comprehension of my desire escapes me. I am like a sleepwalker
11 Dona Prouheze (Soulier de Satin, 11 6 journee): "n ne connaitra pas Ie gaM que
rai." (He will not know the taste which I have.)

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who wakens to find himself in the process of gripping the edge of the bed
while he cannot re~all the nightmare which provoked his gesture. It is
this situation which is at the origin of sadism.
Sadism is passion, barrenness, and tenacity. It is tenacity because it
is the state of a For-itself which apprehends itself as engaged without
understanding in what it is engaged and which persists in its engagement
without having a clear consciousness of the goal which it has set for itself
or a precise recol1ection of the value which it has attached to this engage-
ment. It is barrenness because it appears when desire is emptied of its
trouble. The sadist has reapprehended his body as a synthetic totality and
center of action; he has resumed the perpetual flight from his own fac-
ticity. He experiences himself in the face of the Other as pure transcend-
ence. He has a horror of troubled disturbance tor himself and considers
it ,a humiliating state; it is possible also that he simply can r.ot realize
it in himself. To the extent that he coldly persists, that he is at once a
tenacity and a barrenness the sadist is impassioned. His goal, like that of
desire, is to seize and to make use of the Other not only as the Other-as-
object but as a pure incarnated transcendence. But in sadism the emphasis
is put on the instrumental appropriation of the incarnated-Other. The
"moment" of sadism in sexuality is the one in which the incarnated For-
itself surpasses its own incarnation in order to appropriate the incarnation
of the Other. Thus sadism is a refusal to be incarnated and a flight
from all facticity and at the same time an effort to get hold of the Other's
facticity. But as the sadist neither can nor wiI1 realize the Other's incarna-
tion by means of his own incarnation, as due to this very fact he has no
resource except to treat the Other as an instrumental-object, he seeks
to utilize the Other's body as a tool to make the Other realize an
incarnated existence. Sadism is an effort to incarnate the Other through
violence, and this incarnation "by force" must be already the appropriation
and utilization of the Other. Sadism like desire seeks to strip the Other
of the acts which hide him. It seeks to reveal the flesh beneath the
action. But whereas the For-itself in desire loses itself in its own flesh in
order to reveal to the Other that he too is flesh, the sadist refuses his own
flesh at the same time that he uses instruments to reveal by force the
Other's flesh to him. The object of sadism is immediate appropriation.
But sadism is a blind aIley, for it not only enjoys the possession of the
Other's flesh but at the same time in direct connection with this flesh, it
enjoys its own non-incarnation. It wants the non-reciprocity of sexual
relations, it enjoys being a free appropriating power confronting a free-
dom captured by flesh. That is why the sadist wants to make the flesh pres-
ent to the Other's consc

visible gannent while entirely disrobing its flesh, while the flesh is totally present to the eyes of the spectators.

The ungraceful, on -the contrary, appears when one of the elements of grace is thwarted in its realization. A movement may become mechanical. In this case the body always fomlS part of an ensemble which justifies it but in the capacity of a pure instrument; its transcendence-transcended disappears, and along with it the situation disappears as the lateral over· determination of the instrumental-objects of my universe. It can happen also that the actions are abrupt and violent; in this case it is the adaptation of the situation which collapses; the situation remains but an hiatus slips in like an emptiness between it and the Other in situation. In this case the Other remains free, but this freedom is apprehended only as pure unpredictability; it resembles the c1inamen of Epicurean atoms, in short an indeterminism. At the same time the end remains posited, and it is always in terms of the future that we perceive the Other's gesture. But the fall from adaptation involves this consequence, that the perceptive interpretation by means of the future is always too broad or too narrow; it is an approximate interpretation. Consequently the justification of the gesture and the being of the Other is imperfectly realized. In the final analysis the awkward is unjustifiable; all its facticity, which was engaged in the situation, is absorbed by it, flows back upon it. The awkward one frees his facticity inopportunely and suddenly places it beneath our sight; hence where we expected to seize a key to the situation, spontaneously emanating from the very situation, we suddenly encounter the unjusifiable contingency of an unadapted presence; we are put face to face with the existence of an existent.

Nevertheless if the body is wholly within the act, the facticity is not yet flesh. The obscene appears when the body adopts postures which entirely strip it of its acts and which reveal the inertia of its flesh. The sight of a naked body from behind is not obscene. But certain involuntary waddlings of the rump are obscene. This is because then it is only the legs which are acting for the walker, and the rump is like an isolated cushion which is carried by the legs and the balancing of which is a pure obedience to the laws of weight. It can not be justified by the situation; on the contrary, it is entirely destructive of any situation since it has the passivity of a thing and since it is made to rest like a thing upon the legs. Suddenly it is revealed as an unjustifiable facticity; it is de trop like every contingent. It is isolated in the body for which the present meaning is walking; it is naked even if material covers it, for it no longer shares in the transcendence-transcended of the body in action. Its movement of balancing instead of being interpreted in terms of what is to come is interpreted and known as a physical fact in terms of the past. These remarks naturally can apply to cases in which it is the whole body which is made flesh, either by some sort of ~iness in its movements, which

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can not be interpreted by the situation, or by a defonnity in its structure (for example the proliferation of the fat cells) which exhibits a super-abundant facticity in relation to the effective presence

which the
situation demands. This revealed flesh is specifically obscene when it is revealed to someone who is not in a state of desire and without exciting his desire. A particular lack of adaptation which destroys the situation at the very moment when I apprehend it and which releases to me the inert expanding of flesh as an abrupt appearance beneath the thin clothing of the movements which cover it (when; I am not in a state of desire for this flesh): this is what I shall call the obscene.
Now we can see the meaning of the sadist's demand: grace reveals freedom as a property of the Other-as-object and refers obscurely-just as do the contradictions in the sensible world in the case of Platonic recollection-to a transcendent Beyond of which we preserve only a confused memory and which we can reach only by a radical modification of our being; that is, by resolutely assuming our being-for-others. Grace both unveils and veils the Other's flesh, or if you prefer, it unveils the flesh in.order immediately to veil it; in grace flesh is the inaccessible Other.
The sadist aims at destroying grace in order actually to constitute another synthesis of the Othcr. He wants to make the Other's flesh appear;
and in its very appearance the flesh will destroy grace, and facticity will reabsorb the Other's freedom-as-object. This reabsorption is not annihilation; for the sadist it is the Other-as-free who is manifested as flesh. The identity of the Other-as-object is not destroyed through these avatars, but the relations between flesh and freedom are reversed. In grace freedom contained and veiled facticity; in the new synthesis to be effected it is facticity which contains and hides freedom. The sadist aims therefore at making the flesh appear abruptly and by compulsion; that is, by the aid not of his own flesh but of his body as instrument: He aims at making the Other assume attitudes and positions such that his body appears under the aspect of the obscene; thus the sadist himself remains on the level of instrumental appropriation since he causes flesh to be born by exerting force upon the Other, and the Other becomes an instrument in his hands. The sadist handles the Other's body, leans on the Other's shoulders so as to bend him toward the earth and to make his haunches stick up, etc. On the other hand, the goal of this instrumental utilization is immanent in the very utilization; the sadist treats the Other as an instrument in order to make the Otller's flesh appear. The sadist is the being who apprehends the Other as the instrument whose functiun is his own incarnation. The ideal of the sadist will therefore be to achieve the moment when the Other will be already flesh without ceasing to be an instrument, flesh to cause the birth of flesh, the moment at which the thighs, for example, already offer themselves in an obscene expanding passivity, and yet are instruments which are managed, which are pushed aside, which are bent
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so as to make the buttocks stick out in order in turn to incarnate them. But let us not be deceived here. What the sadist thus so tenaciously seeks, what he wants to knead with his hands and bend under his wrists is the Other's freedom. The freedom is there in that flesh; it is freedom which is this flesh since there is a facticity of the Other. It is therefore this freedom which the sadist tries to

appropriate.
Thus the sadist's effort is to ensnare the Other in his flesh by means of violence and pain, by appropriating the Other's body in such a way that he treats it as flesh so as to cause flesh to be born. But this appropriation surpasses the body which it appropriates, for its purpose is to possess the body only in so far as the Other's freedom has been ensnared within it. This is why the sadist will want manifest proofs of this enslavement of the Other's freedom through the flesh. He will aim at making the Other ask for pardon, he will use torture and threats to force the Other to humiliate himself, to deny what he holds most dear. It is often said that this is done through the will to dominate or thirst for power. But this explanation is either vague or absurd. It is the will to dominate which should be explained first. This can not be prior to sadism as its foundation, for in the same way and on the same plane as sadism, it is born from anxiety in the face of the Other. In fact, if the sadist is pleased upon obtaining a denial by means of torture, this is for a reason analogous to that which allows us to interpret the meaning of Love. We have seen in fact that Love does not demand the abolition of the Other's freedom but rather his enslavement as freedom; that is, freedom's self-enslavement. Similarly the sadist does not seek to suppress the freedom of the one whom he tortures but to force this freedom freely to identify itself with the tortured flesh. This is why the moment of pleasure for the torturer is that in which the victim betrays or humiliates himself.
In fact no' matter what pressure is exerted on the victim, the abjuration remains free; it is a spontaneous production, a response to a situation; it manifests human-reality. No matter what resistance the victim has offered, no matter how long he has waited before begging for mercy, he would have been able despite all to wait ten minutes, one minute, one second longer. He has determined the moment at which the pain became unbearable. The proof of this is the fact that he will later live out his abjuration in remorse and shame. Thus he is entirely responsible for it. On the other hand the sadist for his part considers himself entirely the cause of it. If the victim resists and refuses to beg for mercy, the game is only that much more pleasing. One more turn of the screw, one extra twist and the resistence will finally give in. The sadist posits himself as "having all the time in the world." He is calm, he does not hurry. He uses his instruments like a technician; he tries them one after another as the locksmith tries various keys in a keyhole. He enjoys this ambiguous and contradictory situation. On the one hand indeed he is the one who pa-
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tiently at the heart of universal determinism employs means in view of an end which will be automatically attained-just as the lock will automatically open when the locksmith finds the "right" key; on the other hand, this determined end can be realized only with the Other's free and complete cooperation. Therefore until the the last the end remains both predictable and unpredictable. For the sadist the object realized is ambiguous, contradictory, without equilibrium since it is both the strict consequence of a technical utilization of determinism and the manifestation of an unconditioned freedom. The spectacle which is off

ered to the
sadist is that of a freedom which struggles against the expanding of the flesh and which finally freely chooses to be submerged in the flesh. At the moment of the abjuration the result sought is attained: the body is wholly flesh, panting and obscene; it holds the position which the torturers have given to it, not that which it would have assumed by itself; the cords which bind it hold it as an inert thing, and thereby it has ceased to be the object which moves spontaneously. In the abjuration a freedom chooses to be wholly identified with this body; this distorted and heaving body is the very image of a broken and enslaved freedom.
These few remarks do not aim at exhausting the problem of sadism. We wanted only to show that it is as a seed in desire itself, as the failure of desire; in fact as soon as I seek to take the Other's body, which through my incarnation I have induced to incarnate itself, I break the reciprocity of incarnation, I surpass my body toward its own possibilities, and I orient myself in the direction of sadism. Thus sadism and masochism are the two reefs on which desire may founder-whether I surpass my troubled disturbance toward an appropriation of the Other's flesh or, intoxicated with my own trouble, pay atteption only to my flesh and ask nothing of the Other except that he shot1d be the look which aids me in realizing my flesh. It is because of this inconstancy on the part of desire and its perpetual oscillation between these two perils that "normal" sexuality is commonly designated as "sadistic-masochistic."
Nevertheless sadism too-like blind indifference and like desire-bears within itself the cause of its own failure In the first place there is a profound incompatibility between the apprehension of the body as flesh and its instrumental utilization. If I make an instrument out of flesh, it refers me to other instruments and to potentialities, in short to a future; it is partially justified in its being-there by the situation which I create around myself, just as the presence of nails and of a picture to be nailed on the wall justifies the existence of the hammer. Suddenly the body's character as flesh-that is, its unutilizable facticity-gives way to that of an instrumental-thing. The complex "flesh-as-instrument" which the sadist has attempted to create disintegrates. This profound disintegration can ~e hidden so long as the flesh is the instrument to reveal flesh, for in thiS way I constitute an instrument with an immanent end. But when the

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incarnation is achieved, when I have indeed before me a panting body, then I no longer know how to utilize this flesh. No goal can be assigned to it, precisely because I have effected the appearance of its absolute contingency. It is there, and it is there for nothing. As snch I can not get hold of it as flesh; I can not integrate it in a complex system of instrumentality without its materiality as flesh, its "fleshliness" immediately escaping me. I can only remain disconcerted before it in a state of contemplative astonishment or else incarnate myself in tum and allow myself again to be troubled,'so as to place myself once more at least on the level where flesh is revealed to flesh in its entire "fleshliness." Thus sadism at the very moment when its goal is going to be attained gives way to desire. Sadism is the failure of desire, and desire is t

he failure of
sadism. One can get out of the circle only by means of satiation and so-called "physical possession." In this a new synthesis of sadism and of desire is given. The tumescence of sex manifests incarnation, the fact of "entering into" or of being "penekated" symbolically realizes the sadistic and masochistiC attempt to appropriate. But if pleasure enables us to get out of the circle, this is because it kills both the desire and the sadistic passion without satisfying them.

At the same time and on a totally different level sadism harbors a new motive for failure. What the sadist seeks to appropriate is in actuality the transcendent freedom of the victim. But this freedom remains on principle out of reach. And the more the sadist persists in treating the other as an instrument, the more this freedom escapes him. He can act upon the freedom only by making it an objective property of the Other-as-object; that is, on freedom in the midst of the world with its dead-possibilities. But since the sadist's goal is to recover his being-for-others, he ,misses it on principle, for the only Other with whom he has to do is the Other in the world who has only "images in his head" of the sadist assaulting him.

The sadist discovers his error when his victim looks at him; that is, when the sadist experiences the absolute alienation of his being in the Other's freedom; he realizes then not only that he has not recovered his being-outside but also that the activity by which he seeks to recover it is itself transcended and fixed in "sadism" as an 11abitus and a property with its cortege of dead-possibilities and that this transformation takes place through and for the Other whom he wishes to enslave. He discovers then that he can not act on the Other's freedom even by forcing the Other to humiliate himself and to beg for mercy, for it is precisely in and through the Other's absolute freedom that there exists a world in which there are sadism and instruments of torture and a hundred pretexts for being humiliated and for forswearing oneself. Nobody has better portrayed the power of the victim's look at his torturers than Faulkner has done in the final pages of Light in August. The "good citizens" have just hunted

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down the Negro, Christmas, and have castrated him. Christmas is at the point of death:

"But the man on the floor had not moved. He just lay there, with his eyes open and empty of everything save consciousness, and with something, a shadow, about his mouth. For a long moment he looked up at them with peaceful and unfathomable and unbearable eyes. Then his face, body, all, seemed to collapse, to fall in upon itself and from out th<t slashed garments about his hips and loins the pent black blood seemed to rush like a released breath. It seemed to rush out of his pale body like the rush of sparks from a rising rocket; upon that black blast the man seemed to rise soaring into their memories forever and ever. They are not to lose it, in whatever peaceful valleys, beside whatever placid and reassuring streams of old age, in the mirroring face of whatever children they wiII contemplate old disasters and newer hopes. It will be there, musing, quiet, steadfast, not fading and not particularly threatful, but of itself alon~ serene, of itself alone triumphant. Again from the town, deadened a little by the walls, the scream of the siren mounte

d toward its unbelievable
crescendo~ passing ol;lt of the realm of hearing."12
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Thus this explosion of the Other's look in the world of the sadist causes the meaning and goal of sadism to collapse. The sadist discovers that it was that freedom which he wished to enslave, and at the same time he realizes the futility of his efforts. Here once more we are referred from the being-in-the-act-of-looking to the being-looked-at; we have not got out of the circle.

We have not thought by these few remarks to exhaust the problem of sex, stil1less that of possible attitudes toward the Other. We have wished simply to show that the sexual attitude is a primary behavior towards the Other. It goes without saying that this behavior necessarily includes· within it the original contingency of being-for-others and that of our own facticity. But we can not admit that this behavior is subject from the start to a physiological and empirical constitution. As soon as "there is" the body and as soon as "there is" an Otller, we react by desirc, by Love, and by the derived attitudes which we have mentioned. Our physiological structure only causes the symbolic expression, on the level of absolute contingency, of the fact that we are the permanent possibility of assuming one or the other of these attitudes. Thus we shall be able to say that the For-itself is sexual in its very upsurge in the face of the Other and that through it sexuality comes into the world.

Obviously we do not claim that all attitudes toward the Other arc

12 The italics are Sartre's. I have quoted directly from Faulkner rather than translating back into English from the French translation which Sartre used. Tr. William Faulkner, Light in August. New York: Modem Library. p. 407.

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reducible to those sexual attitudes which we have just described. If we have dealt with them at considerable length, it is for two reasons: first because they are fundamental, and second because all of men's complex patterns of conduct toward one another are only enrichments of these two original attitudes (and of a third-hate-which we are going to describe next). Of course examples of concrete conduct (collaboration, conflict, rivalry, emulation, engagement, obedience, etc.) 18 are infinitely more delicate to describe, for they depend on the historic situation and the concrete particularities of each relation of the For-itself with the Other; but they all include as their skeleton-so to speak-sexual relations.

This is not because of the existence of a certain libido which would slip in everywhere but simply because the attitudes which we have described are the fundamental projects by which the For-itself realizes its being-for-others and tries to transcend this factual situation.

This is not the place to show what of love and desire can be contained in pity, admiration, disgust, envy, gratitude, etc. But each man will be able to determine it by referring to his own experience, as well as to the eidetic intuition of these various essences. Naturally this does not mean that these different attitudes are simply disguises borrowed by sexuality. But it must be understood that sexuality is integrated in them as their foundation and that they include and surpass it just as the notion of a circle includes and surpasses that of a rotating line segment, one of whose extremities is fixed. These fundamental-attitudes

can remain
hidden just as a skeleton is veiled by the flesh which surrounds it; in fact this is what usually happens. The contingency of bodies, the structure of the original project which I am, the history which I historicize can usually determine the sexual attitude to remain implicit, inside more complex conduct. For example, it is only seldom that one explicitly desires an Other "of the same sex." But behind the prohibitions of morality and the taboos of society the original structure remains, at least in that particular form of "trouble" which is called sexual disgust. And it is not necessary to understand this permanence of the sexual project as if it dwclt "within us" in the unconscious state. A project of the For-itself can exist only in conscious form. It exists as. integrated with a particular structure in which it is dissolved. This is what psychoanalysts have had in mind when they have made of sexual affectivity a "tabula rasa" deriving all its dcterminations from the individual history. Only it is not necessary to hold that sexuality at its origin is undertermined; in fact it includes all its determinations from the moment of the upsurge of the For-itself into a world where "there arc" Others. What is undetermined and what must be fixed by each one's history is the particular type of rclation with the Other in which the sexual attitude (desire-love, masochism-sadism) will be manifested in its explicit purity.
18 Also rnatemallove, pity, kindness, etc.

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It is precisely because these attitudes are original that we have chosen them in order to demonstrate the circle of relations with the Other. Since these attitudes are in fact integrated in all attitudes toward Others, they involve in their circularity the integrality of all conduct toward the Other. Just as Love finds its failure within itself and just as Desire arises \-
from the death of Love in order to collapse in turn and give way to Love, so all the patterns of conduct toward the Other.as-object include within themselves an implicit and veiled reference to an Other-as-subject, and this reference is their death. Upon the death of a particular conduct toward the Other-as-object arises a new attitude which aims at getting hold of the Other-as-subject, and this in turn reveals its instabiliy and collapses to give way to the opposite conduct. Thus we are indefinitely referred from the Other-as-object to the Other-as-subject and vice versa. The movement is never arrested, and this movement with its abrupt reversals of direction constitutes our relation with the Other. At whatever moment a person is considered, he is in one or the other of these attitudes- unsatisfied by the one as by the other. We can maintain ourselves for a greater or less length of time in the attitude adopted depending on our bad faith or depending on the particular circumstances of our history. But never will either attitude be sufficient in itself; it always points obscurely in the direction of its opposite. This means that we can never hold a consistent attitude toward the Other unless he is simultaneously revealed to us as subject and as object, as transcendence-transcending and as transcendence-transcended-which is on principle impossible. Thus ceaselessly tossed from being-a-look to being-looked-at, falling from one to the other in alternate revolutions, we are always, no matter what attitude

is adopted, in a state of instability in relation to the Other. We pursue the impossible ideal of the simultaneous apprehension of his freedom and of hi~ Objectivity. To borrow an expression from Jean Wahl, we are-in relation to the Other-sometimes in a state of trans-descendence (when we apprehend him as an object and integrate him with the world), and sometimes in a state of trans-ascendence (when we experience him as a transcendence which transcends us). But neither of these two states is sufficient in itself, and we shall never place ourselves concretely on a plane of equality; that is, on the plane where the recognition of the Other's freedom would involve the Other's recognition of our freedom.

The Other is on principle inapprehensible; he flees me when I seek him and possesses me when I flee him. Even if I should want to act according to the precepts of Kantian morality and take the Other's freedom as an unconditioned end, still this freedom would become a transcendence-transcended by the mere fact that I make it my goal. On the other hand, I could act for his benefit only by utilizing the Other-as-object as an instrument in order to realize this freedom. It would be necessary, in fact, that I apprehend the Other in situation as an object-

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instrument, and my sole power would be then to modify the situation in relation to the Other and the Other in relation to the situation. Thus I am brought to that paradox which is the perilous reef of all liberal politics and which Rousseau has defined in a single word: I must "force" the Other to be free. Even if this force is not always nor even very frequently exercised in the form of violence, nevertheless it still governs the relations of men with each other. If I offer comfort and reassurance, it is in order to disengage the Other's freedom from the fears or griefs which darken it; but consolation or reassuring argument is the organization of a system of means to an end and is designed to act upon the Other and consequently to integrate him in turn as an instrumental-thing in the system. Furthern10re the comforter effects an arbitrary distinction beween the freedom which he is identifying with the use of Reason and the pursuit of the Good, on the one hand, and the affiiction which appears to him the result of a psychic determinism. Therefore the problem is to separate the freedom from the affliction as one separates out each of two components of a chemical product. By the sole fact that the comforter is considering freedom as capable of being separated out, he transcends it and does violence to it, and he can not on the level where he is placed apprehend this truth: that it is freedom itself which makes itself the aftliction and that consequently tp act so as to- free freedom from affliction is to act against freedom.

It does not follow, however, that an ethics of "laisser-faire" and tolerance would respect the Other's freedom any better. From the moment that I exist I establish a factual limit to the Other's freedom. I am this limit, and each of my projects traces the outline of this limit around the Other. Charity, laisser-faire, tolerance-even an attitude of abstention-are each one a project of myself which engages me and which engages the Otllcr in his acquiescence. To realize tolerance with respect to the Other is to cause the Other to be thrown forcefully into a tol

erant world. It
is to remove from him on principle those free possibilities of courageous resistance, of perseverance, of self-assertion which he would have had the opportunity to develop in a world of intolerance. This fact is made still more manifest if we consider the problem of education: a severe education treats the child as an instrument since it tries to bend him by force to values which he has not admitted, but a liberal education in order to make use of other methods nevertheless chooses a priori principles and values in the name of which the child will be trained. To ~rain the child by persuasion and gentleness is no less to. compel him. Thus respect for the Other's freedom is. an empty word; even if we could assume the project of respecting this freedom, each attitude which we adopted with respect to the Other would be a violation of that freedom which we claimed to respect. The extreme attitude which would be given as a

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total indifference toward the Other is not a solution either. We are already thrown in the world in the face of the Other; our upsurge is a free limitation of his freedom and nothing-not even suicide-can change ~his original situation.Whatever our acts may be, in fact, we must accomplish them in a world where there are already others and where I am de trap in relation to others.

It is from this singular situation that the notion of guilt and of sin seems to be derived. It is before the Other that I am guilty. I am guilty first when beneath the Other's look I experience my alienation and my nakedness as a fall from grace which I must assume. This is the meaning of the famous line from Scripture: "They knew that they were naked." Again I am guilty when in turn I look at the Other, because by the very fact of my own self-assertion I constitute him as an object and as an instrument, and I cause him to experience that same alienation which he must now assume. Thus original sin is my upsurge in a world where there are others; and whatever may be my further relations with others, these relations will be only variations on the original theme of my guilL

But this guilt is accompanied by helplessness without this helplessness ever succeeding in cleansing me of my guilt. Whatever I may do for the Other's freedom, as we have seen, my efforts are reduced to treating the Other as an instrument and to positing his freedom as a transcendence-transcended. But on the other hand, no matter what compelling power I use, I shall never touch the Other save in his being-as-object. I shall never be able to accomplish anything except to furnish his freedom with occasions to manifest itself without my ever succeeding in increasing it or diminishing it, in directing it or in getting hold of it. Thus I am guilty toward the Other in my very. being because the upsurge of my being, in spite of itself, bestows on the Other a new dimension of being; and on the other hand I am powerless either to profit from my fault or to rectify it.

A for-itself which by historicizing itself has experienced these various avatars can determine with full knowledge of the futility of its former attempts, to pursue the death of the Other. This free determination is called hate. It implies a fundamental resignation; the for-itself abandons its claim to realize any union with the Other; it gives up using the Other as an instrument to recover its own being-

in-itself. It wishes simply to
rediscover a freedom without factual limits; that is, to get rid of its own inapprehensible being-as-object-for-the-Other and to abolish its dimension of alienation. This is equivalent to projecting the realization of a world in which the Other does not exist. The for-itself which hates consents to being only for-itself; instructed by its various experiences of the impossibility of making use of its being-for-others, it prefers to be again only a free nihilation of its being, a totality detotalized, a pursuit which assigns to itself its own ends. The one who hates projects nO longer

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being an object; hate presents itself as an absolute positing of the freedom of the for-itself before, the Other. This is why hate does not abase the hated object, for it places the dispute on its true level. What I hate in the Other is not this appearance, this fault, this particular action. What I hate is his existence in general as a transcendence-transcended. This is why hate implies a recognition of the Other's freedom. But this recognition is abstract and negative; hate knows only the Other-as-object and attaches itself to this object. It wishes to destroy this object in order by the same stroke to overcome the transcendence which haunts it. This .transcendence is only dimly sensed as an inaccessible beyond, as the perpetual possibility of the alienation of the for-itself which hates. It is therefore never apprehended for itself; moreover it could not be so without becoming an object. I experience it as a perpetually fleeing character in the Other-as-object, as a "not-given," "undeveloped" aspect of his most acccssible empirical qualities, as a sort of perpetual threat which warns me that "I am missing the point." This is why one hates right tl1Tougll the revealed psychiC but not the psychic itself; this is why also it is indifferent whether we hate the Other's transcendence through what we empirically call his vices or his virtues. What I hate is the whole psychic-totality in so far as it refers me to the Other's transcendence. I do not lower myself to hate any particular objective detail. Here we find the distinction between hating and despising. And hate does not necessarily appear on the occasion of my being subjected to something evil. On the contrary, it can arise when one would theoretically expect gratitude-that is, on the occasion of a kindness. The occasion which arouses hate is simply an act by the Other which puts me in the state of being subject to his freedom. This act is in itself humiliating; it is humiliating as the concrete revela.tion of my instrumental object-ness in the face of the Other's freedom. This revelation is immediately obscured, is buried in the past and becomes opaque. But it leaves in me the feeling that there is "something" to be'destroyed if I am to free myself. This is the reason, more· over, why gratitude is so close to hate; to be grateful for a kindness is to recognize that the Other was entirely free in acting as he has done. No compulsion, not even that of duty, has determined him in it. He is wholly responsible for his act and for the values which have presided over its accomplishment. I, myself, have been only the excuse for it, the matter on which his act has been exercised. In view of this recognition the for-itself can project love or hate as it chooses; it ca

n no longer ignore the
Other.
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The second consequence of these observations is that hate is the hate of all Others in one Other. What I want to attain symbolically by pursuing the death of a particular Other is the general principle of the existence of others. The Other whom I hate actually represents all Others.
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My project of suppressing him is a project of suppressing others in general; that is, of recapturing my non-substantial freedom as for-itself. In hate there is given an understanding of the fact that my dim<;nsion of being-alienated is a real enslavement which comes to me through others. It is the suppression of this enslavement which is projected. That is why hate is a black feeling; that is, a feeling which aims at the suppression of an Other and which qua project is consciously projected against the disapproval of others. I disapprove of the hate which one person bears toward another; it makes me uneasy and I seek to suppress it because although it is not explicitly aimed at me, I know that it concerns me and that it is realized against me. And in fact it aims at destroying me not in so far as it would seck to suppress me but in so far as it principally lays claim to my disapproval in order to pass beyond it. Hate demands to be hated-so that to hate is equivalent to an uneasy recognition of the freedom of the one who hates.
But hate too is in turn a failure. Its initial project is to suppress other consciousnesses. But even if it succeeded in this-i.e., if it 'Could at this moment abolish the Other-it could not bring it about that the Other had not been. Better yet, if the abolition of the Other is to be lived as the triumph of hate, it implies the explicit recognition that the Other has existed. Immediately my being-for-others by slipping into the past becomes an irremediable dimension of myself. It is what I have to be as having-been-it. Therefore I can not free myself from it. At least, SOmeone will say, I escape it for the present, I shall escape it in the future. But no. He who has once been for-others is contaminated in his being for the rest of his days even if the Other should be entirely suppressed; he will never cease to apprehend his dimension of being-for-others as a permanent possibility of his being. He can never recapture what he has alienated; he has even lost all hope of acting on this alienation and turning it to his own advantage since the destroyed Other has carried the key to this alienation along with him to the grave. What I was for the Other is fixed by the Other's death, and I shall irremediably be it in the past. I shall be it also and in the same way in the present if I persevere in the attitude, the projects, and the mode of life which have been judged by the Other. The Other's death constitutes me as an irremediable object exactly as my own death would do. Thus the triumph of hate is in its very upsurge transformed into failure. Hate does not enable us to get out of the circle. It simply represents the final attempt, the attempt of despair. After the failure of this attempt nothing remains for the for-itself except to re-enter the circle and allow itself to be indefinitely tossed from one to the other of the two fundamental attitudes.14
14 These considerations do not exclude the possibility of an ethics of deliverance and salvation. But this can be achieved only after a radical co

t conflicts have disappeared, and the consciousnesses which furnished the matter of the "we" are precisely those of all the patrons: "we" look at the event, "we" take part. It is this unanimity which Romains war-ted to describe in Vie unanime or in Vin blanc de la Villette. Here we are brought back again to Heidegger's Mitsein. Was it worth while then to criticize it earlier?111

We shall only remark here that we had no intention of casting doubt on the experience of the "we." We limited ourselves to showing that this experience could not be the foundation of our consciousness of the Other. It is clear, in fact, that it could not constitute an ontological structure of human-reality; we have proved that the existence of the for-itself in the midst of others was at its origin a metaphysical and contingent fact. In addition it is clear that the "we" is not an inter-subjective consciousness nor a new being which surpasses and encircles its parts as a syn-l!hetic whole in the manner of the collective consciousness of the sociologists. The "we" is experienced by a particular consciousness; it is not necessary that all the patrons at the cafe should be conscious of being "we" in order for me to experience myself as being engaged in a "we" with them. Everyone is familiar with this pattern of every-day dialogue: "We are very dissatisfied." "But no, my dear, speak for yourself." This implies that there are aberrant consciousnesses of the "we"-which as such are nevertheless perfectly normal consciousnesses. If this is the case, then in order for a consciousness to get the consciousness of being engaged in a "we," it is necessary that the other consciousnesses which enter into community with it should be first given in some other way; that is, either in the capacity of a transcendence-transcending or as a transcendence-transcended. The "we" is a certain particular experience which is produced in special cases on the foundation of being-for-others in general. The being-for-others pre- . cedes and founds the being-with-others.

Furthermore the philosopher who wants to study the "we" must take precautions and know of what he speaks. There is not only a We-as-subject; grammar teaches us that there is also a We-as-complement-i.e., a We-as-object.16 Now from all which has been said up till now it is easy to understand that the "we" in "We are looking at them" can not be on the same ontological plane as the "us" in "They are looking at us." There is no question here of subjectivities qua subjectivities. In the sentence, "They are looking at me," I want to indicate that I experience myself as

111 Part III, ch. I.

16 Here the difference between English and French presents a certain difficulty for the hanslator since nous in French is used for both subject and object-i.e., "we" and "us." Tr.

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an object for others, as an alienated Me, as a transcendence-transcended. If the sentence, "They are looking at us," is to indicate a real experience, it is necessary that in this experience I make proof of the fact that I am engaged with others in a community of transcendences-transcended, of alienated "Me's." The "Us" here refers to an experience of being-objects in common. Thus there are two radically different forms of the experience of the "we," and the two forms correspond exactly to the being-in-thc-act-of-looking and the being-looked-at which consti

tute the fundamental
relations of the For-itself with the Other. It is these two forms of the "we" which must be studied next.

A. THE US-OBJECf

We shall begin by examining the second of these experiences; its mcaning can be grasped more easily and it will perhaps serve as a means of approach to the study of the Other. First we must note that the Us-object precipitates us into the world; we experience it in shame as a community alienation. This is illustrated by that significant sccne in which convicts choke with anger and shame when a beautiful, elegantly dressed woman comes to visit their ship, sees their rags, their labor, and their misery. We have here a common shame and a common alienation. How then is it possible to experience oneself as an object in a community of objects? To a:lswer this we must return to the fundamental characteristics of our being-for-others.

Hitherto we have considered the simple case in which I am alone confronting the Other who is also alone. In this case I look at him or he looks at me. I seek to transccnd his transcendence or I experience my own as transcended; and I feel my possibilities as dead-possibilitics. We form a pair and we are in situation each one in relation to the Other. But this situation has objective existence only for the onc or the Other. There is no reverse siOe to our reciprocal relation. In our description we have not yet taken into account the fact that my relation with the Other appcars on the infinite ground of my relation and of his relation to alI Others; that is, to the quasi-totality of consciousnesscs. As a result my relation to tllis Other, which I experienced earlier as the foundation of my being-for-others, or the relation of the Other to me can at each instant and according to the motives which intervene be expericnced as objects for Others. This will be manifested clcarly in the case of the appearance of a tlJird person. Suppose, for example, that the Other is looking at me. At this moment I experience myself as wholly alienated, and I assume myself as such. Now the Third cernes on the scene. If he looks at me, I experience them as fonning a community, as "They" (they-subject) through my alienation. This "they" tends, as we know, toward the impersonal "somebody" or "one" (on). It does not alter the fact that I am

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looked at; it does not strengthen (or barely strengthens) my original alienation. But if the Third looks at the Other who is looking at me, the problem is more complex. I can in fact apprehend the Third not directly but upon the Other, who becomes the Other-looked-at (by the Third). Thus the third transcendence transcends the transcendence 'which transcends me and thereby contributes to disarming it. There is constituted here a metastable state which will soon decompose depending upon whether I ally myself to the Third so as to look at the Other who is then transformed into our object-and here I experience the We-as-subject of which we will speak later-or whether I look at the Third and thus transcend this third transcendence which transcends the Other. In the latter case the Third becomes an object in my universe, his possibilities are dead-possibilities, he can not deliver me from the Other. Yet he looks at the Other who is looking at me. There follows a situation which we shall call indeterminate and inconclusive since I am an object f

or the
Other who is an object for the Third who is an object for me. Freedom alone by supporting itself on one or the other of these relations can give a structure to this situation.
But it can just as well happen that the Third looks at the Other at whom I am looking. In this case I can look at both of them and thus disarm the look of the Third. The Third and the Other will appear to me then as 111ey-as-objects or "Them." ~ can also grasp upon the Other the look of the 'TIlird so that without seeing the Third I apprehend upon the Other's behavior the fact that he knows himself to be looked-at. In this case I experience upon tIle Other and apropos of the Other the 111ird's transcendence-transcending. The Third experiences it as a radical and absolute alienation of the Other. The Other flees away from my world; he no longer belongs to me; he is an object for another transcendence. 'TIlerefore he does not lose his character as an objcct, but he becomes ambiguous; he escapes me not by means of his own transcendence but through the transcendence of the Third. \Vhatever I can apprehend upon him and concerning him at present, he is always Other, as many times Other as there are Others to perceive him and think about him. In order for me to reappropriate the Other for myself, it is necessary for me to look at the Third and to confer an object-state upon him. But in the first place, this is not always possible; moreover the Third can be himself looked at by other Thirds; that is, can be indefinitely the Other whom I do not see. There results an original instability in the Other-as-object and an infinite pursuit by the For-itself which :;eeks to reappropriate this object-state. This is the reason, as we have seen, why lovers seck solitude.
It is possible also for me to experience myself as looked-at- by the Third w1lile I look at the Other. In this case I experience my alienation non-positionally at tbe same time that 17" alienation of the
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Other. My possibilities of utilizing the Other as an instrument are experi. enced by me as dead-possibilities, and my transcendence which prepares to transcend the Other toward my own ends falls back into transcendence-transcended. I let go my hold. The Other does not thereby become a subject, but I no longer feel myself qualified to keep him in an object-state. He becomes a neutral; something which is purely and simply there and with which I have nothing to do. This will be the case, for example, if I am surprised in the process of beating and humiliating a man helpless to defend himself. The appearance of the Third "disconnects" me. The helpless man is no longer either "to be beaten" or "to be humiliated"; he is nothing more than a pure existence. He is nothing more, he is no longer even "a helpless man." Or if he becomes so again, this will be through the Third serving as interpreter; I shall learn from the Third that the Other was a helpless man ("Aren't you ashamed? You have attacked one who is helpless," etc.). The quality of helplessness will in my eyes be conferred pn the Other by the Third; it will no longer be part of my world but of a universe in which I am with the helpless man for the Third.
This brings us finally to the case with which we are primarily concerned: I am engaged in a conflict with the Other. The Third comes on the scene and embraces both of us with his look. Corre

latively I make proof of my
alienation and my object-ness. For the Other I am outside as an object in the midst of a world which is not "mine." But the Other whom I was looking at or who was looking at me undergoes the same modification, and I discover this modification of the Other simultaneously with that which I experience. The Other is an object in the midst of the world of the Third. Moreover this object-state is not a simple modification of his being which is parallel with that which I undergo, but the two object-states come to me and to the Other in a global modification of the situation in which I am and in which the Other finds himself. Before the look of the Third appeared there were two situations, one circumscribed by the possibilities of the Other in which I was in the capacity of an instrument, and a reverse situation circumscribed by my own possibilities and including the Other. Each of these situations was the death of the Other and we could grasp the one only by objectivizing the other. Now at the appearance of the Third I suddenly experience the alienation of my possi· bilities, and I discover by the same token that the possibilities of the Other are dead-possibilities. The situation does not thereby disappear, but it flees outside both my world and the Other's world; it is constituted in objective form in the midst of a third world. In this third world it is seen, judged, transcended, utilized, but suddenly there is effected a leveling of the two opposed situations; there is no longer any structure of priority which goes from me to the Other or conversely from the Other to me since our possibilities are equally dead-possibilities for the Third.

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This means that I suddenly experience the existence of an objective situation-form in the world of the Third in which the Other and I shall figure as equivalent structures in solidarity with each other. Conflict does not arise, in this objcctive situation, from the free upsurge of our transcendcnces, but it is established and transcended by the Third as a factual given which defines us and holds us together. The Other's possibility of striking me and my possibility of defending myself, far from being exclusive of one another, are now complementary to each other, imply one another, and involve one another for the Third by virtue of their being dead-possibilities, and this is precisely what I experience non-thetically and without having any knowledge of it. Thus what I experience is a being-outside in which I am organized with the Other in an indissoluble, objective whole, a whole in which I am fundamentally no longer distinct from the Other but which I agree in solidarity with the Other to constitute. And to the extent that On principle I assume my being-outside for the Third, I must similarly assume the Other's being-outside; what I assume is a community of equivalence by means of which I exist engaged in a form which like the Other I agree to constitute. In a word I assume myself as engaged outside in the Other, and I assume the Other as engaged ou~side in me.
I carry the fundamental assumption of this engagement before me without apprehending it; it is this free recognition of my responsibility as including the responsibility for the Other which is the proof of the Us-object. Thus the Us-object is never known in the sense that reflection releases to us the knowledge o

f our Self, for example; it is never felt in the
sense that a feeling reveals to us a particular concrete object as antipathet-
ic, hateful, troubling, etc. Neither is it simply experienced, for what is
experienced is the pure sitnation of solidarity with the Other. The Us-
object is revealed to us only by my assuming the responsibility for this
situation; that is, because of the internal reciprocity of the situation, I
must of necessity-in the heart of my free assumption-assume also the
Other. Thus in the absence of any Third person I can say, "I am fighting
against tIle Other." But as soon as the Third appears,. the Other's possi.
bilities and my own are leveled into dead-possibilities and hence the rela-
tion becomes reciprocal; I am forced to make proof of the fact that "we
are fighting each other." In fact the statement, "I fight him and he fights
me" would be plainly inadequate. Actually I fight him because he fights
me and reciprocally. The project of combat has genninated in his mind
as in mine, and for the Third it is united into a single project common
to that they-as-object which he embraced with his look and which even
constitutes the unifying synthesis of this "Them." Therefore I must as-
sume myself as apprehended by the Third as an integral part of the
"Them." And this "Them" which is assumed by a subjectivity as its
meaning-for-others becomes the "Us."
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Reflective consciousness can not apprehend this "Us." Its .appearance
coincides on the contrary with the collapse of the "Us"; the For-itself
disengages itself and posits its selfness against Ot11ers. In fact it is neces-
sary to conceive that originally the bclonging to the Us-object is felt as a
still more radical alienation on the part of the For-itself since the latter
is no longer compelled only to assume what it is for the Other but to
assume also a totality which it is not although it forms an integral part
of it. In this sense the Us-object is an abrupt experience of the human
condition as engaged among Others as an objectively established fact.
The Us-object although experienced on the occasion of a concrete solidar-
ity and centered in this solidarity (I shall ge ashamed precisely because
we have been caught in the act of fighting one another) has a meaning
which surpasses the particular circumstance in which it is experienced and
which aims at including my belonging as an object to the human totality \.
(minus the pure consciousness of the Third) which is equally apprehend-
ed as an object. Therefore it corresponds to an experience of humilia-
tion and impotence; the one who experiences himself as constituting an
Us with other men feels himself trapped among an infinity of strange
existences; he is alienated radically and without recourse.
Certain situations appear more likely than others to arouse the experi-
ence of the Us. In particular there is communal work: when several per-
sons experience themselves as apprehended by the Third while they work
in solidarity to produce the same object, the very meaning of the manufac-
tured object refers to thc working collectivity as to an "Us." The move-
ment which I make and which is evoked by the subsequent hoisting up
has meaning only if It is preceded by this movement on the part of my
neighbor and followed by that movement on the part of that other work-
man; There results a form of the "Us" more easily a

ccessible since it is
thc requirement of the object itself and its potentialities and its coefficient of adversity which refer to us workmen as an Us-object. We have therefore experienced ourselves as apprehendcd as an "Us" across a material object "to be created." Materiality puts its seal on our solid community, and we appear to ourselves as an instrumental disposition and technique of means, each one having a particular place assigned by an end. But if some situations thus appear empirically more favorable to the upsurge of the "Us," we must not lose sight of the bct that eveI"'! human situation since it is an engagement in the midst of others, is experienced as "Us" as soon as the Third appears. If I am walking in the street behind this man and see only his back, I have with him the minimum of technical and practical relations which can be conceived. Yet once the Third looks at me, looks at the road, looks at the Other, I am bound to the Other by the solidarity of the "Us": we are walking one behind the Other on 1a rue B10met on a July morning. There is always a point of view from which diverse for-itselfs can be united in an "Us" by a look.
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Conversely just as the look is only the concrete manifestation of the original fact of my existence for others, just as therefore I experience myself existing for the Other outside any individual appearance of a look, so it is not necessary that a concrete look should penetrate and transfix us in order for us to be able to experience ourselves as integrated outside in an "Us." So long as the detotalized-totality "humanity" exists, it is possible for some sort of plurality of individuals to experience itself as "Us" in relation to all or part of the rest of men, whether these men are present "itl flesh and blood" or whether they are real but absent. Thus whether in the presence or in the absence of the Third I can always apprehend myself either as pure selfness or asjntegrated in an "Us." This brings us to certain special forms of the "Us," in particular to that which we call "class consciousness."
Class consciousness is evidently the assuming of a particular "Us" on the occasion of a collective situation more plainly structured than usual. It matters little here how we define this situation; what interests us is only the natur~ of the "Us" which is assumed. If a society,. so far as its economical or political structure is concerned, is divided into oppressed classes and oppressing classes, the situation of the oppressing classes presents the oppressed classes with the image of a perpetual Third who considers them and transcends them by his freedom. It is not the hard work, the low living standard, or the privations endured which will constitute the oppressed collectivity as a class. The solidarity of work, in fact, could (as we shall see in the following section) constitute the laboring collectivity as a "We-subject" in so far as this collectivity-whatever may be the coefficient of adversity of tllings-makes proof of itself as transcending the intra-mundane objects towards its own ends. The living standard is a wholly relative thing, and appreciation of it will vary according to circumstances (it can be simply endured or accepted or demanded in the name of a common ideal). The privations if considered in themselves have the result of isolating the persons who suffer them rather t

han of
uniting them and are in general sources of conflict. Finally, the pure and simple comparison which the members of the oppressed collectivity can make between the harshness of their conditions and the privileges enjoyed by the oppressing classes can not in any case suffice to constitute a class consciousness; at most it will provoke individual jealousies or particular despairs; it does not possess the possibility of unifying and of making each one assume the responsibility for the unification. But the ensemble of these characteristics as it constitutes the condition of the oppressed class is not simply endured or accepted. It wou1d be equally erroneous, however, to say that from the beginning it is apprehended by the oppressed class as imposed by the oppressing class. On the contrary, a long time is necessary to construct and spread a theory of oppression. And this theory will have only an explicative value. The primary fact

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is that the member of the oppressed collectivity, who as a simple person is engaged in fundamental conflicts with other members of this collectivity (love, hate, rivalry of interests, etc.), apprehends his condition and tha.t of other members of this collectivity as looked-at and thought about by consciOllsnesses which escape him.
The "master," the "feudal lord," the "bourgeois," the "capitalist" all appear not only as powerful people who command but in addition and above all as Thirds; that is, as those who are outside the opp~ssed community and for whom this community exists. It is therefore for them ;lnd in their freedom that the reality of the oppressed class is going to exist. They cause it to be born by their look. It is to them and through them that there is revealed the identity of my condition and that of the others who are oppressed; it is for them that I exist in a situation organized with others and that my possibles as dead-possibles are strictly equivalent with the possibles of others; it is for them that I am a worker and it is through and in their revelation as the Other-as-a-look that I experience myself as one among others. This means that I discover the "Us" in which I am integrated or "the class" outside, in the look of the Third,and it is this collective alienation which I assume when saying "Us." From this point of view the privileges of, the Third and "our" burdens, "our" miseries have value at first only as a signification; they signify the independence of the Third in relation to "Us"; they present our alienation to us more plainly. Yet,as they are none the less endured, as in particular our work, our fatigue are none the less suffered, it is across this endured suffering that I experience my being-looked-at-as-a-thing-engaged-in-a-totality-of-things. It is in terms of my suffering, of my misery that I am collectively apprehended with others by the Third; that is, in terms of the adversity of the world, in terms of the facticity of my condition. Without the Third, no matter what might be the adversity of the world, I should apprehend myself as a triumphant transcendence; with the appearance of the Third, "I" experience "Us" as apprehended in terms of things and as things overcome by the world.
Thus the oppressed class finds its class unity in the knowledge which the oppressing class has of it, and the appearance among the oppressed of class consciollsness corresponds t

o the assumption in shame of an
Us-object. We shall see in the following section what "class conscious-
ness" can be for a member of the oppressing class. What is important
for us here in any case and what is sufficiently illustrated by the example
which we have just chosen is that the experience of the Us-object pre-
supposes that of the being-far-others, of which it is only a more complex
modality. Therefore by virtue of being a particular case it falls within
the compass of our preceding descriptions. Moreover it incloses within
itself a power of disintegration since it is experienced through shame and
since the "Us" collapses as soon as the for-itself reclaims its selfness in

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the face of the Third and looks at him in turn. This individual claim of
selfness is moreover only one of the possible ways of suppressing the Us-
.object. The assumption of the "Us" in certain strongly structured cases,
as, for example, class consciousness, no longer implies the project of
freeing oneself from the "Us" by an individual recovery of selfness but
rather the project of freeing the whole "Us" from the object-state by trans-
forming it into a We-subject.
At bottom we are dealing with a variation of the project already
described of transforming the one who is looking into the one who is
looked-at; it is the usual passage from one to the other of the two great
fundamental attitudes of the for-others. The"oppressed class can, in fact,
affirm itself as a We-subject only in relation to the oppressing class and at
. the latter's expense; that is, by transforming it in turn into "they-as-ob-
jects" or "Them." The person who is engaged objectively in the class
aims at involving the whole class in and by means of his project of reversal.
In this sense the experience of the Us-object refers to that of the We-sub-
ject just as the experience of my being-an-object-for-others refers me to
the experience of being-an-object-for-others-for-me. Similarly we shall
find in what is called "mob psychology" collective crazes (Boulangism,
etc.) which are a particular form of love. The person who says "Us" then
reassumes in the heart of the crowd the original project of love, but it is
no longer on his own account; he asks a Third to save the whole collec-
tivity in its very object-state so that he may sacrifice his freedom to it.
Here as above disappointed love leads to masochism. This is seen in the
case in which the collectivity rushes into servitude and asks to be treated
as an object. The problem involves here again multiple individual proj-
ects of men in the crowd; the crowd has xen constituted as a crowd
by the look of the leader or the speaker; its unity is an object-unity which
each one of its members reads in the look of the Third who dominates
it, and each one then forms the project of losing himself in this object-ness,
of wholly abandoning his selfness in order to be no longer anything
but an instrument in the hands of the leader. But this instrument in
which he wants to be dissolved is no longer his pure and simple personal
for-others; it is the totality, objective-crowd. The monstrous materiality
of the crowd and its profound reality (although only experienced) are
fascinating for each of its members; each one demands to be submerged
in the crowd-instrument by the look of the leader.IT
In these various instances we have seen that the Us-object is always
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time it melts into the general rhythm of the work or of the march of the concrete community which surrounds me. It gets its meaning only'through this general rhythm; this is what I experience, for example, when the rhythm which I adopt is contre-temps. Yet the enveloping of my rhythm by the rhythm of the Other is apprehended "laterally." I do not utilize the collective rhythm as an instrument; neither do I contemplate it-in the sense in which for example, I might contemplate dancers on a stage. It surrounds me and involves me without being an object for me. I do not transcend it toward my own possibilities; but I slip my transcendence into its transcendence, and my own end-to accomplish a particular work, to arrive at a particular place-is an end of the "They" which is not distinct from the pecu!iar end of the collectivity. Thus the rhythm which I cause to be born is born in connection with me and laterally as the collective rhythm; it is my rhythm to the extent that it is their rhythm and conversely. There precisely is the motive for the experience of the We-subject; it is finally our rhythm.

Yet we can see that this can be only if by the earlier acceptance of a COmmon end and of common instruments I constitute myself as an undifferentiated transcendence by rejecting my personal ends beyond the collective ends at present pursued. Thus whereas in the experience of being-for-others the upsurge of a dimension of real and concrete being is the condition for the very experience, the experience of the We-subject is a pure psychological, subjective event in a single consciousness; it corresponds to an inner modification of the structure of this consciousness but does not appear on the foundation of a concrete ontological relation with others and does not realize any Mitsein. It is a question only of a way of feeling myself in the midst of others. Of course this experience can be looked on as the symbol of an absolute, metaphysical unity of all transcendences; it seems, in fact, that it overcomes the original conflict of transcendences by making them converge in the direction of the world. In this sense the ideal We-subject would be the "we" of a humanity which would make itself master of the earth. But the experience of the "we" remains on the ground of individual psychology and remains a simple symbol of the longed-for unity of transccndences. It is, in fact, in no way a lateral, real apprehension of subjectivities as such by a single subjectivity; the subjectivities remain out of reach and radically separated. But it is things and bodies, it is the material channeling of my transcendence which disposes me to apprehend it as extended and supported by the other transcendences without my getting out of my self and without the others getting out of themselves. I apprehend through the world that I form a part of "we."

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This is why my experience of the We-subject in no way implies a similar and correlative experience in others; this is why also it is so unstable;for it depends on particular organizations in the midst of the world and_ it disappears with those organizations. In truth, there is in the world a host of-fornlations which indicate me as anybody: first of all, all instrumental formations from tools proper to buildings with their elevators, their water or gas pipes, their electricity, not to mention means of transportation

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shops, etc. Every shop window, each plate of glass refers to me my image as an undifferentiated transcendence. In addition professional and technical relations with others make me known to myself as anybody: for the waiter I am any patron, for the ticket collector, I am any user of the subway. Finally the chance incident which suddenly takes place in front of the pavement of the cafe where I am sitting indicates me as an anonymous spectator and as a pure "look which makes this incident exist-as an outside." Similarly it is the anonymity of the spectator which is indicated by the theatrical performance which I am attending or theexhibition of pictures which I visit. And of course I make myself anybody when I try on shoes or uncork a bottle or go into an elevator or laugh in the theater. But the experience of this undifferentiated transcendence is an inner and contingent event which concerns only me. Certain particular circumstances which come from the world can add to my impression of being part of the ·~we." But in every instance we are dealing with only a purely subjective impression which engages only me.

(2) The experience of the We-subject can not be primary; it can not constitute an original attitude toward others since, on the contrary, it must in order to be realized presuppose a twofold preliminary recognition of the existence of others. In the first place, the manufactured object is such only if it refers to the producers who have made it and to rules for its use which have been fixed by others. Confronting an inanimate thing which has not been worked on, for which I myself fix its mode of use and to which I myself assil'?;n a new use (if, for example, I use a stone as a hammer), I have a non-thetic consciousness of my self as a person; that is, of my se1fness, of. my own ends, and of my free inventiveness. The rules for using, the "methods of employing" manufactured objects are both rigid and ideal like taboos and by their essential structure put me in the presence of the Other; it is because the Other treats me as an undifferentiated transcendence that I can realize myself as such. For a ready example, take those big signs which are above the portals of a station or in a waiting room and which bear the words "Exit" or "Entrance"; or again the directing hands on signboards which indicate a building or a direction. Here we are dealing once more with hypothetical imperatives. But here the formulation of the imperative clearly allows the Other to show through, the Other who is speaking and addressing himself directly to me. It is indeed to me that the printed sentence is

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directed; it represents in fact an immediate communication from the Other to me: I am aimed at. But if the Other aims at me, it is in so far as I am an undifferentiated transcendence. As soon as I avail myself of the opening marked "Exit" and go out through it, I am not using it in the absolute freedom of my personal projects. I am not constituting a tool by means of invention; I do not surpass the pure materiality of the thing toward my possibles. But between the object and me there has already slipped in a human transcendence which guides my transcendence. The object is already humanized; it signifies "human control." TIle "Exit"-considered as a pure opening out onto the street-is strictly equivalent to the "Entrance"; neither i

ts coefficient of adversity nor its visible utility
designates it as an exit. I do not submit to the object itself when I use it as an "Exit"; I adapt myself to the human order. By my very act I recognize the Other's existence; I set up a dialogue with the Other.
All this Heidegger has said and very well. But the conclusion which he neglects to derive from it is that in order for the object to appear as manufactured, it is· necessary that the Other be first given in some other way. A person who had not already experienced the Other would in no way be able to distinguish the manufactured object from the pure materiality of a thing which has not been worked on. Even if he were to utilize it according to the method foreseen by the manufacturer, he would be reinventing this method and would thu:, iealize a free appropriation of a natural thing. To go out by the passage marked "Exit" without having read the writing or without knowing the language is to be like the Stoic madman who in broad daylight says, "It is day," not as the consequence of an objective establishment but by virtue of inner resources of his madness. If therefore the manufactured object refers to Others and thereby to my undifferentiated transcendence, this is because I already know Others. Thus the experience of the We-subject is based on the original experience of the Other and can be only a secondary and subordinate experience.
Furthermore, as we have seen, to apprehend oneself as an undifferentiated transcendence-that is, at bottom as a pure exemplification of the "human species"-is not yet to apprehend oneself as the partial structure of a We-subject. For that, in fact, one must discover oneself as any body.in the center of some human stream. Therefore it is necessary to be surrounded by others. We have seen also that the others are in no way experienced as subjects in this experience, but neither are they apprehended as objects. They are not posited at all. Of course, I proceed on the basis of their factual existence in the world and of the perception of their acts. But I do not apprehend their facticity or their movements positionally; I have a lateral and non-positional consciousness of their bodies as correlative with my body, of their acts as unfolding in connection with my acts in such a way that I can not determine whether it is
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my acts which give birth to their acts or their acts which give birth to mine. A few observations will suffice to make clear that the experience of the "We" can not enable me originally to know as Others the Others who make part of the We. Quite the contrary, it is necessary that first there should be some awareness of what the Other is in order for an experience of my relations with Others to be realized in the form of the Mitsein. The Mitsein by itself would be impossible without a preliminary recognition of what the Other is: "I am wifh --." Very well. But with whom? In addition even if this experience were ontologically primary, one cannot see how one could pass into a radical modification of this experi. ence-going from a totally undifferentiated transcendence to the experience of particular persons. If the Other were not given elsewhere, the experience of the "We" when broken up would give birth only to the apprehension of pure object-instruments in the world circumscribed by my transcendence.
These few remarks do not clai

m to exhaust the question of the "We."
They aim only at indicating that the experience of the We-subject has nO value as a metaphysical revelation; it depends strictly on the variou~ forms of the for-others and is only an empirical enrichment of certain ot these forms. It is to this fact evidently that we should attribute the extreme instability of this experience. It comes and disappears capriciously, leaving us in the face of others-as-objects or else of a "They" who look at us. It appears as a provisional appeasement which is constituted at the very heart of the conflict, not as a definitive solution of this conflict. We should hope in vain for a human "we" in which the intersubjective totality would obtain consciousness of itself as a unified subjectivity. Such an ideal could be only a dream produced by a passage to the limit and to the absolute on the basis of fragmentary, strictly psychological experiences. Furthermore this ideal itself implies the recognition of the conflict of transcendencesas the original state of being-for-others.
This fact explains an apparent paradox: since the unity of the oppressed class stems from the fact that it is experienced as an Us-object in the face of an undifferentiated "They" which is the Third or the oppressing class, one might be tempted to believe that by a sort of symmetry the oppressing class apprehends itself as a We-subject in the face of the oppressed class. But the weakness of the oppressing class lies in the fact that although it has at its disposal precise and rigorous means for coercion, it is within itself profoundly anarchistic. The "bourgeois" is not only defined as a certain llomo reconomicus disposing of a precise power and privilege in the heart of a society of a certain type; he is described inwardly as a consciousness which does not recognize its belonging to a class. His situation, in fact, does not allow him to apprehend himself as engaged in an Us-cbject in community with the other members of the bourgeois
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class. But on the other hand, the very nature of the We-subject implies that it is made up of only fleeting experiences without metaphysical bearing. The "bourgeois" commonly denies that there are classes; he attributes the existence of a proletariat to the action of agitators, to awkward incidents, to injustices which can be repaired by particular measures; he affirms the existence of a solidarity of interests between capital and labor; he offers instead of class solidarity a larger solidarity, natural solidarity, in which the worker and the employer are integrated in a Mitsein which suppresses the conflict. The question here is not, as so often said, one of maneuvers or of a stupid refusal to see the situation in its true light; rather the member of the oppressing class sees the totality of the oppressed class confronting him as an objective ensemble of "they-subjects" without his correlatively realizing his community of being with the other members of the oppressing class. The two experiences are in no way complementary; in fact one may be alone in the face of an oppressed collectivity and still be able to grasp it as an object-instrument and apprehend oneself as the internal-negation of this collectivity; i.e., simply as the impartial Third. It is only when the oppressed class by revolution or by a sudden increase of its power po

ning or
the mode of being of the existent. It is true that the for-itself is the being by which existents reveal their mode of being. But Heidegger passes over in silence the fact that the for-itself is not only the being which constitutes an ontology of existents but that it is also the being by whom ontic modifications supervene for the existent qua existent. This perpetual possibility of acting-that is, of modifying the in-itself in its ontic materiality, in its "flesh"-must evidently be considered as an essential characteristic of thc for-itself. As such this possibility must find its foundation in an original relation of the for-itself to the in-itself, a relation which we have not yet brought to light. What does it mean to act? Why does the for-itself act? How can it act? Such are the questions to which we must reply at present. We have all the elements for a reply: nihilation, facticity and the body, being-for-others, the peculiar nature of the in-itself. We must question them once more.
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PART FOUR
Having, Doing, and Being
"HAVING," "doing," and "being"! are the cardinal categories of human reality. Under them are subsumed all types of human conduct. Knowing, for example, is a modality of having. These categories are not without connection with one another, and several writers have emphasized these ties. Denis de Rougemont is throwing light on this kind of relation when he writes in his article on Don Juan, "He was not capable of having." Again a similar connection is indicated when a moral agent is represented as doing in order to "do himself" and "doing himself" in order to be. However since the reaction against the doctrine of substance has won out in modern philosophy, the majority of thinkers have attempted to do on the ground of human conduct what their predecessors have done in physics-to replace substance by simple motion. For a long time the aim of ethics was to provide man with a way of being. This was the meaning of Stoic morality or of SpiI:!Oza's Ethics. But if the being of man is to be reabsorbed in the succession of his acts, then the purpose of ethics will no longer be to raise man to a higher ontological dignity. In this sense the Kantian morality is the first great ethical system which substitutes doing for being as the supreme value of action. The heroes of L'Espoir are for the most part on the level of doing, and Malraux shows us the conflict between the old Spanish democrats who still try to be and the Communists whose morality results in a series of precise, detailed obligations, each of these obligations aiming at a particular doing. Who is right? Is the supreme value of human activity a doing or a being? And whichever solution we adopt, what is to become of having? Ontology should be able to inform us concerning this problem; moreover it is one of ontology's essential tasks if the for-itself is the being which is defined by action. Therefore we must not bring this work to a close without giving a broad outline for the study of action in general and of the essential relations of doing, of being, and of having.
1 Avoir, faire, ~tre. It is difficult to know how to tr3nslate faire since Sartre gives to in all of the twofold significance of doing and making which the word carries in French. On the whole "doing" seems closer, especially since such expressions as "to do a book" or "to do a play" carry the same double meaning

ollected badly, that Rome is not secure from invasions, that it does not have the geographical location which is suitable for the capital of a Mediterranean empire which is threatened by barbarians, that its corrupt morals make the spread of the Christ:an religion difficult? How can anyone fail to see that all these considerations are negative; that is, that they aim at what is not, not at what is. To say that sixty per cent of the anticipated taxes have been collected can pass, if need be for a positive appreciation of the situation such as it is. To say that they are badly collected is to consider the situation across a situation which is posited as an absolute end but which precisely is not. To say that the corrupt morals at Rome hinder the spread of Christianity is not to consider this diffusion for what it is; that is, for a propagation at a rate which the reports of the clergy can enable us to determine. It is to posit the diffusion in itself as insufficient; that is, as suffering from a secret nothingness. But it appears as such only if it is surpassed toward a limiting-situation posited a priori as a value (for example, toward a certain rate of religious conversions, toward a certain mass morality). This limiting-situation can not be conceived in terms of the simple consideration of the real state of things; for the most beautiful girl in the world can offer only what she has, and in the same way the most miserable situation can by itself be designated only as it is without any reference to an ideal nothingness.

In so far as man is immersed in the historical situation, he does not even succeed in conceiving of the failures and lacks in a political organization or determined economy; this is not, as is stupidly said, because he "is accustomed to it," but because he apprehends it in its plenitude of being and because he can not even imagine that he can exist in it otherwise. For it is necessary here to reverse common opinion and on the basis of what it is not, to acknowledge the harshness of a situation or the suffer-

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ings which it imposes, both of which are motives for conceiving of another state of affairs in which things would be better for everybody. It is on the day that we can conceive of a different state of affairs that a new light falls on our troubles and our suffering and that we decide that these are unbearable. A worker in 1830 is capable of revolting if his salary is lowered, for he easily conceives of a situation in which his wretched standard of living would be not as low as the one which is about to be imposed on him. But he does not represent his sufferings to himself as unbearable; he adapts himself to them not through resignation but because he lacks the education and reflection necessary for him to conceive of a social state in which these sufferings would not exist. Consequently he does not act. Masters of Lyon following a riot, the workers at Croix-Rousse do not know what to do with their victory; they return home bewildered, and the regular army has no trouble in overcoming them. Their misfortunes do not appear to them "habitual" but rather natural; they are, that is all, and they constitute the worker's condition. They are not detached; they are not seen in the clear light of day, and consequently they are integrated by the worker with his being. He suffers without considering his suffering and wi

thout conferring value upon it. To suffer and to be are one and the same for him. His suffering is the pure affective tenor of his non-positional consciousness, but he does not contemplate it. Therefore this suffering can not be in itself a motive2 for his acts. Quite the contrary, it is after he has fonned the project of changing the situation that it will appear intolerable to him. This means that he will have had to give himself room, to withdraw in relation to it, and will have to have effected a double nihilation: on the one hand, he must posit an ideal state of affairs as a pure present nothingness; on the other hand, he mllst posit the actual situation as nothingness in relation to this state of affairs. He will have to conceive of a happiness attached to his class as a pure possible-that is, presently as a certain nothingness-and on the other hand, he will return to the present situation in order to illuminate it in the light of this nothingness and in order to nihilate it in turn by declaring: "I am not happy."

Two important consequences result. (1) No factual state whatever it may be (the political.and economic structure of society, the psychological "state," etc.) is capable by itself of motivating any act whatsoever. For an act is a projection of the for-itself toward what is not, and what is can in no way determine by itself what is not. (2) No factual state can deter-

2 In this and following sections Sartre makes a sharp distinction between motif and mobile. The English word "motive" expresses sufficiently adequately the French mobile, which refers to an inner subjective fact or attitude. For motif there is no true equivalent. Since it refers to an ext<;rnaI fact or situation, I am translating it by "cause." The reader must remember, however, that this carries with it no idea of determinism. Sartre emphatically denies the existence of any cause in the usual deterministic sense. Tr.

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mine consciousness to apprehend it as a negatite or as a lack. Better yet no factual state can determine consciousness to define it and to circumscribe it since, as we have seen, Spinoza's statement, "Omnis determinatio est negatio," remains profoundly true. Now every action has for its express condition not only the discovery of a state of affairs as "lacking in --," i.e., as a negatite-but also, and before all else, the constitution of the state of things under consideration into an isolated system. There is a factual state-satisfying or not-only by means of the nihilating power of the for-itself. But this power of nihilation can not be limited to realizing a simple withdrawal in relation to the world. In fact in so far as consciousness is "invested" by being, in so far as it simply suffers what is, it must be included in being. It is the organized form-worker-finding-his-suffering-natural-which must be surmonnted and denied in order for it to be able to form the object of a revealing contemplation. This means evidently that it is by a pure wrenching away from himself and the world that the worker can posit his suffering as unbearable suffering and conscquently can make of it the motive for his revolutionary action. This implies for cohsciousness the permanent possibility of effecting a rupture with its own past, of wrenching itself away from its past so as to be able to consider it in the light of a non-being and so as to be able to confer

on it the
meaning which it has in terms of the project of a meaning which it does not have. Under no circumstances can the past in any way by itself produce an act; that is, the positing of an end which turns back upon itself so as to illuminate it. This is what Hegel caught sight of when he wrote that "the mind is the negative," although he seems not to have remembered this when he came to presenting his own theory of action and of freedom. In fact as soon as one attributes to consciousness this negative power with respect to the world and itself, as soon as the nihilation forms an integral part of the positing of an end, we must recognize that the indispensable and fundamental condition of all action is the freedom of the acting being. Thus at the outset we can see what is lacking in those tedious discussions between determinists and the proponents of free will. The latter are concerned to find cases of decision for which there exists no prior cause, or deliberations concerning two opposed acts which are equally possible and possess causes (and motives) of exactly the same weight. To which the determinists may easily reply that there is no action without a cause and that the most insignificant gesture (raising the right hand rather than the left hand, etc.) refers to causes and motives which confer its meaning upon it. Indeed the case could not be otherwise since every action must be intentional; each action must, in fact, have an end, and the end in tum is referred to a cause. Such indeed is the unity of the three temporal ekstases; the end or temporalization of my future impli~s a cause (or motive); that is, it points toward my past, and the present IS the upsurge of the act. To speak of an act without a cause is to speak of an

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act which would lack the intentional structure of every act; and the proponents of free will by searching for it on the level of the act which is in the process of being performed can only end up by rendering the act absurd. But the determinists in turn are weighting the scale by stopping their investigation with the mere designation of the cause and motive. The essential question in fact lies beyond the complex organization "cause-intention-act-end"; indeed we ought to ask how a cause (or motive) can be constituted as such.
Now we have jQst seen that if there is no act without a cause, this is not in the sense that we can say that there is no phenomenon without a cause. In order to be a cause, the cause must be experienced as such. Of course this does not mean that it is to be thematically conceived and made explicit as in the case of deliberation. But at the very least it means that the for-itself must confer on it its value as cause or motive. And, as we have seen, this constitution of the cause as such can not refer to andther real and positive existence; that is, to a prior cause. For otherwise the very nature of the act as engaged intentionally in non-being would disappear. The motive is understood only by the end; that is, by the non-existent. It is therefore in itself a negatite. If I accept a niggardly salary it is doubtless because of fear; and fear is a motive. But it is tear ot dying trom starvation; that is, this fear has meaning only outside itself in an end ideally posited, which is the preservation of a life which I apprehend as "in danger." And this fear is understood in turn o

nly in relation
to the value which I implicitly give to this life; that is, it is referred to
that hierarchal system of ideal objects which are values. Thus the motive
makes itself understood as what it is by means of the ensemble of beings
which "are not," by ideal existences, and by the future. Just as the future
turns back upon the present and the past in order to elucidate them, so it
is the ensemble of my projects which turns back in order to confer upon
the motive its structure as a motive. It is only because I escape the in-itself
by nihilating myself toward my possibilities that this in-itself can take on
value as cause or motive. Causes and motives have meaning only inside a
projected ensemble which is precisely an ensemble of non-existents. And
this ensemble is ultimately myseif as transcendence; it is Me in so far as
I have to be myself outside of myself.
If we recall the principle which we established earlier-namely that it
is the apprehension of a revolution as possible which gives to the work-
man's suffering its value as a motive-we must thereby conclude that it is
by fleeing a situation toward our possibility of changing it that we organize
this situation into complexes of causes and motives. The nihilation by
which we achieve a withdrawal in relation to the situation is the same as
the ekstasis by which we project ourselves toward a modification of this
situation. The result is that it is in fact impossible to find an act without a
motive but that this does not mean that we must conclude that the motive

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causes the act; the motive is an integral part of the act. For as the resolute
projcct toward a change is not distinct from the act, the motive, the act,
and the end are all constituted in a single upsurge. Each of these three
structures claims the two others as its meaning. But the organized totality
of the three is no longer explained by any particular structure, and its
upsurge as the pure temporalizingnihilation of the in-itself is one with
freedom. It is the act which decides its ends and its motives, and the act
is the expression of freedom.
We cannot, however, stop with these superficial considerations; if the
fundamcntal condition of the act is freedom, we must attempt to de-
scribe this freedom more precisely. But at the start we encounter a great
difficulty. Ordinarily, to describe something is a process of making explicit
by aiming at the structures of a particular essence. Now freedom has no
essence. It is not subjectto any logical necessity; we must say of it what
Heidegger said of the Dasein in general: "In it existence precedes and
commands essence." Freedom makes itself an act, and we ordinarily attain
it across the act which it organizes with the causes, motives, and ends
which the act implies. But precisely because this act has an essence, it
appears to us as constituted; if we wish to reach the constitutive power,
we must abandon any hope of finding it an essence. That would in fact
demand a new constitutive power and so on to infinity. How then are
we to. describe an existence which perpetually makes itself and which re-
fuses to be confined in a definition? The very use of the term "freedom"
is dangerous if it is to imply that the word refers to a concept as words
ordinarily do. Indefinable and unnamable, is freedom also indescribable?
Earlier when we wanted to describe nothingness and the bein

g of the
phenomenon, we encountered comparable difficulties. Yet they did not deter us. This is because there can be descriptions which do not aim at the essence bUt at the existent itself in its particularity. To be sure, I could not describe a freedom which would be common to both the Other and myself; I could not therefore contemplate an essence of freedom. On the contrary, it is freedom which is the foundation of all essences since man reveals intra-mundane essences by surpassing the world toward his own possibilities. But actually the question is of my freedom. Similarly when I described consciousness, I could not discuss a nature common to certain individuals but only my particular consciousness, which like my freedom is beyond essence, or-as we have shown with considerable repetition-for which to be is to have been. I discussed this consciousness so as to touch it in its very existence as a particular experience-the cogito. Husserl and Descartes, as Gaston Berger has shown, demand that the cogito release to them a truth as essence: with Descartes we achieve the connection of two simple natures; with Husserl we grasp the eidetic structure of consciousness.s But if in consciousness its existence must precede its essence,
s Gaston Berger: I.e Cogito chez Husser1 et chez Descartes, 1940.

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then both Descartes and Husserl have committed an error. What we can Jemand from the cogito is only that it discover for us a factual necessity. It is also to the cogito that we appeal in order to determine freedom as the freedom which is ours, as a pure factual necessity; that is, as a contingent existent but One which I am not able not to expericnce. I am indeed an existent who learns his freedom. through his acts, but I am also an existent whose individual and unique existence temporalizes itself as freedom. As such I am necessarily a consciousness (of) freedom since nothing exists in consciousness except as the non-thetic consciousness of existing. Thus my freedom is perpetually in question in my being; it is not a quality added on or a property of my nature. It is very exactly the stuff of my being; and as in my being, my being is in question, I must necessarily possess a certain comprehension of freedom. It is this comprehension which we intend at present to make explicit.
In our attempt to reach to the heart of freedom we may be helped by the few observations which we have made on the subject in the course of this work and which we must summarize here. In the first chapter we established the fact that if negation comes into the world through human-reality, the latter must be a being who can realize a nihilating rupture with the world and with himself; and we established that the permanent possibility of this rupture is the same as freedom. But on the other hand, we stated that this permanent possibility of nihilating what I am in the form of "having-been" implies for man a particular type of existence.
We were able then to determine by means of analyses like that of bad faith that human reality is its own nothingness. For the for-itself, to be is to nihilate the in-itself which it is. Under these conditions freedom can be nothing other than this nihilation. It is through this that the for-itself escapes its being as its essence; it is through this that the for-itself is always something other than what can be said of it. For in the final

analysis the
For-itself is the one which escapes this very denomination, the one which is already beyond the name which is given to it, beyondthe property which is recognized in it. To say that the for-itself has to be what it is, to say that it is what it is not while not being what it is, to say that in it existence precedes and conditions essence or inversely according to Hegel, that for it "Wesen ist was gewesen ist"-all this is to say one and the same thing: to be aware that man is free. Indeed by the sole fact that I am conscious of the causes which inspire my action, these causes are already transcendent objects for my consciousness; they are outside. In vain shall I seek to catch hold of them; I escape them by my very existence. I am condemned to exist forever beyond my essence, beyond the causes and motives of my act. I am condemned to be free. This means that no limits to my freedom' can be found except freedom itself or, if you prefer, that we are not free to cease being free. To the extent that the for-itself wishes to hide its
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own nothingness from itself and to incorporate the in-itself as its true mode of being, it is trying also to hide its freedom from itself.
The ultimate meaning of determinism is to establish within us an unbroken continuity of existence in itself. The motive conceived as a psychic fact-i.e., as a full and given reality-is, in the det~rministic view, articulated without any break with the decision and the act, both of which are equally conceived as psychic givens. The in-itself has got hold of all these "data"; the motive provokes the act as the physical cause its effect; everything is real, everything is full. Thus the refusal of freedom can be conceived only as an attempt to apprehen~ oneself as being-in-itself; it amounts to the same thing. Human reality may be defined as a being such that in its being its freedom is at stake because human reality perpetually tries to refuse to recognize its freedom. Psychologically in each one of us this amounts to trying to take the causes and motives as things. We try to .... confer permanence upon them. We attempt to hide from ouselves that their nature and their weight depend each moment on the meaning which I give to them; we take them for constants. This amounts to considering the meaning which I gave to them just now or yesterday-which is irremediable because it is past-and extrapolating from it a character fixed still in the present. I attempt to persuade myself that the cause is as it was. Thus it would pass whole and untouched from my past consciousness to my present consciousness. It would inhabit my consciousness. This amounts to trying to give an essence to the for-itself. In the same way people will posit ends as transcendences, which is not an error. But instead of seeing that the transcendences there posited are maintained in their being by my own transcendence, people will assume that I encounter them upon my surging up in the world; they come from God, from nature, from "my" nature, from society. These ends ready made and pre-human will therefore define the meaning of my act even before I conceive it, just as causes as pure psychic givens will produce it without my even being aware of them. Cause, act, and end constitute a continuum, a plenum. These abortive attempts to stifle freedom under the weight of being (they collapse with
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e sudden upsurge of anguish before freedom) show sufficiently that freedom in its foundation coincides with the nothingness which is at the heart of man. Human-reality is free because it is not enough. It is free because it is perpetually wrenched away from itself and because it has been separated by a nothingness from what it is and from what it will be. It is free, finally, because its present being is itself a nothingness in the form of the "reflection-reflecting." Man is free because he is not himself but presence to himself. The being which is what it is can not be free. Freedom is precisely the nothingness which is made-to-he at the heart of man and which forces human-reality to make itself instead of to he. As we have seen, for human reality, to be is to choose oneself; nothing comes to it either from the outside or from within which it can receive or accept.

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Without any help whatsoever, it is entirely abandoned to the intolerable necessity of making itself be-down to the slightest detail. Thus freedom is not a being; it is the being of man-i.e., his nothingness of being. If we start by conceiving of man as a plenum, it is absurd to try to find in him afterwards moments or psychic regions in which he would be free. As well look for emptiness in a container which one has filled beforehand up to the brim! Man can not be sometimes slave and sometimes free; he is wholly and forever free or he is not free at all.

These observations can lead us, if we know how to use them, to new discoveries. They will enable us first to bring to light the relations between freedom and what we call the "will." There is a fairly common tendency to seek to identify free acts with voluntary acts and to restrict the deterministic explanation to the world of the passions. In short the point of view of Descartes. The Cartesian will is free, but there are "passions of the soul." Again Descartes will attempt a physiological interpretation of these passions. Later there will be an attempt to instate a purely ps}chological detenninism. Intellectualistic analyses such as Proust, for example, attempts with respect to jealousy or snobbery can serve as illustrations for this concept of the passional "mechanism." In this case it would be necessary to conceive of man as simultaneously free and determined, and the essential problem would be that of the relations between this unconditioned freedom and the determined processes of the psychic life: how will it master the passions, how wiI I it utilize them for its own bcnefit? A wisdom which comes from ancient times- the wisdom of the Stoics-will teach us to come to tenns with these passions so as to master them; in short it will counsel us how to ~onduct ourselves with regard to affectivity as man does with respect to nature in general when he obeys it in order better to control it. Human reality therefore appears as a free power besieged by aa ensemble of determined processes. One will distinguish wholly free acts, determined processes over which the free wiI I has power, and processes which on principle escape the human-will.

It is clear that we shall not be able to accept such a conception.

But let us try better to understand the reasons for our refusal. There is one objcction which is obvious and which we shall not waste time in developing; this is that such a trenchant duality is inconceivable at the heart of t

freedom, then it is of necessity negativity and the power of nihilation. But then we no longer can see why autonomy should be preserved for the will. In fact it is hard to conceive of those holes of nihilation which would be the volitions and which would surge up in the otherwise dense and full web of the passions and of the dOos in general. If the will is nihilation, .fl.e., is not spontaneity. Tr.

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then the ensemble of the psychic must likewise be nihilation. Moreover-and we shall soon return to this point-where do we get the idea that the "fact" of passion or that pure, simple desire is not nihilating? Is not passion first a project and an enterprise? Does it not exactly posit a statc of affairs as intolerable? And is it not thercby forced to effect a withdrawal in relation to this state of affairs and to nihilate it by isolating it and by considering it in the light of an end-i.e., of a non-bcing? And does not passion have its own ends which are recognized precisely at the same moment a.t which it posits them as non-existent? And if nihilation is precisely the being of freedom, how can we refuse autonomy to the passions in order to grant it to the will?

But this is not all: the will, far from being the unique or at least the privileged manifestation of freedom, actually-like every event of the for-itself-must presuppose the foundation of an original freedom in order to be able to constitute itself as will. The will in fact is posited as a reflective decision in relation to certain ends. But it does not create these ends. It is rather a mode of being in relation to them: it decrees that the pursuit of these ends will be reflective and deliberative. Passion can posit the same ends. For example, if I am threatened, I can run away at top speed because of my fear of dying. This passional fact nevertheless posits implicitly as a supreme end the value of life. Another person in the same situation will, on the contrary, understand that he must remain at his post even if resistance at first appears more dangerous than flight; he "will stand firm:' But his goal, although better understood and explicitly posited, remains the same as in the case of the emotional reaction. It is simply that the methods of attaining it are more clearly conceived; certain of them are rejected as dubious or inefficacious, others are more solidly organized. The difference here dcpep..ds on the choice of means and on the degree of reflection and of making explicit, not on the end. Yet the one who flees is said to be "passionate," and we reserve the term "voluntary" for the man who resists. Therefore the question is of a difference of subjective attitude in relation to a transcendent end. But if we wish to avoid the error which we denounced earlier and not consider these transcendent ends as pre-human and as an a priori limit to our transcendence, then we are indeed compelled to recognize that they are the temporalizing projection of our freedom. Human reality can not receive its ends, as we have seen, either from outside or from a so-called inner "nature:' It chooses them and by this very choice confcrs upon them a transcendent existence as the external limit of its projects. From this point of view-and if it is understood that the existence of the Dasf'in precedes and commands its essence-human reality in and through its very upsurge decides to define its own

sters or monarchs; they will seek the causes for a declaration of war: the occasion is propitious, the attacked country is disorganized because of internal troubles; it is time to put an end to an economic conflict which is in danger of lasting interminably. If Clovis is converted to Catholicism, then inasmuch as so many barbarian kings are Arians, it is because Clovis secs an opportunity of getting into the good graces of the episcopate which is all powerful in Gaul. And so on. One will note here that the cause is characterized as an objective appreciation of the situation. The cause of Clovis' conversion is the political and religious state of Gaul; it is the relative strengths of the episcopate, the great landowners, and the common people. What motivates the conversion of the bonds is the state of the national debt. Nevertheless this objective appreciation can be made only in the light of a presupposed end and within the limits of a project of the for-itself toward this end. In order for the power of the episcopate to be revealed to Clovis as the cause of his conversion (that is, in order for him to be able to envisage the objective consequences which this conversion could have) it is necessary first for him to posit as an end the conquest of Caul. If we suppose that Clovis has other ends, he can find in the situation of. the Church causes for his becomin~ Arian or for remaining pagan. It is even possible that in the consideratIon of the Church he can even find no cause for acting in any way at all; he WI11 then di!cover nothing in relation to this subject; he will leave the situation of the episcopate in the state of "unrevealed," in a total obscurity.
We shall therefore use the term cause for the objective apprehension of a determined situation as this situation is revealed in the light of a certain end as being able to serve as the means for attaining this end.
The motive, on the contrary, is generally considered as a subjective fact. It is the ensemble of the desires, emotions, and passiqns which urge me to accomplish a certain act. The historian looks for motives and takes them into account only as a last resort when the causes are not sufficient to explain the act under consideration. Ferdinand Lot, for example, after having shown that the reasons which are ordinarily given for the conversion of Constantine are insufficient or erroneous, writes: "Since it is established that Constantine had everything to lose and apparently nothing to gain by embracing Christianity, there is only one conclusion possible-that he yielded to a sudden impulse, pathological or divine as you prefer.'" Lot is here abandoning the explanation by causes, which seems to him unenlightening, and pJ;.efers to it an explanation by motives.
f Ferdinand Lot: La Up du monde antique et Ie d~but du moyen ~ge, p. 35. Renais-SllDCC da Livre, 1927.
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The explanation must then be sought in the psychic state-even in the "mental" state-of the historical agent. It follows naturally that the event becomes wholly contingent since another individual with other passions and other d~sires would have act~d differently. In contrast to the historian the psychologist will by preference look for motives; usually he supposes, in fact, that they are "contained in" the state of consciousness which has provoked the action. The ideal rational act would therefore be the one for

which the motives would be practically nil and which would be uniquely inspired by an objective appreciation of the situation. The irrational or passionate act will be characterized by the reverse proportion.

It remains for us to explain the relation between causes and motives in the everyday case in which they exist side by side. For example, I can join the Socialist party because I judge that this party serves the interests of justice and of humanity or because I believe that it will become the principal historical force in the years which wiI follow my joining: these are causes. And at the same time I can have motives: a feeling of pity or charity for certain classes of the oppressed, a feeling of shame at being on the "good side of the barricade," as Gide says, or again an inferiority complex, a desire to shock my relatives, etc. What can be meant by the statement that I have. joined the Socialist paity for these causes alld these motives? Evidently we are dealing with two radically distinct layers of meaning. How are we to compare them? How are we to determine the
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part played by each of them in the decision under consideration? This (~difficulty, which certainly is the greatest of those raised by the current ~tinction between causes and motives, has never been resolved; few people indeed have so much as caught a glimpse of it. Actually under a differcnt name it amounts to positing the existence of a conflict between the will and. the passions. But if the classic theory is discovered to be incapable of assigning to cause and motive their proper influence in the simple instance when they join togethcr to produce a single decision, it will be wholly impossible8 for it to explain or even to conceive of a conflict between causes and motives, a conflict in which each group would urge its individual decision. Therefore we must start over again from the beginning.

To be sure, the cause is objective; it is the state of contemporary things as it is revealed to a consciousness. It is objective that the Roman plebs and aristocracy were corrupted by the time of Constantine or that the Catholic Church is ready to favor a monarch who at the time of Clovis will help it triumph over Arianism. Nevertheless this state of affairs can be revealed only to a for-itself since in general the for-itself is the being by which "there is" a world. Better yet, it can be revealed only to a for-itself which chooses itself in this or that particular way-that is, to a for-itself which has made its Own individuality. The for-itself must of neces-

8 Sartre says "wholly possible" (tout ~ fait possible) which I feel sure is a misprint. Tr.

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sity have projected itself in this or that way in order to discover the,instrumental implications. of instrumental-things. Objectively the knife is an instrument made of a blade and a handle. I can grasp it objectively as an instrument to slice with. to cut with. But lacking a hammer, I can just as well grasp the knife as an instrument to hammer with. I can make use of its handle to pound in a nail. and this apprehension is no less objective. When Clovis appreciates the aid which the Church can furnish him. it is not certain that a group of prelates or even one particular priest has made any overtures to him. nor even that any member of the clergy has clearly thought of an alliance with a Catholic monarch. The only stric

tly objective
facts. those which any for-itself whatsoever can establish. are the great power of the Church over the people of Gaul' and the anxiety of the Church with regard to the Arian heresy. In order for these established facts to be organized into a cause for conversion. it is necessary to isolate them from the ensemble-and thereby to nihilate them-and it is necessary to transcend them toward a particular potentiality: the Church's potentiality objectively apprehended by Clovis will be to give its support to a converted king. But this potentiality can be revealed only if the situation is surpassed toward a state of things which does not yet exist-in short, towards a nothingness. In a word the world gives counsel only if one questions it. and one can question it only for a well determined end. Therefore the cause. far from determining the action. appears only in and through the project of an action. It is in and through the project of imposing his rule on all of Gaul that the state. of the Western Church appears objectively to Clovis as a cause for his conversion. In other words the consciousness which carves out the cause in the ensemble of the world has already its own structure; it has given its own ends to itself, it has projected itself toward its possibles, and it has its own manner of hanging on to its possibilities: this peculiar manner of holding to its possibles is here affectivity. This internal organization which consciousness has given to itself in the form of non-positional self-consciousr.ess is strictly correlative with the carving out of causes in the world. Now if one reflects on the matter. one must recognize that the internal structure of the for-itself by which it effects in the world the upsurge of causes for acting is an "irrational" fact in the historical sense of the term. Indeea we can easily understand rationally the technical usefulness of the corrversion of Clovis under the hypothesis by which he would have projected the conquest of Gaul. But we can not do the same with regard to his project of conquest. It is not "self-explanatory." Ought it to be interpreted as a result of Clovis' ambition? But precisely what is the ambition if not the purpose of conquering? I-low could Clovis' ambition be distinguished from the precise project of conquering Gaul? Therefore it would be useless to conceive of this original project of conquest as "incited" by a pre-existing motive which would be ambition. It is indeed true that the

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ambition is a motive since it is wholly subjectivity. But as it is not distinct from the project of conquering, we shall say that this first project of his possibilities in the light of which Clovis discovers a cause for being converted is precisely the motive. Then all is made clear and we can conceive of the relations of these three terms: causes, motives, ends. We are dealing here with a particular case of being-in-the-world: just as it is the upsurge of the for-itself which causes there to be a world, so here it is the very being of the for-itself-in so far as this being is a pure project toward an end-which causes there to be a certain objective structure of the world, one which deserves the name of cause in the light of this end. The for-itself is therefore the consciousness of this cause. But this positional consciousness of the cause is on principle a non-thetic consciousness

of
itself as a project toward an end. In this sense it is a motive; that is, it experiences itself non-thetically as a project, more or less keen, more or less passionate, toward an end at the very moment at which it is constitutcd as a revealing consciousness of the organization of the world into causes.

Thus cause arid motive are correlative, exactly as the non-thetic self-consciousness is the ontological correlate of the thetic consciousness of the object. Just as the consciousness of something is self-consciousness, so the motive is nothing other than the apprehension of the cause in so far as this apprehension is self-consciousness. But it follows obviously that the cause, the motive, and the end are the three indissoluble terms of the thrust of a free and living consciousness which projects itself toward its possibilities and mnkes itself defined by these possibilities.

How docs it happen then that the motive appears to the psychologist as the affective content of a fact of consciousness as this conknt determines another fact of consciousness or a decision? It is because the motive, which is nothing other than a non-thetic self-consciousness, slips into the past with this same consciousness and along with it ceases to be living. As soon as a consciousness is made-past, it is what I have to be in the form of the "was." Consequently when I tum back toward my consciousness of yesterday, it preserves its intentional significance and its meaning as subjectivity, but, as we have seen, it is fixed; it is outside like a thing, since the past is in-itself. The motive becomes then that of Wllich there is consciousness. It can appear to me in the form of "empirical knowledge"; as we saw earlier, the dead past haunts the present in the :tspect of a practical knowing. It can also happen that I tum back toward it so as to make it explicit and fommlate it while guiding myself by the knowledge which it is for me in the present. In this case it is an object of consciousness; it is this very consciousness of which I am conscious. It appears therefore-like my memories in general-simultaneously as mine and as transcendent. Ordinarily we are surrounded by these motives which we "no longer enter," for we not only have to decide concretely to accomplish

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this or that act but also to accomplish actions which we decided upon the day before or to pursue enterprises in which we are engaged. In a general way consciousness at whatever moment it is grasped is apprehended as engaged and this very apprehension implies a practical knowing of the motives of the engagement or even a thematic and positional explanation of these causes. It is obvious that the apprehension of the motive refers at once to the cause, its correlate, since the motive, even when made-past and fixed in in-itself, at least maintains as its meaning the fact that it has been a consciousness of a cause; i.e., the discovery of an objective structure of the world. But as the motive is in-itself and as the cause is objective, they are presented as a dyad without ontological distinction; we have seen, indeed, that our past is lost in the midst of the world. That is why we put them on the same level and why we are able to speak of the causes and of the motives of an action as if they could enter into conflict or both concur in determined proportion in a decision.

Yet if the motive is transcen

dent, if it is only the irremediable being
which we have to be in the mode of the "was," if like all bur past it is separated from us by a breadth of nothingness, then it can act only if it is recovered; in itself it is withont force. It is therefore by the very thrust of the engaged consciousness that a value and a weight will be conferred on motives and on prior causes. \\'hat they have been does not depend on consciousness, but consciousness has the duty of maintaining them in their existence in the past. I have willed this or that: here is what remains irremediable and which even constitutes my essence, since my essence is what I have been. But the meaning held for me by this desire, this fear, these objective considerations of the world when presently I project myself toward my futures-this must be decided by me alone. I determine them precisely and only by the very act by which I project myself toward my ends. The recovery of former motives-or the rejection or new appreciation of them-is not distinct from the project by which I assign new ends to myself and by which in the light of these ends I apprehend myself as discovering a supporting cause in the world. Past motives, past causes, present motives and causes, future ends, all are organized in an indissoluble unity by the very upsurge of a freedom which is beyond causes, motives, and ends.

The result is that a voluntary deliberation is always a deception. How can I evaluate causes and motives on which I myself confer their value before all deliberation and by the very choice which I make of myself? The illusion here stems from the fact that we endeavor to take causes and motives for entirely transcendent things which I balance in my hands like weights and which possess a weightas a permanent property. Yet on the other hand we try to view them as contents of. consciousness, and this is self.<:ontradictory. Actually causes and motives have only the weight which my project-i.e., the free production of the end and of the known

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act to be realized-eonfers upon them. When I deliberate, the chips are down.o And if I am brought to the point of deliberating, this is simply because it is a part of my original project to realize motives by means of deliberation rather than by some other form of discovery (by passion, for example, or simply by action, which reveals to me the organized ensemble of causes and of ends as my language informs me of my thought). There is therefore a choice of deliberation as a procedure which will make known to me what I project and consequently what I am. And the choice of deliberation is organized with the ensemble motives-eauses and end by free spontaneity. When the will intervenes, the decision is taken, and it has no other value than that of making the announcement.

The voluntary act is distinguished from involuntary spontaneity in that the latter is a purely unreflective consciousness of causes across the pure and simple project of the act. As for the motive, in the unreflective act it is not an object for itself but a simple non-positional self-consciousness. The structure of the voluntary act, on the other hand, requires the appearance of a reflective consciousness which apprehends the motive as a quasi-object or which even intends it as a psychic object across the consciousness reflected-on. For the latter, the cause, since it is grasped by the

intermediary of the consciousness reflected-on, is as separated. To adopt Husserl's famous expression, simple voluntary reflection by its structure as reflectivity practices the ~'II"Ox~ with regard to the cause; it holds the cause in suspense, puts it within parentheses. Thus it can build up a semblance of appreciative deliberation by the fact that a more profound nihilation separates the reflective consciousness from the consciousness reflected-on or motive and by the fact that the cause is suspense. Nevertheless, as we know, although the result of the reflection is to widen the gap which separates the for-itself from itself, such is not its goal. The goal of the reflective scissiparity is, as we have seen, to recover the reflected-on so as to constitute that unrealizable totality "In-itself-for-itself," which is the fundamental value posited by the for-itself in the very upsurge of its being. If, therefore, the will is in essence reflective, its goal is not so much to decide what end is to be attained since in any case the chips are down; the profound intention of the will bears rather on the method of attaining this end already posited.-Thefor-itself which exist's in the voluntary mode wishes to recover itself in so far as it decides and acts. It does not wish merely to be carried toward an end, nor to be the one which chooses itself as carried toward a particular end; it wishes again to recover itself as a spontaneous project toward this or that particular end. The ideal of the will is to be an "in-itself-for-itself" as a project toward a certain end.

This is evidently a reflective ideal and it is the meaning of the satisfac-

9 Les jeux sont faits. Sartre has written a novel by this title. Tr.

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tion which accompanies a judgment such as, "I have done what I wished / to do." But it is evi'dent that the reflective scissiparity in general has its (foundation in a project more profound than itself, a project which for lack of a better tenn we called "motiv~tion" in Part Two, Chapter III.

Now that we have defined cause and motive, it is necessary to give to this project which underlies reflection the name intention. To the extent therefore that the will is an instance of reflection, the fact of its being placed so as to act on the voluntary level demands for its foundation a more profound intention. It is not enough for the psychologist to describe a particular subject as realizing his project in the mode of voluntary reflection; the psychologist must also be capable of releasing to us the profound \ intention which makes the subject realize his project in this mode of volition rather than in a wholly different mode. Moreover, it must be clearly understood that any mode of consciousness whatsoever may have produced the same realization once the ends are posited by an original project. Thus we have touched on a more profound freedom than the will, simply by showing ourselves to be more exacting than the psychologists; that is, by raising the question "Why?" whereas they limit themselves to establishing the mode of consciousness as volitional.

This brief study does not attempt to exhaust the question of the will; on the contrary, it would be desirable to attempt a phenomenological description of the will for itself. But this is not our goal; we hope simply that we have shown that the will is not a privileged manifestation of freedom b

ut that it is a psychic event of a peculiar structure which is constituted on the same plane as other psychic events and which is supported, neither more nor less than the others, by an original, ontological freedom.

By the same token freedom appears as an unanalyzable totality; causes, motives, and ends, as well as the mode of apprehending causes, motives, and ends, are organized in a unity within the compass of this freedom and must be understood in tcrms of it. Does this mean that one must view freedom as a series of capricious jcrks comparable to the Epicurean elinamen? Am I free to wish anything whatsoever at any moment whatsoever? And must I at each instant when I wish to explain this or that project encounter the irrationality of a free and contingent choice? Inasmuch as it has seemed that the recognition of freedom had as its consequence these dangerous conceptions which are completely contradictory to experience. worthy thinkers have turned away from a belief in freedom. One could even state that determinism-if one were careful not to confuse it with fatalism-is "more human" than the theory of free will. In fact while detenninism throws into relief the strict conditioning of our acts, it does at least give the reason for each of them. And if it is strictly limited to the psychic, if it gives up looking for a conditioning in the ensemble of ....I.

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the universe, it shows that the reason for our acts is in our!:eIves: we act as we are, and OUT acts contribute to making us.

Let us consider more closely however the few certain results which oUr analysis has enabled us to attain. We have shown that freedom is actually one with the being of the For-itself; human reality is free to the exact extent that it has to be its own nothingness. It has to be this nothingness, as we have seen, in multiple dimensions: first, by temporalizing itself-i.e., by being always at a.distance from itself, which means that it can never let itself be determined by its past to perform this or that particular act; second, by rising up as consciousness of something and (of) itself-i.e., by being presenceto itself and not simply self, which implies that nothing exists in consciousness which is not consciousness of existing and that consequently nothing external to consciousness can motivate it; and finally, by being transcendence-i.e., not something which would first be in order subsequently to put itself into relation with this or that end, but on the contrary, a being which is originally a project-i.e., which is defined by its end.

Thus we do not intend here to speak of anything arbitrary or capricious. An existent which as consciousness is necessarily separated from all others because they are inconnect'ion with it only to the extent that they are for it, an existent which decides its past in the form of a tradition in the light of its future instead of allowing it purely and simply to determine its present, an existent which makes known to itself what it is by means of something other than it (that is, by an end which it is not and which it projects from the other side of the world)-this is what we call a free existent. This does not mean that I am free to get up or to sit down, to enter or to go out, to flee or to face danger-if one means by freedom here a pure capricious, unlawful, gratuitous, and incomprehensible contingency. To be sure, each One

of my acts, even the most trivial, is entirely
free in the sense which we have just defined; but this does not mean that
my act can be anything whatsoever or even that it is unforeseeable. Some-
one, nevertheless may object and ask how· if my act can be understood
neither in terms of the state of the world nor in terms of the ensemble of
my past taken as an irremediable thing, it could possibly be anything but
gratuitous. Let us look more closely.
Common opinion does not hold that to be free means only to choose
oneself. A choice is said to be free if it is such that it could have been
other than what it is. I start out on a hike with friends. At the end of
several hours· of walking my fatigue increases and finally becomes very
painful. At first I resist and then suddenly I let myself go, I give up, I
throw my knapsack down on the side of the road and let myself fall down
beside it. Someone will reproach me for my act and will mean thereby
that I was free-that is, not only was my act not determined by any
thing or person, but also I could have succeeded in resisting my fatigue

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longer, I could have done as my companions did and reached the rest-
ing place before relaxing. I shall defend myself by saying that I was too
tired. Who is right? Or rather is the debate not based on incorrect pre-
mises? There is no doubt that I could have done otherwise, but that is
not the problem. It ought to be formulated rather like this: could I have
done otherwise without perceptibly modifying the organic totality of
the projects which I am; or is the fact of resisting my fatigue such that
instead of remaining a purely local and accidental modification of my
behavior, it could be effected only by means of a radical transformation
of my being-in-the-wDrld-a transformation, moreover, which is possible?
In other words: I could have done otherwise. Agreed. But at what price?
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We are going to reply to this question by first presenting a theoretical
description which will enable us to grasp the principle of our thesis.
We shall see subsequently whether the concrete reality is not shown to be
more complex and wheth~r without contradicting the results- of our
theoretical inquiry, it will not lead us to enrich them and make them
I:,
more flexible.
Let us note first that the fatigue by itself could not provoke my decision.
As we saw with respect to physical pain, fatigue is only the way in which
I exist my body. It is not at first the object of a positional consciousness,
but it is the very f!lcticity of .my consciousness. If then I hike across the
country, what is revealed to me is the surrounding world; this is the object
of my consciousness, and this is what I transcend toward possibilities
which are my own-those, for example, of arriving this evening at the
place which I have set for myself in advance. Yet to the extent that I
apprehend this countryside with my eyes which unfold distances, my legs
which climb the hiIls and consequently cause new sights and new obstacles
to appear and disappear, with my back which carries the knapsack-to this
extent I have a non-positional consciousness (of) this body which rules
my relations with the world and which signifies my engagement in the
world, in the form of fatigue. Objectively and in correlation with this
non-thetic consciousness the roads are revealed as interminable, the slopes
as steeper, the sun as more burning,

etc. But I do not yet think of my
fatigue; I apprehend it as the quasi-object of my reflection. Nevertheless
there comes a moment when I do seek to consider my fatigue and to
recover it. We really ought to provide an interpretation for this same
intention; however, let us take it for what it is. It is not at all a contem-
plative apprehension of my fatigue; rather, as we saw with respect to pain,
I suffer my fatigue. That is, a reflective consciousness is directed upon my
fatigue in order to live it and to confer on it a value and a practical relation
to myself. It is only on this plane that the fatigue will appear to me as
bearable or intolerable., It will never be anything in itself, but it is the
reflective For-itself which rising up suffers the fatigue as intolerable.
Here is posited the essential question: my companions are in good
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health-like me; they have had practically the same training as I so that
although it is not possible to compare psychic events which occur in
different subjeetivities, I usually conclude-and witnesses after an objec-
tive consideration of our bodies-for-others conclude-that they are for.all
practical purposes "as fatigued as I am." How does it happen therefore
that they suffer their fatigue differently? Someone will say that the dif-
ference stems from the fact that I am a "sissy" and that the others are
not. But although this evaluation undeniably has a practical bearing on
the case and although one could take this into account when there arose
a question of deciding whether or not it would be a good idea to take me
on another expedition, such an evaluation can not satisfy us here. We have
seen that to be ambitious is to project conquering a throne or honors;
it is not a given which would incite one to conquest; it is this conquest
itself. Similarly to be a "sissy" can not be a factual given and is only a
name given to the way in which I suffer my fatigue. If therefore I wish
to understand under what conditions I can suffer a fatigue as unbearable,
it will not help to address oneself to so-called factual givens, which are
I;cvealed as being only a choice; it is necessary to attempt to examine this
choice itself and to see whether it is not explained within the perspective
of a larger choice in which it would be integrated as a secondary structure.
If I question one of my companions, he will explain to me· that he is
fatigued, of course, but that he loves his fatigue; he gives himself up to it
as to a bath; it appears to him in some way as the privileged instrument
for discovering the world which surrounds him, for adapting himself to
the rocky roughness of the paths, for discovering the "mountainous"
quality of the slopes. In the same way it is this light sunburn on the
back of his neck and this slight ringing in his ears which will enable him
to realize a direct contact. v:ith the sun. Finally the feeling of effort is
for him that of fatigue overcome. But as his fatigue is nothing but the
passion which he endures so that the dust of the highways, the burning of
the sun, the roughness of the roads may exist to the fullest, his effort
(i.e., this sweet familiarity with a fatigue which he loves, to which he
abandons himself and which nevertheless he himself directs) is given as
a way of appropriating the mountain, of suffering it to the end and being
victor over it. We shall see in the nex

t chapter what is the meaning' of
the word having and to what extent doing is a method of appropriating. __
Thus my companion's fatigue is Jived in a vaster project of a trusting
abandon to nature, of a passion consented to in order that it may exist
at full strength, and at the same time the project of sweet mastery
and appropriation. It is only in and through this project that the fatigue
will be able to be ll'llderstood and that it will have meaning for him.
But this meaning and this vaster, more profound project are still
by themselves unselbstandig. They are not sufficient. For they precisely
presuppose a particular relation of my companion to his body, on the

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one hand, and to things, on the other. It is easy to see, indeed, that there
are as many ways of existing one's body as there are For-itselfs although
naturally certain original structures are invariable and in each For-itself
constitute human-reality. We shall be concerned elsewhere with what is
incorrectly called the relation of the individual to space and to the condi-
tions of a universal truth. For the moment we can conceive in connection
with thousands of meaningful events that there is, for example, a certain
type of flight before facticity, a flight which consists precisely in abandon-
ing oneself to this facticity; that is, in short, in trustingly reassuming it and
loving it in order to try to recover it. This original project of recovery is
therefore a certain choice which the For-itself makes of itself in the pres-
ence of the problem of being. Its project remains a nihilation, but this
nihilation turns back upon the in-itself which it nihilates and expresses it-
self by a particular valorization of facticity. This is expressed especially
by the thousands of behavior patterns called abandon. To abandon oneself
to fatigue, to warmth, to hunger, to thirst, to let oneself fall back upon a
chair or a bed with sensual pleasure, to relax, to attempt to let oneself
be drunk in by one's own body, not now beneath the eyes of others
as in masochism but in the original solitude of the For-itself-none of
these types of behavior can ever be confined to .itself. We perceive this
clearly since in another person they irritate or attract. Their condition is an
initial project of the recovery of the body; that is, an attempt at a solution
of the problem of the absolute (of the In-itself-for-itself).
This initial form can itself be limited to a profound acceptance of
facticity; the project of "making oneself body" will mean then a happy
abandon to a thousand little passing gluttonies, to a thousand little desires,
a thousand little weaknesses. One may recall from Joyce's Ulysses Mr.
Bloom satisfying his natural needs and inhaling with favor "the intimate
odor rising from beneath him." But it is also possible (and this is the
case with my companion) that by means of the body and by compliance
to the body, the For-itself seeks to recover the totality of the non-can-
conscious-that is, the whole universe as the ensemble of material things.
In this case the desired synthesis of the in-itself with the for-itself will be
the quasi pantheistic synthesis of ~he totality of the in-itself with the
for-itself which recovers it. Here the body is the instrument of the synthe-
sis; it loses itself in fatigue, for example, in order that this in-itself may
exist to the fullest. And since it is the body whic

h the for-itself exists as
its own, this passion of the body coincides for the for-itself with the project of "making the in-itself exist." The ensemble of this attitude-which is that of one of my companions-can be expressed by the dim feeling of a kind of mission: he is going on this expedition because the mountain which he is going'\to climb and the forests which he is going to cross exist; his mission is to be the one by whom their meaning will be made

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manifest. Therefore he attempts to be the one who founds them in their very existence.

We shall return in the next chapter to this appropriative relation between the for-itself and the world, but we do not yet have ~t hand the elements necessary to elucidate it fully. In any case it is evident following our analysis that the way in which my companion suffers his fatigue necessarily demands-if we are to understand it-that we undertake a regressive analysis which will lead us back to an initial project. Is this project we have outlined finally selbstiindig? Certainly-and it can be easily proved to be so. In fact by going furt~er and further back we have rcached the original relation which the for-itself chooses with its facticity and with the world. But this original relation is nothing other than the for-itself's being-in-the-world inasmuch as this being-in-the-world is a choice-that is, we have reached the original type of nihilation by which the for-itself has to be its own nothingness. No interpretation of this can be attempted, for it would implicitly suppose the being.in-the-world of the for-itself just as all the demonstrations attempted by Euclid's Postulate implicitly suppose the adoption of this postulate.

Therefore if I apply this same method to interpret the way in which I suffer my fatigue, I shall first apprehend in myself a distrust of my body-for example, a way of wishing not "to have anything to do with it," wanting not to take it into account, which is simply one of numerous possible modes in which I can exist my body. I shall easily discover an analogous distrust with respect to the in-itself and, for example, an original project for recovering the in-itself which I nihilate through tIle intermediacy of others, which project in turn refers me to one of the initial projects w~ich we enumerated in our preceding discussion. Hence my fatigue instead of being suffered "flexibly" will be grasped "sternly" as an importunate phenomenon which I want to get rid of-and this simply because it incarnates my body and my brute con'tingency in the midst of the world at a time when my project is to preserve my body and my presence in the world by means of the looks of others. I am referred to myself as well as to my original project; that is, to my being-in-the-world in so far as this being is a choice.

We are not attempting to disguise how much this method of analysis leaves to be desired. This is because everything remains still to be done in this field. The problem indeed is to disengage the meanings implied by an act-by every act-and to proceed from there to richer and more profound meanings until we encounter the meaning \vhich does not imply any other meaning and which refers only to itself. This ascending dialectic is practiced spontaneously by most people; it can even be established that in knowledge of oneself or of another there is given a spontaneous comprehensio

n of this hierarchy of interpretations. A gesture refers to a
Weltanschauung and we sense it. But nobody has attempted a systematic

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disengagement of the meanings implied by an act. There is only one
school which has based its approach on the same original evidence as we,
and that is the Freudian. For Freud as for us an act can not be limited to
itself; it refers immediately to more profound structures. And psycho-
analysis is the method which enables us to make these structures explicit.
Freud like us asks: under what conditions is it possible that this particu-
lar person has performed this particular act? Like us he refuses to interpret
the action by the antecedent moment-i.e., to conceive of a horizontal
psychic determinism. The act appears to him symbolic; that is, it seems
to him to express a more profound desire which itself could be interpreted
only in terms of an initial determination of the subject's libido. Freud,
however, aims at constituting a vertical determinism. In addition because
of this bias his conception necessarily is going to refer to the subject's past.
Affectivity for Freud is at the basis of the act in the form of psycho-
physiological drives. But this affectivity is originally in each of us a tabula
rasa; for Freud the external circumstances and, so to speak, the history
of the subject will decide whether this or that drive will be fixed on this
or that object. It is the child's situation in the family which will determine
.in him the birth of the Oedipus complex; in other societies composed
of families of another type (such as, for example, among primitive
peoples on the Coral Islands in the Pacific) this complex could not be
formed. Furthermore it is again external circumstances which will decide
whether at the age of puberty this complex will be "resolved" or, on
the contrary, will remain the pole of the sexual life. Consequently through
tIle intermediacy of history Freud's vertical determinism remains axised
on an horizontal determinism. To be sure, a particular symbolic act ex-
presses an underlying, contemporaneous desire just as this desire manifests
a more profound complex and all this within the unity of a single psychic
process;' but the complex nonetheless pre-exists its symbolic manifesta-
tion. It is the past which has constituted it such as it is and in accordance
with the classic connections, transfer, condensation, etc., which we find
mentioned not only in psychoanalysis but in all attempts at a determin-
istic reconstruction of the psychic life. Consequently the dimension of
the future does not exist for p~ychoanalysis. Human reality loses onc of its
ekstases and must be interpreted solely by a regression toward the past
from the standpoint of the present. At the same time the fundamental
structures of the subject, which are signified by its acts, are not so signified
for him but for an objective witness who uses discursive methods to
make these meanings explicit. No pre-ontological comprehension of the
meaning of his acts is granted to the subject. And this is just, since in
spite of everything his acts are only a result of the past, which is on
principle out of reach, instead of seeking to inscribe their goal in the
future.
Thus we should restrict ourselves to taking the psychoanalytic metllOd

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as our inspiration; that is. we should attempt to d

isengage the meanings
of an act by proceeding from the principle that every action, no matter how trivial, is not the simple effect of the prior psychic state and does not result from a linear determinism but rather is integrated as a secondary structure in global structures and finally in the totality which I am. Otherwise. in fact, I should have to understand myself either as a horizontal flux of phenomena, each one of which is externally conditioned by the preceding-or as a supporting substance for a flow, a substance deprived of the meaning of its modes. Both these conceptions would lead us to confuse the for-itself with the in-itself.

But if we accept the method of psychoanalysis-and we shall discuss this at length in the following chapter-we must apply it in a reverse sense. Actually we conceive of every act as a comprehensible phenomenon, and we do not admit any deterministic "chance" as Freud does. But instead of understanding the considered phenomenon in terms of the past, we conceive of the comprehensive act as a turning back of the future toward the present. The way in which I suffer my fatigue is in no way dependent on the chance difficulty of the slope which I am climbing or On the more or less restless night which I have spent; these factors can contribute to constituting my fatigue itself but not to the way in which I suffer it. But we refuse to view this as one of Adler's disciples would, as an expres· sion of an inferiority complex, for ex:;unple, in the sense that this complex. would be a prior formation. 111at a certain passionate and tense way of struggling against the fatigue can express what is called an inferiority complex we shall not deny. But the inferiority complex itself is a project of my own for-itself in the world in the presence of the Other. As such it is always franscendence, as such again it is a way of choosing myself. This· inferiority which I struggle against and which nevertheless I recognize, this I have chosen from the start. No doubt it is indicated by my various "patterns of failure behavior"; but to be exact it is nothing other than the organized totality of my failure behavior, as a projected plan, as a general device of my being, and each attitude of failure is itself transcendence since each time I surpass the real toward my possibilities. To give in to fatigue, for example, is to transcend the path by causing it to constitute in itself the meaning of "a path too difficult to traverse." It is impossible seriously to consider the feeling of inferiority without determining it in terms of the future and of my possibilities. Even assertions such as "I am ugly," "I am stupid," etc. are by nature anticipations. We are not dealing here with the pure establishment of my ugliness but with the apprehension of the coefficient of adversity which is presented by women or by society to my enterprises. And this can be discovered only through and in the choice of these enterprises. Thus the inferiority complex is a free and global project of myself as inferior before others; it is the way in which I choose to assume my being-for-others, the free

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soluti~n :-vhich I give to the Other's existence, that insuperable scandal. ~us It IS necessary to understand my reactions of inferiority and my fallure behavior in terms of the free outline of my inferiority as a choice of myself in the world.

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We giant to

the psychoanalysts that every human reaction is a priori comprehensible. But we reproach them for having misunderstood just this initial "comprehensibility" as is shown by their trying to explain the reaction under consideration by means of a prior reaction, which would reintroduce causal mechanism; comprehension must be otherwise defined. Every project is comprehensible as a project of itself toward a possible. It is comprehensible first in so far as it offers a rational content which is immediately apprehensible-I place·-my knapsack on the ground in order to rest for a moment. This means that we immediately apprehend the possible which it projects and the end at which it aims. In the second place it is comprehensible in that the possible under consideration refers to other possibles, these to still others, and so on to the ultimate possibility which I am. The comprehension is effeded in two opposed senses: by a regressive psychoanalysis one ascends back from the considered act to my ultimate possible; and by a synthetic progression one redescends from this ultimate possible to the considered act and grasps its integration in the total form.

This form which we call our ultimate possibility is not just one possible among others-not even though it be, as Heidegger claims, the possibility of dying or of "no longer realizing any presence in the world." Every particular possibility, in fact, is articulated in an ensemble. It is necessary to conceive of this ultimate possibility as the unitary synthesis of all our actual possibles; each of these possibles resides in an undifferentiated state in the ultimate possibility until a particular circumstance comes to throw it into relief without, however, thereby suppressing its quality of belonging to the totality. Indeed we pointed out in Part Two that the perceptive apprehension of any object whatsoever is effected on the ground of the world.10 By this we meant that what the psychologists are accustomed to call "perception" can not be limited to objects which are strictly "seen" or "understood" etc. at a certain instant but that the objects considered refer by means of implications and various significations to the totality of the existent in-itself from the standpoint of which they are apprehended. Thus it is not true that I proceed by degrees from that table to the room where I am and then going out pass from there to the hall, to the stairway, to the street in order finally to conceive as the result of a passage to the limit, the world as the sum of all existents. ·Quite the contrary, I can not perceive any instrumental thing whatsoever unless it is in terms of the absolute existence of all existents, for my first being is being-in-the-world.

10 Part II, chapter III.

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Thus we find that for man in so far as "there are" things, there is in things a perpetual appeal toward the integration which makes us apprehend things by descending from the total integration which is immediately realized down to this particular structure which is interpreted only ~n relation to this totality. But on the other hand if there is a world, it IS because we rise up into the world suddenly and in totality. We have observed, in fact, in that same chapter devoted to transcendence, that the in-itself by itself alone is not capable of any unity as a world. But our upsurge is a passion in this sense that we lose

ourselves in nihilation
in order that a world may exist. Thus the first phenomenon of being in the world is the original relation between the totality of the in-itself or world and my own totality detotalized; I choose myself as a whole in the world which is a whole. Just as I come from the world to a particular "this," so I come from myself as a detotalized totality to the outline of one of my particular possibilities since I can apprehend a particular "this" on the ground of the world only on the occasion of a particular project of myself. But in this case just as I can apprehend a particular "this" only on the ground of the world by surpassing it toward this or that possibility, so I can project myself beyond the "this" toward this or that possibility only on the ground of my ultimate and total possibility. Thus my ultimate and total possibility, as the original integration of all my particular possibles, and the world as the totality which comes to existents by my upsurge ino being are two strictly correlative notions. I can perceive the hammer (i.e., outline a plan of "hammering" with it) only on the ground of the world; but conversely I can outline this act of "hammering" only on the ground of the totality of myself and in terms of that totality.

Thus the fundamental act of freedom is discovered; and it is this which gives meaning to the particular action which I can be brought to consider. This constantly renewed act is not distinct from my being; it is a choice of myself in the world and by the samc token it is a discovery of the world. This enables us to avoid the perilous reef of the unconscious which psychoanalysis meets at the start. If nothing is in consciousness which is not a consciousness of being, some win say to us by way of objection that then this fundamental choice must of necessity be a conscious choice. They will ask, "Can you maintain that when you yield to fatigue, you are conscious of all the implications which this fact supposes?" We shall reply that we are perfectly conscious of them. Only this consciousness itself must have for its limit the structure of consciousness in general and of the choice which we are making.

So far as the latter is concerned, we must insist on the fact that the question here is not of a deliberate choice. This is not because the choice is less conscious or less explicit than a deliberation but rather because it is the foundation of all deliberation and because as we have seen, a delib-

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eration requires an interpretation in terms of an original choice. Therefore it is necessary to defend,oneself against the illusion which would make of original freedom a positing of causes and motives as objects, then a decision from the standpoint of these causes and these motives. Quite the contrary, as soon as there are cause and motive (that is, an appreciation of things and of the structures of the world) there is already a positing of ends and consequently a choice. But this does not mean that the profound choice is thereby unconscious. It is simply one with the consciousness which we have of ourselves. This consciousness, as we know, can be only non-positional; it is we-as-consciousness since it is not distinct from our being. And as our being is precisely our original choice, the consciousness (of) the choice is identical with the self-consciousness which we have. One must be consc

ious in order to choose, and one must choose in
order to be conscious. -Choice and consciousness are one and the same
thing. This is what many psychologists have felt whcn they declared that
consciousness was "selection." But because they have not traced this selec-
tion back to its ontological foundation, they have remained on a level
in which the selection appeared as a gratuitous function of a consciousness
in other respects substantial. This reproach may in particular be leveled
against Bergson. But if it has been well established that consciousness
is a nihilation, the conclusion is that to be conscious of ourselves and to
choose ourselves are One and the same. This is the explanation of the
difficulties which moralizers like Gide have met when they wanted to
define the purity of the feelings. What difference is there, Gide asked, be-
tween a willed feeling and an experienced feeling?ll Actually there is no
difference. "To will to love" and to love are one since to love is to choose
oneself as loving by assuming consciousness of loving. If the .".6.s80 is free,
it is a choice.
Vie have remarked sufficiently-in particular in the chapter concerning
Temporality-that the Cartesian cogito must be extended. In fact, as we
have seen, to assume self-consciousness never means to assume a con-
sciousness of the instant; for the instant is only one view of the mind and
even if it existed, a consciousness which would apprehend itself in the
instant would no longer apprehend anything. I can assume consciousness
of myself only as a particular man engaged in this or that enterprise,
anticipating this or that success; fearing this or that result, and by means
of the ensemble of these anticipations, outlining his whole figure. Indeed
it is thus that I am apprehending ~yself at this moment when I am
writing; I am not the simple perceptive consciousness of my hand which
is making marks on the paper. I am well in advance of this hand all the
way to the completion of the book and to the meaning of this book-and
of philosophical activity in general-in my life. It is within the compass
of this project (i.e., within the compass of what I am) that there are
11 Journal des faux monnayeurs. (The Counterfeiters.)

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inserted ccrtain projccts toward more restricted possibilities such as that
of prescnting this or that idea in this or that way or of ceasing to write for
a moment or of paging through a volume in which I am looking for this
or that reference, etc. Nevertheless it would be an error to believe that
there is an analytical and differentiated consciousness corresponding to
this global choice. My ultimate and initial project-for these are but
one-is, as we shall see, always the outline of a solution of the problem
of being. But this solution is not first conceived and then realized; we
are this solution. We make it exist by means of our very engagement,
and therefore we shall be able to apprehend it only by living it. Thus we
arc always wholly present to ourselves; but precisely because we are wholly
present, we can not hope to have an analytical and detailed consciousness
of what we are. Moreover this consciousness can be only non-thetic.
On the other hand, the world by means of its very articulaticn refers
to us exactly the image of what we are. Not, as we have seen so many
times, that we can decipher this image-i.e., break it down a)ld subject it
to

analysis-but because the world necessarily appears to us as we are. In fact, it is by surpassing the world toward ourselves that we make it appear such as it is. We choose the world, not in its contexture as in-itself but in its meaning, by choosing ourselves. Through the internal negation by denying that we are the world, we make the world appear as world, and this internal negation can exist only if it is at the same time a projection toward a possible. It is the very way in which I entrust myself to the inanimate, in which I abandon myself to my body (or, on the other hand, the way in which I resist either one of these) which causes the appearance of both my body and the inanimate world with their respective value. Consequently there also I enjoy a full consciousness of myself and of my fundamental projects, and this time the consciousness is positional. Nevertheless, precisely because it is positional, whatit releases to me is the transcendent image of what I am. The value of things, their instrumental role, their proximity and real distance (which have no relation to their spatial proximity and distance) do nothing more than to outline my image-that is, my choice. My clothing (a uniform or a lounge suit, a soft or a starched shirt) whether neglected or cared for, carefully chosen or ordinary, my furniture, the street on which I live, the city in which I reside, the books with which I surround myself, the recreation which I enjoy, everything which is mine (that is, finally, the world of which I am perpetually conscious, at least by way of a meaning implied by the object which I look at or use) : all this informs me of my choice-that is, my being. But such is the structure of the positional consciousness that I can trace this knowledge back to a subjective apprehension of myself, and it refers me to other objects which I produce or which I dispose of in connection with the order of the preceding without being able to perceive that I am thus more and more sculpturing my figure in

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the world. Thus we are fully conscious of the choice which we are. And if someone objects that in accordance with these observations it would be necessary to be conscious not of our being-chosen but of choosing ourselves, we shall reply that this consciousness is expressed by the two-fold "feeling" of anguish and of responsibility. Anguish, abandonment, responsibility, whether muted or full strength, constitute the quality of our consciousness in so far as this is pure and simple freedom. Earlier we posed a question: I have yielded to fatigne, we said, and doubtless I could have done otherwise but at what price? At present we are in a position to answer this. Our analysis, in fact, has just shown us that this act was not gratuitous. To be sure, it was not explained by a motive or a cause conceived as the content of a prior state of consciousness, but it had to be interpreted in tenns of an original project of which it formed an integral part. Hence it becomes evident that we can not suppose that the act could have been modified without at the same time supposing a fundamental modification of my original choice of myself. This way of yielding to fatigue and of letting myself fall down at the side of the road expresses a certain initial stiffening against my body and the inanimate in-itself. It is placed within the compass of a certain view of the world in

which difficulties can appear "not worth the trouble of being tolerated"; or, to be exact, since the motive is a pure non-thetic consciousness and consequently an initial project of itself toward an absolute end (a certain aspect of the in-itself-for-itself), it is an apprehension of the world (warmth, distance from the city, uselessness of effort, etc.) as the cause of my ceasing to walk. Thus this possible-to stop-theoretical1y takes on its meaning only in and through the hierarchy of the possibles which I am in terms of the ultimate and initial possible. This does not imply that I must necessarily stop but merely that I can refuse to stop only by a radical conversion of my being-in-the-world; that is, by an abntpt metamorphosis of my initial project-i.e., by another choice of myself and of my ends. Moreover this modification is always possible.

The anguish which, when this possibility is revealed, manifests our freedom to our consciousness is witness of this perpetual modifiability of our initial project. In anguish we do not simply apprehend the fact that the possibles which we project are perpetually eaten away by our freedom-to-come; in addition we apprehend our choice-i.e., ourselves-as unjustifiable. This means that we apprehend our choice as not deriving from any prior reality but rather as being about to serve as foundation for the ensemble of significations which constitute reality. Unjustifiability is not only the subjective recognition of the absolute contingency of our being but also that of the interiorization and recovery of this contingency on our own account. For the choice-as we shall see-issues from the contingency of the in-itself which it nihilates and transports it to the

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level of the gratuitous determination of the for-itself by itself. Thus we are perpetually engaged in our choice and perpetually conscious of the fact that we ourselves can abruptly invert this choice and "reverse steam"; for we project the future by our very being, but our existential freedom' perpetually eats it away as we make known to ourselves what we are by means of the future but without getting a grip on this future which remains always possible without ever passing to the rank of the real. Thus we are perpetually threatened by the nihilation of our actual choice and perpetually threatened with choosing ourselves-and consequently with becoming-other than we are. By the sole fact that our choice is absolute, it is fragile; that is, by positing our freedom by means of it, we posit by the same stroke the perpetual possibility that the choice may become a "here and now" which has been made-past in the interests of a "beyond" which I shall be.

Nevertheless let us thoroughly understand that our actual choice is such that it furnishes us with no motive for makiilg it past by means of a further choice. In fact, it. is this original choice which originally creates all causes and all motives which can guide us to partial actions; it is this which arranges the world with its meaning, its instrumental-complexes, and its coefficient of adversity. The absolute change which threatens us from our birth until our death remains pcrpetually unpredictable and incomprehensible. Even if we envisage other fundamental attitudes as possible, we shall never consider them except from outside, as the behavior of Others. And if we attempt to refer our conduc

t to them,
they shall not for all that lose their character as external and ~s tran-
scended-transcendences. To "understand" them in fact would be already
to have chosen them. We are going to return to this point.
In addition we must not think of the original choice as "producing
itself from one instant to the next"; this would be to return to the instan-
taneous conception of consciousness from which Husser! was never able
to free himself. Since, on the contrary, it is consciousness which tem-
poralizes itself, we must conceive of the original choice as unfolding time
and being one with the unity of the three ekstases. To choose ourselves
is to nihilate ourselves; that is, to cause a future to come to make known
to us what we are by conferring a meaning on our past. Thus there is
not a succession of instants separated by nothingnesses-as with Descartes
-such that my choice at the instant t can not act on my choice of the
instant t. To choose is to effect the upsurge along with my engagement
of a certain finite extension of concrete and cont.inuous duration, which
is precisely that which separates me from the realization of my original
possibles. Thus freedom, choice, nihilation, temporalization are all one
and the same thing.
. Yet the instant is not an empty invention ofphilosophers. To be sure,
there is nO subjective o;nstant when I am engaged in my task. At this
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moment, for example, when I am writing and trying to grasp my ideas
and put them in order, there is no instant for me, there is only a perpetual
pursued-pursuit of myself toward the ends which define me (the making
expli.cit of ideas which are to form the basis of this work). And yet we
are perpetually threatened by the instant. That is, we are. such, by the
very choice of our freedom, that we can always cause the instant to appear
as the rupture of our ekstatic unity. What then is the instant? In the
process of temporalization the instant can not be cut off from a concrete
project; we have just shown this. But neither can it be identified with
the initial term or with the final term (if it is to exist) of this process.
For both of these terms are incorporated in the totality of the process
and are an integral part of it. Therefore neither term has the characteristics
of the instant. The initial term is incorporated in the process of which it
is the initial term in that it is the process' beginning. But on the other
hand, it is limited by a prior nothingness in that it is a beginning. The
final term is incorporated in the process which it terminates in that it is
the process' end; the last note belongs to the melody. But it is followed
by a nothingness which limits it in that it is an end. The instant if it is to
PJe able to exist, must be limited by a double nothingness. This is in no
way conceivab1e if it is to be given ahead of time to all the processes of
temporali7..ation-as we have shown. But in the very development of our
temporalization, we can produce instants if certain processes arise on the
collapse of prior processes. The instant will be then both a beginning and
an end. In short, if the end of one project coincides with the beginning of
another project, an ambiguous, temporal reality will arise which will be
limited by a prior nothingness in that it is a beginning and limited by a
posterior nothingness in that it is an end. But this temporal structure
will be

concrete only if the beginning is itself given as the end of the process which it is making-past. A beginning which is given as the end of a prior project-such must be the instant. It will exist therefore only if we are a beginning and an end to ourselves within the unity of a single act. Now it is precisely this which is produced in the case of a radical modification of our fundamental project. By the free choice of this modification, in fact, we temporalize a project which we are, and we make known to ourselves by a future the being which we have chosen; thus the pure present belongs to the new temporalization as a beginning, and it receives from the future which has just arisen its own nature as a beginning. It is the future alone, in fact, which can turn back on the pure present in order to qualify it as a beginning; otherwise this present would be merely any sort of present whatsoever. Thus the present of the choice belongs already, as an integral structure, to the newly begun totality. But on the other hand, it is not possible for this choice not to determine itself in connection with the past which it has to be. The chQice is even, on principle, a decision to apprehend as past the choice for which it is substituted. A

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converted atheist is not simply a believer; he is a believer who has for himself rejected atheism, who has made past within him the project of being an atheist. Thus the new choice is given as a beginning in so far as it is an end and as an end in so far as it is a beginning; it is limited by a double nothingness, and as such it realizes a break in the ekstatic unity of our being. However the instant is by itself only a nothingness, for wherever we cast our view, we apprehend only a continuous temporalization which will be in accordance with the direction in which we look: either the completed and closed series which has just passed dragging its final term with it-or else the living temporaliza#on which is beginning and whose initial term is caught and dragged along by the future possibility. Thus every fundamental choice defines the direction of the pursued-pursuit at the same time that it temporalizes itself. This does not mean that it gives an initial thrust or that there is something .settled-which I can exploit to my profit so long as I hold myself within the limits of this choice. On the contrary, the nihiIation is pursued continuously, and consequently the free and continuous recovery of the choice is obligatory. This recovery, however, is not made from instant to instant while I freely reassume my choice. This is because there is no instant. The recovery is so narrowly joined to the en'semble of the process that it has no instantaneous meaning and can not have any. But precisely because it is free and perpetually recovered by freedom, my choice is limited by freedom itself; that is, it is haunted by the specter of the instant. In so far as I shaJJ reassume my choice, the making-past of the process will be effected in perfect ontological continuity with the present. The process which is made-past remains organized with the present nihilation in the form of a practical knowing; that is, meaning which is lived and interiorized without ever being an object for the consciousness which projects itself toward its own ends. But precisely because I am free I always have the possibility of positing my immediate

past as an object. This means that even though
my prior consciousness was a pure non-positional consciousness (of) the past while it constituted itself as an internal negation of the co-present real and made its meaning known to itself by its ends posited as "re-assumed," now at the time of the new choice, consciousness posits its own past as an object; that is, it evaluates its past and takes its bearings in relation to it. This act of objectivizing the immediate past is the same as the new choice of other ends; it contributes to causing the instant to spring forth as the nihilating rupture of the temporalization.

It will be easier for the reader to understand the results obtained by this analysis if we compare them to another theory of freedom-for example, to that of Leibniz. For Leibniz as for us, when Adam took the apple it would have been possible for him not to take it, But for Leibniz as for us the implications of this gesture are so numerous and so ramified that ultimately to declare that it would have been possible
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for Adam not to take the apple amounts to saying that another Adam would have been possible. Thus Adam's contingency is the same as his freedom since this contingency means that this real Adam is surrounded by an infinity of possible Adams, each one of whom as compared to the real Adam is characterized by a slight or profound alteration of all his attributes; that is, ultimately, of his substance. For Leibniz, then, the freedom claimed by human reality is as the organization of three different notions: that man is free who (1) determines himself rationally to perform an act; (2) is such that this act is understood fully by the very nature of the one who has committed it; (3) is contingent-that is, exists in such a way that other persons committing other acts in connection with the same situation would have been possible. But because of the necessary connection of possibles, another gesture of Adam would have been possible only for and by another Adam, and the existence of another Adam implies that of another world. We recognize along with Leibniz that Adam's gesture engages his whole person and that another gesture could be understood ~>nly in the light of and within the compass of another personality in Adam. But Leibniz falls into a necessitarianism completely opposed to the idea of freedom when at the outset he establishes the assertion of the substance of Adam as a premise which will bring in the act of Adam as one of its partial conclusions; that is, when he reduces the chronological order to being only a symbolic expression of the logical order. The result is that on the one hand, the act is strictly necessitated by the very essence of Adam; also the contingency which according to Leibniz makes freedom possible is found wholly contained within the essence of Adam. And this essence is not chosen by Adam himself but by God. Thus it is true that the a·:t committed by Adam necessarily derives from Adam's essence ane that it thereby depends on Adam himself and on no other, which, to be sure, is one condition of freedom. But Adam's essence is for Adam himself a given; Adam has not chosen it; he could not choose to be Adam. Consequently he dbes not support the responsibility for his being. Hence once he himself has been given, it is of little importance that one can attribut~ to him the relative responsi

bility for his act.
For us, on the contrary, Adam is not defined by an essence since for human reality essence comes after existence. Adam is defined by the choice of his ends; that is,by the upsurge of an ekstatic temporalization which has nothing in common with the logical order. Thus Adam's contingency expresses the finite choice which he has made of himself. But henceforth what makes his person known to him is the future and not the past; he chooses to learn what he is by means of ends toward which he projects himself-that is, by the totality of his tastes, his likes, his hates, etc. inasmuch as there is a thematic organization and an inherent meaning in this totality. Thus we can avoid the objection which we offered to

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Leibniz when we said, "To be sure, Adam chose to take the apple, but he did not choose to be Adam." For us, indeed, the problem of freedom is placed on the level of Adam's choice of himself-that is, on the determination of essence by existence. In addition we recognize with Leibniz that another gesture of Adam, implying another Adam, implies another world; but by "another world" we do not mean a particular organization of co-possibles such that the other possible Adam finds his place there, rather that the revelation of another face of the world will correspond to another being-in-the-world of Adam.
Finally for Leibniz since the possible gesture of the other Adam is organized in another possible world, it pre-exists for all eternity-as possible-the realization of the contingent, real Adam. Here again essence precedes existence for Lcibniz, and the chronological order depends on the eternal order of logic. For us, on the contrary, the possible is only a pure and unformed possibility of another being such that it is not existed as possible by a new project of Adam toward new possibilities. Thus the possible of Leibniz remains eternally an abstract possible whereas for us the possible appears only by possibilizing itself; that is, by coming to announce to Adam what he is. Consequently the order of psychological explanation in the work of Leibniz goes from past to present to the same extent that this succession expresses the eternal order of essences; everything is finally fixed in a logical eternity, and the only contingency is that of principle, which means that Adam is a postulate of the divine understanding. For us, on the conHary, the order of interpretation is strictly chronological; it does [lot seek to reduce time to a purely logical concatenation (reason) or a chronological-logical (cause, determinism). It is interpreted therefore from the standpoint of the future.
But what we must especially insist on is that our preceding analysis is purely theoretical. In theory only, another gesture of Adam is possible and only within the limits of the total overthrow of the ends by which Adam chooses himself as Adam. We have presented things in this way-and hence we have been able to seem like Leibnizians-so as to present our view first with the maximum of simplicity. In actual fact reality is far more complex. This is because in reality the order of interpretation is purely chronological.and not logical; the understanding of an act in terms of the original ends posited by the freedom of the for-itself is not an inteIlection. And the descending hierarchy of possibles from the final and initial possible to the deri

ved possible which we are trying to under-
stand has nothing in common with the deductive series which goes from a principle to its consequence. First of all, the connection between the derived possible (to resist fatigue or to give into it) and the fundamental possible is not a connection of deductibility. It is the connection between a totality and a partial structure. The view of the total project enables one to "understand" the particular structure considered. But the Gestalt

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School has shown us that the pragnanz of the total forms does not exclude the variability of certain secondary structures. There are certain lines which I can add to or subtract from a given figure without altering its specific character. There are others, on the contrary, which cannot be added without involving the immediate disappearance of the figure and the appearance of another figure. The same thing is true with regard to the relation between the secondary possibles and the fundamental possi. ble or the formal totality of my possibles. The meaning of the second-ary possible considered refers always, to be sure, to the total meaning which r am. But other possibles could have replaced this One without altering the total meaning; that is, they could always and just as well have indicated this totality as the form which enables them to be under-stood-or in the ontological order of realization they could just as well have been projected as the means of attaining the totality and in the light of this totality. In short the act of understanding is the interpretation of a factual connection and not the apprehension of a necessity.
Thus the psychological interpretation of our acts must frequently re-turn to the Stoic· notion of "indifferents." To relieve my fatigue, it is indifferent whether I sit down on the side of the road or whether I take a hundred steps more in order to stop at the inn which I see from a distance. This ~eans that the apprehension of the complex, global form which I have chosen as my ultimate possible does not suffice to account for the choice of one possible rather than another. There is not here an act de-prived of motives and causes but rather a spontaneous invention of mo-tives and causes, which placed within the compass of my fundamcntal choice thereby enriches it. In the same way each "this" must appear on the ground of the world and in the perspective of my facticity, but neither my facticity nor the world allows us to understand why I pres-ently grasp this glass rather than this inkwell as a figure raising itself on the ground. In relation to these illdifferents our freedom is entire and un-conditioned. This fact of choosing one indifferent possible and then abandoning it for another will not cause the instant to surge up as the rupture of duration; on the contrary, these free choices are all integrated -even if they are successive and contradictory-in the unity of my funda-mental project. This does not mean that they are to be apprehended as gratuitous. In fact whatever they may be, they will always be interpreted in terms of the original choice; and to the extent that they enrich this choice and make it concrete, they will always bring with them their mo-tive-that is, the consciousness of their cause or, if you prefer, the appre-.hension of the situation as articulated in this or that way.
Another thing which will render the strict ap

preciation of the conneC-
tion between the secondary possible and the fundamental possible particularly delicate is the fact that there exists no a priori "ready-reckoner" to which one can refer in order to determine this connection. On the

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contrary, it is the for-itself which cheoscs to consider the secondary possible as indicative of the fundamental possible. Just where we have the impression that the free subject is turning his back on his fundamental goal, we often introduce the observer's coefficient of error; that is, we use our own scales to wcigh the relation between the act considered and the final ends. But the for-itself in its freedom invents not only primary and secondary ends; by the same stroke it invents the whole system of interpretation which allows their interconnections. In no case can there be a question of establishing a system of universal understanding of the secondary possibles in terms of the primary possibles: in every instance the subject himself must furnish his touchstone and his personal criteria. Finally the for-itself can make voluntary decisions which are opposed to the fundamental ends which it has chosen. These decisions can be only voluntary-that is, reflective. In fact they can derive only from an error committed either in good faith or in bad faith against the ends which I pursue, and this error can be committed only if the ensemble of motives which I am are discovered in the capacity of an object by the reflective consciousness. Since the unreflective consciousness is a spontaneous self-projection toward its possibilities, it can never be deceived about itself; one must take care not to hold it responsible for making a mistake regarding itself when the error is actually a false evaluation of the objective situation-an error which can bring into the world consequences absolutely opposed to those which the unreflective consciousness wanted to effect; without however there having been any misunderstanding of its proposed ends. The reflective attitude, on the contrary, involves a thousand possibilities of error, not in that it apprehends the pure motive -i.e., the consciousness reflected-on-as a quasi-object but in so far as it aims at constituting across that consciousness reflected-on veritable psychic object~ which are only probable objects, as we have seen in Part II, chapter III, and which can even be false objects. It is therefore possible for me as regards errors concerning myself to impose upon myself reflectively-i.e., on the voluntary plane-projects which contradict my initial project without, however, fundamentally modifying the initial project. Thus, for example, if my initial project aims at choosing myself as inferior in the midst of others (what is called the inferiority complex), and if stuttcring, for example, is a behavior which is understood and interprcted in terms of the primary project, I can for social reasons and through a misunderstanding of my own choice of inferiority decide to cure myself of stuttering. I can even succeed in it, yet without having ceased to feel myself and to will myself to be inferior. In fact I can obtain a result by using merely technical methods. This is what we usually call a voluntary self-reform. But these results will only displace the infirmity from which I suffer; another will arise in its place and will in its own way express the total

obtained. The
artist who wishes to be great and who chooses to be inferior intentionally maintains this gap; he is like Penelope and destroys by night wnat he makes by day. Thus with his artistic realizations he maintains himself constantly on the voluntary level and hence displays a desperate energy. But his very will is in bad faith; that is, it flees the recognition of the true ends chosen by the spontaneous consciousness, and it constitutes false psychic objects as motives in order to be able to deliberate concerning these motives and to determine itself in terms of them (the love of glory; the love of the beautiful, etc.). The will here is by no means opposed to the fundamental choice; quite the contrary it is understood in its ends and in its fundamental bad faith only within the perspective of a fundamental choice of inferiority. Whereas in the form of reflective consciousness the will constitutes in bad faith false psychic objects as motives, On the other hand in the capacity of a non-reflective and non-thetic self-consciousness, it is consciousness (of) being in bad faith and consequently (of) the fundamental project pursued by the for-itself. Thus the divorce between the spontaneous and willed consciousness is not a purely established factual given. OIl the contrary this duality is projected and initially realized by our fundamental freedom; it is conceived only in and through the profound unity of our fundamental project, which is to choose ourselves as inferior: But precisely, this divorce implies that the voluntary deliberation decides in bad faith to offset or to hide our inferiority by means of works whose inner goal is actually to enable us on the contrary to measure this inferiority.
Thus, as is seen, our analysis enables us to accept the two levels on which Adler places the inferiority complex: like him we admit a fundamental recognition of this inferiority, and like him we admit a heavy and ill-balanccd development of acts, work~, and statements designed to offset or to hide this deep feeling. But there are these differences: (1) We do not allow ourselves to conceive of the fundamental recognition as unconscious; it is so far from being unconscious that it even constitutes the bad faith of the will. Due to this fact we do not establish between the two levels considered the difference between the unconscious and the conscious, but rather that which separates the fundamental unreflective consciousness and its tributary, the consciousness reflected-on. (2) It sccms to us that the concept of bad faith-as we established in Part One -should rcplac:e those of the censor, repression, and the unconscious which Adler uses. (3) The unity of the consciousness such as it is revealed to the cogito is too profound fur us to admit a division into two levels unless the unity is recovered by a more profound synthetic
II
intention leading from one level to the other and unifying them. Con-
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sequently we feel that there is something of deeper significance than the
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inferiority complex itself; not only is the inferiority complex recognized, but this recognition is a choice. Not only does the will seek to hide this inferiority by means of shifting and feeble affirmations; a more profo'und intention traverses it and chooses precisely the feebleness and shiftiness of these affirmations with the intention of rendering mor

e noticeable
this inferiority which we claim to flee and which we shall experience in shame and in the feeling of failure. Thus the man who suffers from Minderwertigkeit has chm:en to be his own tormenter. He has chosen shame and suffering, which does not mean, however, that he is to experience any joy when they are most forcefully realized.
But if these new possibles are chosen in bad faith by a will which is produced within the limits of Our initial project, they must nevertheless be realized to a certain extent against the initial project. To the extent that we wish to hide our inferiority from ourselves precisely in order to create it, we can wish to overcome the timidity and the stuttering which on the spontaneous level manifest our initial project of inferiority. We shall then undertake a systematic and reflective effort to' cause these manifestations to disappear. We make this attempt in the state of mind of patients who come to consult the psychoanalyst. That is, on the one hand we work for an achievement which on the other hand we refuse. Thus the patient decides voluntarily to come to consult the psychoanalyst in order to be cured of certain troubles which he can no longer hide from himself; and by the mere fact that he puts himself in the hands of the physician he runs the risk of being cured. But on the other hand, if he runs this risk, it is in order to persuade himself that he has in vain done everything possible in order to be cured and that therefore he is incurable. Hence he approaches the psychoanalytic treatment with bad faith and bad will. All his efforts will have as their goal causing the attempt to fail although he voluntarily continues to lend himself to the enterprise. Similarly the psychasthenics whom Janet studied suffer from an obsession which they intentionally enter into and wish to be cured or. But, to be precise, their wiI to be cured has for its goal the confirmation of these obsessions as sufferings and consequently the realization of them in all their strength. We know the result; the patient can not confess his obsessions; he lies sobbing on the floor, but he does not determine himself to make the requisit.e confession. It would be useless to speak here of a struggle between the will and the disease; these processes unfold within the ekstatic unity of bad faith in a being who iswhat he is not and who is not what he is. Similarly when the psychoanalyst is close to grasping the initial project of the patient, the latter abandons the treatment or begins to lie. It would be uselesss to try to explain this resistance by a revolt or an unconscious anxiety. How then could the unconscious be informed of the progress of the psychoanalytical investigation unless precisely by being a consciousness? But if the patient plays the game to the end, it is necessary

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that he experience a partial cure; that is, there must be produced in him the disappearance of the morbid phenomena which have brought him to seek the help of the physician. Thus he will have chosen the lesser evil: having come in order to persuade himself that he is incurable, he is forced-in order to avoid apprehending his project in full light and consequently having to nihilate it and to become freely another project-he is forced to depart in full possession of the cure. Similarly the methods which I shall employ to cure myself of stuttering and

of timidity may
have been attempted in bad faith. Nonetheless the fact remains that I have been forced to recognize their efficacy. In this case the timidity-and the stuttering will disappear; it is the lesser evil. An artificial and voluble assurance will come to replace them. But it is the same with these cures as it is with the cure of hysteria by electric shock treatment. We know that this therapy can effect the disappearance of an hysterical contraction of the leg, but as one will see, some time later the contraction will appear in the arm. This is because the hysteria can be cured only as a totality, for it is a total project of the for-itself. Partial medications only succ~ed in displacing the manifestations. Thus the cure of the timidity or of the stuttering is consented to and chosen in a project which extends to the appearance of other troubles-for example, to the realization of a foolish and equally unbalanced self-assurance.
Since the upsurge of a voluntary decision finds its motive in the fundamental free choice of my ends, it can attack these ends in appearance only. It is therefore only within the compass of my fundamental project that the will can be efficacious; and I can be "freed" from my "inferiority complex" only by a radical modification of my project which could in no way find its causes and its motives in the prior project, not even in the suffering and shame which I experience, for the latter are designed expressly to realize my project of inferiority. Thus so long as I am "in" the inferiority complex, lean not even conceive of the possibility of getting out of it. Even if I dream of getting out of it, the precise function of this dream is to make me experience even further the abjection of my state; it can be interpreted therefore only in and through the intention which makes me inferior. Yet at each moment I apprehend this initial choice as contingent and unjustifiable; at each moment therefore I am on the site suddenly to consider it objectively and consequently to surpass it and to make-it-past by causing the liberating instant to arise. Hence my anguish, the fear. which I have of being suddenly exorcized (i.e., of becoming radically other); but hence also the frequent upsurge of "conversions" which cause me totally to metamorphose my original project. These conversions which have not been studied by philosophers, have often inspired nove1ists.u One may recall the instant at which Gide's
12 Sartre seems not to bave read or to have forgotten William James, The Varieties of Religious Experience. Tr.

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Philoctetes casts off his hate, his fundamental project, his reason for being, and his being. One may recall the instant when Raskolnikoff decides to give himself up. These extraordinary and marvelous instants when the prior project collapses into the past in the light of a new project which rises on its ruins and which as yet exists only in outline, in which humiliation, anguish, joy, hope are delicately blended, in which we let go in order to grasp and grasp in order to let go-these have often appeared to furnish the clearest and most moving image of our freedom. But they are only one among others of its many manifestations.
Thus presented, the "paradox" of the inefficacy of voluntary decisions will appear less offensive. It amounts to saying that by means of the will, we can construct ourselves entirely, b

ut that the will which presides over
this construction finds its meaning in the original project which it can appear to deny, that consequently this construction has a function wholly different from that which it advertises, and that finally it can reach only details of structures and will never modify the original project from which it has issued any more than the consequences of a ,theorem can tum back against it and change it.

At the end of this long discussion, it seems that we have succeeded in making a little more precise our ontological understanding of freedom. It will be well at present to gather together and summarize the various results obtained.

(1) A first glance at human reality informs us that for it being is reduced to doing. The psychologists of the nineteenth century who pointed out the "motor" structures of drives, of the attention, of perception, etc. were right. But motion itself is an act. Thus we find no given in human reality in the sense that temperament, character, passions, principles of reason would be acquired or innate data existing in the manner of things. The empirical consideration of the human being shows him as an organized unity of conduct patterns or of "behaviors." To be ambitious, cowardly, or irritable is simply to conduct oneself in this or that matter in this or that circumstance. The Behaviorists were right in considering that the sole positive psychological study ought to be of conduct in strictly defined situations. Just as the work of Janet and the Gestalt School have put us in a position to discover types of emotional conduct, so we ought to speak of types of perceptive conduct since perceptionis never conceived outside an attitude with respect to the world. Even the disinterested attitude of the scientist, as Heidegger has shown, is the assumption of a disinterested position with regard to the object and consequently one conduct among others. Thus human reality does not exist first in order to act later; but for human reality, to be is to act, and to cease to act is to cease to be.

(2) But if human reality is action, this means evidently that its determination to action is itself action. If we reject this principle, and if we

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admit that human reality can be determined to action by a prior state of the world or of itself, this amounts to putting a given at the beginning of the series. Then these acts disappear as acts in order to give place to a series of movements. Thus the notion of conduct is itself destroyed with Janet and with the Behaviorists. The existence of the act implies its autonomy.

(3). Furthermore, if the act is not pure motion, it must be defined by an intention. No matter how this intention is considered, it can be only a surpassing of the given toward a result to be obtained. This givcn, in fact, since it is pure presence, can not get out of itself. Precisely because it is, it is fully and solely what it is. Therefore it can not provide the reason for a phenomenon which derives all its meaning from a result to be attained; that is, from a non-existent. When the psychologists, for example, view the drive as a factual state, they do not see that they are removing from it all its character as an appetite (ad-petitio). In fact, if the sexual drive can be differentiated from the desire to sleep, for example, this can be only by means of its end, and this end doe

s not exist. Pyscholo-
gists ought to have asked what could be the ontological structure of a phenomenon such that it makes known to itself what it is by means of something which does not yet exist. The intention, which is the fundamental structure of human-reality,' can in no case be explained by a given, not even if it is presented as an emanation from a given. But if one wishes to interpret the intention by its end, care must be taken not to confer on this end an existence as a given. In fact if we could admit that the end is given prior to the result to be attained, it would then be necessary to concede to this end a sort of being-in-itself at the heart of its nothingness and an attractive virtue of a truly magical type. Moreover we should not succeed any better in understanding the connection between a given human reality and a given end than in understanding the connection between consciousness-substance and reality-substance in the realists' . arguments. If the drive or the act is to be interpreted by its end, this is because the intention has for its structure positing its end outside itself. Thus the intention makes itself be by choosing the end which makes it known.

(4) Since the intention)s a choice of the end and since the world reveals itself across our conduct, iUs the intentional choice of the end .which reveals the world, and theworlcl is revealed as this or that' (in this or that· order) according to the end chosen. The end, illuminating the world, is a state of the world to be obtained and not yet existing. The intention is a thetic consciousness of the end. But it can be so only by making itself a non-thetic consciousness of its own possibility. Thus my end can be a good meal if I am hungry. But this meal which beyond the dusty road on which I am traveling is projected as the meaning of this road (it goes toward a hotel where the table is set, where' the dishes are prepared,

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where I am expected, etc.) can be apprehended only correlatively with my non-thetic project toward my own possibility of eating this meal. Thus by a double but unitary upsurge the intention illuminates the world in terms of an end not yet existing and is itself defined by the choice of its possible. My end is a certain objective state of the world, my possible /" is a certain structure of my subjectivity; the one is revealed to the thetic consciousness, the other flows back over the non-thetic consciousness in order to characterize it.

(5) If the given can not explain the intention, it is necessary that the intention by its very upsurge realize a rupture with the given, whatever this may be. Such must be the case, for otherwise we should have a present plenitude succeeding in continuity a present plenitude, and we could not prefigure the future. Moreover, this rupture is necessary for the appreciation of the given. The givcn, in fact, could never be a cause for an action if it were not appreciated. But this appreciation can be realized only by a withdrawal in relation to the given, a putting of the given into parentheses, which exactly supposes a break in continuity. In addition, the appreciation if it is not to be gratuitous, must be effccted in the light of something. And this something which serves to appreciate the given can be only the end. Thus the intention by a single.unitary upsurge posits the end, chooses itself, and appreciates the

given in terms of' the end.
Under these conditions the given is appreciated in terms of something which does not yet exist; it is in the light of non-being that being-in-itself is. illuminated. There results a double nihilating coloration of the given; on the one hand, it is nihilated in that the rupture makes it lose all efficacy over thc intention; on the other hand, it undergoes a new nihilation due to the fact that efficacy is returned to it in terms of a nothingness appreciation. Since human reality is act, it can be conceived only as being at its core a rupture with the given. It is the being which causes there to be a given by breaking with it and illuminating it in the light of the not-yet-existing.
(6) The necessity 011 the part of the given to appear only within the compass of a nihilation which reveals it is actually the same as the internal negation which we described in Part Two. It would be in vain to ima~ine that consciousness can exist without a given; in that case it· would be consciousness (of) itself as consciousness of noth;d~-that is, absolute nothingness. But if consciousness exists in terms of the given, this does not mean that the given conditions consciousness; consciousness is a pure and simple negation of the given, and it exists as the disengagement from a certain existing given and as an engagement toward a certain not yet cxisting end. But in addition this internal negation can be only the fact of a being which is in perpetual withdrawaUn relation to itself. If this being were not its own negation, it would be what it is-i.e., a pure and simple given. Due to this fact it would have no connection with any

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other datum since the given is by nature only what it is. Thus' any possibilityof the appeilrance of a world would ~e excluded. In order not to be a given, the for-itself must perpetually constitute itself as in withdrawal in relation to itself; that is, it must leave itself behind it as a datum which it already no longer is. This characteristic of the for-itself implies that it is the being which finds no help, no pillar of support in what it was. But on the other hand, the for-itself is free and can cause there to be a world because the for-itself is the being which has to be what it was in the light of what it will be. Therefore the freedom of the for-itself appears as its being. But since this freedom is neither a given nor a property, it can be only by choosing itself. The freedom of the for-itself is always engaged; there is no question here of a freedom which could be undetermined and which would pre-exist its choice. We shall never apprehend ourselves except as a choice in the making. But freedom is simply the fact that this choice is always unconditioned.
(7) Such a choice made without base of support and dictating its own causes to itself, can very well appear absurd, and in fact it is absurd. This is because freedom is a c1lOice of ;ts being but not the foundation of its being. We shall return to this relation between freedom and facticity in the course of this chapter. For the moment it will suffice us to say that human-reality can choose itself as it intends but is not able not to choose itself. It can not even refuse to be; suicide, in fact, is a choice and affirmation-of being. By this being which is given to it, human reality participates in the universal contingency of being and there

by in what we may
call absurdity. This choice is absurd, not because it is without reason but because there has never been any possibility of not choosing oneself. Whatever the choice may be, it is founded and reapprehcnded by being, for it is choice which is. But what must be noted here is that this choice is not .absurd in the sense in which in a rational universe a phenomenon might arise which would not be bound to others by any reasons. It is absurd in this sense-that the choice is that by which all foundations and all reasons come into being, that by which the very notion of the absurd receives a meaning. It is absurd as being beyond all reasons. Thus freedom is not pure and simple contingency in so far as it turns back toward its being in order to illuminate its being in the light of its end. It is the perpetual escape from contingency; it is the interiorization, the nihilation, and the subjectivizing of contingency, which thus modified passes wholly into the gratuity of the choice.
(8) The free project is fundamental, for it is my being. Neither ambition nor the passion to be loved nor the inferiority complex can be considered as fundamental projects. On the contrary, they of necessity must be understood in terms of a primary project which is recognized as the project which can no longer be interpreted in terms of any other and which is total. A special phenomenological method will be necessary in

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order to make this initial project explicit. This is what we shall call existential psychoanalysis. We shall speak of this in the next chapter. For the present we can say that the fundamental project which I am is a project concerning not my relations with this or that particular object in the world, but my total being-in-the-world; since the world itself is revealed only in the light of an end, this project posits for its end a certain type of relation to being which the for-itself wills to adopt. This project is not instantaneous, for it can not be "in" time. Neither is it non-temporal in order to "give time to itself" afteIWards. That is why we reject Kant's "choice of intelligible character." The structure of the choice necessarily implies that it be a choice in the world. A choice which would be a choice in terms of nothing, a choice against nothing would be a choice of nothing and would be annihilated as choice. There is only phenomenal choice, provided that we understand that the phenomenon is here the absolute. But in its very upsurge, the choice is temporalized since it causes a future to come to illuminate the present and to constitute it as a present by giving the meaning of pa~tl1ess to the in-itself "data." However we need not understand by this that the fundamental project is coextensive with the entire "life" of the for-itself. Since fre~dom is a being-without-support and without-a-springboard, the project in order to be must be constantly renewed. I choose myself perpetually and can never be merely by virtue of having-been-chosen; otheIWise I should fall into the pure and simple existence of the in-itself. The necessity of perpetually choosing myself is one with the pursued-pursuit which r am. But precisely because here we are dealing with a c1lOice, this choice as it is made indicates in gcneral other choices as possibles. The possibility of these other choices is neither made cxplicit nor posited, but it is li

ved in the feeling of unjustifiability;
and it is this which is expressed by the fact of the absurdity of my choice
and consequently of my being. Thus my freedom eats away my freedom.
Since I am free, I project my total possible, but I thereby posit that I am
free and that I can always nihilate this first project and make it past.
Thus at the moment at which the for-itself thinks to apprchend itself
and make known to itself by a projected nothingness what it is, it escapes
itself; for it thereby posits that it can be other than it is. It will be enough
for it to make explicit its unjustifiability in order to cause the instant to
arise; that is, the appearance of a new project on the coilapse of the former.
Nevertheless this upsurge of the new project has for its exprcss condition
the nihilation of the fonner, and hence the for-itself can not confer on
itself a new existence. As soon as it rejects the project which has lapsed
into the past, it has to be this project in the form of the "was"; this means
that this lapsed project belongs henceforth to the for-itself's situation.
No law of being can assign an a priori number to the different projects
which I am. The existence of the for-itself in fact conditions its essence.
But it is necessary to consult each man's history in order to get from it
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a particular idea with regard to each indivii'ual for-itself. Our particular
projects, aimed at the realization in the world of a particular end, are
united in the global project which we are. But precisely because we are
wholly choice and act, these partial projects are not determined by the
global project. They must themselves be choices; and a certain margin
of contingency, of unpredictability, and of the absurd is allowed to each
of them although each project as it is projected is the specification of the
global project on the occasion of particular elements in the situation
and so is always understood in relation to the totality of my being-in-the:
world.
With these few observations we think that we have described the free-
dom of the for-itself in its original existence. But it will have been ob-
served that this freedom requires a given, not as its condition but for
other sound reasons. First, freedom is conceived only as the nihilation of
a given (5); and to the extent that it is an internal negation and a con-
sciousness, it participates (6) in the necessity which prescribes that con-
sciousness be consciousness of something. In addition freedom is the. free-
dom of choosing but not the freedom of not choosing. Not to choose is,
in fact, to choose not to choose. The result is that the choice is the
foundation of being-chosen but not the foundation of choosing. Hence
the absurdity (7) of freedom. There again we are referred to a given
which is none other than the very facticity of the for-itself. Finally the
global project while illuminating the world in its totality can be made
specific 011 the occasion of this or that element of the situation and con-
sequently of the contingency of the world. All these remarks therefore
refer us to a difficult problem: that of the relation of freedom to facticity.
Moreover we shall inevitably meet other concrete objections. Can I
choose to be tall if I am short? To have two arms if I have only one?
etc. These depend on the "limitations" which my factual situation would
impose on my free choice of mysel

f. It will be well therefore to examine
the other aspect of freedom, its "reverse side:" its relation to facticity.

II. FREEDOM AND FACTICITY : THE SITUATION

THE decisive argument which is employed by common sense against freedom consists in reminding us of our impotence. Far from being able to modify our situation at our whim, we seem to be unable to change ourselves. I am not "free" either to escape the lot of my class, of my nation, of my family, or even to build up my own power or my fortune or to conquer my most insignificant appetites or habits. I am born a worker, a Frenchman, an hereditary syphilitic, or a tubercular. The history of a life, whatever it may be, is the history of a failure. The coefficient of adversity of· things is such that years of patience are necessary to obtain the feeblest result, Again it is necessary "to obey nature in order to com-

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mand it"; that is, to insert my action into the network of detenhinism. Much more than he appears "to make himself," man seems "to be made" by climate and the earth, race and class, language, the history of the collectivity of which he is a part, heredity, the individual circumstances of his childhood, acquired habits, the great and small events of his life.

This argument has never greatly troubled the partisans of human freedom. Descartes, first of all, recognized both that the will is infinite and that it is necessary "to try to conquer ourselves rather than fortune." Here certain distinctions ought to be made. Many of t~e facts set forth by the determinists do not actually deserve to enter into our considerations. In particular the coefficient of adversity in things can not be an argument against our freedom, for it is by us-i.e., by the preliminary positing of an end-that this coefficientof adversity arises. A particular crag, which manifests a profound resistance if I wish to displace it, will be on the contrary a valuable aid if I want to climb upon it in order to look over the countryside. In itself-if one can even imagine what the crag can be in itself-it is neutral; that is, it waits to be illuminated by an end in order to manifest itself as adverse or helpful. Again it can manifest itself in one or the other way only within an instrumental-complex which is already established. Without' picks and piolets, paths already worn, and a technique of climbing, the crag would be neither easy nor difficult to climb; the question would not be posited, it would not support any relation of any kind with the technique of mountain climbing. Thus although brute things (what Heidegger calls "brute existents") can from the start limit our freedom of action, it is our freedom itself which must first constitute the framework, the technique, and the ends in relation to which they will manifest themselves as limits. Even if the crag is revealed as "too difficult to climb," and if we must give up the ascent, let us note that the crag is revealed as such only because it was originally grasped as "climbable"; it is therefore our freedom which constitutes the limits which it will subsequently encounter.

Of course, even after all these observations, there remains an unnamable and unthinkable residuum which belongs to the in-itself considered and which is responsible for the fact that in a world illuminated by our freedom, this particular crag will be more favorable for scaling and that

one not. But this residue is far from being originally a limit for freedom; in fact, it is thanks to this residue-that is, to the brute in-itself as such -that freedom arises as freedom. Indeed common sense will agree with us that the being who is said to be free is the one who can realize his projects. But in order for the act to be able to allow a realization, the simple projection of a possible end must be distinguished a priori from the realization of this end. If conceiving is enough for realizing, then I am plunged in a world like that of a dream in which the possible is no longer in any way distinguished from the real. I am condemned hence-

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forth to see the world modified at the whim of the changes of my consciousness; I can not practice in relation to my conception the "putting into brackets" and the suspension of judgment which will distinguish a simple fiction from a real choice. If the object appears as soon as it is simply conceived, it will no longer be chosen or merely wished for. Once the distinction between the simple wish, the representation which I could choose, and the choice is abolished, freedom disappears too. We are free when the final term by which we make known to ourselves what we are is an end; that is, not a real existent like that which in the supposition which we have made could fulfill our wish, but an object which does not yet exist. But consequently this end can be transcendent only if it is separated from us at the same time that it is accessible. Only an ensemble of real existents can separate us from this end-in the same way that this end can be conceived only as a state to-come of the real existents which separate me from it. It is nothing but the outline of an order of existents -that is, a series of dispositions to be assumed by existents on the foundation of their actual relations. By the internal negation, in fact, the for-itself illuminates the existents in their mutual relations by means of the end which it posits, and it projects this end in terms of the determinations which it apprehends in the existent. There is no circle, as we have seen, for the upsurge of the for-itself is effected at one stroke. But if this is the case, then the very order of the existents is indispensable to freedom itself. It is by means of them that freedom is separated from and reunited to the end which it pursues and which makes known to it what it is. Consequently the resistance which freedom reveals in the existent, far from being a danger to freedom, results only in enal>ling it to arise as freedom. There can be a free for-itself only as engaged in a resisting world. Outside of this engagement the notions of freedom, of determinism, of necessity lose all meaning.

In addition it is necessary to point out to "common sense" that. the· formula "to be free" does not mean "to obtain what one has wished" but rather "by oneself to determine oneself to wish" (in the broad sense of choosing). In other words success is not important to freedom. The discussion which opposes common sense to philosophers stems here from a misunderstanding: the empirical and popular concept of "freedom" which has been produced by historical, political, and moral circumstances is equivalent to "the ability to obtain the ends chosen." The technical and philosophical concept of freedom, the only one which we are considering here, means o

nly the autonomy of choice. It is necessary, however, to
note that the choice, being identical with acting, supposes a commence-
ment of realization in order that the choice may be distinguished from
the dream and the wish. Thus we shall not say that a prisoner is always
free to go out of prison, which would be absurd, nor that he is always
free to long for release, which would be an irrelevant truism, but that he

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is always free to try to escape (or get himself liberated); that is, that
whatever his condition may be, he can project his escape and learn the
value of his project by undertaking some action. Our description of free-
dom, since it does not distinguish between choosing and doing, compels
us to abandon at once the distinction between the intention and the act.
The intention can no more be separated from the act than thought can
be separated from the language which expresses it; and as it happens
that our speech informs us of our thought, so our acts will inform us of
our intentions-that is, it will enable us to disengage our intentions, to
schematize them, and to make objects of them instead of limiting us to
living them-i.e., to assume a non-thetic consciousness of them. This
essential distinction between the freedom of choice· and the freedom
of obtaining was certainly perceived by Descartes, following Stoicism. It
puts an tnd to all arguments based on the distinction between "willing"
and "being able," which are still put forth today by the partisans and the
opponents of freedom.
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His nonetheless true that freedom encounters or seems to encounter
limitations on account of the given which it surpasses or nihilates. To
show that the coefficient of adversity of the thing and its character as an
obstacle (joined to its character as an instrument) is indispensable to the
existence of a freedom is to use an argument that cuts two ways; for
while it enables us to establish that freedom is not invalidated by the
given, it indicates, on the other hand, something like an ontological
conditioning of freedom. Would it not be reasonable to say, along with
certain contemporary philosophers: if no obstacle, then no freedom?
And as we can not admit that freedom by itself creates its own obstacle-
which would be absurd for anyone who has understood the meaning of
spontaneity-there seems to be here a kind of ontological priority of the
in-itself over the for-itself. Therefore we must consider the previous re-
marks as simple attempts to clear the ground, and we must take up
again from the beginning the question of facticity.
\Ve have established that the for-itself is free. But this does not mean
that it is its own foundation. If to be free meant to be its own foundation,
it would be necessary that freedom should decide the existence of its
being. And this necessity can be understood in two ways. First, it would
be necessary that freedom should decide its being-free; that is, not only
that it should be a choice of an end, but that it should be it choice of
itself as freedom. This would suppose therefore that the possibility of
being-free and the possibility of not-being-free exist equally before the .
free choice of either one of them-i.e., before the free choice of freedom.
But since then a previous freedom would be necessary which would choose
to be free-i.e., basically, which would choose to be what it is already-
we should be refer

l production from the standpoint of noth-
ingness can be only being-in-itself.
We have proved elsewhere in Part One of this work that nothingness can appear nowhere except at the heart of being. Here we add also the demands of common sense: empirically we can be free only in relation to a state of things and in spite of this state of things. I will be said to be free in relation to this state of things when it does not constrain me. Thus the empirical and practical concept of freedom is wholly negative; it issues from the consideration of a situation and establishes that this situation leaves me free to pursue this or that end. One might say even that this situation conditions my freedom in this 'Sense, that the situation is there in order not to constrain me. Remove the prohibition to circulate in the streets after the curfew, and what meaning can there be for me to have the freedom (which, for example, has been conferred on me by a pass) to take a walk at night?
Thus freedom is a lesser being which supposes being in order to elude it. It is not free not to exist or not to be free. We are going. to grasp immediately the connection of these two structures. In fact, as freedom is the escape from being, it could not produce itself laterally alongside being and in a project of "surveying;" one can not escape from a gaol in which one is not imprisoned. A projection of the self on the margin of being can in no way constitute itself as the nihilation of this being. Freedom is ,the escape from an engagement in being; it is the nihilation of a being which it is. This does not mean that human-reality exists first, to be free subsequently. "Subsequently" and "first" are terms created by freedom ~tse1f. The upsurge of freedom is effected by the double nihilation of the being which it is and of the being in the midst of which it is. Naturally freedom is not this being in the sense of being-in-itself. But by freedom's illuminating insufficiencies in the light of the end chosen, there is this being which is its own. Freedom has to be behind itself this being which it has not chosen; and precisely to the extent that it tumsback upon it in order to illuminate it, freedom causes this being which is its own to appear in relation with the plenum of being-that is, to exist in the midst of the world. We said that freedom is not free not to be free and that it is not free not to exist. This is because the fact of not being able not to be free is the facticity of freedom, and the fact of not being able not to exist is its contingency. Contingency and facticity are really one; there is a being which freedom has to be in the fonn of non-being (that is, of nihilation). To exist as the fact of freedom or to have to be, a being in the midst of the world are one and the same thing, and this means that freedom is originally a relation to the given.
But what is this relation to the given? Are we to understand by this that the given (the in-itself) conditions freedom? Let us look more closely. The given does not cause freedom (since it can produce only the

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given) nor is it the reason of freedom (since all "reason" comes into the world through freedom). Neither is it the necessary condition of free~ dom since we are on the level of pure contingency. Neither is it an indis~ pensable matter on which freedom must exercise itself, for this wopld be to suppose that fre

edom exists ready-made as an Aristotelian form or
as a Stoic Pneuma and that it looks for a matter to work in. The given in
no way enters into the constitution of freedom since freedom is interi-
orized as the internal negation of the given. It is simply the pure con-
tingency which freedom exerts by denying the given while making itself
a choice; the given is the plenitude of being which freedom colors with
insufficiency and with negatite by illuminating it with the light of an end
which does not exist. The given is freedom itself in so far as freedom
exists; and whatever it does, freedom can not escape its existence. The
reader will have understood that this given is nothing other than the in-
itself nihilated by the for-itself which has to be it, that the body as a point
of view on the world, that the past as the essence which the for-itself
was-that these are three designations for a single reality. By its nihiJat-
ing withdrawal, freedom causes a whole systcm of relations to be estab-
lished, from the point of view of the end, between all in-itselfs; that is,
between the plenum of being which is revealed then as the world and
the being which it has to be in the midst of this plenum and which is
revealed as one being, as one "this" which it has to be.
Thus by its very projection toward an end, freedom constitutes as a
being in the midst of the world a particular datum which it has to be.
Freedom does not choose it, for this would be to choose its own existence;
but bv the choice which it makes of its end, freedom causes the datum to
be re~'ealed in this or that way, in this or that light in connection with
the revelation of the world itself. Thus the very contingency of freedom
and the world which surrounds this contingency with its own contingency
will appear to freedom only in the light of the end which it has chosen;
that is, not as brute existents but in the unity of the illumination of a
single nihilation. And freedom would never be able to reapprehend this
ensemble as a pure datum, for in that case it would be necessary that
this freedom be outside of all choice and therefore that it should cease
to be freedom. 'Ve shall use the term situation for the contingency of
freedom in the plenum of being of the world inasmuch as this datum,
which is there only in order not to constrain freedom, is revealed to this
freedom only as already illuminated by the end which freedom chooses.
Thus the datum never appears to the for-itself as a brute existent in-itself;
it is discovered always as a cause since it is revealed only in the light
of an end which illuminates it. Situation and motivation are really one.
The for-itself discovers itself as engaged in being, hemmed in by being,
threatened by being; it discovers the state of things which surrounds it as
the cause for a reaction of defense or attack. But it can make this discovery

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only because it freely posits the end in relation to which the state of
things-is threatening or favorable.
These observations should show us that the situation, the common
product of the contingency of the in-itself and of freedom, is at:! ambigu-
ous phenomenon in which it is impossible for the for-itself to distinguish
the contribution of freedom from that of the brute existent. In fact, just
as freedom is the escape from a contingency which it has to be in order
to escape it, so the situation is the free co

ordination and the free qualifica-
tion of a brute given which does not allow itself to be qualified in any way at all. Here I am at the foot of this crag which appears to me as "not scalable." This means that the rock appears to me in the light of a projected scaling-a secondary project which finds its meaning in terms of an initial project which is my being-in-the-world. Thus the rock is carved out on the ground of the world by the effect of the initial choice of my freedom. But on the other hand, what my freedom can not determine is whether the rock "to be scaled" will or will not lend itself to scaling. This is part of the brute being of the rock. Nevertheless the rock can show its resistance to the scaling only if the rock is integrated by freedom in a "situation" of which the general theme is scaling~ For the simple traveler who passes over this road and whose free project is a pure aesthetic ordering 6f the landscape, the crag is not revealed either as scalable or as not-scalable; it is manifested only as beautiful or ugly.
Thus it is impossible to determine in each particular case what comes from freedom and what comes from the brute being of the for-itself.
The given in-itself as resistance or as aid is revealed only in the light of the projecting freedom. But the projecting freedom organizes an illumination such that the in-itself is revealed by it as it is (i.e., resisting or favorable); but we must clearly understand that the resistance of the given is not directly admissible as an in-itself quality of the given but only as an indication-across a free illumination and a free refraction....:.of an inapprehensible quid. Therefore it is only in and through the free upsurge of a freedom that the world develops and reveals the resistance which can render the projected end unrealizable. Man encounters an obstacle only within the field of his freedom. Better yet, it is impossible to decree a priori what comes from the brute existent and what from freedom in the character of this or that particular existent functioning as an obstacle. What is an obstacle for me may not be so for another. There is no obstacle in an absolnte sense, but the obstacle reveals its coefficient of adversity across freely invented and freely acquired techniques. The obstacle reveals this coefficient also in terms of the value of the end posited by freedom. The rock will not be an obstacle if I wish at any cost to arrive at the top of the mountain. On the other hand, it will discourage me if I have freely fixed limits to my desire of making the projected climb. Thus the world by coefficients of adversity reveals to me 'the way in which I

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stand in. relation ~o the ends which I assign myself, so that I can never know if it is giving me information about myself or about it. Furthermore the coefficient of adversity of the given is never a simple relation to my freedom as a pure nihilating thrust. It is a relation, illuminated by freedom, between the datum which is the cliff and the datum which my freedom has to be; that is, between the contingent which it is not and its pure facticity. If the desire to scale it is equal, the rock will be easy for one athletic climber but difficult for another, a novice, who is not well trained and who has a weak body. But the body in turn is revealed as well or poorly trained only in relation to a free choice. It is becaus

e I
am there and because I have made of myself what I am that the rock
develops in relation to my body a coefficient of adversity. For the lawyer
who has rcmained in the city and who is pleading a case, whose body is
hidden under his lawyer's robe, the rock is neither-hard nor easy to climb;
it is dissolved in the totality "world" without in any way emerging from
it. And in one sense it is I who choose my body as weak by making it
face the difficulties which I cause to be born (mountain climbing, cycling,
sport). If I have not chosen to take part in sports, if I live in the city, and
if I concern myself exclusively with business or intellectual work, then
from this point of view my body will have no quality whatsoever.
Thus we begin to catch a glimpse of the paradox of freedom: there is
freedom only in a si.tuation, and there is a situation only through freedom.
Human-reality everywhere encounters resistance and obstacles which it
has not created, but these resistances and obstacles have meaning only in
and through the free choice which human-rcality is. But in order better
to grasp the meaning of these remarks and to derive the advantages which
they allow, it will be well at present to analyze in the light of them certain
specific examples. What we have called the facticity of freedom is the
given which it has to be and which it illuminates by its project. This
given is manifested in several ways although within the absolute unity
of a single illumination. It is my place, my body, my past, my position
in so far as it is already determined by the indications of Others, finally
my fundamental relation to the Other. We are going to examine succes-
sively and with specific examples these various structures of the situation.
But we must never lose sight of the fact that no one of them is given
alone and that when we consider one of them in isolation, we are re-
stricted to making it appear on the synthetic ground of the others.
A. MY PLACE
My place is defined by the spatial order and by the particular nature of
the "thises" which are revealed to me on the ground of the world. It is
naturally the spot in which I "live" (my "country" with its sun, its cli-
mate, its rcsources, its hydrographic and orographic configuration). It is
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also more simply the arrangement and the order of the objects which at
present appear to me (a table, beyond the table a window, to the left of
the window a cabinet, to the right a chair, and beyond the window the
street and the sea), which indicate me as the reason for their order.
It is not possible for me not to have a place; othenvise my relation to
the world would be a state of survey, and the world would no longer
be manifested to me in any way at all-as we have seen earlier. More-
over, although this actual place. can have been assigned to me by my
freedom (I hilVe "come" here), I have been able to occupy it only
in .connection with that which I occupied previously and by following
paths marked out by the objects themselves. This previous place refers
me to another, this to another, and so on to the pure contingency of my
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place; that is, to that place of mine which no longer refers to anything
else which is a part of my experience: the place which is assigned to me
by my birth.
It would be useless to explain this last place by the one which my
mother occupied when she brought me into the world.· The chai

n is
broken, the places freely chosen by my parents would be invalid as an explanation of my places. If one considers anyone of them in its connection with my original place-as when one says, for example, "I was born at Bordeaux because my father was given a position there as a civil servant," or "I was 'born at Tours because my grandparents had property there and my mother took refuge near them when during her pregnancy she learned of my father's death"-this merely shows more clearly how for me birth and the place which it assigns me are contingent things. Thus to be born is, among other characteristics, to take one's place, or rather according to what we have just said, to receive it. And as this original place will be that in terms of which I shall occupy new places according to determined rules, it seems that we have here a strong restriction of my freedom. Moreover as soon as one reflects on it, the question is seen to be exceedingly complicated. The partisans of free-will point out that along with any place presently occupied, an infinity of other places is offered to my choice. The opponents of freedom insist on the fact that an infinity of places is denied me by the fact that objects turn toward me a face which I have not chosen and which is exclusive of all others; they add that my place is too profoundly bound up with other conditions of my existence (my dietary habits, climate, etc.) not to contribute to making me. Between the partisans and opponents of freedom a decision seems impossible. This is because the debate has not been placed on its true level.
If we wish to posit the question as it should be, we must proceed from this antinomy: human-reality originally receives its place in the midst of things; human-reality is that by which something we can call place comes to things. Without human-reality there would have been
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neither space nor place, and yet this human-reality by which placing cOmes to things comes to receive its place among things without having any say in the matter. In truth there is no mystery here, but the description must proceed from the antinomy; for it is this which will give to us the exact relation between freedom and facticity.
We have seen that geometrical space-i.e., the pure reciprocity of spatial relations-is a pure nothingness. The only concrete placing which can be revealed to me is absolute extension-i.e., that which is defined by my place considered as the center for which distances are accounted for absolutely, with me as object and without reciprocity. The only abso, lute extension is that which unfolds starting from a location which I am absolutely. No other point could be chosen as an absolute center of reference without being immediately involved in universal relativity. If there is an extension within the limits of which I shall apprehend myself as free or as not·free, an extension which will be presented to me as helpful or as adverse (separating), this can be only because before all else I exist my place without choice, without necessity either, 'as the pure absolute fact of my being-there. I am there, not here but there. This is the absolute and incomprehensible fact which is at the origin of extension and consequently of my original relations with things (with these things rather than with those). A fact of pure contingency-an absurd fact.
Yet on the other han

d, this place which I am is a relation. A univocal
relation, to be sure, but a relation all the same. If I am limited to existing
my place, I can not at the same time be elsewhere in order to establish
this fundamental relation; I can not have even a dim comprehension of
the.object in relation to which my place is defined. I can only exist the
inward determin'ations which the inapprehensible and unthinkable ob-
jects which surround me without my knowing it can provoke in me. By
the same token the very reality of absolute extension disappears, and I
am separated from everything which resembles a place. Furthermore I
am neither free nor not-free; I am a pure existent without constraint, but
without any way either of denying the constraint. In order that such a
thing as an extension originally defined as my place may corne into the
world and by the same stroke strictly define me, it is not merely neccs-
sary that I exist my place-i.e., that I have to be there. It is necessary as
well that I be able to be not wholly here so that I can be over there, ncar
the object whJch I locate at ten feet from me and from the standpoint
of which I make my place known to myself. The univocal relation which
defines my place functions in fact as a relation between something which
I am and something which I am not. This relation in order to be re-
vealed must be established. It supposes therefore that I am in a position
to effect the following operations:
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(1) I must be able to escape what I am and to nihilate it in· such a way
that what I am, although it is existed, can still be revealed as the term
of a relation. This relation is immediately given. It is not, however, given
in the simple contemplation of objects (if we tried to derive space from
pure contemplation,. one could well objcct, for objects are· given with
absplute dimensions, not with absolute distances). It is givcn rather in
our contemplating our immediate action ("He is coming toward us,"
"Let's avoid him," "I am running after him," etc.). It implies as such a
.comprehension of what I am as being-there. But at the same time it is
very necessary to define what I am from the standpoint of the being-there
of other "thises." I am as being-there the one toward whom someone
comes running, the one who has still an hour to climb before being at the
top of the mountain, etc. Thcrefore when I look at the mountain top,
for example, we are dealing with an escape from myself accompanied by
a reflux which I effect in terms of the summit of the mountain toward
my being-there in order to situate myself. Thus I must be "what I have
to be" by the very fact of escaping it. In order for me to be defined by my
place, it is necessary first that I escape myself in order to proceed to
posit the co-ordinates in terms of which I shall define myself more nar-
rowly as the center of the world. It should be noted that my being-there
can in no way determine the surpassing which is going to fix and to locate
things since my being-there is a pure given, incapable of projecting and
since, moreover, in order to be defined strictly as this or that being-there,
it is already necessary that it has been determined by th~ surpassing
followed by the reflux.
(2) I must be able by an internal negation to escape the "thises"-
in the midst of-the world which I am not and by which I make known
to myself what I am. To discover them and t

o escape them is the result,
as we have seen, of a single negation. Here again the intcrnal negation is first and spontaneous in relation to the datum as discovered. We can not admit that the datum provokes our apprehension; on the contrary, in order that there may be a "this" which announces its distances to the Being-there which I am, it is necessary for me to escape it by a pure negation. Nihilation, internal negation, a determining turning back upon the being-there which I am-tpese three operations are really one. They are only moments of an original transcendence which launches toward an end by nihilating me so that I may make known to myself what I am by means of the future. Thus it is my freedom which comes to confer on my place and to define it as such by situating me. The sole reason that I can be strictly limited to this being-there w1J.ich I am is that my ontological structure is not to be what I am and'lo be what I am not. Furthermore this determination of placing, which presupposes all transcendence, can occur only in relation to an end. It is in the light of an end that my place takes on its meaning. For I could never be simply there.
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My place is grasped as an exile or, on the contrary, as that natural, reassuring and favored location which Mauriac called quetenci, comparing it to the place to which the wounded bull always returns in the arena. In relation to what I project doing, in relation to the world in totality and hence to my being-in-the-world, my place appears to me as an aid or a hindrance. To be in place is to be far from -- or near'to --'; that is, place is provided with a meaning in relation to a certain not-yet existing being which one wants to attain. It is the accessibility or the inaccessibility of this end which defines place. It is therefore in the light of not-being and of the future that my position can be actually understood.
"To be there" is to have to take just one step in order to reach the teapot, to be able to dip the pen in the ink by stretching my arm, to have to turn my back to the window if J want to read without tiring my eyes, to have to ride my bicycle and to put up with the fatigue of a hot afternoon for two hours if I wish to see my friend Pierre, to take the train and pass a sleepless night if I want to see Annie. For a Colonial, "to be there" is to be twenty days away from France; better yet, if he is a civil servant and is waiting for a trip at government ~nse, it is to be six months and seven days from Bordeaux or from Etaples. For a soldier, "to be there" is to be a hundred and ten, a hundrcd and twenty days from his discharge. The future-a projected future-intervenes everywhere; it is my future life at Bordeaux, at Etaples, the future discharge of the soldier, the future word which I shall write with a pen wet with ink-it is all this which means my place to me and which makes me exist with nervousness, or impatience or nostalgia. On the other hand, if I am fleeing from a group of men or from public opinion, then my place is defined by the time which, would be necessary for these people to discover me at the far end of the village where I am lodging, for them to arrive at this village, etc. In this case the isolation is what makes my place known to me as favorable. Here to be in place is to be sheltered.
This choice of my end slips into even purely spatial relations

(high
and low, right and left, etc.) so as to give them an existential meaning. The mountain is "overwhelming" if I live at the foot of it; on the other hand, if I am at its peak, the mountain is recovered by the very project of my pride and symbolizes the superiority which I attribute to myself over other men. The place of rivers, the distance from the sea, etc. come into play and are provided with symbolic mcaning; constituted in the light of my end, my place reminds me symbolically of this end in all its details as in its ensemble connections. We shall return to this point when we want to define more exactly the object and the method of existential psychoanalysis. The brute relation of distance to objects can never be allowed to get its meaning and symbols from outside, for these are our very way of constituting it. Even more this brute relation itself has meaning only in relation to the choice of techniques which allow distances

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to be measured and to be traversed. A particular city situated twenty miles from my village and connected with it by a streetcar is much nearer to me than a rocky peak situated four miles away but at an altitude of two thousand eight hundred meters. Heidegger has shown how daily concerns assign to instruments a place which has nothing in common with pure geometric distance: my glasses, he says, once they are on my nose, are much farther from me than the object which I see through them. Thus it must be said that the facticity of my place is revealed to me only in and through the free choice which I make of my end. Freedom is indispensable to the discovery of my facticity. I learn of this facticity from all the points of the future which I project; it is from the standpoint of this chosen future that facticity appears to me with its characteristics of impotence, of contingency, of weakness, of absurdity. It is in relation to my dream of seeing New York that it is absurd and painful for me to live at Mont-de·Marsan. But conversely facticity is the only reality which freedom can discover, the only one which it can nihilate by the positing of an end, the only thing in terms of which it is meaningful to posit an end. For if the end can illuminate the situation, this is because the end is con· stituted as a projected modification of this situation. My place appears in terms of the changes which I project. But to change implies something to be changed, which is precisely my place. Thus freedom is the apprehension of my facticity. It would be absolutely useless to s~ek to define or to describe the "quid" of this- facticity "before" freedom turns back upon it in order to apprehend it as a determined deficiency. My place, before freedom has circumscribed my placing as a lack of a certain kind, "is" not, strictly speaking, anything at all since the very extension in terms of which all place is understood does not exist. On the other hand, the question itself is unintelligible, for it involves "before" which has no meaning; it is freedom, in fact, which temporalizes itself along the lines of a "before" and "after." Nevertheless the fact remains that this brute and unthinkable "quid" is that without which freedom could not be freedom. It is the very facticity of my freedom.
It is only in the act by which freedom has revealed facticity and apprehended it as place that this place thus defined is manifested as an impedi-
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nt to my desires, an obstacle, etc. Otherwise how could it possibly be an obstacle~ An obstacle to what? A compulsion to do what? The story is told of a1' emigrant who was going to leave France for Argentina after the failure of his political party: When someone remarked to him that ArgentilL was "very far away," he asked, "Far from what?" And it is very certain that if Argentina appears "far away" to those who live in France, it is so in relation to an implicit national project which valorizes their place as French. For the internationalist revolutionary, Argentina is a center of the world as is any other country. But if we have by a primary project first constituted French territory as our absolute place; and if
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some catastrophe forces us to go into exile, it is in relation to this initial project that Argentina will appear to us as "very far away," as a "land of exile"; it is in relation to this project that we shall feel ourselves expatriated.

Thus our freedom itself creates the obstacles from which we suffer. It is freedom itself which by positing its end and by choosing this end as inaccessible or accessible with difficulty, causes our placing to appear to our projects as an insurmountable resistance or a resistance to be surmounted with difficulty. It is freedom again which establishes the spatial connections between objects as the first type ofa relation of instrumentality, which decides on techniques permitting distances to be measured and cleared, and thus constitutes its own restriction. But to be precise, freedom can exist only as restricted since freedom is choice. Every choice, as we shall see, supposes elimination and selection; every choicc is a choice of finitude. Thus freedom can be truly free only by constituting facticityas its own restriction. It would therefore be to no point to say that I am not free to go to New York because of the fact that I am a minor government official at Mont-de-Marsan. On the contrary, it is in relation to my project of going to New York that I am going to situate myself at Mont-de-Marsan. My placing in the world, the relation of Mont-de-Marsan to New York and to China would be altogether different if, for example, my project were to become a wealthy farmer at Mont-de-Marsan. In the first case Mont-de-Marsan appears on the ground of a world which maintains an organized connection with New York, Melbourne, and Shanghai; in the second it emerges on the ground of an undifferentiated world. As for the real importance of my project of going to New York, I alone decide it. It can be just a way of choosing myself as discontented with Mont-de-Marsan; and in this case everything is centered on Mont-de-Marsan; I simply make proof of the need of perpetually nihilating my place, of living in a perpetual withdrawal in relation to the city which I inhabit. It can also be a project in which I wholly engage myself. In the first case I shall apprehend my place as an insurmountable obstacle, and I shall have simply used an indirect means to dcfine it indirectly in the world. In the second case, on the other hand, the obstacles will no longer exist; my place will be no longer a point of attachment but a point of departure, for in order to go to New York, some point of departure is necessary. Thus I shall apprehend myself at any moment whatsoever as engaged in the world at my contingent place. But i

conceived only within a narrow connec-
tion with what is. It is not possible that what is should illuminate what is not yet, for what is is a lack and consequently can be known as such only in terms of that which it lacks. The end illuminates what is. But to go looking for the end to-come in order by means of it to make known that-which-is, requires being already beyond what-is in a nihilating withdrawal which makes what-is appear clearly in the state of an isolated-system. What-is, therefore, takes on its meaning only when it is surpassed toward the future. Therefore what-is is the past. We see how the past as "that which is to be changed" is indispensable to the choice of the future and how consequently no free surpassing can be effected except in terms of a past, but we can see too how the very nature of the past comes to the past from the original choice of a future. In particular the irremediable quality of the past comes from my actual choice of the future; if the past is that in terms of which I conceive and project a new state of things in the future, then the past itself is that which is left in place, that which consequently is itself outside all perspective of change. Thus in order for the future to be realizable, it is necessary that the past be irremediable.

It is possible for me not to exist~ but if I exist, I can Rot lack having a past. Such is the form which is assumed here by the "necessity of my contingency." But on the other hand, as we have seen, two existential characteristics in particular qualify the For-itself:

(1) Nothing is in consciousness which is not consciousness of being.

(2.) In my being, my being is in question. This means that nothing comes to mcwhich is not chosen.

\Ve have seen, indeed, that a Past which was only Past would collapse in an honorary existence in which it would have lost all connection with the present. In order for us to "have" a past, it is necessary that we maintain it in existence by our very project towards the future; we do not receive our past, but the necessity of our contingency implies that we are not able not to choose it. This is what it means "to have to be one's own past." We see that this necessity, considered here from a purely temporal point of view, is not basically distinct from the primary structure of freedom, which must be the nihilation of the being which it is and which, by this very nihilation, brings it about that there is a being which it is.

But while freedom is the choice of an end in terms of the past, conversely the past is what it is only in relation to the end- chosen. There is an unchangeable element in the past, (e.g., I had whooping cough when I was five years old) and an element which is eminently variable (the meaning of the brute fact in relation to the totality of my being). But

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since, on the other hand, the meaning of the past fact penetrates it through and through (I can not "recall" my childhood whooping cough outside of a precise project which defines its meaning), it is finally impossible for me to distinguish the unchangeable brute existence from the variable meaning which it includes. To say, "I had whooping cough when I was four years 01d"13 supposes a thousand projects, in particular the adoption of the calendar as a system of reference for my individual existence (hence the adoption of an original position with regard to the socia

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order) and a confident belief in the accounts which third persons give of my childhood, a belief which certainly goes along with a respect or an affection for my parents, a respect which shapes its meaning for me, etc. That brute fact itself is, but apart from the witness of others, its date, the technical name of the illness (an ensemble of meanings which depend on my projects) what can it be? Thus this brute existence, although necessarily existent and unchangeable stands as the ideal end-beyond reach-of a systematic specification of all the meanings included in a memory. There is, of course, a "pure matter" of memory in the sense in which Bergson speaks of pure memory; but when it shows itself, it is always in and through a project which includes the appearance of this matter in its purity.

Now the meaning of the past is strictly dependent on my present project. This certainly does not mean that I can make the meaning of my previous acts vary in any way I please; quite the contrary, it means that the fundamental project which I am decides absolutely the meaning which the past which I have to be.can have for me and for others. I alone in fact can decide at each moment the bearing of the past. I do not decide it by debating it, by deliberating over it, and in each instance evaluating the importance of this or that prior event; but by projecting myself toward my ends, I preserve the past with me, and by action I decide its meaning. Who shall decide whether that mystic crisis in my fifteenth year "was" a pure accident of puberty or, on the contrary, the first sign of a future conversion? I myself, according to whether I shall decide-at twenty years of age, at thirty years-to be converted. The project of conversion by a single stroke confers on an adolescent crisis the value of a premonition which I had not taken seriously. Who shall decide whether the period which I spent in prison after a theft was fruitful or deplorable? I-according to whether I give up stealing or become hardened. Who can decide the educational value of a trip, the sincerity of a profession of love, the purity of a past intention, etc.? It is I, always I, according to the ends by which I illuminate these past events. Thus all my past is there pressing, urgent, imperious, but its meanings and the orders which it gives me I choose by the very project of my end.

13 Sartre's uncertainty as to just when he had whooping cough seems to imply even more shiftiness on the part of the past than his philosophy justifies! Tr.

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Of course the engagements which I have undertaken weigh upon me. Of course the marriage I made earlier, the house I bought and furnished last year limit my possibilities and dictate my conduct; but precisely because my projects are such I reassume the marriage contract. In other words, precisely bccause I do not make of it a "marriage contract which is past, surpassed, dead" and because, on the contrary, my projects imply fidelity to the engagements undertaken or the decision to have an "honorable life" as a husband and a father, etc., these projects necessarily come to illuminate the past marriage vow and to confer on it its always actual value. Thus the urgency of the past comes from the future. Suppose that in the manner of Schlumberger's heroH I radically modify my fundamental project, that I seek, for example, to free myself from a continued sta

te of happiness, and my earlier engagements will lose all
their urgency. They will no longer be here except as the towers and ramparts of the Middle Ages are here, structures which one can not deny but which have no other meaning than that of recalling a stage previously traversed, a civilization and a period of political and economic existence which today are surpassed and perfectly dead. It is the future which decides whether the past is living or dead. The past, in fact, is originally a project, as the actual upsurge of my being. And to the same extent that it is a project, it is an anticipation; its meaning comes to it from the future which it sketches in outline. When the past slips wholly into the past, its absolute value depends on the validation or invalidation of the anticipations which it was. But it depends on my actual freedom to confirm the meaning of these anticipations by again accepting responsibility for them-i.e., by anticipating the future which they anticipated-or to invalidate them by simply anticipating another future. In this case the past falls back as a disarmed and duped expectation; it is "withoutforce." This is because the only force of the past comes to it from the future; no matter how I live or evaluate my past, I can do so only in the light of a project of myself toward the future.
Thus the order of my choices of the future is going to determine an order of my past, and this order will contain nothing of the chronological. There will be first the always living past which is always confirmed: my promise of love, certain business contracts, a certain picture of myself to which I am faithful. Then there is the ambiguous past which has ceased to please me and to which I still hold indirectly: for example, this suit which I am wearing, and which I bought at a certain period when I had the desire to be fashionable, displeases me extremely at present; hence the past in which I "chose" the suit is truly dead. But on the other hand, my actual project of economy is such that I must continue to wear this suit rather than get another. Hence it belongs to a past which
H Scblumbcrger. Un homme heureux. N.R.F.

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is both dead and living like those social institutions which having been created for a determined end, have now outlived the regime which established them and have been made to serve altogether different ends, sometimes even opposed ends. A living past, a half-dead past, survivals, ambiguities, discrepancies: the ensemble of these'layers of pastness is organized by the unity of my project. It is by means of this project that there is installed the complex system of references which causes any fragment of my past to enter into an hierarchical, plurivalent organization in which, as in a work of art, each partial structure indicates in different ways, various other partial structures and the total structure.
Furthermore this decision with respect to the value, the order, and the nature of our past is simply the llistorical choice in general. If human societies are historical, this does not stem simply from the fact that they have a past but from the fact that they reassume the past by making it a memorial. When American capitalism decides to enter the European war of 1914-1918 because it sees there the opportunity for profitable bansactions, it is not historical; it is only utilitarian. But when in the light of

its utilitarian projects, it recovers the previous relations of the United States with France and gives to them the meaning of the paying of a debt of honor by Americans to France, then it becomes historical. In particular it makes itself historical by the famous sentence: "Lafayette, we are here!" It goes without saying that if a different view of her real interests had led the United States to place itself on the side of Germany, she would not have lacked past elements to recover on the memorial level. One can imagine, for example, propaganda based on "blood kinship," which chiefly would have taken into account the proportion of Germans in the emigration to America in the nineteenth century. It would be in vain to try to view these references to the past as purely publicity enterprises; actually the essential fact is that they are necessary in order to gain the adherence of the masses and that therefore the masses demand a political project which illuminates and justifies their past. Moreover, it is evident that the past is thus created. There has been in this way the construction of a common French-American past which, on the one hand, signified the great economic interests of the Americans and, on the other hand, the actual affinities of two democratic capitalisms. Similarly about 1938 we saw how a new generation, concerned ~th the international events which were in preparation, now suddenly illuminated the period of 1918-1938 with a new light by calling it "the period between the wars'.' even before war actually had burst forth in 1939. Suddenly the period under consideration (1918-1938) was constituted ina form which was limited, surpassed, and repudiated whereas those who had lived through it by projecting themselves toward a future in continuity with their present and their immediate past had experienced it as the start of acontinuous and unlimited progress. The actual project
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therefore decides whether a defined period of the past is in continuity with the present or whether it is a discontinuous fragment from which one is emerging and'which is put at a distance.
Thus human history would have to be finished before a particular event, for example the taking of the Bastille, could receive a definitive meaning. Nobody denies, of course, that the Bastille was taken in 1789; there is the immutable fact. But are we to see in this event a revolt without consequence, a popular outburst against a half dismantled fortress, an event which the Convention, anxious to create a famous past for itself, was able to transform into a glorious deed? Or should we consider it as the first manifestation of popular strength by which the populacF asserted itself, give itself confidence, and put itself in a position to effect the march on Versailles in those "Last Days of October"? He who would like to decide the question today forgets that the historian is himself historical; that is, that he historicizes himself by illuminating "history" in the light of his projects and of those of his society. Thus it is necessary to say that the meaning of the social past is perpetually "in suspense."
Now exactly likesocieties, the human person has a memorial past in suspense. It is this perpetual putting into question of the past which the sages realized very eady and which the Greek tragedians expressed, for example, by that proverb which appears in all th

eir plays: "No man
can be called happy before his death." The perpetual historization of
the For-itself is the perpetual affirmation of its freedom.
Once this fact is established, it is not necessary to hold that the past's
character as "in suspense" appears to the For-itself in the form of a vague
or incomplete aspect of its prior history. On the contrary, quite as much
as the choice of the For-itself, which in its own way it expresses, the
Past is apprehended by the For-itself each moment as strictly defined.
Similarly the Arch of Titus or the Column of Trajan, whatever may be
the historical evolution of their meaning elsewhere, appear to the Roman
or the tourist who considers them, as realities perfectly individualized.
In the light of the project which illuminates it, the. Past is revealed as
perfectly compelling. The suspended character of the Past is in no way
miraculous; it only serves to express-on the level of making-past and
of the in-itself-the projective and expectant aspect which human
reality had before turning to the past. It is because this human-rcality
was a free project eaten away by an unpredictable freedom that it be-
comes "in the past" a tributary of the further projects of the For-itself.
Human-reality is condemned to make-itself-past and hence to wait for-
ever for the confirmation which it expected from tIle future. Thus the
past is indefinitely in suspense because human-reality "was" and "will
be" perpetually expecting. Expectation and suspense only succeed in
affirming still more plainly that freedom is their original constituent.
To say that the past of the For-itself is in suspense, to say that its pres-

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eDt is an expecting, to say that its future is a free project, or that it can
be nothing without having to be it, or that it is a totality-detotalized-all
these are one and the same thing. But this does not imply any indeter-
mination in my past as it is revealed to me at present; it means simply
that the right of my actual revelation of my past to be definitive is put
into question. But just as my present is an expectation of a confirmaion
or of an invalidation which nothing allows it to foresee, so the past, which
is involved in this expectation is precise to the same extent that the
expectation is precise. But the meaning of the past, although strictly
individualized, is totally dependent Qn this expectation which itself de-
pends on an absolute nothingness; that is, on a free project which does
not yet exist. My past therefore is a concrete and precise proposition
which as such awaits ratification. This is certainly one of the meanings
which Kafka's The Trial tries to bring to light, the characteristic in hu-
man reality of being perpetually in court. To be free is to have one's free-
dom perpetually on trial. The result is that the past whileconfined with-
in my actual free choice is-once this choice has determined it-an in-
tegral and necessary condition of my project.
An example may mal,<e this point clearer. The past of a retired soldier
under the Restoration is to have been a hero of the retreat from RUSsia.
And what we have explained just now enables us to understand that
this past itself is a free choice of the future. It is by choosing not to join
in with the government of Louis XVIII and the new customs, by choos-
ing until the end to hope for the triumphal return of the Emperor, by
choosing even to cons

pire to hasten this return and to prefer to be a
retired soldier rather than an active solider that the old soldier of Napoleon chooses for himself a past as a hero of Beresina. Another soldier who had formed the project of going over to the new government would certainly not have chosen the same past. But conversely, if we are considering only one retired solider, if he lives in almost indecent poverty, if he is embittered, and if he longs for the Emperor's return, this is because he was a hero of the retreat from Russia. We must be sure to understand this: the past does not act before any constituting recovery, and it does not in any way act deterministically; but once the past "soldier of the Empire" has been chosen, then the conduct of the for-itself realizes this past. There is even no difference between the soldier's choosing this 'past and his realizing it by his behavior. Thus the for-itself by endeavoring to make of its past glory an intersubjective reality, constitutes it in the eyes of others as being an objectivity-for-others (the reactions of the officials, for example, to the danger represented by these old soldier:;). Treated as such by others, the soldier acts henceforth in such a way as to render himself worthy of a past which he has chosen in order to compensate for his present misery and failure. He shows himself intransi-
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gent, he loses every chance of a pension; this is because he "can not" be unworthy of his past.
Thus we choose.our past in the light of a certain end, but from then on it imposes itself upon us and devours us. This is not because this past has an existence by itself diffelent from that which we have to be but simply because: (1) it is the actually revealed materialization of the end which we are; (2) it appears in the midst of the world for us and for others, is nevcr alone but sinks into the universal past and thereby offers itself to the evaluation of others. Just as the geometrician is free to create a particular figure which pleases him but can not conceive of one which does not immediately enter into an infinity of relations with the infinity of other possible figures, so our free choice of ourselves by causing the upsurge of a certain evaluative order of our past, causes the appearance in the world of an infinity of relations of this past to the world and to the Other. And this infinity of relations is presented to us as an infinity of conducts to be adopted since it is in the future that we evaluate our past. We are compelled to adopt these conducts in so far as our past appears within the compass of our essential project. To will this project, in fact, is to will the past; and to will this past is to will to realize it by a thousand secondary behaviors. Logically the requirements of the past are hypothetical imperatives: "If you wish to have such and such a past, act in such and such a way." But as the first term is a concrete and categorical choice, the imperative also is transformed into a categorical imperative. But since the force of compulsion in my past is borrowed from my free, reflecting choice and from the very power which this choice has givcn itself, it is impossible to determine a priori the compelling power of a past. It is not only its content and the order of this content which my free choice decides; it is also the adherence of my past to my actuality. If with

in a fundamental perspective which we do not yet have to determine, one of my principal projects is to progress-i.e., to be always at any cost a little further advanced along a certain path than I was yesterday or an hour earlier, this progressive project involves in relation to my past a series of "uprootings." The past-which now from the height of my progress I regard with a slightly scornful pity-is that which is strictly a passive ob;ect for moral evaluation and judgment. "How stupid I was thenl" or "How wicked I was!" It exists only because I can dissociate myself from it. I no longer enter into it, nor do I any longer wish to enter into it. This is not, of course, because it ceases to exist, but it exists only as that self which I no longer am-i.e., that being which I have to be as the self wl1ich I am no longer. Its .function is to be what I have chosen of myself in order to oppose myself to it, that which enables me to measure myself. Such a for-itself chooses itself therefore without solidarity with itself, which means not that it abolishes its past but that it posits its past so as not to be associated with it, exactly so as to affirm its
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total freedom (that which is past is a certain kind of engagement with respect to the past and a certain kind of tradition). On the other hand, there are other for-itselfs whose project implies the rejection of time and a narroW' solidarity with the past. In their desire to find a solid ground these latter have, by contrast, chosen the past as that which they are, everything else being only an indefinite and unworthy flight from tradition. They have chosen at the start the refusal of flight; that is, the refusal to refuse. The past consequently has the function of requiring of them a fidelity. Thus we shall see that the fonner persons admit scornfully and easily to a mistake which they have made whereas the very admission will be impossible for the others without their deliberately changing their fundamental project; the latter will then employ all the bad faith in the world and all the subt-::rfuges which they can invent in order to avoid breaking that faith in "what is" which constitutes an essential structure of their project.
Thus like place, the past is integrated with the situation when the for-itself by its choice of the future confers on its past facticity a value, an hierarchical order, and an urgency in terms of which this facticity motivates the act and conduct of the for-itself.
C. MY ENVIRONMENT
My "environment" must not be con.fused with the place which I occupy and which we have already discussed. My environment is made up of the instrumental-things which surround me, including their peculiar coefficients of adversity and utility. Of course in occupying my place, I prepare the ground for the revelation of my environment, and by changing place -an operation, which, as we have seen, I freely realize-I provide the basis for the appearance of a new environment. But on the other hand the environment can change or be changed by others without my having any hand in the change. To be sure, Bergson has shown in Matter and Memory that a single modification of my place involves the total change of my environment while it would be necessary to imagine a total and simultaneous modification of all my environment in order to be able to speak of a modification of my place. Now thi

s global change of the
environment is inconceivable, but the fact remains that my field of action is perpetually traversed by the appearances and disappearances of objects with which I have nothing to do. In a general way the coefficient of adversity and utility of complexes does not depend solely on my place, but on the particular potentiality of the instruments. Thus as soon as I exist I am thrown into the midst of existences different from me which develop their potentialities around me, for and against me. For example, I wish to arrive on my bicycle as quickly as possible at the next town. This project involves my personal ends, the appreciation· of my place

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and of the distance from my place to the town, and the free adaptation of means (efforts) to the end pursued. But I have a flat tire, the sun is too hot, the wind is blowing against me, etc., all phenomena which I h~d not foreseen: these are the environment. Of course they manifest themselves in and through my principal project; it is through the project that the wind can appear as a head wind or asa "good" wind, through the project that the sun is revealed as a propitious or an inconvenient warmth. The synthetic organization of these perpetual "accidents" constitutes the unity of what the Germans call my Umwelt, and this Umwelt can be revealed only within the limits of a free project-i.e., of the choice of the ends which I am.

If our description stopped here, however, it would be much too simple. If it is true that each object in my surroundings is made known in a situation already revealed and that the sum of these objects can not by itself alone constitute a situation, if it is true that each instrument is raised on the ground of a situation in the world, still the fact remains that the abrupt transformation or the abrupt appearance of another instrument can contribute to a radical change in the situation. Let my tire be punctured, and my distance from the next town suddenly changes; now it is a distance to be counted by steps and not by the revolutions of the wheels. From this fact I can acquire the certainty that the person whom I wish to see will have already taken the train when I arrive at his house, and this certainty can involve other decisions on my part (a return to my point of departure, the sending of a telegram, etc.) It is even possible, for example, that sure of not being able to conclude aprojected deal with this person, I may return to some one else and sign another contract. Perhaps I shall evcn give up the whole attempt. And shall I count my project as a total failure? In this case I shall say that I was not able to inform Pierre in time, to come to an understanding with him,etc. Is not this explicit recognition of my powerlessness the clearest admission of the limits of my freedom? Of course my freedom to choose, as we have seen, must oot be confu~ed with my freedom to obtain. But is it not my very choice which is here brought into play since the adversity of the environment is in many cases precisely the occasion for the changing of my project?

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Before attacking the fundamental question at issue here, it will be well for us to make the question precise and to delimit it. If the changes which occur in my environment can involve modifications of my projects,they must be subject to two reservations. First, they can not by themselves effect the aband

oning of my principal project which, on the contrary,
serves to measure their importance. In fact, if they are grasped as the causes of my abandoning this or that project, it can be only in the light of a more fundamental project; otherwise they could not be causes since the cause is apprehended by the motivating-consciousness which is itself a free choice
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of an end. If the clouds which cover the sky can move me to give up my project of an outing, this is because they are grasped in a free projection in which the value of the outing is bound to a certain state of the sky, which step by step refers back to the value of an outing in general, to my relati.on to nature, and to the place which this relation occupies in the ensemble of relations which I sustain with the world. Secondly, under no circumstances can the objcct which has appeared or disappeared induce even a partial rcnunciation of a project. This object must of necessity be apprehended as a lack in the orit;inal situation; it is necessary therefore that the given of its appearance or of its disappearance be nihilated, that I effect a withdrawal "in relation to it," and consequently that I myself determine myself in its presence. We have already shown that even the red hot pincers of the torturer do not exempt us from being free. This does not mean that it is always possible to get around the difficulty, to repair the damage, but simply that the very impossibility of continuing in a certain direction must be freely constituted. This impossibility comes to things by means of our free renunciation; our renunciation is not induced by the impossibility of maintainillg the behavior.
Once this fact has been established, we must recognize that the presfnce of the given here again, far from being an obstacle to our freedom, is demanded by the very existence of freedom. This freedom is 'a certain freedom which I am. But what-am I if not a certain internal negation of the in-itself? Without this in-itself which I deny, I should vanish into nothingness. In our Introduction we pointed out that consciousness can serve as the "ontological proof" of the existence of an in-itself. In fact, if there is consciousness of something, then it is necessary at the start that this "something" have a real being-that is, a being not relative to consciousness. But we see at present that this proof has a larger bearing: if I am to be able to do something-anything-it is necessary that I exercise my action upon beings whose existence is in general independent of my existence and in particular independent of my action. My action can reveal this other existence to me but does not condition it. To be free is to-be-free-to-change. Freedom implies therefore the existence of an environment to be changed: obstacles to be cleared, tools to be used. Of course it is freedom which reveals them as obstacles, but by its free choice it can only interpret the meaning of their being. It is necessary that they be simply there, wholly brute, in order that there may be freedom. To be free is to-be-free-to-do, and it is to-be-free-in-the-world. But if this is the case, then freedom by recognizing itself as the freedom to change, recognizes and implicitly foresees in its original project the independent existence of the given On which it is exercised. The internal negation reveals the in-itself as independent, and it is this

is a world in general; that is, that I am thrown among a totality of existents thoroughly indifferent to me. This is because in choosing an end, I choose to have relations with these existents and because these existents have relations among themselves. I choose that they should enter into combination to make known to me what I am. Thus the adversity of which things bear witness to me is pre-outlined by my freedom as one of its conditions, and it is on a freely projected meaning of adversity in general that this or that complex can manifest its individual coefficient of adversity.

Each time that there is a question of the situation it is necessary to insist on the fact that the state of things described has a reverse side. Here also if freedom pre-outlines adversity in general, then this is one way of sanctioning the exteriority and indifference of the in-itself. Of course adversity comes to things through freedom, but this is in so far as freedom illuminates its facticity as "being-in-the-midst-of-an-in-itself-of-indifference." Freedom gives itself things as adverse (i.e., it confers On them a meaning which makes them things), but it ,is by assuming the very given which will be meaningful; that is, freedom assumes its exile in the midst of an indifferent in-itself in order to surpass this exile. Conversely, furthermore, the contingent given which is assumed can support even this primary meaning which is the support of all others, this "exile in the midst of indifference" only in and through a free assumption of the for-itself.

Such, in fact, is the primitive structure of the situation; it appears here in all its clarity. It is by its very surpassing of the given toward its ends that freedom causes the given to exist as this given here (previou31y there was neither this nor that nor here) and the given thus designated is not formed in any way whatsoever; it is a brute existent, assumed in order to be surpassed. But at the same time that freedom is a surpassing of this given, it chooses itself as this surpassing of the given. Freedom is not just any kind of surpassing of any kind of given. By assuming the brute given and be conferring meaning on it, freedom has suddenly chosen itself; its end is exactly to change this given, just as the given appears as this given in the light of the end chosen. Thus the upsurge of freedom is the crystallization of an end across a given and the /evelatiun-of a given in the lig1lt of an end; these two structures are simultaneous and inseparable. We shall see later in fact that the universal values of the chosen ends are disengaged only by analysis; every choice is the choice of a concrete change to be bestowed on a concrete given. Every situation is concrete.

Thus the adversity of things and their potentialities in general are illuminated by the end chosen. But there is an end only for a for-itself which assumes itself as abandoned in the midst of indifference. By this assumption it brings nothing new into this contingent, brute abandon-

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ment except for a meaning. It is responsible for the fact that henceforth there is an abandonment, that this abandonment is revealed as a situation.

We have seen in Part II, chapter IV, that the for:itself by its upsurge causes the in-itself to come into the world; still more generally, it is by means of nothingness that "there is" the in-itself-that is

, things. We
have seen also that the reality-in-itself is there at hand, with its qualities, without any distortion or adjunction. We are simply separated from it by the various types of nihilation which we instate by our very upsurge: world, space and time, potentialities. "Ve have seen in particular that although we are surrounded by presences (this glass, this inkwell, this table, etc.), these presences are inapprehensible as such, for they release whatever it may be of them only after a gesture or an act projected by us-that is, in the future. At present we are able to understand the meaning of this state of things: We are separated from things by nothing except by our freedom; it is our freedom which is responsible for the fact that there are things with all their indifference, their unpredictahility, and their adversity, and for the fact that we are inevitably separated from them; for it is on the ground of nihilation that they appear and that they are revealed as bound one to another. Thus the project of my freedom adds nothing to things: it causes there to be things; that is, precisely, realities provided with a coefficient of adversity and utilizable instrumentality. Freedom makes these things reveal themselves in experience-that is, raise themselves successively on the ground of the world in the course of a process of temporalization. Finally our freedom causes these things to manifest themselves as out of reach, independent, separated from me by the very nothingness which I secrete and which I am. It is because freedom is condemned to be free-i.e., can not choose itself as freedom-that there are things; that is, a plenitude of contingency at tke heart of which it is itself contingency. It is by the assumption of this contingency and by its surpassing that there can be at once a choice and an organization of things in situation; and it is the contingency of freedom and the contingency of the in-itself which are expressed in situation by the unpredictability and the adversity of the environment. Thus I am absolutely free and absolutely responsible for my situation. But I am never free except in situation.

D. MY FELLOWMAN

To live in a world haunted by my fellowman is not only to be able to encounter the Other at every tum of the road; it is also to find myself engaged in a world in which instrumental-eomplexes can have a meaning which my free project has not first given to them. It means also that
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in the midst of this world already provided with meaning I .meet with a meaning which is mine and which I have not given to myself, which I discover that I "possess already." Thus when we ask what the original and contingent fact of existing in a world in which "there are" also Others can mean for our situation, the problem thus formulated demands that we study successively three layers of reality which come into play so as to constitute my concrete situation: instruments which are already meaningful (a station, a railroad sign, a work of art, a mobilization notice), the meaning which I discover as already mine (my nationality, my race, my physical appearance), and finally the Other as a center of reference to which these meanings refer.

Everything would be very simple if I belonged to a world whose meanings were revealed simply in the light of my own ends. In this case I would dispose of things as instruments

or as instrumental complexes
within the limits of my own choice of myself; it is this choice which would make of the mountain an obstacle difficult to overcome or a spot from which to get a good view of the landscape, etc; the problem would not be posed of knowing what meaning this mountain could have in itself since I would be the one by whom meanings 'come to reality in itself. The problem would again be very much simplified if I were a monad without doors or windows and if I merely knew in some way or other that other monads existed or were possible, each of them conferring new meanings on the things which I see. In this case, which is the one to which philosophers have too often limited themselves in their inquiry, it would be sufficient for me to hold other meanings as possible, and finally the plurality of meanings corresponding to the plurality of consciousnesses would coincide very simply for me with the possibility always open to me of making another choice of myself. But we have seen that this monadic conception conceals a hidden solipsism precisely because it is going to confuse the plurality of meanings which I can attach t~ the real and the plurality of meaningful systems each one of which refers to a consciousness which I am not. Moreover on the level of concrete experience this monadic description is revealed as inadequate. There exists,in fact, something in "my" world other than a plurality of possible meanings; there exist objective meanings which are given to me as not having been brought to light by me. I, by whom meanings come to things, I find myself engaged in an already meaningful world which reflects to me meanings which I have not put into it.
One may recall, for example, the innumerable host of meanings which are independent of my choice and which I discover if I live in a city: streets, houses, shops, streetcars and buses, directing signs, warning sounds, music on the radio, etc. In solitude, of course, I should discover the brute and unpredictable existence-this rock, for example-and I should. limit myself, in short, to making there be a rock; that is, that
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there should be this existent here and outside of it nothing. Nevertheless I should confer on it its meaning as "to be climbed,""to be avoided," "to be contemplated," etc. When there where the street curves, I discover a building, it is not only a brute existent which'I reveal in the world; I do not only cause there to be a "this" qualified in this or that way; but the meaning of the object which is revealed then resists me and remains independent of me. I discover that the property is an apartment house, or a group of offices belonging to the Gas Company, or a prison, etc. The meaning here is contingent, independent of my choice; it is presented with the same indifference as the reality of the in-itself; it is made a thing and is not distinguished from the quality of the in-itself. Similarly the coefficient of adversity in things is revealed to me before being experienced by me. Hosts of notices put me on my guard: "Reduce Speed. Dangerous curve," "Slow. School," "Danger," "Narrow Bridge 100 feet ahead," etc. But these meanings while deeply imprinted on things and sharing in their indifferent exteriority-at least in appearance -are nonetheless indications for a conduct to be adopted, and they directly concern me. I shall cross the street in the I

iscuss a little later. Yet the fact remains that
on the level of techniques of apprrpriating the world, the very fact of
the Other's existence results in the fact of the collective owncrship of
techniques. Therefore facticity is expressed on this level by the fact of
my appearance in a world which is revealed to me only by collective and
already constituted techniques which aim at making me apprchend the
world in a form whose meaning has been defined outside of me.
These techniques are going to determine my belonging to collcctivities:
to the human race, to the national collectivity, to the professional and
to the family group.
It is even necessary to underscore this fact further:outside of my being-
for-others-of which we shall speak later-the only positive W<lY which I
have to exist my factual belonging to these collectivities is the use which
I constantly make of the techniques which arise from them. Belonging to
the human race is defined by the use of ve1Y elementary and very
general techniques: to know how to walk, to know how to take hold, to
know how to pass judgment on the surface and the relative size of per-
ceived objects, to know how to speak, to know how in general to distin-
guish the true from the false, etc. But we do not possess these techniques
in this abstract and universal fonn: to know how to speak is not to
know how to pronounce and understand words in general; it is to know
how to speak a certain language and by it to manifest one's belonging
to humanity on the level of the national collectivity. Moreover to know
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how to speak a language is not to have an abstract and pure knowledge
of the language as it is defined by academic dictionaries and grammars;
it is to make the language one's own across the peculiar changes and
emphasis brought in by one's province, profession, and family. Thus it
can be said that the reality of our belonging to the human is our nationa-
lity and that the reality of our nationality is our belonging to the family,
to the region, to the profession, etc. in the sense that the reality of speech
is language and that the reality of language is dialect, slang, jargon, etc.
And conversely the truth of the dialect is the language, the truth of the
language is speech. This means that the concrete terhniques by which
we manifest our belonging to the family and to the locality refer us to
more abstract and more general structures which constitute its mean·
ing and essence; these refer to others still more general until we arrive
at the universal and perfectly simple essence of any technique whatsoever
by which any being whatsoever appropriates the world.
Thus to be French, for example, is only the truth of being a Savoyard.
But to be a Savoyard is not simply to inhabit the high valleys of Savoy;
it is, among a thousand other things, to ski in the winters, to use the
ski as a mode of transportation. And precisely, it is to ski according to
the French method, not that of Arlberg or of Norway.t~ But since the
mountain and the snowy slopes are apprehended only through a tech·
nique, this is precisely to discover the French meaning of ski slopes. In
fact according to whether one will employ the Norwegian method,
which is better for gentle slopes, or the French method which is better
for steep slopes, the same slope will appear as steeper or more gentle
exactly as an upgrade will appear as more or les

s have observed that the word is not the
concrete element of speech-not even the word of the dialect or the
word of the family with its particular variation; the elementary structure
of speech is the sentence. It is within the sentence, in fact, that the
word can receive a real function as a designation; outside of the sentence
the word is just a propositional function-when it is not a pure and
simple rubric designed to group absolutely disparate meanings. Only
when it appears in discourse, does it assume a "holophrastic" character,
as has often been pointed out. This does not mean that the word can
be limited by itself to a precise meaning but that it is integrated in a
context as a secondary form in a primary form. The word therefore has
only a purely virtual existence outside of complex and active organizations
which integrate it. It can not exist "in" a consciousness or an unconscious
before the use which is made of it: the sentence is not made out of words.
But we need not be content with this. Paulhan has shown in Fleurs de
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Tarbes that entire sentences, "commonplaccs," do not, any more than
words, pre-exist the use which is made of them. They are mere common-
placcs if they are looked at from the outside by a reader who recomposes
the paragraph by passing from one sentence to the next, but they lose
their banal and conventional character if they are placed within the point
of view of the author who saw the thing to be expressed and who attended
to the most pressing things first by producing an act of designation or
re-creation without slowing down to consider the very elements of this
act. If this is true, then neither the words nor the syntax, nor the "ready-
made sentences" pre-exist the use which made of them. Since the verbal
unity is the meaningful sentence, the latter is a constructive act which
is conceived only by a transcendence which surpasses and nihilates the
given toward an end. To understand the word in the light of the sentence
is very exactly to understand any given whatsoever in terms of the situa-
tion and to understand the situation in the light of the original ends.
To understand a sentence spoken by my companion is, in fact, to under-
stand what he "means"-that is, to espouse his movement of transcend-
ence, to throw myself with him toward possibles, toward ends, and to
return again to the ensemble of organized means so as to understand
them by their function and their end. The spoken language, moreover,
is always interpreted in terms of the situation. References to the weather,
to time, to place, to the environment, to the situation of the city,
of the province, of the country are given before the word.16 It is enough
for me to have read the papers and to hav~scen Pierre's healthy appear-
ancc and anxious expression in order for me to understand the "Things
aren't so good" with which he greets me this morning. It is not his health
which "is not so good" since he has a rosy complexion, nor is it his
business nor his household; it is the situation of our city or of our country.
I kncwit already. In asking him, "How goes it?", I was already out-
lining an interpretation of his reply; I transported myself already to
the four corners of the horizon, ready to return from there to Pierre in
order to understand him. To listen to conversation is to "speak with,"
not simply because we imitate in order to interpret, b

self according to its own laws, if meanings are fixed in
in-itself while we preserve a human transcendence, then the role of man
will be reduced to that of a pilot employing the determined forces of
winds, waves, and tides in order to direct a ship. But gradually each
technique in order to be directed toward human ends will require another
technique; for example, to direct a boat, it is necessary to speak. Thus we
shall perhaps arrive at the technique of techniques-which in turn will
17 Brice.Parain: Essai sur Ie logos platonicien.
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be applied by itself-but we shall have lost forever the possibility of
meeting the technician.
If on the other hand, it is by speaking that we cause words to exist,
we do not thereby suppress the necessary tec1mical connections or the
connections in fact which are articulated inside the sentence. Better yet,
we found this necessity. But in order for it to appear, in order for words
to enter into relations with one another, in order for them to latch on
to one another or repulse one another, it is necessary that they be united
in a synthesis which does not come from them. Suppress this synthetic
unity and the block which is called "speech" disintegrates; each word
returns to its solitude and at the same time loses its unity, being par-
celled out among various incommunicable meanings. Thus it is within
the free project of the sentence that the laws of speech are organized; it
is by speaking that I make grammar. Freedom is the only possible founda-
tion of the laws of language.
Furthermore, for whom do the laws of language exist? Paulhan has
given the. essential answer: they are not for the one who speaks, they are
for the one who listens. The person who speaks is only the choice of a
meaning and apprehends the order of the words only in so far as he
makes iU8 The only relations which he will grasp within this organized
complex are specifically those which he has established. Consequently
if we discover that hvo (or several) words hold between them not one
but several defined relations and that there results from this a multi-
plicity of meanings which are arranged in an hier:uchy or opposed to
each other-all for one and the same sentence-if, in short, we discover
the "Devil's share," this can be only under the two following conditions:
(1) The words must have been assembled and presented by a meaning-
ful rapprochement; (2) this synthesis must be seen from outside-i.e.,
by The Other and in the course of a hypothetical deciphering of the
possible meanings of this rapprochement. In this case, in fact, each word
grasped first as a square of meaning is bound to another word similarly
apprehended. And the rapprochement will be multivocal. The appre-
hension of the true meaning (i.e., the one expressly willed by the speaker)
will be able to put other meanings in the shade or subordinate them,
but it will not suppress them. Thus speech, which is a free project for
me, has specific laws for others. And these laws themselves can come
into play only within an original synthesis.
Thus we can grasp the clear distinction between the event "sentence"
and a natural event. The natural fact is produced in conformi~ to a
law which it manifests but which is a purely external rule ofproduction
of which the considered fact is only one example. The "sentence". as an
18 I am simplifying: one can also learn one's own thougbt f

itself
as a personal self that the for-itself sustains in existence certain social
and abstract characteristics which make of it a man (or a woman); and
the necessary connections which accompany the ~ssential elements of
man appear only on the foundation of a free choice; in this sense each
for-itself is responsible in its being for the existence of a human race. But
it is necessary for us again to stress the undeniable fact that the for-
itself can choose itself only beyond certain meanings of which it is not
the origin. Each for-itself, in fact, is a for-itself only by choosing itself
beyond nationality and race just as it speaks only by choosing the designa-
tion beyond the syntax and morphemes. This "beyond" is enough to
assure its total independence in relation to the structures which it sur-
passes; but the fact remains that it constitutes itself as beyond in relation
to tllese particular structures. What does this mean? It means that the
for-itself arises in a world which is a world for other for-itselfs. Such is
the given. And thercby, as we have seen, the meaning of the world is
alien to the for-itself. This means simply that each man finds himself
in the presence of meanings which do not come into the world through
him. He arises in a world which is given to him as already looked-at,
furrowed, explored, worked over in all its meanings, and whose very
contexture is already defined by these investigations. In the very act by
which he unfolds his time, he temporalizes himself in a world whose
temporal meaning is already defined by other temporalizations: this is
the fact of simultaneity. We are not dealing here with a limit of freedom;
rather it is in tllis world that the for-itself must be free; that is, it must
choose itself by taking into account these circumstances and not ad
libitum. But on the othcr hand, the for-itself-i.e., man-in rising up
does not merely suffer the Other's existence; he is compelled to make
the Other's existence manifest to himself in the form vf n choice. For
it is by a choice that he will apprehend the Other as The-Othcr-as-subject
or as The-Other-as-object.19 Inasmuch as the Other is for him the Other-
as-a-look, there can be no question of tecllniques or of foreign meanings;
the for-itself experiences itself as an object in the Universe beneath the
Other's look. But as soon as the for-itself by surpassing the Other toward
its ends makes of him a transcendence-transcended, that which was a free
surpassing of the given toward ends appears to it as meaningful, given con-
duct in the world (fixed in in-itself). The Other-as-object becomes an
indicator of ends and by its own free project, the For-itself throws itself
into a world in which conducts-as-objects designate ends. Thus the Other's
presence as a transcended transcendence reveals given complexes of means
to ends. And as the end decides the means and the means the end by its
upsurge in the face of the Other-as-object, the For-itself causes ends in
19 We shall see later that the problem is more complex. But these remarks are suffi-
cient for the present.
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the world to be indicated to itself; it comes into a world peopled by ends.
But if consequently the techniques and their ends arise in the look of the
For-itself, we must necessarily recognize that it is by means of the free
assumption of a position by the For-itself confronting the Other that

d on certain objects. It is I
myself who see a meaning conferred upon me, and I do not have the recourse of accepting the responsibility for this meaning which I have since it can not be given to me except in the form of an empty indication. Thus something of myself-according to this new dimeI)sion-exists in the manner of the given; at least for me, since this being which I am is suffered, it is without being existed. I learn of it and suffer it in and through the relations which I enter into with others, in and through their conduct with regard to me. I encounter this being at the origin of a thousand prohibitions and a thousand resistances which I bump up against at each instant: Because I am a minor I shall not have this or that privilege. Because I am a few I shall be deprived-in certain societies-of certain possibilities, etc. Yet I am unable in any way to feel myself as a Jew or as a minor or as a Pariah. It is at this point that I can react against these interdictions by declaring that race, for example, is purely and simply a collective fiction, that only individuals exist. Thus here I suddenly encounter the total alienation of my person: I am something which I have not chosen to be. What is going to be the result of this for the situation?
We must recognize that we have just encountered a real limit to our freedom-that is, a way of being which is imposed on us without our freedom being its foundation. Still it is necessary to understand this: the limit imposed does not come from the action of others. In a preceding chapter we observed that even torture does not dispossess us of our freedom; when we give in, we do so freely. In a more general way the encounter with a prohibition in my path ("No Jews allowed hen.:," or "Jewish restaurant. No Aryans allowed," etc.) refers us to the case considered earlier (collective techniques), and this prohibition can have meaning only on and through the foundation of my free choice. In fact according to the free possibilities which I choose, I can disobey the prohibition, pay no attention to it, or, on the contrary, confer upon it a coercive value which it can hold only because of the weight which I attach to it. Of course the prohibition fully retains its character as an

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"emanation from an alien will;" of course it has for its specific structure the fact of taking me for an object and thereby manifesting a transcendence which transcends me. Still the fact remains that it is not incarnated in my universe, and it loses its peculiar force of compulsion only within the limits of my own choice and according to whether under any circumstances I prefer life to death or whether, on the contrary, I judge that in certain particular cases death is preferable to certain kinds of life, etc. The true limit of my freedom lies purely and simply in the very fact that an Other apprehends me as the Other-as-object and in that second corollary fact that my situation ceases for the Other to be a situation and becomes an objective form in which I exist as an objective structure. It is this alienating process of making an object of my situation which is the constant and specific limit of my situation, just as the making an object of my being-for-itself in being-for-others is the limit of my being. And it is precisely these two characteristic limits which represent the boundaries of my freedom.
In short, b

h an ensemble of structures, of which certain are
abstract but whose totality is an absolute concrete, an ensemble which
simply is indicated to me as on principle escaping me. TIlis ensemble
is in fact what I am. Now we observed at the beginning of Part Two
that the for-itself can not be anything. For-myself I am not a professor or
a waiter in a cafe, nor am I handsome or ugly, Jew or Aryan, spiritual,
vulgar, or distinguished. We shall call these characteristics unrealizables.
We must be careful not to confuse them with the imaginary. We have to
do with perfectly real existences; but those for which these characteristics
are really given are not these characteristics, ar.d I who am them can not
realize them. If I am told that I am vulgar, for example, I have often
grasped by intuition as regards others the nature of vulgarity; thus I can
apply the word "vulgar" to my person. But I can not join the meaning of
this word to my person. There is here exactly the indication of a connec·
tion to be effected but one which could be made only by an interiorization
and a subjectivizing of the vulgarity or by the objectivizing of the person
-two operations which involve the immediate collapse of the reality in
question.
Thus we are surrounded by an infinity of unrealizables. Certain among
these unrealizables we feel vividly as irritating absences. Who has not
felt a profound disappointment at not being able after his return from a
long exile to realize that he "is in Paris." The objects are there and offer
themselves familiarly, but I am only an absence, only the pure nothing.

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ness which is necessary in order that there may be a Paris. My friends,
my relatives offer the image of a promised land when they say to me: "At
last you are here! You have returned! You are in Paris!" But access to this
promised land is wholly denied me. And if the majority of· people de-
serve the reproach of "applying a double standard" according to whether
they are considering others or themselves, if when they perceive that they
are guilty of a fault which they had blamed in someone else the day before,
they have a tendency to say, "That's not the same thing," this is because in
fact "it is not the same thing." The one action is a given object of
moral evaluation; the other is a pure transcendence which carries its
justification in its very existence since its bejng is a choice. We shall be
able to convince its agent by a comparison of the results that the two
acts have a strictly identical "outside", but the best wiII in the world
will not allow him to realize this identity. Here is the source of a good
part of the troubles of the moral consciousness, in particular despair at
not being able truly to contemn oneself, at not being able to. realize one-
self as guilty, at feeling perpetually a gap between the expressed mean-
ing of the words: "I am guilty, I have sinned," etc., and the rcal appre-
hension of the situation. In short this is the origin of all the anguish of
a "bad conscience,"20 that is, the consciousness of bad faith which has for
its ideal a self-judgment-i.e., taking toward oneself the point of view of
the Other.
But if some particular kinds of unrealizables have impressed us more
than others, if they have become the ohject of psychological descriptions,
they must not blind us to the fact that unrealizables are infinite in number
since they represent the

reverse side of the situation.
These unrealizabJes, however, are not only appresented to us as unrealizables; in fact in order that they may have the charac-ter of unrealizables, they must be revealed in the light of some project aiming at realizing. them. This is indeed what we noted earlier when we were showing how the for-itself assumes its hcing-for-others in and by the very act which recognizes the existence of otllers. Correlatively therefore with this assuming project, the unreali7..ables are revealed as to be realized. At first, indeed, the assumption is made in the perspective of my fundamental project. I do not limit myself to receiving passively the meaning "ugliness," "infirmity," "race," etc., but, on the contrary, I can grasp these characteristics-in the simple capacity of a meaning-only in the light of my own ends. This is what is expressed-but by completely reversing the terms-when it is said that the fact of being of a certain race can determine a reaction of pride or an inferiority complex. In actual fact
20 There is no distinction in French between "conscience" and "consciousness," both of which are expressed by the word conscience. This is, I believe, the only passage in Being and Nothingness in which Sartre intends to emphasize the idea of a "con· science" (English sense), which, of course, has no place in his philosophy. Tr.

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the race, the infirmity, the ugliness can appear only within the limits of my own choice of inferiority or of pride;21 in other words, they can appear only with a meaning which my freedom confers on them. This means once again that they are for the Other but that they can be for me only if I choose them. The law of my freedom which makes me unable to be without choosing myself applies here too: I do not choose to be for the Other what I am, but I can try to be for myself what I am for the Other, by choosing myself such as I appear to the Other-i.e., by an elective assumption. A Jew is not a Jew first in order to be subsequently ashamed or proud; it is his pride of being a Jew, his shame, or his indifference "hich will reveal to him his being-a-Jcw; and this being-a-Jew is nothing outside the free manner of adopting it. Although I have at my disposal an infinity of ways of assuming my being-for-others, I am not able not to assume it. We find here again that condemnation to freedom which we defined above as facticity. I can neither abstain totally in relation to what I am (for the Other)-for to refuse is not to abstain but still to assume-nor can I submit to it passively (which in a sense amounts to the same thing). Whether in fury, hate, pride, shame, disheartened refusal or joyous demand, it is necessary for me to choose to be what I am. Thus the unrealizables are revealed to the for-itself as "unrealizables-to-be-realized." They do not thereby lose their character as limits; quite the contrary, it is as objective and external limits that they are presented to the for-itself as to be interiorized. They have therefore a character which is distinctly obligatory. In fact we are not dealing with an instrument revealing itself as "to be employed" in the movement of the free project which I am. Here the unrealizahle appears as an a priori limit given to my situation (since I am such for the Other) and hence as an existent which does not wait for me to give it existence; but also it appears

as able to exist only in and through the free project by which I shall assume it-the assumption evidently being identical with the synthetic organization of all the conduct aimed at realizing the unrealizable for me. At the same time since it is given in the capacity of an unrealizable, it is manifested as beyond all the attempts which I can make to realize it. The unrealizable is an a priori which requires my engagement in order to be, while depending only on this engagement and while placing itself at the start beyond any attempt to realize it. What then is this if not precisely an imperative? It is indeed to be interiorized (that is, it comes from the outside as does every fact) but the order, whatever it may be, is defined always as an exteriority recovered ininteriority. If an order is to be order-and not a flatus vocis or a pure fact'UaLgiven which one merely seeks to change-it is necessary that I reassume it with my freedom, that I make of it a structure of my free projects. But if the order is to be order and not a

21 Or of any other choice of my ends.

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free movement toward my own ends, it must necessarily preserve at the very heart of my free choice its character as exteriority. It is the exteriority which remains exteriority even in and through the attempt on the part of the For-itself to interiorize it. This is precisely the definition of the unrealizable to be realized; that is why it is given as an imperative.

But we can go further in the description of this unrealizable; it is in fact my limit. But precisely because it is my limit it can not exist as the limit of a given being but only as the limit of my freedom. This means that my freedom by freely choosing itself chooses its limits; or, if you prefer, the free choice of my ends (i.e., of what I am for myself) includes the assumption of the limits of this choice, whatever they may be. Here again the choice is a choice of finitude as we indicated earlier, but whereas the chosen finitude is an inner finitude-i.e., the determination of freedom by itself-the finitude assumed by the recovery of unrealizables is an external finitude. I choose to have a being at a distance, which limits all my choices and constitutes their reverse side; that is, I choose that my choice be limited by something other than itself. If I should grow angry over it and attempt in every way to recover these limits, as we saw in the preceding section of this work, even the most energetic of these attempts at recovery must of necessity have its foundation in the free recovery as limits of the limits which one wishes to interiorize. Thus freedom is fully responsible and makes the unrealizable limits enter into the situation by choosing to be a freedom limited by the Other's freedom. Consequently the external limits of the situation become a situation-limit -that is, they are incorporated in the interior of the situation with the characteristic "unrealizable" as "unrealizables to be realized." As a chosen and fugitive reverse side of my choice, they become a meaning of my desperate effort to be although they are situated a priori beyond this effort exactly as death-another type of unrealizable which we do not have to consider for the moment-becomes a situation-limit on condition that it be taken as an event of life even though it points toward a world where my presence and my life are no longer real

ized-i.e., toward what
is beyond life.
The fact that tllere is a beyond for life, a beyond which derives its meaning only through and in my life and which yet remains for me an unrealizable, and the fact that there is a freedom beyond my freedom, a situation beyond my situation and one for which what I live as a situation is given as an objective form in the midst of the world: here are two types of situation-limit which have the paradoxical character of limiting my freedom on every side and yet not having any other meaning than that which my freedom confers on them. For class, for race, for the body, for the Other, for function, etc., there is a "being-free-for--." By it the For-itself projects itself towards one of its possibles which is always its ultimate possible, for the envisaged possibility isa possibility of seeing
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itself; that is, of being another than itself in order to see itself from outside. In one case as in the other there is a projection of self towards an "ultimate" which thereby interiorized becomes a thematic out-of-reach meaning of hierarchized possibles. One can "be-in-order-to-be-French," "be-in-order-to-be-a-worker,"· the son of a king can "be-in-order-to-reign." We are dealing here with limits and negating states of our being which we have to assume in the sense in which, for example, the Zionist Jew resolutely assumes himself within his race-that is, assumes concretely and once and for all the permanent alienation of his being; in the same way the revolutionary worker by his very revolutionary project assumes a "being-in-order-to-be-a-worker." And we shall note as Heidegger did (although the expressions "authentic" and "unauthentic" which he employs are dubious and insincere because of their implicit moral content) that the attitude of refusal and of flight which remains always possible is despite itself the free assumption of what it is fleeing. Thus the bourgeois makes himself a bourgeois by denying that there are any classes, just as toe worker makes himself a worker by asserting that classes exist and by realizing through his revolutionary activity his "being-in-a-class." But these external limits of freedom, precisely because they are external and are interiorized only a~ unrealizables, will never be either a real obstacle for freedom or a limit suffered. Freedom is total and infinite, which does not mean that it has no limits but that it never encounters them. The only limits which freedom bumps up against at each moment are those which it imposes on itself and of which we have spoken in connection with the past, with the environment, and with techniques.

E. My DEATH

AFTER death had appeared to us as pre-eminently non-human since it was what there was on the other side of the "wall," we decided suddenly to consider it from a wholly different point of view-that is, as an event of human life. This change is easily explained: death is a boundary, and every boundary (whether it be final or initial) is a Janus bifrons. Whether it is thought of as adhering to the nothingness of being which limits the process considered or whether On the contrary it is revealed as adhesive to the series which it terminates, in either case it is a being which belongs to an existent process and which in a certain way constitutes the meaning of the process. Thus the final chord of a melody always looks on the one

side toward silence-that is, toward the nothingness of sound which will follow the melody; in one sense it is made with the silence since the silence which will follow is already present in the resolved chord as its meaning. But on the other side it adheres to this plenum of being which is the melody intended; without the chord this melody would

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remain in the air, and this final indecision would flow back from note to note to confer on each of them the quality of being unfinished.

Death has always been-rightly or wrong1y is what we can not yet determine-considered as the final boundary of human life. As such it was natural that a philosophy which was primarily concerned to make precise the human position in relation to the non-human which surrounded it, would first consider death as a door opening upon the nothingness of human-reality, and that this nothingness \;rould be the absolute cessation of being or else existence in a non-human form. Thus we may say that there has been-in correlation with the great realist theories-a realistic conception of death such that death appeared as an immediate contact with the non-human. Thus death escaped man at the same time that it rounded him off with the non-human absolute. It was not possible, of course, for an idealist and humanistic conception of the real to tolerate the idea that man would encounter the non-human even as his limit, It would then have sufficed in fact, to adopt the point of view of this limit in order to illuminate man with a non-human light,22 The idealist attempt to recover death was not originally the fact of philosophers but that of poets like Rilke or novelists like Malraux. It was sufficient to consider death as the- final term belonging to the series. If the series thus recovers its terminus ad quem, then precisely because of this ad which indicates its interiority, death as the end of life is interiorized and humanized. Man can no longer encounter anything but the human; there is no longer any other side of life, and death is a human phenomenon; it is the final phenomenon of life and is still life. As such it influences the entire life by a reverse flow. Life is limited by life; it becomes like the world of Einstein, "finite but unlimited " Death becomes the meaning of life as the resolved chord is the meaning of the melody. There is nothing miraculous in this; it is one term in the series under consideration, and, as one knows, each term of a series is always present in ~ll the terms of the series.

But death thus recovered does not remain simply human; it becomes mine. By being interiorized it is individualized. Death is no longer the great unknowable which limits the human; it is the phenomenon of my personal life which makes of this life a unique life-that is, a life which does not begin again, a life in which one never recovers his stroke. Hence I become responsible for my death as for my life. Not for the empirical and contingent phenomenon of my decease but for this character of finitude which causes my life like my death to be my life. It is in this sense that Rilke attempts to show that the end of each man resembles his life because all his individual life has been a preparation for this end. In this sense Malraux in Les Conquerants shows that European culture

22 See, for example, the realistic Platonism of Morgan in SparJcenbrooJc?

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ing itself free1;i towards its final possibility that the Dasein will attain authentic existenc~ and wrench itself away from ever/day banality in order to attain tlv;: irreplacooble uniqueness of the person. But there is a circle here. How indeed can one prove that death has this individuality and the power of conferring it? Of course, if death is described as my death, I can .await it; it is a possibility which is characterized and distinct. But is the death which will overtake me my death? In the first place it is perfectly gratuitous to say that "to die is the only thing w~ich nobody can do for me." Or rather there is here an evident bad faith in the reasoning; if one considers death as the ultimate subjective possibility, the event which COncerns only the for-itself, then it is evident that nobo~ can die for me. But then it follows that none of my possibilities taken from this point of view-which is that of the cogito~whether taken in authentic existence or unauthentic-can be projected by anyone other than me. Nobody can love for me-if we mean by that to make vows which are my vows, to experience the emotions (however commonplace they may be) which are my emotions. And the my here has nothing to do with a personality won by overcoming everyday banality (which would allow Heidegger to retort that it is very necessary that I be "free to die," in order that a love which I experience should be my love and not the love in me of the "they") ; it refers simply to that selfness which Heidegger expressly recognizes in every Dasein-whether it exists in the authentic or unauthentic mode-when he declares that "Dasein ist je meincs." l1ms from this point of view the most commonplace love is, like death, irreplaceable and unique; nobody can love for me.

On the other hand, if my acts in the world are considered from the point of view of their function, their efficacy, and their result, it is ccrtain that the Other can always do what I do. If it is a quesion of making this woman happy, of safeguardingher life or her freedom, of giving her the means of finding her salvation, or simply of realizing a home with her, of "giving her" children, if that is what we call loving, then another will be able to love in my place, he will even be able to love for me. This is the actual meaning of those sacrifices recounted thousands of times in sentimental novels which show us the amorous hero longing for the happiness of the woman whom he loves and effacing himself before his rival because the latter "will be able to love better than he." Here the rival is specifically charged to love for, for to love is defined simply as "to make happy by the love which is borne to her." And so it will be with all my conduct. In this case, however, my death also will fall into

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this category. If to die is to die in order to inspire, to bear witness, for the country, etc., then anybody at all can die in my place-as in the song in which lots are drawn to see who is to be eaten. In short there is no personalizing virtue which is peculiar to my death. Quite the contrary, it becomes my death only if I place myself already in the perspective of subjectivity; it is my subjectivity defined by the pre-reflective cogito which makes of my death a subjective irreplaceable, and not death which would give an irreplaceable selfncss to my for-itself. In this case death can not be chara

cterized; for it is death as my death, and consequently its
essential structure as death is not sufficient to make of it that personalized
and qualified event which one can wait for.
Furthermore death can not be awaited unless it b very precisely desig-
nated as my condemnation to death (the execution which will take place
in eight days, the issue of my illness, which I know to be immanent
and ruthless, etc.), for it is nothing but the revelation of the absurdity
oj every expectation even though it be the expectation of death itself.
To begin with, we must carefully distinguish between two meanings of
the verb "expect" which are continually confused: to expect death is not
to wait for death.28 We can "wait for" only a determined event which
equally determined processes are in the act of realizing. I can wait for the
arrival of the train from Chartres because I know that it has left the
station at Chartres and that each tum of the wheels brings it closer to
the station at Paris. Of course the train can be late; an accident ev.::n
can happen. But the fact remains that the process itself by which the
entrance into the station will be realized is "underway;" and the phe-
nomena which can delay or prevent this entrance into the station mean
here simply that the process is only a relatively dosed, relatively isolated
system and,that it is in fact immersed in a universe with a "fibrous struc-
ture," as Meyerson put it. Thus I can say that I am waiting for Pierre and
that "1 expect that his train is late." But in the same way the possibility of
my death means only that I am biologically only a relatively closed, rela-
tively isolated system; it indicates only the fact that my body belongs to
the totality of existents. It is of the same type as the probable delay of
trains, not of the type of Pierre's arrival. It stands with the unforeseen,
unexpected impediment which we must always take into account even
while it preserves its specific character as unexpected, the impediment
which one can not wait for because it is itself lost in the undetermined.
Indeed even if we admit that the factors are strictly conditioned, which
is not even proved and which requires therefore a metaphysical option,
still their number is infinite and their implications infinitely infinite;
their ensemble does not constitute a system. At least from the point of
28 Sartre here is distinguishing between the reflexive and non-reflexive form of the
verb attendre. I am translating s'attendre as "to expect" and attendre as "to wdt for." As
Sartre indicates, the distinction ordinarily is not sharply maintained. Tr.
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view considered, the envisioned result-my death~n not be foreseen for
any date, and consequently it can not be waited for. Perhaps while I am
peacefully writing in this room, the state of the universe is such that my
death has approached considerably closer; but perhaps, on the contrary,
it has just been considerably removed. For example, if I am waiting for a
a mobilization order, I can consider that my death is imminent-i.e.,
that the chances of an imminent death are considerably increased; but
. it can happen that at the same moment an international conference is
being held in secret and that it has discovered a way of prolonging the
peace.
Thus I can not say that the minute which,is passing is bringing death
closer to me. It is true that death is coming to me if I co

nsider very
broadly that my life is limited. But within these very elastic limits (I can
die at the age of a hundred or at thirty-seven, tomorrow) I can not
know whether this end is coming closer to me or being removed farther
from me. This is because there is a considerable differenc~ in quality
between death at the limit of old age and sudden death which annihilates
us at the prime of life or in youth. To wait for the former is to accept
the fact that life is a limited enterprise; it is one way among others of
choosing finitude and electing our ends on the foundation of finitude.
To wait for the second wodd be to wait with the idea that my life is an
enterprise which is lacking. If only deaths from old age existed (or deaths
by explicit condemnation), then I could wait for my death. But the
unique quality of death is the fact that it can always before the end sur-
prise those who wait for it at such and such a date. And while death
from old age can be confused with the finitude of our choice and con-
sequently can be lived as the resolved chord of our life (we are given a
task and we are given time to accomplish it), sudden death, on the
contrary, is such that it can in no way be waited for. Sudden death is
undetennined and by definition can not be waited for at any date; it
always, in fact, includes the possibility that we shall die in surprise before
the awaited date and consequently that our waiting may be, qua waiting,
a deception or that we shall survive beyond this date; in the latter case
since we were only this waiting, we shall outlive ourselves.
Moreover as the sudden death is qualitatively different from the other
only to the extent that we live one or the other biologically (that is, from
the point of view of the universe they differ in no way as to their causes
and the factors which determine them) the indetermination of the one
actually is reflected in the other. This means that one can wait for a death
from old age only blindly or in bad faith. We have, in fact, every chance
of dying before we have accomplished our task, or, on the other hand,
of outliving it. There is therefore a very slim chance that our death will be
presented to us as that of Sophocles was, for example, in the manner of a
resolved chord. And if it is only chance which decides the character
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of our death and therdore of our life, then even the death which most
resembles the end of a melody can not be waited for as such; luck by
determining it for me removes from it any character as an harmonious
end. An end of a melody in order to confer its meaning on the melody
must emanate from the melody itself. A death like that of Sophocles
will therefore resemble a resolved chord but will not be one, just as the
group of letters formed by the falling of alphabet blocks will perhaps
resemble a word but will not be one. Thus this perpetual appearance of
chance at the heart of my projects can not be apprehended as my possi-
bility but, on the contrary, as the nihilation of all my possibilities, a nihila-
tion which itself is no longer a part of my possibilities. Thus death is not
my possibility of no longer realizing a presence in the world but rather
an always possible nihilation of my possibles which is outside my possi-
bilities.
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This can be expressed in a slightly different way if we approach the
problem from the consideration of meanings.

Human reality is meaning-
ful, as we know. This means that human reality makes known to itself what it is by means of that which is not, or if you prefer, that it is to come to itself. If therefore it is perpetually engaged in its own future, this compels us to say that it waits for the confirmation of this future. As future, in fact, that which is to come is pre-outlined by a present which will be; one puts oneself in the. hands of this present which alone, by virtue of bl:ing present, is to be able to confirm or invalidate the pre-outlined mearl1i:g which I am. As this present will be itself a free recovery of the past in the light of a new future, we shall not be able to determine it but only to project it and wait for it. The meaning of my actual conduct is the reprimand which I wish to be administered to a particular person who has soriously offended me. But how do I know whether this reprimand will not be transformed into irritated and timid stammerings and wheth;:r the meaning of my present conduct will not be transformed in the past? Freedom limits freedom; the past derives its meaning from the present. This, as we have shown, explains the paradox that our actual conduct is both tOtally translucent (the pre-reflective cogito) and .1t the same time totally hidden by a free determination which we must wait for. The adolescent is perfectly conscious of the mystic sense of his conduct, and at the same time he must entrust himself to all his future in order to determine whether he is in the process of "passing through a crisis of puberty" or of engaging himself in earnest in the way of devotion. 1bus our further freedom, inasmuch as it is not our aetual possibility but the foundation of possibilities which we are not yet, constitutes as a sort of opacity in full translucency something like what Barres calk:d "the mystery in broad daylight." Hence this necessity for us to wa:t for ourselves. Our life is only a long waiting: first a waiting for the realization of our ends (to be engaged in an undertaking is to wait for its outcome)

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and especially a waiti~g for ourselves (even if this undertaking is realized, even if I am able to make myself loved, to obtain this distinction, this favor, it remains for me to determine the place, the meaning, and the value of this very enterprise in my life). This does not stern from a contingent lack in human "nature," from a nervousness which would prevent us from limiting ourselves to the present and which could be corrected by practice"but rather from the very nature of the for-itself which "is" to the extent that it temporalizes itself. Thus it is necessary to consider our life as being made up not· only of waitings but of waitings which themselves wait for waitings. There we have the very structure of selfness: to be oneself is to come to oneself. These waitings evidently all include a reference to a final term which would be waited for without waiting for anything more. A repose which would be being and no longer a waiting for being. The whole series is suspended from this final term which on principle is never given and which is the value of our being-that is, evidently, a plenitude of the type "in-itself-for-itself." By means of this final term the recovery of our past would be made once and for all. We should know for always whether a particular youthful experience had been fruitful or ill-s

tarred, whether a particular crisis of puberty was a caprice or
a real pre-formation of my later engagements; the curve of our life would
be fixed forever. In short, the account would be closed. Christians have
tried to take death as this final term. The Reverend Father Boisselot in a
private conversation with me gave me to understand that the "Last Judg-
ment" was precisely this closing of the account which renders one unable
any longer to recover his stroke and which makes one finally be what one
has been-irremediably.
But there is an error here analogous to that which we pointed out
earlier in connection with Leibniz although it is put at the other ,end of
existence. For Leibniz we are free since our acts derive from our essence.
Yet the single fact that our essence has not been chosen by us shows
that all this freedom in particulars actually covers over a total slavery.
God chose Adam's essence. Conversely if it is the closing of the account
which gives our life its meaning and its value, then it is of little import-
ance that all the acts of which the web of our life is made have been free;
the very meaning of them escapes us if we do not ourselves choose the
moment at which the account will be closed. This has been clearly per-
_ ceived by the free-thinking author of an anecdote echoed in the work of
Diderot. Two brothers appeared at the divine tribunal on the Day of
Judgment. The first said to God, "Why did you make me die so young?"
And God said, "In order to save you. If you had lived longer, you would
have committed a crime as your brother did." Then the brother in tum
asked, "Why did you make me die so old?" If death is not the free deter-
mination of our being, it can not complete our life. If one minute more or
less may perhaps change everything and if this minute is added to or
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removed from my account, then even admitting that I am free to use my
life, the meaning of my life escapes me. Now the Christian death comes
from God. He chooses our hour, and in a general way I know clearly that
even if it is I who by temporalizing myself cause there to be minutes
and hours in general, still the minute of my death is not fixed by me;
the seauences of the universe detemline it.
If this is the case, we can no longer even say that death confers a mean-
ing on life from the outside; a meaning can COme only from subjectivity.
Since death does not appear on the foundation of our freedom, it can only
remove all meaning from life. If I am a waiting for waitings for waiting
and if suddenly the object of my final waiting and the one who awaits it
are suppressed, the waiting takes on retrospectively the character of
absurdity. For example, this young man has lived for thirty years in the
expectation of becoming a great writer, but this waiting itself is not
enough; it becomcs a vain and senseless obstinacy or a profound compre-
hension of his value according to the books which he writes. His first
book has appeared, but by itself what does it mean? It is the book of a
beginner. Let us admit that it is good; still it gets its meaning through
the future. If it is unique, it is at once inauguration and testament. He
had only one book to write; he is limited and cut off by his work; he will
not be "a great writer." If the novel is one in a mediocre series, it is an
"accident." If it is followed by other better books, it can classify its au

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in the first rank. But exactly at this point death strikes the author-at the very moment when he was anxiously testing himself to find out "whether he had the stuff" to write another work, at the moment when he was still expecting to become a great writer. This is enough to cause everything to fall into the undetermined: I can not say that the dead writer is .the author of a single book (in the sense that he would have had only one book to write) nor that he would have written several (since in fact only one has appeared). I can say nothing. Suppose that Balzac had died before Les Chouans; he would remain the author of some execrable novels of intrigue. But suddenly the very expectation which this young man was, this expectation of being a great man, loses any kind of meaning; it is neither an obstinate and egotistical blindness nor the true sense of his own value since nothing shall ever decide it. It would be useless indeed to try to decide it by considering the sacrifices which he made to his art, the obscure and hard life which he was willing to lead; just as many mediocre figures have had the strength to make comparable sacrifices. On the contrary, the final value of this conduct remains forever in suspense; or if you prefer, the ensemble (particular kinds of conduct, expectations, values) falls suddenly into the absurd. Thus death is never that which gives life its meanings; it is, on the contrary, that which on principle removes all meaning from life. If we must die, then our life has no meaning because its problems receive no. solu-
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tion and because the very meaning of the problems remains undetermined.

It would be in vain for us to resort to suicide in order to escape this necessity. Suicide can not be considered as an end of life for which I should be the unique foundation. Since it is an act of my life, indeed, it itself requires a meaning which only the future can give to it; but as it is the last act of my life, it is denied this future. Thus it remains totally undetermined. If I escape death, or if I "misfire," shall I not judge later that my suicide was cowardice? Will the outcome not show me that other solutions were possible? But since these solutions can be only my own projects, they can appear only if I live. Suicide is an absurdity which causes my life to be submerged in the absurd.

These remarks, it will be noted, are not derived from the consideration of death but, on the contrary from the consideration of life; this is because the for-itself is the being in whose being being is in question; since the for-itself is the being which always lays claim to an "after," there is no place for death in the being which is for-itself. What then could be ,the meaning oi a waiting for death if it is not the waiting for an undetermined event which would reduce all waiting to the absurd, even including that of death itself. A waiting for death would be self-destructive, for it would be the negation of all waiting. My project toward a particular death is comprehensible (suicide, martyrdom, heroism) but not the project toward my ideath as the undetermined possibility of no longer realizing a presence in the world, for this project would be the destruction of all projects. Thus death can not be my peculiar possibility; it can not even be one of my possibilities.

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Furthermore, death, in so far as it can be revealed

to me, is not only
the always possible nihilation of my possibles, a nihilation outside my possiblities. It is not only the project which destroys all projects and which destroys itself, the impossible destruction of my expectations. It is also the triumph of the point of view of the Other over the point of view which I am toward myself. This is doubtless what Malraux means when in l'Espoir he says of death that it "transforms life into destiny." Death, in fact, is only on its negative side the nihilation of my possibilities; since indeed I am my possibilities only through the nihilation of being-in-itself which I have to be, death as the nihilation of a nihilation is a positing of my being as in-itself in the sense in which for Hegel the negation of a negation is an affirmation. So long as the for-itself is "in life" it surpasses its past toward its future, and the past is that which the for-itself has to be. When the for-itself "ceases to live:' this past is not thereby abolished. The disappearance of the nihilating being does not touch that part of its being which is of the type of the in-itself; it is engulfed in the in-itself. My whole life is. This means not that it is an harmonious totality but that it has ceased to be its own suspense and
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that it can no longer change itself by the simple consciousness which it has of itself. Quite the contrary, the meaning of any phenomenon whatsoever in that life is henceforth fixed not by itself but by this open totality which is the arrested life. This meaning in the primary and fundamental sense is an absence of meaning, as we have seen. But in a secondary and derived sense thousands of shimmering, iridescent relative meanings can come into play upon this fundamental absurdity of a "dead" life.
For example, whatever may have been its ultimate vanity, the fact remains that Sophocles' life was happy, that Balzac's life was prodigiously industrious, etc. Naturally these general 'qualifications can be made tighter; we can risk a description, an analysis, along with a narration of this life. \Ve shall obtain more distinct characteristics; for example, we shall be able to speak of a particular dead woman in the same way as Mauriac speaks of one of his heroines when he says that she lived in "pmdent desperation." We shall be able to grasp the meaning of Pascal's "soul" (i.e., of his inward "life") as "magnificent and bitter" as Nietzsche described it. We can go on to qualify a particular episode as "rowardly" or "tactless" without, however, ever losing sight of the fact that only the contingent arrest of this "being-in-perpetual-suspense" which is the living for-itself allows us on the foundation of a radical absurdity to confer a relative meaning on the episode considered, and that this meaning is an essentiaIly provisory meaning, the provisory quality of which has accidentaIly passed into the definitive. But these various explanations of the meaning of Pierre's life-when it was Pierre himself who effected them in his own life-resulted in changing the meaning and the orientation; for every description of one's own life when it is attempted by the for-itself is a project of the self beyond this life. And as the altering project is by the same token bound to life which it alters, it is Pierre's own life which metamorphoses its meaning by continually temporalizing itself. Now that his life i

s dead, only the memory of the Other can prevent Pierre's
life from shriveling up in its plenitude in-itself by cutting all its moor-
ings with the present.
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The unique characteristic of a dead life is that it is a life of which the
Other makes himself the guardian. This does not mean simply that the
Other preserves the life of the "deceased" by effecting an explicit, cogni-
tive reconstruction of it. 'Quite the contrary, such a reconstruction is
only one of the possible attitudes of the Other in relation to the dead
life; consequently the character of a "reconstructed life" (in the midst
of the family through the memories of relatives, in the historic environ-
ment) is a particular destiny which is going to mark some lives to the
exclusion of others. The necessary result is that the opposite quality "a
life fallen into oblivion"-also represents a specific destiny capable of
description, one which comes to certain lives again in terms of the Other.
To be forgotten is to be made the object of an attitude of another,
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and of an implicit decision on the part of the Other. To be forgottcn is, in
fact, to be resolutely apprehended forever as one element dissolved into a
mass (the "great feudi1110rds of the thirteenth century," the "bourgeois
Whigs" of the eighteenth, the Soviet officials," etc.); it is in no way to
be annihilated, but it is to lose one's personal existence in order to be
constituted with others in a collective existence.
This shows us clearly what we hoped to prove~ it is that the Other can
not be first without any contact with the dead so as to decide subse-
quently (or so that circumstances may decide) that he will have this or
that relation with certain particular dead (those whom he has known
while they were alive, the "famous dead," etc.). In reality the relation
with the dead-with all the dead-is an essential structure of the funda-
mental relation which we have called "being-for-others." In its upsurge
into being, the for-itself must assume a position in relation to the dead;
his initial project organizes them in large anonymous masses or as distinct
individualities. And for these collective masses as for these individualities
he determines their removal or their absolute proximity; he 'unfolds tem-
poral distances between them and himself by temporalizing himself just
as he unfolds spatial distances in terms of his surroundings. While making
himself known to himself through his end he decides the peculiar impor-
tance of the extinct collectivities or individualities. A particular group
which will be strictlyanonymons and amorphous for Pierre will be specific
and structured for me; another, purely uniform for me, will for Jean
effect the appearance of its component individuals. Byzantium, Rome,
Athens, the second Crusade, the Convention, as many immense necropo-
leis as I can see from near or far, from casual observation 0:' careful
scrutiny according to the position which I take, which I "am." It is not
impossible (provided one understands this properly) to define a "person"
by his dead-i.e., by the areas of individualization or of collectivization
which he has determined in the necropolis, by the roads and pathways
which he has traced, by the information which he has decided to get for
himself, by the "roots" which he has put down there.
Of course the dead choose us, but it is necessary first that we have
chosen them

. We find here again the original relation which binds facticity to freedom: we choose our own attitude toward the dead, but it is not possible for us not to choose an attitude. Indifference with respect to the dead is a perfectly possible attitude (examples of it will be found among the heimatIos, among certain revolutionaries, or among individualists). But this indifference-which consists of making the dead "die again"-is one conduct among others with respect to them. Thus by its very facticity, the for-itself is thrown into full "responsibility" with respect to the dead; it is obliged to decide freely the fate of the dead. In particular, when it is a question of the dead who surround us, it is not possible for 1.15 not to decide-explicitly or. implictly-the fate of their
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enterprises; this is obvious when it is a question of the son who continues his father's business or .the disciple who continues the school and the teachings of his master. But although the bond is less clearly visible in a good number of circumstances, it is there also in every case in which the dead and the living belong to the same historical and concrete collectivity. It is I, it is the men of my generation who decide the meaning of the efforts and the enterprises of the preceding generation whether we resume and continue their social and political attempts, or whether we realize a decisive rupture and throw the dead back into inefficacy. As we have seen, it is the America of 1917 which decides the value and the meaning of the deeds of La Fayette.

Thus from this point of view we can see clearly the difference between life and death: life decides its own meaning because it is always in suspense; it possesses essentially a power of self-criticism and self-metamorphosis which causes it to define itself as a "not-yet" or, if you like, makes it be as the changing of what it is~ The dead life does not thereby cease to change, and yet it is all done. This means that for it the chips are down and that it will henceforth undergo its changes without being in any way responsible for them. For this life it is not a question only of an arbitrary and definitive totalization. In addition there is a radical transformation: nothing more can happen to it inwardly; it is entirely closed; nothing more can be made to enter there; but its meaning does not cease to be modified from the outside. Until the death of this apostle of peace the meaning of his enterprises (as folly or as a profound sense of the truth of things, as successful or a failure) was in his own hands. "So long as I am here, there will not be any war." But to the extent that this meaning surpasses the limits of a simple individuality, to the extent that the person makes himself known to himself through an objective situation to be realized (the peace in Europe), death represents a total dispossession; it is the Other who dispossesses the Apostle of peace of the very meaning of his efforts and therefore of his being, for the Other despite himself and by his very upsurge undertakes to transform into failure or success, into folly or an intuition of genius the vcry enterprise by which the person made himself known to himself and which he was in his being.

Thus the very existence of death alienates iIS wholly in our own life to the advantage of the Other. To be dead is to be a prey for the living. This means t

herefore that the one who tries to grasp the meaning of his future death must discover himself as the future prey of others. We have here therefore a case of alienation which we did not consider in the section of this work which we devoted to the For-others. The alienations which we studied there, in fact, were those which we could nihilate by transforming the Other into a transcendence-transcended, just as we could nihilate our outside by the absolute and subjective positing of oar free·

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dom. So long as I live I can escape what I am for the Other by revealing to myself by my freely posited ends that I am nothing and that I make myself be what I am; so long as I live, I can give the lie to what others discover in me, by projecting myself already toward other ends and in every instance by revealing that my dimension of being-for-myself is incommensurable with my dimension of being-for-others. Thus ceaselessly I escape my outside and ceaselessly I am reapprehended by the Other; and in this "dubious battle" the definitive victory belongs to neither the one nor the other of these modes of being. But the fact of death without being precisely allied to either of the adversaries jn this same combat. gives the final victory to the point of view of the Other by transferring the combat and the prize to another level-that is, by suddenly suppressing one of the combatants. In this sense to die is to be condemned no matter what ephemeral victory one has won over the Other; even if one has made use of the Other to "sculpture one's own statue," to die is to exist only through the Other, and to owe to him one's meaning and the very meaning of one's victory.

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If we share the realist views which we presented in Part Three, we must recognize that my existence after death is not the simple spectral survival "in the Other's consciousliess" of simple representations (images, memories, etc.) concerning me. My being-for-others is a rca! being. If .it remains in the hands of the Other like a coat which I leave to him after my disappearance, this is by virtue of a real dimension of my being-a dimension which has become my unique dimeusion-and not in the form of an unsubstantial specter. Richelieu, Louis XV, my grandfather are by no means the simple sum of my memories, nor even the sum of the memories or the pieces of knowledge of all those who have heard of them; they are objective and opaque beings which are reduced to the single dimension of extcriority. In this capacity they will pursue their history in the human world, but they will never be more than transccndences-transcended in the midst of the world. Thus not only does death disarm my waiting by definitively removing the waiting and by abandoning in indetermination the realization of the ends which make knowll to me what I am-but again it confers a meaning from the outside on everything which I live in subjectivity. Death reapprehends all this subjective which while it "lived" defended itself against exteriorization, and death deprives it of all subjective meaning in order to hand it over to any objective meaning which th~ Othcr is pleased to give to it. Nevertheless it should be noted that this "destiny" thus conferred on my life remains also in suspense, in reprievc. The reply to the question, "\Vhat will be the definitive historical destiny of Robespierre?" depends on the reply to this preli

nouncing Heidegger's being-unto-death, have we abandoned forever the possibility of frcely giving to our being a meaning for which we are responsible?

Quite the contrary. As it seems to us, death by being revealed to us as it really is frees us wholly from its so-called constraint. This will be clearer if we but reflect on the matter.

First, however, it will be well to separate r2dically the two usually combined ideas of death and finitude. Ordinarily the belief seems to be that it is death which constitutes our finitude and which reveals it to us. From this combination it results that death takes on the shape of an ontological np.cessity and that finitude, on the other hand, borrows from death its contingent character. Heidegger in partil:ular seems to have based his whole theory of Sein-zum-Tode on the strict identification of death and finitude. In the same way Malraux when he tells us that death reveals to us the uniqueness of life, seems to hold that it is just because we die that we are powerless to recover our stroke and are therefore finite. But if we consider the matter a little more closely, we detect their error: death is a contingent fact which belongs to facticity; finitude is an ontological structure of the for-itself which determines freedom and exists only in and through the free project of the end which makes my being knO\vn to me. In other words human reality would remain finite even if it wcre immortal, because it makes itself finite by choosing itself as human. To be finite, in fact, is to choose oneself-that is, to make known to onesclf what one is by projecting oneself toward one possible to the exclusion of others. The very act of freedom is therefore the assumption and creation of finitude. If I make myself, I make myself finite and hence my life is unique. Consequently even if I were immortal, it would be forbidden me to "recover my stroke;" it is the irreversibility of temporality which forbids me, ;'Ind this irreversibility is nothing but the peculiar character ofa freedom which temporalizes itself. Of course if I am immortal and have had to reject the possible B in order to realize the possible A, the opportunity may be offered me later to realize the refused possible. But by the very fact that this opportunity will be presented after the refused opportunity, it will not be the same, and consequently I shall for all eternity have made myself finite by irremediably rejecting the first opportunlty. From this point of view, the immortal man like the mortal is born several and makes himself one. Even if one is temporally indefinite-i.e., without limits-one's "life" will be nevertheless finite in its very being because it makes itself unique. Death has nothing to do with this. Death occurs "within time," and human-reality by revealing to itself its unique finitude does not thereby discover its mortality.

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Thus death is in no wayan ontological structure of my being, at least not in so far as my being is for itself; it is the Other who is mortal in

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his being. There is no place for death in being-for-itself; it can neither wait for death nor realize it nor project itself toward it; death is in no way the foundation of the finitude of the for-itself. In a general way death can neither be founded from within like the project of original freedom, nor can it be received from the outside as a quality

by the for-itself. What
then is death? Nothing but a certain aspect of facticity and of being-for-others-i.e., nothing other than the given. It is absurd that we are born; it is absurd that we die. On the other hand, this absurdity is presented as the permanent alienation of my being-possibility which is no longer my possibility but that of the Other. It is therefore an external and factual limit of my subjectivity!

But do we not recognize at this point the description which we attempted in the preceding section? This factual limit which on the one hand WI; must affirm since nothing penetrates us from outside and since in one sense it is very necessary that we experience death if we are to be able even to name it, this factual limit which, on the other hand, is never encountered by the for-itself since it does not enter into the for-itself save as the indefinite permanence of its being-for-others-what is this limit if not precisely one of the unrealizables? What is it if not a synthetic aspect of our reverse side? Mortal represents the present being which I am for the Other; dead represents the future meaning of my actual for-itself for the Other. We are dealing therefore with a permanent limit of my projects; and as such this limit is to be assumed. It is therefore an exteriority which remains exteriority even in and through the attempt of the for-itself to realiz:.- it. It is what we defined above as the unrealizable to be realized. There is basically no difference between the choice by which freedom assumes its death as the inapprehensible and inconceivable limit of its 'subjectivity and that by which it chooses to be a freedom limited by the fact of the Other's freedom. Thus death is not my possibility in the sense previously defined; it is a situation-limit as the chosen and fugitive reverse side of my choice. It is not my possible in the sense that it would be my own end which would make known to me my being. But due to the fact that it is an unavoidable necessity of existing elsewhere as an outside and an in-itself, it is interiorized as "ultimate;" that is, as a thematic meaning of the hierarchical possibles, a meaning out of reach.

Thus death haunts me at the very heart of each of my projects as their inevitable reverse side. But precisely because this "reverse" is to be assumed net as my possibility but as the possibility that there are for me no longer any possibilities, it does not penetrate me. The freedom which is my freedom remains total and infinite. Dcath is not an obstacle to my projects; it is only a destiny of these projects elsewhere. And this is not because death does not Ilimit my freedom but because freedom never encounters this limit. I am not "free to die," but I am a free

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mortal. Since death escapes my projects because it is unrealizable, I myself escape death in my very project. Since death is always beyond my subjectivity, there is no place for it in my subjectivity. This subjectivity does not affirm itself against death but independently of it although this affirmation is immediately alienated. Therefore we can neither think of death nor wait for it nor arm ourselves against it; but also our projects as projects are independent of death-not because of our blindness, as the Christian says, but on principle. And although there are innumerable possible attitudes with which we may confront this unrealizable

which
"in the bargain"'is to be realized, there is no place for classifying these attitudes as authentic or unauthentic since we always die in the bargain. These various descriptions relating to my place, my past, my environment, my death, and my fellowman do not claim to be exhaustive or even detailed. Their aim is simply to grant us a clearer conception of the "situation." Thanks to these descriptions, it is going to be possible for us to define mOre precisely this "being-in-situation" which characterizes the For-itself in so far as it is responsible for its manner of being without being the foundation of its being.

(1) I am an existent in the midst of other existents. But I can not "realize" this existence in the midst of others; I can not apprehend as objects the existents which surround me nor apprehend myself as a surrounded existence nor even give a meaning to this notion of "in the midst of" except by choosing myself-not in my being but in my manner of being. The choice of this end is the choice of what is not-yet-existing. My position in the midst of the world is defined by the relation between the instrumental utility or adversity in the realities which surround me and my own facticity; that is, the discovery of the dangers which I risk in the world, of the obstacles which I can encounter there, the aid which can be offered me, all in the light of a radical nihilation of myself and of it radical, internal negation of the in-itself and all effected from the point of view of a freely posited end. This is what we mean by the situation.

(2) The situation exists only in correlation with the surpassing of the given toward an end. It is the way in which the given which I am and the given which I am not are revealed to the For-itself ,which I am in the mode of not-being it. When we speak of situation therefore we arc speaking of a "position apprehended by the For-itself which is in situation." It is impossible to consider a situation from the outside; it is fixed in a form in itself. Consequently the situation can not be called either objective nor subjective although the partial structures of this situation (the cup which I use, the table on which I lean, etc.) can and must be strictly objective.

The situation can not be subjective, for it is neither the sum nor the unity of the impressions which things make on us. It is the things them-
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selves and myself among things; for my upsurge into the world as the pure nihilation of being has no other result but to cause there to be things, and it adds nothing. In this aspect the situation betrays my facticity; that is, the fact that things simply are there as they are without the necessity or the possibility of being otherwise and that I am there among them.

But neither can the situation be objective in the sense that it would be a pure given whioh the subject would establish without being in any way engaged in the system thus constituted. In fact the situation by the very meaning of the given (a meaning without which there would not even be any given) reflects to the for-itself its freedom. If the situation is neither subjective nor objective, this is because it does not constitute a knowledge nor even an affective comprehension of the state of the world by a subject. The situation is a relation of being between a for-itself and the in-itself which the for-itself nihilates.

The situation is the
whole subject (he is nothing but his situation) and it is also the whole "thing" (there is never anything more than things). The situation is the subject illuminating things by his very surpassing, if you like; it is things referring,to the subject his own image. It is the total facticity, the absolute contingency of the world, of my birth, of my place, of my past, of my environment, of the fact of my fellowman-and it is my freedom without limits as that which causes there to be for me a facticity. It is this dusty, ascending road, this burning thirst which I have, the refusal of these people to give me anything to drink because I do not have any money or because I am not of their country or of their race; it is my abandonment in the midst of these hostile populations along with this fatigue in my body which will perhaps prevent me from reaching the goal which I had set for myself. But also it is precisely this goal, not in so far as I clearly and explicitly formulate it but in so far as it is there everywhere around me as that which unifies and explains all these facts, that which organizes them in a totality capable of description instead of making of them a disordered nightmare.

(3) If the for-itself is nothing other than its situation, then it follows that being-in-situation defines human reality by accounting both for its being-there and for its being-beyond. Human reality is indeed the being which is always beyond its being-there. And the situation is the organized totality of the being-there, interpreted and lived in and through being-beyond. Therefore there is no priviledged situation. We mean by this that there is no situation in which the given would crush beneath its weight the freedom which constitutes it as such-and that conversely there is no situation in which the for-itself would be more free than in others. This must not be understood in the sense of that "inward freedom" of Bergson's which Politzer ridiculed in La fin d'une parade philosophique (The End of a Philosophical Parade) and which simply amounted

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to recognizing in the slave the independence of the inner life and of the heart in chains. When we declare..that. the slave in chains is as free as his master, we do not mean to speak of a freedom which would remain undetermined. The slave in chains is free to break them; this means that the very meaning of his chains will appear to him in the light of the end which he will have chosen: to remain.a-slave or to risk the worst in order to get rid of his slavery. Of course the slavewill·not be able to obtain the wealth and the standard of living of his master; but these are not the objects of his projects; he can only dream of the possession of these treasures. The slave's facticity is such that the world appears to him with another countenance and that he has to posit and to resolve different problems; in particular it is necessary fundamentally to choose himself on the ground of slavery and thereby to give a meaning to this obscure constraint. For example, if he chooses revolt, then slavery, far from being at the start an obstacle to this revolt, takes on its meaning and its coefficient of adversity only through the revolt. To be elcact, just because the life of the slave who revolts and dies' in the course of this revolt is a free life, just because the situation illuminated by a free p

roject is full and concrete, just because the urgent and principal problem of this life is "Shall I attain my goal?"-just because of all this, the situation of the slave can not be compared with that of the master. Each of them in fact takes on its meaning only for the for-itself in situation and in terms of the free choice of its ends. A comparison could be made only by a third person and consequently it could take place only between two objective forms in the midst of the world; moreover it could be established only in the light of a project freely chosen by this third person. There is no absolute ~oint of view which one can adopt so as to compare different situations, ~ach person realizes only one situation-his own.

(4) Since the situation is illumined by ends which are themselves projected only in terms of the being-there, which they illuminate, it is presented as eminently concrete. Of course it contains and sustains abstract and universal structures, but it must be understood as the single countenance which the world turns toward us as our unique and personal chance. We may recall here a fable of Kafka's: A merchant comes to plead his case at the castle where a forbidding guard bars the entrance. The merchant does not dare to go further; he waits and dies still waiting. At the hour of death he asks the guardian, "How does it happen that I was the only one waiting?" And the guardian replies, "This gate was made only for you." Such is precisely the case with the for-itself if we may add in addition that each man makes for himself his own gate. The concreteness of the situation is expressed particularly by the fact that th~ for-itself never aims at ends which are fundamentally abstract and unIversal. Ofcourse we shall see in the next chapter that the profound mean-

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ing of the choice is universal and that consequently the for-itself causes a human-reality to exist as a species. Again itl is necessary to disengage the meaning which is implicit, and it is for this that we shall use existential psychoanalysis. Once disengaged the temlinal and initial meaning of the for-itself will appear as an UnseIbstandig which in order to manifest itself needs a particular kind of concretion.24 But the end of the for-itself as it is lived and pursued in the project by which the for-itself surpasses and founds the real is revealed in its concrcteness to the for-itself as a particular change in the situation which it lives (e.g., to break its chains, to be King of the 'Franks, to liberate Poland, to fight for the proletariat) . At first the for-itself will not project fighting for the proletariat in general but will aim at the proletariat across a particular concrete group of workers to which the person belongs. This is due to the fact that the end illuminates the given only because the end is chosen as the surpassing of this given. The for-itself does not arise with a wholly given end. but by "making" the situation, the for-itself "makes itself"-and conversely.

(5) Just as the situation is neither objective or subjective, so it can be considered neither as the free result of a freedom nOT as the ensemble of the constraints to which I am subject; it stems from the illumination of the constraint by freedom which gives to it its meaning as constraint. Among brute existents there can be no connection; it is freedom which founds the connectio

ns by grouping the existents into instrumental-com-
plexes; and it is freedom which projects the reason for the connections-
that is, its end. But precisely because I project myself toward an end
across a world of connections, I now meet with sequences, with linked
series, with complexes, and I must determine to act according to laws.
These laws and the way I make use of them decide the failure or the suc-
cess of my attempts. But it is through freedom that legal relations come
into the world. Thus freedom enchains itself in the world as a free proj-
ect toward ends.
(6) The For-itself is a temporalization. This means that it is not but
that it "makes itself." It is the situation which must account for that
substantial permanence which we readily recognize in people ("He has
not changed." "He is always the same.") and which the person experi-
ences empirically in most cases as being his own. The free perseverance in
a single project does not imply any permanence; quite the contrary, it is a
perpetual renewal of my engagement-as we have seen. On the other
hand, the realities enveloped and illuminated by a project which develops
and confirms itself present the permanence of the in-itself; and to the
c'(tent that they refer our image to us, they support us with their ever-
lastingness; in fact it frequently happens that we take their permanence
for our own. III particular the permanence of place and environment, of
24 Cf. the following chapter.
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the judgments passed on us by our fellowmen, of our past-all shape a
degraded image of our perseverance. While I am temporalizing myself,
I am always French, a civil servant or a proletarian for otheis. This un-
realizable has the character of an invariable limit for my situation.
Similarly what we call a person's temperament or character but which
is nothing but his free project in so far as it is-for-the-Other, appears
also for the For-itself as an invariable unrealizable. 'Alain has perceived
correctly that character is a vow. When a man says, "I am not easy to
please," he is entering into a free engagement with his ill-temper, and
by the same token his words are a free interpretation of certain ambiguous
details in his past. In this sense there is no character; there is only a
project of oneself. But we must not, however, misunderstand the given
aspect of the character. It is true that for the Other who apprehends me
as the Other-as-object, I am ill-tempered, hypocritical or frank, cowardly
or courageous. This aspect is referred to m~ by the Other's look; by
the experience of the look, this character, which was a free, project lived
and self-conscious, b-:·::omes an unrealizable ne varietur to be assumed.
It depends then not only on the Other but on the position which I have
taken with respect to the Other and on my perseverance in maintaining
this position. So long as I let myself be fascinated by the Other's look,
my character will figure in my own eyes as an unrealizable ne varietur,
the substantial permanence of my being-the kind of thing expressed in
such ordinary everyday remarks as "I am forty-five years old, and I'm not
going to start changing myself today." The Character often is what the
For-itself tries to recover in order to become the In-itself-for-itself which
it projects being. Nevertheless it should be noted that this permanence
of the past, of the environment, and of characte

r are not given qualities;
they are revealed on things only in correlation with the continuity of my project. For example, when after a war, after a long exile one finds a particular mountain landscape unchanged, it would be in vain to hope to found upon the inertia and apparent permanence of these stones the hope for a renascence of the past. This landscape reveals its permanence only across a persevering project. These mountabshave a meaning inside my situation; in one way or another they shape my belonging to a nation which is at peace, her own mistress, one who holds a certain rank in the international hierarchy. Let me find them again after a defeat and during the occupation of a part of the national territory, and they can not offer me the same countenance. This is because I myself have other projects, because I am engaged differently ill the world.
Finally we have seen that internal upheavals of the situation because of autonomous changes in the environment are always to be anticipated. These changes can never provoke a change of my project, but on the foundation of my freedom they can effect a simplification or a complication of the situation. Consequently my initial project will be revealed to
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me with more or less simplicity.' For a person is never either simple or complex; it is his situation which can be one or the other. In fact I am nothing but the project of myself beyond a determined situation, and this project pre-outlines me in terms of the concrete situation as in addition it illumines the situation in terms of my choice. If therefore the situation in its ensemble is simplified, even iJ landslides, cave-ins, erosions have imprinted upon it a well-marked aspect of heavier features with violent contrasts, I shall myself be simple, for my choice-the choice which I am-is an apprehension of this situation here and can only be simple. The birth of new complications will have the result of presenting me with a complicated situation beyond which I shall find myself complicated. This is something which everyone has been able to establish if he has observed with what almost animal simplicity prisoners of war react following the extreme simplification of their situation. This simplification can not modify the meaning of their project; but on the very foundation of my freedom it causes my environment to become con· densed and uniform and to be constituted in and through a clearer, more brutal, and more condensed apprehension of the fundamental ends of the captive person. In short we are dealing with an internal metabolism, not with a global metamorphosis which would affect as well the l0rm of the situation. These are, nevertheless, changes which I discover:Js changes "in my life"-that is, changes within the unitary compass of a single project.

III. FREEDOM AND RESPONSIBILITY

ALTHOUGH the considerations which are about to follow are of interest primarily to' the ethicist, it may nevertheless be worthwhile after these descriptions and arguments to return to the freedom of the for-itself and to try to understand what the fact of this freedom represents for human destiny.
The essential consequence of our earlier remarks is that man being condemned to be free carries the weight of the whole world on his shoulders; he is responsible for the world and for himself as a way of being. We are taking the word "responsibility"

in its ordinary sense as
"consciousness (of) being the incontestable author of an event or of an object." In this sense the responsibility of the for-itself is overwhelming since he25 is the one by whom it happens that there is a world; since he is also the one who makes himself be, then whatever may be the situation in which he finds himself, the for-itself must wholly assume this situa-

25 I am shifting to the persona}pronoun here since Sartre is describing the for-itself in concrete personal terms rather than as a metaphysical entity. Strictly speaking, of course, this is his position throughout, and the French "i!" is indifferently "he" or "it." Tr.

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tion with its peculiar coefEcient of adversity, even though it be insupportable. He must assume the situation with the proud consciousness ot being the author of it, for the very worst disadvantages or the worst threats which can endanger my person have meaning only in and through my project; and it is on the ground of the engagement which I am that they appear. It is therefore senseless to think of complaining since nothing foreign has decided what we feel, what we live, or what we are. Furthermore this absolute responsibility is not resignation; it is simply the logical-requirement of the consequences of our freedom. What happens to mc happens through me, and I can neither affect myself with it nor revolt against it nor resign myself to it. Moreover everything which happens to me is mine. By this we must understand first of all that I am always equal to what happens to me qua man, for what happens to a man through other men and through himself can be only human. TIIe most terrible situations of war, the worst tortures do not create a non-human state of things; there is no non-human situation. It is only through fear, flight, and recourse to magical types of conduct that I shall decide on the non-human, but this decision is human, and I shall carry the entire responsibility for it. But in addition the situation is mine because it is the image of my free choice of myself, and everything which it presents to me is mine in that this represents me and symbolizes me. Is it not I who decide the coefficient of adversity in things and even their unpredictability by deciding myself?

Thus there are no accidents in a life; a community event which suddenly bursts forth and involves me in it does not corne from the outside. If I am mobilized in a war, this war is my war; it is in my image and I deserve it. I deserve:it first because I could always get out of it by suicide or by desertion; these ultimate possibles are those which must always be present for us when there is a question of envisaging a situation. For lack of getting out of it, I have chosen it. This can be due to inertia, to cowardice in the face of public opinion, or because I prefer certain other values to the value of the refusal to join in the war (the good opinion of my relatives, the honor of my family, etc.). Anyway you look at it, it is a matter of a choice. This choice will be repeated later on again and again without a break until the end of the war. Therefore we must agree with the statement by J. Romains, "In war there are no innocent victims."27 If therefore I have preferred war to death or to dishonor, everything takes place as if I bore the entire responsibility for this war. Of course other

s have deelared it, and one might be tempted perhaps to
consider me as a simple accomplice. But this notion of complicity has
only a juridical sense, and it does not hold here. For it depended on me
that for me and by me this war should not exist, and· I have decided
that it does exist. There was no compulsion here, for the compulsion
27]. Romains: Les hommes de bonne volonte; "Prelude aVerdun."

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could have got no hold on a freedom. I did not have any excuse; for as
we have said repeatedly in this book, the peculiar character of human-
reality is that it is without excuse. Therefore it -remains for me only to
lay claim to this war.
But in addition the war is mine because by the sole fact that it arises
in a situation which I cause to be and that I can discover it there only
by engaging myself for or against it, I can no longer distinguish at pres-
ent the choice which I make of myself from the choice which I make of
the war. To live this war is to choose myself through it and to choose
it through my choice of myself. There can be no question of considering
it as "four years of vacation" or as a "reprieve," as a "recess," the essential
part of my responsibilities being elsewhere in my married, family, or pro-
fessionallife. In this war which I have chosen I choose myself from day
to day, and I make it mine by making myself. If it is going to be four
empty years, then it is I who bear the responsibility for this.
Finally, as we pointed out earlier, each person is an absolute choice
of self from the standpoint of a world of knowledges and of techniques
which this choice both assumes and illumines; each person is an absolute
upsurge at an absolute date and is perfectly unthinkable at another date.
n is therefore a waste of time to ask what I should have been if this war
had not broken out, for I have chosen myself as one of the possible mean-
ings of the epoch which imperceptibly led to war. I am not distinct
from this same epoch; I could not be transported to another epoch with-
uut contradiction. Thus I am this war which restricts and limits and
makes comprehensible the period which preceded it. In this sense we
may define mme precisely the responsibility of the for-itself if to the
earlier quoted statement, "There are no innocent victims,"we add the
words, "We have the war we deserve." Thus, totally free, undistinguish-
able from the period for which I have chosen to be the meaning, as pro-
foundly responsible for the war as if I had myself declared it, unable to
live without integrating it in my situation, engaging myself in it wholly
and stamping it with my seal, I must be without remorse or regrets as
I am without excuse; for from the instant of my upsurge into being, I
carry the weight of the world by myself alone without anything or any
person being able to lighten it.
.Yet this responsibility is of a very particular type. Someone will say, "I
dId not ask to he born." This is a naive way of throwing greater emphasis
On our facticity. I am responsible for everything, in fact, except for my
very responsibility, for I am not the foundation of my being. Therefore
everything takes place as if I were compelled to be responsible. I am
abandoned in thclworld, not in the sense that I might remain abandoned
and passive in a hostile universe like a board floating on the water, but
rather in the sense that I find myself suddenly alone and withou

only from the point of view
of its free project, which is the impulse by which it thrusts itself toward its end. We should now question this end itself, for it forms a part of absolute subjectivity and is, in fact, its transcendent, objective limit. This is what empirical psychology has hinted at by admitting that a particulat man is defined by his desires. Here, however, we must be on our guard against two errors. First, the empirical psychologist, while defining man by his desires, remains the victim of the illusion of substance. He views desire as being in man by virtue of being "contained" by his consciousness, and he believes that the meaning of the desire is inherent in the desire itself. Thus he avoids everything which could evoke the idea of transcendence. But if I desire a house or a glass of water or a woman's body, how could this body, this glass, this piece of property reside in my desire, and how can my desire be anything but the consciousness of these objects as desirable? Let us beware then of considering these desires as little psychic entities dwelling in consciousness; they are consciousness itself in its original projective, transcendent structure, for COnsciousness is on principle consciousness of something.
The other error, which fundamentally is closely connected with the first, consists in considering psychological research as terminated as soon as the investigator has reached the concrete ensemble of empirical desires. Thus a man would be defined by the bundle of drives or tendencies which empirical observation could establish. Naturally the psychologist will not always limit himself to making up the sum of these tendencies; he will want to bring to light their relationships, their agreements and har-

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monies; he will try to present the ensemble of desires as a synthetic organization in which each desire acts on the others and influences them. A critic, for example; wishing to explain the "psychology" of Flaubert, will write that he "appeared in his early youth to know as his normal state, a continual exaltation resulting from the two-fold feeling of his grandiose ambition and his invincible power.... The effervescence of his young blood was then turned into literary passion as happens about the eighteenth year in precocious souls who find in the energy of style or the intensities of fiction some way of escaping from the need of violent action or of intense feeling, which tonnents them."l
In this passage there is an effort to reduce the complex personality of an adolescent to a few basic desires, as the chemist reduces compound bodies to merely a combination of simple bodies. The primitive givens will be grandiose ambition, the need of violent action and of intense feel· ing; these elements when thp-y enter into combination, produce a permanent exaltation. Then-as Bourget remarks in a few wOl"ds which we have not quoted-this· exaltation nourished by numerous weil chosen readings, is going to seek to delude itself by self-expression in fictions which will appease it symbolically and channel it. There in outline is the genesis of a literary "temperament."
Now in the first place such a psychological analysis proceeds from the postulate that an individual fact is produced by the intersection of abstract, universal laws. The fact to be explained-which is here the literary disposition of the young Flaubert-is

resolved into a combination of
typical, abstract desires such as we meet in "the average adolescent."
What is concrete here is only their combination; in themselves they are
only possible patterns. The abstract then is by hypothesis prior to the
concrete, and the concrete is only an organization of abstract qualities;
the individual is only the intersection of universal schemata. But-aside
from the logical absurdity of such a postulate-we see clearly in the
example chosen, that it simply fails to explain what makes the individu-
ality of the project under consideration. The fact that "the need to feel
intensely," a universal pattern, is disguised and channeled into becoming
the need to write-this is not the explanation of the "calling" of
F1aubert; on the contrary, it is what must be explained. Doubtless one
could invoke a thousand circumstances, known to us and unknown,
which have shaped this need to feel into the need to act. But this is to
give up at the start all attempt to explain and refers the que~:_ion to
the undiscoverable.2 In addition this method rejects the pure individual
1 Paul Bourget: Essai de Psychologie contemporaine: G. Flaubert.
2 Since Flaubert's adolescence, so far as we can know it, offers us nothing specific in this connection, we must suppose the action of imponderable facts which on principle escape the critic.

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who has been banishecJ from the pure subjectivity of F1aubert into the
external circumstances of his life. Finally, Flaubert's correspondence
proves that long before the "crisis of adolescence," from his earliest child-
hood, he was tormented by the need to write.
.At each 'stage in the description just quoted, we mced with an hiatus.
Why did ambition and the feeling of his power produce in Flaubert
exaltation rather than tranquil waiting or gloomy impatience? Why did
this exaltation express itself specifically in the need to act violently and
fcel intensely? Or rather why does this need make a sudden appearance
by spontaneous generation at the end of the paragraph? And why does
this need instead of seeking to appease itself in acts of violence, by
amorous adventures, or in debauch, choose precisely to satisfy itself
symbolically? And why does F1aubert tum to writing rather than to
painting or music for this symbolic satisfaction; he could just as well
not resort to the artistic field at all (there is also mysticism, for example) .
"I could have been a great actor," wrote Flaubert somewhere. Why did he
not try to be one? In a word, we have understood nothing; we h'lveseen
a succession of accidental happenings, of desire springing forth fully
armed, one from the other, with no possibility for us to grasp their genesis.
The transitions, the becomings, the transformations, have been carefully
veiled from us, and we have been limited to putting order into the succes-
sion by invoking empirically established but literally unintelligible se-
quences (the need to act preceding in the adolescent the need to write).
Yet this is called psychology! Open any biography at random, and
this is the kind of description which you will find more or less interspersed
with accounts of external events and allusions to the great explanatory
idols of our epoch-heredity, education, environment, physiological
constitution. Occasionally, in the better works the connection established
between antecedent and consequent or between two con

comitant desires
and their reciprocal action is not conceived merely as a type of regular sequence; sometimes it is "comprehensible" in the sense which Jaspers understands in his general treatise on psychopathology. But this compre-?ension remains a grasp of general connections. For example we will real-Ize the link between chastity and mysticism, between fainting and hy-pocrisy. But we are ignorant always of the concrete relation betwecn this chastity (this abstinence in relation to a particular woman, this struggle against a definite temptation) and the individual content of the mysticism; in the same way psychiatry is too quickly satisfied when it throws light on the general structures of delusions and does not seek to comprehend the individual, concrete content of the psychoses (why this man believes himself to be that particular historical personality rather than some other; why his compensatory delusion is satisfied with specifically these ideas of grandeur instead of others, etc.).
But most important of all, these "psychological" explanations refer us

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ultimately to inexplicable original givens. These are the simple bodies of psychology. We are told, for example, that Flaubert had a "grandiose ambition'~ and all of the previously quoted description depends on this original ambition. So far so good. But this ambition is an irreducible fact which by no means satisfies the mind. The ineducibility here has no. justification other than refusal to push the analysis further. There where the psychologist stops, the fact confronted is given as primary. This is why we experience a troubled feeling of mingled resignation and dissatisfaction when we read these psychological treatises. "See," we say to ourselves, "Flaubert was ambii:ious. He was that kind of man." It would be as futile to ask why he was such as to seek to know why he was tall and blond. Of course we have to stop somewhere; it is the very contingency of all real existence. This rock is covered with moss, the rock next to it is not. Gustave Flaubert had literary ambition, and his brother Achille lacked it. That's the way it is. In the same way we want to know the properties of phosphorus, and we attempt to reduce them to the structure of the chemical molecules which compose it. But why are there molecules of this type? That's the way it is, that's all. The explanation of Flaubert's psychology will consist, if it is possible, in referring the complexity of his behavior patterns, his feelings, and his tastes back to certain prbperties, comparable to those of chemical bodies, beyond which it would be foolish to attempt to proceed. Yet we feel obscurely that Flaubert had not "received" his ambition. It is meaningful; therefore it is free. Neither heredity, nor bourgeois background nor education can account for it, still less those physiological considerations regarding the "nervous temperament," which have been the vogue for some time now. The nerve is not meaningful; it is a colloidal substance which can be described in itself and which does not have the quality of transcendence; that is, it does not transcend itself in order to make known to itself by means of other realities what it is. Under no circumstances could the nerve furnish the basis for meaning. In one sense Flaubert's ambition is a fact with all a fact's contingency-and it is true that it is impossible to advance be

yond that fact-but in another sense it makes itself, and our satisfaction is a guarantee to us that we may be able to grasp beyond this ambition something more, something like a radical decision which, without ceasing to be contingent, would be the veritable psychic irreducible. What we are demanding then-and what nobody ever attempts to give us-is a veritable irreducible; that is, an irreducible of which the irreducibility would be self-evident, which would not be presented as the postulate of the psychologist and the result of his refusal or his incapacity to go further, but which when established would produce in us an accompanying feeling of satisfaction. This demand on our part does not COme from that ceaseless pursuit of a cause, that infinite regress which has often been described as constitutive of rational research and
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which consequently-far from being exclusively associated with psychological investigation-may be found in all disciplines ~md in all problems. This is not the childish quest of a "because," which allows no further "why?" It is on the contraly a demand based on a preontological comprehension of human reality and on the related refusal to consider man as capable of being analyzed and reduced to original givens, to determined desires (or "drives"), supported by the subject as properties by an object. Even if we were to consider him as such, it would be necessary to choose: either Flaubert, the man, whom we' can love or detest, blame or praise, who represents for us the Other, who directly attacks our being by the very fact that he has existed, would be originally a substratum unqualified by these desires; that is, a sort of indeterminate clay which would have to receive them passively or he would be reduced to the simple bundle of these irreducible drives or tendencies. In either case the man disappears; we can no longer find "the (lne" to wllOm this or that experience has happened; either in looking for the person, we encounter a useless, contradictory metaphysical substance-or else the being whom we seek vanishes in a dust of phenomena bound together by external connections. But what each one of us requires in his very effort to comprehend another is that he should never have to resort to this idea of substance which is inhuman because it is well this side of the human. Finally the fact is that the being considered does not crumble into dust, and one can discover in him that unity-for which substance was only a caricature-which must be a unity of responsibility, a unity agreeable or hateful, blamable and praiseworthy, in short personal. This unity, which is the being of the man under consideration, is a free unification, and this unification can not come after a diversity which it unifies.
But to be, for Flaubert, as for every subject of "biography," means to be unified in the world. The irreducible unification which we ought to find, which is Flaubert, and which we require biographers to reveal to us-this is the unification of an original project, a unification which should reveal itself to us as a non-substantial absolute. Therefore we should forego these so-called irreducible details and, taking the very evidence of them for a criterion, not stop in our investigation before it is evident that we neither can nor ought to go any further. In particular we must avoid trying to reconstruct a person by means

of his inclinations, just as
Spinoza warns us not to attempt to reconstruct a substance or its attributes by the summation of its modes. Every desire if presented as an irreducible is an absurd contingency and involves in absurdity human reality taken as a whole. For example, if I declare of one of my friends that he "likes to go rowing," I deliberately intend to stop my investigation there. But on the other hand, I thus establish a contingent fact, which nothing can explain and which, though it has the gratuity of free decision, by no means has its autonomy. I can not in fact consider this fQnd·
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ness for rowing as the fundamental project of Pierre; it contains something secondary and derived. Those who portray a character in this way by successive strokes come close to holding that each of these sf:rokes-each one of the desires confronted-is bound to the others by connections which are purcly contingent and simplyexternaI. Those who, on the other hand, try to explain this liking will fall into the view of what Comte called materialism; that is, of explaining the higher by the lower. Someone will say, for example, that the subject considered is a sportsman who likes violent exercise and is in addition a man of the outdoors who especially like~ open air sports. By more general and less difft:rentiated tendencies he will try to explain this desire, w}lich stands in. exactly the same relation to ther... as the zoological species does to the genus. Thus the psychological explanation when it does not suddenly decide to stop, is sometimes the mere putting into relief relations of pure concomitance or of constant succession, and it is at other times a simple classification. To explain Pierre's fondness for rowing is to make it a mp.mberof the family of fondness for open air sports and to attach this family to that of fondness for sport in general. Moreover we will be able to find still more general and barren rubrics if we classify the taste for sports as one aspect of the love of chance, which will itself be given as a specific instance of the fundamental fondness for play. It is obvious that this so-called explanatory classification has no more value or interest than the classifications in ancient botany; like the latter it amounts to assuming the priority of the abstract over the concrete-as if the fondness for play existed first in general to be subsequently made specific by the action of these circumstances in the love of sport, the latter in the fondness for rowing, and finally the rowing in the desire to row on a particular stream, under certain circumstances in a particular season-and like the ancient classifications it fails to explain the concrete enrichment which at each stage is undergone by the abs~ract inclination considered. Furthermore how are we to believe that a desire to row is only a desire to row. Can we truthfully admit that it can be reduced so simply to what it is? The most discerning ethicist~ have shown how a desire reaches beyond itself. Pascal believed that he could discover in hunting, for example, or tennis, or in a hundred other occupations, the need of being diverted. He revealed that in an activity which would be absurd if reduced to itself, there was a meaning which transcended it; that is, an indication which referred to the reality of man in general and to his condition. Similarly

Stendhal in spite of his attachment to ideologists, and Proust in spite of his intellectualistic and analytical tendencies, have shown that love and jealousy can not be reduced to the strict desire of possessing a particular woman, but that these emotions aim at laying hold of the world in its entirety through the woman. This is the meaning of Stendhal's crystallization, and it is precisely for this reason that love as Stendhal describes it
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appears as a mode of being in the world. Love is a fundamental relation of the for-itself to the world and to itself (selfness) through a particular woman; the woman represents only a conducting body which is placed in the circuit. These analyses may be inexact or only partially true; nevertheless they make us suspect a method other than pure analytical description. In the same way Catholic novelists immediately see in carnal love its surpassing toward God-in Don Juan, "the eternally unsatisfied," in sin, "the place empty of God." There is no question here of finding again an abstract behind the concrete; the impulse toward God is no less concrete than the impulse toward a particular woman. On the contrary, .it is a matter of rediscovering under the partial and incomplete aspects of the subject the veritable concreteness which can be only the totality of his impulse toward being, his original relation to himself, to the world, and to the Other, in the unity of internal relations and of a fundamental project. This impulse can be only purely individual and unique. Far from estranging us from the person, as Bourget's analysis, for example, does in constituting the individual by means of a summation of general maxims, this impulse will not lead us to find in the need of writing-and of writing particular books-the need of activity in general. On the contrary, rejecting equally the theory of malleable clay and that of the bundle of drives, we will discover the individual person in the initial project which constitutes him. His for this reason that the irreducibility of the result attained will be revealed as self-evident, not because it is the poorest and the most abstract but because it is the richest. The intuition here will be accompanied by an individual fullness.
The problem poses itself in approximately these terms: If we admit that the person is a tota:ity, we can not hope to reconstruct him by an addition or,by an organization of the diverse tendencies which we have empirically discovered in him. On the contrary, in each inclination, in each tendency the person expresses himself completely, although from a different angle, a little as Spinoza's substance expresses itselfcomplete1y in each of its attributes. But if this is so, we should discover in each tendency, in each attitude of the subject, a meaning which transcends it. A jealousy of a particular date in which a subject historicizes himself in relation to a certain woman, signifies for the one who knows how to interpret it, the total relation to the world by which the subject constitutes himself as a self. In other words this empirical attitude is by itself the expression of the "choice of an intelligible character." There is no mystery about this. We no longer have to do with an intelligible pattern which can be present in our thought only, while we apprehend and conceptualize the unique pattern of the subject's empirical existence.

If the empiri-
cal attitude signifies the choice of the intelligible character, it is bec:mse
it is itself this choice. Indeed the distinguishing characteristic of the
intelligible choice, as we shall see later, is that it can exist only as the
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transcendent meaning of each concrete, empirical choice. It is by nO means
first effected in somc unconscious or on the noumenallevel to be subse-
quentlyexpressed in a particular observable attitude; there is not even an
ontological pre-eminence over the empirical choice, but it is on principle
that which must always detach itself from the empirical choice as its
beyond and the infinity of its transcendence. Thus if I am rowing on the
river, I am nothing-either here or in any other world-save this concrete
project of rowing. But this project itself inasmuch as it is the totality of
my being, explcsses my original choice in particular circumstances; it is
nothing other than the choice of myself as a totality in these circum-
stances. That is why a special method must aim at detaching the funda-
mental meaning which the project admits and which can be only the
individual secret of the subject's being-in-the-world. It is then rather by a
comparison of the various empirical drives of a subject that we try to
discover and disengage the fundamental project which is common to
them all-and not by a simple summation or reconstruction of' these
tendencies; each drive or tendency is the entire person.
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, There is naturally an infinity of possible projects as' there is an infinity
of possible human beings. Nevertheless, if we are to recognize certain
common characteristics among them and if we are going to attempt to
classify them in larger categories, it is best first to undertake individual
investigations in the cases which we can study more easily. In our re-
search, we will be guided by this principle: to stop only in the presence
of evident irreducibility; that is, never to believe that we have reached
the initial project until the projected end appears as the very being of the
subject under consideration. This is why we can not stop at those classifi-
cations of "authentic project" and "unauthentic project of the self" which
Heidegger wishes to establish. In addition to the fact that such a classifica-
tion, in spite of its author's intent, is tainted with an ethical concern
shown by its very terminology, it is based on the attitude of the subject
toward his own death. Now if death causes anguish, and if consequently
we can either flee the anguish or throw ourselves resolutely into it, it is a
truism to say that this is because we wish to hold on to life. Conse-
quently anguish before death and resolute decision or flight into un-
authenticity can not be considered as fundamental projects of our being.
On' the contrary, they can be understood only On the foundation of an
original project of living; that is, on an original choice of our being. It is
right then in each case to pass beyond the results of Heidegger's interpre-
tation toward a still more fundamental project.
This fundamental project must not of course refer to any other and
should be conceived by itself. It can be concerned neither with death nor
life nor any particular characteristic of the human condition; the original
project of a for-itself can aim only at its being. The project of being or
desire ofbeing or drive toward bei

gent, absurd in-itself, comparable at every point to that which it encounters and which' it nihilates. The nihilation, as we have seen, is in fact like a revolt of the in-itself, which nihilates itself against its contingency. To say that the for-itself lives its facticity, as we have seen in the . chapter concerning the body, amounts to saying that the nihilation is the vain effort of a being to found its own being and that it is the withdrawal to found being which provokes the minute displacement by which nothingness enters into being. The being which forms the object of the desire of the for-itself is then an in-itself which would be to itself its Own foundation; that is, which would be to its facticity in the same relation as the for-itself is to its motivations. In addition the for-itself, being the negation of the in-itself, could not desire the pure and simple return to the in-itself. Here as with Hegel, the negation of the negation can not bring us back to our point of departure. Quite the contrary, what the for-itself demands of the in-itself is precisely the totality detotalized- "In-itself nihilated in for-itself." In other words the for-itself projects being as for-itself, a being which is what it is. It is as being which is what it is not, and which is not what it is, that the for-itself projects being what it is. It is as consciousness that it wishes to have the impermeability and infinite density of the in-itself. It is as the nihilation of the in-itself and a perpetual evasion of contingency and of facticity that it wishes to be its own foundation. This is why the possible is projected in general as what the for-itself lacks in order to become in-itself-for-itself. The fundamental value which presides over this project is exactly the in-itself-for-itself; that is, the ideal of a consciousness which would be the foundation of its own being-in-itself by the pure consciousness which it would have of itself. It is this ideal which can be called God. Thus the best way to conceive of the fundamental project of human reality is to say that man is the being whose project is to be God. Whatever may be the myths and rites of the religion considered, God is first "sensible to the heart" of man as the one who identifies and defines him in his ultimate and fundamental project. If man possesses a pre-ontological comprehension of the being of God, it is not the great wonders of nature nor the power of society which have conferred it upon him. God, value and supreme end of transcendence, represents the permanent limit in terms of which man makes known to himself what he is. To be man means to reach toward being God. Or if you prefer, man fundamentally is the desire to be God.

It may be asked, if man on coming into the world is borne toward God as toward his limit, if he can choose only to be God, what becomes of freedom? For freedom is nothing other than a choice which creates for itself its own possibilities, but it appears here that the initial project of being God, which "defines" man, comes close to being the same as a human "nature" or an "essence." The answer is that while the meaning of

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the desire is ultimately the project of being God, the desire is never constituted by this meaning; on the contrary, it always represents a particular discovery of its ends. These ends in fact are pursued in terms of a particular empirical situa

tion, and it is this very pursuit which constitutes
the surroundings as a situation. The desire of being is always realized as the desire of a mode of being. And this desire of a mode of being expresses itself in turn as the meaning of the myriads of concrete desires which constitute the web of our conscious life. Thus we find ourselves before very complex symbolic structures which have at least three stories. In empirical desire I can discern a symbolization of a fundamental concrete desire which is the person himself and which represents the mode in which he has decided that being would be in question in his being. This fundamental desire in turn expresses concretely in the world within the particular situation enveloping the individual, an abstract meaningful structure which is the desire of being in general; it must be considered as human reality in the person, and it brings about his community with others, thus making it possible to state that there is a truth concerning man and not only concerning individuals who cannot be compared. Absolute concreteness, completion, existence as a totality belong then to the free and fundamental desire which is the unique person. Empirical desire is only a symbolization of this; it refers to this and derives its meaning from it while remaining partial and reducible, for the empirical desire can not be conceived in isolation. On the other hand, the desire of being in its abstract purity is the truth of the concrete fundamental desire, but it does not exist by virtue of reality. Thus the fundamental project, the person, the free realization of human truth is everywhere in all desires (save for those exceptions treated in the preceding chapter, concerning, for example" "indifferents"). It is never apprehended except through desires-as we can apprehend space only through bodies which shape it for us, though space is a specific reality and not a concept. Or, if you like, it is like the object of Husserl, which reveals itself only by Abschattungen, and which nevertheless does not allow itself to be absorbed by anyone Abschattung. We can understand after these remarks that the abstract, ontological "desire to be" is unable to represent the fundamental, human structure of the individml; it cannot be anobstacle to his freedom. Freedom in fact, as we have shown in the preceding chapter, is strictly identified with nihilation. The only being which can be called free is the being which nmilates its being. Moreover we know that nihilation is lack of being and can not be otherwise. Freedom is precisely the being which makes itself a lack of being. But since desire, as we have established, is identical with lack of being, freedom can arise only as being which makes itself a desire of being; that is, as the project-for-itself of being in-itself-for-itself. Here we have arrived at an abstract structure which can by no means be considered, as the nature or essence of freedom. Freedom is

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existence, and in it existence precedes essence. The upsurge of freedom T is immediate and concrete and is not to be distinguished from its choice; that is, from the person himself. But the structure under consideration can be called the truth of freedom; that is, it is the human meaning of freedom.
It should be possible to establish the human truth of the person, as we have attempted to do by an ontological phenomenology. The ca

ta-
logue of empirical desires ought to be made the object of appropriate psychological· investigations, observation and induction and, as needed, experience can serve to draw up this list. They will indicate to the philosopher the comprehensible relations which can unite to each other various desires and various patterns- of behaviors, and will bring to light certain concrete connections between the subject of experience and "situations" experientially defined (which at bottom originate only from limitations applied in the name of positivity to the fundamental situation. of the subject in the world). But in establishing and classifying fundamental desires of individual persons neither of these methods is' appropriate. Actually there can be no question of determining a priori and ontologically what appears in all the unpredictability of a free act. This is why we shall limit ourselves here to indica:ting very summarily the possibilities of such a quest and its perspectives. The very fact that we can subject any man whatsoever to such an investigation-that is what belongs to human reality in general. Or, if you prefer, this is what can be established by an ontology. But the inquiry itself and its results are on principle wholly outside the possibilities of an ontology.

On the other hand, pure, simple empirical description can only give us catalogues and put us in the presence of pseudo-irreducibles (the desire to write, to swim, a taste for adventure, jealousy, etc.). It is not enough in fact to draw up a list of behavior patterns, of drives and inclinations, it is necessary also to decipher them; that is, it is necessary to know how to question them. This research can be conduded only according to the 1'llles of a specific method. It is this method which we call existential psychoanalysis.

The principle of this psychoanalysis is that man is a totality and not a collection. Consequently he expresses himself as a whole in even his most insignificant and his most superficial behavior: In other words there is not a taste, a mannerism, or an human act which is not revealing.

The goal of psychoanalysis is to decipher the empirical behavior patterns of man; that is to bring out in the open the revelations which each one of them contains and to fix them conceptually.

Its point of departure is experience; its pillar of support is the fundamental, pre-ontological comprehension which man has of the human person. Although the majority of people can well ignore the indications contained in a gesture, a word, a sign and can look with SCOrn on the revela-

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tion which they carly, each human individual nevertheless possesses a priori the meaning of the revelatory value of these manifestations and is capable of. deciphering them, atleast if he is aided and guided by a helping hand. Here as elsewhere, truth is not encountered by chance; it does not belong to a domain where one must seek it without ever having any presentiment of its location, as one can go to look for the source of the Nile or of the Niger. It belongs a priori to human comprehension and the essential task is an hermeneutic; that is, a deciphering, a determination, and a conceptualization.

Its method is comparative. Since each example of human conduct symbolizes in its own manner the fundamental choice which must be ~rought to light, and· since at the same time e

ach one disguises this
choice under its occasional character and its historical opportunity, only the comparison of these acts of conduct can effect the emergence of the unique revelation which they all express ina different way. The first outline of this method has been furnished for us by the psychoanalysis of Freud and his disciples. For this reason it will be profitable here to indicate more specifically the points where existential psychoanalysis will be inspired by psychoanalysis proper and those where it will radically differ from it.

Both kinds of psychoanalysis consider all objectively discernible manifestations of "psychic life" as symbols maintaining symbolic relations to the fundamental, total structures which constitute the individual person. Both consider that· there are no primary givens such as hereditary dispositions, character, etc. Existential psychoanalysis recognizes nothing before the original upsurge of human freedom; empirical psychoanalysis holds that the original affectivity of the individual is virgin wax before its history. The libido is nothing besides its concrete fixations, save for a permancnt possibility of fixing anything whatsoever upon anything whatsoever. Both consider the human being as a perpetual, searching, historization. Rather than uncovering static, constant givens they discover the meaning, orientation, and adventures of this history. Due to this fact both consider man in the world and do not imagine that one can question the being of a. man without taking into account all his situation. Psychological investigations aim at reconstituting the life of the subject from birth to the moment -of the cure; they utilize all the objective documentation which they can find; letters, witnesses, intimate diaries, "social" information of every kind. What they aim at restoring is less a pure psychic event than a twofold structure: the crucial event of infancy and the psychic crystallization around this event. Here again we have to do with a situation. Each "historical" fact from this point of view will be considered at once as a factor of the psychic evolution and as a symbol of that evolution. For it is nothing in itself. It operates only according to

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the way in which it is taken and this very manner of taking it expresses symbolically the internal disposition of the individual.

Empirical psychoanalysis and existential psychoanalysis both search within an existing situation for a fundamental attitude which can not be expressed by simple, logical definitions because it is prior to all logic, and which requires reconstruction according to the laws of specific syntheses. Empirical psychoanalysis seeks to determine the complex, the very name of which indicates the polyvalence of all the meanings which are referred back to it. Existential psychoanalysis seeks to determine the original choice. This original choice operating in the face of the world and being a choice of position in the world is total like the complex; it is prior to logic like the complex. It is this which decides the attitude of the person when confronted with logic and principles; therefore there can be no possibility of. questioning it in conformance to logic. It brings together in a prelogical synthesis the totality of the existent, and as such it is the center of reference for an infinity of polyvalent meanings. Both our psychoa

nalyses refuse to admit that the subject is in a privi-
leged position to proceed in these inquiries concerning himself. They
equally insist on a strictly objective method, using as documentary evi-
dence the data of reflection as well as the testimony of others. Of course
the subject can undertake a psychoanalytic investigation of himself.
But in this case he must renounce at the outset all benefit stemming
from his peculiar position and must question himself exactly as if he
were someone else. Empirical psychoanalysis in fact is based on the
hypothesis of the existence of an unconscioU3 psyche, which on principle
escapes the intuition of the subject. Existential psychoanalysis rejects
the hypothesis of the unconscious; it makes the psychic act coextensive
with consciousness. But if the fundamental project is fully experienced
by the subject and hence wholly conscious, that certainly does not mean
that it must by the same token be known by him; quite the contrary.
The reader will perhaps recall the care we took in the Introduction to
distinguish between consciousness and knowledge. To be sure, as we
have seen earlier, reflection can be considered as a quasi-knowledge. But
what it grasps at each moment is not the pure project of the for-itself as it
is symbolically expressed-often in several ways at once-by the concrete
behavior which it apprehends. It grasps the concrete behavior it~elf;
that is, the specific dated desire in all its characteristic network. It grasps at
once symbol and symbolization. This apprehension, to be sure, is entirely
constituted by a pre-ontological comprehension of the fundamental pro-
ject; better yet, in so far as reflection is almost a non·thetic consciousn~ss
of itself as reflection, it is this same project, as well as the non-reflective
consciousness. But it does not follow that it commands the instruments
and techniques necessary to isolate the choice symbolized, to fix it bv
concepts, and to bring it forth into the full light of day. It is penetrated

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by a great light without being able to express what this light is iIluminat-
ing. We are not dealing with an unsolved riddle as the Freudians believe;
all is there, luminous; reflection is in full possession of it, apprehends all.
But this "mystery in broad daylight" is due to the fact that this possession
is deprived of the means which would ordinarily permit analysis and
conceptualization. It grasps everything, all at once, without shading, with-
out relief, without connections of grandeur-not that these shades, these
values, these reliefs exist somewhere and are hidden from it, but rather
because they must be established by another human attitude and because
they can exist only by means of and for knowledge. Reflection, unable
to serve as the basis for existential psychoanalysis, will then simply furnish
us with the brute materials toward which the psychoanalyst must take
an objective attitude. Thus only will he be able to know what he~1ready
understands. The result is that complexes uprooted from the depths of
the unconscious, like projects revealed by existential psychoanalysis, will
be apprehended from the point of view of the Other. Consequently the
object thus brought into the light will be articulated according to the
structures of the transcended-transcendence; that is, its being wiI I be
the being-for-others even if the psychoanalyst and the s

ubject of the
psychoanalysis are actual1y the same person. Thus the project which is brought to light by either kind of psychoanalysis can be only the totality of the individual human being, the irreducible element of the transcendence with the structure of being-for-others. What always escapes these methods of investigation is the project as it is for itself, the complex in its own being..This project-for-itself can be experienced only as a living possession; there is an incompatibility between existence for-itself and objective existence. But the object of the two psychoanalyses has in it nonetheless the reality of a being; the subject's knowledge of it can in addition contribute to clarify reflection, and that reflection can then become a possession which wiI be a quasi-knowing.
At this _point the similarity between the two kinds of psychoanalysis ceases. They differ fundamental1y in that empirical psychoanalysis has decided upon its own irreducible instead of allowing this to make itself known in a self-evident intuition. The libido or the will to power in actuality constitutes a psycho-biological residue which is not clear in itself and which does not appear to us as being beforehand the irreducible limit of the investigation. Final1y it is experience which establishes that the foundation of complexes is this libido or this wiI to power; and these results of empirical inquiry are perfectly contingent, they are not convincing. Nothing prevents our conceiving a priori of a "human reality" which would not be expressed by the will to power, for which the libido would not constitute the original, undifferentiated project.
On the other hand, the choice to which existential psychoanalysis will lead us, precisely because it is a choice. accounts for its original contin-
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gency, for the contingency of the choice is the reverse side of its freedom. Furthermore, inasmuch as it is established on the iack of being, conceived as a fundamental characteristic of being, it receives it,s legitimacy as a choice, and we know that we do not have to push further. Each result then will be at once fully contingent and legitimately irreducible. Moreover it will always remain particular; that is, we will not achieve as the ultimate goal of our investigation and the foundation of an behavior an abstract, general term, libido for example, which would be differentiated and made concrete first in complexes and then in detailed acts of conduct, due to the action of external facts and the history of the subject. On the contrary, it will be a choice which remains unique and which is from the start absolute concreteness. Details of behavior can express or particularize this choice, but they can not make it more concrete than it already known in a self-evident intuition. The libido or the will to power in
is. That is because the choice is nothing other than the being of each human reality; this amounts to saying that a particular partial behavior is or expresses the original choic~ of this human reality since for human reality there is no difference between existing and choosing for itself. From this fact we understand that existential psychoanalysis does not have to proceed from the fundamental "complex," which is exactly the choice of being, to an abstraction like the libido which would explain it. The complex is the ultimate choice, it is the cho

ice of being and makes
itself such. Bringing it into the light will reveal it each time as evidently irreducible. It follows necessarily that the libido and the will to power will appear to existential psychoanalysis neither as general characteristics common to all mankind nor asirreducibles. At most it will be possible after the investigation to establish that they express by virtue of particular ensembles in certain subjects a fundamental choice which can not be reduced to eithe:J:' one of them. We have seen in fact that desire and sexuality in general express an original effort of the for-itself to recover its being which has become estranged through contact with the Other. The will to power also originally supposes· being-for-others, the comprehension of the Other, and the choice of winning its own salvation by means·of the Other. The foundation of this attitude must be an original choice which would make us understand the radical identification of being-in-itself-for-itself with being-for-others.
The fact that the ultimate term of this existential inquiry must be a . choice, distinguishes even better the psychoanalysis for which we have outlined the method and principal features. It thereby abandons the supposition that the environment acts mechanically on the subject under consideration. The environment can act on the subject only to the exact extent that he comprehends it; that is, transforms it into a situation. Hence no objective description of this environment could be of any use to us, FJ:om· the start the environment conceived as a situation refers --l.

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to the for-itself which is choosing. just as the for-itself refers to the environment by the very fact that the for-itself is in the world. By renouncing all mechanical causation, we renounce at the same time all general interpretation of the symbolization confronted. Our goal could not be tD establish empirical laws of succession, nor could we constitute a universal symbolism. Rather the psychoanalyst will have to rediscover at each step a symbol functioning in the particular case which he is considering. If each being is a totality, it is not conceivable that there can exist elementary symbolic relationships (e.g.; the faeces = gold, or a pincushion = the breast) which preserve a constant meaning in all cases; that is, which remain unaltered when they pass from one meaningful ensemble to another ensemble. Furthermore the psychoanalyst will never lose sight of the fact that the choice is living and consequently can be revoked by the subject who is being studied. We have shown in the preceding chapter the importance of the instant, which represents abrupt changes in orientation and the assuming of a new position in the face of an unalterable past. From tHis moment on, we must always be ready to consider that symbols change meaning and to abandon the symbol used hitherto. Thus existential psychoanalysis will have to be completely flexible and adapt itself to the slightest observable changes in the subject. Our concern here is to understand what is individual and often even instantaneous. The method which has served for one subject will not necessarily be suitable to use for another subject or for the same subject at a later period.
Precisely because the goal of the inquiry must be to discover a choice and not a state, the investigator must recall on every occasion that h

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obiect is not a datum buried in the darkness of the unconscious but a free, conscious determination-which is not even resident in consciousness, but which is one with this consciousness itself. Empirical psychoanalysis, to the extent that its method is better than its principles, is rften in sight of an existential discovery, but it always stops part way. When it thus approaches the fundamental choice, the resistance of the subject collapses suddenly and he recognizes the image of himself which is presented to him as if he were seeing himself in a mirror. This involuntary testimony of the subject is precious for the psychoanalyst; he sees there the sign that he has reached his goal; he can pass on from the investi-.gation proper to the cure. But nothing in his principles or in his initial postulates permits hiM to understand or to utilize this testimony. Where could he get any such right? If the complex is really unconscious-that is, if there is a barrier separating the sign from the thing signified-how could the subject recognize it? Does the unconscious complex recognize itself? But haven't we been told that it lacks understanding? And if of necessity we granted to it the faculty of understanding the signs, would this not be to make of it by the same token a conscious unconscious? What is understanding if not to be conscious of what is understood?

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Shall we ,say on the other hand that. it is the subject as conscious who recognizes the image presented? But how could he compare it with his true state since that is out of reach and since he has never had any knowledge of it? At most he' will be able to judge that the psychoanalytic explanation of his case' is a probable hypothesis, which derives its probability from the number of behavior patterns which it explains. His relation to this interpretation is that of a third party, that of the psychoanalyst himself; he has no privileged position. And if he believes in the probability of the psychoanalytic hypothesis, is this simple belief, which lives in the limits of his consciousness, able to effect the breakdown of the barriers which dam up the unconscious tendencies? The psychoanalyst doubtless has some obscure picture of an abrupt coincidence of conscious and unconscious. .But he has removed all methods of conceiving of this coincidence in any positive sense.
Still, the enlightenment of the subject is a fact. There is an intuition here which is accompanied by evidence. The subject guided by the psychoanalyst does more and better than to give his agreement to an hypothesis; he touches it, he sees what it is. This is truly understandable only if the subject has never ceased being conscious of his deep tendencies; better yet, only if,these drives are not distinguished from his conscious self. In this case as we have seen, the traditional psychoanalytic interpretation does not cause him to attain consciousness of what he is; it causes him to attain knowledge of what he is. It is existential psychoanalysis then which claims the final intuition of the subject as decisive. This comparison allows us to understand better what an existential psychoanalysis must be if it is entitled to exist. It is a method destined to bring to light, in a strictly objective form, the subjective choice by which each living person makes himself a person; that is, makes known to himself what he is. Since

what the method setks is a choice of being
at the same time as a being, it must reduce particular behavior patterns
to fundamental relations-not of sexuality or of the will to power, but
of being-which are expressed in this behavior. It is then guided from
tbe start toward a comprehension of being and must not assign itself
any other goal than to discover being and the mode of being of the
being confronting this being. It is forbidden to stop before attaining
this goal. It will utilize the comprehension of being which characterizes
the investigator inasmuch as he is himself a human reality; and as it seeks
to detach being from its symbolic expressions, it will have to rediscover
each time on the basis of a comparative study of acts and attitudes, a
symbol destined to decipher them. Its criterion of success will be the
numbel' of facts which its hypothesis pennits it to explain and to unify as
well as the self-evident intuition of the irreducibility of the end attaine~.
To this criterion will be added in all cases where it is possible, the decI-
sive testimony of the subject. The results thus achieved-that is, the

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ultimate ends of the individual-can then become the object of a classifi-
cation, and it is by the comparison of these results that we will be able
to establish gencral considerations about human reality as an empirical
choice of its own ends. The behavior studied by this psychoanalysis will
include not only dreams, failures, obsessions, and neuroses, but also
and especially the thoughts of waking life, successfully adjusted acts,
style, etc. This psychoanalysis has not yet found its Freud. At most
we can find the foreshadowing of it in certain particularly successful biog-
raphies. We hope to be able to attempt elsewhere two examples in rela-
tion to Flaubert and Dostoevsky. But it matters little to us whether it
now exists; the important thing is that it is possible.

II. "DOING" AND "HAVING": POSSESSION

THE information which ontology can furnish concerning behavior pat-
terns and desire must serve as the basiC principles of existential psycho-
analysis. This does not mean that there is an over-all pattern of abstract
desires common to all men; it means that concrete desires have structures
which emerge during the study of ontology because each desire-the de-
sire of eating or of sleeping as well as the desire of creating a work of art-
expresses all human reality. As I have shown elsewhere,S the knowledge
of man must be a totality; empirical, partial pieces of knowledge on this
level lack all significancc. We shall succeed in our task if we utilize the
pieces of knowledge achieved up to this point, for laying down the bases
of existential psychoanalysis. Indeed this is the point where ontology
must stop; its final discoveries are the first principles of psychoanalysis.
Henceforth we must have another method since the object is different.
What then does ontology teach us about desire, since desire is the being
of human reality?

Desire is a lack of being. As such it is directly supported by the being
of which it is a lack. This being, as we have said, is the in-itself-for-itself,
consciousness become substance, substance become the cause of itself,
the Man-God. Thus the being of human reality is originally not a sub-
stance but a lived relation. The limiting terms of this relation are first
the original In-itself, fixed in its contingency an

d its facticity, its essential
characteristic being that it is, that it exists; and second the In-itself-for-itself or value, which exists as the Ideal of the contingent In-itself and which is characterized as beyond all contingency and all existence. Man is neither the one nor the other of these beings, for strictly speaking, we should never say of him that he is at all. He is what he is not and he is not what he is; he is the nihilation of the contingent In-itself in so far as the self of this nihilation is its flight ahead toward the In-itself as self-
S Esquisse d'une tMorie phenomenologique des emotions. Hennann, 1939.
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calise. Human reality is the pure effort to become God without there being any given substratum for that effort, without there being anything which so endeavours. Desire expresses this endeavour.
Nevertheless desire is not defined solely in relation to the In-itself-as-self-ease. It is also relative to a brute, concrete existent which we COmmonly call the object of the desire. This object may be now a slice of bread, now an automobile, now a woman, now an object not yet realized and yet defined-as when the artist desires to. create a work of art. TIIUS by its very structure desire expresses a man's relation to one or several objects in the world; it is one of the aspects of Being-in-the-world. From this point of view we see first that this relation is not of a unique type.
It is only by a sort of abbreviation that we speak of "the desire of some-, thing:' Actually a thousand empirical examples show that we desire to possess this object or to do that thing or to be someone. If I desire this picture, it means that I desire to buy it, to appropriate it for myself. If I desire to write a book, to go for a walk, it means that I desire to "do" this book, to "do" this walk. If I dress up, it is because I desire to be well-groomed. I train myself in order to be a scientist, etc. Thus from the outset, the three big categories of concrete human existence appear to us in their original relation: to do, to have, to be.'
It is easy to see, however, that the desire to do is not irreducible. One does (= makes) an object in order to enter into a certain relation with it. This new relation can be immediately reducible to having. For example, I cut a cane from a branch of a tree (I do a cane out of a branch) in order to have this cane. The "doing" is reduced to a mode of having. This is the most common example. But it can also happen that my activity does not appear on the surface as reducible. It can appear gratuitous as in the case of scientific research, or sport, or aesthetic creation. Yet in these various examples doing is still not irreducible. If I create a picture, a drama, a melody, it is in order that I may be at the origin of a coucrete existence. This existence interests me only to the degree that the bund of creation which I establish between it and me gives to me a particular right of ownership over it. It is not enough that a certain picture which I have in mind should exist; it is necessary as well that it exist throug}! me. Evidently in one sense the ideal would be that I should sustain the picture in being by a sort of continuous creation and that consequently it should be mine as though by a perpetually renewed emanation. But in another sense it must be radically distmct from myself-in order that it may

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mine but not me. Here as in the Cartesian theory of substances, there IS danger that the being of the created object may be reabsorbed in lhy being because of lack of independence and objectivity; hence it must of necessity exist also in itself, must perpetually renew Its existence by itself.
4 The reader willlecall that as st2ted earlier the French word faile means both "do" and "mae:' Tr.

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Consequently my work appears to me as a continuous creation but fixed in the in-itself; it carries indefinitely my "mark"; that is, it is for an indefinite period "my" thought. Every work of art is a thought, an "idea"; its characteristics are plainly ideal to the extent that it is nothing but a meaning. But on the other hand, this meaning, this thought which is in one sense perpetually active as if I were perpetually forming it, as if a mind were conceiving it without respite-a mind which would be my mind --this thought sustains itself alone in being; it by no means ceases to be active when I am not actually thinking it. I stand to it then in the double relation of the consciousness which conceives it and the consciousness which encounters it. It is precisely this double relation which I express by saying that it is mine. We shall see the meaning of it when we have defined precisely the significance of the category "to have." It is in order to enter into this double relation in the synthesis of appropriation that I create my work. In fact it is this synthesis of self and not-self (the intimacy and translucency of thought on the one hand and the opacity and indifference of the in-itself on the other) that I am aiming at and which will establish my ownership of the work. In this sense it is not only strictly artistic works which J appropriate in this manner. This cane which I have cut from the branch is also destined to belong to me in this double relation: first as an object for everyday use, which is at my disposition and which I possess as I possess my clothes or my books, and second as my own work. Thus people who like to surround themselves with everyday objects which they themselves have made, are enjoying subtleties of appropriation. They unite in a single object and in one syncretism the appropriation by enjoyment and the appropriation by creation. We find this same uniting into a single project everywhere from artistic creation to the cigarette which "is better when I wH it myself." Later we shall meet this project in connection with a special type of ownership which stands as the degradation of it-luxury-for we shall see that luxury is distinguished not as a quality of the object possessed but as a quality of possession.
Knowing also-as we showed in the introduction to Part Four-is a form of appropriation. That is why scientific research is nothing other than an effort to appropriate. The truth discovered, like the work of art, is my knowledge; it is the noerna of a thought which is discovered only when I form the thought and which consequently appears in a certain way as maintained in existence by me. It is through me that a facet of the world is revealed; it is to me that it reveals itself. In this sense I am creator and possessor, not that I consider the aspect of being which I discover, as a pure representation, but on the contrary, because this aspect although it is revealed only by me, exists profoundly and really. I can say only t

ledge is
assimilation. The writings of French epistomology swarm with alimentary metaphors (absorption, digestion, assimilation). There is a movement of dissolution which passes from the object to the knowing subject. The known is transformed into me; it becomes my thought and thereby consents to receive its existence from me alone. But this movement of dissolution is fixed by the fact that the known remains in the same place, indefinitely absorbed, devoured, and yet indefinitely intact, wholly digested and yet wholly outside, as indigestible as a stone. For naive imaginations the symbol of the "digested indigestible" is very important; for example, the stone in the stomach of the ostrich or Jonah in the stomach of the whale. The symbol represents the dream of a non-destructive assimilation. It is an unhappy fact-as Hegel noted-that desire destroys its object. In this sense, he said, desire is the desire of devouring. In reaction against this dialectical necessity, the For-itself dreams of an object which may be entirely assimilated by me, which would be me, without dissolving into me but still keeping the structure of the in-itse1t; for what I desire exactly is this object; and if I eat it, I do not have it any more, I find nothing remaining except myself.
This impossible synthesis of assimilation and an assimilated which maintains its integrity, has deep-rooted connections with basic sexual drives. The idea of "carnal possession" offers us the irritating but seductive figure of a body perpetually possessed and perpetually new, on which possession leaves no trace. This is deeply symbolized in the quality of "smooth" or "polished." What is smooth can be taken and felt but remains no less impenetrable, does not give way in the least beneath the appropriative caress-it is like water. This is the reason why erotic descriptions insist on the smooth whiteness of a woman's body. Smooth-it is what re-forms itself under the caress, as water re-forms itself in its passage over the stone which has pierced it. At the same time, as we have seen earlier, the lover's dream is to identify the beloved object with himself and still preserve for it its own individuality; let the Other become me without ceasing to be the Other. It is at this point that we encounter the similarity to scientific research: the known object, like the stOrie in the stomach of the ostrich, is entirely within me, assimilated, transformed into myself, and it is entirely me; but at the same time it is impenetrable, untransformable, entirely smooth, with the indifferent nudity of a body which is beloved and caressed in vain. It remains outside; to know it is to devour it yet without consuming it. We see here how the sexual and· alimentary currents mingle and interpenetrate in order to constitute the Actaeon complex and the Jonah complex; we can see the digestive and sensual roots which are reunited to give birth to the desire of knowing. Knowledge is at one and the same time a penetration and a
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superficial caress, a digestion and the contemplation from afar of an object which will never lose its form, the production of a thought by a continuous creation and the establishment of the total objective independence of that thought. The known object is my thought as a thing
This is precisely what I profoundly desire when I undertake my research
-to apprehend my thought as a t

hing and the thing as my thought. The
syncretic relation which provides the basis for the ensemble of such di·
verse tendencies can be only a relation of appropriation. That is why the
desire to know, no matter how disinterested it may appear, is a relation
of appropriation. To know is one of the forms which can be assumed by
to ha\-'c.
There remains one type of activity which we willingly admit is entirely
gratuitous; the activity of play and the "drives" which relate back to it.
Can we discover an appropriative drive in sport? To be sure, it must be
noted first that playas contrasted with the spirit of seriousness appears
to be ,the least possessive attitude; it strips the real of its reality. The
serious attitude involves starting from the world and attributing more
reality to the world than to oneself; at the very least the serious man
confers reality on himself to the degree to which he belongs to the world.
It is not by chance that materialism is serious; it is not by chance that
it is found at all times and places as the favorite doctrine of the revolu-
tionary. This is because revolutionaries are serious. They come to know
themselves first in terms of the world which oppresses them, and they
wish to change this world. In this one respect they are in agreement with
their ancient adversaries, the possessors, who also come to know them-
selves and appreciate themselves in terms of their position in the world.
Thus all serious thought is thickened by the world; it coagulates; it is a
dismissal of human reality in favor of the world. The serious man is
"of the world" and has no resource in himself. He does not even imagine
any longer the possibility of getting out of the world, for he has given to
himself the type of existence of the rock, the consistency, the inertia, the
opacity of being-in-the-midst-of-the-world. It is obvious that the serious
man at bottom is hiding from himself the consciousness of his free-
dom; he is in bad faith and his bad faith aims at presenting himself
to his own eyes as a consequence; everything is a consequence for him,
and there is never any beginning. That is why he is so concerned with
the consequences of his acts. Marx proposed the original dogma of the
serious when he asserted the priority of object over snbject. Man is
serious when he takes himself for an object.
Plat, like Kierkegaard's irony, releases subjectivity. What is play in-
deed if not an activity of which man is the first origin, for which man
himself sets the rules, and which has no consequences except according to
the rules posited? As soon as a man apprehends himself as free and wishes
to use his freedom, a freedom, by the way, which could just as well be

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his anguish, then his activity is play. The first principle of play is man
himself; through it he escapes his natural nature; he himself sets the
value and rules for his acts and consents to play only according to the
rules which he himself has established and defined. As a result, there is
in a sense "little reality" in the world. It might appear then that when a
man is playing, bent on discovering himself as free in his very action, he
certainly could not be conc;erned with possessing a.being in the world.
His goal, which he aims at through sports or pantomime or games, is to
attain himself as a certain being, precisely the being which is in question
in his being.
The point of these remar

ks, however, is not to show us that in play
the desire to do is irreducible. On the contrary we must conclude that the desire to do is here reduced to a certain desire to be. The act is not its own goal for itself; neither does its explicit end represent its goal and its profound meaning; but the function of the act is to make manifest and to present to itself the absolute freedom which is the very being of the person. This particular type of project, which has freedom for its foundation and its goal, deseryes a special study. It is radically different from all others in that it aims at a radically different type of being. It would be necessary to explain in full detail its relations with the project of being-God, which has appeared to us as the deep-seated structure of human reality. But such a study can not be made here; it belongs rather to an Ethics and it supposes that there has been a preliminary definition of nature and the role of purifying reflection (our descriptions have hitherto aimed only at accessory reflection); it supposes in addition taking a position which can be moral only in the face of values which haunt the For-itself. Nevertheless the fact remains that the desire to play is fundamentally the desire to be.

Thus. the three ca~egories "to be," "to do," and "to have" are reduced here as everywhere to two; "to do" is purely transitional. Ultimately a desire can be only the desire to be or the desire to have. On the other hand, it is seldom that play is pure of all appropriative tendency. I am passing over the desire of achieving a good perfonnance or of beating a record which can act as i. stimulant for the sportsman; I am not even speaking ofthe desire "to have" a handsome body and hannonious muscles, which springs from the desire of appropriating objectively to myself my own being-for-others. These desires do not always enter in and besides they are not fundamental. But there is always in sport an appropriative component. In reality sport is a free transformation of the worldly environment into the supporting element of the. action. This fact makes it creative like art. The environment may be a field of snow, an Alpine slope. To see it is already to possess it. In itself it is already apprehended by sight as a symbol of being.8 It represents pure exteriority, radical

8 See section III.

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spatiality; its undifferentiation, its monotony, and its whiteness manifest the absolute nudity of substance; it is the in-itself which is only in-itself, the being of the phenomenon, which being is manifested suddenly outside all phenomena. At the same time its solid immobility expresses the permanence and the objective resistance of the In-itself, its opacity and its impenetrability. Yet this first intuitive enjoyment can not suffice me. That pure in-itself, comparable to the absolute, intelligible plenum of Cartesian extension, fascinates me as the pure appearance of the not-me; What I wish precise1y is that this in-itself might be a sort of emanation of myself while stilI remaining in itself. This is the meaning even of the snowmen and snowballs which children- make; the goal is to "do something out of snow"; that is, to impose on it a form which adheres so deeply to the matter that the matter appears to exist for the sake of the form. But if I approach, if I want to establish an appropriative contact with the field of snow,

everything is changed. Its scale of being is
modified; it exists bit by bit instead of existing in vast spaces; stains, brush, and crevices come to individualize each square inch. At the same· time its solidity melts into water. I sink into the snow up to my knees; if I pick some up with my hands, it turns to liquid in my fingers; it runs off; there is nothing left of it. The in-itself is transformed into nothingness. My dream of appropriating the snow vanishes at the same moment. Moreover I do not know what to do with this snow which I have just come to see close at hand. I can not get hold of the field; I can not even reconstitute it as that substantial total which offered itself to my eyes and which has abruptly, doubly collapsed.

To ski means not only to enable me to make rapid movements and to acquire a technical skill, nor is it merely to play by increasing according to my whim the speed or difficulties of the course; it is also to enable me to possess this field of Snow. At present I am doing something to it. That means that by my very activity as a skier, I am changing the matter and meaning of the snow. From the fact that now in my course it appears to me as a slope tQ go down, it finds again a continuity and a unity which it had lost. It is at the moment connective tissue. It is included between two limiting terms; it unites the point of departure with the point of arrival. Since in the descent I do not consider it in itself, bit by bit, but am always fixing on a point to be reached beyond the position which I now occupy, it does not collapse into an infinity of individual details but is traversed toward the point which I assign myself. This traversal is not only an activity of movement; it is also and especially a synthetic activity of organization and connection; I spread the skiing field before me in the same way that the geometrician, according to Kant, can apprehend a straight line only by drawing one. Furthermore this organization is marginal and not focal; it is not for itself and in itself that the field of snow is unified; the goal, posited and clearly perceive~ the object of my atten-

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tion is the spot at the edge of the field where I shall arrive. The snowy space is massed underneath implicitly; its cohesion is that of the blank space understood in the interior of a circumference, for example, when I look at the black line of the cirCle without paying explicit attention to its surface. And precisely because I maintain it marginal, implicit, and understood, it adapts itself to me, I have it well in hand; I pass beyond it toward its end just as a man hanging a tapestry passes beyond the hammer which he uses, toward its end, which is to nail an arras on the wall.

No appropriation can be more complete than this instrumental appropriation; the synthetic activity of appropriation is here a technical activity of utilization. The upsurge of the snow is the matter of my act in the same way that the upswing of the hammer is the pure fulfillment of the hammering. At the same time I have chosen a certain point of view in order to apprehend this snowy slope: this point of view is a determined speed, which emanates from me, which I can increase or diminish as I like; through it the field traversed is constituted as a definite object, entirely distinct from what is would be at another speed. The speed organizes the ensembles at wil

l; a specific object does or does not form a part
of a particular group according to whether I have or have not taken a particular speed. (Think, for example, of Provence .seen "on foot;" "by car," "by train," "by bicyde." It offers as many different aspects according to whether or not Beziers is one hour, a morning's trip, or two days distant from Narbonne: that is, according to whether Narbonne is isolated and posited for itself with its environs or whether it constitutes a coherent group with Beziers and Sete, for example. In this last case Narbonne's relation to the sea is directly accessible to intuition; in the other it is denied; it can form the object only of a pure concept.) It is I myself then who'give form to the field of snow by the free speed which I give myself. But at the same time I am acting upon my matter. The speed is not limited to imposing a form on a matter given from the outside; it creates its matter. The snow, which sank under my weight when I walked, which melted into water when I tried to pick it up, solidifies suddenly under the action of my speed; it supports me. It is not that I have lost sight of its lightness, its non-substantiality, its perpetual evanescence. Quite the contrary. It is precisely that lightness, that evanescence, that secret liquidity which 'hold me up; that is, which condense and melt in order to support me. This is because I hold a special relation of appropriation with the snow: sliding. This relation we will study later in detail. But at the moment we can grasp its essential meaning. We think of sliding as remaining on the surface. This is inexact; to be sure, I only skim the surface, and this skimming in itself is worth a whole study. Nevertheless I realize a synthesis which has depth. I realize that the bed of snow organizes itself in its lowest depths in order to hold me up; the sliding
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is action at a distance; it assures my mastery over the material without my needing to plunge into that material and engulf myself in it in order to overcome it. To slide is the opposite of taking root. The root is already half assimilated into the earth which nourishes it; it is a living concretion of the earth; it can utilize the earth only by making itself earth; that is, by submitting itself, in a sense, to the matter which it wishes to utilize. Sliding, on the contrary, realizes a material unity in depth without penetrating farther than the surface; it is like the dreaded master who does not need to insist nor to raise his voice in order to be obeyed. An admirable picture of power. From this comes that famous advice: "Slide, mortals, don't bear down!" This does not mean "Stay on the surface, don't go deeply into things," but on the contrary, "Realize syntheses in depth without compromising yourself."
Sliding is appropriation precisely because the synthesis of support realized by the speed is valid only for the slider and during the actual time when he is sliding. The solidity of the snow is effective only for me, is sensible only to me; it is a secret which the snow releases to me alone and which is already no longer true behind my back. Sliding realizes a strictly individual relation with matter, an historical relation; the matter reassembles itself and solidifies in order to hold me up, and it falls back exhausted and scattered behind me. Thus by my passage I have realized that whic

h is unique for me. The ideal for sliding then is a sliding which
does not leave any trace. It is sliding on water with a rowboat or motor
boat or especially with water skis which, though recently invented,
represent from this point of view the ideal limit of aquatic sports. Slid·
ing on snow is already less perfect; there is a trace behind me by which I
am compromised, however light it may be. Sliding on ice, which scratches
the ice and finds a matter already organized, is very inferior, and if people
continue to do it despite all thi8, it is for other reasons. Hence that
slight disappointment which always seizes us when we see behind us
the imprints which our skis have left on the snow. How much better
it would be if the snow re-formed itself as we passed over it! Besides
when we let ourselves slide down the slope, we are accusi:omed to the
illusion of not making any mark; we ask the snow to behave like that
water which secretly it is. Thus the sliding appears as identical with a
continuous creation. The speed is comparable to consciousness and here
symbolizes consciousness.7 While it exists, it effects in the material the
birth of a deep quality which lives only so long as the speed exists, a sort
of reassembling which conquers its indifferent exteriority and which faUs
back like a blade of grass behind the moving slider. The informing uni·
fica~ion and synthetic condensation of the field of snow, which masses
itself into an instrumental organization, which is utilized, like the hammer
'I' \Ve have ~ell in I'artThree the relation of motion to the for-itself.
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or the anvil, and which docilely adapts itself to an action which under·
stands it and fulfills it; a continued and'creative action on the very mat·
ter of the snow; the solidification of the snowy mass by the sliding; the
similarity of the snow to the water which gives support, docile and with-
out memory, or to the naked body of the 'woman, which the caress
leaves intact and troubled in its inmost depths"":"such is the action of the
skier on the real. But at the same time the snow remains impenetrable
and out of reach; in one sense the action of the skier only develops its
potentialities. The skier makes it produce what it can produce; the
homogeneous, solid matter releases for him a solidity and homogeneity
only through the act of the sportsman, but this solidity and this homo·
geneity dwell as properties enclosed in the matter. This synthesis of
self and not-self which the sportsman's action here realizes is expressed,
as in the case of speCUlative knowledge and the work of art, by the
affirmation of the right of the skier over the snow. It is my field of snow;
I have traversed it a hundred times, a hundred times I have through my
speed effected the birth of this force of condensation and support; it is
mine.
To this aspect of appropriation through sport, there must be added
another-a difficulty overcomc. It is more generally understood, and we
shan scarcely insist on it here. Before descending this snowy slope, I
must climb up it. And this ascent has offered to me another aspect of the
snow-resistance. I have realized this resistance through my fatigue, and
I have been able to measure at each instant the progress of my victory.
Here the snow is identical with the Other, and the common expressions
"to overcome," "to conquer," "to master," etc. indicate sufficientlytha

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it is a matter of establishing between me and the snow the relation of master to slave. This aspect of appropriation which we find in the ascent, exists also in swimming, in an obstacle course, etc. The peak on which a flag is planted is a peak which has been appropriated. Thus a· principal aspect of sport-and in particular of open air sports-is the conquest of these enormous masses of water, of earth, and of air, which seem a priori indomitable and unutilizable; and in each case it is a question of possessing not the element for itself, but the type of existence in-itself which is expressed by means of this element; it is the homogeneity of substance which we wish to possess in the form of snow; it is the impenetrCIbility of the in-itself and its non-temporal permanence which we wish to appropriate in the form of the earth or of the rock, etc. Art, science, play are activities of appropriation, either wholly or in part, and what they want to appropriate beyond the concrete object of their quest is being itself, the absolute being of the in-itself.
Thus ontology teaches us that desire is originally a desire of being and that it is characterized as the free lack of being. But it teaches us also that desire is a relation with a concrete existent in the midst of the world and
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that this existent is conceived as a type of in-itself; it teaches us that the relation of the for-itself to this desired in-itself is appropriation. We are, then, in the presence of a double determination of desire: on the one hand, desire is determined as a desire to be a certain being, which is the in-itself-for-itself and whose existence is ideal; on the other hand, desire is determined in the vast majority of cases as a relation with a contingent and concrete in-itself which it has the project of appropriating.s Does one of these determinations dominate the other? Are the two characteristics compatible? Existential psychoanalysis can be assured of its principles only if ontology has given a preliminary definition of the relation of these two beings-the concrete and contingent in-itself or object of the desire, and the in-itself-for-itself or ideal of the desire-and if it has made explicit the relation which unites appropriation as a type of relation to the in-itself, to being, as a type of relation to the in-itself-for-itself. This is what we must attempt at present.
What is meant by "to appropriate"? Or if you prefer, what· do we understand by possessing an object? Wc have seen the reducibility of the category "to do," which allows us to see in it at one time "to be" and at another "to have." Is it the same with the category "to have"? It is evident that in a great number of cases, to possess an object is to be able to use it. However, lam not satisfied with this definition. In this cafe I use this plate and this glass, yet they are not mine. I can not "use" that picture which hangs on my wall, and yet it belongs to me. The right which I have in certain cases to destroy what I possess is no more decisive. It would be purely abstract to define ownership by this right, and furthermore in a society with a "planned economy" an owner can possess his factory without having the right to close it; in imperial Rome the master possessed his slave but did not have the right to put him to death. Besides what is meant here by the right to destroy, the right to use? I

caq see that this right refers me to the social sphere and
that ownership seems to be defined within the compass of life in society.
But I see also that the right is purely ncgative and is limited to preventing
another from destroying or using what belongs to me. Of course we
could try to define ownership as a social function. But first of all,
. although society confers in fact the rigllt to possess according to certain
rules, it does not follow that it creates the relation of appropriation. At
the very most it makes it legal. If ownership is to be elevated to the rank
of the sacred, it must first of all exist as a relation spontaneously estab-
lished between the for-itself and the concrete in-itself. If we can imagine
the future existence of a more just collective organization, where indi-
vidual possession will cease to be protected and sanctified at least within
certain limits-this does not mean that the appropriative tie will cease
8 Except where there is simply a desire to be-the desire to be happy, to be strong.
e:·c.

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to exist; it can remain indeed by virtue of a private relatio'n of men to
things. Thus in primitive societies where the matrimonial bond is not
yet a legal one and where hereditary descent is still matrilineal, the sexual
tie exists at the very least as a kind of concubinage. It is necessary then to
distinguish between possession and the right to possess. For the same
reason I must reject any definition of the type which Proudhon gives-
such as "ownership is theft"-for it begs the question. It is possible of
course for private property to be the product of theft and for the holding
of this property to have for its result the robbing of another. But whatever
may be its origin and its results, ownership remains no less capable of
description and definition in itself. The thief considers himself the owner
of the money which he has stolen. Our problem then includes describing
the precise relation of the thief to the stolen goods as well as the relation
of the lawful owner to property "honestly acquired."
If I consider the object which I possess, I see that the quality of being
possessed does not indicate a purely external denomination marking the
object's external relation to me; on the contrary, this quality affects its very
depths; it appears to me and it appears to others as making a part of the ob-
ject's being. This is why primitive societies say of certain individuals that
they are "possessed"; the "possessed" are thought of as belonging to ...
This is also the significance of primitive funeral ceremonies where the
dead are buried with the objects which belong to them. The rational ex-
planation, "so that they can use the objects," is evidently after the event.
It is more probable that at the period when this kind of custom appeared
spontaneously, no explanation seemed to be required. The objects had the
specific quality belonging to the deceased. They formed a whole with
him; there was no more question of burying the dead man without
his usual objects than of burying him without one of his legs. The corpse,
the cup from which the dead man drank, the knife which he used make a
single dead person. The custom of burning widows.in Malabar can very
well be included under this principle; the woman has been possessed;
the dead man takes her along with him in his death. lathe eyes of the com-
munity, by rights she

is dead; the burning is only to help her pass from
this death by right to death in fact. Objects which can not be put in the grave are haunted. A ghost is only the concrete materialization of the idea that the house and furnishings "are possessed." To say that a house is haunted means that neither money nor effort will efface the metaphysical, absolute fact of its possession by a former occupant. It is true that the ghosts which haunt ancestral castles are degraded Lares. But what are these Lares if not layers of possession which have been .deposited one by one on the walls and furnishings of the house? The veryiexpression which designates the relation of the object to its owner indicates sufficiently the deep penetration of the appropriation; to be possessed means to be for someone (etre a...). This means that the possessed object is touched
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i~l its being. We have seen moreover that the destruction of the possessor involves the destruction of the right of the possessed and inversely the survival of the possessed involves the survival of the right of the possessor. The bond· of possession is an internal bond of being. I meet the possessor in and through the object which he possesses. This is evidently the explanation of the importance of relics; and we mean by this not only religious relics, .but also and especially the·totality of the property of a famous man in which we try to rediscover him, the souvenirs of the beloved dead which seem to "perpetuate" his memory. (Consider, for example, the Victor Hugo Museum, or the "objects which belonged" to Balzac, to Flaubert.)
This internal, ontological bond between the possessed and the possessor (which customs like branding have often attempted to materialize) can not be explained by a "realistic" theory of appropriation. If we are· right in defining realism as a doctrine which makes subject and object two independent substances possessing existence for themselves and by themselves, then a realistic theory can no more account for appropriation than it can for knowledge, which is one of the forms of appropriation; both remain external relations uniting temporarily subject and object.
But we have seen that a substantial existence must be attributed to the object known. It is the same with ownership in general: the possessed object exists in itself, is defined by 'permanence, non-temporality, a sufficiency of being, in a word by substantiality. Therefore we must put Vnselbstandigkeit on the side of the possessing subject. A substance cannot appropriate another substance, and if we apprehend in things a certain quality of "being possessed," it is because originally the internal relation of the for-itself to the in-itself, which is ownership, derives its origin from the insufficiency of being in the for-itself. It is obvious that the object possessed is not really affected by the act of appropriation, any more than the object known is affected by knowledge. It remains untouched (except in cases where the possessed is a human being, like a slave or a prostitute). But this quality on the part of the possessed does not affect its meaning ideally in the least; in a word, its meaning is to reflect this possession to the for-itself.
If the possessor and the possessed are united by an internal relation based on the insufficiency of being in the for-itself, we must try to determine the nature and

the meaning of the dyad which they form. In fact
the internal relation is synthetic and effects the unification of the possessor and the possessed. This means that the possessor and the possessed constitute ideally a unique reality. To possess is to be united with tIle object· possessed in the form of appropriation; to wish to possess is to wish to be united to an object in this relation. Thus the desire of a particular object is not the simple desire of this object; it is the desire to be united with the object in an internal relation, in the mode of constitut-
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ing with it the unity "possessor-possessed." The desire to have is at bottom reducible to the desire to be related to a certain object in a certain relation of being.
In determining this relation, observations made earlier on the behavior of the scientist, the artist, and the sportsman will be very useful to us. We discovered in the behavior of each one a certain appropriative attitude, and the appropriation in each case was marked by the fact that the object appeared simultaneously to be a kind of subjective emanation of ourselves and yet to remain in an indifferently external relation with us. The "mine" appeared to us then as a relation of being intermediate between the absolute interiority of the me and the absolute ey.teriority of the not-me. There is within the same syncretism a self becoming not-self and a not-self becoming self. But we must describe this relation more carefully. In the project of possession w~ meet a for-itself which is "unselbstiindig," separated by a nothingness from the possibility which it is. This possibility is the possibility of appropriating the object. We meet in addition a value which haunts the for-itself and which ~tands as the ideal indication of the total being which would be realized by the union in identity of the possible and the for-itself which is its possible; I mean here the being which would be realized if I were in the indissoluble unity of identity-myself and my property. Thus appropriation would be a relation of being between a for-itself and a concrete in-itself, and this relation would be haunted by the ideal indication of an identification between this for-itself and the in-itself which is possessed.
To possess means to have for myself; that is, to be the unique end of the existence of the object. If possession is entirely and concretely given, the possessor is the raison d'etre of the possessed object. I possess this pen; that m~ans this pen exists for me, has been made for me. Moreover originally it is I who make for myself the object which I want to possess. My bow and arrows-that means the objects which I have made for myself. Division of labor can dim this ori~inal relation but cannot make it disappear. Luxury is a degradation of it; in the primitive form of luxury I possess an object which I have had made: (done) for myself by people belonging to me (slaves.,. servants born in the house). Luxury therefore is the form of ownership closest to primitive ownership; it is this which next to ownership itself throws the most light on the relation of creation which originally constitutes appropriation. This relation in a society where the division of labor is pushed to tbe limit, is hidden but not suppressed. The object which I possess is one which I have bought. Money represents my strength; it is less

a possession
in itself than an instrument for possessmg. That is why except in most unusual cases of avarice, money is effaced before its possibility for purchase; it is evanescent, it is made to unveil the object, the concrete thing; money has only a transitive being. But to me it appears as a creative

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force: to buy an object is a symbolic act which amounts to creating the object. That is why money is synonymous with power; not only because it is in fact capable of procuring for us what we desire, but especially because it represents the effectiveness of my desire as such. Precisely because it is transcended toward the thing, surpassed, and simply implied, it represen~ my magical bond with the object. Money suppresses the technical connection of subject and object and renders the desire immediately operative, like the magic wishes of fairy tales. Stop before a show case with money in your pocket; the objects displayed are already more than half yours. Thus money establishes a bond of appropriation be· tween the for-itself and the total collection of objects in the world. By means of money desire as such is already informer and creator.
Thus through a continuous degradation, the bond of creation is maintained between subject and object. To have is firstto create. And the bond of ownership which is established then is a bond of continuous creation; the object possessed is inserted by me into the total form of my environment; its existence is determined by my situation and by its integration in that same situation. My lamp is not only that electric bulb, that shade, that wrought iron stand; it is a certain power of lighting this desk, these books, this table; it is a certain luminous nuance of my work at night in connection with my habits of reading or writing late; it is animated, colored, defined by the use which I make of it; it is that use and exists only through it. If isolated from my desk, from my work, and placed in a lot of objects on the floor of a salesroom, my lamp is radically extinguished; it is no longer my lamp; instead, merely a member of the class of lamps, it has returned to its original matter. Thus I am responsible for the existence of my possessions in the human order. Through ownership I raise them up to a certain type of functional being; and my simple life appears to me as creative exactly because by its continuity it perpetuates the quality of being possessed in each of the objects in my possession. I draw the collection of my surroundings into being along with myself. If they are taken from me, they die as my arm would die if it were severed from me.
But the original, radical relation of creation is a relation of emanation, and the difficulties encountered by the Cartesian theory of substance are there to help us discover this relation. What I create is still me-if by creating we mean to bring matter and form to existence. The tragedy of the absolute Creator, if he existed, would be the impossibility of getting out of himself, for whatever he created could be only himself. Where could my creation derive any objectivity and independence since its form and its matter are from me? Only a sort of inertia could close it off from my presence, but in order for this same inertia to function, I must sustain it in existence by a continuous creation. Thus to the extent that I appear to myself as creating objects b

as
I exist in an in-itself. In so far as poss('~sion is a continuous creation, I apprehend the possessed object as founded by me in its being. On the other hand, in so far as creation is emanation, this object is reabsorbed in me, it is. only myself. Finally, in so far as it is originally in itself, it is not-me, it is myself facing myself, objective, in itself, permanent, impenetrable, existing in relation to me in the relation of exteriority, of indifference. Thus I am the foundation for myself in so far as I exist as an indifferent in-itself in relation to myself. But this is precisely the project of the in-itself-for-itself. For this ideal being is defined as an in-itself which, for-itself, would be its own found:,tion, or as a for-itself whose original project would not be a mode of being, but a being precisely the being-in-itself which it is. We see that appropriation is nothing save the symbol of the ideal of the for-itself or value. The dyad, for-itself possessing and in-itself possessed, is the same as that being which is in order to possess itself and whose possession is in its own creation-God. Thus the possessor aims at enjoying his being-in-itself, his being-outside. Through possession I recover an object-being identical with my being-for-others. Consequently the Other can not surprise me; the being which he wishes to bring into the world, which is myself-for-the-Other-this being I already enjoy possessing. Thus possession is in addition a defense against others. What is mine is myself in a non-subjective form inasmuch as I am its free foundation.
We can not insist too strongly on the fact that this relation is symbolic and ideal. My original desire of being my own foundation for myself is never satisfied through appropriation any more than Freud's patient satisfies his Oedipus complex when he dreams that a'soldier kills the Czar (i.e., his father). This is why ownership appears to the owner simultaneouslyas something given at one stroke in the eternal and as requiring an infinite time to be realized. No particular act of utilization really realizes the enjoyment of full possession; but it refers to other appropriative acts, each one of which has the value of an incantation. To possess a bicycle is to be able first to look at it, then to touch it. But touching is revealed as being insufficient; what is necessary is to be able to get on the bicycle and take a ride. But this gratuitous ride is likewise insufficient; it would be necessary to use the bicycle to go on some errands. And this refers us to longer uses and more complete, to long trips across France. But these trips themselves disintegrate into a thousand appropriative behavior patterns, each one of which refers to others. Finally as onc could foresee, handing over a bank-note is enough to make the bicycle belong to me, but my entire life is needed to realize this possession. In acquiring the object, I perceive that possession is an enterprise which

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death always renders still unachieved. Now we can understand why; it is because it is impossible to realize the relation symbolized by appropriation. In itself appropriation contams nothing concrete. It is not a real activity (such as eating, drinking, sleeping) which could serve in addition as a symbol for a particular desire. It exists, on the contrary, only as a symbol; it is its symbolism which gives it its mea

ning, its coherence, its
existence. There can be found in it no positive enjoyment outside its symbolic value; it is only the indication of a supreme enjoyment of possession (that of the being which would be its own toundation), which is always beyond all the appropriative conduct meant to realize it.
This is precisely why the recognition that it is impossible to possess an object involves for the for-itself a violent urge to destroy it. To destroy is to reabsorb into myself; it is to enter along with the being-in-itself of the destroyed object into a relation as profound as that of creation. TIle flames which burn the farm which I myself have set on fire, gradually effect the fusion of the farm with myself. In annihilating it I am changing it into myself. Suddenly I rediscover the relation of being found in creation, but in reverse; I am the foundation of the barn which is burning; I am this barn since I am destroying its being. Destruction realizes appropriation perhaps more keenly than creation does, for the object destroyed is no longer there to show itself impenetrable. It has the impenetrability and the sufficiency of being of the in-itself which it has been, but at the same time it has the invisibility and translucency of the nothingness which I am, since it no longer exists. This glass which I have broken and which "was" on this table, is there still, but as an absolute transparency. I see all beings superimposed. This is what movie producers have attempted to render by overprinting the film. The destroyed object resembles a consciousness although it has the irreparability of the in-itself. At the same time it is positively mine because the mere fact that I have to be what I was keeps the destroyed object from being annihilated. I recreate it by recreating myself; thus to destroy is to recreate by assuming oneself as solely responsible for the being of what existed for all.
Destruction then is to bL given a place among :.ppropriative behaviors. Moreover many kinds of appropriative conduct have a destructive structure along with other structures. To utilize is to use. In making use of my bicycle, I use it up-wear it out; that is, continuous appropriative creation is marked by a partial destruction. This wear can cause distress for strictly practical reasons, but in the majority of cases it brings a secret joy, almost like the joy of possc~sion; this is because it is coming from us-we are consuming. It should be noted that the word "consume" holds the double meaning of an appropriative destruction and an alimentary enjoyment. To COnsume is to annihilate and it is to eat; it is to destroy by incorporating into oneself. If I ride on my bicycle, I can

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be annoyed at wearing out its tires because it is difficult to find others to replace them; but the image of enjoyment which my body invokes is that of a destructive appropriation, of a "creation-destruction." The bicycle gliding alone, carrying me, by its very movement is created and made mine; but this creation is deeply imprinted on the object by the light, continued wear which is impressed on it and which is like the brand on the slave. The object is mine because it is I who have used it; the using up of what is mine is the reverse side of my life.s
These remarks will enable us to understand better the meaning of certain feelings or behavior ordinarily considered as irredu

cible; for ex-
ample, generosity. Actually the gift is a primitive form of destruction.
We know for example that the potlatch involves the destruction of enor·
. mous quantities of merchandise. These destructions are forbidden to the
Other; the gifts enchain him. On this level it is indifferent whether the
object is destroyed or given to another; in any case the potlatch is destruc-
tion and enchaining of the Other. I destroy the object by giving it away
as well as by annihilating it; I suppress in it the quality of being mine,
which constituted it to the depths of its being; I remove it from my
sight; I constitute it-in relation to my table, to my room-as absent;
I alone shall preserve for it the ghostly, transparent being of past objects,
because I am the one through whom beings pursue an honorary existence
after their annihilation. Thus generosity is above all a destructive func-
tion. The craze for giving which sometimes seizes certain people is first
and foremost a craze to destroy; it is equivalent to an attitude of madness,
a "love" which accompanies the shattering objects. But the craze to
destroy which is at the bottom of generosity is nothing else than a craze
to possess. All which I abandon, all which I give, I enjoy in a higher
manner through the fact that I give it away; giving is a keen, brief enjoy-
ment, almost sexual. To give is to enjoy possessively the object which
one gives; it is a destructive-appropriative contact. But at the same time
the gift casts a spell over the recipient; it obliges him to recreate, to main-
tain in being by a continuous creation this bit of myself which I nO
longer want, which I have just possessed up to its annihilation, and which
finally remains only as an image. To give is to enslave. That aspect of the
gift does not interest us here, for it concerns primarily our relations with
others. What we wish to emphasize is that generosity is not irreducible;
to give is to appropriate by destruction while utilizing this destruction
to enslave another. Generosity then is a feeling structured by the exist-
ence of the Other and indicates a preference for appropriation by destruc-
tion. In this way it leads us toward nothingness still more than toward the
in-itself (we have here a nothingness of in-itself which is evidently itself
9 Brummell carried his elegance to the extent of wearing only clothes which had been
worn a little. He had a horror of anything new; what is new is "dressed up" because it
does not belong to anybody.
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in-itself but which as nothingness can symbolize with the being which
is its own nothingness). If then existential psychoanalysis encounters
evidence of generosity in a subject, it must search further for his original
project and ask why the subject has chosen to appropriate by destruction
rather than by creation. The answer to this question will reveal that
original relation to being which constitutes the person who is being
studied.
These observations aim only at bringing to light the ideal character
of the appropriative tie and the symbolic function of all appropriative
conduct. It is necessary to add that the symbol is not deciphered by the
subject himself. It has not been prepared by a symbolic process in an
unconscious but comes from the very structure of being-in-the-world.
We have seen in the chapter devoted to transcendence that the order of
instruments in the

world is the result of my projecting into the in-itself
the image of my possibilities-that is, of what I am-but that I could
never decipher this worldly image since it would require nothing less
than reflective scissiparity to enable me to consider myself in the pattern
of an object. Thus since the circuit of selfness is non-thetic and conse-
quently the identification of what I am remains non-thematic, this "being'
in-itself" of myself which the world refers to as me is necessarily hidden
from my knowledge. I can only adapt myself to it in and through the
approximative action which gives it birth. Consequently to possess does
not mean to know that one holds with the object possessed a relation
identified as creation-destruction; rather to possess means to be in this
relation or better yet to be this relation. The possessed object has for us
an immediately apprehensible quality which transforms it entirely-the
quality of being mine-but this quality is in itself strictly undecipherable;
it reveals itself in and through action. It makes clear that it has a particu-
lar meaning, but from the moment that we want to withdraw a little
in relation to the object and to contemplate it, the quality vanishes
without revealing its deeper structure and its meaning. This withdrawal
indeed is itself destructive of the appropriative connection. An instant
earlier I was engaged in an ideal totality, and precisely because I was
engaged in my being, I could not know it; an instant later the totality
has been broken and I can not discover the meaning of it in the· discon-
nected fragments which formerly composed it, This can be observed in
that contemplative experience called depersonalization which certain
patients have in spite of efforts to resist it. We are forced then to have
recourse to existential psychoanaly~is to reveal in each particular case
the meaning of the appropriative synthesis for which we have just deter-
mined the general, abstract meaning by ontology.
It remains to determine in general the me:ming of the ob~ect possessed.
This investigation should complete our knowledge of the appropriative
project. What then is it which we'seekto appropriate?

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In the first place it is easy to see abstractly that we originally aim at
possessing not so much the mode of being of an object as the actual being
of this particular object. In fact it is as a concrete representative of being-
in-itself that I desire to appropriate it; that is, to apprehend that ideally
I am the foundation of its being in so far as it is a part of myself and
on the other hand to apprehend that empirically the appropriated ob-
ject is never valid in itself alone nor for its individual use. No particular
appropriation has any meaning outside its indefinite extensions: the pen
which I possess is' the same as all other pens; it is the class of pens which I
possess in it. But in addition I possess in it the possibility of writing, of
tracing with certain characteritic forms and color (for I combine the in-
strument itself and the ink which I use in it). These characteristic forms
and color with their meaning are condensed in the pen as well as the paper,
its special resistance, its odor, etc. With all possession there is made the
crystallizing synthesis which Stendhal has described for the one case of
love. Each possessed object which raises itself on the foundation of the
world, manifests

the entire world, just as a beloved woman manifests
the sky, the shore, the sea which surrounded her when she appeared. To
appropriate this lobject is then to appropriate the world symbolically.
Each one can recognize it by referring to his own experience: for myself,
I shall cite a personal example, not to prove the point but to guide the
reader in his inquiry.
Some years ago I brought myself to the decision not to smoke any
more. The struggle was hard, and in truth, I did not care so much for
the taste of the tobacco which I was going to lose, as for the meaning
of the act of smoking. A complete crystallization had been formed. I
used to smoke at the theater, in the morning while working, in the
evening after dinner, and it seemed to me that in giving up smoking I
was going to strip the theater of its interest, the evening meal of its
savor, the morning work of its fresh animation. Whatever unexpected
happening was going to meet my eye, it seemed to me that it was funda-
mentally impoverished from the moment that I could not welcome it
while smoking. To-be-capable-of-being-met-by-me-smoking: such was the
concrete quality which had been spread over everything. It seemed to
me that I was going to snatch it away from everything and that in the
midst of this universal impoverishment, life was scarcely worth the effort.
But to smoke is an appropriative, destructive action. Tobacco is a symbol
of "appropriated" being, since it is destroyed in the rhythm of my breath-
ing, in a mode of "continuous destruction," since it passes into me and
its change in myself is manifested symbolically by the transformation of
the consumed solid into smoke. The connection between the land-
scape seen while I was smoking and this little crematory sacrifice was such
that as we 'have just seen, the tobacco symbolized the landscape. This

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means then that the act of destructively appropriating the tobacco was
the symbolic equivalent of destructively appropriating the entire world.
Across the tobacco which I was smoking was the world which was burn-
ing, which was going up in smoke, which was being reabsorbed into vapor
so as to reenter into me. In order to maintain my decision not to smoke,
I had to realize a sort of decrystallization; that is, without exactly account-
ing to myself for what I was doing, I reduced the tobacco to being nothing.
but itself-an herb which burns. I cut its symbolic ties with the world;
I persuaded myself that I was not taking anything away from the play at
the theater, from the landscape, from the book which I was reading, if
I considered them without my pipe; that is, I rebuilt my possession
of these objects in modes other than that sacrificial ceremony. As soon
as I was persuaded of this, my regret was reduced to a very small matter;
I deplored the thought of not perceiving the odor of the smoke, the
warmth of the bowl between my fingers and so forth. But suddenly my
regret was disarmed and quite bearable.
Thus what fundamentally we desire to appropriate in an object is its
being and it is the worid. These two ends of appropriation are in reality .
only one. I search behind the phenomenon to possess the being of the
phenomenon. But this being, as we have seen, is very different from the
phenomenon of being; it is being-in-itself, and not only the being of a
particular thing. It is not because there is here a passage to the universal
but ra

ther the being considered in its concrete nudity becomes suddenly the being of the totality. Thus the relation of possession appears to us clearly: to possess is to wish to possess the the world across a particular object. And as possession is defined as the effort to apprehend ourselves as the foundation of a being in so far as it is ourselves ideally, every possessive project aims at constituting the For-itself as the foundation of the world or a concrete totality of the in-itself, and this totality is, as totality, the for-itself itself existing in the mode of the in-itself. To-be-in-the-world is to form the project of possessing the world; that is, to apprehend the total world as that which is lacking to the for-itself in order that it may become in-itself-for-itself. It is to be engaged in a totality, which is precisely the ideal or value or totalized totality and which would be ideally constituted by the fusion of the for-itself as a detotalized totality which has to be what it is, with the world, as the totality of the in-itself which is what it is.

It must be understood of course that the project of the for-itself is not to establish a being of reason, that is a being which the for-itself would first conceive-form and matter--and then endow with existence. Such a being actually would be a pure abstraction, a universal; its conception could not be prior to being-in-the-world; on the contrary its conception would presuppose being-in-the-world as it supposes the pre-ontological wmprehension of a being which is eminently concrete and present at

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the start, which is the "there" of the first being-there of the for-itself; that is the being of the world. The for-itself does not exist so as first to think a universal and then determine itself in terms of concepts. It is its choice and its choice can not be abstract without making the very being of the for-itself abstract. The being of the for-itself is an individual ven· ture, and the choice must be an individual choice of a concrete being. This applies, as we have seen, to the situation in general. The choice of the for-itself is always a choice of a concrete situation in its incomparable uniqueness. But it is true as well for the ontological meaning of this choice. \\'hen we say that the for-itself is a project of being, we do not mean that the being-in-itself which it forms the project of being, is conceived by the for-itself as a structure common to all existents of a certain type; its project is in no way a conception, as we have seen. That which it forms the project of being appears to it as an eminently concrete totality; it is this particular being. Of course we can foresee in this project the possibilities of a universalizing development; but it is in the same way as we say of a lover that he loves all women or all womankind in one woman. The for-itself has the project of being the foundation of this concrete being, which as we have just seen, can not be conceived- for the .very reason that it is concrete; neither can it be imagined, for the imaginary is nothingness and this being is eminently being. It must exist; that is, it must be encountered, but this encounter is identical with the choice which the for-itself makes. The for-itself is an encountered-choice; that is, it is defined as a choice of founding the being which it encounters. This means that the for-itself as an

individual enterprise is a choice of tllis
world, as an individual totality of being; it does not surpass it towards a logical universal but towards a new concrete "state" of the same world, in which being would be an in-itself founded by the for-itself; that is, it surpasses it towards a concrete-being-beyond-the-concrete-existing-being. Thus being-in-the-world is a project of possessing-this world, and the value which haunts the for-itself is the concrete indication of an individual being constituted by the synthetic function of this for-itself and this world. Being, in fact, whatever it may be, wherever it may come from and in whatever mode we may consider it, whether it is in-itself or for-itself or the impossible ideal of in-itself-for-itself, is in its original contingency an individual venture.

Now we can define the relations which unite the two categories, to be and to lJave. We have seen that desire can be originally either the desire to be or the desire to have. But the desire to have is not irreducible. While the desire to be bears directly on the for-itself and has the project of conferring on it without intermediary the dignity of in-itself-for-itsel~, the desire to have aims at the for-itself on, in and through the world. It IS by the appropriation of the world .that the project to have aims at realizing the same value as the desire to be. 'rhat is why these desires, which

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can be distinguished by analysis, are in reality inseparable. It is impossible to find a desire to be which is not accompanied by a desire to have, and conversely. Fundamentally we have to do with two ways of looking toward a single goal, or if you prefer, with two interpretations of the same fun.damental situation, the one tending to confer being on the For-itself without detour, the other establishing the circuit of selfness; that is, inserting the world between the for-itself and its being. As for the original situation, it is the lack of being which I am; that is, which I make myself be. But the being of which I make myself a lack is strictly individual and concrete; it is the being which exists already and in the midst of which I arise as being its lack. Thus the very nothingness which I am is individual and concrete, as being this nihilation and not any other.

Every for-itself is a free choice; each of its acts-the most insignificant as well as the most weighty-expresses this choice and emanates from it. This is what we have called our freedom. We have now grasped the f!leaning of this choice; it is a choice of being, either directly or by the appropriation of the world, or rather by both at once. Thus my freedom is a choice of being God and all my acts, all my projects translate this choice and reflect it in a thousand and one ways, for there is an infinity of ways of being and of ways of having. The goal of existential psychoanalysis is to rediscover through these empirical, concrete projects the original way in which each man has chosen his being. It remains to explain, someone V'.:1I say, why I choose to possess the world through this particular object rather than another. We shall reply that here we see the peculiar character of freedom.

Yet the object itself is not irreducible. In it we aim at its being through its mode of being or quality. Quality-particularly a material quality like the fluidity of water or the density of a stone,-is a m

ode of being an~
so can only present being in one certain way. Vlhat we choose is a certain way in which being reveals itself and lets itself be possessed. The yellow and red, the taste of a tomato, or the wrinkled softness of split peas are by no means irreducible givens according to our view. They translate symbolically to our perception a certain way which being has of giving itself, and we react by disgust or desire, according to how we see being spring forth in one way or another from their surface. Existential psychoanalysis must bring out the ontological meaning of qualities. It is only thus-and not by considerations of sexuality-that we can explain, for example, certain constants in poetic "imaginations" (Rimbaud's "geological," Poe's fluidity of water) or simply the tastes of each one, those famous tastes which we are forbidden to discuss without taking into account that they symbolize in thcir own way a whole \Veltanschauung, a whole choice of being and that hence comes their self-evidence to the eyes of the man who has made them his. Our next procedure thcn is to sketch in outline this particular attempt of existential psychoanalysis,

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for the sake of making suggestions for further research. For it is not on the level of a taste for sweetness or for bitterness and the like that the free choice is irreducible, but on the level of the choice of the aspect of being which is revealed through and by means of sweetness, bitterness, and the rest.

III. QUALITY AS A REVELATION OF BEING

WHAT we must do is to attempt a psychoanalysis of things. M. Bachelard has tried this and shown much talent in his last book, Water and Dreams. There is great promise in this work; in particular the author has made a real discovery in his "material imagination." Yet in truth this term imagination does not suit llsand neither does that attempt to look behind things and their gelatinous, solid, or fluid matter, for the "images" which we project there. Perception, as I have shown elsewhere,lO has nothing in common with imagination; on the contrary each striCtly excludes the other. To perceive does not mean to assemble images by means of sensations; this thesis, originating with the association theory in psychology, must be banished entirely. Consequently psychoanalysis will not look for images but rather will seek to explain the meaning which really belongs to things. Of course the "human" meaning of stid:y, of slimy, etc. does not belong to the in-itself. But potentialities do not belong to it either, as we have seen, and yet it is these which constitute the world. Material meanings, the human sense of needles, snow, grained wood, of crowded, of greasy, etc., are as real as the world, neither more nor less, and to come into the world means to rise up in the midst of these meanings. But no doubt we have to do here with a simple difference in terminology. M. Bachelard appears bolder and seems to reveal the basis of his thought when he speaks in his studies of psychoanalyzing plants or when he entitles one of his works The Psychoanalysis of Fire. Actually he is applying not to the subject but to things a method of objective interpretation which does not suppose any previous reference to the subject. When for instance I wish to determine the objective meaning of snow, I see. for example, that it melts at certain temperatures and that this melting of the sn

ow is its death. Here we merely have to do with
objective confirmation. When I wish to determine the meaning of this
melting, I must compare it to other objects located in other rerions of
existence but equally objective, equally transcendent-ideas, friendship,
persons-concerning which I can also say that they melt. Money melts
in my hands. I am swimming and I melt in the water. Certain ideas-in
the sense of socially objective meanings-"snowball" and others melt
10 L'Imaginaire. N.R.F., 1939.

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away.u We say, "How thin he has become! How he has melted away!"
(Comme il a fondu!) Doubtless I shall thus obtain a certain relation
binding certain forms of being to certain others.
It is important to compare the melting snow to certain other more
mysterious examples of melting. Take for example the content of certain
old myths. The tailor in Grimm's fairy tales takes a piece of cheese
in his hands, pretends it is a stone, squeezes it so hard that the whey oozes
out of it; his assistants believe that he has made a stone drip, that he is
extracting the liquid from it. Such a comparison informs us of a secret
liquid quality in solids, in the sense in which Audiberti by a happy
inspiration spoke of the secret blackness of milk. This liquidity which
ought to be compared to the juice of fruits and to human blood-which
is to man something like his own secret and vital liquidity-this liquidity
refers us to a certain permanent possibility which the "granular compact"
(designating a certain quality of the being of the pure in-itself) possesses
of changing itself into homogenous, undifferentiated fluidity (another
quality of the being of the pure in-itself). We apprehend here in its origin
and with all its ontological significance the polarity of the continuous and
discontinuous, the feminine and masculine poles of the world, for which
we shall subsequently see the dialectical development all the way to the
quantum theory and wave mechanics. Thus we shall succeed in decipher-
ing the secret meaning of the snow, which is an ontological meaning.
But in all this where is the relation to the subjective? To imagination?
All we have done is to compare strictly objective structures and to fonnu-
late the hypothesis which can unify and group these structures. That
is why psychoanalysis depends here on the things themselves, not upon
men..That is also why I should have less confidence then M. Bachelard in
resorting at this level to the material imaginations of poets, whether
Lautreamont, Rimbaud, or Poe. To be sure, it is fascinating to look for
the "Bestiary of Lautreamont." But actually if in this research we have
returned to the subjective, we shall attain results truly significant only
if we consider Lautreamont as an original and pure preference for ani-
mality and if we have first detennined the objective meaning of ani-
mality12. In fact if Lautreamont is what he prefers, it is necessary first
to understand the nature of what he prefers. To be sure, we know well
that he is going "to put':, into the animal world, something different and
more than I put into it. But the subjective enrichments which infonn
us about Lautreamont are polarized by the objective structure of ani-
mality. This is why the existential psychoanalysis of Lautreamont sup-
poses first an interpretation of the objective meaning of animal. Similarly
I have thought for a long time of establishing a lapid

be concerned with establishing the
way in which each thing is the objective symbol of being and of the relation of human reality to this being. We do not deny that we should discover afterwards a whole sexual symbolism in nature, but it is a secondary and reducible stratum, which supposes first a psychoanalysis of presexual structures. Thus M. Bachelard's study of water, which abounds in ingenious and profound insights, will be for us a set of suggestions, a precious collection of materials which should now be utilized by a psychoanalysis which is aware of its own principles.

What ontology can teach psychoanalysis is first of all the true origin of the meanings of things and their true relation to human reality. Ontology alone in fact can take its place on the plane of transcendence and from a single viewpoint apprehend being-in-the-world with its two terms, because ontology alone has its place originally in the perspective of the cogito. Once again the ideas of facticity and situation will enable us to understand the existential symbolism of things. We have seen that it is in theory possible but in practice impossible to distinguish facticity from the project which constitutes it in situation. This observation can be of use to us here; we have seen that there is no necessity to hold that the "this" has any meaning whatever when considered in the indifferent exteriority of its being and independently from the upsurge of the for-itself. Actually its quality, as we have seen, is nothing other than its being. The yellow of the lemon, we said, is not a subjective mode of apprehending the lemon; it is the lemon. We have shown also that the whole lemon extends throughout its qualities and that each one of the qualities is spread over the others; that is what we have correctly called "this."[13] Every quality of being is all of being; it is the presence of its absolute contingency; it is its indifferent irreducibility. Yet in Part Two we insisted on the inseparability of project and facticity in the single quality. "For in order for there to be quality, there must be being for a nothingness which by nature is not being ... Quality is the whole of being unveiling itself within the limitations of the there is." Thus from the beginning we could not attribute the meaning of a quality to being-in-itself, since the "there is" is already necessary; that is, the nihilating meditation of the for-itself must be there in order for qualities to be there. But it is easy to understand in view of these remarks that the meaning of quality in turn indicates something as a re-enforcement of "there is," since we take it as our support in order to surpass the "there is" toward being as it is absolutely and in-itself.

In each apprehension of quality, there is in this sense a metaphysical effort to escape from our condition so as to pierce through the shell of nothingness about the "there is" and to penetrate to the pure in-itself. But obviously we can apprehend quality only as a symbol of a being which

13 Part Two, ch. III, section iii.

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totally escapes us, even though it is totally there before us; in short, we can only make revealed being function as a symbol of being-in-itself. This means that a new structure of the "there is" is constituted which is the meaningful level although this level is revealed in the absolute unity of one and the same fundamental

priori, although it is a free project and although it is identified with the being of the for-itself. In fact the appropriative mode does not depend originally on the mode of being of the slimy but only on its brute being there, on its pure encountered existence; it is like any other e,ncounter since it is a simple project of appropriation, since it is nO,t distinguished in any way from the pure "there is" and since it is, according to whether we consider it from one point of view or the other, either pure freedom or pure nothingness. But it is precisely within the limits of this appropriative project that the slimy reveals itself and develops its sliminess. From the first appearance of the slimy, this sliminess is already a response to a demand, already a bestowal of self; the slimy appears as already the outline of a fusion of the world with myself. What it teaches me about the world, that it is like a leech sucking me, is already a reply to a concrete question; it responds with its very being, with its mode of being, with all its matter. The response which it gives is at the same time fully appropriate to the question and yet opaque and indecipherable, for it is rich with all its inexpressible materiality. It is clear inasmuch as the reply is exactly appropriate; the slimy lets itself be apprehended as that which I lack; it lets itself be examined by an appropriative inquiry; it allows its sliminess to be revealed to this outline of appropriation. Yet it is opaque because if the meaningful form is evoked in the slimy by the for-itself, all its sliminess comes to succour and replenish it. We are referred then to a meaning which is full and dense, and this meaning rel~ases for us first being-in-itself in so far as the slimy is at the moment thaffwhich is manifesting the world, and second an outline of ourselves, in so far as the appropriation outlines something like a founding act on the part of the slimy.

What comes back to us then as an objective quality is a new nature which is neither material (and physical) nor psychic, but which transcends the opposition of the psychic and the physical, by revealing itself to us as the ontological expression of the entire world; that is, which offers itself as a rubric for classifying all the "thises" in the world, so that we have to deal with material organizations or transcended transcend-

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ences. This means that the apprehension of the slimy as such has, by the same stroke, crcated for the in-itself of the world a particular mode of giving itself. In its own way it symbolizes being; that is, so long as the Contact with the slimy endures, everything takes place for us as if sliminess were the meaning of the entire world or the unique mode of being of being-in-itself-in the same way as for the primitive clan of lizards all objects are lizards.

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What mode of being is symbolized by the slimy? I see first that it is the homogeneity and the imitation of liquidity. A slimy substance like pitch is an aberrant fluid. At first, with the appearance of a fluid it manifests to us a being which is everywhere fleeing and yet everywhere similar to itself, which on all sides escapes yet on which one can float, a being without danger and without memory, which eternally is changed into itself, on which one leaves no mark and which could not leave a mark on us, a being which slides and on which one can

slide, which can
be possessed by something sliding (by a rowboat, a motor boat, or water ski), and which never possesses because it rolls over us, a being which is eternity and infinite temporality because it is a perpetual change without anything which changes, a being which best symbolizes in this synthesis of eternity and temporality, a possible fusion of the for-itself as pure temporality and the in-itself as pure eternity. But immediately the slimy reveals itself as essentially ambiguous because its fluidity exists in slow motion; there is a sticky thickness in its liquidity; it represcnts in itself a dawning triumph of the solid over the liquid-that is, a tendency of the indiffcrent in-itself, which is represented by the pure solid, to fix the liquidity, to absorb the for-itsclf which ought to dissolve it.
Slime i~ the agony of water. It presents itsclf as a phenomenon in process of b(;(":"Ill;ng; it does not have the permanence within change that water has but on the contrary represents an accomplished break in a change of state. This fixed instability in the slimy discourages possession. \Vater is more fleeting, but it can be possessed in its very flight as something fleeing. The slimy flees with a heavy flight which has the same relation to water as the unwieldy earthbound flight of the chicken has to that of the hawk. Even this flight can not be possessed because it denies itself as flight. It is already almost a solid permanence. Nothing testifies more clearly to its ambiguous character as a "subst:mce in between two states" than the slowness with which the slimy melts into itself. A drop of water touching the surface of a large body of water is instantly transformed into the body of water; we do not see the operation as buccal absorption, so to speak, of the drop of water by the body of water but rather as a spiritualizing and breaking down of the individuality of a single being which is dissolved in the great All from which it had issued. The symbol of the body of water seems to playa very important role in the construction of pantheistic systems; it reveals a particular type of

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relation of being to being. But if we consider the slimy,J5 we llote that it pre~ents a constant hysteresis in the phenomenon of being transmuted into itself. The honey which slides off my spoon on to the honey COntained in the jar first sculptures the surface by fastening itself on it in relief, and its fusion with the whole is presented as a gradual sinking, a collapse which appears at once as a deflation (think for example of children's pleasure in playing with a toy which whistles when inflated and groans moumfuBy whendeflating16) and as display-like the flattening out of the full breasts of a woman who is lying on her back.
In the slimy substance which dissolves into itself there is a visible resistance, like the refusal of an individual who does not want to be annihilated in the whole of being, and at the same time a softness pushed to its ultimate limit. For the soft is only an annihilation which is stopped half way; the soft is what furnishes us with the best image of our own destructive power and its limitations. The slowness of the disappearance of the slimy drop in the bosom of the whole is grasped first in softness, which is like a retarded annihilation and seems 'to be playing for time, but this softness lasts up to the end; the d

rop is sucked into
the body of the slimy substance. This phenomenon gives rise to several characteristics of the slimy. First it is soft to touch. Throw water on the ground; it LUllS. Throw a slimy substance; it draws itself out, it displays itself, it flattens itself out, it is soft; touch the slimy; it does not flee, it yields. There is in the very fact that we cannot grasp water a pitiless hardness which gives to it a secret sense of being metal; finally it is incompressible like steel. The slimy is compressible. It gives us at first the impression that it is a being which can be possessed. Doubly so: its sliminess, its adherence to itself prevent it from escaping; I can take it in my hands. separate a certain quantity of honey or of pitch from the rest in the jar, and thereby create an individual object by a continuous creation; but at the same time the softness of this substance which is squashed in my hands gives me the impression that I am perpetually destroying it. Actually we have here the image of destruction-creation. The slimy is docile. Only at the very moment when I believe that I possess it, behold by a curious reversal, it possesses me. Here appears its essential character: its softness is leech-like. If an object which I hold in my hands is solid, I can let go when I please; its inertia symbolizes for me my total power; I give it its foundation, but it does not furnish any foundation for me; the For-itself collects the In-itself in the object and raises the object to

13 Although slime has mysteriously preserved al1 fluidity in slow motion, it must not be confused with purees where fluidity roughly outlined, undergoes abrupt breaks and blocks and where the substance after a preliminary plan of pouring, rolls abruptly head over heels.

16 In the original the reference is to gold-beater's skin, a thin membrane used in making gold leat Tr.

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the dignity of the In-itself without compromising itself (i.e., the self of the For-itself) but always remaining an assimilating and creative power. It is the For-itself which absorbs the In-itself. In other words, possession asserts the primacy of the For-itself in the synthetic being "In-itself-For-itself." Yet here is the slimy reversing the terms; the For-itself is suddenly compromised. I open my hands, I want to let go of the slimy and it sticks to me, it draws me, it sucks at me. Its mode of being is neither the re3ssuring inertia of the solid nor a dynamism like that in water which is exhausted in flecing from me. It is a soft, yieldingaction, a moist and feminine sucking, it lives obscurely under my fingers, and I ser:se it like a dizziness; it draws me to it as the bottom of a precipice might draw me. There is something like a tactile fascination in the slimy. I am no longer the master in arresting the process of appropriation. It continues. In one sense it is like the supreme docility of the possessed, the fidelity of a dog who gives himself even when one does not want him any longer, and in another sense there is underneath this docility a surreptitious appropriation of the possessor by the possessed.

Hcre we can see the symbol which abruptly discloses itself: there exists a poisonous possession; there is a possibility that the In-itself might absorb the For-itself; that is, that a being might be constituted in a manner just the reverse of the "In-itself-For-itself," and that

in this new being
the In-itself would draw the For-itself into its contingency, into its indif-
ferent exteriority, into its foundationless existence. At this instant I sud-
denly understand the snare of the slimy: it is a fluidity which holds me
and which compromises me; I can not slide on this slime, all its suction
cups hold me back; it can not slide over me, it clings to me like a leech.
The sliding however is not simply denied as in the case of the solid;
it is degraded. The slimy seems to lend itself to me, it invites me; for a
body of slime at rest is not noticeably distinct from a body of very dense
liquid. But it is a trap. The sliding is sucked in by the sliding substance,
and it leaves its traces upon me. The slime is like a liquid seen in a night-
mare, where all its properties are animated by a sort of life and turn
back against me. Slime is the revenge of the In-itself. A sickly-sweet,
feminine revenge which will be symbolized on another level by the quality
"sugary." This is why the sugar-like sweetness to the taste-an indelible
sweetness, which remains indefinitely in the mouth even after swallow-
ing-perfectly completes the essence of the slimy. A sugary sliminess is
the ideal of the slimy; it symbolizes the sugary death of the For-itself
(like that of the wasp which sinks into the jam and drowns in it).
But at the same time the slimy is myself, by the very fact that I outline
an appropriation of the slimy substance. That sucking of the slimy which
I feel on my hands outlines a kind of continuity of the slimy substance
in myself. These long, soft strings of substance which fall from me to the
slimy body (when, for example, I plunge my hand into it and then pull
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it out again) symbolize a rolling off of myself in the slime. And the
hysteresis which I establish in the fusion of the ends of these strings with
the larger body, symbolizes the resistance of my being to absorption into
the In-itself. If I dive into the water, if I plunge into jt, if I let myself sink
in it, I experience no discomfort, for I do not have any fear whatsoever
that I may dissolve in it; I remain a solid in its liquidity. If I sink in tIle
slimy, I feel that I am going to be lost in it; that is, that I may dissolve in
the slime precisely because the slimy is in process of solidification. The
sticky would present the same aspect as the slimy from this point of view,
but it does not have the same fascination, it does not compromise
because it is inert. In the very apprehension of the slimy there is a gluey
substance, compromising and without equilibrium, like the haunting
memory of a metamorphosis.
To touch the slimy is to risk being dissolved in sliminess. Now this dis-
solution by itself is frightening enough,because it is the absorption of the
For-itself by the In-itself as ink is absorbed by a blotter.. But it is still
more frightening in that the metamorphosis is not just into a thing (bad
as that would be) but into slime. Even if I could conceive of a liquefac-
tion of myself (that is, a transformation of my being into water) I would
not be inordinately affected because water is the symbol of consciousness
-its movement, its fluidity, its deceptive appearance of being solid, its
perpetual flight-everything in it recalls the For-itself; to such a degree
that psychologists who first noted the characteristics of duration of con-
sciousness (James, Berg

son) have very often compared it to a river. A river best evokes the image of the constant interpenetration of the parts by a whole and their perpetual dissociation and free movement.

But the slimy offers a horrible image; it is horrible in itself for a consciousness to become slimy. This is because the being of the slimy is a soft clinging, there is a sly solidarity and complicity of all its leechlike parts, a vague, soft effort made by each to individualize itself, followed by a falling back and flattening out that is emptied of the individual, sucked in on all sides by the substance. A consciousness which became slimy would be transformed by the thick stickiness of its ideas. From the time of our upsurge into the world, we are haunted by the image of a consciousness which would like to launch forth into the future, toward a projection of self, and which at the very moment when it was conscious of arriving there would be slyly held back by the invisible suction of the past and which would have to assist in its own slow dissolution in this past which it was fleeing, would have to aid in the invasion of its project by a thousand parasites until finally it completely lost itself. The "flight of ideas" found in the psychosis of influence gives us the best image of this horrible condition. But what is it then which is expressed by this fear on the ontological level if not exactly the flight of the For-itself before the In-itself of facticity; that is, exactly temporalization.

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The horror of the slimy is the horrible fear that time might become slimy, that facticity might progress continually and insensibly and absorb the For-itself which exists it. It is the fear not of death, not of the pure In-itself, not of nothingness, but of a particular type of being, which does not actually exist any more than the In-itsclf-For-itself and which is only represented by the slimy. It.is an ideal being which I reject with all my strength and which haunts me as value haunts my being, an ideal being in which the foundationless In-itself has priority over thc For-itself. We shall call it an Antivalue.

Thus in the project of appropriating the slimy, the sliminess is revealed suddenly as a symbol of an antivalue: it is a type of being not realized but threatening which will perpetually haunt consciousness as the constant danger which it is fleeing, and hence will suddenly transform the projcct of appropriation into a projcct of flight. Something has appeared which is not the result of any prior expericnce but only of the pre-ontological compre,hension of the In-itself and the For-itself, and this is the peculiar meaning of the slimy. In one sense it is an experience since sliminess is an intuitive discovery; in another sense it is like the discovery of an adventure of being. Henceforth for the For-itself there appears a new danger, a threatening mode of being which must be avoided, a concrete category which it will discover everywhere. The slimy does not symbolize any psychic attitude a priori; it manifests a certain relation of being with itself and this relation has originally a psychic quality because I have discovered it in a plan of appropriation and because the sliminess has returned my image i.o me. Thus I am enriched from my first contact with the slimy, by a valid ontological pattern beyond the distinction between psychic and non-psychic, which will

interpret the meaning of
being and of all the existents of a certain category, this category arising, moreovcr, like an empty skeletal framework before the experience with diffcrent kinds of sliminess. I· have projected it into the world by my original project when faced with the slimy; it is an objective structure of the world and at thc same time an antivalue; that is, it dctennines an area where slimy objects will arrange themselves. Henceforth each time that an object will manifest to me this relation of being, whether it is a matter of a handshake, of a smile, or of a thought, it will be apprehended by definition as slimy: that is, beyond its phenomenal context, it will appear to me as constituting along with pitch, glue, honey, etc. the great ontological region of sliminess.
Conversely, to the extent that the this which I wish to appropriate, represents the entire world, the slimy, from my first intuitive contact, appears to me rich with a host of obscure meanings and references which surpass it. The slimy is revealed in itself as "much more than the slimy." From the moment of its appearance it transcends all distinctions between psychic and physical, between the brute existent and the meanings of
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the world; it is a possible meaning of being. The first experience which the infant can have with the slimy enriches him psychologically and morally; he will not need to reach adulthood to discover the kind of sticky baseness which we figuratively name "slimy"; it is there near him in the very sliminess of honey or of glue. What we say concerning the slimy is valid for all the objects which surround the child. The simple revelation of their matter extends his horizon to the extreme limits of being and bestows upon him at the same stroke a collection of clues for deciphering the being of all human facts. This certainly does not mean that he knows from the start the "uglinesS;" the "characteristics," or the "beauties" of existence. He is merely in possession of 'all the meanings of being . of which ugliness and beauty, attitudes, psychic traits, sexual relations, etc. will never be more than particular exemplifications. The gluey, the sticky, the hazy, etc., holes in the sand and in the earth, caves, the light, the night, etc.-all reveal to him modes of pre-psychic and pre-sexual being which he will spend the rest of his life explaining. There is no such thing as an "innocent" child. We will gladly recognize along with the Freudians the innumerable relations existing between sexuality and certain matter and forms in the child's environment. But we .do not understand by this that a sexual instinct already constituted has charged them with a sexual significance. On the contrary it seems to us that this matter and these forms are apprehended in themselves, and they reveal to the child the For-itself's modes of being and relations to being which wiH illuminate and shape his sexuality.
To cite only one example-many psychoanalysts have been struck by the attraction which all kinds of holes exert on the child (whether holes in the sand or in the ground, crypts, caves, hollows, or whatever), and they have explained this attraction either by the anal character of infant sexuality, or by prenatal shock, or by a presentiment of the adult sexual act. But we can not accept any of these explanations. The idea of "birth trauma" is highly fanta

stic. The comparison of the hole to the feminine
sexual organ supposes in the child an experience which he can not possibly have had or a presentiment which we can not justify. As for the child's anal sexuality, we would not think of denying it; but if it is going to illuminate the holes which he encounters in the perceptual field and charge them with symbolism, then it is necessary that the child apprehend his anus as a hole. To put it more clearly, the child would have to apprehend the essence of the hole, of the orifice, as corresponding to the sensation which he receives from his anus. But we have demonstrated suJiiciently the subjective character of "my relation with my body" so that 'we can understand the impossibility of saying that the child apprehends a partIcular part of his body as an objective structure of the universe. It is only to another person that the anus appears as an orifice. The child himself can never have experienced it as such; even the intimate

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care which the mother gives the child could not reveal the anus in this aspect, since the anus as an erogenous zone, or a zone of pain is not provided with tactile nerve endings. On the contrary it is only through another-through the words which the mother uses to designate the child's body-that he learns that his anus is a hole. It is therefore the objective nature of the hole perceived in the world which is going to illuminate for him the objective structure and the meaning of the anal zone and which wiI give a transcendent meaning to the erogenous sensations which hitherto he was limited to merely "existing." In itself then the hole is the symbol of a mode of being which existential psychoanalysis must elucidate.

We can not make such a detailed study here. One can see at once, however, that the hole is originally presented as a nothingness "to be filled" with my own flesh; the child can not restrain himself from putting his finger or his whole arm into the hole. It presents itself to me as the empty image of myself. I have only to crawl into it in order to make myself exist in the world which awaits me. The ideal of the hole is then an excavation which can be carefully moulded about my flesh in such a manner that by squeezing myself into it and fitting myself tightly inside it, I shall contribute to making a fullness of being exist in the world. Thus to plug up a hole means originally to make a sacrifice of my body in order that the plenitude of being may exist; that is, to subject the passion of the For-itself so as to shape, to perfect, and to preserve the totality of the In-itselfP

Here at its origin we grasp one of the most fundamental tendencies of human re-ality-the tendency to fill. We shall meet with this tendency again in the adolescent and in the adult. A good part of our life is passed in plugging up holes, in filling empty places, in realizing and symbolically establishing a plenitude. The child recognizes as the results of his first experiences that he himself has holes. When he puts his fingers in his mouth, he tries to wall up the holes in his face; he expects that his finger wiI merge with his lips and the roof of his mouth and block up the buccal orifice as one fills the crack in a wall with cement; he seeks again the density, the uniform and spherical plenitude of Pannenidean being; if he sucks his thumb, it is precisely in order to dissolve it,

to
transform it into a sticky paste which wiII seal the hole of his mouth.
This tendency is certainly one of the most fundamental among those
which serve as the basis for the act of eating; nourishment is the "cement"
which wiII seal the mouth; to eat is among other things to be filled up.
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It is only from this standpoint that we can pass on to sexuality. The
obscenity of the feminine sex is that of everything which "gapes open."
It is an appeal to being as all holes are. In herself woman appeals to a
17 We should note as well the importance of the opposite tendency, to poke through
holes, which in itself demands an existential analysis.

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. strange flesh which is to transform her into a fullness of being by pene-
tration and dissolution. Conversely woman senses her condition as an
appeal precisely because she is "in the form of a hole." This is the true
origin of Adler's complex. Beyond any doubt her sex is a mouth and a
voracious mouth which devours the penis-a fact which can easily lead
to the idea of castration. The amorous act is the castration of the man;
but this is above all because sex is a hole. We have to do here with a
pre-sexual contribution which will become one of the components of
sexuality as an empirical, complex, human attitude but which far from
deriving its origin from the sexed being has nothing in common with
basic sexuality, the nature of which we have explained in Part III. Never-
theless the experience with the hole, when the infant sees the reality,
includes the ontological presentiment of sexual experience in general; it is
with his flesh that the child stops up the hole and the hole, before all
sexual specification, is an obscene expectation, an appeal to the flesh.
We can see the importance which the elucidation of the~e immediate
and concrete existential categories will assume for existential psycho-
analysis. In this way we can apprehend the very general projects of hu-
man reality. But what chiefly interests the psychoanalyst is to determine
the free project of the unique person in terms of the individual relation
which unites him to these various symbols of being. I can love slimy
contacts, have a horror of holes, etc. That does not mean that for me the
slimy, the greasy, a hole, etc. have lost their general ontological meaning,
but on the contrary that because of this meaning, I dctermine myself in
this or that manner in relation to them. If the slimy is indeed the symbol
of a being in which the for-itself is swallowed up by the in-itself, wbat
kind of a person am I if in encountering othc"~, I love the slimy? To what
fundamental project of myself am I referre!' l.f I want to explain this love
of an ambiguous, sucking in-itself? In this way tastes do not remain
irreducible givens; if one knows how to question them, they reveal to us
the fundamental projects of the person. Down to even our alimentary
preferences they all have a meaning. We can account for this fact if we
will reflect that each taste is presented, not as an absurd datum which
we must excuse but as an evident value. If I like the taste of garlic, it
seems irrational to me that other people can not like it.
To eat is to appropriate by destruction; it is at the same time to be
filled up with a certain being. And this being is given as a synthesis of
temperature, density, and flavor proper. In a word this synthesis signifies
a certain being; and

when we eat, we do not limit ourselves to knowing
certain qualities of this being through taste; by tasting them we appropriate them. Taste is assimilation; by the very act of biting the tooth reveals the density of a body which it is transforming into gastric contents. Thus the synthetic intuition of food is in itself an assimilative destruction. It reveals to me the being which I am going to make my flesh.
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Henceforth, what I accept or what I reject with disgust is the very being of that existent, or if you prefer, the totality of the food proposes to me a certain mode of being of the being which I accept or refuse. This totality is organized as a form in which less intense qualities of density and of temperature are effaced behind the flavor proper which expresses them. The sugary, for example, expresses the slimy when we eat a spoonful of honey or molasses, just as an analytical function expresses a geometric curve. This means that all qualities which are not strictly speaking flavor but which are massed, melted, buried in the flavor, represent the matter of the flavor. (The piece of chocolate which at first offers a resistance to my tooth, soon abruptly gives way and crumbles; its wsistance first, then its crumbling is chocolate.) In addition they are united to certain temporal characteristics of flavor; that is, to its mode of temporalization. Certain tastes give themselves all at once, some are like delayed-action fuses, some release themselves by degrees, certain ones dwindle slowly until they disappear, and still others vanish at the very moment one thinks to possess them. These qualities are organized along with density and temperature; in addition on another level they express the visual aspect of the food. If I eat a pink cake, the taste of it is pink; the light sugary perfume, the oiliness of the butter cream arc the pink. Thus I eat the pink as I see the sugary. We conclude that flavor, due to this fact, has a complex architecture and differentiated matter; it is this structured matter-which represents for us a particular type of being-that we can assimilate or reject with nausea, according to our original project. It is not a matter of indifference whether we like oysters or clams, snails or shrimp, if only we know how to unravel the existential significance of these foods.
Generally speaking there is no irreducible taste or inclination. They all represent a certain appropriative choice of being. It is up to existential psychoanalysis to compare and classify them. Ontology abandons us here; it has merely enabled us to determine the ultimate ends of human reality, its fundamental possibilities, and the value which haunts it. Each human reality is at the same time a direct project to metamorphose its own For-itself into an In-itself-For-itself and a project of the appropriation of the world as a totality of being-in-itself, in the form of a fundamental quality. Every human reality is a passion in that it projects losing itself so as to found being and by the same stroke to constitute the In-itself which escapes contingency by being its own foundation, the Ens causa sui, which religions call God. Thus the passion of man is the reverse of that of Christ, for man loses himself as man in order that God may be born. But the idea of God is contradictory and we lose ourselves in vain. Man is a useless passion.

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ranger in the Sophist gives of this "other,"l which
can be apprehended only "as in a dream," which has no being except
its being-other (i.e., which enjoys only a borrowed being), which if con-
sidered by itself disappears and which takes on a marginal existence only
if one fixes his look on being, this other which is exhausted in being
other than itself and other than being. It even seems that Plato perceived
the dynamic character which the otherness of the other presented in rela-
tion to itself, for in certain passages he sees in this the origin of motion.
But he could have gone still further; he would have seen then that the
other, or relative non-being, could have a semblance of existence only by
virtue of consciousness. To be other than being is to be self-consciousness
in the unity of the temporalizing ekstases. Indeed what can the otherness
be if not that game of musical chairs played by the reflected and the
reflecting which we described as at the heart of the for-itself? For the
only way in which the other can exist as other is to be consciousness
(of) being other. Otherness is, in fact, an internal negation, and only a
consciousness can be constituted as an internal negation. Every other
conception of otherness will amount to positing it as an in-itself-that
is, establishing between it and being an external relation which would
necessitate the presence of a witness so as to establish that the other is
other than the in-itself. However the other can not be other without
emanating from being; in this respect it is relative to the in-itself. But
neither can it be other without making itse1f other; otherwise its otherness
would become a given and therefore a being capable of being considered
1 "The other" in this passage must of course not be confused with, "The Other" dis-
cussed in connection with the problem of human relationships. Tr. '
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in-itself. In so far as it is relative to the in-itself, the other is affected
with facticity; in so far as it makes itself, it is an absolute. This is what
we pointed out when we said that the for-itself is not the foundation of
its being-as-nothingness-of-being but that it perpetually founds its noth-
ingness-of-being. Thus the for-itself is an absolute Unselbstiindig, what
we have called a non-substantial absolute. Its reality is purely interrogative.
If it can posit questions this is because it is itself always in question; its
being is never given but interrogated since it is always separated from
itself by the nothingness of otherness. The for-itself is always in suspense
because its being is a perpetual reprieve. If it could ever join with its
being, then the otherness would by the same stroke disappear and along
with it possibles, knowledge, the world. Thus the ontological problem
of knowledge is resolved by the affirmation of the ontological primacy of
the in-itself over the for-itself.
But this immediately gives rise to a metapllysical interrogation. The
upsurge of the for-itself starting from the in-itself is in no way compara-
ble to the dialectical genesis of the Platonic Other starting from being.
"Being" and "other" are, for Plato, genera. But we, on the contrary,
have seen that being is an individual venture. Similarly the appearance
of the for-itself is the absolute event which comes to being. There is
therefore room here for a metaphysical problem which could be formu-
lated thus: Why does t

he for-itself arise in terms of being? We, indeed,
apply the term "metaphysical" to the study of individual processes which
have given birth to tllis world as. a concrete and particular totality. In
this sense metaphysics is to ontology as history is to sociology. We have
seen that it would be absurd to ask why being is other, that the question
can have meaning only within the limits of a for-itself and that it even
supposes the. ontological priority of nothingness over being. It can be
posited only if combined with another question which is externally analogous and yet very different: \Vhy is it that there is being? But we
know now that we must carefully distinguish between these two questions. The first is devoid of meaning: all the "Whys" in fact are subsequent to being and presuppose it. Being is without reason, without cause,
and without necessity; the very definition of being releases to us its
original contingency. To the second question we have already replied,
for it is not posited on the metaphysical level but on that of ontology:
"There is" being because the for-itself is snch that there is being. The
character of a phenomenon comes to being through the for-itself.
But while questions on the origin of being or on the origin of the
world are either devoid of meaning or receive a reply within the actual
province of ontology, the case is not the same for the origin of the
for-itself. The for-itself is such that it has the right to turn back on itself
toward its own origin. The being by which the "Why" comes into being
has the right to posit its own "Why" since it is itself an interrogation, a

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"Why." To this question ontology can not reply, for the problem here
is to explain an event, not to describe the structures of a being. At-most it
can point out that the nothingness which is made-ta-be by the in-itself
is not a simple emptiness devoid of meaning. The meaning of the nothingness of the nihilation is to-be-made-to-be in order to found being.
Ontology furnishes us two pieces of information which serve as the basis
for metaphysics: first, that every process of a foundation of the self is a
rupture in the identity-of-being of the in-itself, a withdrawal by being in
relation to itself and the appearance of presence to self or consciousness.
It is only by making itself for-itself that being can aspire to be the cause
of itself. Consciousness as the nihilation of being appears therefore as
one stage in a progression toward the immanence of causality-i.e., toward being a self-cause. The progression, however, stops there as the
result of the insufficiency of being in the for-itself. The temporalization
of consciousness is not an ascending progress toward the dignity of the
causa sui; it is a surface run-off whose origin is, on the contrary, the impossibility of being a self-cause. Also the ens causa sui remains as the lacked,
the indication of an impossible vertical surpassing which by its very nonexistence conditions the flat movement of consciousness; in the same
way the vertical attraction which the moon exercises on the ocean has
for its result the horizontal displacement which is the tide. The second
piece of information which metaphysics can draw from ontology is that
the for-itself is effcctively a perpetual project of founding itself qua
being and a perpetual failure of this pro}ect. Presence to itself with the
variou

s directions of its nihilation (the ekstatic nihilation of the three temporal dimensions, the twin nihilation of the dyad reflected-reflecting) represents the primary upsurge of this project; reflection represents the splitting of the project which turns back on itself in order to found itself at least as a project, and the aggravation of the nihilating hiatus by the failure of this project itself. "Doing" and "having," the cardinal categories of human reality, are immediately or mediately reduced to the project of bejng. Finally the plurality of both can be interpreted as 1m-man reality's final attempt to found itsclf, resulting in the radical separation of being and the consciousness of being.

Thus ontology teaches us two thin!;s: (1) If the in-itself were to found itself, it could attempt to do so only by making itself consciousness; that is, the concept of causa sui includes within it that of presence to self-i.e., the nihilating decompression of being; (2) Consciousness is in fact a project of founding itself; that is, of attaining to the dignity of the in-itself-for-itself or in-itself-as-self-cause. But we can not derive anything further from this. Nothing allows us to affirm on the ontological level that the nihilation of the in-itself in for-itself has for its meaning-from the start and at the very heart of the in-itself-the project of being its own self-cause. Quite the contrary. Ontology here comes up against a profound

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contradiction since it is through the for-itself that the possibility of a foundation comes to the world. In order to be a project of founding itself, the in-itself would of necessity have to be originally a presence to itself-i.e., it would have to be already consciousness. Ontology will therefore limit itself to declaring that everything takes place as it the in-itself in a project to found itself gave itself the modification of the for-itself.

It is up to metaphysics to form the hypotheses which will allow us to conceive of this process as the absolute event which comes to crown the individual venture which is the existence of being. It is evident that these hypotheses will remain hypotheses since we can not expect either further validation or invalidation. \Vhat will make their validity is only the possibility which they will offer us of unifying the givens of ontology. This unification naturally must not be constituted in the perspective of an historical becoming since temporality comes into being through the for-itself. There would be therefore no sense in asking what being was before the appearance of the for-itself. But metaphysics must nevertheless attempt to determine the nature and the meaning of this prehistoric process, the source of all history, which is the articulation of the individual venture (or existence of the in-itself) with the absolute event (or upsurge of the for-itself). In particular the task belongs to the metaphysician of deciding whether the movement is or is not a first "attempt" on the part of the in-itself to found itself and to determine what are the relations of motion as a "malady of being" with the for-itself as a more profound malady pushed to nihilation.

It remains for us to consider the second problem which we formulated in our Introduction: If the in-itself and the for-itself are two modalities of being, is there not an hiatus at the very core of the idea of being? And

is its comprehension not severed into two incommunicable parts by the very fact that its extension is constituted by two radically heterogenous classes? What is there in common between the being which is what it is, and the being which is what it is not and which is not what it is? What can help us here, however, is the conclusion of our preceding inquiry. We have just shown in fact that the in-itself and the for-itself are not juxtaposed. Quite the contrary, the for-itself without the in-itself is a kind of abstraction; it could not exist any more than a color could exist without form or a sound without pitch and without timbre. A consciousness which would be consciousness of nothing would be an absolute nothing. But if consciousness is bound to the in-itself by an internal relation, doesn't this mean that it is articulated with the in-itself so as to constitute a totality, and is it not this totality which would b~ given the name being or reality? Doubtless the for-itself is a nihilation, but as a nihilation it is; and it is in a priori unity with the in-itself. Thus the Greeks were accustomed to distinguish cosmic reality, which they called To rav, from the totality constituted by this and by

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the infinite void which surrounded it-a totality which they called To ISXov. To be sure, we have been able to call the for-itself a nothing and to declare that there is "outside of the in-itself" nothing except a reflection of this nothing which is itself polarized and defined by the in-itself-inasmuch as the for-itself is precisely the nothingness of tllis in-itself. But here as in Greek philosophy a question is raised: which shall we call real? To which shall we attribute being? To the COsmos or to what we called '1'& IlXcv? To the pure in-itself or to the in-itself surrounded by that shell of nothingness which we have designated by the name of the for-itself? But if we are to consider total being as constituted by the synthetic organization of the in-itself and of the for-itself, are we not going to encounter again the difficulty which we wished to avoid? And as for that hiatus which we revealed in the concept of being, are we not going to mect it at present in the existent itself? What definition indeed are we to give to an existent which as in-itself would be what it is and as for-itself would be what it is not?

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1£ we wish to resolve these difficulties, we must take into account what is required of an existent if it is to be considered as a totality: it isnecessary ..that the diversity of its structures be held within a unitary synthesis in such a way that each of them considered apart is only an abstraction. And certainly consciousness considered apart is only an abstraction; but the in-itself has no need of the for-itself in order to be; the "passion" of the for-itself only causes there to be in-itself. The phenomenon of in-itself is an abstraction without consciousness but its being is not an abstraction.

If we wish to conceive of a synthetic organization such that the for-itself is inseparable fromthe in-itself and conversely such that the in-itself is indissolubly bound to the for-itself, we must conceive of this synthesis in such a way that the in-itself would receive its existence from the nihilation which caused there to be consciousness of it. What does this mean if not that the indissoluble totality of in-itself and for-itse

If is conceivable
only in the form of a being which is its own "self-cause"? It is this being and no other which could be valid absolutely as that IIXov of which we spoke earlier. And if we can raise the question of the being of the for-itself articulated in the in-itself, it is because we define ourselves a priori by means of a pre-ontological comprehension of the ens causa sui. Of course this ens causa sui is impossible, and the concept of it, as we have seen, ineludes a contradiction. Nevertheless the fact remains that since we raise the question of the being of the ISXov by adopting the point of view of the ens causa sui, it is from this point of view that we must set about examining the credentials of this ISXov. Has it not appeared due to the mere fact of the upsurge of the for-itself, and is not the for-itself originally a project of being its own selkause? Thus we begin to grasp

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we nature of tatal reality. Total being, the concept of which would not be cleft by an hiatus and which would nevertheless not exclude the nihilating-nihilated being of the for-itself, that being whose existence would be a unitary synthesis of the in-itself and of consciousness-this ideal being would be the in-itself founded by the for-itself and identical with the for-itself which founds it-i.e., the ens causa sui. But precisely because we adopt the point of view of this ideal being in order to judge the real being which we call IS\ov, we must establish that the real is an abortive effort to attain to the dignity of the self-caus~. Everything happens as if the world, man, and man-in-the-world succeeded in realizing only a missing God. Everything happens therefore as if the in-itself and the for-itself were presented in a state of disintegration in relation to an ideal synthesis. Not that the integration has ever taken place but on the contrary precisely because it is always indicated and always iITlpossible.
It is this perpetual failure which explains both the indissolubility of the in-itself and of the for-itself and at the same time their relative independence. Similarly when the unity of the cerebral functions is shattered, phenomena are produced which simultaneously present a relative autonomy and which at the same time can be manifested only on the ground of the disintegration of a totality. It is this failure which explains the hiatus which we encounter both in the concept of being and in the existent. If it is impossible to pass from the notion of being-in-itself to that of being-far-itself and to reunite them in a common genus, this is because the passage in fact from the one to the other and their reuniting can not be effected. \Ve know that for Spinoza and for Hegel, for example, if a synthesis is arrested before its completion and the terms fixed in a relative dependence and at the same time in a relative independence, then the synthesis is constituted suddenly as an error. For example, it is in the notion of a sphere that for Spinoza the rotation of a semicircle around its diameter finds its justification and its meaning. But if we imagine that the notion of a sphere is on principle out of reach, then the phenomenon of the rotation of the semicircle becomes false. It has been decapitated; the idea of rotation and the idea of a circle are held together without being able to be united in a synthesis which surpasses them and justifies them; th

e one remains irreducible to the other. This is precisely what
happens here. We shall say therefore that the IIXov we are considering
is like a decapitated notion in perpetual disintegration. And it is in the
form of a disintegrated ensemble that it presents itself to us in its ambi-
guity-that is, so that one can ad libitum insist on the dependence of
the beings under consideration or on their independence. There is here
a passage which is not completed, a short circuit.
On this level we find again that notion of a detotalized totality which
we have already met in connection with the for-itself itself and in con-
nection with the consciollsnesses of others. But this is a third type of de-

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totalization. In the simply detotalized totality of reflection the reflective
had to be reflected-on, and the reflected-on had to be the reflected. The
double negation remained evanescent. In the case of the for-others the
(reflection-reflecting) reflected was distinguished from the (reflection-
reflecting) reflecting in that each one had to not-be the other. Thus the
for-itself and the-other-for-itself constitute a being in which each one
confers the being-other on the other by making himself other. As for
the totality of the for-itself and the in-itself, this has for its characteristic
the fact that the for-itself makes itself other in relation to the in-itself
but that the in-itself is in no way other than the for-itself in its being;
the in-itself purely and simply is. If the relation of the in-itself to the for-
itself were the reciprocal of the relation of the for-itself to the in-itself,
we should fall into the case of being-for-others. But this is definitely not
the case, and it is this absence of reciprocity which characterizes the Il~oJl
of which we spoke earlier. To this extent it is not absurd to raise the
question of the totality. In fact when we studied the for-others, we
esl:ablished that it was necessary that there be a being which was an
"other-me" and which had to be the reflective scissiparity of the for-
others. But at the sal:1e time this being which is an other-me appeared
to us as being able to exist only if it included an inapprehensible non-
being of exteriority. We asked then if the paradoxical character of the
totality was in itself an irreducible and if we could posit the mind as
the being which is and which is not. But we decided that the question
of the synthetic unity of consciousnesses had no meaning, for it presup-
posed that it was possible for us to assume a point of view on the totality;
actually we exist on the foundation of this totality and as engaged in it.
But if we can not "adopt a point of view on the totality," this is
because the Other on principle denies that he is I as I deny that I am he.
It is the reciprocity of the relation which prevents me from ever grasping
it in its integrity. In the case of the internal negation for-itself-in-itself,
on the contrary, the relation is not reciprocal, and I am both one of the
terms of the relation and the relation itself. I apprehend being, I am the
apprehension of being, I am only an apprehension of being. And the
being which I apprehend is not posited against me so as to apprehend
me in turn; it is what is apprehended. Its being simply does not coincide
in any way with its being-apprehended. In one sense therefore I can pose
the question of the totality. To be sure, I exist

here as engaged in this
totality, but I can be an exhaustive consciousness of it since I am at once consciousness of the being and self-consciousness. This question of the totality, however, does not belong to the province of ontology. For ontology the only regions of being which can be elucidated are those of the in-itself, of the for-itself, and the ideal region of the "self-cause." For ontology it makes no difference whether we consider the for-itself articulated in the in-itself as a well marked duality or as a disintegrated being.

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62.5
CONCLUSION
It is up to metaphysics to decide which will be more profitable f~r knowledge (in particular for phenomenological psychology, for anthropology, etc.) : will it deal with a being which we shall call the phenomenon and which will be provided with two dimensions of being, the dimension in-itself and the dimension for-itself (from this point of view there would be only one phenomenon: the world), just as in the physics of Einstein it has been found advantageous to speak of an event conceived as having spatial dimensions and a temporal dimension and as determining its place in a space-time; or, on the other hand will it remain preferable despite all to preserve the ancient duality "consciousness-being." The only observation which ontology can hazard here is that in case it appears useful to employ the new notion of a phenomenon as a disintegrated totality, it will be necessary to speak of it both in terms of immanence and in terms of transcendence. The danger, in fact, would be of falling into either a doctrine of pure immanence (Husserlian idealism) or into one of pure transcendence which would look on the phenomenon as a new kind of object. But immanence will be always limited by the phenomenon's dimension in-itself, and transcendence will be limited by its dimension for-itself.
After having decided the question of the origin of the for-itself and of the nature of the phenomenon of the world, the metaphysician will be able to attack various problems of primary importance, in particular that of action. Action, in fact, is to be considered simultaneously on the piane of the for-itself and on that of the in-itself, for it involves a project which has an immanent origin and which determines a modification in the being of the transcendent. It would be of no use to declare that the action modifies only the phenomenal appearance of the thing. If the phenomenal appearance of a cup can be modified up to the annihilation of the cup qua cup, and if the being of the cup is nothing but its quality, then the action envisaged must be capable of modifying the very being of the cup. The problem of action therefore supposes the elucidation of the transcendent efficacy of consciousness, and it puts us on the path of its veritable relation of being with being. It reveals to us also, owing to the repercussions of an act in the world, a relation of being with being which, although apprehended in exteriority by the physicist, is neither pure exteriority nor immanence but which refers us to the notion of the Gestalt form. It is therefore in these terms that one might attempt a metaphysics of nature.
II. ETHICAL IMPLICATIONS
ONTOLOGY itself can not formulate ethical precepts. It is concerned solely with what is, and we can not possibly derive imperatives from ontology's indicatives. It does, however, allow us to catch a glimpse of wha

ssess this knowledge, they refrain from appropriating things
for their own sake and try to realize the symbolic appropriation of their
being-in-itself. But to the extent that this attempt still shares in the spirit
of seriousness and that these men can still believe that their mission of
effecting the existence of the in-itself-for-itself is written in things, they
are condemned to despair; for they discover at the Same time that all hu-
man activities are equivalent (for they all tend to sacrifice man in order
that the self-cause may arise) and that all are on principle doomed to fail-
ure. Thus it amounts to the same thing whether one gets drunk alone or
is a leader of nations. If one of these activities takes precedence over the
other, this will not be because of its real goal but because of the degree
of consciousness which it possesses of its ideal goal; and in this case it
will be the quietism of the solitary drunkard which will take precedence
over the vain agitation of the leader of nations.
But ontology and existential psychoanalysis (or the spontaneous and
empirical application which men have always made of these disciplines)
must reveal to the moral agent that he is the being by whom values exist.
It is then that his freedom will become conscious of itself and will re-
veal itself in anguish as the unique source of value and the nothingness
by which the world exists. As soon as freedom discovers the quest for
being and the appropriation of the in-itself as its own possibles, it will
apprehend by and in anguish that they are possibles only on the ground
of the possibility of other possibles. But hitherto although possibles could
be chosen and rejected ad libitum, the theme which made the unity of
an choices of possibles was the value or the ideal presence of the ens causa
sui. What will become of freedom if it turns its back upon this value?
Will freedom carry this value along with it whatever it does and even in its
very turning back upon the in-itself-for-itself? Will freedom be reappre-
hended from behind by the value which it wishes to contemplate? Or
will freedom by the very fact that it apprehends itself as a freedom in
relation to itself, be able to put an end to the reign of this value? In par-
ticular is it possible for freedom to take itself for a value as the source of an
value, or must it necessarily be defined in relation to a transcendent
value which haunts it? And in case it could will itself as its own possible
and its determining value, what would this mean? A freedom which
wills itself freedom is in fact a being-which-is-not-what-it-is and which-
is-what-it-is-not, and which chooses as the ideal of being, being-what-it-is-
not and not-being-what-it-is.
This freedom chooses then not to recover itself but to flee itself, not
to coincide with itself but to be always at a distance from itself. What
are we to understand by this being which wills to hold itself in awe, to be

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at a distance from itself? Is it a question of bad faith or of another funda-
mental attitude? And can one live this new aspect of being? In particular
will freedom by taking itself for an end escape all situation? Or on the
contrary, will it remain situated? Or will it situate itself so much the
more precisely and the more individually as it projects itself further in
anguish as a conditioned freedom and accepts more fully its responsibility
as an exi

stent by whom the world comes into being. All these questions, which refer us to a pure and not an accessory reflection, can find their reply only on the ethical plane. We shall devote to them a future work.

THE END

Key to Special TerlTIinologyl

Abolition (disparition). The fact of ceasing to exist on the part of an object. This is, of course, from the point\of view of the For-itself, npt of the In-. itself since Being does not increase or-.diminish.

Abschattungen. Used by Sartre in the usual phenomenological sense to refer to the successive appearances of the object "in profile."

Absurd. That which is meaningless. Thus man's existence is absurd because his contingency finds no external justification. His projects are absurd because they are directed toward an unattainable goal (the "desire to become God" or to be simultaneously the free For-itself and the absolute In-itself.)

Actaeon Complex. Totality of images which suggest that "knowing" is a form of appropriative violation with sexual overtones.

Anguish. The reflective apprehcnsion of the Self as freedom, the realization that a nothingness slips in between my Self and my past and future so that nothing relieves me from the necessity of continually choosing myself and nothing guarantees the validity of the values which I choose. Fear is of something in the world, anguish is anguish before myself (as in Kierkegaard) .

Apparition (apparition). The coming int<;> existence of an object. This is only from the point of view of the For-itself since Being itself neither "comes" nor "goes."

Appearance (apparition). See "Phenomenon" and "Abschattungen."

Bad Faith. A lie to oneself within the unity of a single consciousness. Through bad faith a person seeks to escape the responsible freedom of Being.for-it. self. Bad faith rests on a vacillation between transcendence and facticity which refuses to recognize either one for what it really is or to synthesize them.

1 This far from exhaustive list of terms will perhaps be confusing to the person who has read none of BEING AND NOTHINGNESS and will certainTy appear inadequate to anyone who has completed the volume. I am nevertheless including it in the hope that these approximate definitions may serve as a guide for readers so that they may thus more easily attain for themselves a full comprehension of Sartre's philosophy. I am including here both technical terms coined by Sartre and familiar words to which he gives special meanings. All direct quotations are from Being and Nothingness. Tr.

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Being (etre). "Being is. Being is in-itself. Being is what it is." Being includes both Being-in-itself and Being-for-itself, but the latter is the nihilation of the former. As contrasted with Existence, Being is all-embracing and objective rather than individual and subjective.

Being-for-itself (etre-pour-soi). The nihilation of Being-in-itself; consciousness conceivcd as a lack of Being, a desire for Being, a relation to Being. By bringing Nothingness into the world the For-itself can stand out from Being and judge other beings by knowing what it is not. Each For-itself is the nihilation of a particular being.

Being-in-itself (etre-en-soi). Non-conscious Being. It is the Being of the phenomenon and overflows the knowledge which we have of it. It is a plenitude, and strictly spcaking we can say of it orily that it is.

Being-for-others (etre-pour-autr

ui). The third ekstasis (q.v.) of the For-itself.
There arises here a new dimension of being in which my Self exists outside as an object for others. The For-others involves a perpetual conflict as each For-itself seeks to recover its own Being by directly or indirectly making an object out of the other.
Cause. Occasionally used in the ordinary sense of physical cause and effect. In the human sphere cause (motif) is empty of all deterministic quality and stands for an objective apprehension of a situation which in the light of a certain end may serve as a means for attaining that end.
Coefficient of adversity. A term borrowed from Gaston Bachelard. It refers to the amount of resistance offered by external objects to the projects of the For-itself.
Cogito. Sartre claims that the pre-reflective cogito (see "consciousness") is the pre-cognitive basis for the Cartesian cogito.
There is also, he says, a sort of cogito concerning the existence of Others. While we can not abstractly prove the Other's existence, this cogito will disclose to me his "concrete, indubitable presence," just as my own "contingent butnecessary existence" has been revealed to me.
Consciousness. The transcending For-itself. "Consciousness is a being such that in its being, its being is in question in so far as this being implies a being other than itself." Like Husserl Sartre insists that consciousness is always consciollsness of something. He sometimes distinguishes types. of consciousness according to psychic objects; e.g. pain-consciousness, shame-consciousness. Two more basic distinctions are made:
(1) Unreflective consciousness (also called non-thetic consciousness or non-positional self-consciousness). This is the pre-reflective cogito. Here there is no knowledge but an implicit consciousness of being consciousness of an object.
(2) Reflective consciousness (aiso called thetic consciousness or positional self-consciousness). For this see "reflection."
Contingency. In the For-itself this equals facticity, the brute fact of being this For-itself in the world. The contingency of freedom is the fact that freedom is not able not to exist.
Dasein. Heidegger's term for the human being as a conscious existent. Basic meaning is "Being-there."
Dissociation (dCdoubkment), The never ,completed split in consciousness

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attempted by consciousness in reflection. The two parts (if they were separated) would be the reflective consciousness and the consciousness reflected-on.
Distraction. An act by which consciousness in order to flee anguish forces itself to look on certain of its own future possibilities as if they were actually possibilities of someone else. Distraction as regards the Past tries to view the Self as a fully constituted personality and to hold that acts are free when in conformity with this Essence, thus avoiding a free, new choice of Being. More generally distraction is any act by which consciousness determincs itself not to see certain of its own reactions.
Eidetic Reduction. (Husserl). The process of considering any object or isolated example of subjectivity as merely an example of what it is apart from any affirmation of its actual existence. Sartre refers to it as meaning simply that "one can always pass beyon~ the concrete phenomenon toward its essence."
Ekstasis. Used in the original Greek sense of "standing out from." The For-itself is separated

from its Self in three successive ekstases:
(1) Temporality. The For-itself nihilates the In-itself (to which in one 'sense it still belongs) in the three dimensions of past, present, and future (the three temporal ekstases) .
(1.) Reflection. The For-itself tries to adopt an external point of view on itself.
(3) Being-for-others. The For-itself discovers that it has a Self for·the-Other, a Self which it is without ever being able to know or get hold of it.
Engage (engager). Includes both the idea of involvement and the idea of deliberate commitment. Thus the human being is inescapably engaged in the world, and freedom is meaningful only as engaged by its free choice of ends.
Epoche. Husserl's "putting into parentheses" all ideas about the existence of the world so as to examine consciousness independently of the question of any worldly existence. Sartre, of course, can not follow this procedure since his task is to examine consciousness in-the-world.
Essence. For Sartre as for Hegel, essence is what has been. Sartre calls it man's past. Since there is no pre-established pattern for human nature, each man makes his essence as he lives.
Existence. Concrete, individual being here and now. Sartre says that for all existentialists existence precedes essence. Existence has for them also always a subjective quality when applied to human reality.
External negation. "An external bond established between two bcings by a witness,"
Facticity (facticite). The For·itself's necessary connection with the In-itself, hence with the world and its own past. It is what allows us to say that the For-itself is or exists. The facticity of freedom is the fact that freedom is not able not to be free.
Finitude. To be carefully distinguished from "mortality," Finitude refers not to the fact that man dies but to the fact that as a free choice of his own project of being, he makes himself finite by excluding other possibilities each time that he chooses the one which he prefers. Man would thus because of his facticity be finite even if immortal.

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Freedom. The very being of the For-itself which is "condemned to be free" and must forever choose itself-i.e., make itself. "'To be free' does not mean 'to obtain what one has wished' but rather 'by oneself to determine oneself to wish' (in the broad sense of choosing). In other words success is not important to freedom."
Future. The "possibles" of the For-itself. The future is what the For-itself has to be. It is "the determining being which the For-itself has to be beyond being."
Historicize (state or quality, "historicity"; active process, "historization"). To become involved as a concrete existent in an actual world so as to have an "history:'
Human-reality. Sartre's term for the human being or For-itself. Used both generally (like "mankind") and for the individual man.
Instant. Sartre denies that time is a succession of instants. The instant is psy·· chologically important, however, as indicating the everpresent possibility that the For-itself may at any point suddenly effect a rupture in its existence by choosing a new project of being. The instant thus becomes simultaneously the final and the initial terms for the respective projects.
Internal negation. Found only in connection with the action of the For-itself. A negation which influences the inner structure of a being who or which is , denied something

. "Such a relation between two beings that the one which
is denied to the other qualifies the other at the heart of its essence-by
absence."
Jonah complex. Irrational desire to assimilate and to identify with oneself
either the object of kliowledge or a beloved person-without in any way
impairing that object's character as an external object.
Made-to-be. An unsatisfactory translation of est ete, literally "is been."
Sartre's use of the verb "to be" as transitive is, so far as I know, unique.
Metaphysics. "The study of individual processes which have given birth to
this world as a concrete and particular totality." Metaphysics is thus con-
cerned with the problem of why concrete existents are as they are. Sartre
says that metaphysics is to ontology as history is to sociology.
Mine. "A synthesis of self and not-self."
Motive (mobile). "The ensemble of the desires, emotions, and passions
which urge me to accomplish a certain act:' Sartre holds that these are
freely constituted as a motive, not psychologically determined.
Nausea. The "taste" of the facticity and contingency of existence. "A dull
and inescapable nausea perpetually reveals my body to my consciousness."
On the gronnd of this fundameptal nausea are produced all concrete, em-
pirical nauseas (caused by spoiled meat, excrement, etc.).
Negatitc. Sartre's word for types of human activity which while not obvi-
ously involving a negative judgment nevertheless contain negativity as an
integral part of their structure; e.g., experiences involving absence. change,
interrogation, destruction.
Nihilate. (neantir). A word coined by Sartre. Consciousness exists as con-
sciousness by making a nothingness (q.v.) arise between it and the object
of which it is consciousness. Thus nihilation is that by which consciousness
exists. To nihilate is to encase with a shell of non-being. The English word

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"nihilate" was first used by Helmut Kuhn in his Encoullter with Nothing-
ness.
Noema (Husserl). The objective "pole" of conscious experience viewed after
the epoche (q.v.); the object intended by consci9usness-as it is in itself
plus all its phenomenal essential features.
Noesis. Husserl's term for the intentional direction by consciousness toward
an object external to it. The intepding act as such with all its essential fea-
tures.
A"~
Nothingness"~ leant). Nothingness does not itself have Being, yet it is sup-
ported by Being. It comes into the world by the For-itself and is the recoil
from fullness of self-contained Being which allows consciousness to exist as
such.
Objectness. (ObjectiM). Not quite objectivity but rather the quality or state
of being an object. Sometimes objectite is here translated as "object-state."
"Objectivation" and "objectivize" are related words and refer to making
an object out of something or someone.
Ontology. The study "of the structures of being of the existent taken as a
totality." Ontology describes Being itself, the conditions by which "there
is" a world, human reality, etc. Cf. "metaphysics."
Past. What the For-itself has been. The Past thus becomes Being-in-itself and
is theFor-itself's essence and substance as well as part of its facticity. This
is the only sense in which the For-itself has either essence or substance
since in its living present it "is what it is not and is not what it is."
Phenomenon. Being as it appears or is revealed. Sartre uses the word in its

hocles, 115, 536-37, 541
Spaier,2.6
Spinoza, x."iii, liv, Ix n., 4, 15, 16, 76, 87,
96, 97, 150, 158, 185, 2.2.5, 2.86,
431,436,52.5,561,563,62.3
Steckel,54
Stendhal, 65, 562., 596
Stern, ix n.
Taine,2.6
Toulouse, de, 52.2.
Trencavel, de, 52.2.
Valery, 10,60,65
Verville, de, 381
Waehlens, de, 373
Wahl'408
Watson, 2.2.9
\Vellington, 10
ZenO,2.10
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